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Early English
Alliterative Poems
in the
West-Midland Dialect
of the
Fourteenth Century

The Project Gutenberg eBook of Early English Alliterative Poems

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK EARLY
ENGLISH ALLITERATIVE POEMS ***

This e-text is based on the 1869 (second) edition of the *Alliterative Poems*. A few apparent misprints were checked against the 1864 edition, but the texts as a whole were not closely compared.

The text includes characters that will only display in UTF-8 (Unicode) text readers, primarily ȝ ȝ (yogh). There are also a few Greek words in the Index, and a handful of letters with overline or macron, such as ī. If these characters do not display properly, or if the quotation marks in this paragraph appear as garbage, you may have an incompatible browser or unavailable fonts. First, make sure that your browser's "character set" or "file encoding" is set to Unicode (UTF-8). You may also need to change the default font.

All brackets are in the original.

Typographical errors are shown with mouse-hover popups. Quotation-mark errors—especially orphaned open quotes—are similarly marked. In some cases it may be possible to guess where the missing quotation mark belongs, but it seemed safer to leave the text as printed. No quotation marks disappeared between the 1864 and 1869 editions.

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EDITED FROM
THE UNIQUE MANUSCRIPT
BRITISH MUSEUM MS. COTTON
NERO A. x

BY

RICHARD MORRIS

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(added by transcriber)

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PREFACE.

All page references in Arabic numerals refer to the main text, located in a separate file. Parenthetical Roman numerals *do not* correspond to the editor's section headings, but the text summary is generally similar to the appropriate headnote.

THE following poems are taken from a well known manuscript in the Cottonian collection, marked Nero A. x, which also contains, in the same handwriting and dialect, a metrical romance,¹ wherein the adventures of Sir Gawayne with the "Knight in Green," are most ably and interestingly described.

Unfortunately nothing can be affirmed with any certainty concerning the authorship of these most valuable and interesting compositions. The editor of "Syr Gawayn and the Green Knight" considers that Huchowne, a supposed² Scotch *maker* of the fourteenth century, has the best claims to be recognised as the author, inasmuch as he is specially referred to by

Wyntown as the writer of the *Gret gest of Arthure* and the *Awntyre of Gawayne*.

I do not think that any certain conclusions are to be drawn from the Scotch historian's assertion. It is well known that more versifiers than one during the fourteenth century attempted romance composition in the English language, having for their theme the knightly deeds of Arthur or Sir Gawayne. These they compiled from French originals, from which they selected the most striking incidents and those best suited to an Englishman's taste for the marvellous. We are not surprised, then, at finding so many romance poems treating of the exploits of the same hero, and laying claim to be considered as original productions. In Scotland, Huchowne's works might no doubt have been regarded as the standard romances of the period, but that they were the only English *gests* is indeed very doubtful.

The Early English alliterative romance, entitled the *Morte Arthure*, published from a manuscript in Lincoln Cathedral by Mr. Halliwell,³ is considered by Sir F. Madden to be the veritable *gest of Arthure* composed by Huchowne. An examination of this romance does not lead me to the same conclusion, unless Huchowne was a Midland man, for the poem is not written in the old Scotch dialect,⁴ but seems to have been originally composed in one of the Northumbrian dialects spoken *South* of the Tweed.⁵

The manuscript from which Mr. Halliwell has taken his text is not the original copy, nor even a literal transcript of it. It exhibits certain orthographical and grammatical peculiarities unknown to the Northumbrian dialect which have been introduced by a Midland transcriber, who has here and there taken the liberty to adapt the original text to the dialect of his own locality, probably that one of the North Midland counties, where many of the Northumbrian forms of speech would be intelligible.⁶

A comparison of the Arthurian romance with the following poems throws no light whatever upon the authorship of the poems. The dialect of the two works is altogether different, although many of the terms employed are common to both, being well known over the whole of the North of England. The grammatical forms (the best test we can have) in the poems are quite distinct from those in the *Morte Arthure*, and of course go far to prove that they do not proceed from the pen of the same writer.

The Editor of “Syr Gawayn and the Green Knight” acknowledges that the poems in the present volume, as now preserved to us in the manuscript, are not in the Scottish dialect, but he says “there is sufficient internal evidence of their being *Northern*,⁷ although the manuscript containing them appears to have been written by a scribe of the Midland counties, which will account for the introduction of forms differing from those used by writers beyond the Tweed.”

Now, with regard to this subsequent transcription of the poems from the Scotch into a Midland dialect,—it cannot be said to be improbable, for we have abundant instances of the multiplication of copies by scribes of different localities, so that we are not surprised at finding the works of some of our popular Early English writers appearing in two or three forms; but, on the other hand, a comparison of the original copy with the *adapted transcriptions*, or even the reading of a transcribed copy, always shows how the author’s productions have suffered by the change. Poetical works, especially those with final rhymes, of course undergo the greatest amount of transformation and depreciation. The changes incident upon the kind of transcription referred to are truly surprising, and most perplexing to those who make the subject of Early English *dialects* a matter of investigation.

But, in the present poems, the uniformity and consistency of the grammatical forms is so entire, that there is indeed no internal evidence of subsequent transcription into any other dialect than that in which they were originally written. However, the dialect and grammatical peculiarities will be considered hereafter.

Again, in the course of transcription into another dialect, any literary merit that the author’s copy may have originally possessed would certainly be destroyed. But the poems before us are evidently the work of a man of birth and education; the productions of a true poet, and of one who had acquired a perfect mastery over that form of the English tongue spoken in his own immediate locality during the earlier part of the fourteenth century. Leaving out of consideration their great philological worth, they possess an intrinsic value of their own as literary compositions, very different from anything to be found in the works of Robert of Gloucester, Manning, and many other Early English authors, which are very important as philological records, but

in the light of poetical productions, cannot be said to hold a very distinguished place in English literature. The poems in the present volume contain many passages which, as Sir F. Madden truly remarks, will bear comparison with any similar ones in the works of Douglas or Spenser.

I conclude, therefore, that these poems were not transcribed from the Scotch dialect into any other, but were written in their own West-Midland speech in which we now have them.

Mr. Donaldson, who is now editing for the Early English Text Society the Troy Book, translated from Guido di Colonna, puts forward a plea for Huchowne as its author, to whom he would also assign the *Morte Arthure* (ed. Perry) and the Pistel of Sweet Susan.⁸ But Mr. Donaldson seems to have been misled by the similarity of vocabulary, which is not at all a safe criterion in judging of works written in a Northumbrian, West or East Midland speech. The dialect, I venture to think, is a far safer test. A careful examination of the Troy Book compels me to differ in toto from Mr. Donaldson, and, instead of assigning the Troy Book to a Scotchman, say that it cannot even be claimed, in its present form, by any Northumbrian south of the Tweed; moreover, it presents no appearance of having been tampered with by one unacquainted with the dialect, though it has perhaps been slightly modernised in the course of transcription.

The work is evidently a genuine West-Midland production,⁹ having most of the peculiarities of vocabulary and inflexions that are found in these *Alliterative Poems*.¹⁰ I feel greatly inclined to claim this English Troy Book as the production of the author of the *Alliterative Poems*; for, leaving out identical and by no means common expressions, we find the same power of description,¹¹ and the same tendency to inculcate moral and religious truths on all occasions where an opportunity presents itself.¹² Without dwelling upon this topic, which properly falls to the Editor of the Troy Book, it may not be out of place to ask the reader to compare the following description of a storm from the Troy Book, with that selected from the present volume on pp. 14 and 18.

A TEMPEST ON ðE SEE.

There a tempest *hom* toke on þe torres hegh:—

A *rak* and a royde wynde rose in *hor* saile,
 A myst & a *merkenes* was mervell to se;
 With a *routond* rayn ruthe to be-holde,
 Thonret ¹³ full *throly* with a thicke haile;
 With a leuenyng light as a *low* fyre,
 Blaset all the brode see as it bren wold.
 The flode with a felle cours flowet on hepis,
 Rose uppon rockes as any *ranke* hylles.
 So wode were the waghes & þe wilde *ythes*,
 All was like to be lost þat no lond hade
 The ship ay shot furth o þe *shire waghes*,
 As qwo clymbe at a clyffe, or a clent ¹⁴ hille.
 Eft *dump* in the depe as all drowne wolde.
 Was no *stightlyng* with stere ne no stithe ropes,
 Ne no sayle, þat might serue for *unsound* wedur.
 But all the buernes in the bote, as *hom* best liked,
 Besoght unto sainttes & to sere goddes; (p. 65)

A STORME ON THE SE.

All the company enclinet cairyn to ship;
 Cachyn in cables, knyrt up *hor* ancrs,
 Sesit vp *hor* sailes in a sad hast;
Richet þere rapes, rapit unto see.
 Hokit out of hauyn, all the hepe somyn,
Hade bir at hor bake, blawen to þe depe;
 Sailyn forthe *soberly*, somyn but a while,
 Noght fyftene forlong fairly to the end.

 When sodenly the softe aire *unsoberly* rose;
 The cloudis overcast, *claterrit* aboute;
 Wyndes full wodely *walt* up the ythes;
 Wex *merke* as the mydnighte mystes full thicke:
 Thunret in the *thestur throly* with all;
 With a *launchant laite* lightonyd the water;
 And a *ropand* rayne *raiked* fro the heuyn.
 The storme was full stithe with mony stout windes,
 Hit *walt* up the wilde se vpon wan hilles.
 The ffolke was so ferd, that *on flete* were,
 All drede for to drowne with dryft of the se;
 And in perell were put all the proude kynges.
 —(p. 150.)

The poems in the present volume, three in number, seem to have been written for the purpose of enforcing, by line upon line and precept upon precept, Resignation to the will of God; Purity of life as manifested in thought, word, and deed; Obedience to the Divine command; and Patience under affliction.

In the first poem, entitled by me “*The Pearl*”, the author evidently gives expression to his own sorrow for the loss of his infant child, a girl of two years old, whom he describes as a

Perle plesaunte to prynces paye
Pearl pleasant to princes' pleasure,
To clanly clos in golde so clere
Most neatly set in gold so clear.

Of her death he says:

Allas! I leste hyr in on erbere
Alas! I lost her in an arbour,
Þurȝ gresse to grounde hit fro me yot
Through grass to ground it from me got. —(p. 1.)

The writer then represents himself as visiting his child's grave (or arbour) in the “high season of August,” and giving way to his grief (p. 2). He falls asleep, and in a dream is carried toward a forest, where he saw rich rocks gleaming gloriously, hill sides decked with crystal cliffs, and trees the leaves of which were as burnished silver. The gravel under his feet was “precious pearls of orient,” and birds “of flaming hues” flew about in company, whose notes were far sweeter than those of the cytole or gittern (guitar) (p. 3). The dreamer arrives at the bank of a stream, which flows over stones (shining like stars in the welkin on a winter's night) and pebbles of emeralds, sapphires, or other precious gems, so

Þat all the loȝe lemed of lyȝt
That all the deep gleamed of light,
So dere watȝ hit adubement
So dear was its adornment. —(p. 4.)

Following the course of the stream, he perceives on the opposite side a crystal cliff, from which was reflected many a “royal ray” (p. 5).

At þe fote þer-of þer sete a faunt
At the foot thereof there sat a child,

A mayden of menske, ful debonere
A maiden of honour, full debonnair;
 Blysnande whyt wat3 hyr bleaunt
Glistening white was her robe,
 (I knew hyr wel, I hade sen hyr ere)
(I knew her well, I had seen her before)
 At glyslande golde þat man con schore
As shining gold that man did purify,
 So schon þat schene an-vnder schore
So shone that sheen (bright one) on the opposite shore;
 On lenghe I loked to hyr þere
Long I looked to her there,
 Þe lenger I knew hyr more & more
The longer I knew her, more and more. —(pp. 6, 7.)

The maiden rises, and, proceeding along the bank of the stream, approaches him. He tells her that he has done nothing but mourn for the loss of his Pearl, and has been indeed a “joyless jeweller” (p. 8). However, now that he has found his Pearl, he declares that he is no longer sorrowful, but would be a “joyful jeweller” were he allowed to cross the stream (p. 8). The maiden blames her father for his rash speech, tells him that his Pearl is not lost, and that he cannot pass the stream till after death (p. 10). The dreamer is in great grief; he does not, he says, care what may happen if he is again to lose his Pearl. The maiden advises him to bear his loss patiently, and to abide God’s doom (p. 11). She describes to him her blissful state in heaven, where she reigns as a queen (p. 12). She explains to him that Mary is the Empress of Heaven, and all others kings and queens (p. 13). The parable of the labourers in the vineyard ¹⁵ (pp. 15-18) is then rehearsed at length, to prove that “innocents” are admitted to the same privileges as are enjoyed by those who have lived longer upon the earth (p. 18). The maiden then speaks to her father of Christ and his one hundred and forty thousand brides (p. 24), and describes their blissful state (p. 26). She points out to him the heavenly Jerusalem, which was “all of bright burnished gold, gleaming like glass” (p. 29). Then the dreamer beholds a procession of virgins going to salute the Lamb, among whom he perceives his “little queen” (p. 33). On attempting to cross the stream to follow her, he is aroused from his dream (p. 35), laments his rash curiosity in seeking to know so much of God’s mysteries, and declares that man ever desires more happiness than he has any right to expect (p. 35).

The second poem, entitled “*Cleanness*,” is a collection of Biblical stories, in which the writer endeavours to enforce Purity of Life, by showing how greatly God is displeased at every kind of impurity, and how sudden and severe is the punishment which falls upon the sinner for every violation of the Divine law.

After commending cleanness and its “fair forms,” the author relates (I.) The Parable of the Marriage Feast (p. 39); (II.) the Fall of the Angels (p. 43); (III.) The wickedness of the antediluvian world (p. 44),

He wat3 famed for fre þat fe3t loued best
He was famous as free that fight loved best,
& ay þe bigest in bale þe best wat3 halden
And ever the biggest in sin the best was held; (p. 45.)

(IV.) The destruction of mankind by the Flood. When all were safely stowed in the ark,

Thenne sone com þe seuenþe day, when samned wern alle
Then soon came the seventh day when assembled were all,
& alle woned in þe whichche þe wylde & þe tame.
And all abode in the ark (hutch), the wild and the tame.
þen bolned þe abyme & bonke3 con ryse
Then swelled the abyss and banks did rise,
Waltes out vch walle-heued, in ful wode streme3
Bursts out each well-head in full wild streams,
Wat3 no brymme þat abod vnbrosten bylyue
There was no brim (stream) that abode unburst by then,
þe mukel lauande loghe to þe lyfte rered
The much (great) flowing deep (loch) to the loft (sky) reared.
Mony clustered clowde clef alle in clowte3
Many a clustering cloud cleft all in clouts (pieces),
To-rent vch a rayn-ryfte & rusched to þe vrþe
Rent was each a rain-rift and rushed to the earth;
Fon neuer in forty daye3, & þen þe flod ryse3
Failed never in forty days, and then the flood rises,
Ouer-walte3 vche a wod and þe wyde felde3
Over-flows each wood and the wide fields;
.
Water wylger ay wax, wone3 þat stryede
Water wildly ever waxed, abodes that destroyed,
Hurled in-to vch hous, hent þat þer dowedled
Hurled into each house, seized those that there dwelt.
Fyrst feng to þe fly3t alle þat fle my3t

First took to flight all that flee might,
 Vuche burde with her barne þe byggyng þay leue3
Each bride (woman) with her bairn their abode they leave,
 & bowed to þe hy3 bonk þer brentest hit wern
And hied to the high bank where highest it were,
 & heterly to þe hy3e hille3 þay [h]aled on faste
And hastily to the high hills they rushed on fast;
 Bot al wat3 nedle3 her note, for neuer cowþe stynt
But all was needless their device, for never could stop
 Þe ro3e raynande ryg [&] þe raykande wawe3
The rough raining shower and the rushing waves,
 Er vch boþom wat3 brurd-ful to þe bonke3 egge3
Ere each bottom (valley) was brim-ful to the banks' edges,
 & vche a dale so depe þat demmed at þe brynke3
And each dale so deep that dammed at the brinks. —(pp. 47, 48).

The ark is described as “heaved on high with hurling streams.”

Kest to kyþe3 vncouþe þe clowde3 ful nere
Cast to kingdoms uncouth the clouds ful near,
 Hit waltered on the wylde flod, went as hit lyste
It tossed on the wild flood, went as it list,
 Drof vpon þe depe dam, in daunger hit semed
It drove upon the deep dam, in danger it seemed,
 With-outen mast, oþer myke, oþer myry bawe-lyne
Without mast, or mike, or merry bow-line,
 Kable, oþer capstan to clyppe to her ankreg
Cable or capstan to clip to their anchors,
 Hurrok, oþer hande-helme hasped on roþer
Oar or hand-helm hooked on rudder,
 Oþer any sweande sayl to seche after hauen
Or any swinging sail to seek after haven,
 Bot flote forthe with þe flyt of þe felle wynde3
But floated forth with the force of the fell winds.
 Wheder-warde so þe water wafte, hit rebounde
Whither-ward so (as) the water waft, it rebounded,
 Ofte hit roled on-rounde & rered on ende
Oft it rolled around and reared on end,
 Nyf our lorde hade ben her lode3-mon hem had lumpen harde
Had our Lord not been their (pilot) leader hardship had befallen them. —(p. 49.)

mike] See Glossary.

(V.) The Visit of Three Angels to Abraham (p. 54).

(VI.) The destruction of Sodom and Gomorrah (pp. 64, 65), including a description of the Dead Sea, the tarn (lake) of traitors (p. 66).

(VII.) The invasion of Jerusalem by Nebuchadnezzar (p. 71), and the captivity of Judah (p. 74).

The following is a paraphrase of the fourth and fifth verses in the twenty-fifth chapter of the second book of Kings. ¹⁷

Þenne þe kyng of þe kyth a counsayl hym takes
Then the king of the kingdom a counsel him takes,
Wyth þe best of his burnes, a blench for to make
With the best of his men a device for to make;
Þay stel out on a styлле nyȝt er any steuen ryse
They stole out on a still night ere any sound arose,
& harde hurles þurȝ þe oste, er enmies hit wyste
And hard hurled through the host, ere enemies it wist,
Bot er þay at-wappe ne moȝt þe wach wyth oute
But ere they could escape the watch without,
Hiȝe skelt watȝ þe askry þe skewes an-vnder
High scattered was the cry, the skies there under,
Loude alarom vpon launde lulted was þenne
Loud alarm upon land sounded was then;
Ryche, ruȝed of her rest, ran to here wedes,
Rich (men) roused from their rest, ran to their weeds,
Hard hattes þay hent & on hors lepes
Kettle hats they seized, and on horse leap;
Cler claryoun crak cryed on-lofte
Clear clarion's crack cried aloft.
By þat watȝ alle on a hepe hurlande swyȝee
By that (time) was all on a heap, hurling fast,
Folȝande þat oȝer flote, & fonde hem bilyue
Following that other fleet (host), and found them soon,
Ouer-tok hem, as tyd, tult hem of sadeles
Over-took them in a trice, tilted them off saddles,
Tyl vche prynce hade his per put to þe grounde
Till each prince had his peer put to the ground;
& þer watȝ þe kyng kaȝt wyth calde prynces
And there was the king caught with crafty princes,
& alle hise gentyle for-iusted on Ierico playnes
And all his nobles vanquished on Jericho's plains. —(pp. 71, 72.)

as tyd] Immediately.

(VIII.) Belshazzar's impious feast (pp. 76-80), and the handwriting upon the wall (pp. 80, 81).

In þe palays pryncipale vpon þe playn wowe
In the palace principal upon the plain wall,
In contrary of þe candelstik þat clerest hit schyned

Opposite to the candlestick that clearest there shone.

Þer apered a paume, with poyntel in fyngres

There appeared a palm with a pointel in its fingers,

Þat wat3 grysly & gret, & grymly he wrytes

That was grisly and great, and grimly it writes,

None oþer forme bot a fust faylaynde þe wryst

None other form but a fist failing the wrist

Pared on þe parget, purtrayed lettres

Pared on the plaister, pourtrayed letters.

When þat bolde Balta3ar blusched to þat neue

When that bold Belshazzar looked to that fist,

Such a dasande drede dusched to his hert

Such a dazzling dread dashed to his heart.

Þat al falewed his face & fayled þe chere

That all paled his face and failed the cheer;

Þe stronge strok of þe stonde strayned his ioyntes

The strong stroke of the blow strained his joints,

His cnes cachchez to close & cluchches his hommes

His knees catch to close, and he clutches his hams,

& he with plat-tyng his paumes displayes his lers

lers] ? feres.

And he with striking his palms displays his fears,

& romyes as a rad ryth þat rore3 for drede

And howls as a frightened hound that roars for dread,

Ay biholdand þe honde til hit hade al grauen,

Ever beholding the hand till it had all graven,

& rasped on þe ro3 wo3e runisch saue3

And rasped on the rough wall uncouth saws (words).

(IX.) The story of Nebuchadnezzar's pride and its punishment (pp. 84, 85),
and the interpretation of the handwriting by Daniel (p. 86).

(X.) The invasion of Babylon by the Medes (pp. 87, 88).

Balta3ar in his bed wat3 beten to deþe

Belshazzar in his bed was beaten to death,

Þat boþe his blood & his brayn blende on þe cloþes

That both his blood and his brains blended on the clothes;

Þe kyng in his cortyn wat3 ka3t by þe heles

The king in his curtain was caught by the heels,

Feryed out bi þe fete & fowle dispysed

Ferried out by the feet and foully despised;

Þat wat3 so do3ty þat day & drank of þe vessayl

He that was so doughty that day and drank of the vessels,

Now is a dogge also dere þat in a dych lygges

Now is as dear (valuable) as a dog that in a ditch lies. —(p. 88.)

The third poem, entitled “*Patience*,” is a paraphrase of the book of Jonah. The writer prefaces it with a few remarks of his own in order to show that “patience is a noble point though it displease oft.”

The following extract contains a description of the sea-storm which overtook Jonah:—

Anon out of þe norþ est þe noys bigynes
Anon out of the north east the noise begins,
When boþe breþes con blowe vpon blo watteres
When both breezes did blow upon blue waters:
Roȝ rakkes þer ros with rudnyng an-vnder
Rough clouds there arose with lightning there under,
þe see souȝed ful sore, gret selly to here
The sea sobbed full sore, great marvel to hear;
þe wyndes on þe wonne water so wrastel togeder,
The winds on the wan water so wrestle together,
þat þe wawes ful wode waltered so hiȝe
That the waves full wild rolled so high,
& efte busched to þe abyme þat breed fyssches
And again bent to the abyss that bred fishes;
Durst nowhere for roȝ arest at þe bothem.
Durst it nowhere for roughness rest at the bottom.
When þe breth & þe brok & þe bote metten
When the breeze and the brook and the boat met,
Hit watȝ a ioyles gyn þat Ionas watȝ inne
It was a joyless engine that Jonah was in,
For hit reled on round vpon þe roȝe yþes
For it reeled around upon the rough waves.
þe bur ber to hit baft þat braste alle her gere
The bore (wave) bear to it abaft that burst all her gear,
þen hurled on a hepe þe helme & þe sterne
Then hurled on a heap the helm and the stern,
Furste to murte mony rop & þe mast after
First marred many a rope and the mast after.*
þe sayl sweyed on þe see, þenne suppe bihoued
The sail swung on the sea, then sup behoved
þe coge of þe colde water, & þenne þe cry ryses
The boat of the cold water, and then the cry rises;
Ȝet coruen þay þe cordes & kest al þer-oute
Yet cut they the cords and cast all there-out.
Mony ladde þer forth-lep to laue & to kest
Many a lad there forth leapt to lave and to cast,
Scopen out þe scaþel water, þat fayn scape wolde

boþe breþes]
Eurus and Aquilo.

to murte, marred]
? = to-marte.

*To scoop out the scathful water that fain escape would;
For be monnes lode neuer so luper, þe lyf is ay swete
For be man's lot never so bad, the life is aye sweet. —(p. 93.)*

The writer, in concluding the story of Jonah, exhorts his readers to be “patient in pain and in joy.”

*For he þat is to rakel to renden his cloþeȝ,
Mot efte sitte with more vn-sounde to sewe hem togeder.
For he that is too rash to rend his clothes,
Must afterwards sit with more unsound (worse ones) to sew them together. (p. 104.)*

This brief outline of the poems, together with the short extracts from them, will, it is hoped, give the reader stomach to digest the whole. It is true that they contain many “uncouth” terms; but this will be their highest merit with the student of language, as is shown, by Dr. Guest’s testimony, that they are “for several reasons curious, and especially so to the philologist.”²² To those readers who do not appreciate the importance of such a very large addition to the vocabulary of our Early Language as is made by these treatises, let Sir Frederic Madden’s opinion of their literary merit suffice. That distinguished editor says, of the author’s “poetical talent, the pieces contained in the MS. afford unquestionable proofs; and the description of the change of the seasons, the bitter aspect of winter, the tempest which preceded the destruction of Sodom and Gomorrah, and the sea storm occasioned by the wickedness of Jonas, *are equal to any similar passages in Douglas or Spenser.*”²³ Moreover, as to the hardness of the language—inasmuch as the subject matter of the poem will be familiar to all who may take up the present volume, the difficulty on the word-point will not be such as to deter the reader from understanding and appreciating the production of an old English poet, who—though his very name, unfortunately, has yet to be discovered—may claim to stand in the foremost rank of England’s early bards.

The Editor of the present volume has endeavoured to do justice to his author by giving the text, with some few exceptions, as it stands in the manuscript.²⁴ The contractions of the scribe have been expanded and printed in italics, a plan which he hopes to see adopted in every future edition of an early English author.

The [Glossary](#) has been compiled not only for the benefit of the reader, but for the convenience of those who are studying the older forms of our language, and who know how valuable a mere index of words and references sometimes proves.

In conclusion, I take the present opportunity of acknowledging the kind assistance of Sir Frederic Madden and E. A. Bond, Esq., of the British Museum, who, on every occasion, were most ready to render me any help in deciphering the manuscript, in parts almost illegible, from which the poems in the present volume are printed.

REMARKS UPON THE DIALECT AND GRAMMAR.

Higden, writing about the year A.D. 1350, affirms, distinctly, the existence of three different forms of speech or dialects, namely, Southern, Midland, and Northern; ²⁵ or, as they are sometimes designated, West-Saxon, Mercian, and Northumbrian. Garnett objects to Higden's classification, and considers it certain "that there were in his (Higden's) time, and probably long before, five distinctly marked forms, which may be classed as follows:— 1. Southern or standard English, which in the fourteenth century was perhaps best spoken in Kent and Surrey by the body of the inhabitants. 2. Western English, of which traces may be found from Hampshire to Devonshire, and northward as far as the Avon. 3. Mercian, vestiges of which appear in Shropshire, Staffordshire, and South and West Derbyshire, becoming distinctly marked in Cheshire, and still more so in South Lancashire. 4. Anglian, of which there are three sub-divisions—the East Anglian of Norfolk and Suffolk; the Middle Anglian of Lincolnshire, Nottinghamshire and East Derbyshire; and the North Anglian of the West Riding of Yorkshire—spoken most purely in the central part of the mountainous district of Craven. 5. Northumbrian," spoken throughout the Lowlands of Scotland, Northumberland, Durham, and nearly the whole of Yorkshire.

Garnett's division is based upon peculiarities of pronunciation, which will be found well marked in the *modern* provincial dialects, and not upon any

essential differences of inflexion that are to be found in our Early English manuscripts. ²⁶

The distinction between Southern and Western English was not at all required, as the Kentish Ayenbite of Inwyt (A.D. 1340) exhibits most of the peculiarities that mark the Chronicles of Robert of Gloucester (Cottonian MS. Calig. A. xi.) as a Southern (or West-Saxon) production. The Anglian of Norfolk, Lincolnshire, and Nottinghamshire may be referred to one group with the Mercian of Lancashire, as varieties of the Midland dialect.

A careful examination of our early literature leads us to adopt Higden's classification as not only a convenient but a correct one.

There is, perhaps, no better test for distinguishing these dialects from one another than the verbal inflexions of the plural number in the present tense, indicative mood.

To state this test in the briefest manner, we may say that the Southern dialect employs *-eth*, the Midland *-en*, and the Northumbrian *-es* as the inflexion for all persons of the plural present indicative: ²⁷—

	Southern.	Midland.	Northern.
1st pers.	Hop- <i>eth</i> .	Hop- <i>en</i> .	Hop- <i>es</i> . (we) hope.
2nd „	Hop- <i>eth</i> .	Hop- <i>en</i> .	Hop- <i>es</i> . (ye) hope.
3rd „	Hop- <i>eth</i> .	Hop- <i>en</i> .	Hop- <i>es</i> . (they) hope.

It is the constant and systematic employment of these inflexions, and not their occasional use that must be taken as the criterion of dialectical varieties.

In a pure specimen of the Southern dialect, we never find the Northumbrian *-es*. We do occasionally meet with the Midland *-en*, but only in those works written in localities where, from their geographical position, Southern and Midland forms would be intelligible. ²⁸ We might look in vain for the Southern plural *-eth* in a pure Northumbrian production, but might be more successful in finding the Midland *-en* in the third person plural; as, “*thay arn*” for “*they ar*”, or “*thay er*.”

In a work composed in Lincolnshire, Nottinghamshire, or Lancashire, we should be sure to find the occasional use of the Northumbrian plural *-es*. ²⁹

The inflexions of the verb in the singular are of value in enabling us to discriminate between the several varieties of the Midland dialect. ³⁰ The Southern and Midland idioms (with the exception of the West-Midland of Lancashire, Cheshire, etc.) conjugated the verb in the singular present indicative, as follows:—

1st pers.	hope	(I) hope.
2nd „	hop- <i>est</i>	(thou) hopest.
3rd „	hop- <i>eth</i>	(he) hopes.

The West-Midland, corresponding to Garnett's Mercian, instead of *-est* and *-eth* employs the inflexions that are so common in the so-called Northumbrian documents of the ninth and tenth centuries:—

1st pers.	hope	(I) hope.
2nd „	hop- <i>es</i>	(thou) hopest.
3rd „	hop- <i>es</i>	(he) hopes.

The Northumbrian dialect takes *-es* in all three persons; but mostly drops it in the first person.

The peasantry of Cheshire and Lancashire still preserve the verbal inflexions which prevailed in the fourteenth century, and conjugate their verbs in the present indicative according to the following model:—

	Singular.	Plural.
1st pers.	hope	hopen.
2nd „	hopes	hopen.
3rd „	hopes	hopen.

Inasmuch as the poems in the present volume exhibit the systematic use of these forms, we cannot but believe that they were originally composed in one of those counties where these verbal inflexions were well known and extensively used. We have to choose between several localities, but if we assign the poems to Lancashire we are enabled to account for the large number of Norse terms employed. It is true that the ancient examples of the Lancashire dialect contained in Mr. Robson's *Metrical Romances*, ³¹ the *Boke of Curtasye*, ³² and *Liber Cure Cocorum*, ³³ present us with much

broad forms, as *-us* for *-es* in the plural number and possessive case of nouns, *-un* for *-en* in the plural present indicative mood, in passive participles of irregular (or strong) verbs, *-ud* (*-ut*) for *-ed* in the past tense and passive participle of regular (or weak) verbs, and the pronominal forms *hor* (their), *hom* (them), for *her* and *hem*.³⁴

These forms are evidence of a broad pronunciation which, at the present time, is said to be a characteristic of the northwestern division of Lancashire, but I think that there is good evidence for asserting that this strong provincialism was not confined, formerly, to the West-Midland dialect, much less to a division of any particular county. We find traces of it in Audelay's Poems (Shropshire), the Romance of William and the Werwolf,³⁵ and even in the Wicliffite version of the Scriptures.

Formerly, being influenced by these broad forms, I was led to select Cheshire or Staffordshire as the probable locality where the poems were written; but I do not, now, think that either of these counties ever employed a vocabulary containing so many Norse terms as are to be found in the Lancashire dialect. But although we may not be able to fix, with certainty, upon any one county in particular, the fact of the present poems being composed in the West-Midland dialect cannot be denied. Much may be said in favour of their Lancashire origin, and there are one or two points of resemblance between our poems, the Lancashire Romances, and *Liber Cure Cocorum*, that deserve especial notice.

I. In *Sir Amadace*,³⁶ lxviii. 9, there occurs the curious form *miztus* = *miztes* = *mightst*.³⁷ As it appears only once throughout the Romances we might conclude that it is an error of the scribe for *miztest*, but when we find in the poems before us not only *myzte3* = *myztes* (mightst), but *wolde3* = *woldes* (wouldst), *couthes3* = *couthes* (couldst), *dippte3* (dippedest), *travaylede3* (travelledst), etc., we are bound to consider *miztus* as a genuine form.³⁸ In no other Early English works of the fourteenth century have I been able to find this peculiarity. It is very common in *the Wohunge of Ure Lauerd* (xiiith cent.). See O.E. Homilies, p. 51. The Northumbrian dialect at this period rejected the inflexion in the second person preterite singular, of regular verbs,³⁹ and in our poems we find the *-es* often dropped, so that we

get two conjugations, which may be called the inflected and the uninflected form.

	Inflected.	Uninflected.	
1st pers.	hopede	hoped	(I) hoped.
2nd „	hopedes	hoped	(thou) hopedest.
3rd „	hopede	hoped	(he) hoped.

Originally the inflected form may have prevailed over the whole of the North of England, but have gradually become confined to the West-Midland dialect.

II. The next point of resemblance is the use of the verb *SCHIN* or *SCHUN* = *schal* = *shall*. It is still preserved in the modern dialect of Lancashire in combination with the adverb *not*, as *schunnot* ⁴⁰ = *shall not*. The following examples will serve to illustrate the use of this curious form:—

“— pay *schin* knawe sone,

þere is no bounté in burne lyk Baltazar þewes.” ⁴¹

—(B. l. 1435.)

“& þose þat seme arn & swete *schyn* se his face.” ⁴²

—(*Ibid.* l. 1810.)

“Pekokys and pertrikys perboylyd *schyn* be.” ⁴³

—(Liber Cure Cocorum, p. 29.)

“For þer bene bestes þat *schyn* be rost.” ⁴⁴

—(*Ibid.* p. 34.)

“Alle *schun* be drazun, Syr, at þo syde.” ⁴⁵

—(*Ibid.* p. & 35.)

“Seche ferlies *schyn* falle.” ⁴⁶

—(Robson’s Met. Rom. p. 12, l. 4.)

^{41.} They *shall* know soon there is no goodness in man like Belshazzar’s virtues.

^{42.} And those that seemly are and sweet *shall* see His (God’s) face.

^{43.} Peacocks and partriches parboiled *shall* be.

^{44.} For þer are beasts þat *shall* be roasted.

^{45.} All *shall* be drawn (have the entrails removed), Sir, at the side.

^{46.} Such marvels *shall* happen.

III. Nothing is more common in the present poems than the use of *hit* as a genitive = *its*, which is also found in the Lancashire romances.

“Forþy þe derk dede see hit is demed ever more,

For *hit* dede3 of deþe duren þere 3et.” ⁴⁷

—(Patience, l. 1021.)

“And, as hit is corsed of kynde & *hit* cooste3 als,

þe clay þat clenges þer-by arn corsyes strong.” ⁴⁸

—(*Ibid.* l. 1033.)

“For I wille speke with the sprete,

And of *hit* woe wille I wete,

^{47.} Wherefore the dark dead sea it is called ever more.

For *its* deeds of death endure there yet.

^{48.} And as it is cursed of kind and *its* properties also,

Gif that I may *hit* bales bete.” ⁴⁹
—(Robson’s Met. Romances, p. 5, ll. 3, 4.)

The clay that clings thereby
are corrosives strong.

⁴⁹. I will speak with the
spirit,
And of *its* woe will I wit
(know),
If that I may *its* bales (grief)
abate.

The present dialect of Lancashire still retains the uninflected genitive:—

“So I geet up be strike o’ dey, on seet eawt; on went ogreath tilly welly coom within two mile
oth’ teawn; when, os tha dule woud height, o tit wur stonning ot an ale heawse dur; on me
kawve (the dule bore eawt *it* een for me) took th’ tit for *it* mother, on woud seawk her.” ⁵⁰
(Tummus and Meary).

Thus much for the dialectical peculiarities of our author. The scanty material at our disposal must be a sufficient excuse for the very meagre outline which is here presented to the reader. As our materials increase, the whole question of Early English dialects will no doubt receive that attention from English philologists which the subject really demands, and editors of old English works will then be enabled to speak with greater confidence as to the language and peculiarities of their authors. Something might surely be done to help the student by a proper classification of our manuscripts both as to date and place of composition. We are sadly in want of unadulterated specimens of the Northumbrian and East-Midland idioms during the twelfth and thirteenth centuries. There must surely be some records of these dialects in our university libraries which would well repay editing. ⁵¹

GRAMMATICAL DETAILS.

I. NOUNS.

(1) *Number*.—The plurals generally end in *-es* (*e3*), *-s*. *Y3en* (eyes), *trumpen* (trumpets), are the only plurals in *-en* that occur in the poems. In Robson’s Metrical Romances we find *fellun* (fells, hills,), *dellun* (dells), and *eyren* (eggs), in Liber Cure Cocorum. The plurals of *brother*, *child*, *cow*, *do3ter* (daughter), are *brether*, *childer*, *kuy*, and *de3ter*.

(2) *Gender*.—The names of inanimate things are in the neuter gender, as in modern English. The exceptions are *deep* (fem.), *gladnes* (fem.), and *wind* (masc.).

(3) *Case*.—The genitive singular (masc. and fem.) ends in *-es* (*-e3*), *-s*, but occasionally the inflexion is dropped; as, “Baltazar thewes,” the virtues of Balshazzar. ⁵² If “*honde my3t*,” “*honde werk*,” “*hellen wombe*,” are not compounds, we have instances of the final *-e* (*en*) which formed the genitive case of *feminine* nouns in the Southern English of the fourteenth century.

In the phrases “*besten blod*” (blood of beasts), “*blonkken bak*” (back of horses), “*chyldryn fader*” (father of children), “*nakeryn noyse*” (noise of nakers), we have a trace of the genitive plural *-ene* (A.S. *-ena*).

II. ADJECTIVES.

(1) *Number*.—The final *e*, as a sign of the plural, is very frequently dropped. *Pover* (poor), *sturn* (strong), make the plurals *poveren* and *sturnen*. In the phrase, “þo sy3te3 so *quyke3*” ⁵³ (those sights so living), the *-e3* (= *-es*) is a mark of the plural, very common in Southern writers of the fourteenth century, and employed as a plural inflexion of the adjective until a very late period in our literature.

The Article exhibits the following forms:

SINGULAR.		PLURAL.
Masc.	Fem.	
The.	tho. ⁵⁴	tho.

This forms the plural *thise* and *thes* (*these*). *That* is always used as a demonstrative, and never as the neuter of the article; its plural is *thos* (those). ⁵⁵ The older form, *theos* = *these*, shows that the *e* is not a sign of the plural, as many English grammarians have asserted.

(2) *Degrees of Comparison*.—The comparative degree ends in *-er*, and the superlative in *-est*.

Adjectives and adverbs terminating in the syllable *-lyche* form the comparative in *-loker* and the superlative in *-lokest*; as, positive *uglyche* (=

ugly), comp. *ugloker*, superl. *uglokest*. The long vowel of the positive is often shortened in the comp. and superl., as in the modern English *late*, *latter*, *last*.

Positive.	Comparative.	Superlative.
Brade (broad),	bradder,	braddest.
Dere (dear),	derrer,	derrest.
Lyke (like),	lykker,	lykkest.
Swete (sweet),	swetter,	swettest.
Wayke (weak),	wakker,	wakkest.
Wode (mad),	wodder,	woddest.

The following irregular forms are occasionally met with:

Positive.	Comparative.	Superlative.
Fer (far),	ferre (fyrre),	ferrest.
Heze (high),	herre,	hezeest (hest).
Neze (nigh, near)	nerre,	nerrest (nest).
Sare (sore),	sarre,	sarrest.
Forme (first),		formast.
Mikelle (great),	mo	most.
Yvel, ill (bad),	wers (worre),	werst.

Numerals.—*Twinne* and *thrinne* occur for two and three. The ordinal numbers are—

first (fyrste), the forme,
 secunde, that other, tother,
 thryd, }
 thrydde, }
 furþe,
 fyfþe,
 sexte,
 sevenþe,
 aȝtþe,

nente,	
tenþe,	}
tyþe.	

The Northumbrian numerals corresponding to *sevenþe*, *aʒtþe*, *nente*, *tenþe*, are *sevend*, *aghtend*, *neghend*, *tend*. The Southern forms end in *-the*, as *sevenþe*, *eiʒteope*, *nyþe*, *teope* (*tyþe*).

III. PRONOUNS.

In the following poems we find the pronoun *ho*, she, still keeping its ground against the Northumbrian *scho*.⁵⁶ *Ho* is identical with the modern Lancashire *hoo* (or *huh* as it is sometimes written), which in some parts of England has nearly the same pronunciation as the accusative *her*.

The Northumbrian *thay* (they) has displaced the older Midland *he*, corresponding to the Southern pronoun *hii*, *hi* (A.S. *hī*). *Hores* and *thayrez* (theirs) occasionally occur for *here*.⁵⁷ The genitives in *-es*, due no doubt to Scandinavian influence, are very common in Northumbrian writers of the fourteenth century, but are never found in any Southern work of the same period.

Hit is frequently employed as an indefinite pronoun of all genders, and is plural as well as singular. It is, as has been previously shown, uninflected in the genitive or possessive case.

Me in Southern writers is used as an indefinite pronoun of the *third* person, and represents our *one*, but in the present poems it is of all persons, and seems to be placed in apposition with the subject of the sentence corresponding to our use of *myself*, *thyself*, *himself*, etc.; as,

“*He* swenges *me* þys,” etc. = He himself sends this, etc. ⁵⁸

“Now sweʒe *me* þider swyftly” = Now go (thou) thyself thither swiftly. ⁵⁹

“*He* meteʒ *me* þis good man” = He himself meets this good man. ⁶⁰

Sturzen-Becker (“Some Notes on the leading Grammatical Characteristics of the Principal Early English Dialects, Copenhagen, 1868”) thinks that I have been led astray with regard to this use of *me*, which he says is nothing more than the *dativus ethicus*.

The *me* in these examples may be merely an expletive, having arisen out of the general use of the dative ethicus, but the context does not satisfy me that it has the force of a dative. Dr. Guest (Proceedings of Philolog. Soc., vol. i. p. 151-153, 1842-1844) has discussed this construction at some length, and he carefully distinguishes the dative of the 1st person from the indeterminate (or indefinite) pronoun *me* = Fr. one. He says that in Old Frisian the indefinite pronoun has two forms, *min* and *me*, “the latter of which seems to be always used as a suffix to the verb, as *momme*, one may; *somme*, one should,” etc. The same construction was occasionally used in our own language, and it no doubt gave rise to those curious idioms which are noticed by Pegge in his “Anecdotes of the Eng. Lang.,” p. 217. This writer, whose evidence to a *fact* we may avail ourselves of, whatever we think of his criticism or his scholarship, quotes the following as forms of speech then prevalent among the Londoners: “and so says *me* I;” “well what does *me* I;” “so says *me* she;” “then away goes *me* he;” “what does *me* they?” Here it is obvious that *me* is the indeterminate pronoun, and represents the *subject*, while the personal pronoun is put in apposition to it, so that “says *me* I” is equivalent to “*one* says, *that is I*,” ⁶¹. These idioms are not unknown to our literature.

(1) ‘But as he was by diverse principall young gentlemen, to his no small glorie, lifted up on horseback, *comes me a page* of Amphialus, etc.’ Pembr. Arcad. B. iii.

Other idioms, which have generally been confounded with those last mentioned, have the indeterminate pronoun preceded by a nominative absolute.

(2) ‘*I*, having been acquainted with the smell before, knew it was Crab, and—*goes me* to the fellow, who whips the dogs,’ etc. Two Gent. of Verona, 4. 4.

(3) ‘*He thrusts me* himself into the company of three or four gentlemanlike dogs under the Duke’s Table.’ *Ib.* See B. Jons. Ev. Man in his Humour, 3, 1.

Johnson considers the *me* in examples 2 and 3 to be the oblique case of the first pers. pron., and treats it as “a ludicrous expletive.” It is difficult to say how he would have parsed example 2 on such a hypothesis.

With these instances of the use of *me* (indef. or reflexive), the reader may compare the following:

(1) “Suche a touche in that tyde, *he* tazte (Gauan) hym in tene

And *gurdes me*, Sir Gallerun, evyn grovelonges on grounde.”

(The Anturs of Arther at the Tarnewathelan, p. 22.)

(2) There at the dore he (the Fox) cast *me* downe hys pack.

Spenser's Shep. Cal. ed. Morris, p. 460, l. 243.

Cp. *Cut me*, i. Hen. IV. Act 4. Sc. 4; *steps me*, Ib. Act 4, Sc. 3; *comes me*, *runs me*, Ib. Act 3, Sc. 1.

(3) “Juno enraged, and fretting thus,

Runs me unto one Æolus.”

(Virgile Travestie, 1664.)

The indefinite *me* = one is not uncommon in Elizabethan writers. Cf. “*touch me* his hat;” “*touch me* hir with a pint of sack,” etc.; “and *stop me* his dice you are a villaine” (Lodge's Wit's Miserie).

The following table exhibits the declension of the personal and relative pronouns:—

SINGULAR.					
Nom.	I,	thou,	<u>he</u> ,	ho,	hit.
Gen.	My, myn,	thy, thyn,	his,	hir, her,	hit.
Dat.	Me,	the,	him,	hir, her,	hit.
Acc.	Me,	the,	him,	hir, her,	hit.
PLURAL.					
Nom.	We,	3e,	thay,		hit.
Gen.	Oure,	yor, youre,	her (here), hor,		hit.
Dat.	Vus (= uus),	yow, you,	hem, hom,		hit.
Acc.	Vus (= uus),	yow, you,	hem, hom,		hit.
Nom.	Who (quo).				
Gen.	Whose (quos).				
Dat.	Whom,	}	(quom).		
	Wham				
Acc.	Whom,	}	(quom).		
	Wham				

IV. VERBS.

Infinitive Mood.—The *-en* of the infinitive is frequently dropped, without even a final *-e* to mark its omission. Infinitives in *-y*, as *louy* (love), *schony* (shun), *spotty* (spot, defile), *stiry* (stir), *wony* (dwell), occasionally occur, and probably owe their appearance to the author's acquaintance with Southern literature. ⁶²

Indicative Mood.—The final *e* often disappears in the first and third persons of the preterite tense, as I *loved*, he *loved*, instead of I *lovede*, he *lovede*.

The *-en* in the plural of the present and preterite tenses is frequently dropped. The pl. present in *-e3* occasionally occurs.

Imperative Mood.—The imperative plural ends in *-es* (*e3*), and not in *-eth* as in the Southern and ordinary Midland dialects.

Participles.—The active or imperfect participle ends in *-ande* ⁶³ and never in *-ing*.

The participle passive or perfect of regular verbs terminates in *-ed*; of irregular verbs in *-en*. Occasionally we find the *n* disappearing, as *bigonn-e*, *fund-e*, *runn-e*, *wonn-e*, where perhaps it is represented by the final *-e*.

The prefix *-i* or *-y* (A.S. *-ge*) occurs twice only in the poems, in *i-chose* (chosen), and *i-brad* (extended); but, while common enough in the Southern and Midland dialects, it seems to be wholly unknown to the Northumbrian speech.

The verb in the West-Midland dialect is conjugated according to the following model:—

I.—CONJUGATION OF REGULAR VERBS.

INDICATIVE MOOD.

PRESENT TENSE.

Singular.	Plural.
(I) hope,	(We) hopen.
(Thou) hopes,	(3e) hopen.
(He) hopes,	(Thay) hopen.

PRETERITE TENSE.

(I) hopede ⁶⁴ (hoped),	(We) hopeden.
(Thou) hopedes (hoped),	(3e) hopeden.
(He) hopede ⁶⁴ (hoped),	(Thay) hopeden.

IMPERATIVE MOOD.

Hope (thou).	Hopes (3e).
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PARTICIPLES.

Imperfect or Active.	Perfect or Passive.
Hopande.	Hoped.

II.—CONJUGATION OF IRREGULAR VERBS.

INDICATIVE MOOD.

PRESENT TENSE.

Singular.

(I) kerve,	renne,	smite,	stonde.
(Thou) kerves,	rennes,	smites,	stondes.
(He) kerves,	rennes,	smites,	stondes.

Plural.

(We) kerven,	rennen,	smiten,	stonden.
(3e) „	„	„	„
(Thay) „	„	„	„

PRETERITE TENSE.

Singular.

(I) carf,	ran,	smot,	stod.
(Thou) carve,	ranne,	smote,	stode.
(He) carf,	ran,	smot,	stod.

Very frequently the *e* in the second person is dropped, ⁶⁵ as in the Northumbrian dialect, but we never meet with such forms as carves (= carvedest), rannes (= ranst), smotes (= smotest), etc.

	Plural.		
(We) corven,	runnen,	smiten,	stonden.
(3e) „	„	„	„
(Thay) „	„	„	„

PASSIVE PARTICIPLES.

Corven,	runnen,	smiten,	stonden.
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The Northumbrian dialect does not preserve any separate form for the preterite plural, and this distinction is not always observed in the present poems.

TABLE OF VERBS.

A.—SIMPLE ORDER.

	Present.	Preterite.	Passive Participle.
Class I.	Hate,	hatede,	hated.
Class II. (a)	Bede (offer),	bedde,	bed.
	Dype (dip),	dypte,	dypt.
	Kythe (show),	kydde,	kyd.
	Lende,	lende,	lent.
	Rende,	rende,	rent.
	Sende,	sende,	sent.
(b)	Clothe,	cladde,	clad.
	Dele (deal),	dalte,	dalt.
	Lede,	ladde,	lad.
	Leve,	lafte,	laft.
	Rede (advise),	radde,	rad.
	Sprede (spread),	spradde,	sprad.
	Swelt (die),	swalte,	—
	Swette (sweat),	swatte,	—

Class III.	Threte (threaten),	thratte,	thrat.
	Byye (buy),	boʒte,	boʒt
	Bringe,	broʒte,	broʒt.
	Cache (catch),	caʒte,	caʒt.
	Lache (seize),	laʒte,	laʒt.
	Reche (reck),	roʒte,	—
	Reche (reach),	raʒte,	—
	Selle,	solde,	sold.
	Worche (work),	wroʒte,	wroʒt.

B.—COMPLEX ORDER.

DIVISION I.

	Present.	Preterite.	Passive Participle.
Class I.	Bere (bear),	ber,	born.
	Bete (beat),	bet,	beten.
	Breke (break),	brek,	broken.
	Chese (choose),	ches (chos),	chosen.
	Cleve (cleave),	clef,	cloven.
	Ete (eat),	ette (<i>for</i> et),	eten.
	Forʒete (forget),	forʒet,	forʒeten.
	Frese (freeze),	fres,	frosen.
	Gife (give),	gef,	given, geven.
	Heve (heave),	hef,	hoven.
	Ligge (lie),	leʒ,	leyen, leʒen.
	Lepe (leap),	lep,	lopen.
	Nemme } Nimme }	(take), nem (nam),	nomen.
	(take),		
	Schere (shear),	scher,	schorn.

Class II.	Slepe (sleep),	slep,	slepen.
	Speke (speak),	spek,	spoken.
	Stele (steal),	stel,	stolen.
	Swere (swear),	swer,	sworen.
	Wepe (weep),	wep,	wopen.
	Wreke (avenge),	wrek,	wroken.
	Falle,	fell,	fallen.
	Fonge (take),	feng,	fongen.
	Growe,	grew,	growen.
	Hange, honge,	heng,	hangen, hongen.
Class III.	Knowe, knawe,	knew,	knawen, knownen.
	Schape (make),	schep,	schapen.
	Walke,	welk,	walken.
	Wasche,	wesch,	waschen.
	Drawe, draze,	droz,	drawen,.
	Fare (go),	for,	faren.
	Laze (laugh),	loz,	lazen.
	Stande, stonde,	stod,	standen.
	Slaye,	slow, slew,	slayn.
	Take,	tok,	tane, tone.
	Wake,	wok,	waken.

DIVISION II.

	Present.	Preterite.	Passive Participle.
Class I.	Biginne,	bigon,	bigonnen, bigunnen.
	Breste,	brast, borst,	brusten, bursten.

Class II.	Climbe,	clamb, clomb,	clumben.
	Drinke,	dronk, drank,	drunken, dronken.
	Finde,	fand, fond,	funden.
	Fizte,	fa3t, fe3t,	fo3ten.
	Helpe,	halp,	holpen.
	Kerve (cut),	carf,	corven.
	Melte,	malt,	molten.
	Renne (run),	ran,	runnen.
	Ringe,	rong,	rungen, rongen.
	Singe,	song, sang,	sungen.
	Steke,	stac,	stoken.
	Sterve (die),	starf,	storven.
	Werpe (throw),	warp,	worpen.
	Win,	wan, won,	wonnen, wunnen.
	3elde (yield),	3ald,	3olden.
	Bide (abide),	bod,	biden.
	Bite,	bot,	biten.
	Drive,	drof,	driven.
	Fine (cease),	fon,	—
	Glide,	glod,	gliden.
	Ride,	rod,	riden.
	Rise,	ros,	risen.
	Schine,	schon,	—
	Slide,	slod,	sliden.
	Smite,	smot,	smiten.
	Trine (go),	tron,	—

Class III.	Fly,	fle3, flegh, fla3,	flowen.
	See,	se3, segh, sy3,	seen.
	Sti3e, ste3e,	ste3	—

ANOMALOUS VERBS.

Can,	pret. couthe.
Dare,	„ dorste.
May,	„ mi3te.
Mot,	„ moste.
O3e (owe),	„ o3te.
Schal,	„ scholde, schulde.
Thar,	„ thurte.
Wote,	„ wiste.
Wille,	„ wolde.

Schal (shall) in the second person singular is *schal* or *schalt*; so, too, we occasionally find *wyl* for *wylt*.

The present plural of *schal* is *schul*, *schulen*, or *schyn*.

The verb *to be* is thus conjugated:—

INDICATIVE MOOD.

PRESENT TENSE.	PAST TENSE.
Singular.	
(I) am.	(I) was, wat3.
(Thou) art.	(Thou) was, wat3.
(He) is, bes, bet3.	(He) was, wat3.
Plural.	
(We) arn, are, ar.	(We) wern, were.
(3e) arn, are, ar.	(3e) wern, were.
(Thay) arn, are, ar.	(Thay) wern, were.

The verbs *be*, *have*, *wille*, have negative forms; as, *nam* = am not; *nar* = are not; *nas* = was not; *naf* = have not; *nade* = had not; *nyl* = will not.

The following contractions are occasionally met with: *bos* = behoves; *byhod* = behoved; *ha* = have; *ma* = make; *man* = make (pl.) *matz* (*mas*) = makes; *ta* = take; *tatz* (= *tas*) = takes; *tane*, *tone* = taken.

V. ADVERBS.

The Norse forms *hethen*, *quethen* (*whethen*), ⁶⁶ and *thethen*, seem to have been known to the West-Midland dialect as well as the Saxon forms *hence* (*hennes*, *henne*), *whence* (*whennes*), *thence* (*thennes*), etc. ^A The adverbs *in-blande* (together), *in-lyche* (alike), *in-myddde* (amidst), *in-monge* (amongst), are due, perhaps, to Scandinavian influence.

VI. PREPOSITIONS.

The preposition *from* never occurs in the following poems; it is replaced by *fro*, *fra* (Northumbrian), O.N. *frá*.

VII. CONJUNCTIONS.

The conjunction *if* takes a negative form; as, *nif* = if not, unless.

DESCRIPTION OF THE MANUSCRIPT USED IN THE PRESENT VOLUME. ⁶⁷

COTTON MS. NERO A. x. A small quarto volume, consisting of three different MSS. bound together, which originally had no connection with each other. Prefixed is an imperfect list of contents in the hand-writing of James, the Bodley Librarian.

The first portion consists of a panegyrical oration in Latin by Justus de Justis, on John Chedworth, archdeacon of Lincoln, dated at Verona 16th July, 1468. It occupies thirty-six folios, written on vellum, and is the original copy presented by the author.

The second portion is that we are more immediately concerned with. It is described by James as "*Vetus poema Anglicanum, in quo sub insomnia figmento multa ad religionem et mores spectantia explicantur,*" and this account, with some slight changes, is adopted by Smith and Planta, in their catalogues; both of whom assign it to the fifteenth century. It will appear, by what follows, that no less than four distinct poems have been confounded together by these writers.

This portion of the volume extends from fol. 37 to fol. 126, inclusive, and is written by one and the same hand, in a small, sharp, irregular character, which is often, from the paleness of the ink, and the contractions used, difficult to read. There are no titles or rubrics, but the divisions are marked by large initial letters of blue, flourished with red, and several illuminations, coarsely executed, serve by way of illustration, each of which occupies a page.

1. Four of these are prefixed to the first poem. In the first the Author is represented slumbering in a meadow, by the side of a streamlet, clad in a long red gown, having falling sleeves, turned up with white, and a blue hood attached round the neck.

In the second the same person appears, drawn on a larger scale, and standing by the stream. In the third he occurs nearly in the same position, with his hands raised, and on the opposite side a lady dressed in white, in the costume of Richard the Second's and Henry the Fourth's time, buttoned tight up to the neck, with long hanging sleeves. Her hair is plaited on each side, and on her head is a crown. In the fourth we see the author kneeling by the water, and beyond the stream is depicted a castle or palace, on the embattled wall of which appears the same lady, with her arm extended towards him.

The poem commences on fol. 39, and consists of one hundred and one twelve-line stanzas, ⁶⁸ every five of which conclude with the same line, and

are connected by the iteration of a leading expression. It concludes on fol. 55b.

2. Then follow two more illuminations; in the first of which Noah and his family are represented in the ark; in the second the prophet Daniel expounding the writing on the wall to the affrighted Belshazzar and his queen. These serve as illustrations to the second poem, which begins at fol. 57, and is written in long alliterative lines. It concludes on fol. 82.

3. Two illuminations precede, as before; one of which represents the sailors throwing the prophet Jonas into the sea, the other depicts the prophet in the attitude of preaching to the people of Nineveh. The poem is in the same metre as the last, and commences at fol. 83.

It is occupied wholly with the story of Jonas, as applicable to the praise of meekness and patience; and ends on fol. 90.

4. The Romance intitled *Sir Gawayne and the Grene Knyzt* follows, fol. 91. Prefixed is an illumination of a headless knight on horseback, carrying his head by its hair in his right hand, and looking benignly at an odd-eyed bill-man before him; while from a raised structure above, a king armed with a knife, his queen, an attendant with a sabre, and another bill-man scowling looks on. Here and elsewhere the only colours used are green, red, blue, and yellow. It ends on fol. 124b., and at the conclusion, in a later hand, is written “Hony soit q̃ mal penc,” which may, perhaps, allude to the illumination on the opposite page, fol. 125, representing the stolen interview between the wife of the Grene Knyzt and Sir Gawayne. Above the lady’s head is written:

Mi mind is mukel on on, þat wil me noȝt amende,
Sum time was trewe as ston, & fro schame coupe hir defende.

It does not appear very clearly how these lines apply to the painting. Two additional illuminations follow; in the first of which Gawayne is seen approaching the *Grene Chapel*, whilst his enemy appears above, wielding his huge axe; and in the second Sir Gawayne, fully equipped in armour, is represented in the presence of king Arthur and queen Guenever, after his return to the court.

The third and concluding portion of the Cotton volume extends from fol. 127 to fol. 140*b*, inclusive, and consists of theological excerpts, in Latin, written in a hand of the end of the thirteenth century. At the conclusion is added *Epitaphium de Ranulfo, abbate Ramesiensi*, who was abbot from the year 1231 to 1253, and who is erroneously called *Ralph* in the *Monasticon*, vol. ii. p. 548, new ed.

CONTRACTIONS USED IN THE GLOSSARY.

The letters A. B. C. refer severally to the poems, entitled by me, “The Pearl,” “Cleanness,” and “Patience.”

A.S.	Anglo-Saxon.
Dan.	Danish.
Du.	Dutch.
E.	English.
O.E.	Old English.
Prov.E.	Provincial English.
N.Prov.E.	} North Provincial English.
<u>N.P.E.</u>	
Fr.	French.
O.Fr.	Old French.
Prov. Fr.	Provincial French.
Fris.	Frisian.
G. Doug.	Gawin Douglas’s <i>Æneid</i> , published by the Bannatyne Club, 2 vols.
<u>Ger.</u>	German.
Goth.	Gothic.
Icel.	Icelandic.

Jam.	Jamieson's Scottish Dictionary.
K. Alex.	King Alexander, Romance of (Ed. Stevenson).
Met. Hom.	Metrical Homilies (Ed. Small).
O.N.	Old Norse.
O.S.	Old Saxon.
<u>Prompt.</u>	Promptorium Parvulorum (Ed. Way).
Parv.	
Sc.	Scotch.
O.Sc.	Old Scotch.
S.Sax.	Semi-Saxon.
Sw.	Swedish.
O.Sw.	Old Swedish.
Town.	Townley Mysteries.
Myst.	
T. B.	Troy Book (Ed. Donaldson).

Gaps in numbering represent notes that were shown inline, with or without visible numbers.

1. Edited by Sir Frederic Madden for the Bannatyne Club, under the title of "Syr Gawayn and the Grene Knyȝt," and by me for the Early English Text Soc., 1865.

2. Wyntown nowhere asserts that Huchowne is a Scotchman.

3. Edited for E. E. T. Soc. by Rev. G. G. Perry, M.A.

4. This is evident from the following particulars:—

I. In old Scotch manuscripts we find the guttural *gh* (or *ȝ*) represented by *ch*; thus, *aght*, *laght*, *saght*, *wight*, are the English forms which, in the Scotch orthography, become *aucht* (owed), *laucht* (seized), *saucht* (peace), *wicht* (active). It is the former orthography, however, that prevails in the *Morte Arthure*.

II. We miss the Scotch use of (1) *-is* or *-ys*, for *-es* or *-s*, in the plural number, and of possessive cases of nouns, and in the person endings of the present tense indicative mood of verbs; (2) *-it* or *-yt*, for *-ed* or *-ȝ*, in the preterites or passive participles of regular verbs.

III. There is a total absence of the well-known Scotch forms *begouth* (began), *sa* (so), *sic* (such), *throuch*, *thorow* (through). Instead of these *bigan*, *so*, *syche*, *thrughe* (*thurgh*) are employed. See Preface to Hampole's *Pricke of Conscience*, pp. vii, viii.

5. This is shown by the frequent employment of *-es* as the person ending of the verb in the present tense, plural number. The corresponding Southern verbal inflexion *-eth* never occurs; while the Midland *-en* is only occasionally met with in the third person plural present, and has been introduced by a later copyist. There are other characteristics, such as the predominance of words containing the A.S. long *a*; as *hame* (home), *stane* (stone), *thra* (bold), *walde* (would), etc.; the frequent use of *thir* (these), *tha* (the, those), etc.

6. The peculiarities referred to do not appear to be owing to the copyist of the Lincoln manuscript (Robert de Thornton, a native of Oswaldkirk in Yorkshire), who, being a Northumbrian, would probably have restored the original readings. The non-Northumbrian forms in the *Morte Arthure* are— 1. The change of *a* into *o*, as *bolde* for *balde*, *bote* for *bate*, *one* for *ane*, *honde* for *hande*, *londe* for *lande*; 2. *they*, *theyre*, *them*, *theym*, for *thay*, *thaire*, *tham*; 3. *gayliche*, *kindliche*, *semlyche*, etc., for *gayly*, *kindly*, *seemly*, etc. (the termination *liche*, was wholly unknown to the Northumbrian dialect, being represented by *ly* or *like*); 4. *churle*, *churche*, *iche*, *mache*, *myche*, *syche*, *wyrche*, etc., for *carle*, *kirke*, *ilk*, *make*, *mykelle*, *swilk*, *wyrk*, etc.; 5. infinitives in *-en*, as *drenschen*, *schewenne*, *wacchenne*, etc.; 6. the use of *eke*, *thos*, for *als* (*alswa*), *thas*; 7. the employment of *aye* for *egg*. The former word never occurs in any pure Northumbrian work, while the latter is seldom met with in any Southern production.

7. The poems are *Northern* in contradistinction to *Southern*, but they are not Northern or Northumbrian in contradistinction to *Midland*.

8. Printed by Mr. D. Laing in his “Inedited Pieces,” from a MS. of Mr. Heber’s. Other copies are in the Vernon MS., and Cotton Calig. A. ii.; the latter imperfect.

9. Other specimens of this dialect will doubtless turn up. Mr. Brock has found a MS. in British Museum (Harl. 3909) with most of the peculiarities pointed out by me in the preface to the present work, and I believe that this dialect was probably a flourishing one in the 13th century. See O.E. Homilies, p. li.

10. (1) *en* as the inflexion of the pres. tense pl., indic. mood of verbs; (2) *s* in the second and third pers. sing. of verbs; (3) *ho* = she; (4) *hit* = its; (5) *tow* = two; (6) *de3ter* = daughters, etc.

11. See p. 36, ll. 1052-1066; p. 37, ll. 1074-1089; pp. 161-162, ll. 4956-4975.

12. See pp. 25, 26 (Jason’s unfaithfulness); pp. 74, 75, ll. 2241-2255; p. 75, ll. 2256-2263; p. 69, ll. 2267-2081; p. 158, ll. 4839-4850; p. 189, ll. 4881-4885; p. 165, ll. 5078-5086, etc.

13. In the Harl. MS. 3909, nearly all the p. part. and preterites end in *-et* (*-ut* and *-et* occur in Romances ed. by Robson).

14. This seems to furnish an etymology for *Clent* Hills, Worcestershire—*brent* is the term employed in Alliterative.

15. Matthew, chapter xx.

17. “4. And the city was broken up, and all the men of war fled by night by the way of the gate between two walls, which is by the king’s garden: (now the Chaldees were against the city round about:) and the king went the way toward the plain.

“5. And the army of the Chaldees pursued after the king, and overtook him in the plains of Jericho: and all his army were scattered from him.”

22. History of English Rhythms, vol. i. p. 159.

23. Syr Gawayn, ed. Madden, p. 302.

24. Wherever the Text has been altered, the reading of the MS. will be found in a foot-note.
25. Polychronicon R. Higdeni, ap. Gale, p. 210, 211. See Garnett's Philological Essays, p. 43, and Specimens of Early English, p. 338.
26. It is to be regretted that Garnett did not enter upon details, and give his readers some tests by which to distinguish the "five distinctly marked forms."
27. In English works of the fourteenth century the *-en* of the Midland, and the *-es* of the Northumbrian is frequently dropped, thus gradually approximating to our modern conjugation.
28. We are here speaking of works written in the thirteenth and fourteenth centuries.
29. Robert of Brunne, in his "Handlyng Synne," often employs it instead of *-en*, but only for the sake of the rhyme.
30. The Midland dialect is a very difficult one to deal with, as it presents us with no uniform type; and, moreover, works written in this idiom are marked by Northern or Southern peculiarities, which have led many of our editors altogether astray in determining the locality of their composition.
31. Published by the Camden Society, 1842.
32. Edited by Mr. Halliwell for the Percy Society.
33. Edited by me for the Philological Society, 1862.
34. *-us* and *-ud* for *-es* and *-ed*, as well as *hom*, *hor*, do occasionally occur in the MS. containing our poems.
35. The Romance of William and the Werwolf is written in the West-Midland dialect as spoken probably in Shropshire.
36. Robson's Metrical Romances, p. 54, l. 9.
37. *Woldus* = *woldes* = *wouldst*, appears in Audelay's poems (in the Shropshire dialect of the fifteenth century), p. 32, l. 6.
38. The so-called Northumbrian records of the ninth and tenth centuries frequently use *-es* instead of *-est*, in the 2nd pers. preterite of regular verbs, *e.g.*,
- ðu forcerdes usic on-bec* = Thou turnedst us hindward. —(Ps. xliii. 11.)
- ðu saldes usic* = Thou gavest us. —(Ps. xliii. 12.)
- ðu bi-bohtes folc ðin butan weorðe* = Thou soldest thy folk without price. —(Ps. xliii. 12.)
- ðu ge-hiowades me & settes ofer me hond ðine* = Thou madest me and settest over me thy hand. —(Ps. cxxxviii. 5.)
- ðu ðreades ða ofer-hygdan* = Thou hast rebuked the proud. —(Ps. cxviii. 21.)
- Ic ondeto ðe fader drihten heofnes forðon ðu *gedeigeldes* ðas ilco from snotrum & hogum & *ædeaudes* ða ðæm lytlum = I thank thee, O father, Lord of heaven and earth, because thou hast hid these things from the wise and prudent, and hast revealed them unto babes. —(Matt. xi. 25).
39. *Þou torned* us hindward. —(Early English Nn. Psalter, xliii. 11.)
- Þou salde* þi folk. —(*Ibid.* xliii. 12.)
- Þou meked* us. —(*Ibid.* xliii. 20.)
- Þou made* me and set þi hand over me. —(*Ibid.* cxxxviii. 5.)

Dou snibbed proude. —(*Ibid.* cxviii. 21.)

40. I am informed by a Shropshire friend that it prevails in his county under the form *shinneh*.

Win = will, in *winnot*, *wunnot* = will not, is still heard in the West-Midland districts. It is found in Robson's Romances and in Liber Cure Cocorum.

50. So I got up by break of day and set out; and went straight till I well nigh came within two miles of the town, when, as the devil would have it, a horse was standing at an ale-house door; and my calf (the devil bore out *its* eyes for me) took the horse for *its* mother, and would suck her.

51. Three specimens of the East-Midland dialect have come to light since writing the above. Harl. MS. 3909; Troy Book, ed. Donaldson, E. E. T. Soc.; The Lay-folks Mass-Book, ed. Simpson, E. E. T. Soc.

52. In the romance of "Syr Gawayn and the Grene Knyzt" we find "*blonk* (horse) sadele," "*fox felle*" (skin). In *blonk* an *e* has probably been dropped.

53. The feminine form is seldom employed.

54. The Northumbrian plural article is *tha*.

55. The Northumbrian corresponding form is *thas*.

56. *Scho* occurs *once* in the present poems.

57. *Yowrez* (yours) sometimes takes the place of *youre* in the romance of "Sir Gawayne and the Grene Knyzt."

58. Page 92, l. 108.

59. Page 91, l. 72.

60. Syr Gawayn, l. 1932.

61. I would say that *says me I* = I myself say. —R. M.

62. *Schonied* occurs for *schoned*. No Southern writer would retain, I think, the *i* in the preterite.

63. Garnett asserts that the present participle in *-ande* is "a *certain criterion* of a Northern dialect subsequent to the thirteenth century." It is never found in any Southern writer, but is common to many Midland dialects. Capgrave employs it frequently in his Chronicles. It is, however, no safe criterion by itself.

64. The final *e* is often dropped.

65. In *The Wohunge of Ure Lauerd* the *e* is constantly omitted.

66. "Syr Gawayn and the Grene Knyzt."

67. Taken with some few alterations from Sir F. Madden's "Syr Gawayn."

68. A line, however, is missing from the MS. on fol. 55*b*. See page 15.

Collected Sidenotes

This section was added by the transcriber. It contains the editor's summaries as given in his sidenotes, and can be read as a condensed version of the full text. Headings in Roman numerals link to sections of the poem.

[The Pearl](#)
[Cleanness](#)
[Patience](#)

The Pearl: Sidenotes

I.

Description of a lost pearl (*i.e.* a beloved child).

The father laments the loss of his pearl.

He often visits the spot where his pearl disappeared, and hears a sweet song.

Where the pearl was buried there he found lovely flowers.

Each blade of grass springs from a dead grain.

In the high season of August the parent visits the grave of his lost child.

Beautiful flowers covered the grave.

From them came a delicious odour.

The bereaved father wrings his hands for sorrow, falls asleep upon the flowery plot, and dreams.

II.

In spirit he is carried to an unknown region, where the rocks and cliffs gleamed gloriously.

The hill sides were decked with crystal cliffs.

The leaves of the trees were like burnished silver.

The gravel consisted of precious pearls.

The father forgets his sorrow.

He sees birds of the most beautiful hues, and hears their sweet melody.

No tongue could describe the beauty of the forest.

All shone like gold.

The dreamer arrives at the bank of a river, which gave forth sweet sounds.

In it, stones glittered like stars in the welkin on a winter night.

III.

His grief abates, and he follows the course of the stream.

No one could describe his great joy.

He thought that Paradise was on the opposite bank.
The stream was not fordable.
More and more he desires to see what is beyond the brook.
But the way seemed difficult.
The dreamer finds new marvels.
He sees a crystal cliff, at the foot of which, sits a maiden clothed in glistening white.
He knows that he has seen her before.
He desires to call her but is afraid, at finding her in such a strange place.

IV.

So he stands still, like a well trained hawk.
He fears lest she should escape before he could speak to her.
His long lost one is dressed in royal array—decked with precious pearls.
She comes along the stream towards him.
Her kirtle is composed of 'sute,' ornamented with pearls.
She wore a crown of pearls.
Her hair hung down about her.
Her colour was whiter than whalebone.
Her hair shone as gold.
The trimming of her robe consisted of precious pearls.
A wonderful pearl was set in her breast.
No man from here to Greece, was so glad as the father, when he saw his pearl on the bank of the stream.
The maiden salutes him.

V.

The father enquires of the maiden whether she is his long-lost pearl, and longs to know who has deprived him of his treasure.
The maiden tells him that his pearl is not really lost.
She is in a garden of delight, where sin and mourning are unknown.
The rose that he had lost is become a pearl of price.
The pearl blames his rash speech.
The father begs the maiden to excuse his speech, for he really thought his pearl was wholly lost to him.
The maiden tells her father that he has spoken three words without knowing the meaning of one.
The first word. The second. The third.

VI.

He is little to be praised who loves what he sees.
To love nothing but what one sees is great presumption.

To live in this kingdom (*i.e.* heaven) leave must be asked.
This stream must be passed over by death.
The father asks his pearl whether she is about to doom him to sorrow again.
If he loses his pearl he does not care what happens to him.
The maiden tells her father to suffer patiently.
Though he may dance as any doe, yet he must abide God's doom.
He must cease to strive.
All lies in God's power to make men joyful or sad.

VII.

The father beseeches the pearl to have pity upon him.
He says that she has been both his bale and bliss.
And when he lost her, he knew not what had become of her.
And now that he sees her in bliss, she takes little heed of his sorrow.
He desires to know what life she leads.
The maiden tells him that he may walk and abide with her, now that he is humble.
All are meek that dwell in the abode of bliss.
All lead a blissful life.
She reminds her father that she was very young when she died.
Now she is crowned a queen in heaven.

VIII.

The father of the maiden does not fully understand her.
Mary, he says, is the queen of heaven.
No one is able to remove the crown from her.
The maiden addresses the Virgin.
She then explains to her father that each has his place in heaven.
The court of God has a property in its own being.
Each one in it is a king or queen.
The mother of Christ holds the chief place.
We are all members of Christ's body.
Look that each limb be perfect.
The father replies that he cannot understand how his pearl can be a queen.
He desires to know what greater honour she can have.

IX.

She was only two years old when she died, and could do nothing to please God.
She might be a countess or some great lady but not a queen.
The maiden informs her father that there is no limit to God's power.
The parable of the labourers in the vineyard.

The lord of the vineyard hires workmen for a penny a day.
At noon the lord hires other men standing idle in the market place.
He commands them to go into his vineyard, and he will give them what is right.
At an hour before the sun went down the lord sees other men standing idle.
Tells them to go into the vineyard.

X.

As soon as the sun was gone down the “reeve” was told to pay the workmen.
To give each a penny.
The first began to complain.
Having borne the heat of the day he thinks that he deserves more.
The lord tells him that he agreed only to give him a penny.
The last shall be first, and the first last.
The maiden applies the parable to herself.
She came to the vine in eventide, and yet received more than others who had lived longer.
The father says that his daughter’s tale is unreasonable.

XI.

In heaven, the maiden says, each man is paid alike.
God is no niggard.
The grace of God is sufficient for all.
Those who live long on the earth often forfeit heaven by sinning.
Innocents are saved by baptism.
Why should not God allow their labour.
Our first father lost heaven by eating an apple.
And all are damned for the sin of Adam.
But there came one who paid the penalty of our sins.
The water that came from the pierced side of Christ was baptism.

XII.

Repentance must be sought by prayer with sorrow and affliction.
The guilty may be saved by contrition.
Two sorts of people are saved, the *righteous* and the *innocent*.
The words of David.
The innocent is saved by right.
The words of Solomon.
David says no man living is justified.
Pray to be saved by innocence and not by right.
When Jesus was on earth, little children were brought unto him.
The disciples rebuked the parents.

Christ said, "Suffer little children to come unto me," etc.

XIII.

No one can win heaven except he be meek as a child.
The pearl of price is like the kingdom of heaven, pure and clean.
Forsake the mad world and purchase the spotless pearl.
The father of the maiden desires to know who formed her figure and wrought her garments.
Her beauty, he says, is not natural.
Her colour passes the fleur-de-lis.
The maiden explains to her father that she is a bride of Christ.
She is without spot or blemish.
Her weeds are washed in the blood of Christ.
The father asks the nature of the Lamb that has chosen his daughter, and why she is selected as a bride.

XIV.

The Lamb has one hundred and forty thousand brides.
St. John saw them on the hill of Sion in a dream, in the new city of Jerusalem.
Isaiah speaks of Christ or the Lamb.
He says that He was led as a lamb to the slaughter.
In Jerusalem was Christ slain.
With buffets was His face flayed.
He endured all patiently as a lamb.
For us He died in Jerusalem.
The declaration of St. John, "Behold the Lamb of God," etc.
Who can reckon His generation, that died in Jerusalem?
In the New Jerusalem St. John saw the Lamb sitting upon the throne.

XV.

The Lamb is without blemish.
Every spotless soul is a worthy bride for the Lamb.
No strife or envy among the brides.
None can have less bliss than another.
Our death leads us to bliss.
What St. John saw upon the Mount of Sion.
About the Lamb he saw one hundred and forty thousand maidens.
He heard a voice from heaven, like many floods.
He heard the maiden sing a new song.
So did the four beasts and the elders "so sad of cheer."
This assembly was like the Lamb, spotless and pure.

The father replies to the maiden.
He says he is but dust and ashes.
He wishes to ask one question, whether the brides have their abode in castle-walls or in manor.

XVI.

Jerusalem, he says, in Judea.
But the dwelling of the brides should be perfect.
For such “a comely pack” a great castle would be required.
The city in Judæa, answers the maiden, is where Christ suffered, and is the Old Jerusalem.
The New Jerusalem is where the Lamb has assembled his brides.
Jerusalem means the city of God.
In the Old city our peace was made at one.
In the New city is eternal peace.

XVII.

The father prays his daughter to bring him to the blissful bower.
His daughter tells him that he shall see the outside, but not a foot may he put in the city.

XVIII.

The maiden then tells her father to go along the bank till he comes to a hill.
He reaches the hill, and beholds the heavenly city.
As St. John saw it, so he beheld it.
The city was of burnished gold.
Pitched upon gems, the foundation composed of twelve stones.
The names of the precious stones.

- i. Jasper.
- ii. Sapphire.
- iii. Chalcedony.
- iv. Emerald.
- v. Sardonyx.
- vi. Ruby.
- vii. Chrysolite.
- viii. Beryl.
- ix. Topaz.
- x. Chrysoprasus.
- xi. Jacinth.
- xii. Amethyst.

The city was square.
The wall was of jasper.
Twelve thousand furlongs in length and breadth.

XIX.

Each “pane” had three gates.
Each gate adorned with a pearl.
Such light gleamed in all the streets, that there was no need of the sun or moon.
God was the light of those in the city.
The high throne might be seen, upon which the “high God” sat.
A river ran out of the throne; it flowed through each street.
No church was seen.
God was the church; Christ the sacrifice.
The gates were ever open.
There is no night in the city.
The planets, and the sun itself, are dim compared to the divine light.
Trees there renew their fruit every month.
The beholder of this fair city stood still as a “dased quail.”

XX.

As the moon began to rise he was aware of a procession of virgins crowned with pearls, in white robes, with a pearl in their breast.
As they went along they shone as glass.
The Lamb went before them.
There was no pressing.
The “alder men” fell groveling at the feet of the Lamb.
All sang in praise of the Lamb.
The Lamb wore white weeds.
A wide wound was seen near his breast.
Joy was in his looks.
The father perceives his little queen.

XIX.

Great delight takes possession of his mind.
He attempts to cross the stream.
It was not pleasing to the Lord.
The dreamer awakes, and is in great sorrow.
He addresses his pearl; laments his rash curiosity.
Men desire more than they have any right to expect.
The good Christian knows how to make peace with God.
God give us grace to be his servants!

Cleanness: Sidenotes

I.

Cleanness discloses fair forms.

God is angry with the unclean worshipper, and with false priests.

The pure worshipper receives great reward.

The impure will bring upon them the anger of God, Who is pure and holy.

It would be a marvel if God did not hate evil.

Christ showed us that himself.

St. Matthew records the discourse.

The clean of heart shall look on our Lord.

What earthly noble, when seated at table above dukes, would like to see a lad badly attired approach the table with "rent cockers," his coat torn and his toes out?

For any one of these he would be turned out with a "big buffet," and be forbidden to re-enter, and thus be ruined through his vile clothes.

The parable of the "Marriage of the King's Son."

The king's invitation.

Those invited begin to make excuses.

One had bought an estate and must go to see it.

Another had purchased some oxen and wished to see them "pull in the plough."

A third had married a wife and could not come.

The Lord was greatly displeased, and commanded his servants to invite the wayfaring, both men and women, the better and the worse, that his palace might be full.

The servants brought in bachelors and squires.

When they came to the court they were well entertained.

The servants tell their lord that they have done his behest, and there is still room for more guests.

The Lord commands them to go out into the fields, and bring in the halt, blind, and "one-eyed."

For those who denied shall not taste "one sup" to save them from death.

The palace soon became full of "people of all plights."

They were not all one wife's sons, nor had they all one father.

The "brightest attired" had the best place.

Below sat those with "poor weeds."

All are well entertained "with meat and minstrelsy."

Each with his "mate" made him at ease.

II.

The lord of the feast goes among his guests.

Bids them be merry.

On the floor he finds one not arrayed for a holyday.

Asks him how he obtained entrance, and how he was so bold as to appear in such rags.

Does he take him to be a harlot?

The man becomes discomfited.

He is unable to reply.

The lord commands him to be bound, and cast into a deep dungeon.

This feast is likened to the kingdom of heaven, to which all are invited.

See that thy weeds are clean.

Thy weeds are thy works that thou hast wrought.

For many faults may a man forfeit bliss.

For sloth and pride he is thrust into the devil's throat.

He is ruined by covetousness, perjury, murder, theft, and strife.

For robbery and ribaldry, for preventing marriages, and supporting the wicked, for treason, treachery, and tyranny, man may lose eternal bliss.

III.

The high Prince of all is displeased with those who work wickedly.

For the first fault the devil committed, he felt God's vengeance.

He, the fairest of all angels, forsook his sovereign, and boasted that his throne should be as high as God's.

For these words he was cast down to hell.

The fiends fell from heaven, like the thick snow, for forty days.

From heaven to hell the shower lasted.

The devil would not make peace with God.

Affliction makes him none the better.

For the fault of one, vengeance alighted upon all men.

Adam was ordained to live in bliss.

Through Eve he ate an apple.

Thus all his descendants became poisoned.

A maiden brought a remedy for mankind.

IV.

Malice was merciless.

A race of men came into the world, the fairest, the merriest, and the strongest that ever were created.

They were sons of Adam.

No law was laid upon them.

Nevertheless they acted unnaturally.

The "*fiends*" beheld how fair were the daughters of these mighty men, and made fellowship with them and begat a race of giants.

The greatest fighter was reckoned the most famous.

The Creator of all becomes exceedingly wroth.

Fell anger touches His heart.

It repents Him that He has made man.

He declares that all flesh shall be destroyed, both man and beast.

There was at this time living on the earth a very righteous man: Noah was his name.
Three bold sons he had.
God in great anger speaks to Noah.
Declares that He will destroy all “that life has.”
Commands him to make “a mansion” with dwellings for wild and tame.
To let the ark be three hundred cubits in length, and fifty in breadth, and thirty in height, and a window in it a cubit square.
Also a good shutting door in the side, together with halls, recesses, bushes, and bowers, and well-formed pens.
For all flesh shall be destroyed, except Noah and his family.
Noah is told to take into the ark seven pairs of every clean beast, and one of unclean kind, and to furnish the ark with proper food.
Noah fills the ark.

V.

God asks Noah whether all is ready.
Noah replies that all is fully prepared.
He is commanded to enter the ark, for God tells him that he will send a rain to destroy all flesh.
Noah stows all safely in the ark.
Seven days are passed.
The deep begins to swell, banks are broken down, and the clouds burst.
It rains for forty days, and the flood rises, and flows over the woods and fields.
All must drown.
The water enters the houses.
Each woman with her bairns flees to the hills.
The rain never ceases.
The valleys are filled.
People flock to the mountains.
Some swim for their lives.
Others roar for fear.
Animals of all kinds run to the hills.
All pray for mercy.
God’s mercy is passed from them.
Each sees that he must sink.
Friends take leave of one another.
Forty days have gone by, and all are destroyed.
All rot in the mud, except Noah and his family, who are safe in the ark.
The ark is lifted as high as the clouds, and is driven about, without mast, bowline, cables, anchors, or sail to guide its course.
At the mercy of the winds.

Oft it rolled around and reared on end.
The age of the patriarch Noah.
Duration of the flood.
The completeness of the destruction.
God remembers those in the ark.
He causes a wind to blow, and closes the lakes and wells, and the great deep.
The ark settles on Mount Ararat.
Noah beholds the bare earth.
He opens his window and sends out the raven to seek dry land.
The raven “croaks for comfort” on finding carrion.
He fills his belly with the foul flesh.
The lord of the ark curses the raven, and sends out the dove.
The bird wanders about the whole day.
Finding no rest, she returns about eventide to Noah.
Noah again sends out the dove.

VI.

The dove returns with an olive branch in her beak.
This was a token of peace and reconciliation.
Joy reigns in the ark.
The people therein laugh and look thereout.
God permits Noah and his sons to leave the ark.
Noah offers sacrifice to God.
It is pleasing to Him that “all speeds or spoils.”
God declares that He will never destroy the world for the sin of man.
That summer and winter shall never cease.
Nor night nor day, nor the new years.
God blesses every beast.
Each fowl takes its flight.
Each fish goes to the flood.
Each beast makes for the plain.
Wild worms wriggle to their abodes in the earth.
The fox goes to the woods.
Harts to the heath, and hares to the gorse.
Lions and leopards go to the lakes.
Eagles and hawks to the high rocks.
The four ‘frekes’ take the empire.
Behold what woe God brought on mankind for their hateful deeds!
Beware of the filth of the flesh.
“One speck of a spot” will ruin us in the sight of God.

The beryl is clean and sound,—it has no seam.

VII.

When God repented that he had made man, he destroyed all flesh.

But afterwards He was sorry, and made a covenant with mankind that He would not again destroy all the living.

For the filth of the flesh God destroyed a rich city.

God hates the wicked as “hell that stinks.”

Especially harlotry and blasphemy.

Nothing is hidden from God.

God is the ground of all deeds.

He honours the man that is honest and whole.

But for deeds of shame He destroys the mighty ones.

VIII.

Abraham is sitting before his house-door under a green oak.

He sees three men coming along, and goes toward them.

He entreats them to rest awhile, that he may wash their feet, and bring them a morsel of bread.

Abraham commands Sarah to make some cakes quickly, and tells his servant to seethe a tender kid.

Abraham appears bare-headed before his guests.

He casts a clean cloth on the green, and sets before them cakes, butter, milk, and pottage.

God praises his friend’s feast, and after the meat is removed, He tells Abraham that Sarah shall bear him a son.

Sarah, who is behind the door, laughs in unbelief.

God tells Abraham that Sarah laughs at His words.

Sarah denies that she laughed.

Abraham’s guests set out towards Sodom, two miles from Mamre.

The patriarch accompanies them.

God determines to reveal to Abraham his secret purposes.

IX.

He informs him of the destruction about to fall upon the cities of the plain, for their great wickedness, in abusing the gifts bestowed upon them.

The ordinance of marriage had been made for them, but they foully set it at nought.

The flame of love.

Therefore shall they be destroyed as an example to all men for ever.

Abraham is full of fear, and asks God whether the “sinful and the sinless” are to suffer together.

Whether he will spare the cities provided fifty righteous are found in them?

For the sake of fifty the cities shall be spared.

The patriarch beseeches God to spare the city for the sake of forty-five righteous.

For the lack of five the cities shall not be destroyed.
For forty the cities shall be spared.
Abraham entreats God's forbearance for his speech.
Thirty righteous, found in the cities, shall save them from destruction.
For the sake of twenty guiltless ones God will release the rest.
Or if ten only should be found pure.
The patriarch intercedes for Lot.
Beseeches Him to "temper His ire," and then departs weeping for sorrow.

X.

God's messengers go to Sodom.
Lot is sitting alone at the "door of his lodge."
Staring into the street he sees two men.
Beardless chins they had, and hair like raw silk.
Beautifully white were their weeds.
Lot runs to meet them.
Invites them to remain awhile in his house, and in the morning they may take their way.
Lot invites them so long that at last they comply.
The wife and daughters of Lot welcome their visitors.
Lot admonishes his men to prepare the meat, and to serve no salt with it.
Lot's wife disregards the injunction.
The guests are well entertained.
But before they go to rest the city is up in arms.
With "keen clubs" the folk clatter on the walls, and demand that Lot should deliver up his guests.
The wind yet stinks with their filthy speech.
Lot is in great trouble.
He leaves his guests and addresses the Sodomites.
He offers to give up to them his two daughters.
The rebels raise a great noise, and ask who made him a justice to judge their deeds, who was but a boy when he came to Sodom.
The young men bring Lot within doors, and smite those outside with blindness.
In vain they try to find the door of Lot's house.

XI.

Early in the morning the angels command Lot to depart from Sodom, with his wife and two daughters, and to look straight before him, for Sodom and Gomorrah shall be destroyed.
Lot asks what is best to be done, that he may escape.
He is told to choose himself a dwelling which shall be saved from destruction.
He chooses Zoar.
The angels command Lot to depart quickly.

He wakes his wife and daughters.

All four are hastened on by the angels, who “preach to them the peril” of delay.

Before daylight Lot comes to a hill.

God aloft raises a storm.

A rain falls thick of fire and sulphur.

Upon the four cities it comes, and frightens all folks therein.

The great bars of the abyss do burst.

Cliffs cleave asunder.

The cities sink to hell.

Such a cry arises that the clouds clatter again.

Lot and his companions are frightened, but continue to follow their face.

Lot’s wife looks behind her, and is turned to a stiff stone “as salt as any sea.”

Her companions do not miss her till they reach Zoar.

By this time all were drowned.

The people of Zoar, for dread, rush into the sea and are destroyed.

Only Zoar with three therein (Lot and his daughters) are saved.

Lot’s wife is an image of salt for two faults:

1. She served salt before the Lord at supper.
2. She looked behind her.

Abraham is up full early on the morn.

He looks towards Sodom, now only a pit filled with pitch, from which rise smoke, ashes and cinders,
as from a furnace.

A sea now occupies the place of the four cities.

It is a stinking pool, and is called the Dead Sea.

Nothing may live in it.

Lead floats on its surface.

A feather sinks to the bottom of it.

Lands, watered by this sea, never bear grass or weed.

A man cannot be drowned in it.

The clay clinging to it is corrosive, as alum, alkanet, sulphur, etc., which fret the flesh and fester the bones.

On the shores of this lake grow trees bearing fair fruits, which, when broken or bitten, taste like ashes.

All these are tokens of wickedness and vengeance.

God loves the pure in heart.

Strive to be clean.

Jean de Meun tells how a lady is to be loved.

By doing what pleases her best.

Love thy Lord!

Conform to Christ, who is polished as a pearl.

By how comely a contrivance did he enter the womb of the virgin!
In what purity did he part from her!
No abode was better than his.
The sorrow of childbirth was turned to joy.
Angels solaced the virgin with organs and pipes.
The child Christ was so clean that ox and ass worshipped him.
He hated wickedness, and would never touch ought that was vile.
Yet there came to him lazars and lepers, lame and blind.
Dry and dropsical folk.
He healed all with kind speech.
His handling was so good, that he needed no knife to cut or carve with.
The bread he broke more perfectly than could all the tools of Toulouse.
How can we approach his court except we be clean?
God is merciful.
Through penance we may shine as a pearl.
Why is the pearl so prized?
She becomes none the worse for wear.
If she should become dim, wash her in wine.
She then becomes clearer than before.
So may the sinner polish him by penance.
Beware of returning to sin.
For then God is more displeased than ever.
The reconciled soul God holds as His own.
Ill deeds rob Him of it.
God forbids us to defile any vessels used in His service.
In Belshazzar's time, the defiling of God's vessels brought wrath upon the king.

XII.

Daniel in his prophecies tells of the destruction of the Jews.
For their unfaithfulness in following other gods, God allowed the heathen to destroy them, in the reign of Zedekiah, who practised idolatry.
Nebuchadnezzar becomes his foe.
He besieges Jerusalem, and surrounds the walls.
The city is stuffed full of men.
Brisk is the skirmish.
Seven times a day are the gates assailed.
For two years the fight goes on, yet the city is not taken.
The folk within are in want of food.
Meager they become.
For so shut up are they that escape seems impossible.

But on a quiet night they steal out, and rush through the host.
They are discovered by the enemy.
A loud alarm is given.
They are pursued and overtaken.
Their king is made prisoner.
His chief men are presented as prisoners to Nebuchadnezzar.
His sons are slain.
His own eyes are put out.
He is placed in a dungeon in Babylon.
All for his “bad bearing” against the Lord, who might otherwise have been his friend.
Nebuchadnezzar ceased not until he had destroyed Jerusalem.
Nebuzaradan was “chief of the chivalry.”
The best men were taken out of the city.
Nevertheless Nebuzaradan spared not those left.
Brains of bairns were spilt.
Priests pressed to death.
Wives and wenches foully killed.
All that escaped the sword were taken to Babylon, and were made to drag the cart or milk the kine.
Nebuzaradan burst open the temple, and slew those therein.
Priests, pulled by the poll, were slain along with deacons, clerks, and maidens.
The enemy pillages the temple of its pillars of brass, and the golden candlestick from off the altar.
Goblets, basins, golden dishes, all are taken by Nebuzaradan, and hampered together.
Solomon had made them with much labour.
The temple he beats down, and returns to Babylon.
Presents the prisoners to the king, among whom were Daniel and his three companions.
Nebuchadnezzar has great joy, because his enemies are slain.
Great was his wonder when he saw the sacred jewelry.
He praises the God of Israel.
Such vessels never before came to Chaldea.
They are thrust into the treasury.
Nebuchadnezzar reigns as emperor of all the earth, through the “doom of Daniel,” who gave him good counsel.
Nebuchadnezzar dies and is buried.
Belshazzar succeeds him.
He holds himself the biggest in heaven or on earth.
He honours not God, but worships false phantoms.
He promises them rewards if good fortune befall.
If they vex him he knocks them in pieces.
He has a wife, and many concubines.
The mind of the king was fixed upon new meats and other vain things.

XIII.

Belshazzar, to exhibit his vainglory, proclaims throughout Babylon, that all the great ones should assemble on a set day, at the Sultan's feast.

Kings, dukes, and lords were commanded to attend the court.

To do the king honour many nobles came to Babylon.

It would take too long to name the number.

The city of Babylon is broad and big.

It is situated on a plain, surrounded by seven streams, a high wall, and towers.

The palace was long and large, each side being seven miles in length.

High houses were within the walls.

The time of the feast has come.

Belshazzar sits upon his throne: the hall floor is covered with knights.

When all are seated, service begins.

Trumpets sound everywhere.

Bread is served upon silver dishes.

All sorts of musical instruments are heard in the hall.

The king, surrounded by his loves, drinks copiously of wine.

It gets into his head and stupifies him.

A cursed thought takes possession of him.

He commands his marshal to bring him the vessels taken from the temple by Nebuchadnezzar, and to fill them with wine.

The marshal opens the chests.

Covers the cupboard with vessels.

The Jewels of Jerusalem deck the sides of the hall.

The altar and crown, blessed by bishop's hands, and anointed with the blood of beasts, are set before the bold Belshazzar.

Upon this altar were noble vessels curiously carved, basins of gold, cups arrayed like castles with battlements, and towers with lofty pinnacles.

Upon them were portrayed branches and leaves, the flowers of which were white pearls, and the fruit flaming gems.

The goblets were ornamented with flowers of gold.

The candlestick was brought in, with its pillars of brass, and ornamental boughs, upon which sat birds of various hues.

Lights shone bright from the candlestick, which once stood before the "Holy of Holies."

The pollution of the sacred vessels is displeasing to God.

For "a boaster on bench" drinks from them till he is as "drunken as the devil."

God is very angry.

Before harming the revellers He sends them a warning.

Belshazzar commands the sacred vessels to be filled with wine.

The cups and bowls are soon filled.

Music of all kind is heard in the hall.
Dukes, princes, concubines, and knights, all are merry.
Drinking of the sweet liquors they ask favours of their gods, who, although dumb, are as highly
praised "as if heaven were theirs."
A marvel befalls the feasters.
The king first saw it.
Upon the plain wall, "a palm with pointel in fingers" is seen writing.
The bold Belshazzar becomes frightened.
His knees knock together.
He roars for dread, still beholding the hand, as it wrote on the rough wall.
The hand vanishes but the letters remain.
The king recovers his speech and sends for the "book-learned;" but none of the scholars were wise
enough to read it.
Belshazzar is nearly mad.
Commands the city to be searched throughout for the "wise of witchcraft."
He who expounds the strange letters, shall be clothed in "gowns of purple."
A collar of gold shall encircle his throat.
He shall be the third lord in the realm.
As soon as this cry was upcast, to the hall came clerks out of Chaldea, witches and diviners, sorcerers
and exorcists.
But after looking on the letters they were as ignorant as if they had looked into the leather of the left
boot.
The king curses them all and calls them churls.
He orders the harlots to be hanged.
The queen hears the king chide.
She inquires the cause.
Goes to the king, kneels before him, and asks why he has rent his robes for grief, when there is one
that has the Spirit of God, the counsellor of Nebuchadnezzar, the interpreter of his dreams, through
the holy Spirit of God.
The name of this man is Daniel, who was brought a captive from Judæa.
The queen tells the king to send for Daniel.
Her counsel is accepted.
Daniel comes before Belshazzar.
The king tells him that he has heard of his wisdom, and his power to discover hidden things, and that
he wants to know the meaning of the writing on the wall.
Promises him, if he can explain the text of the letters and their interpretation, to clothe him in purple
and pall, and put a ring about his neck, and to make him "a baron upon bench."
Daniel addresses the king, and reminds him how that God supported his father, and gave him power
to exalt or abase whomsoever he pleased.
Nebuchadnezzar was established on account of his faith in God.
So long as he remained true, no man was greater.

But at last pride touches his heart.

He forgets the power of God, and blasphemes His name.

He says that he is “god of the ground,” and the builder of Babylon.

Hardly had Nebuchadnezzar spoken, when God’s voice is heard, saying, “Thy principality is departed.

Thou, removed from men, must abide on the moor, and walk with wild beasts, eat herbs, and dwell with wolves and asses.”

For his pride he becomes an outcast.

He believes himself to be a bull or an ox.

Goes “on all fours,” like a cow, for seven summers.

His thighs grew thick.

His hair became matted and thick, from the shoulders to the toes.

His beard touched the earth.

His brows were like briars.

His eyes were hollow, and grey as the kite’s.

Eagle-hued he was.

At last he recovered his “wit,” and believed in God.

Then soon was he restored to his seat.

But thou, Belshazzar, hast disregarded these signs, and hast blasphemed the Lord, defiled his vessels, filling them with wine for thy wenches, and praising thy lifeless gods.

For this sin God has sent thee this strange sight, the fist with the fingers writing on the wall.

These are the words: “Mene, Tekel, Peres.

Mene.— God has counted thy kingdom and finished it.

Tekel.—Thy reign is weighed and is found wanting in deeds of faith.

Peres.— Thy kingdom is divided, and given to the Persians.

The Medes shall be masters here.”

The king commands Daniel to be clothed in a frock of fine cloth.

Soon is he arrayed in purple, with a chain about his neck.

A decree is made, that all should bow to him, as the third lord that followed Belshazzar.

The decree was made known, and all were glad.

The day, however, past.

Night came on.

Before another day dawned, Daniel’s words were fulfilled.

The feast lasts till the sun falls.

The skies become dark.

Each noble hies home to his supper.

Belshazzar is carried to bed, but never rises from it, for his foes are seeking to destroy his land, and are assembled suddenly.

The enemy is Darius, leader of the Medes.

He has legions of armed men.

Under cover of the darkness, they cross the river.
By means of ladders they get upon the walls, and within an hour enter the city, without disturbing any of the watch.
They run into the palace, and raise a great cry.
Men are slain in their beds.
Belshazzar is beaten to death, and caught by the heels, is foully cast into a ditch.
Darius is crowned king, and makes peace with the barons.
Thus the land was lost for the king's sin.
He was cursed for his uncleanness, and deprived of his honour, as well as of the joys of heaven.
Thus in three ways has it been shown, that uncleanness makes God angry.
Cleanness is His comfort.
The seemly shall see his face.
God give us grace to serve in His sight!

Patience: Sidenotes

I.

Patience is often displeasing, but it assuages heavy hearts, and quenches malice.
Happiness follows sorrow.
It is better to suffer than to be angry.
Matthew tells us of the promises made by Christ: Blessed are the poor, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.
Blessed are the meek, for they shall "wield the world."
Blessed are the mourners, for they shall be comforted.
Blessed are the hungry, for they shall be filled.
Blessed are the merciful, for mercy shall be their reward.
Blessed are the clean of heart, for they shall see the Saviour.
Blessed are the peace-makers, for they shall be called God's sons.
Blessed are they that live aright, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.
These blessings are promised to those who follow poverty, pity, penance, meekness, mercy, chastity, peace and patience.
Poverty and patience are to be treated together.
They are "fettled in one form," and have one meed.
Poverty will dwell where she lists, and man must needs suffer.
Poverty and patience are play-fellows.
What avails impatience, if God send affliction?
Patience is best.
Did not Jonah incur danger by his folly?

II.

Jonah was a prophet of the gentiles.

God's word came to him, saying, "Rise quickly, take the way to Nineveh.

Say that which I shall put in thine heart.

Wickedness dwells in that city.

Go swiftly and carry my message."

Jonah is full of wrath.

He is afraid that the shrews will put him in the stocks, or put out his eyes.

He thinks that God desires his death.

He determines not to go near the city, but fly to Tarshish.

Grumbling, he goes to port Joppa.

He says that God will not be able to protect him.

Jonah reaches the port, finds a ship ready to sail.

The seamen catch up the cross-sail, fasten the cables, weigh their anchors, and spread sail.

A gentle wind wafts the ship along.

Was never a Jew so joyful as was Jonah then.

He has, however, put himself in peril, in fleeing from God.

The words of David.

Does He not hear, who made all ears?

He is not blind that formed each eye.

Jonah is now in no dread.

He is, however, soon overtaken.

The wielder of all things has devices at will.

He commands Eurus and Aquilo to blow.

The winds blow obedient to His word.

Out of the north-east the noise begins.

Storms arose, winds wrestled together, the waves rolled high, and never rested.

Then was Jonah joyless.

The boat reeled around.

The gear became out of order.

Ropes and mast were broken.

A loud cry is raised, Many a lad labours to lighten the ship.

They throw overboard their bags and feather beds.

But still the wind rages, and the waves become wilder.

Each man calls upon his god.

Some called upon Vernagu, Diana, and Neptune, to the sun and to the moon.

Then said one of the sailors: "Some lawless wretch, that has grieved his God, is in the ship.

I advise that we lay lots upon each man.

When the guilty is gone the tempest may cease."

This is agreed to.

All are assembled, from all corners of the ship, save Jonah the Jew, who had fled into the bottom of the boat.

There he falls asleep.

Soon he is aroused, and brought on board.

Full roughly is he questioned.

The lot falls upon Jonah.

Then quickly they said: "What the devil hast thou done, doted wretch?

What seekest thou on the sea?

Hast thou no God to call upon?

Of what land art thou?

Thou art doomed for thy ill deeds."

Jonah says: "I am a Hebrew, a worshipper of the world's Creator.

All this mischief is caused by me, therefore cast me overboard."

He proves to them that he was guilty.

The mariners are exceedingly frightened.

They try to make way with their oars, but their endeavours are useless.

Jonah must be doomed to death.

They pray to God, that they may not shed innocent blood.

Jonah is cast overboard.

The tempest ceases and the sea settles.

The stiff streams drive the ship about.

At last they reach a bank.

The seamen thank God, and perform solemn vows.

Jonah is in great dread.

III.

Jonah is shoved from the ship.

A wild whale swims by the boat.

He opens his swallow, and seizes the prophet.

It is not to be wondered at that Jonah suffered woe.

The prophet is without hope.

Cold was his comfort.

Jonah was only a mote in the whale's jaws.

He entered in by the gills, and by means of one of the intestines of the fish, came into a space as large as a hall.

The prophet fixes his feet firmly in the belly of the whale.

He searches into every nook of its navel.

The prophet calls upon God.

He cries for mercy.

He sits safely in a recess, in a bowel of the beast, for three days and three nights.
The whale passes through many a rough region.
Jonah makes the whale feel sick.
The prophet prays to God in this wise:

IV.

“Lord! to thee have I cried out of hell’s womb.
Thou dippedst me in the sea.
Thy great floods passed over me.
The streams drive over me.
I am cast out from thy sight.
The abyss binds me.
The rushing waves play on my head.
Thou possessest my life.
In my anguish I remembered my God, and besought His pity.
When I am delivered from this danger, I will obey thy commands.”
God speaks fiercely to the whale, and he vomits out the prophet on a dry space.
Jonah has need to wash his clothes.
God’s word comes to the prophet.
He is told to preach in Nineveh.
By night Jonah reaches the city.
Nineveh was a very great city.
Jonah delivers his message; “Yet forty days and Nineveh shall come to an end.
It shall be turned upside down, and swallowed quickly by the black earth.”
This speech spreads throughout the city.
Great fear seizes all.
The people mourn secretly, clothe themselves in sackcloth, and cast ashes upon their heads.
The message reaches the ears of the king.
He rends his robes, clothes himself in sackcloth, and mourns in the dust.
He issues a decree, that all in the city, men, beasts, women and children, prince, priest, and prelates,
should fast for their sins.
Children are to be weaned from the breast.
The ox is to have no hay, nor the horse any water.
Who can tell if God will have mercy?
Though He is mighty, He is merciful, and may forgive us our guilt.
All believed and repented.
God forgave them through his goodness.

V.

Much sorrow settles upon Jonah.

He becomes very angry.

He prays to God and says: “Was not this my saying, when Thy message reached me in my own country?

I knew Thy great goodness, Thy long-suffering, and Thy mercy.

I knew these men might make their peace with Thee, therefore I fled unto Tarshish.

Take my life from me, O Lord!

It is better for me to die than live.”

God upbraids Jonah, saying: “Is this right to be so wroth?”

Jonah, jangling, uprises, and makes himself a bower, of hay and ever-fern, to shield him from the sun.

He slept heavily all night.

God prepared a woodbine.

Jonah awakes, and is exceedingly glad of the bower.

The prophet, under its gracious leaves, is protected from the sun’s rays.

Jonah wishes he had such a lodge in his own country.

God prepared a worm, that made the woodbine wither.

Jonah awakes and finds his woodbine destroyed.

The leaves were all faded.

The sun beat upon the head of Jonah.

He is exceedingly angry, and prays God that he may die.

God rebukes the prophet.

“Dost thou well,” He says, “to be angry for the gourd?”

Jonah replies, “I would I were dead.”

God asks if it is to be wondered at that He should help His handy work.

Is not Jonah angry that his woodbine is destroyed, which cost him no labour?

God is not to be blamed for taking pity upon people that He made.

Should He destroy Nineveh the sorrow of such a sweet place would sink to His heart.

In the city there are little bairns who have done no wrong.

And there are others who cannot discern between their right hand and their left hand.

There are also dumb beasts in the city incapable of sinning.

Judgment must be tempered with mercy.

He that is too hasty to rend his clothes must afterwards sit with worse ones to sew them together.

Poverty and pain must be endured.

Patience is a noble point, though it displeases oft.

Text and Layout

The text is intended to replicate the layout of the printed book as closely as possible.

Headnotes, printed at the top of each page, have been moved to the most appropriate sentence break. Some shorter headnote pairs may be merged into one. **Sidenotes** giving plot summary are placed close to their original location.

The **Notes** were originally printed as a short (12 pages) section before the Glossarial Index. For this e-text they have been distributed among their respective texts. Links to the Notes are intended to be visible but not distracting.

Text-Critical Notes such as variant readings have been handled differently than in the printed book, where they appeared either as footnotes (numbered) or sidenotes (sometimes but not always marked). Here, the word they refer to is underlined if necessary, and the note itself will generally have this form:

leak] the *t* of the MS. has a *k* over it.

Where a single word has both an endnote and a marginal note, the link to the endnote is shown.

A. An unusual typographical error, shown with beginnings of adjoining lines:

the Saxon forms
thennes), etct The
in-myddde (amidst),

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1

THE PEARL.

I.

Perle plesaunte to prynces paye,
To clanly clos in golde so clere,
Oute of oryent I hardyly saye,
4 Ne proued I neuer her precios pere,
So rounde, so reken in vche araye,
So smal, so smoþe her syde3 were.
Quere-so-euer I Iugged gemme3 gaye,
8 I sette hyr sengeley in synglure;
Allas! I leste hyr in on erbere,
þur3 gresse to grounde hit fro me yot;
I dewyne for-dolked of luf daungere,

[Fol. 3r]
Description of a lost pearl
(*i.e.* a beloved child).

The father laments the los
of his pearl.
yot] ? got.

12 Of þat pryuy perle *with*-outen spot.

HER VISITS HIS CHILD'S GRAVE,

Syþen in þat spote hit fro me sprange,
Ofte haf I wayted wyschande þat wele,
þat wont wat3 whyle deuoyde my wrange,
16 & heuen my happe & al my hele,
þat dot3 bot þrych my hert þrange,
My breste in bale bot bolne & bele.
3et þo3t me neuer so swete a sange,
20 As style stounde let to me stele,
For-soþe þer fleten to me fele,
To þenke hir color so clad in clot;
O moul þou marrez a myry mele.
24 My priuy perle *with*-outen spotte,
2

þat spot of spysez my3t nede3 sprede,
þer such ryche3 to rot is runnen;
Blome3 blayke & blwe & rede,
28 þer schyne3 ful schyr agayn þe sunne.
Flor & fryte may not be fede,
þer hit doun drof in molde3 dunne,
For vch gresse mot grow of graynez dede,
32 No whete were elle3 to wone3 wonne;
Of goud vche goude is ay by-gonne.
So semly a sede mo3t fayly not,
þat spryngande spyce3 vp ne sponne,
36 Of þat *precios* perle wyth-outen spotte.

To þat spot þat I in speche expoun
I entred in þat erber grene,
In augoste in a hy3 seysoun,
40 Quen corne is coruen wyth croke3 kene.
On huyle þer perle hit trendeled doun,
Schadowed þis worte3 ful schyre & schene
Gilofre, gyngure & gromylyoun,

He often visits the spot
where his pearl disappear

and hears a sweet song.

moul] ? *mould*.

Where the pearl was burie
there he found lovely
flowers.

rot] ? *rote*.

Each blade of grass spring
from a dead grain.

spryngande] The MS.
reads *sprygande*.

[Fol. 3]

In the high season of Aug
the parent visits the grave
his lost child.

Beautiful flowers covered
the grave.

44 & pyonys powdered ay by-twene.
3if hit wat3 semly on to sene,
A fayr reflowr 3et fro hit flot,
þer wonys þat worpyly I wot & wene,
48 My *precious* perle, wyth-uten spot.

From them came a delicious
odour.

THE FALLING ASLEEP, HE DREAMS.

Bifore þat spot my honde I spenn[e]d,
For care ful colde þat to me ca3t[e];
A denely dele in my hert denned,
52 Þa3 resoun sette my seluen sa3t[e].
I playned my perle þat þer wat3 spenned
Wyth fyrte skylle3 þat faste fa3t[e],
Þa3 kynde of kryst me comfort kenned,
56 My wreched wyll in wo ay wra3te.
I felle vpon þat floury fla3t[e],
Suche odour to my herne3 schot;
I slode vpon a slepyng sla3te,
60 On þat prec[i]os perle *with*-uten spot.
3

The bereaved father wring
his hands for sorrow, falls
asleep upon the flowery p
and dreams.

II.

Fro spot my spyryt þer sprang in space,
My body on balke þer bod in sweuen,
My goste is gon in gode3 grace,
64 In auenture þer meruayle3 meuen;
I ne wyste in þis worlde quere þat hit wace,
Bot I knew me keste þer klyfe3 cleuen;
Towarde a foreste I bere þe face,
68 Where rych rokke3 wer to dyscreuen;
þe ly3t of hem my3t no mon leuen,
þe glemande glory þat of hem glent;
For wern neuer webbe3 þat wy3e3 weuen,
72 Of half so dere adubmente.

In spirit he is carried to an
unknown region,

where the rocks and cliffs
gleamed gloriously.

Dubbed wern alle þo downe3 syde3
 With crystal klyffe3 so cler of kynde,
 Holte-wode3 bry3t aboute hem byde3;
 76 Of bolle3 as blwe as ble of ynde,
 As bornyst syluer þe lef onslyde3,
 Þat þike con trylle on vch a tynde,
 Quen glem of glode3 agayn3 hem glyde3,
 80 Wyth schymeryng schene ful schrylle þay schynde.
 Þe grauayl þat on grounde con grynde
 Wern *precious* perle3 of oryente;
 Þe sunne beme3 bot blo & blynde,
 84 In respecte of þat adubbement.

The adubbemente of þo downe3 dere
 Garten my goste al greffe for-3ete
 So frech flauore3 of fryte3 were,
 88 As fode hit con me fayre refete.
 Fowle3 þer flowen in fryth in fere,
 Of flaumbande hwe3, boþe smale & grete,
 Bot sytole stryng & gyternere,
 92 Her reken myrþe mo3t not retrete,
 For quen þose brydde3 her wynges bete
 Þay songen wyth a swete asent;

4
 So grac[i]os gle coupe no mon gete
 96 As here & se her adubbement.

So al wat3 dubbet on dere asyse;
 Þat fryth þer fortwne forth me fere3,
 Þe derþe þer-of for to deuyse
 100 Nis no wy3 worþe þat tonge bere3.
 I welke ay forth in wely wyse,
 No bonk so byg þat did me dere3,
 Þe fyrre in þe fryth þe feier con ryse,
 104 Þe playn, þe plontte3, þe spyse, þe pere3,
 & rawe3 & rande3 & rych reuere3,

[Fol. 4]

The hill sides were decked
 with crystal cliffs.

The leaves of the trees we
 like burnished silver.

The gravel consisted of
 precious pearls.

The father forgets his sorrow

He sees birds of the most
 beautiful hues,
hwe3] Or *hiwe3*.

and hears their sweet
 melody.

No tongue could describe
 beauty of the forest.

All shone like gold.

As fyldor fyn her b[o]nkes brent.
I wan to a water by schore þat schere3,
108 Lorde! dere wat3 hit adubblement!

The dreamer arrives at the
bank of a river,

[Fol. 4]

The dubbemente of þo derworth depe
Wern bonke3 bene of beryl bry3t;
Swangeande swete þe water con swepe
112 Wyth a rownande rourde raykande ary3t;
In þe founce þer stonden stone3 stepe,
As glente þur3 glas þat glowed & gly3t,
A stremande sterne3 quen stroþe men slepe,
116 Staren in welkyn in wynter ny3t;
For vche a pobbel in pole þer py3t
Wat3 Emerad, saffer, oþer gemme gente,
þat alle þe lo3e lemed of ly3t,
120 So dere wat3 hit adubblement.

which gave forth sweet
sounds.

In it, stones glittered like
stars

A] ? As.

in the welkin on a winter
night.

H CAUSES HIS GRIEF TO ABATE.

III.

The dubbement dere of doun & dale3,
Of wod & water & wlonk playne3,
Bylde in me blys, abated my bale3,
124 For-didden my [dis]tresse, dystried my payne3.
Doun after a strem þat dry3ly hale3,
I bowed in blys, bred ful my brayne3;
þe fyrre I fol3ed þose floty vale3,
5
128 þe more strengþe of ioie myn herte strayne3,
As fortune fares þer as ho frayne3,
Wheþer solace ho sende oþer elle3 sore,
þe wy3, to wham her wylle ho wayne3,
132 Hytte3 to haue ay more & more.

His grief abates, and he
follows the course of the
stream.

More of wele wat3 in þat wyse
þen I cowþe telle þa3 I tom hade,
For vrpely herte my3t not suffyse

No one could describe his
great joy.

136 To þe tenþe dole of þo gladne3 glade;
For-þy I þo3t þat paradyse
Wat3 þer oþer gayn þo bonke3 brade;
I hoped þe water were a deuysse
140 By-twene myrþe3 by mere3 made,
By-3onde þe broke by slente oþer slade,
I hope[de] þat mote merked wore.
Bot þe water wat3 depe I dorst not wade
144 & euer me longed a more & more.

He thought that Paradise was
on the opposite bank.

The stream was not fordable

More & more, & 3et wel mare,
Me lyste to se þe broke by-3onde,
For if hit wat3 fayr þer I con fare,
148 Wel loueloker wat3 þe fyrre londe.
Abowte me con I stote & stare
To fynde a forþe, faste con I fonde,
Bot woþe3 mo i-wysse þer ware,
152 þe fyrre I stalked by þe stronde,
& euer me þo3t I schulde not wonde
For wo, þer wele3 so wyne wore.
þenne nwe note me com on honde
156 þat meued my mynde ay more & more,

[Fol. 4

More and more he desires
see what is beyond the
brook.

But the way seemed difficult

The dreamer finds new
marvels.

ATHER SEES HIS LOST CHILD DRESSED IN WHITE ROBES.

More meruayle con my dom adaunt;
I se3 by-3onde þat myry mere,
A crystal clyffe ful relusaunt,
160 Mony ryal ray con fro hit rere;
At þe fote þer-of þer sete a faunt,
A mayden of menske, ful debonere;
Blysnande whyt wat3 hyr bleaunt,
6
164 (I knew hyr wel, I hade sen hyr ere)
As glysnande golde þat man con schere,
So schon þat schene an vnder schore;
On lenghe I loked to hyr þere,
168 þe lenger I knew hyr more & more

He sees a crystal cliff,

at the foot of which, sits a
maiden clothed in glistening
white.

He knows that he has seen
her before.

The more I frayste hyr fayre face.
 Her fygyre fyn, quen I had fonte,
 Suche gladande glory con to me glace,
 172 As lyttel byfore þerto wat3 wonte;
 To calle hyr lyste con me enchace,
 Bot baysment gef myn hert a brunt,
 I se3 hyr in so strange a place,
 176 Such a burre my3t make myn herte blunt
 Penne vere3 ho vp her fayre frount,
 Hyr vysayge whyt as playn yuore,
þat stonge myn hert ful stray atount,
 180 & euer þe lenger, þe more & more.

He desires to call her but is
afraid,

at finding her in such a
strange place.

IV.

More þen me lyste my drede aros,
 I stod ful styлле & dorste not calle,
 Wyth y3en open & mouth ful clos,
 184 I stod as hende as hawk in halle;
 I hope þat gostly wat3 þat porpose,
 I dred on ende quat schulde byfalle,
 Lest ho me eschaped þat I þer chos,
 188 Er I at steuen hir mo3t stalle.
 þat gracios gay *with-ou*ten galle,
 So smope, so smal, so seme sly3t,
 Ryse3 vp in hir araye ryalle,
 192 A prec[i]os pyece in perle3 py3t.

[Fol. 4.

So he stands still, like a w
trained hawk.

He fears lest she should
escape before he could sp
to her.

His long lost one is dresse
in royal array—decked wi
precious pearls.

pyece] MS. looks like
pyete.

She comes along the strea
towards him.

Perle3 py3te of ryal prys,
 Þere mo3t mon by grace haf sene,
 Quen þat frech as flor-de-lys,
 196 Doun þe bonke con bo3e by-dene.
 Al blysnande whyt wat3 hir beau uiys,
 7
 Vpon at syde3 & bounden bene
 Wyth þe myryeste margarys at my deuyse,

200 Þat euer I seȝ ȝet with myn yȝen;
Wyth lappeȝ large I wot & I wene,
Dubbed with double perle & dyȝte,
Her cortel of self sute schene,
204 *With precious perleȝ al vmbe-pyȝte.*

A pyȝt coroune ȝet wer þat gyrlē,
Of mariorys & non oþer ston,
Hiȝe pynakled of cler quyt perle,
208 Wyth flurted flowreȝ perfet vpon;
To hed hade ho non oþer werle,
Her here heke al hyr vmbe-gon;
Her semblaunt sade, for doc oþer erle,
212 Her ble more blaȝt þen whalleȝ bon;
As schorne golde schyr her fax þenne schon,
On schyldereȝ þat leghe vnlapped lyȝte;
Her depe colour ȝet wonted non,
216 Of *precious perle in porfyl* pyȝte,

Pyȝt watȝ poyned & vche a hemme,
At honde, at sydeȝ, at ouerture,
Wyth whyte perle & non oþer gemme,
220 & bornyste quyte watȝ hyr uesture.
Bot a wonder perle *with-uten wemme*,
In myddeȝ hyr breste watȝ sette so sure;
A manneȝ dom moȝt dryȝly demme,
224 Er mynde moȝt malte in hit mesure;
I hope no tong moȝt endure
No sauerly saghe say of þat syȝt,
So watȝ hit clene & cler & pure,
228 Þat *precious perle þer* hit watȝ pyȝt,

1AIDEN ADDRESSES HER FATHER.

Pyȝt in perle þat *precious p[r]lyse*.
On wyȝer half water com down þe schore,
No gladder gome heȝen in to grece,
232 Þen I, quen ho on brymme wore;

Her kirtle is composed of
'sute,' ornamented with
pearls.

She wore a crown of pearls.

Her hair hung down about
her.

here heke] In the MS. it
lere leke.

Her colour was whiter than
whalebone.

Her hair shone as gold.

The trimming of her robe
consisted of precious pearls.

[Fol. 4v]

A wonderful pearl was set
her breast.

No man from here to Greece
was so glad as the father,
when he saw his pearl on
bank of the stream.

Ho wat3 me nerre þen aunte or nece,
8
My loy for-þy wat3 much þe more.
Ho profered me speche þat special spyce,
236 Enclynande lowe in wommon lore,
Ca3te of her coroun of grete tresore,
& haylsed me wyth a lote lyzte.
Wel wat3 me þat euer I wat3 bore,
240 To sware þat swete in perlez pyzte!

The maiden salutes him.

V.

“O perle,” quod I, “in perlez pyzt,
Art þou my perle þat I haf playned,
Regretted by myn one, on nyzte?
244 Much longeyng haf I for þe layned,
Syþen into gresse þou me aglyzte;
Pensyf, payred, I am for-payned,
& þou in a lyf of lykyng lyzte
248 In paradys erde, of stryf vnstrayned.
What wyrde hat3 hyder my iuel vayned,
& don me in þys del & gret daunger?
Fro we in twynne wern townen & twayned,
252 I haf ben a loyle3 Iuelere.”

The father enquires of the
maiden whether she is his
long-lost pearl,

and longs to know who has
deprived him of his treasure

ELLS HIM OF HER BLISS.

That Iuel þenne in gemmy3 gente,
Vered vp her vyse with y3en graye,
Set on hyr coroun of perle orient,
256 & soberly after þenne con ho say:
“Sir 3e haf *your* tale myse-tente,
To say *your* perle is al awaye,
þat is in cofer, so comly clente,
260 As in þis gardyn gracios gaye,
Here-inne to lenge for euer & play.

[Fol. 4v]

The maiden tells him that
pearl is not really lost.

Per mys nee mornynge com neuer here,
Her were a forser for þe in faye,
264 If þou were a gentyl Iueler.

She is in a garden of delig
where sin and mourning a
unknown.

Bot Iueler gente if þou schal lose
9
þy ioy for a gemme þat þe wat3 lef,
Me þynk þe put in a mad porpose,
268 & busye3 þe aboute a raysoun bref,
For þat þou leste3 wat3 bot a rose,
þat flowred & fayled as kynde hyt gef;
Now þur3 kynde of þe kyste þat hyt con close,
272 To a perle of prys hit is put in pref;
& þou hat3 called þy wyrde a þef,
þat o3t of no3t hat3 mad þe cler;
þou blame3 þe bote of þy meschef,
276 þou art no kynde Iueler.”

busye3] Looks like *husy*
in MS.

The rose that he had lost i
become a pearl of price.

The pearl blames his rash
speech.

A Iuel to me þen wat3 þys geste,
& iuele3 wern hyr gentyl sawe3,
“I-wyse,” *quod* I, “my blysfol beste,
280 My grete dystresse þou al to-drawe3,
To be excused I make requeste;
I trawed my perle don out of dawe3,
Now haf I fonde hyt I schal ma feste,
284 & wony *with* hyt in schyr wod schawe3,
& loue my lorde & al his lawe3,
þat hat3 me bro3[t] þys blys ner;
Now were I at yow by-3onde þise wawe3,
288 I were a ioyfol Iueler.”

The father begs the maide
to excuse his speech, for I
really thought his pearl w
wholly lost to him.

“Iueler,” sayde þat gemme clene,
“Wy borde 3e men, so madde 3e be?
þre worde3 hat3 þou spoken at ene,
292 Vn-avysed, for soþe, wern alle þre,
þou ne woste in worlde quat on dot3 mene,
þy worde byfore þy wytte con fle.
þou says þou trawe3 me in þis dene,
296 By cawse þou may *with* y3en me se;

[Fol. 4:

The maiden tells her fathe
that he has spoken three
words without knowing th
meaning of one.

The first word.

Anoþer þou says, in þys countre
þy self schal won *with* me ryȝt here;
þe þrydde, to passe þys water fre,
300 þat may no ioȝfol Iueler.

10

The second.

The third.

VI.

I halde þat iueler lyttel to prayse.
þat loueȝ wel þat he seȝ wyth yȝe,
& much to blame & vn-cortoyse,
304 þat loueȝ oure lorde wolde make a lyȝe,
þat lelly hyȝte *your* lyf to rayse,
þaȝ fortune dyd *your* flesch to dyȝe;
ȝe setten hys wordeȝ ful westernays
308 þat loueȝ no þynk bot ȝe hit syȝe,
& þat is a poynt o sorquydryȝe,
þat vche god mon may euel byseme
To leue no tale be *true* to tryȝe,
312 Bot þat hys one skyl may dem[e].

He is little to be praised w
loves what he sees.

loueȝ] Looks at first sig
like *lyueȝ*—MS. rubbe
but read *leueȝ*.

loueȝ] Read *leueȝ*.
To love nothing but what
sees is great presumption.
is] The MS. reads *is*.

H IS THE ROAD TO PARADISE.

Deme now þy-self, if þou con, dayly
As man to god wordeȝ schulde heue.
þou saytȝ þou schal won *in* þis bayly;
316 Me þynk þe burde fyrst aske leue,
& ȝet of graunt þou myȝteȝ fayle;
þou wylneȝ ouer þys water to weue,
Er moste þou ceuer to oþer counsayl,
320 þy corse in clot mot calder keue,
For hit watȝ for-garte, at paradys greue
Oure ȝore fader hit con mysseȝeme;
þurȝ drwry deth boȝ vch ma dreue,
324 Er ouer þys dam hym dryȝtyn deme.”

To live in this kingdom (*i.*
heaven) leave must be ask

This stream must be passe
over by death.

“Deme3 þou me,” quod I, “my swete
 To dol agayn, þenne I dowyne;
 Now haf I fonte þat I for-lete
 328 Schal I efte for-go hit er euer I fyne?
 Why schal I hit boþe mysse & mete?
 My precios perle dot3 me gret pyne,
 What seruez tresor, bot gare3 men grete
 332 When he hit schal efte with tenez tyne?
 Now rech I neuer forto declyne,
 Ne how fer of folde þat man me fleme,
 11
 When I am partlez of perlez myne.
 336 Bot durande doel what may men deme?”

JUST ABIDE GOD’S DOOM.

“Thow deme3 no3t bot doel dystresse,”
 Penne sayde þat wy3t “why dot3 þou so?
 For dyne of doel, of lure3 lesse,
 340 Ofte mony mon for-gos þe mo;
 Þe o3te better þy seluen blesse,
 & loue ay god & wele & wo,
 For anger gaynez þe not a cresse.
 344 Who nede3 schal þole be not so þro;
 For þo3 þou daunce as any do
 Braundysch & bray þy braþe3 breme,
 When þou no fyrre may, to ne fro,
 348 Þou moste abyde þat he schal deme.

Deme dry3tyn, euer hym adyte,
 Of þe way a fote ne wyl he wryþe,
 Þy mende3 munte3 not a myte,
 352 Ða3 þou for sor3e be neuer blyþe;
 Stynst of þy strot & fyne to flyte,
 & sech hys blyþe ful swefte & swyþe,
 Þy prayer may hys pyte byte,
 356 Ðat mercy schal hyr crafte3 kype;
 Hys comforte may þy langour lyþe,

[Fol. 4v]

The father asks his pearl whether she is about to do him to sorrow again.

If he loses his pearl he does not care what happens to him.

The maiden tells her father to suffer patiently.

&] *in* or *an* (?).

Though he may dance as a fool, yet he must abide God's doom.

He must cease to strive.

swefte] MS. *sweste*.

& þy lure3 of lyztly leme,
For marre oþer madde, morne & myþe,
360 Al lys in hym to dyzt & deme.”

All lies in God’s power to
make men joyful or sad.

DEREAVED PARENT ASKS HIS CHILD’S PITY.

VII.

Thenne demed I to þat damyselle,
Ne worþe no wrath þe vnto my lorde,
If rapely raue spornande in spelle.
364 My herte wat3 al *with* mysse remorde,
As wallande water got3 out of welle;
I do me ay in hys myserecorde.
Rebuke me neuer *with* worde3 felle,
368 Þa3 I forloyne my dere endorde,

12

Bot lyþe3 me kyndely *your* coumforde,
Pytosly þenkande vpon þysse;
Of care & me 3e made acorde,
372 Þat er wat3 grounde of alle my blysse;

My blysse, my bale 3e han ben boþe,
Bot much þe bygger 3et wat3 my mon,
Fro þou wat3 wroken fro vch a woþe.
376 I wyste neuer quere my perle wat3 gon;
Now I hit se, now leþe3 my loþe,
& quen we departed we wern at on,
God forbede we be now wroþe,
380 We meten so selden by stok oþer ston;
Þa3 cortaysly 3e carp con,
I am bot mol & marere3 mysse,
Bot crystes mersy & mary & Ion,
384 Þise arn þe grounde of alle my blysse.

In blysse I se þe blyþely blent
& I a man al mornyf mate,
3e take þer-on ful lyttel tente,

[Fol. 4.

raue] *rane* (?).

The father beseeches the
pearl to have pity upon hi

He says that she has been
both his bale and bliss...

And when he lost her, he
knew not what had becom
of her.

And now that he sees her
bliss, she takes little heed
his sorrow.

388 Þaȝ I hente ofte harmeȝ hate.
Bot now I am here *in your* presente,
I wolde bysech wythouten debate,
Ȝe wolde me say *in* sobre asente,
392 What lyf ȝe lede, erly & late,
For I am ful fayn þat *your* astate
Is worþen to worschyp & wele I wysse,
Of alle my Ioy þe hyȝe gate
396 Hit is *in* grounde of alle my blysse.”

He desires to know what I
she leads.

“Now blysse burne mot þe bytyde;”
Pen sayde þat lufsoum of lyth & lere,
“& welcum here to walk & byde,
400 For now þy speche is to me dere;
Maysterful mod & hyȝe pryde
I hete þe arn heterly hated here;
My lorde ne loueȝ not forto chyde,
404 For meke arn alle þat woneȝ hym nere,
13
& when *in* hys place þou schal apere,
Be dep deuote *in* hol mekenesse;
My lorde þe lamb, loueȝ ay such chere,
408 Þat is þe grounde of alle my blysse.

[Fol. 4.

The maiden tells him that
may walk and abide with
now that he is humble.

All are meek that dwell in
the abode of bliss.

DESCRIBES HER MODE OF LIFE.

A blysfyl lyf þou says I lede,
Þou woldeȝ know þer-of þe stage;
Þow wost wel when þy perle con schede,
412 I watȝ ful ȝong & tender of age,
Bot my lorde þe lombe, þurȝ hys god-hede,
He toke my self to hys maryage,
Corounde me quene *in* blysse to brede,
416 *In* lenghe of dayeȝ þat euer schal wage,
& sesed *in* alle hys herytage
Hys lef is, I am holy hysse;
Hys prese, hys prys & hys parage,
420 Is rote & grounde of alle my blysse.”

All lead a blissful life.

She reminds her father that
she was very young when
she died.

Now she is crowned a que
in heaven.

VIII.

“**B**lysfyl,” *quod* I, “may þys be trwe,
Dysplesez not if I speke errour;
Art þou þe quene of heuene3 blwe,
424 Þat al þys worlde schal do honour?
We leuen on marye þat grace of grewe,
Þat ber a barne of vyrgyn flour,
Þe croune fro hyr quo mo3t remwe,
428 Bot ho hir passed in *sum* fauour?
Now for synglerty o hyr dousour,
We calle hyr fenyx of arraby,
Þat freles fle3e of hyr fasor,
432 Lyk to þe quen of cortaysye.”

“Cortayse quen” þenne s[a]lyde þat gaye,
Knelande to grounde, folde vp hyr face,
“Makelez moder & myrrest may,
436 Blessed bygynner of vch a grace!”
Þenne ros ho vp & con restay,

14

& speke me towarde in þat space:
“*Sir* fele here porchase3 & fonge3 pray
440 Bot supplantore3 none *with-inne* þys place;
Þat emperise al heuen3 hat3,
& vrþe & helle in her bayly;
Of erytage 3et non wyl ho chace,
444 For ho is quen of cortaysye.

The court of þe kyndom of god alyue,
Hat3 a *property in hyt self beyng*;
Alle þat may þer-inne aryue
448 Of alle þe reme is quen oþer kyng,

The father of the maiden
does not fully understand
her.

Mary, he says, is the quee
of heaven.

No one is able to remove
crown from her.

[Fol. 4v]

The maiden addresses the
Virgin.

bygynner] MS. reads
bȳgyner.

She then explains to her
father that each has his place
in heaven.

The court of God has a
property in its own being.

& neuer oþer 3et schal depryue,
Bot vchon fayn of oþere3 hafyng,
& wolde her coroune3 wern worþe þo fyue,
452 If possyble were her mendyng.
Bot my lady of quom Iesu con spryng,
Ho halde3 þe empyre ouer vus ful hy3e,
& þat dysplese3 non of oure gyng,
456 For ho is quene of cortaysye.

Each one in it is a king or queen.

The mother of Christ hold the chief place.

Of courtaysye, as sayt3 saynt poule,
Al arn we membre3 of ihesu kryst,
As heued & arme & legg & naule,
460 Temen to hys body ful trwe & t[r]lyste;
Ry3t so is vch a krysten sawle,
A longande lym to þe mayster of myste;
Þenne loke what hate oþer any gawle,
464 Is tached oþer tyzed þy lymme3 by-twyste,
þy heued hat3 nauþer greme ne gryste,
On arme oþer fynger, þa3 þou ber by3e;
So fare we alle wyth luf & lyste,
468 To kyng & quene by cortaysye.”

We are all members of Christ’s body.

Look that each limb be perfect.

“Cortayse,” *quod* I, “I leue
& charyte grete be yow among,
Bot my speche þat yow ne greue,
472
þy self in heuen ouer hy3 þou heue,
15
To make þe quen þat wat3 so 3onge,
What more-hond mo3te he acheue
476 þat hade endured in worlde stronge,
& lyued in penaunce hys lyue3 longe,
With bodyly bale hym blysse to byye?
What more worschyp mo3t ho fonge,
480 Þen corounde be kyng by cortayse?

[Fol. 4]

The father replies that he cannot understand how hi pearl can be a queen.

He desires to know what greater honour she can ha

That cortayse is to fre of dede,
 3yf hyt be soth þat þou cone3 saye,
 Þou lyfed not two 3er in oure þede,
 484 Þou cowþe3 neuer god nauþer plese ne pray,
 Ne neuer nawþer pater ne crede,
 & quen mad on þe fyrst day!
 I may not traw, so god me spede,
 488 Ðat god wolde wryþe so wrange away;
 Of countes damysel, par ma fay,
 Wer fayr in heuen to halde asstate
 Aþer elle3 a lady of lasse aray,
 492 Bot a quene, hit is to dere a date.”

She was only two years old when she died, and could nothing to please God.

She might be a countess or some great lady but not a queen.

The maiden informs her father that there is no limit to God's power.

“Þer is no date of hys god-nesse,”
 Þen sayde to me þat worþy wy3te,
 “For al is trawþe þat he con dresse,
 496 & he may do no þynk bot ry3t,
 As mathew mele3 in your messe,
 In sothfol gospel of god al-my3t
 In sample he can ful grayþely gesse,
 500 & lykne3 hit to heuen ly3te.”
 “My regne, he sayt3, is lyk on hy3t,
 To a lorde þat hade a uyne I wate,
 Of tyme of 3ere þe terme wat3 ty3t,
 504 To labor vyne wat3 dere þe date,

The parable of the labourers in the vineyard.

PARABLE OF THE LABOURERS IN THE VINEYARD.

Ðat date of 3ere wel knawe þys hyne;
 16
 Þe lorde ful erly vp he ros,
 To hyre werkmen to hys vyne,
 508 & fynde3 þer summe to hys porpos,
 Into acorde þay con de-clyne,
 For a pené on a day & forth þay got3,
 Wryþen & worchen & don gret pyne,
 512 Keruen & caggen & man hit clos;

[Fol. 41]

The lord of the vineyard hires workmen for a penny a day.

Aboute vnder, þe lorde to marked tot3
& ydel men stande he fynde3 þer-ate,
“Why stande 3e ydel” he sayde to þos,
516 Ne knawe 3e of þis day no date?

“Er date of daye hider arn we wonne,”
So wat3 al samen her ansvar so3t;
“We haf standen her syn ros þe sunne,
520 & no mon bydde3 *vus* do, ry3t no3t.”
“Gos in-to my vyne, dot3 þat 3e conne.”
So sayde þe lorde & made hit *to3t*.
“What resonabele hyre be na3t be runne,
524 I yow pray in dede & þo3te.”
Þay wente in to þe vyne & wro3te,
& al day þe lorde þus 3ede his gate,
& nw men to hys vyne he bro3te;
528 Wel ne3 wyl day wat3 passed date,

At þe day of date of euen-songe,
On oure byfore þe sonne go doun
He se3 þer ydel men ful stronge
532 & sa[y]de to *hem* with sobre soun;
“Wy stonde 3e ydel þise daye3 longe.”
Þay sayden her hyre wat3 nawhere boun.
“Got3 to my vyne 3emen 3onge
536 & wyrke3 & dot3 þat at 3e *moun*.”
Sone þe worlde by-com wel broun,
Þe sunne wat3 doun & hit wex late;
To take her hyre he mad sumoun;
540 Þe day wat3 al apassed date.

17

AYMENT OF THE LABOURERS.

X.

The date of þe daye þe lorde con knaw,
Called to þe reue “lede pay þe meyny,

At noon the lord hires oth
men standing idle in the
market place.

He commands them to go
into his vineyard, and he
give them what is right.

At an hour before the sun
went down the lord sees
other men standing idle.

hem] MS. *hen*.

Tells them to go into the
vineyard.

&] MS. & &.

Gyf hem þe hyre þat I hem owe,
544 & fyrre, þat non me may repreue,
Set hem alle vpon a rawe,
& gyf vchon in-lyche a peny.
Bygyn at þe laste þat stande3 lowe,
548 Tyl to þe fyrste þat þou atteny;”
& þenne þe fyrst by-gonne to pleny
& sayden þat þay hade trauayled sore,
Þese bot an [h]oure hem con streny,
552 *Vus þynk vus o3e to take more.*

More haf we serued *vus þynk* so,
Þat suffred han þe daye3 hete,
Þenn þyse þat wro3t[e] not houre3 two,
556 & þou dot3 hem *vus* to counterfete.
Þenne sayde þe lorde to on of þo,
“Frende no wrang I wyl þe 3ete,
Take þat is þyn owne & go;
560 & I hyred þe for a peny a grete,
Quy bygynne3 þou now to þrete;
Wat3 not a pené þy couenaunt þore?
Fyrre þen couenaunde is no3t to plete,
564 Wy schalte þou þenne ask more?

More weþer louyly is me my gyfte
To do wyth myn quat so me lyke3?
Oþer elle3 þyn y3e to lyþer is lyfte,
568 For I am goude & non by-swyke3.”
“Þus schal I,” *quod* kryste, “hit skyfte,
Þe laste schal be þe fyrst þat stryke3,
& þe fyrst þe laste, be he neuere so swyft,
572 For mony ben calle[d] þa3 fewe be myke3.”
Þus pore men her part ay pyke3,
Þa3 þay com late & lyttel wore,
18
& þa3 her sweng wyth lyttel at-slyke3,
576 Þe merci of god is much þe more.

As soon as the sun was gone
down the “reeve” was told
to pay the workmen.

[Fol. 4v]

To give each a penny.

The first began to complain

Having borne the heat of the day
he thinks that he
deserves more.

wrang] MS. *wanig*.

The lord tells him that he
agreed only to give him a
penny.

The last shall be first, and
the first last.

The maiden applies the
parable to herself.

“More haf I of ioie & blysse here-inne,
 Of ladyschyp gret & lyue3 blom,
 Þen alle þe wy3e3 in þe worlde my3t wyne
 580 By þe way of ry3t to aske dome.
 Wheþer wel nygh[t] now I con bygynne,
 In euentyde in-to þe vyne I come,
 Fyrst of my hyre my lorde con mynne,
 584 I wat3 payed anon of al & sum;
 3et oþer þer werne þat toke more tom,
 Þat swange & swat for long 3ore,
 Þat 3et of hyre no þynk þay nom,
 588 Paraunter no3t schal to 3ere more.”

Then more I meled & sayde apert,
 “Me þynk þy tale vnresounable,
 Godde3 ry3t is redy & euer more rert,
 592 Oþer holy wryt is bot a fable;
 In sauter is sayd a verce ouerte
 Þat speke3 a poynt determynable,
 ‘Þou quyte3 vchon as hys desserte,
 596 Þou hy3e kyng ay pretermynable,’
 Now he þat stod þe long day stable,
 & þou to payment com hym byfore,
 Þenne þe lasse in werke to take more able,
 600 & euer þe lenger þe lasse þe more.”

S NO NIGGARD.

XI.

“Of more & lasse in gode3 ryche,”
 Þat gentyl sayde “lys no Ioparde,
 For þer is vch mon payed inliche,
 604 Wheþer lyttel oþer much be hys rewarde,
 For þe gentyl cheuentayn is no chyche,

[Fol. 4]

She came to the vine in
 eventide, and yet received
 more than others who had
 lived longer.

The father says that his
 daughter's tale is
 unreasonable.

rert] ert (?).

pretermynable] MS.
pertermynable.

In heaven, the maiden say
 each man is paid alike.

Queper-so-euer he dele nesch oþer harde,
He laue3 hys gyfte3 as water of dyche,
608 Oþer gote3 of golf þat neuer charde;

19

Hys fraunchyse is large þat euer dard,
To hym þat mat3 in synne no scoghe
No blysse bet3 fro hem reparde,
612 For þe grace of god is gret I-noghe.

Bot now þou mote3 me for to mate
Þat I my peny haf wrang tan here,
Þou say3 þat I þat com to late,
616 Am not worþy so gret lere.
Where wyste3 þou euer any bourne abate
Euer so holy in hys prayere,
Þat he ne forfeþed by sumkyn gate,
620 Þe mede sum-tyme of heuene3 clere;
& ay þe ofter, þe alder þay were,
Þay laften ry3t & wro3ten woghe
Mercy & grace moste hem þen stere,
624 For þe grace of god is gret in-no3e.

Bot in-noghe of grace hat3 innocent,
As sone as þay arn borne by lyne
In þe water of babtem þay dysseþte,
628 Þen arne þay boro3t in-to þe vyne,
Anon þe day *with* derk endente,
Þe my3t of deth dot3 to en-clyne
Þat wro3t neuer wrang er þenne þay wente;
632 Þe gentyle lorde þenne paye3 hys hyne,
Þay dyden hys heste, þay wern þere-ine,
Why schulde he not her labour alow,
3y[rd] & pay hem at þe fyrst fyne
636 For þe grace of god is gret in-noghe?

DISE WAS LOST THROUGH AN APPLE.

Ino3e is knawen þat man-kyn grete,

gyfte3] MS. *gyste3*.

God is no niggard.

no scoghe] In the MS. i
looks like *rescoghe*.

The grace of God is
sufficient for all.

[Fol. 4'

Those who live long on th
earth often forfeit heaven
sinning.

Innocents are saved by
baptism.

Why should not God allow
their labour.

hem] MS. *hym*.

Fyrste wat3 wro3t to blysse parfyt;
Oure forme-fader hit con forfeite,
640 Þur3 an apple þat he vpon con byte;
Al wer we dampned for þat mete,
To dy3e in doel out of delyt,
& syþen wende to helle hete,
644 Þer-inne to won with-oute respyt;

20

Bot þer on com a bote as-tyt.
Ryche blod ran on rode so roghe,
& wynne [&] water, þen at þat plyt
648 Þe grace of god wex gret in-noghe.

Innoghe þer wax out of þat welle,
Blod & water of brode wounde;
Þe blod *vus* bo3t fro bale of helle,
652 & delyuered *vus* of þe deth secounde;
Þe water is baptem þe soþe to telle;
Þat fol3ed þe glayue so grymly grounde,
Þat wasche3 away þe gylte3 felle,
656 Þat adam wyth inne deth *vus* drounde.
Now is þer no3t in þe worlde rounde
Bytwene *vus* & blysse bot þat he with-dro3
& þat is restored in sely stounde,
660 & þe grace of god is gret in-nogh.

XII.

Grace in-nogh þe mon may haue,
Þat synne3 þenne new, 3if hym repente,
Bot with sor3 & syt he mot hit craue,
664 & byde þe payne þer-to is bent,
Bot resoun of ry3t þat con not raue,
Saue3 euer more þe innossent;
Hit is a dom þat neuer god gaue,
668 Þat euer þe gyltle3 schulde be schente.

Our first father lost heave
by eating an apple.

And all are damned for th
sin of Adam.

But there came one who p
the penalty of our sins.

[Fol. 41

out] MS. *out out*.

The water that came from
the pierced side of Christ
was baptism.

Repentance must be sougl
by prayer with sorrow and
affliction.

Be gyltyf may contrysyoun hente
& be þurȝ mercy to grace þryȝt;
Bot he to gyle þat neuer glente,
672 At in-oscente is saf & ryȝte.

CENTS ARE SAVED BY RIGHT.

Ryȝt þus I know wel in þis cas,
Two men to saue is god by skylle;
Be ryȝt-wys man schal se hys face,
676 Be harmleȝ hapel schal com hym tylle,
Be sauter hyt satȝ þus in a pace:
“Lorde quo schal klymbe þy hyȝ hylleȝ
21
Oþer rest *with-inne* þy holy place?”
680 Hymself to on-sware he is not dylle;
“Hondelyngeȝ harme þat dyt not ille,
þat is of hert boþe clene & lyȝt,
þer schal hys step stable styлле,”
684 Be innosent is ay saf by ryȝt.

The ryȝtwys man also sertayn
Aproche he schal þat proper pyle,
þat takeȝ not her lyf in vayne
688 Ne glauereȝ her nieȝbor wyth no gyle;
Of þys ryȝt-wys saȝ salamon playn,
How kyntly oure con aquyle
By wayeȝ ful streȝt he con hym strayn,
692 & scheued hym þe rengne of god a whyle,
As quo says “lo ȝon louely yle,
þou may hit wynne if þou be wyȝte,”
Bot hardyly *with-oute* peryle,
696 Be innosent is ay saue by ryȝte!

An-ende ryȝtwys men, ȝet saytȝ a gome
Dauid in sauter, if euer ȝe seȝ hit,
“Lorde þy seruauȝt draȝ neuer to dome,
700 For non lyuyunde to þe is Iustyfyet.”

The guilty may be saved by
contrition.

þus] MS. þus þus.

Two sorts of people are
saved, the *righteous* and the
innocent.

face] MS. fate.

The words of David.

The innocent is saved by
right.

[Fol. 4v]

saȝ] satȝ (?).

The words of Solomon.

David says no man living
justified.

For] MS. sor.

For-þy to corte quen þou schal com,
þer alle oure cause3 schal be tryed,
Alegge þe ry3t þou may be *in-nome*,
704 By þys ilke spech I haue asspyed;
Bot he on rode þat bloody dyed,
Delfully þur3 honde3 þry3t
Gyue þe to passe when þou arte tryed
708 By innocens & not by ry3te.

Pray to be saved by
innocence and not by righ

ST BLESSED LITTLE CHILDREN.

Ry3t-wysly quo con rede,
He loke on bok & be awayed
How Ihesuc hym welke in are þede,
712 & burne3 her barne3 vnto hym brayde,
For happe & hele þat fro hym 3ede,
To touch her chylder þay fayr hym prayed.

When Jesus was on earth,
little children were broug
unto him.

touch] MS. *touth*.

22
His dessypele3 *with* blame let be hym bede,
716 & wyth her resoune3 ful fele restayed;
Ihesuc þenne hem swetely sayde,
“Do way, let chylder vnto me ty3t.
To suche is heuen-ryche arayed,”
720 Þe *innocent* is ay saf by ry3t.

The disciples rebuked the
parents.

Christ said, “Suffer little
children to come unto me,
etc.

XIII.

Ihesuc con calle to hym hys mylde
& sayde hys ryche no wy3 my3t wyne.
Bot he com þyder ry3t as a chylde,
724 Oþer elle3 neuer more com þer-inne,
Harmle3, trwe & vnde-fylde,
With-outen mote oþer mascle of sulpande synne;
Quen such þer cnoken on þe bylde,
728 Tyt schal hem men þe 3ate vnpynne,
þer is þe blys þat con not blynne,

[Fol. 4]

No one can win heaven
except he be meek as a ch

þat þe lueler soʒte þurʒ perre pres
& solde alle hys goud boþe wolen & lynne,
732 To bye hym a perle [þat] watʒ mascelleʒ.

This makelleʒ perle þat boʒt is dere,
þe loueler gef fore alle hys god,
Is lyke þe reme of heuenesse clere
736 So sayde þe fader of folde & flode,
For hit is wemleʒ, clene & clere,
& endeleʒ rounde & blyþe of mode,
& commune to alle þat ryʒtwys were,
740 Lo! euen in myddeʒ my breste hit stode;
My lorde þe lombe þat schede hys blode,
He pyʒt hit þere in token of pes;
I rede þe forsake þe worlde wode,
744 & porchace þy perle maskelles.”

AKE THE MAD WORLD.

“O maskeleʒ perle in perleʒ pure
þat bereʒ,” *quod* I, “þe perle of prys,
Quo formed þe þy fayre fygure?
748 Þat wroʒt þy wede, he watʒ ful wys;
23
þy beaute com neuer of nature,
Pymalyon paynted neuer þy vys,
Ne arystotel nawþer by hys lettrure
752 Of carpe þe kynde þese properteʒ.
þy colour passeʒ þe flour-de-lys,
þyn angel hauyng so clene corteʒ
Breue me bryʒt, quat-kyn of priys
756 Bereʒ þe perle so maskelleʒ.”

“My makeleʒ lambe þat al may bete,”
Quod scho, “my dere destyné
Me ches to hys make al-þaʒ vnmete,
760 Sum tyme semed þat assemblé
When I wente fro yor worlde wete.

The pearl of price is like t
kingdom of heaven, pure &
clean.

ryʒtwys] MS. *ryʒtywys*.

Forsake the mad world an
purchase the spotless pear

The father of the maiden
desires to know who form
her figure and wrought he
garments.

Her beauty, he says, is not
natural.

Her colour passes the fleu
de-lis.

priys] The MS. has *triy*:

[Fol. 4^r

The maiden explains to he
father that she is a bride o
Christ.

He calde me to hys bonerté,
 ‘Cum hyder to me my lemman swete,
 764 For mote ne spot is non in þe:’
 He gef me myȝt & als bewté.
 In hys blod he wesch my wede on dese,
 & coronde clene in vergynté,
 768 & pyȝt me in perlez maskelleȝ.”

“Why maskelleȝ bryd þat bryȝt con flambe
 þat reiateȝ hatȝ so ryche & ryf,
 Quat-kyn þyng may be þat lambe,
 772 þat þe wolde wedde vnto hys vyf?
 Ouer alle oþer so hyȝ þou clambe,
 To lede with hym so ladyly lyf
 So mony a cumly on vnder cambe,
 776 For kryst han lyued in much stryf,
 & þou con alle þo dere out-dryf,
 & fro þat maryag al oþer depres,
 Al only þyself so stout & styf,
 780 A makeleȝ may & maskelleȝ.”

She is without spot or
 blemish.

Her weeds are washed in
 blood of Christ.

The father asks the nature
 the Lamb that has chosen
 daughter,

and why she is selected as
 bride.

AMB AND HIS BRIDES.

XIV.

“**M**askelles,” quod þat myry quene,
 “Vnblemyst I am wyth-outen blot,
 24
 & þat may I with mensk menteene;
 784 Bot makeleȝ quene þenne sade I not,
 Þe lambes vyueȝ in blysse we bene,
 A hondred & forty þowsande flot
 As in þe apocalyppeȝ hit is sene;
 788 Sant Iohan hem syȝ al in a knot,
 On þe hyl of syon þat semly clot.
 Þe apostel hem segh in gostly drem
 Arayed to þe weddyng in þat hyl coppe,

The Lamb has one hundre
 and forty thousand brides.

St. John saw them on the
 of Sion in a dream, in the
 new city of Jerusalem.

792 Þe nwe cyte u Ierusalem.

Of Ierusalem I in speche spelle.
If þou wyl know what-kyn he be,
My lombe, my lorde, my dere luelle,
796 My ioy, my blys, my lemman fre,
Þe profete ysaye of hym con melle,
Pitously of hys debonerté
Þat glorious gyltle3 þat mon con quelle,
800 *With*-outen any sake of felonye,
As a schep to þe sla3t þer lad wat3 he
& as lombe þat clypper in lande nem,
So closed he hys mouth fro vch query,
804 Quen lue3 hym iugged in Iherusalem.

In Ierusalem wat3 my lemman slayn
& rent on rode *with* boye3 bolde;
Al oure bale3 to bere ful bayn,
808 He toke on hym self oure care3 colde,
With boffete3 wat3 hys face flayn,
Þat wat3 so fayr on to byholde;
For synne he set hym self in vayn,
812 Þat neuer hade non hym self to wolde,
For vus he lette hym fly3e & folde
& brede vpon a bostwys bem,
As meke as lomb þat no playnt tolde.
816 *For vus* he swalt in Ierusalem:

AMB WAS SLAIN IN JERUSALEM.

Ierusalem, Iordan & galalye,
Þer as baptysed þe goude saynt Ion,
25
His worde3 acorded to ysaye;
820 When Ihesuc con to hym warde gon
He sayde of hym þys professye,
“Lo gode3 lombe as trwe as ston,
Þat dot3 away þe synne3 dry3e!”

[Fol. 5]

Isaiah speaks of Christ or Lamb.

gyltle3] MS. reads *gystl*
He says that He was led a lamb to the slaughter.

nem] MS. *men*.

In Jerusalem was Christ slain.

With buffets was His face flayed.

He endured all patiently a lamb.

lomb] The MS. reads *lomp*.

For us He died in Jerusale

The declaration of St. Joh
“Behold the Lamb of God etc.

824 Þat alle þys worlde hat3 wro3t vpon,
Hym self ne wro3t neuer 3et non,
Wheþer on hym self he con al clem,
Hys generacyoun quo recen con,
828 Þat dy3ed for *vus* in Ierusalem?

Who can reckon His
generation, that died in
Jerusalem?

[Fol. 50v]

In Ierusalem þus my lemman swatte,
Tweye3, for lombe wat3 taken þere,
By trw recorde of ayþer prophete,
832 For mode so meke & al hys fare,
Þe þryde tyme is þer-to ful mete
In apokalype3 wryten ful 3are.
In myde3 þe trone þere saynte3 sete,
836 Þe apostel iohan hym sayt3 as bare,
Lesande þe boke with leue3 sware,
Þere seuen syngnette3 wern sette *in-sume*
& at þat sy3t vche douth con dare,
840 In helle, in erþe & Ierusalem.

In the New Jerusalem St.
John saw the Lamb sitting
upon the throne.

XV.

Thys Ierusalem lombe hade neuer pechche
Of oþer huee bot quyt Iolyf
Þat mot ne masklle mo3t on streche
844 For wolle quyte so ronk & ryf,
For-þy vche saule þat hade neuer teche,
Is to þat lombe a worthyly wyf;
And þa3 vch day a store he feche,
848 Among *vus comme3* non oþer strot ne stryf,
Bot vchon enle we wolde were fyf,
Þe mo þe myryer so god me blesse.
In compayny gret our luf con þryf
852 In honour more & neuer þe lesse.

The Lamb is without
blemish.

teche] MS. *tethe*.

Every spotless soul is a
worthy bride for the Lamb

No strife or envy among the
brides.

vchon enle] *vch onlepi*

26

Lasse of blysse may non *vus* bryng

None can have less bliss than
another.

Pat beren þys perle vpon oure bereste,
 For þay of mote couþe neuer mynge,
 856 Of spotlez perlez þa[y] beren þe creste,
 Al-þa3 oure corses in clottez clynge,
 & 3e remen for rauþe wyth-ouen reste,
 We þur3-outly hauen cnawyng;
 860 Of [o]n dethe ful oure hope is drest,
 Þe lonbe *vus* glade3, oure care is kest;
 He myrþe3 *vus* alle at vch a mes,
 Vchone3 blysse is breme & beste,
 864 & neuer one3 honour 3et neuer þe les.

Our death leads us to bliss

VISION OF SAINT JOHN.

Lest les þou leue my tale farande,
 In appocalyppece is wryten *in wro*
 I seghe, says Iohan, þe lombe hym stande,
 868 On þe mount of syon ful þryuen & þro,
 & wyth hym maydenne3 an hundreþe þowsande
 & fowre & forty þowsande mo
 On alle her forhede3 wryten I fande,
 872 Þe lombe3 nome, hys fadere3 also.
 A hue fro heuen I herde þoo,
 Lyk flode3 fele laden, runnen on resse,
 & as þunder þrowe3 in torre3 blo,
 876 Þat lote I leue wat3 neuer þe les.

[Fol. 5.

tale] MS. *talle*, but *tale*
the catchwords.

What St. John saw upon the
Mount of Sion.

About the Lamb he saw o
hundred and forty thousar
maidens.

He heard a voice from
heaven, like many floods.

Nauþeles þa3 hit schowted scharpe,
 & ledden loude al-þa3 hit were.
 A note ful nwe I herde hem warpe,
 880 To lysten þat wat3 ful lufly dere,
 As harpore3 harpen in her harpe,
 Þat nwe songe þay songen ful cler.
 In sounande note3 a gentyl carpe,
 884 Ful fayre þe mode3 þay fonge in fere
 Ry3t byfore gode3 chayere,
 & þe fowre beste3 þat hym obes,
 & þe alder-men so sadde of chere,

He heard the maiden sing
new song.

So did the four beasts and
the elders “so sad of cheer

888 Her songe þay songen neuer þe les;

27

Now þe-lese non wat3 neuer so quoynt,
For alle þe crafte3 þat euer þay knewe.
Þat of þat songe my3t synge a poynt,
892 Bot þat meyny þe lombe þay swe,
For þay arn bo3t fro þe vrþe aloynte.
As newe fryt to god ful due
& to þe gentyl lombe hit arn amoynt,
896 As lyk to hym self of lote & hwe,
For neuer lesyng ne tale vn-trwe,
Ne towched her tonge for no dysstresse.
Þat moteles meyny may neuer remwe,
900 Fro þat maskele3 mayster neuer þe les.”

This assembly was like th
Lamb, spotless and pure.

“Neuer þe les let be my þonc,”
Quod I, “my perle þa3 I appose,
I schulde not tempte þy wyt so wlonc,
904 To kryste3 chambre þat art Ichose,
I am bot mokke & mul among,
& þou so ryche a reken rose,
& byde3 here by þys blysful bonc
908 Ðer lyue3 lyste may neuer lose,
Now hynde þat sympelnesse cone3 enclose,
I wolde þe aske a þynge expresse,
& þa3 I be bustwys as a blose
912 Let my bone vayl neuer þe lese.

[Fol. 5

The father replies to the
maiden.

He says he is but dust and
ashes.

He wishes to ask one
question,

.BODE OF CHRIST’S BRIDES.

XVI.

Neuer þe lese cler I yow by-calle
If 3e con se hyt be to done,
As þou art glorious *with-ou*ten galle,
916 With-nay þou neuer my ruful bone.
Haf 3e no wone3 *in* castel walle,

Ne maner þer 3e may mete & won?
Þou telle3 me of Ierusalem þe ryche ryalle,
920 Þer dauid dere wat3 dy3t on trone,
Bot by þyse holtez hit con not hone
Bot in Iudee hit is þat noble note;

28

As 3e ar maskelez vnder mone,
924 *Your* wone3 schulde by wyth-uten mote.

Þys motelez meyny þou cone3 of mele,
Of þousande3 þry3t so gret a route,
A gret cete, for 3e arn fele,
928 Yow by-hod haue *with*-uten doute;
So cumly a pakke of Ioly Iuele,
Wer euel don schulde ly3 þer-oute;
& by þyse bonkez þer I con gele
932 & I se no bygyng nawhere aboute,
I trowe al-one 3e lenge & loute,
To loke on þe glory of þys grac[i]ous gote;
If þou hat3 oþer lygynge3 stoute,
936 Now tech me to þat myry mote.

“That mote þou mene3 in Iudy londe,”
Þat specyal spyce þen to me spakk,
“Þat is þe cyte þat þe lombe con fonde
940 To soffer inne sor for mane3 sake,
Þe olde Ierusalem to vnder-stonde,
For þere þe olde gulte wat3 don to slake,
Bot þe nwe þat ly3t of gode3 sonde,
944 Þe apostel in apocalyppe *in* theme con take.
Þe lombe þer, *with*-uten spottez blake,
Hat3 feryed þyder hys fayre flote,
& as hys flok is *with*-uten flake,
948 So is hys mote *with*-uten moote.

OLD AND NEW JERUSALEM.

Of motes two to carpe clene

whether the brides have th
abode in castle-walls or in
manor.

Jerusalem, he says, in Jud

But the dwelling of the
brides should be perfect.

For such “a comely pack”
great castle would be
required.

[Fol. 5:

The city in Judæa, answer
the maiden, is where Chri
suffered, and is the Old
Jerusalem.

The New Jerusalem is wh
the Lamb has assembled t
brides.

lombe] The MS. reads
lompe.

& Ierusalem hyȝt boþe nawþeles,
 Þat nys to yow no more to mene,
 952 Bot cete of god oþer syȝt of pes.
 In þat on oure pes watȝ mad at ene,
 With payne to suffer þe lombe hit chese,
 In þat oþer is noȝt bot pes to glene,
 956 Þat ay schal laste with-uten reles,
 Þat is þe borȝ þat we to pres,
 Fro þat oure flesch be layd to rote;
 29
 Þer glory & blysse schal euer encres,
 960 To þe meyny þat is with-uten mote.

Jerusalem means the city of God.

In the Old city our peace was made at one.

In the New city is eternal peace.

flesch] MS. *fresth*.

XVII.

“**M**oteleȝ may so meke & mylde,”
 Þen sayde I to þat lufly flor,
 “Bryng me to þat bygly bylde,
 964 & let me se þy blysfyl bor.”
 Þat schene sayde, þat god wyl schylde,
 “Þou may not enter *with-inne* hys tor,
 Bot of þe lombe I haue þe aquylde
 968 For a syȝt þer-of þurȝ gret fauor.
 Vt-wyth to se þat clene cloystor,
 Þou may, bot *inwyth* not a fote,
 To strech in þe strete þou hatȝ no vygour,
 972 Bot þou wer clene *with-uten* mote.

The father prays his daughter to bring him to the blissful bower.

His daughter tells him that he shall see the outside,

but not a foot may he put into the city.

XVIII.

If I þis mote þe schal vn-hyde,
 Bow vp to-warde þys borneȝ heued,
 & I an-endeȝ þe on þis syde
 976 Schal sve, tyl þou to a hil be veued,

[Fol. 5v]

The maiden then tells her father to go along the bank till he comes to a hill.

þen wolde [I] no lenger byde,
Bot lurked by launce3 so lufly leued,
Tyl on a hyl þat I asspyed
980 & blusched on þe burghe, as I forth dreued,
By-3onde þe brok fro me warde keued,
þat schyrrer þen sunne *with* schafte3 schon;
In þe apokalypce is þe fasoun preued,
984 As deuyse3 hit þe apostel Ihoñ.

He reaches the hill, and
beholds the heavenly city.

DESCRIPTION OF THE NEW JERUSALEM.

As Iohan þe apostel hit sy3 *with* sy3t
I sy3e þat cyty of gret renoun,
Ierusalem so nwe & ryally dy3t,
988 As hit wat3 ly3t fro þe heuen adoun.
þe bor3 wat3 al of brende golde bry3t,
As glemande glas burnist broun,
30
With gentyl gemme3 an-vnder py3t;
992 *With* bantele3 twelue on basyng boun,
þe foundementē3 twelue of riche tenoun;
Vch tabelment wat3 a serlype3 ston,
As derely deuyse3 þis ilk toun,
996 In apocalyppe3 þe apostel Iohan.

As St. John saw it, so he
beheld it.

The city was of burnished
gold.

Pitched upon gems,

the foundation composed
twelve stones.

As þise stone3 in writ con nemme
I knew þe name after his tale;
Iasper hy3t þe fyrst gemme,
1000 þat I on þe fyrst basse con wale,
He glente grene in þe lowest hemme.
Saffer helde þe secounde stale,
þe calsydoyne þenne *with*-outen wemme,
1004 In þe þryd table con purly pale;
þe emerade þe furþe so grene of scale;
þe sardonysē þe fyfþe ston;
þe sexte þe rybe he con hit wale,
1008 In þe apocalyppe3 þe apostel Iohan.

The names of the precious
stones.

i. Jasper.

ii. Sapphire.

iii. Chalcedony.

iv. Emerald.

v. Sardonyx.

vi. Ruby.

3et Ioyned Iohan þe crysolyt,
 þe seuenþe gemme *in* fundament;
 þe a3tþe þe beryl cler & quyt
 1012 þe topasye twynne how þe nente endent;
 þe crysopase þe tenþe is ty3t;
 þe Iacyngh þe enleuenþe gent;
 þe twelfþe þe gentyleste *in* veh a plyt,
 1016 þe amatyst purple *with* ynde blente;
 þe wal abof þe bantels bent,
 Masporye as glas þat glysnande schon,
 I knew hit by his deuysement,
 1020 *In* þe apocalyppe3 þe apostel Iohan.

As Iohan deuysed 3et sa3 I þare.
 Þise twelue de-gres wern brode & stayre,
 þe cyte stod abof ful sware,
 1024 As longe as brode as hy3e ful fayre;
 þe strete3 of golde as glasse al bare,
 þe wal of Iasper þat glent as glayre;
 31
 þe wone3 *with-inne* enurned ware
 1028 Wyth alle kynne3 perre þat mo3t repayre,
 Þenne helde vch sware of þis manayre,
 Twelue forlonge space er euer hit fon,
 Of he3t, of brede, of lenþe to cayre,
 1032 For meten hit sy3 þe apostel Iohan.

JN NOR MOON IN HEAVEN.

XIX.

As Iohan hym wryte3 3et more I sy3e
 Vch pane of þat place had þre 3ate3,
 So twelue *in* poursent I con asspye
 1036 þe portale3 pyked of rych plate3
 & vch 3ate of a margyrye,
 A parfyt perle þat neuer fate3;

[Fol. 5:

vii. Chrysolite.

viii. Beryl.

ix. Topaz.

x. Chrysoprasus.

Iacyngh] *Iacynth* (?).

xi. Jacinth.

xii. Amethyst.

The city was square.

The wall was of jasper.

Twelve thousand furlongs
length and breadth.

Each "pane" had three gat

Each gate adorned with a
pearl.

Vchon in scrypture a name con plye,
1040 Of israel barne3 folewande her date3,
Bat is to say as her byrþ whate3;
Be aldest ay fyrst þer-on wat3 done.
Such lyzt þer lemed in alle þe strate3
1044 Hem nedde nawþer sunne ne mone.

Of sunne ne mone had þay no nede
Be self god wat3 her lompe lyzt,
Be lombe her lantyrne *with*-outen drede,
1048 Þur3 hym blysned þe bor3 al bryzt.
Þur3 wo3e & won my lokyng zede,
For sotyle cler mozt lette no lyzt;
Be hy3e trone þer mozt 3e hede
1052 *With* alle þe apparaylmente vmbe-py3te,
As Iohan þe appostel in terme3 tyzte;
Be hy3e gode3 self hit set vpone.
A reuer of þe trone þer ran out-ryzte
1056 Wat3 bryzter þen boþe þe sunne & mone.

CHURCH IN HEAVEN.

Sunne ne mone schon neuer so swete;
A! þat foyssoun flode out of þat flet,
Swyþe hit swange þur3 vch a strete,
1060 *With*-outen fylþe oþer galle oþer glet.
32
Kyrk þer-inne wat3 non 3ete,
Chapel ne temple þat euer wat3 set,
Be al-my3ty wat3 her mynyster mete,
1064 Be lombe þe saker-fyse þer to reget;
Be 3ates stoken wat3 neuer 3et,
Bot euer more vpen at vche a lone;
Ber entre3 non to take reset,
1068 Þat bere3 any spot an-vnder mone.

The mone may þer-of acroche no myzte
To spotty, ho is of body to grym,

Such light gleamed in all the
streets, that there was no
need of the sun or moon.

[Fol. 5v]

lompe] MS. *lombe*.

God was the light of those
the city.

mozt] MS. *nozt*.

The high throne might be
seen, upon which the "high
God" sat.

A river ran out of the thro

it flowed through each str

No church was seen.

God was the church; Christi
the sacrifice.

The gates were ever open.

an-vnder] MS. *an-vnde*.

& al-so þer ne is neuer nyȝt.
 1072 What schulde þe mone þer compas clym
 & to euen wyth þat worþly lyȝt,
 Þat schyneȝ vpon þe brokeȝ brym?
 Þe planeteȝ arn in to pouer a plyȝt,
 1076 & þe self sunne ful fer to dym.
 Aboute þat water arn tres ful schym,
 Þat twelue fryteȝ of lyf con bere ful sone;
 Twelue syþeȝ on ȝer þay beren ful frym
 1080 & re-nowleȝ nwe in vche a mone.

An-vnder mone so gret merwayle
 No fleschly hert ne myȝt endeure,
 As quen I blusched vpon þat baly,
 1084 So ferly þer-of watȝ þe falure.
 I stod as styлле as dased quayle,
 For ferly of þat french fygure,
 Þat felde I nawþer reste ne trauayle,
 1088 So watȝ I rauyste wyth glymme pure;
 For I dar say, *with* conciens sure,
 Hade bodyly burne abiden þat bone,
 Þaȝ alle clerkeȝ hym hade in cure,
 1092 His lyf wer loste an-vnder mone.

CESSION OF VIRGINS.

XX.

Ryȝt as þe maynful mone con rys,
 Er þenne þe day-glem dryue al doun,
 33
 So sodanly on a wonder wyse,
 1096 I watȝ war of a prosessyoun,
 Þis noble cite of ryche enpresse
 Watȝ sodanly ful *with*-outen sommoun
 Of such vergyneȝ in þe same gyse
 1100 Þat watȝ my blysful an-vnder croun,

There is no night in the ci

lyȝt] Or *syȝt*.

The planets, and the sun
 itself, are dim compared to
 the divine light.

Trees there renew their fr
 every month.

[Fol. 5.

The beholder of this fair c
 stood still as a “dased qua
french] *fresch* (?).

As the moon began to rise
 was aware of a proccession

of virgins crowned with
 pearls,

& coronde wern alle of þe same fasoun
Depaynt in perlez & wedez qwyte,
In vchone3 breste wat3 bounden boun,
1104 þe blysful perle with gret delyt.

With gret delyt þay glod in fere,
On golden gate3 þat glent as glasse;
Hundreth þowsande3 I wot þer were,
1108 & alle in sute her liure3 wasse,
Tor to know þe gladdest chere.
þe lombe byfore con proudly passe,
Wyth horne3 seuen of red golde cler,
1112 As praysed perlez his wedez wasse;
Towarde þe throne þay trone a tras.
þa3 þay wern fele no pres in plyt,
Bot mylde as maydene3 seme at mas,
1116 So dro3 þay forth with gret delyt.

Delyt þat hys come encroched,
To much hit were of for to melle;
þise alder men quen he aproched,
1120 Grouelyng to his fete þay felle;
Legyounes of aungelez togeder uoched,
þer kesten ensens of swete smelle,
þen glory & gle wat3 nwe abroched.
1124 Al songe to loue þat gay luelle,
þe steuen mo3t stryke þur3 þe vrþe to helle,
þat þe vertues of heuen of Ioye endyte,
To loue þe lombe his meyny in melle,
1128 I-wysse I la3t a gret delyt;

Delit þe lombe forto deuise,
With much meruayle in mynde went.

34

Best wat3 he, blyþest & moste to pryse,
1132 þat euer I herde of speche spent,
So worþly whyt wern wedez hys;
His loke3 symple, hym self so gent,
Bot a wounde ful wyde & weete con wyse

in white robes,
with a pearl in their breast
with gret] MS. with out

As they went along they
shone as glass.

The Lamb went before the
golde] MS. glode.

There was no pressing.

[Fol. 5.

The "alder men" fell
groveling at the feet of the
Lamb.

All sang in praise of the
Lamb.

The Lamb wore white
weeds.

1136 An-ende hys hert þurȝ hyde to-rente;
Of his quyte syde his blod out-sprent,
A-las! þoȝt I, who did þat spyt?
Ani breste for bale aȝt haf for-brent,
1140 Er he þer-to hade had delyt,

A wide wound was seen n
his breast.

SHES TO CROSS THE STREAM.

The lombe delyt non lyste to wene,
þaȝ he were hurt & wounde hade,
In his sembelaunt watȝ neuer sene,
1144 So wern his glenteȝ glorious glade.
I loked among his meyny schene,
How þay wyth lyf wern laste & lade,
þen saȝ I þer my lyttel quene,
1148 þat I wende had standen by me in sclade;
Lorde! much of mirþe watȝ þat ho made,
Among her fereȝ þat watȝ so quyt!
þat syȝt me gart to þenk to wade,
1152 For luf longyng in gret delyt.

Joy was in his looks.

The father perceives his li
queen.

XXI.

Delyt me drof in yȝe & ere,
My maneȝ mynde to maddyng malte;
Quen I seȝ my frely I wolde be þere,
1156 Byȝonde þe water, þaȝ ho were walte,
I þoȝt þat no þyng myȝt me dere
To fech me bur & take me halte;
& to start in þe strem schulde non me stere,
1160 To swymme þe remnaunt, þaȝ I þer swalte,
Bot of þat munt I watȝ bi-talt;
When I schulde start in þe strem astraye,
Out of þat caste I watȝ by-calt;
1164 Hit watȝ not at my prynceȝ paye,

[Fol. 5]

Great delight takes
possession of his mind.

He attempts to cross the
stream.

It was not pleasing to the
Lord.

Hit payed hym not þat I so flonc,
 Ouer meruelous mereȝ so mad arayde,
 Of raas þaȝ I were rasch & ronk,
 1168 Ȝet rapely þer-inne I watȝ restayed;
 For ryȝt as I sparred vn-to þe bonc,
 Þat brathe out of my drem me brayde;
 Þen wakned I in þat erber wlonk,
 1172 My hede vpon þat hylle watȝ layde,
 Þer as my perle to grounde strayd;
 I raxled & fel in gret affray,
 & sykyng to my self I sayd:
 1176 “Now al be to þat prynceȝ paye.”

The dreamer awakes,

and is in great sorrow.

Me payed ful ille to be out-fleme,
 So sodenly of þat fayre regioun,
 Fro alle þo syȝteȝ so quykeȝ & queme.
 1180 A longeyng heuy me strok in swone,
 & rewfully þenne I con to reme;
 “O perle,” *quod* I, “of rych renoun,
 So watȝ hit me dere þat þou con deme,
 1184 In þys veray avysoun;
 If hit be ueray & soth sermoun,
 Þat þou so stykeȝ in garlande gay,
 So wel is me in þys doel dounȝoun,
 1188 Þat þou art to þat prynseȝ paye.”

He addresses his pearl;

If] MS. inf.

laments his rash curiosity.

[Fol. 5]

To þat prynceȝ paye hade I ay bente,
 & ȝerned no more þen watȝ me geuen,
 & halden me þer in trwe entent,
 1192 As þe perle me prayed þat watȝ so þryuen,
 As helde drawen to goddeȝ present,
 To mo of his mysterys I hade ben dryuen.
 Bot ay wolde man of happe more hente
 1196 Þen moȝten by ryȝt vpon hem clyuen;
 Þer-fore my ioye watȝ sone to-riuen,
 & I kaste of kytheȝ þat lasteȝ aye.

Men desire more than they
 have any right to expect.

Lorde! mad hit arn þat agayn þe stryuen,
1200 Oþer proferen þe oȝt agayn þy paye;
36

GIVE US GRACE TO SERVE HIM.

To pay þe prince oþer sete saȝte,
Hit is ful eþe to þe god krystyn;
For I haf founden hym boþe day & naȝte,
1204 A god, a lorde, a frende ful fyin.
Ouer þis hyl þis lote I laȝte,
For pyty of my perle enclynin,
& syþen to god I hit by-taȝte,
1208 In krysteȝ dere blessyng & myn,
Þat in þe forme of bred & wyn,
Þe preste *vus* scheweȝ vch a daye;
He gef *vus* to be his homly hyne,
1212 Ande precious perleȝ vnto his pay. Amen. Amen.

The good Christian know:
how to make peace with
God.

hyl] MS. *hyil*.
1864 edition had
“*hyil*”, with note “*hye*
hil or *hyul*?”

God give us grace to be hi
servants!

105

NOTES TO THE PEARL.

The Notes were printed in a group, immediately before the Index. They have been distributed among the three poems for convenience.

Page 1. l. 2, *to*, very.

8 *sengeley in synglure*, ever in singleness (uniqueness).

Now is Susan in sale *sengeliche* arayed.

Pistel of Susan, Vernon MS., fol. 317.

11 *dewyne*, pine; *for-dolked*, for-wounded (severely hurt).

16 *heuen my happe*, increase my happiness.

17 *þrych my hert þrange*, through my heart pierce.

- 20 *style stounde*, a secret sorrow.
- 23 *O moul þou marrez a myry mele*,
 O mould (earth) thou spoilest a merry discourse.
- P. 2. l. 27 *Blomez blayke & blwe & rede*,
 Flowers yellow, blue, and red.
- 49 *spenned*, wrung.
- 51, 52 A secret grief in my heart dinned (resounded),
 Though reason set myself at peace.
- 53 *spenned*, allured, enticed away.
- 54 *Wyth fyrte skyllez þat faste fazt*,
 With trembling doubts that fast fought (struggled).
- P. 3. l. 76 *bollez* = *bolez*, trunks of trees.
 78 *on vch a tynde*, on each branch.
 92 *reken myrþe*, pleasant, joyous mirth.
- P. 4. l. 99 *þe derþe þer-of*, the value (preciousness) thereof.
 101 *in wely wyse*, in joyful mood.
 102 *derez*, injuries, harms.
 103 *fyrre*, farther.
 105 *rawez & randez*, borders and paths.
 107 *I wan to*, I reached. *Winne* in O.E. was used much in the
 same way as we now employ the word *get*.
 112 *Wyth a rownande rourde raykande aryzt*,
 With a murmuring (whispering) sound flowing aright.
 113 *founce*, bottom; *stepe*, bright.
 114 *glente*, shone; *glyzt*, glistened.
 115 *A[s] stremande sternez*, as glittering stars; *stroþe*, stout,
 brave.
 119 *loze*, deep.
 125 *dryzly halez*, strongly (or deeply) flows.
 126 *bred ful* = *bred-ful* = *bretful* (?), full to the brim.
- P. 5. l. 131 *wayneþ*, grants.

132 *hitteȝ*, seeks.

138 *gayn*, opposite.

142 *I hopede þat mote merked wore*,
I supposed that building was devised.

149 *stote & stare*, stand (loiter) and gape.

150-1 ¹⁰⁶
To fynde a forþe, faste con I fonde,
Bot woþeȝ mo I-wysse þer ware,
To find a way fast did I go,
But paths more indeed there were.

153 *wonde*, cease, abstain (from fear).

155 *nwe note*, a new matter.

163 *blysnande whyt*, glistening white. See 197.

P. 6. l. 165 *schere*, purify, refine.

169 *þe more I frayste hyr fayre face*.
The more I examined her fair face.

frayst (*fraist*) usually signifies to try, tempt.

170 *fonte*, tried, examined, *found*.

176 *Such a burre myȝt make myn herte blunt*,
Such a blow might make mine heart faint.

179 *þat stonge myn hert ful stray atount*,
Should we not read—þat stonge myn hert ful stray a stount (?),
“full stray a stount” = a blow full stray.

187 *chos*, was following, was seeking.

188 *Er I at steuen hir moȝt stalle*,
Before I could place her within reach of discourse.

190 *seme* = *semely*, seemingly.

P. 7. l. 208 *flurtd*, figured. Cf. *flurt*-silk, figured-silk.

210 *Her here heke al hyr vmbe-gon*,
Her hair eke (also) all her about gone.

212 *Her ble more blaȝt*, her complexion whiter.

213 *schorne golde schyr*, refined gold pure.

216 *porfyl*, hem of a dress, or rather an embroidered hem.

217 *poyned*, ornamented, trimmed.

223-4 *A mannez dom myzt dryzly demme*,

Er mynde mozt malte in hit mesure,

A man's judgment might greatly dim,

Before (his) mind could discourse of it in sufficient terms
of praise.

226 *No = ne* (nor) would be a better reading.

230 *wyber half*, opposite side.

P. 8. 1. 243 *myn one*, myself.

244 *layned*, kept secret, hidden.

251 *Fro*, from the time that. *towen & twayned*, made two and
separated.

P. 9. 1. 272 *is put in pref*, has been proved.

275 *bote of þy meschef*, the remedy of thy misfortune (misery).

290 *Wy borde ze men so madde ze be?*

Why should you talk, so foolish you are?

P. 10. 1. 307 *westernays*, wrongly, in vain? It may be another form of
westernways, from the A.Sax. *wéste*, barren, empty; *wéstern*,
a desert place. Or is it connected with A.Sax. *winstre*, the left
hand?

320 *Þy corse in clot mot colder keue*,

Thy body in earth (clods) must colder plunge.

321 *for-garte* forfeited.

322 *zore fader* for *form-fader*, first-father.

323 *drwry = drery*, dreary (?). *boȝ (= bos = bus ?) vch ma*
(*man ?*) *dreue*, behoves each man to drive (go). See B. l. 687.

327-8 *Now haf I fonte þat I for-lete*

Schal I efte forgo hit er euer I fyne?

Now I have found what I have lost.

Shall I again forego it ere ever I die?

P. 11. l. 336 *durande doel*, lasting grief.

343 *For anger gaynez þe not a cresse,*

For anger avails the not a cress, (i.e. not a mite).

Cf. the following passage from "Piers Ploughman," p. 174,
l. 5629:

"Wisdom and wit now
Is noght worth a *kerse*."

353 *Stynst (stynt?) of þy strot & fyne to flyte,*

Leave off thy complaining and cease to chide.

354 *blyþe* is here used as a substantive in the sense of bliss, joy.
swefte = swift.

356 *hyr craftez kyþe*, manifest her powers.

359-60 *For marre oþer madde, morne & myþe,*

Al lys in him to dyzt & deme.

For to ruin, or make foolish, grieve or to soothe,

All lies in him to order and doom.

363 *If rapely raue*, etc. = *If rapely I raue*, etc. (?)

368 Though I go astray, my dear, adored one.

P. 12. l. 369 *lyþez*, grant.

374 *Bot much þe bygger zet wat3 my mon,*

Fro þou wat3 wroken fro vch a woþe.

But much the greater yet was my moan (sorrow),

From (the time) thou wast banished from every path.

377 *now leþez my loþe*, now my sorrow ceases (is softened).

382 *marerez* = *marez* (?).

386 *mate*, dejected.

402 *I hete þe*, I promise the.

P. 14. l. 446 *in hyt self beyng*, in its very being.

455 *gyng*, company.

460 *Temen*, are united, joined. *tryste*, trusty, faithful, firm.

- P. 16. l. 511 *wrypen*, toil, literally to turn, twist.
 512 *keruen*, dig. *caggen*, draw. *man* = *maken*, make. Cf. *ma* = make, *ta* = take, *tan* = taken.
 522 *tozt*, binding, firm.
 524 *pray* (so in MS.), read *pay*.
 536 *at ze moun*, that ye are able.
- P. 17. l. 560 *a grete*, in the gross, a head.
 563 *plete*, plead, ask for.
 572 *be* = *he* (?).
- P. 18. l. 575 *Þaʒ her sweng wyth lyttel at-slykeʒ*,
 Though their labour (blow) with little falls off (fails to accomplish much).
 605 *chychē*, niggard.
 608 *goteʒ*, streams; *charde*, past tense of *charre*, to turn, deviate.
- P. 19. l. 617 *bourne abate* = *burne abade*, man continued.
 626 *by lyne*, by lineage descent.
- P. 20. l. 645 *Bot þer on com a bote as-tyt*,
 But there came one as a remedy at once.
 659 *in sely stounde*, in a happy moment.
 671 *glente*, fell, slided.
- P. 21. l. 680 *dylle*, slow, sluggish.
 681 *dyt* = *dyde*, did (?), or *dotʒ*, does (?).
 690 *oure*, prayer.
- P. 22. l. 726 *sulpande synne*, defiling, polluting, sin.
 727 *bylde*, building.
 735 *reme*, realm.
- P. 23. l. 752 *Of carpe*, discourse of.
 754 *hauyng*, condition, behaviour.
 757 *bete*, save, ransom.
 759 *make*, wife.

775 *vnder cambe* = *under-cam*, came under, took an inferior position (?).

- P. 24. l. 802 & *as a lombe þat clypper in lande nem*,
And as a lamb that a *shearer* has taken, etc.

108

813-4 For us he let himself be scourged and buffeted, and stretched upon a rough tree (*i.e.* nailed to the cross).

- P. 25. l. 836 *as bare*, (?) *al bare*, openly. See 1025.
837 *Lesande þe boke with leuez sware*,
Opening the book with leaves square.
839 & *at þat syzt vche douth con dare*,
And at that sight each doughty (one) did tremble (with fear).

849 *enle* = *eneli* = onely or *onlepi* (?) = singly, alone.

- P. 26. l. 865 *talle farande* = *tale farande*, pleasing story.
873 *hue*, cry, voice.
876 *lote*, sound.
P. 27. l. 896 *lote*, features.
909 *hynde* = *hende*, gentle, courteous (one).
911 *bustwys as a blose*, boisterous (wild) as a blaze (flame).
916 *With nay þou neuer my ruful bone*,
Do thou never refuse my mournful request.

- P. 28. l. 948 *So is hys mote with-uten moote*,
So is his building without mote (blemish).

- P. 29. ll. 975-6 & *I an-endeþ þe on his syde*
 Schal sve, tyl þou to a hil be veued,
And I opposite thee on this side
 Shall go, till thou to a hill be passed.
980-81 & *blusched on þe burghe, as I forth dreued*,
 Byzonde þe brok fro me warde keued,
And looked on the city, as I forth drove (urged),

Beyond the brook that cut me off from (the object of my desire).

- P. 30. l. 1018 *Masporye* = *was pure* (?).
1022 *brode & stayre*, broad and steep (high).
1026 *pat glent as glayre*, that shone as amber.
- P. 31. l. 1030 *fon*, ceased, the preterite of *fine*.
1038 *fate3* = *fade3*, fades.
1041 *whate3* = *wat3*, was.
- P. 32. ll. 1065-66 *De zates stoken wat3 neuer zet,*
Bot euer more vpen at vche a lone.
The gates shut were never yet,
But ever more open at every lane.
1073 *to euen with*, to equal with, to match with.
1084 *falure* = *fasure*, form (?).
- P. 33. l. 1124 *to loue*, to praise.
1127 *in melle* = *in-melle* = *i-melle*, among. Cf. *in-lyche* and *i-lyche*, etc.
- P. 34. l. 1141 *De lombe delyt non lyste to wene,*
The lamb's delight none desired to doubt.
1146 *laste and lade*, followed and preceded (?).
1161 *Bot of pat munt I wat3 bi-talt,*
But from that purpose I was aroused (shaken).
1163 *bi-calt* = *bi-called* (?), called away.
- P. 35. l. 1165 *flonc* = *flong* (?), flung.
1193 *helde*, willingly (inclined).

I.

Claunesse who-so kyndly cowþe comende,
& rekken vp alle þe resoun3 þat ho by ri3t aske3,
Fayre forme3 my3t he fynde in forering his
speche,

[Fol. 5'

Cleanness discloses fair
forms.

4 & in þe contraré, kark & combraunce huge;
For wonder wroth is þe wy3 þat wro3t alle þinges,
Wyth þe freke þat in fylþe fol3es hym after,
As renke3 of relygioun þat reden & syngen,
8 & aprochen to hys presens, & preste3 arn called;
Thay teen vnto his temple & temen to hym seluen,
Reken with reuerence þay r[ec]hen his auter,
Þay hondel þer his aune body & vsen hit boþe.

God is angry with the
unclean worshipper,

and with false priests.

12 If þay in clannes be clos þay cleche gret mede,
Bot if þay conterfete crafte, & cortaysye wont,
As be honest vtwyth, & in-with alle fylþe3,
Þen ar þay synful hemself & sulped altogeder,
16 Boþe god & his gere, & hym to greme cachen.

The pure worshipper
receives great reward.

The impure will bring upc
them the anger of God, W
is pure and holy.

He is so clene in his courte, þe kyng þat al welde3,
& honeste in his hous-holde & hagherlych serued,
With angele3 enourled in alle þat is clene,
20 Boþe with-inne & with-uten, in wede3 ful
bry3t.

It would be a marvel if Go
did not hate evil.

Nif he nere scoymus & skyg & non scape louied,
Hit were a meruayl to much, hit mo3t not falle;
Kryst kydde hit hym self in a carp one3,
24 Þer as he heuened a3t happe3 & hy3t hem her
mede3;

Christ showed us that
himself.

Me myne3 on one amonge oþer, as mapew
recorde3,

St. Matthew records the
discourse.

Þat þus of clannesse vn-close3 a ful cler speche.

38

The clean of heart shall lo
on our Lord.

Þe hapel clene of his hert hapene3 ful fayre,

28 For he schal loke on oure lorde *with* a bone chere,
 As so sayt3, to þat sy3t seche schal he neuer,
 Þat any vnclannesse hat3 on, anwhere abowte: *anwhere] anywhere (?)*
 For he þat flemus vch fylþe fer fro his hert,
 32 May not byde þat burne þat hit his body ne3en; *burne] Looks like burr MS.*
 For-þy hy3 not to heuen *in* hatere3 to-torne,
 Ne *in* þe harlote3 hod & hande3 vnwaschen;
 For what vrpþy hapeþ þat hy3 honour halde3
 36 Wolde lyke, if a ladde com lyþerly attyred,
 When he were sette solempnely *in* a sete ryche, *[Fol. 5'*
 Abof dukes on dece, *with* dayntys serued,
 Þen þe harlot *with* haste helded to þe table
 40 *With* rent cokre3 at þe kne & his clutte trasches,
 & his tabarde to-torne & his tote3 oute;
 Oþer ani on of alle þyse he schulde be halden
 vtter,
 With mony blame ful bygge, a boffet, *peraunter*,
 44 Hurlled to þe halle dore & harde þer-oute schowued,
 & be forboden þat bor3e to bowe þider neuer, *and be forbidden to re-ent*
 On payne of enprysonment & puttyng *in* stokke3;
 & þus schal he be schent for his schrowde feble, *and thus be ruined throug
his vile clothes.*
 48 Þa3 neuer *in* talle ne *in* tuch he trespas more.
 & if vnwelcum he were to a worpþlych prynce
 3et hym is þe hy3e kyng harder in her euen,

ARABLE OF THE MARRIAGE FEAST.

As mapew mele3 in his masse of þat man ryche,
 52 Þat made þe mukel mangerye to marie his here
 dere,
 & sende his sonde þen to say þat þay samne schulde,
 & in comly quoyntis to com to his feste;
 “For my boles & my bore3 arn bayted & slayne,
 56 & my fedde foule3 fatted with sclazt,
 My polyle þat is penne-fed & partrykes bope,
 Wyth schelde3 of wylde swyn, swane3 & crone3;
 Al is ropeled & rosted ry3t to þe sete,

*The parable of the “Marri
of the King’s Son.”*

The king’s invitation.

60 Come3 cof to my corte, er hit colde worþe.”

E INVITED TO THE FEAST REFUSE TO COME.

When þay knewen his cal þat þider com schulde,
Alle ex-cused hem by þe skyly he scape by mozt:

39

On hade bozt hym a bor3 he sayde by hys trawþe,
64 Now t[ur]ne I þeder als tyd, þe toun to by-holde;

An oþer nayed also & nurned þis cawse:

I haf 3erned & 3at 3okke3 of oxen,

& for my hy3e3 hem bozt, to bowe haf I mester,

68 To see hem pulle in þe plow aproche me byhoue3;

& I haf wedded a wyf, sower hym þe þryd,

Excuse me at þe court, I may not com þere;

Þus þay dro3 hem adre3 with daunger vchone,

72 Þat non passed to þe place þa3 he prayed were.

Thenne þe ludych lorde lyked ful ille

& hade dedayn of þat dede, ful dry3ly he carpe3:

He sayt3 “now for her owne sor3e þay for-saken
habbe3,

76 More to wyte is her wrange, þen any wylle gentyl;

Þenne got3 forth my gome3 to þe grete streete3,

& forsette3 on vche a syde þe cete aboute;

Þe wayferande freke3, on fote & on hors,

80 Boþe burne3 & burde3, þe better & þe wers,

Lape3 hem alle luflyly to lenge at my fest,

& brynge3 hem blyþly to bor3e as baroune3 þay were,

So þat my palays plat-ful be pyzt al aboute,

84 Þise oþer wreche3 I-wysse worþy nozt wern.”

Þen þay cayred & com þat þe cost waked,

Bro3ten bachlere3 hem wyth þat þay by bonke3
metten,

Swyere3 þat swyftly swyed on blonke3,

88 & also fele vpon fote, of fre & of bonde.

When þay com to þe courte keppte wern þay
fayre,

Those invited begin to make
excuses.

One had bought an estate
and must go to see it.

Another had purchased so
oxen and wished to see th
“pull in the plough.”

A third had married a wife
and could not come.

sower] swer (?).

place] MS. plate.

[Fol. 5]

The Lord was greatly
displeased,

and commanded his serva
to invite the wayfaring,

both men and women, the
better and the worse,

that his palace might be fi

The servants brought in
bachelors and squires.

When they came to the co
they were well entertainec

Styztled with þe stewarde, stad in þe halle,
 Ful manerly with marchal mad forto sitte,
 92 As he wat3 dere of de-gre dressed his seete.
 Þenne segge3 to þe souerayn sayden þer-after,
 “Lo! lorde with your leue at your lege heste,
 & at þi banne we haf bro3t, as þou beden habbe3,

The servants tell their lord
 that they have done his
 behest, and there is still ro
 for more guests.

IALT AND THE BLIND ARE INVITED.

96 Mony renischche renke3 & 3et is roum more.”
 Sayde þe lorde to þo lede3, “layte3 3et ferre,
 Ferre out in þe felde, & feche3 mo geste3,

The Lord commands them
 go out into the fields,

40

Wayte3 gorste3 & greue3, if ani gome3 lygge3,
 100 What-kyn folk so þer fare, feche3 hem hider,
 Be þay fers, be þay feble for-lote3 none,
 Be þay hol, be þay halt, be þay ony3ed,
 & þa3 þay ben boþe blynde & balterande

for-lote3] forlete3 (?).

and bring in the halt, blind
 and “one-eyed.”

cruppele3,

104 Þat my hous may holly by halkes by fylled;
 For certe3 þyse ilk renke3 þat me renayed habbe
 & de-nounced me, no3t now at þis tyme,
 Schul neuer sitte in my sale my soper to fele,
 108 Ne suppe on sope of my seve, þa3 þay swelt
 schulde.”

For those who denied shal
 not taste “one sup” to save
 them from death.

þa3] MS. þa3 þa3.

Thenne þe sergaunte3, at þat sawe, swengen þer-
 oute,
 & diden þe dede þat [is] demed, as he deuised
 hade,

[Fol. 51

The palace soon became f
 of “people of all plights.”

& with peple of alle plyte3 þe palays þay fyllen;
 112 Hit weren not alle on wyue3 sune3, wonen
 with on fader;

They were not all one wif
 sons, nor had they all one
 father.

Wheþer þay wern worþy, oþer wers, wel wern
 þay stowed,

The “brightest attired” ha
 the best place.

Ay þe best byfore & bry3test atyred,
 Þe derrest at þe hy3e dese þat dubbed wer fayrest;
 116 & syþen on lenþe bilooghe lede3 inogh,

& ay a segge soerly semed by her wede3;
 So with marschal at her mete mensked þay were,
 Clene men in compaynye for-knowen wern lyte,
 120 & 3et þe symplest in þat sale wat3 serued to þe
 fulle,
 Boþe with menske, & with mete & mynstrasy noble,
 & alle þe layke3 þat a lorde a3t in londe schewe.
 & þay bigonne to be glad þat god drink haden,
 124 & vch mon with his mach made hym at ese.

Below sat those with “poc
 weeds.”

soerly] *soberly* (?).

All are well entertained
 “with meat and minstrelsy

Each with his “mate” mad
 him at ease.

II.

N^{ow} in-myddes þe mete þe mayster hym
 biþo3t,
 þat he wolde se þe semblé þat samned was þere,
 & re-hayte rekenly þe riche & þe poueren,
 128 & cherisch hem alle with his cher, & chaufen her
 loye,
 þen he bowe3 fro his bour in to þe brode halle,
 & to þe best on þe bench, & bede hym be myry,
 Solased hem with semblaunt & syled fyrre;
 132 Tron fro table to table & talkede ay myrþe,
 41

The lord of the feast goes
 among his guests.

poueren] MS. *poueuer*.

Bids them be merry.

IAN WITHOUT A WEDDING GARMENT.

Bot as he ferked ouer þe flor he fand *with* his
 y3e,
 Hit wat3 not for a haly day honestly arayed,
 A þral þry3t in þe þrong vnþryuandely cloped,
 136 Ne no festiual frok, bot fyled with werkke3.
 Þe gome wat3 vn-garnyst with god men to dele,
 & gremed þer-with þe grete lord & greue hym he þo3t;
 “Say me, frende,” *quod* þe freke with a felle
 chere,

On the floor he finds one
 arrayed for a holyday.

Asks him how he obtained
 entrance, and how he was
 bold as to appear in such
 rags.

140 “Hov wan þou into þis won in wede3 so fowle?
þe abytt þat þou hat3 vpon, no haly day hit menske3;
þou burne for no brydale art busked in wede3!
How wat3 þou hardy þis hous for þyn vnhap [to] ne3e,
144 In on so ratted a robe & rent at þe syde3?
þow art a gome vn-goderly in þat goun febele;
þou praysed me & my place ful pouer & ful
[g]nede,

[Fol. 5]

þat wat3 so prest to aproche my presens here-inne;
148 Hope3 þou I be a harlot þi erigant to prayse?”
þat oþer burne wat3 abayst of his broþe worde3,
& hurkele3 doun with his hede, þe vrþe he bi-
holde3;

Does he take him to be a
harlot?

The man becomes
discomfited.

He wat3 so scoumfit of his scylle, lest he skape hent,
152 þat he ne wyst on worde what he warp
schulde.

He is unable to reply.

þen þe lorde wonder loude laled & cryed,
& talke3 to his tormenttoure3: “take3 hym,” he
bidde3,

The lord commands him to
be bound,

“Bynde3 byhynde, at his bak, boþe two his hande3,
156 & felle fettere3 to his fete festene3 bylyue;
Stik hym stifly in stoke3, & steke3 hym þer-after
Depe in my doungeoun þer doel euer dwelle3,
Greuing, & gretyng, & gryspyng harde

and cast into a deep
dungeon.

160 Of teþe tenfully to-geder, to teche hym be quoynt.”

Thus comparisune3 kryst þe kyndom of heuen,
To þis frelych feste þat fele arn to called,
For alle arn laped luflyly, þe luþer & þe better,
164 þat euer wern ful3ed in font þat fest to haue.

This feast is likened to the
kingdom of heaven, to wh
all are invited.

Bot war þe wel, if þou wylt, þy wede3 ben clene,
& honest for þe haly day, lest þou harme lache,
For aproch þou to þat prynce of parage noble.

See that thy weeds are cle

168 He hates helle no more þen hem þat ar sowle.

sowle] fowle (?)....

42

Wich arn þenne þy wede3 þou wrappe3 þe inne,
þat schal schewe hem so schene schrowde of þe
best?

Thy weeds are thy works
that thou hast wrought.

Hit arn þy werke3 wyterly, þat þou wro3t haue3,
172 & lyued with þe lykyng þat ly3e in þyn hert,
þat þo be frely & fresch fonde in þy lyue,
& fetyse of a fayr forme, to fote & to honde,
& syþen alle þyn oþer lyme3 lapped ful clene,
176 Þenne may þou se þy sauior & his sete ryche.

For many faults may a man
forfeit bliss.

For fele faute3 may a freke forfeite his blysse,
þat he þe souerayn ne se þen, for slaue one,
As for bobaunce & bost & bolnande pryde,

For sloth and pride he is
thrust into the devil's thro

180 Þroly in-to þe deuele3 þrote man þrynge3 bylyue,
For couetyse, & colwarde & croked dede3,

[Fol. 5v]

For mon-sworne, & men-scla3t, & to much drynk,
For þefte, & for þrepyng, vn-þonk may mon haue;

He is ruined by
covetousness, perjury,
murder, theft, and strife.

184 For roborrye, & riboudrye & resoune3 vntrwe,
& dysheriete & depryue dowrie of wydoe3,
For marryng of maryage3 & mayntnaunce of
schrewe3,

For robbery and ribaldry,
preventing marriages, and
supporting the wicked,

For traysoun, & trichcherye, & tyrauntyré boþe,

boþe] loþe (?).

188 & for fals famacions & fayned lawe3;

for treason, treachery, and
tyranny, man may lose
eternal bliss.

Man may mysse þe myrþe, þat much is to prayse,
For such vnþewe3 as þise & þole much payne,
& in þe creatores cort com neuer more,

192 Ne neuer see hym with sy3t for such sour tourne3.

S DISPLEASED WITH THE WICKED.

III.

Bot I haue herkned & herde of mony hy3e clerke3,
& als in resoune3 of ry3t red hit my seluen,
þat þat ilk proper prynce þat paradys welde3
196 Is displeased at vch a poynt þat plyes to scape.
Bot neuer 3et in no boke breued I herde
þat euer he wreke so wyþerly on werk þat he made,
Ne venged for no vilté of vice ne synne,
200 Ne so hastyfly wat3 hot for hatel of his wylle,

The high Prince of all is
displeased with those who
work wickedly.

Ne neuer so sodenly so3t vn-soundely to weng,
As for fylþe of þe flesch þat foles han vsed;

43

For as I fynde þer he for3et alle his fre þewes,
204 & wex wod to þe wrache, for wrath at his hert,
For þe fyrste felonye þe falce fende wro3t.

For the first fault the devil
committed, he felt God's
vengeance.

Whyl he wat3 hy3e in þe heuen houen vpon lofte,
Of alle þyse ap̃el aungelez attled þe fayrest,
208 & he vnkyndely as a karle kydde areward,
He se3 no3t bot hym self how semly he were,
Bot his souerayn he forsoke & sade þyse worde3:
“I schal telde vp my trone in þe tra mountayne
212 & by lyke to þat lorde þat þe lyft made.

He, the fairest of all angel
forsook his sovereign,

and boasted that his throne
should be as high as God's

With þis worde þat he warp, þe wrake on hym ly3t,
Dry3tyn with his dere dom hym drof to þe abyme,
In þe mesure of his mode, his met3 neuer þe lasse,
216 Bot þer he tynt þe type dool of his tour ryche,
Þa3 þe feloun were so fers for his fayre wede3
& his glorious glem þat glent so bry3t;
As sone as dry3tyne3 dome drof to hym seluen,
220 [þi]kke þowsande3 þro þrwen þer-oute

For these words he was cast
down to hell.

[Fol. 6v]

ALL OF THE ANGELS.

Fellen fro þe fyrmament, fende3 ful blake
Weued at þe fyrst swap as þe snaw þikke,
Hurled in-to helle-hole as þe hyue swarme3;
224 Fyltyr fenden folk forty daye3 lencþe,
Er þat styngande storme stynt ne my3t;
Bot as smylt mele vnder smal siue smokes for-þikke,
So fro heuen to helle þat hatel schor laste,
228 On vche syde of þe worlde aywhere ilyche.
Þis hit wat3 a brem brest & a byge wrache,
& 3et wrathed not þe wy3, ne þe wrech sa3tled,
Ne neuer wolde, for wylnesful, his worþy god
 knaue,

The fiends fell from heaven
Weued] wened (?).

like the thick snow, for forty
days.

From heaven to hell the
shower lasted.

Þis] 3is (?).

The devil would not make
peace with God.

232 Ne pray hym for no pité, so proud wat3 his wylle,

For-þy þa3 þe rape were rank, þe rawþe wat3 lyttel;
 þa3 he be kest into kare he kepes no better.
 Bot þat oþer wrake þat wex on wy3e3, hit ly3t
 236 þur3 þe faut of a freke þat fayled in trawþe.
 Adam in obedyent ordaynt to blysse,
 þer pryuely in paradys his place wat3 de-vised,
 44
 To lyue þer in lykyng þe lenþe of a terme,
 240 & þenne en-herite þat home þat aungele3 for-gart,
 Bot þur3 þe eggyng of eue he ete of an apple
 þat en-poysened alle peple3 þat parted fro hem boþe,
 For a defence þat wat3 dy3t of dry3tyn seluen,
 244 & a payne þer-on put & pertly halden;
 þe defence wat3 þe fryt þat þe freke towched,
 & þe dom is þe deþe þat drepe3 *vus* alle.
 Al in mesure & meþe wat3 mad þe vengiaunce,
 248 & efte amended *with* a mayden þat make hade
 neuer.

lyttel] MS. *lyttel*.

Affliction makes him non
the better.

For the fault of one,
vengeance alighted upon :
men.

obedyent] *obedience* (?)

Adam was ordained to liv
in bliss.

Through Eve he ate an ap

Thus all his descendants
became poisoned.

A maiden brought a reme
for mankind.

VICKEDNESS OF THE ANTEDILUVIAN WORLD.

IV.

Bot in þe þryd wat3 forþrast al þat þryue schuld,
 þer wat3 malys mercyles & mawgre much
 scheued,
 þat wat3 for fylþe vpon folde þat þe folk vsed,
 252 [þ]at þen wonyed in þe worlde *with-uten* any
 mayster3;
 Hit wern þe fayrest of forme & of face als,
 þe most & þe myriest þat maked wern euer,
 þe styfeste, þe stalworþeste þat stod euer on fete;
 256 & lengest lyf in hem lent of lede3 alle oþer,
 For hit was þe forme-foster þat þe folde bred,
 þe apel auncetere3 sune3 þat adam wat3 called,
 To wham god hade geuen alle þat gayn were,

Malice was merciless.

A race of men came into t
world,

[Fol. 6]

the fairest, the merriest, a
the strongest that ever we
created.

They were sons of Adam.

260 Alle þe blysse bout blame þat bodi myzt haue,
& þose lykkest to þe lede þat lyued next after,
For-þy so semly to see syþen wern none.

þer wat3 no law to hem layd bot loke to kynde,
264 & kepe to hit, & alle hit cors clanly ful-fylle;
& þenne founden þay fylþe in fleschlych dede3
& controeued agayn kynde contraré werke3,
& vsed hem vn-þryftyly vchon on oþer,
268 & als with oþer, wylsfully, vpon a wrange wyse.

So ferly fowled her flesch þat þe fende loket,
How þe de3ter of þe douþe wern dere-lych fayre,
& fallen in fela3schyp with hem on folken wyse
272 & en-gendered on hem ieaunte3 with her Iape3
ille.

No law was laid upon them

Nevertheless they acted unnaturally.

The “fiends” beheld how they were the daughters of these mighty men,

and made fellowship with them and begat a race of giants.

45

þose wern men meþele3 & mazty on vrþe,
þat for her lodlych layke3 alosed þay were.
He wat3 famed for fre þat fezt loued best,
276 & ay þe biggest in bale þe best wat3 halden;
& þenne euele3 on erþe earnestly grewen
& multiplyed mony-folde in-monge3 mankynde,
For þat þe mazty on molde so marre þise oþer.
280 þat þe wy3e þat al wro3t ful wroþly bygynne3.
When he knew vche contre corupte in hit seluen,
& vch freke forloyned fro þe ry3t waye3,
Felle temptande tene towched his hert;
284 As wy3e, wo hym with-inne werp to hym seluen:
“Me for-þynke3 ful much þat euer I mon made,
Bot I schal delyuer & do away þat doten on þis
molde,

[famed] fained (?).

The greatest fighter was reckoned the most famous

The Creator of all become exceedingly wroth.

Fell anger touches His heart

It repents Him that He has made man.

DETERMINES TO DESTROY ALL FLESH.

& fleme out of þe folde al þat flesch were3,
288 Fro þe burne to þe best, fro brydde3 to fysche3;
Al schal doun & be ded & dryuen out of erþe,
þat euer I sette saule inne; & sore hit me rwe3

He declares that all flesh shall be destroyed, both man and beast.

[Fol. 6]

Pat euer I made hem my self; bot if I may her-after,
292 I schal wayte to be war her wrenche3 to kepe.”

Þenne in worlde wat3 a wy3e wonyande on lyue,
Ful redy & ful ry3twys, & rewled hym fayre;
In þe drede of dry3tyn his daye3 he vse3,
296 & ay glydande wyth his god his grace wat3 þe
more.

Hym wat3 þe nome Noe, as is innoghe knawen,
He had þre þryuen sune3 & þay þre wyue3;
Sem sobly þat on, þat oþer hy3t cam
300 & þe Iolef Iapheth wat3 gendered þe þryd.
Now god in nwy to Noe con speke,
Wylde wrakful worde3 in his wylle greued:
“Þe ende of alle-kyne3 flesch þat on vrþe meue3,
304 Is fallen forþ wyth my face & forþer hit I þenk,
With her vn-worþelych werk me wlate3 *with-inne*,
þe gore þer-of me hat3 greued & þe glette *nwyed*;
I schal strenkle my distresse & strye al to-geder,
308 Boþe lede3 & londe & alle þat lyf habbe3.

46

There was at this time livi
on the earth a very rightec
man:

Noah was his name.
Three bold sons he had.

God in great anger speaks
Noah.

Declares that He will dest
all “that life has.”

HE IS COMMANDED TO BUILD AN ARK.

Bot make to þe a mancioun & þat is my wylle,
A cofer closed of tres, clanlych planed;
Wyrk wone3 þerinne for wylde & for tame,
312 & þenne cleme hit *with* clay comly *with-inne*
& alle þe endentur dryuen daube *with-outen*.
& þus of lenþe & of large þat lome þou make,
þre hundred of cupyde3 þou holde to þe lenþe,
316 Of fyfty fayre ouer-þwert forme þe brede;
& loke euen þat þyn ark haue of he3þe þretté,
& a wyndow wyd vpon, wro3t vpon lofte,
In þe compas of a cubit kyndely sware,
320 A wel *dutande* dor, don on þe syde;
Haf halle3 þer-inne & *halke3* ful mony,
Boþe boske3 & boure3 & wel bounden pene3;

Commands him to make “
mansion” with dwellings :
wild and tame.

with-inne] MS. *withinn*

To let the ark be three
hundred cubits in length,
and fifty in breadth, and
thirty in height, and a
window in it a cubit squar

Also a good shutting door
the side,...
together with halls, recess
bushes, and bowers, and

For I schal waken vp a water to wasch alle þe
worlde,

324 & quelle alle þat is quik *with* quauende flode3.

Alle þat glyde3 & got3, & gost of lyf habbe3,

I schal wast with my wrath þat wons vpon vrþe;

Bot my forwarde *with* þe I festen on þis wyse,

328 For þou in reysoun hat3 rengned & ry3twys

ben euer;

Pou schal enter þis ark *with* þyn aþel barne3

& þy wedded wyf; with þe þou take

þe make3 of þy myry sune3; þis meyny of a3te

332 I schal saue of monne3 saule3, & swelt þose oþer.

Of vche best þat bere3 lyf busk þe a cupple,

Of vche clene comly kynde enclose seuen make3,

Of vche horwed, in ark halde bot a payre,

336 For to saue me þe sede of alle ser kynde3;

& ay þou meng *with* þe male3 þe mete ho-beste3,

Vche payre by payre to plese ayþer oþer;

With alle þe fode þat may be founde frette þy

cofer,

340 For sustnaunce to yow self & also þose oþer.”

Ful grayþely got3 þis god man & dos gode3

hestes,

In dry3 dred & daunger, þat durst do non oþer.

Wen hit wat3 fettled & forged & to þe fulle grayþed,

344 Þenn con dry3ttyn hym dele dry3ly þyse worde3:

47

well-formed pens.

[Fol. 6

For all flesh shall be
destroyed,

except Noah and his famil

Noah is told to take into tl
ark seven pairs of every
clean beast, and one of
unclean kind,

and to furnish the ark with
proper food.

Noah fills the ark.

V.

“**N**ow Noe,” *quod* oure lorde, “art þou al
redy?

Hat3 þou closed þy kyst *with* clay alle aboute?”

“3e lorde *with* þy leue,” sayde þe lede þenne,

God asks Noah whether a
ready.

Noah replies that all is ful
prepared.

348 “Al is wrozt at þi worde, as þou me wyt lante3.”

“Enter in þenn,” *quod* he, “& haf þi wyf with þe,

By þre sune3 with-outen þrep & her þre wyue3;

Beste3, as I bedene haue, bosk þer-inne als,

352 & when 3e arn staued, styfly steke3 yow þerinne;

Fro seuen daye3 ben seyed I sende out by-lyue,

Such a rowtande ryge þat rayne schal swyþe,

þat schal wasch alle þe worlde of werke3 of fylþe;

356 Schal no flesch vpon folde by fonden onlyue;

Out-taken yow a3t in þis ark staued,

& sed þat I wyl saue of þyse ser beste3.”

Now Noe neuer styste3 (þat niy3[t] he bygynne3),

360 Er al wer stawed & stoken, as þe steuen wolde.

He is commanded to enter the ark,

for God tells him that he will send a rain to destroy all flesh.

Noah stows all safely in the ark.

styste3] *stynte3* (?).

AIN DESCENDS.

Thenne sone com þe seuenþe day, when samned

wern alle,

& alle woned in þe whichche þe wylde & þe tame.

þen bolned þe abyne & bonke3 con ryse,

364 Waltes out vch walle-heued, in ful wode

streme3,

Wat3 no brymme þat abod vnbrosten bylyue,

þe mukel lauande loghe to þe lyfte rered.

Mony clustered clowde clef alle in clowte3,

368 To-rent vch a rayn-ryfte & rusched to þe vrþe;

Fon neuer in forty daye3, & þen þe flod ryses,

Ouer-walte3 vche a wod & þe wyde felde3;

For when þe water of þe welkyn with þe worlde

mette,

372 Alle þat deth mozt dry3e drowned þer-inne;

þer wat3 moon forto make when meschef was cnowen,

þat nozt dowed bot þe deth in þe depe streme3.

Water wylger ay wax, wone3 þat stryede,

376 Hurlled in-to vch hous, hent þat þer dowelled.

Fyrst feng to þe flyzt alle þat fle myzt,

Vuche burde with her barne þe byggyng þay leue3,

[Fol. 6v]

Seven days are passed.

The deep begins to swell, banks are broken down,

and the clouds burst.

It rains for forty days, and the flood rises,

and flows over the woods and fields.

All must drown.

The water enters the houses

& bowed to þe hy3 bonk þer brentest hit wern,
 380 & heterly to þe hy3e hylle3 þay [h]aled on faste;
 Bot al wat3 nedle3 her note, for neuer cowþe stynt
 þe ro3e raynande ryg [&] þe raykande wawe3,
 Er vch boþom wat3 brurd-ful to þe bonke3 egge3,
 384 & vche a dale so depe þat demmed at þe brynke3.
 Þe moste mountayne3 on mor þenne wat3 no more

Each woman with her bai
 flees to the hills.

The rain never ceases.

The valleys are filled.

dry3e,
 & þer-on flokked þe folke, for ferde of þe wrake,
 Syþen þe wylde of þe wode on þe water flette;
 388 Summe swymmed þer-on þat saue hemself
 trawed,

People flock to the
 mountains.

Some swim for their lives

Summe sty3e to a stud & stared to þe heuen,
 Rwly wyth a loud rurd rored for drede.
 Hare3, hertte3 also, to þe hy3e runnen,
 392 Bukke3, bausene3 & bule3 to þe bonkke3
 hy3ed,

Others roar for fear.

Animals of all kinds run to
 the hills.

& alle cryed for care to þe kyng of heuen,
 Re-couerer of þe creator, þay cryed vchone,
 Þat amounted þe masse, þe mase his mercy wat3
 passed,

All pray for mercy.

God's mercy is passed from
 them.

396 & alle his pyte departed fro peple þat he hated.
 Bi þat þe flod to her fete flo3ed & waxed,
 Þen vche a segge se3 wel þat synk hym byhoued;
 Frende3 fellen in fere & faþmed togeder
 400 To dry3 her delful deystyné & dyzen alle samen;
 Luf loke3 to luf & his leue take3,
 For to ende alle at one3 & for euer twynne.
 By forty daye3 wern faren, on folde no flesch
 styryed,

[Fol. 6:

Each sees that he must sin

Friends take leave of one
 another.

Forty days have gone by,
 all are destroyed.

404 Þat þe flod nade al freten with fe3tande waze3,
 For hit clam vche a clyffe cubites fyftene,
 Ouer þe hy3est hylle þat hurkled on erþe.

waze3] wawe3 (?).

Penne *mourkne* in þe mudde most ful nede
 408 Alle þat spyrakle *in-spranc*, no *sprawlyng*
 awayled,
 Saue þe hapel vnder hach & his *here* straunge,
 Noe þat ofte neuened þe name of oure lorde,
 Hym *a3t-sum* in þat ark as ap̃el god lyked,
 412 Þer alle lede3 in lome lenged druye,
 Þe arc houen wat3 on hy3e *with hurlande gote3*,
 Kest to *kythe3 vncoupe* þe clowde3 ful nere.
 49
 Hit waltered on þe wylde flod, went as hit lyste,
 416 Drof vpon þe depe dam, *in daunger* hit semed,
 With-uten mast, *oper* myke, *oper* myry
 bawelyne,
 Kable, *oper* capstan to clyppe to her ankrez,
 Hurrok, *oper* hande-helme hasped on roþer,
 420 *Oper* any sweande sayl to seche after hauen,
 Bot flote forthe *with þe flyt* of þe felle wynde3;
 Wheder-warde so þe water waftē, hit rebounde.
 Ofte hit roled on-rounde & rered on ende,
 424 Nyf oure lorde hade ben her lode3-mon hem
 had *lumpen* harde.
 Of þe lenþe of noe lyf to lay a lel date,
 Þe sex hundreth of his age & none odde 3ere3,
 Of seconde monyth, þe seueneþe day ry3te3,
 428 To-walten alle þyse welle-hede3 & þe water
 flowed,
 & þrye3 fyfty þe flod of folwande daye3,
 Vche hille wat3 þer hidde *with yre3* ful graye;
 Al wat3 wasted þat þer wonyed þe worlde *with-*
 inne,
 432 Þer euer flote, *oper* flwe, *oper* on fote 3ede,
 That ro3ly wat3 þe remnaunt þat þe *rac* dryue3,
 Þat alle gendre3 so ioyst wern ioyned wyth-inne.
 Bot quen þe lorde of þe lyfte lyked hymselfen
 436 For to mynne on his mon his *meth* þat abyde3,
 Þen he wakened a wynde on wattere3 to blowe;

All rot in the mud,
 in-spranc] *in-sprang* (?)

except Noah and his famil

 who are safe in the ark.

The ark is lifted as high as
 the clouds,
 and is driven about,

without mast, bowline,
 cables, anchors, or sail to
 guide its course.

At the mercy of the winds

Oft it rolled around and
 reared on end.

The age of the patriarch
 Noah.

Duration of the flood.

yre3] *yþe3* (?).

The completeness of the
 destruction.

[Fol. 6:

God remembers those in t
 ark.

He causes a wind to blow,

Penne lasned þe llak þat large wat3 are,
 Þen he stac vp þe stange3, stoped þo welle3,
 440 Bed blynne of þe rayn, hit batede as fast,
 Penne lasned þe lo3 lowkande to-geder.
 After harde daye3 wern out an hundreth & fyfté,
 As þat lyftande lome lugged aboute,
 444 Where þe wynde & þe weder warpen hit wolde,

llak] So in MS.
 and closes the lakes and
 wells, and the great deep.

RK RESTS ON MOUNT ARARAT.

Hit sa3tled on a softe day synkande to grounde.
 On a rasse of a rok, hit rest at þe laste,
 On þe mounte of mararach of armene hilles,
 448 Þat oper-waye3 on ebrv hit hat þe thanes.
 Bot þa3 þe kyste in þe crage3 wern closed to byde,
 50
 3et fyned not þe flod ne fel to þe boþeme3,
 Bot þe hy3est of þe egge3 vnhuled wern a lyttel,
 452 Þat þe burne bynne borde byhelde þe bare erþe;
 Penne wafte he vpon his wyndowe, & wysed þer-
 oute
 A message fro þat meyny hem molde3 to seche,
 Þat wat3 þe rauen so ronk þat rebel wat3 euer;
 456 He wat3 colored as þe cole, corbyal vn-trwe.
 & he fonge3 to þe fly3t, & fanne3 on þe wynde3,
 Houe3 hy3e upon hy3t to herken tybynges.
 He crouke3 for comfort when carayne he fynde3;
 460 Kast vp on a clyffe þer costese lay drye,
 He hade þe smelle of þe smach & smoltes þeder sone,
 Falle3 on þe foule flesch & fylle3 his wombe,
 & sone 3ederly for-3ete 3ister-day steuen,
 464 How þe cheuetayn hym charged þat þe kyst 3emed.
 Þe rauen rayke3 hym forth þat reches ful lyttel
 How alle fode3 þer fare, elle3 he fynde mete;

The ark settles on Mount Ararat.

Noah beholds the bare ear

He opens his window and sends out the raven to see dry land.

The raven “croaks for comfort” on finding carriage

He fills his belly with the foul flesh.

I SENDS FORTH A DOVE.

Bot þe burne bynne borde þat bod to hys come,
468 Banned hym ful bytterly *with bestes* alle
samen,

He seche3 an oþer sonde3mon & sette3 on þe
doune;

Brynge3 þat bryzt vpon borde blessed & sayde,
“Wende worþelych wyzt *vus wone3* to seche,
472 Dryf ouer þis dymme water; if þou druye fynde3
Bryng bodworde to bot blysse to *vus* alle;
Þa3 þat fowle be false, fre be þou euer.”

Ho wyrle out on þe weder on wynges ful scharpe,
476 Dre3ly alle a longe day þat dorst neuer lyzt;

& when ho fynde3 no folde her fote on to pyche,
Ho vmbe-keste3 þe coste & þe kyst seche3,
Ho hitte3 on þe euentyde & on þe ark sitte3;
480 Noe nymmes hir anon & naytly hir staue3.

Noe on anoþer day nymme3 efte þe dovene,
& bydde3 hir bowe ouer þe borne efte bonke3 to
seche;

& ho skyrme3 vnder skwe & skowte3 aboute,
484 Tyl hit wat3 ny3e at þe na3t & noe þen seche3.

51

borde] MS. *lorde*.

The lord of the ark curses
raven,

[Fol. 6:

doune] *douue* or *douen*
(?).

and sends out the dove.

The bird wanders about th
whole day.

Finding no rest, she return
about eventide to Noah.

Noah again sends out the
dove.

VI.

On ark on an euentyde houe3 þe downe,
On stamyn ho stod & styll hym abyde3;
What! ho brozt in hir beke a bronch of olyue,
488 *Gracyously* vmbe-grouen al *with grene leue3*;
Þat wat3 þe syngne of sauýté þat sende hem oure
lorde,

& þe sa3tlyng of hym-self *with þo sely bestes*.
Þen wat3 þer ioy in pat gyn where lumphred er
dry3ed,

492 & much comfort in þat cofer þat wat3 clay-daubed.
Myryly on a fayr morn, monyth þe fyrst,

The dove returns with an
olive branch in her beak.

This was a token of peace
and reconciliation.

Joy reigns in the ark.

Þat falle3 formast in þe 3er, & þe fyrst day,
 Ledē3 lo3en in þat lome & lokēd þer-outē,
 496 How þat wattere3 wern wonēd & þe worlde dryed.
 Vchon loued oure lorde, bot lenged ay styllē,
 Tyl þay had tyþyng fro þe tolke þat tynēd hem þer-
 inne;

The people therein laugh & look thereout.

I LEAVES THE ARK.

Þen gode3 glam to hem glod þat gladed hem alle,
 500 Bede hem drawe to þe dor, delyuer hem he
 wolde;

God permits Noah and his sons to leave the ark.

Þen went þay to þe wykket, hit walt vpon sone,
 Boþe þe burne & his barne3 bowed þer-outē;
 Her wyue3 walke3 hem wyth & þe wylde after,
 504 Þroly þrublande in þronge, þrowen ful þykke;
 Bot Noe of vche honest kynde nem out an odde
 & heuened vp an auter & hal3ed hit fayre,
 & sette a sakerfyse þer-on of vch a ser kynde,
 508 Þat wat3 comly & clene, god kepe3 non oþer.
 When bremly brened þose beste3, & þe breþe rysed,
 Þe sauour of his sacrafyse so3t to hym euen
 Þat al spede3 & spylle3; he spekes with þat ilke
 512 In comly comfort ful clos & cortays worde3:
 “Now noe no more nel I neuer wary,
 Alle þe mukel mayny [on] molde for no manne3
 synne3,

[Fol. 6.

Noah offers sacrifice to G

It is pleasing to Him that ‘speeds or spoils.’

God declares that He will never destroy the world for the sin of man.

For I se wel þat hit is sothe, þat alle manne3 wytte3
 516 To vn-þryfte arn alle þrawen with þo3t of her
 hertte3,

& ay hat3 ben & wyl be 3et fro her barnage;
 Al is þe mynde of þe man to malyce enclyned,
 52

For-þy schal I neuer schende so schortly at ones,
 520 As dysstrye al for mane3 synne [in] daye3 of þis
 erþe.

Bot waxe3 now & wende3 forth & worþe3 to monye,

Multyplye3 on þis molde & menske yow by-tyde.
Sesoune3 schal yow neuer sese of sede ne of
heruest,

That summer and winter
shall never cease.

524 Ne hete, ne no harde forst, vmbre ne dro3þe,
Ne þe swetnesse of somer, ne þe sadde wynter,
Ne þe ny3t, ne þe day, ne þe newe zere3,
Bot euer renne restle3 rengne3 3e þer-inne.”

Nor night nor day, nor the
new years.

528 Þerwyth he blesse3 vch a best, & byta3t hem
þis erþe.

God blesses every beast.

Þen wat3 a skylly skyualde, quen scaped alle þe wylde;

BEASTS ARE DISPERSED.

Vche fowle to þe fly3t þat fyþere3 my3t serue,
Vche fysch to þe flod þat fynne couþe na3te,
532 Vche beste to þe bent þat bytes on erbe3;
Wylde worme3 to her won wryþe3 in þe erþe,
Þe fox & þe folmarde to þe fryth wynde3,
Herttes to hy3e heþe, hare3 to gorste3,
536 & lyoune3 & lebarde3 to þe lake ryftes,
Herne3 & haueke3 to þe hy3e roche3;
Þe hole-foted fowle to þe flod hy3e3,
& vche best at a brayde þer hym best lyke3;
540 Þe fowre freke3 of þe folde fonge3 þe empyre.

Each fowl takes its flight.
Each fish goes to the floor

þat] MS. *þat þat*.

Each beast makes for the
plain. Wild worms wriggli
their abodes in the earth.

The fox goes to the wood;
Harts to the heath, and hai
to the gorse.

Lions and leopards go to t
lakes. Eagles and hawks t
the high rocks.

The four ‘frekes’ take the
empire.

OF HATRED OF WICKEDNESS.

Lo! suche a wrakful wo for wlatsum dede3
Parformed þe hy3e fader on folke þat he made;
Þat he chysly hade cherished he chastysed ful
hardee,
544 In de-voydyngþe þe vylanye þat venkquyst his
þewe3.
For-þy war þe now, wy3e, þat worschyp desyres,
In his comlych courte þat kyng is of blysse,
In þe fylþe of þe flesch þat þou be founden neuer,
548 Tyl any water in þe worlde to wasche þe fayly,

[Fol. 6.

Behold what woe God
brought on mankind for th
hateful deeds!

Beware of the filth of the
flesh.

For is no segge vnder sunne so seme of his crafte3,
If he be sulped in synne, þat [ne] sytte3 vnclene.

On spec of a spote may spede to mysse

552 Of þe sy3te of þe souerayn þat sytte3 so hy3e,

For þat schewe me schale in þo schyre howse3,

As þe beryl bornyst byhoue3 be clene,

53

Þat is sounde on vche a syde & no sem habes,

556 *With*-outen maskle oþer mote as margerye perle.

“One speck of a spot” wil
ruin us in the sight of God

The beryl is clean and sou
—it has no seam.

VII.

Syþen þe souerayn in sete so sore for-þo3t
Þat euer he man vpon molde merked to lyuy,

For he in fylþe wat3 fallen, felly he uenged,

560 Quen fourferde alle þe flesch þat he formed hade, *fourferde] for-ferde (?)*.

Hym rweð þat he hem vp-rerde & ra3t hem
lyflode,

& efte þat he hem vndyd, hard hit hym þo3t;

For quen þe swemande sor3e so3t to his hert,

564 He knyht a couenaunde cortaysly *with*
monkynde þere,

In þe mesure of his mode & meþe of his wylle,

Þat he schulde neuer for no syt smyte al at one3,

As to quelle alle quyke3 for qued þat my3t falle,

568 Whyl of þe lenþe of þe londe laste3 þe *terme*.

Þat ilke skyl for no scape ascaped hym neuer,

Wheder wonderly he wrak on wykked men *after*;

Ful felly for þat ilk faute forferde a kyth ryche,

572 In þe anger of his ire þat ar3ed mony;

& al wat3 for þis ilk euel, þat vn-happen glette,

Þe venym & þe vylanye & þe vycios fylþe,

Þat by-sulpe3 manne3 saule in vnsounde hert,

576 Þat he his saueour ne see *with* sy3t of his y3en,

Þat alle ille3 he hates as helle þat stynkke3;

When God repented that he
had made man, he destroy
all flesh.

But afterwards He was so

and made a covenant with
mankind

that He would not again
destroy all the living.

For the filth of the flesh God
destroyed a rich city.

God hates the wicked as
“hell that stinks.”

Bot non nuye3 hym, on na3t ne neuer vpon daye3,
As harlottrye vn-honest, hepyng of seluen;
580 þat schame3 for no schrewedschyp schent mot
he worþe!

[Fol. 65.

Especially harlotry and
blasphemy.

Bot sauour mon *in* þy self, þa3 þou a sotte lyuie,
þa3 þou bere þy self babel, by-þenk þe sum-tyme,
Wheþer he þat stykked vche a stare *in* vche steppe y3e,
584 3if hym self be bore blynde hit is a brod wonder; *self*] MS. *sele*.
& he þat fetly *in* face fettled alle eres

If he hat3 losed þe lysten hit lyfte3 meruayle;
Trave þou neuer þat tale, vn-trwe þou hit fynde3,
588 þer is no dede so derne þat ditte3 his y3en;

he] MS. *he he*.

Nothing is hidden from G

54

þer is no wy3e *in* his werk so war ne so styлле
þat hit ne þrawe3 to hym þre er he hit þo3t haue;
For he is þe gropande god, þe grounde of alle
dede3,

þre] *þer* (?).

God is the ground of all
deeds.

592 Rypande of vche a ring þe reynye3 & hert;
& þere he fynde3 al fayre a freke wyth-inne
þat hert honest & hol, þat hapel he honoure3,
Sende3 hym a sad sy3t to se his auen face,
596 & harde honyse3 þise oþer & of his erde fleme3.
Bot of þe dome of þe douþe for dede3 of schame
He is so skoymos of þat skape, he scarre3 bylyue,
He may not dry3e to draw allyt, bot drepe3 *in* hast
600 & þat wat3 schewed schortly by a scape one3.

ring] *rink* or *renk* (?).

He honours the man that i
honest and whole.

But for deeds of shame H
destroys the mighty ones.

HAM RECEIVES THREE GUESTS, AND ENTERTAINS THEM.

VIII.

Olde Abraham *in* erde one3 he sytte3
Euen byfore his hous-dore vnder an oke grene;
Bry3t blykked þe bem of þe brode heuen,
604 *In* þe hy3e hete þer-of Abraham bide3,
He wat3 schunt to þe schadow vnder schyre leue3;

Abraham is sitting before
house-door under a green
oak.

Penne wat3 he war on þe waye of wlonk wy3e3
þrynne.

He sees three men coming
along,

If þay wer farande & fre & fayre to beholde,
608 Hit is eþe to leue by þe last ende;

For þe lede þat þer laye þe leue3 an-vnder,
When he hade of hem sy3t he hy3e3 bylyue,
& as to god þe good mon gos hem agayne3
612 & haylsed hem in onhede & sayde, “hende lorde

and goes toward them.

3if euer þy mon vpon molde merit disserued,
Lenge a lyttel with þy lede I lo3ly bi-seche;
Passe neuer fro þi pouere, 3if I hit pray durst,
616 Er þou haf biden with þi burne & vnder bo3e
restted;

[Fol. 6]

He entreats them to rest
awhile,

& I schal wynne yow wy3t of water a lyttel,
& fast aboute schal I fare *your* fette wer
waschene;

that he may wash their feet

Restte3 here on þis rote & I schal rachche after
620 & brynge a morsel of bred to banne *your*
hertte.”

and bring them a morsel of
bread.

“Fare forthe,” *quod* þe freke3, “& fech as þou segge3;
By bole of þis brode tre we byde þe here.”

55

Abraham commands Sara
to make some cakes quick

Penne orppedly in-to his hous he hy3ed to Saré
624 Comaunded hir to be cof & quyk at þis one3;
“Þre mette3 of mele menge & ma kake3,
Vnder aske3 ful hote happe hem byliue;
Quyl I fete sumquat fat þou þe fyr bete,
628 Prestly at þis ilke poynte sum polment to make.”

He cached to his cobhous & a calf brynge3
Þat wat3 tender & not to3e; bed tyrne of þe hyde,
& sayde to his seruauent þat he hit seþe faste
632 & he deruely at his dome dy3t hit bylyue.

cobhous] *cov-hous* = cow
house (?).

and tells his servant to see
a tender kid.

Þe burne to be bare-heued buske3 hym þenne,
Cleche3 to a clene cloþe & keste3 on þe grene,
Þrwe þryftyly þer-on þo þre þerue kake3,
636 & brynge3 butter wyth-al, & by þe bred sette3
Mete; messe3 of mylke he merkke3 bytwene,

Abraham appears bare-
headed before his guests.

He casts a clean cloth on the
green,

and sets before them cake
butter, milk, and pottage.

Syþen potage & polment in plater honest;
As sewer in a god assyse he serued hem fayre,
640 Wyth sadde semblaunt & swete of such as he hade,

DISCLOSES HIS PURPOSE TO ABRAHAM.

& god as a glad gest mad god chere,
þat wat3 fayn of his frende & his fest prayسد.
Abraham, al hodel3 with arme3 vp-folden,
644 Mynystred mete byfore þo men þat my3tes al
welde3;

God praises his friend's
feast,

þenne þay sayden, as þay sete samen alle þrynne,
When þe mete wat3 remued & þay of mensk
speken,

and after the meat is
removed,

“I schal efte here away abram,” þay sayden,
648 “3et er þy lyue3 ly3t leþe vpon erþe,
& þenne schal saré consayue & a sun bere,
þat schal be abrahame3 ayre, & after hym wynne
With wele & wyth worschyp þe worpely peple
652 þat schal halde in heritage, þat I haf men 3ark.”
þenne þe burde byhynde þe dor for busmar la3ed;
& sayde sothly to hir-self saré þe madde:

[Fol. 6]

He tells Abraham that Sar
shall bear him a son.

“May þou traw for tykle þat þou tonne mo3te3,
656 & I so hy3e out of age & also my lorde,”
For sobely, as says þe wryt, he wern of sadde elde,
Boþe þe wy3e & his wyf, such werk wat3 hem fayled,

Sarah, who is behind the
door, laughs in unbelief.

sothly] ? *softly* or *sotly*
foolishly

56
Fro mony a brod day by-fore ho barayn ay byene,
660 þat selue saré with-uten sede in-to þat same tyme.
þenne sayde oure syre þer he sete “se! so saré
la3es,

byene] ? *bycame*.

God tells Abraham that
Sarah laughs at His words

Not trawande þe tale þat I þe to schewed;
Hope3 ho o3t may be harde my honde3 to work?
664 & 3et I a-vow verayly þe avaunt þat I made,
I schal 3eþly a3ayn & 3elde þat I hy3t,
& sothely sende to saré a soñ & an hayre.”
þenne swenged forth saré & swer by hir trawþe,

668 Þat for lot þat þay lanced ho lazed neuer.
“Now innoghe hit is not so” þenne nurned þe
dryȝtyn,

Sarah denies that she
laughed.
lanced] laused (?).

“For þou lazed aloȝ, bot let we hit one.”
With þat þay ros vp radly as þay rayke schulde,
672 & setten toward sodamas her syȝt alle at-oneȝ;

Abraham’s guests set out
towards Sodom,

For þat Cite þer bysyde watȝ sette in a vale,
No myleȝ fro mambre mo þen tweyne,
Where-so wonyed þis ilke wyȝ þat wendeȝ with oure
lorde,

two miles from Mamre.

676 For to tent hym with tale & teche hym þe gate,
Þen glydeȝ forth god, þe godmon hym folȝeȝ.
Abraham heldeȝ hem wyth, hem to conueye,
In towarde þe Cety of sodamas þat synned had þenne
680 In þe faute of þis fylþe; þe fader hem þretes,
& sayde þus to þe segg þat sued hym after:
“How myȝt I hyde myn hert fro habraham þe
trwe,

The patriarch accompanie
them.

God determines to reveal
Abraham his secret purpo

Þat I ne dyscouered to his corse my counsayl so dere.
684 Syþen he is chosen to be chef chyldryn fader,
Þat so folk schal falle fro, to flete alle þe worlde,
& vche blod in þat burne blessed schal worþe.
Me þos telle to þat tolk þe tene of my wyll
688 & alle myn atlyng to abraham vn-haspe bilyue.

[Fol. 6]

ILTHINESS OF SODOM AND GOMORRAH.

IX.

“**T**he grete soun of sodamas synkkeȝ in myn
ereȝ,

He informs him of the
destruction about to fall u
the cities of the plain,

& þe gult of gomorre gareȝ me to wrath;
I schal lyȝt in-to þat led & loke my seluen,
692 If þay haf don as þe dyne dryueȝ on-lofte,

If] MS. inf.

57

Þay han lerned a lyst þat lykeȝ me ille,

for their great wickedness

Þat þay han founden in her flesch of fauteþ þe werst,
 Vch male matþ his mach a man as hym seluen,
 696 & fylter folyly in fere, on femmaleþ wyse.
 I compast hem a kynde crafte & kende hit hem derne,
 & amed hit in myn ordenaunce oddely dere,
 & dyþt drwry þer-inne, doole alþer-swettest,
 700 & þe play of paramoreþ I portrayed my seluen;
 & made þer-to a maner myriest of oþer,
 When two true togeder had tyged hem seluen,
 By-twene a male & his make such merþe schulde
 conne;
 704 Wel nyþe pure paradys moþt preue no better,
 Elleþ þay moþt honestly ayþer oþer welde.
 At a styлле stollen steuen, vnstered wyth syþt,
 Luf lowe hem bytwene lasched so hote,
 708 Þat alle þe meschefeþ on mold moþt hit not
 sleke;
 Now haf þay skyfted my skyl & scorned natwre,
 & hentteþ hem in heþyng an vsage vn-clene;
 Hem to smyte for þat smod smartly I þenk
 712 Þat wyþeþ schal be by hem war, worlde with-
 outen ende.”

in abusing the gifts bestow
upon them.

The ordinance of marriag
had been made for them,

conne] come (?).

but they foully set it at
nought.

The flame of love.

Therefore shall they be
destroyed as an example t
all men for ever.

HAM PLEADS FOR THE CITIES.

Þenne arþed abraham & alle his mod chaunge[d],
 For hope of þe harde hate þat hyþt hatþ oure lorde;
 Al sykande he sayde “*sir with* yor leue,
 716 Schal synful & sakleþ suffer al on payne;
 Weþer euer hit lyke my lorde to lyfte such domeþ,
 Þat þe wykked & þe worþy schal on wrake suffer,
 & weye vpon þe worre half þat wrathed þe neuer?
 720 Þat watþ neuer þy won þat wroþteþ *vus* alle.
 Now fyfty fyn frendeþ wer founde in 3onde toune
 In þe Cety of Sodamas & also gomorré
 Þat neuer lakked þy laue, bot loued ay traupe,

Abraham is full of fear,

and asks God whether the
“sinful and the sinless” ar
suffer together.

[Fol. 6’

Whether he will spare the
cities provided fifty
righteous are found in the

724 & reȝt-ful wern & resounable & redy þe to serue,
Schal þay falle in þe faute þat oþer frekeȝ wroȝt
& ioyne to her iuggement her iuise to haue?
Þat nas neuer þyn note, vnneuened hit worþe,
728 Þat art so gaynly a god & of goste mylde!”

58

“Nay for fyfty,” *quod* þe fader, “& þy fayre
speche,

& þay be founden in þat folk of her fylþe clene,
I schal for-gyue alle þe gylt þurȝ my *grace* one,
732 & let hem *smolt* al unsmyten smobely atoneȝ.”

“AA! blessed be þow,” *quod* þe burne, “so boner
& þewed,

& al haldeȝ in þy honde, þe heuen & þe erþe,
Bot for I haf þis talke tatȝ to non ille,

736 Ȝif I mele a lyttel more þat mul am & askeȝ;
What if fyue faylen of fyfty þe noumbre,
& þe remnaunt be reken, how restes þy wyлле?”

“And fyue wont of fyfty,” *quod* god, “I schal
forȝete alle

740 & wyth-halde my honde for hortyng on lede.”

“& quat if faurty be fre & fauty þyse oþer
Schalt þow schortly al schende & schape non oþer.”

“Nay þaȝ faurty forfeȝe ȝet *fryst* I a whyle,

744 & voyde away my vengauunce, þaȝ me vyl
þynk.”

Þen abraham obeched hym & loȝly him þonkkeȝ,

“Now sayned be þou sauour, so symple in þy wrath!

I am bot erþe ful euel & *vsle* so blake,

748 Forto mele wyth such a mayster as myȝteȝ hatȝ
alle,

Bot I haue by-gonnen wyth my god, & he hit gayn
þynkeȝ,

Ȝif I for-loyne as a fol þy fraunchyse may serue;

What if þretty þryuande be þrad in ȝon touneȝ,

752 What schal I leue if my lorde, if he hem *leþe*
wolde?”

&] An (?).

For the sake of fifty the ci
shall be spared.

The patriarch beseeches C
to spare the city for the sa
of forty-five righteous.

For the lack of five the cit
shall not be destroyed.

For forty the cities shall b
spared.

Abraham entreats God’s
forbearance for his speech

þenne þe godlych god gef hym onsware,
“Ȝet for þretty in þrong I schal my þro steke,
& spare spakly of spyt in space of my þeweȝ,
756 & my rankor refrayne four þy reken wordeȝ.”
“What for twenty,” quod þe tolke, “vntwyneȝ þou
hem þenne?”

Thirty righteous, found in
the cities, shall save them
from destruction.

[Fol. 6]

“Nay, ȝif þou ȝerneȝ hit, ȝet ȝark I hem grace;
If þat twenty be trwe I tene hem no more,
760 Bot relece alle þat regioun of her ronk
werkkeȝ.”

For the sake of twenty
guiltless ones God will
release the rest.

“Now aþel lorde,” quod Abraham, “oneȝ a speche
& I schal schape no more þo schalkkeȝ to helpe;
59

If ten trysty in toun be tan in þi werkkeȝ
764 Wylt þou mese þy mode & menddyng abyde?”
“I graunt,” quod þe grete god, “graunt mercy,” þat
oþer.

Or if ten only should be
found pure.

& þenne arest þe renk & raȝt no fyrre;
& godde glydeȝ his gate by þose grene wayeȝ
768 & he conueyen hym con with cast of his yȝe,

ENGERS ARE SENT TO LOT.

& als he loked along þere as oure lorde passed,
Ȝet he cryed hym after with careful steuen:
“Meke mayster on þy mon to mynne if þe lyked,
772 Loth lengeȝ in ȝon leede þat is my lef broþer,
He sytteȝ þer in sodomis, þy seruaunt so pouere
Among þo mansed men þat han þe much greued;
Ȝif þou tyneȝ þat toun, tempre þyn yre
776 As þy mersy may malte þy meke to spare.”
þen he wendeȝ, wendeȝ his way wepande for care
To-warde þe mere of mambre wepande for
so[rȝe,]

The patriarch intercedes f
Lot.

Beseeches Him to “tempe
His ire,”

and then departs weeping
sorrow.

so[rȝe]] sorewe is writt
by a late hand over the
original word.

& þere in longyng al nyȝt he lengeȝ in wones,
780 Whyl þe souerayn to sodamas sende to spye.

X.

His sondes *in-to* sodamas wat3 sende *in* þat
tyme,

God's messengers go to
Sodom.

In þat ilk euentyde, by aungels tweyne,
Meuand meuande mekely togeder as myry men
3onge,

Meuand meuande] So i
MS.

784 As loot in a loge dor lened hym alone,
In a porche of þat place py3t to þe 3ates,
þat wat3 ryal & ryche, so wat3 þe renkes seluen.
As he stared *in-to* þe strete þer stout men played
788 He sy3e þer swey *in* asent swete men tweyne;
Bolde burne3 wer þay boþe *with* berdles chynne3,
Royl rollande fax to raw sylk lyke,
Of ble as þe brere flour where-so þe bare scheweed,
792 Ful clene wat3 þe countenaunce of her cler y3en;
Wlonk whit wat3 her wede & wel hit hem semed.

Lot is sitting alone at the
"door of his lodge."

Staring into the street he s
two men.

Beardless chins they had,
and hair like raw silk.

Of alle feture3 ful fyn & faulte3 boþe;
Wat3 non autly *in* ouþer, for aungels hit wern,
60

[Fol. 6i
Beautifully white were the
weeds.

796 & þat þe 3ep vnder-3ede þat *in* þe 3ate sytte3.

ENTERTAINS THE MESSENGERS.

He ros vp ful radly & ran hem to mete
& lo3e he loute3 hem to, loth, to þe grounde,
& syþen soberly [sat3] "syre3 I yow by-seche,
800 þat 3e wolde ly3t at my loge & lenge þer-inne,
Come3 to *your* knaues kote I craue at þis one3;
I schal fette yow a fatte *your* fette forto wasche;
I norne yow bot for on ny3t ne3e me to lenge,
804 & *in* þe myry mornyng 3e may *your* waye
take."

Lot runs to meet them.

Invites them to remain
awhile in his house,

and in the morning they m
take their way.

& þay nay þat þay nolde ne3 no howse3,
Bot styllly þer *in* þe strete as þay stadde wern,
þay wolde lenge þe long na3t & logge þer-oute;
808 Hit wat3 hous inno3e to hem þe heuen vpon lofte.

Loth laped so longe wyth luflych worde3,
þat þay hym graunted to go & gru3t no lenger.
þe bolde to his byggyng brynge3 hem bylyue,
812 þat ryally [wat3] arayed, for he wat3 ryche
euer.

Lot invites them so long t
at last they comply.

The wife and daughters of
Lot welcome their visitors

þe wy3e3 wern welcom as þe wyf coupe,
His two dere do3tere3 deuoutly hem haylsed,
þat wer maydene3 ful meke, maryed not 3et,
816 & þay wer semly & swete, & swyþe wel arayed.

Lot admonishes his men t
prepare the meat,

Loth þenne ful ly3tly loke3 hym aboute,
& his men amonestes mete forto dy3t,
Bot þenkke3 on hit be þrefte what þynk so 3e make,
820 For wyth no sour ne no salt serue3 hym neuer.

þynk] *þyng* (?).

sour] *savour* (?).

Bot 3et I wene þat þe wyf hit wroth to dyspyt,
& sayde softly to hir self “þis vn-sauere hyne
Loue3 no salt in her sauce 3et hit no skyl were
824 þat oþer burne be boute þa3 boþe be nyse.”

and to serve no salt with i
wroth] *wro3t* (?).

vn-sauere] MS. *vnfauer*

þenne ho sauere3 *with* salt her seue3 vchone
Agayne þe bone of þe burne þat hit forboden
hade,

Lot’s wife disregards the
injunction.

& als ho scelt hem in scorne þat wel her skyl knewen.
828 Why wat3 ho wrech so wod, ho wrathed oure lorde!

þenne seten þay at þe soper, wern serued by-lyue,
þe gestes gay & ful glad, of glam debonere,
Welawynnely wlonk tyl þay waschen hade,

[Fol. 6i

The guests are well
entertained.

61

832 þe trestes tylt to þe wo3e & þe table boþe.
Fro þe segge3 haden souped & seten bot a whyle,
Er euer þay bosked to bedde þe bor3 wat3 al vp;
Alle þat weppen my3t welde, þe wakker & þe stronger,
836 To vmbe-ly3e lothe3 hous þe lede3 to take,
In grete flokke3 of folk, þay fallen to his 3ate3,
As a scowte-wach scarred, so þe asscry rysed;

But before they go to rest
city is up in arms.

HOUSE IS BESET.

With kene clobbe3 of þat clos þay clat3 on þe wowe3,

840 & wyth a schrylle scharp schout þay schewe
þyse worde:

“If þou louye3 þy lyf loth in þyse wone3
3ete *vus* out þose 3ong men þat 3ore-whyle here
entred,

þat we may lere hym of lof, as oure lyst bidde3,
844 As is þe asyse of Sodomas to segge3 þat passen.”

Whatt! þay sputen & speken of so spitous fylþe,

What! þay 3e3ed & 3olped of 3estande sor3e,

þat 3et þe wynd, & þe weder, & þe worlde stynkes

848 Of þe brych þat vp-brayde3 þose broþelych
worde3.

þe god man glyfte with þat glam & gloped for noyse,
So scharpe schame to hym schot, he schrank at þe hert,
For he knew þe costoum þat kyþed þose wreche3,
852 He doted neuer for no doel so depe in his mynde.

Allas! sayd hym þenne loth, & ly3tly he ryse3
& bowe3 forth fro þe bench in-to þe brode 3ates.

What! he wonded no woþe of wekked knaue3,

856 þat he ne passed þe port þe peril to abide.

He went forthe at þe wyket & waft hit hym after,
þat a clyket hit cle3t clos hym byhynde.

þenne he meled to þo men mesurable worde3,

860 For harlote3 with his hendelayk he hoped to chast;

“Oo! my frende3 so fre, *your* fare is to strange,

Dot3 away *your* derf dyn & dere3 neuer my gestes,

Avoy! hit is *your* vylaynye, 3e vylen *your* seluen;

864 & 3e ar iolyf gentylnen *your* iapes ar ille.

Bot I schal kenne yow by kynde a crafte þat is
better;

I haf a tresor in my telde of tow my fayre de3ter,
þat ar maydene3 vnmard for alle men 3ette;

62

868 In sodamas, þa3 I hit say, non semloker burdes,

Hit arn ronk, hit arn rype & redy to manne;

To samen wyth þo semly þe solace is better,

I schal biteche yow þo two þat tayt arn & quoynt,

With “keen clubs” the foll
clatter on the walls,

and demand that Lot shou
deliver up his guests.

hym] *hem* (?).

The wind yet stinks with
their filthy speech.

Lot is in great trouble.

peril] MS. *pil*.

He leaves his guests

and addresses the Sodomi

&] *And* = *An* (?).

[Fol. 6]

He offers to give up to the
his two daughters.

872 & layke3 wyth hem as yow lyst & lete3 my gestes
one.”

Þenne þe rebaude3 so ronk rerð such a noyse,
Þat a3ly hurled in his ere3 her harlote3 speche;
“Wost þou not wel þat þou wone3 here a wy3e
strange,

The rebels raise a great
noise,

and ask who made him a
justice to judge their deed

876 An out-comlyng, a carle, we kylle of þyn heued.
Who Ioyned þe be iostyse oure iape3 to blame,
Þat com a boy to þis bor3, þa3 þou be burne
ryche?”

who was but a boy when I
came to Sodom.

Þus þay þrobled & þrong & þrwe vmbe his ere3,
880

& distresed hym wonder strayt, *with* strenkþe in þe
prece,

THE MEN OF SODOM SMITTEN WITH BLINDNESS.

Bot þat þe 3onge men, so 3epe, 3ornen þer-oute,
Wapped vpon þe wyket & wonnen hem tylle,
& by þe honde3 hym hent & horyed hym *with-inne*,
884 & steken þe 3ates ston-harde wyth stalworth barre3.

The young men bring Lot
within doors,

Þay blwe a boffet in blande þat banned peple,
Þat þay blustered as blynde as bayard wat3 euer;
Þay lest of lote3 logging any lysoun to fynde,
888 Bot nyteled þer alle þe ny3t for no3t at þe last;
Þenne vch tolke ty3t hem þat hade of tayt fayled,
& vchon ropeled to þe rest þat he reche mo3t;
Bot þay wern wakned al wrank þat þer in won

and smite those outside w
blindness.

In vain they try to find the
door of Lot’s house.

wrank] *wrang* (?).

lenged,
892 Of on þe vglokest vnhap þat euer on erd suffred.

3 SENT OUT OF THE CITY.

XI.

Ruðdon of þe day-rawe ros vpon v3ten,
When merk of þe mydny3t mo3t no more last,

Ful erly þose aungelez þis habel þay ruþen
896 & glopnedly on godez halue gart hym vpryse,
Fast þe freke ferkez vp ful ferd at his hert;
Þay comaunded hym cof to cach þat he hade,
“Wyth þy wyf & þy wy3ez & þy wlone de3tters,
900 For we laþe þe, *sir* loth, þat þou þy lyf haue;
Cayre tid of þis kythe er combred þou worþe,

63

With alle þi here vpon haste, tyl þou a hil fynde;
Foundez faste on *your* fete, bifore *your* face lokes,
904 Bot bes neuer so bolde to blusch yow bihynde,
& loke 3e stemme no stepe, bot strechez on faste,
Til 3e reche to a reset, rest 3e neuer;
For we schal tyne þis toun & trayþely disstrye,
908 Wyth alle þise wy3ez so wykke wy3tly de-
voyde

& alle þe londe *with* þise ledez we losen at one3;
Sodomas schal ful sodenly synk *in-to* grounde,
& þe grounde of gomorre gorde *in-to* helle,
912 & vche a koste of þis kythe clater vpon hepes.
Þen laled loth, “lorde what is best?
If I me fele vpon fote þat I fle mo3t,
Hov schulde I huyde me fro hem þat hat3 his hate
kynned,

916 *In* þe brath of his breth þat brennez alle þinke3,
To crepe fro my creatour & know not wheder,
Ne wheþer his fooschip me fol3ez bifore oþer
bihynde?”

Þe freke sayde “no foschip oure fader hat3 þe schewed,
920 Bot hizly heuened þi hele fro hem þat arn combred:
Nov walle þe a wonnyng þat þe warisch my3t,
& he schal saue hit for þy sake þat hat3 *vus* sende
hider,

For þou art oddely þyn one out of þis fylþe,
924 & als Abraham þyn em hit at *him* self asked.”
“Lorde, loued he worþe,” *quod* loth, “vpon erþe!
Þen is a cite herbisyde þat segor hit hatte,

Early in the morning the
angels command Lot to
depart from Sodom,

with his wife and two
daughters,

[Fol. 6v]

and to look straight before
him,

for Sodom and Gomorrah
shall be destroyed.

Lot asks what is best to be
done,

that he may escape.

þinke3] *þinge3*.

He is told to choose himse
a dwelling which shall be
saved from destruction.

em] *broþer* is written ov
in a later hand.

He chooses Zoar.

Here vtter on a rounde hil hit houe3 hit one,
 928 I wolde, if his wylle wore, to þat won scape.”
 “Þenn fare forth,” *quod* þat fre, “& fyne þou neuer
 With þose ilk þat þow wylt þat þrenge þe after,
 & ay goande on *your* gate, wyth-oute agayn-tote,
 932 For alle þis londe schal be lorne, longe er þe sonne
 rise.”

The angels command Lot
 depart quickly.

Þe wy3e wakened his wyf & his wlonk de3teres,
 & oþer two myri men þo maydene3 schulde
 wedde;

He wakes his wife and
 daughters.

& þay token hit as tyt & tented hit lyttel,
 936 Þa3 fast laped hem loth, þay lezen ful styлле.

64

[Fol. 70

Þe aungelez hasted þise oþer & a3ly hem þratten,
 & enforsed alle fawre forth at þe 3ate3,
 Þo wern loth & his lef, his luflyche de3ter,
 940 Þer so3t no mo to sauement of cities aþel fyue.
 Þise aungelez hade hem by hande out at þe 3ate3,
 Prechande hem þe perile, & beden hem passe fast.
 “Lest 3e be taken in þe teche of tyraunte3 here,
 944 Loke 3e bowe now bi bot, bowe3 fast hence!”

All four are hastened on b
 the angels,

who “preach to them the
 peril” of delay.

& þay kayre-ne con & kenely flowen;
 Erly, er any heuen glem, þay to a hil comen.
 Þe grete god in his greme bygynne3 onlofte;
 948 To wakan wedere3 so wylde þe wynde3 he calle3,
 & þay wropely vp-wafte & wrastled togeder,
 Fro fawre half of þe folde, flytande loude.

Before daylight Lot come
 a hill.

God aloft raises a storm.

Clowde3 clustered bytwene kesten vp torres,
 952 Þat þe þik þunder þrast þirled hem ofte.

A rain falls thick of fire ar
 sulphur.

Þe rayn rueled adoun, ridlande þikke,
 Of felle flaunkes of fyr & flakes of soufre,
 Al in smolderande smoke smachande ful ille,
 956 Swe aboute sodamas & hit syde3 alle,

Swe] Sweyed (?).

Gorde to gomorra þat þe grounde lansed;
 Abdama & syboym, þise ceteis alle faure,
 Al birolled wyth þe rayn, rostted & brenned,
 960 & ferly flayed þat folk þat in þose fees lenged;

Upon the four cities it
 comes,

For when þat þe helle herde þe houndez of heuen
He wat3 ferlyly fayn, vnfolded bylyue.

and frightens all folks
therein.

DESTRUCTION OF THE CITIES.

þe grete barre3 of þe abyme he barst vp at one3,
964 þat alle þe regioun to-rof in riftes ful grete,
& clouen alle in lyttel cloutes þe clyffe3 aywhere,
As lance leue3 of þe boke þat lepes in twynne.
þe brethe of þe brynston bi þat hit blende were,
968 Al þo citees & her sydes sunkken to helle.
Rydelles wern þo grete rowtes of renkkes *with-inne*,
When þay wern war of þe wrake þat no wy3e achaped,
Such a 3omerly 3arm of 3ellyng þer rysed;
972 þer-of clatered þe cloudes þat kryst my3t haf
rawþe.

The great bars of the abys
do burst.

Cliffs cleave asunder.

The cities sink to hell.

Such a cry arises that the
clouds clatter again.

65

[Fol. 71

þe segge herde þat soun to segor þat 3ede,
& þe wenchis hym wyth þat by þe way fol3ed;
Ferly ferde wat3 her flesch, þat flowen ay ilyche,
976 Trynande ay a hy3e trot þat torne neuer
dorsten.

Lot and his companions a
frightened,

Loth & þo luly-whit his lefly two de3ter,
Ay fol3ed here face, bifore her boþe y3en;
Bot þe balleful burde, þat neuer bode keped,

but continue to follow the
face.

WIFE BECOMES A STIFF STONE.

980 Blusched by-hynden her bak, þat bale forto
herkken;
Hit wat3 lusty lothes wyf þat ouer he[r] lyfte schulder.
Ones ho bluschet to þe bur3e, bot bod ho no lenger,
þat ho nas stadde a stiffe ston, a stalworth image
984 Al so salt as ani se & so ho 3et stande3.
þay slypped bi & sy3e hir not þat wern hir samen
feres,
Tyl þay in segor wern sette, & sayned our lorde;

Lot's wife looks behind h

and is turned to a stiff stoi
"as salt as any sea."

Her companions do not m
her till they reach Zoar.

Wyth lyzt loue3 vplyfte þay loued hym swyþe,
988 Þat so his seruauntes wolde see & saue of such
woþe.

Al wat3 dampþed & don, & drowned by þenne;
þe lede3 of þat lyttel toun wern lopen out for
drede,

In-to þat malscrande mere, marred bylyue,
992 Þat no3t saued wat3 bot segor þat sat on a
lawe,

þe þre lede3 þer-in, loth & his de3ter;
For his make wat3 myst, þat on þe mount lenged
In a stonen statue þat salt sauor habbes,
996 For two fautes þat þe fol wat3 founde in
mistrauþe;

On, ho serued at þe soper salt bifore dry3tyn
& syþen, ho blusched hir bihynde, þa3 hir
forboden were;

For on ho standes a ston, & salt for þat oþer,
1000 & alle lyst on hir lik þat arn on launde bestes.
Abraham ful erly wat3 vp on þe morne,
þat alle na3t [so] much niye hade no mon in his
hert,

Al in longing for loth leyn in a wache,
1004 þer he lafte hade oure lorde, he is on lofte
wonnen;

He sende toward sodomas þe sy3t of his y3en,
þat euer hade ben an erde of erþe þe swettest
As aparaunt to paradis þat plantted þe dry3tyn,
66

1008 Nov is hit plunged in a pit like of pich fylled.
Suche a ropun of a reche ros fro þe blake,
Aske3 vpe in þe ayre & vselle3 þer flowen,
As a fornes ful of flot þat vpon fyr boyles,
1012 When bry3t brennande bronde3 ar bet þer an-
vnder.

þis wat3 a uengaunce violent þat voyded þise places,
þat foundered hat3 so fayr a folk & þe folde sonkken.

By this time all were
drowned.

The people of Zoar, for
dread, rush into the sea and
are destroyed.

Only Zoar with three there
(Lot and his daughters) are
saved.

Lot's wife is an image of
for two faults:
1. She served salt before the
Lord at supper.
2. She looked behind her.

Abraham is up full early on
the morn.

He looks towards Sodom,

now only a pit filled with
pitch,

[Fol. 7v]

from which rise smoke,
ashes and cinders, as from
furnace.

Þer faure citees wern set, nov is a see called,
 1016 Þat ay is drouy & dym, & ded in hit kynde,
 Blo, blubrande, & blak, vnblyþe to neþe,
 As a stynkande stanc þat stryed synne,
 Þat euer of synne & of smach, smart is to fele;
 1020 For-þy þe derk dede see hit is demed euer
 more,

For hit dedeþ of deþe duren þere 3et.
 For hit is brod & boþemleþ, & bitter as þe galle,
 & no3t may lenge in þat lake þat any lyf bereþ,
 1024 & alle þe costeþ of kynde hit combreþ vchone;
 For lay þer-on a lump of led & hit on loft fleteþ,
 & folde þer-on a lyþt fyþer & hit to founs
 synkkeþ.

& þer water may walter to wete any erþe,
 1028 Schal neuer grene þer-on growe, gresse ne
 wod nawþer.

If any schalke to be schent wer schowued þer-inne,
 Þaþ he bode in þat boþem broþely a monyth,
 He most ay lyue in þat loþe in losyng euer-more,
 1032 & neuer dryþe no dethe, to dayes of ende;
 & as hit is corsed of kynde & hit coosteþ als,
 Þe clay þat clenges þer-by arn corsyes strong,
 As alum & alkaran, þat angré arn boþe,
 1036 Soufre sour, & saundyuer, & oþer such mony;
 & þer walteþ of þat water in waxlokes grete,
 Þe spuniande aspaltoun þat spysereþ sellen;
 & suche is alle þe soyle by þat se halues,
 1040 Þat fel fretes þe flesch & festred bones.
 & þer ar tres by þat terne of traytours;
 & þay borgouneþ & beres blomeþ ful fayre,
 & þe fayrest fryt þat may on folde growe,
 67

1044 As orange & oþer fryt & apple garnade
 Also red & so ripe & rychely hwed,

A sea now occupies the place of the four cities.

It is a stinking pool,

and is called the Dead Sea

Nothing may live in it.

Lead floats on its surface.

A feather sinks to the bottom of it.

Lands, watered by this sea, never bear grass or weed.

A man cannot be drowned in it.

The clay clinging to it is corrosive,

alkaran] *alkatran* (?).

angré] *augre* = *aigre* (?)

as alum, alkaran, sulphur, etc.,

spuniande] *spinnande* (

festred] *festres* (?).

which fret the flesh and fester the bones.

On the shores of this lake grow trees bearing fair fruit

As any dom myȝt deuice of dayntyȝ oute;	
Bot quen hit is brused oȝer broken, oȝer byten in	which, when broken or
twynne,	bitten, taste like ashes.
1048 No worldeȝ goud hit wyth-inne, bot <u>wydowande</u>	wydowande] MS.
askes;	wyndowande.

A TOKEN OF WICKEDNESS AND VENGEANCE.

Alle þyſe ar teches & tokenes to trow vpon ȝet,	All these are tokens of
& wittneſſe of þat wykked werk & þe wrake	wickedness and vengeance
after,	
Þat oure fader forferde for fylþe of þoſe ledes.	
1052 Þenne vch wyȝe may wel wyt þat he þe wlonk	God loves the pure in heart
louies,	
& if he louyes clene layk þat is oure lorde ryche,	
& to be coupe in his courte þou coueytes þenne	Strive to be clean.
To ſe þat ſemly in ſete & his ſwete face,	
1056 Clerrer counſeyl, counſayl con I non, bot þat þou	
clene worþe.	
For clopyngnel in þe compas of his clene roſe,	Jean de Meun tells how a
Þer he expouneȝ a ſpeche, to hym þat ſpede	lady is to be loved.
wolde,	
Of a lady to be loued, loke to hir ſone,	
1060 Of wich beryng þat ho be, & wych ho beſt	By doing what pleases her
louyes,	beſt.
& be ryȝt ſuch in vch a borȝe of body & of dedes,	
& folȝ þe fet of þat fere þat þou fre haldes.	
& if þou wyrkkes on þiſ wyſe, þaȝ ho wyk were,	
1064 Hir ſchal lyke þat layk þat lyknes hir tylle.	
If þou wyl dele drwrye wyth dryȝtyn þenne,	
& lelly louy þy lorde & his leef worþe.	Love thy Lord!
Þenne confourme þe to kryſt, & þe clene make,	Conform to Christ, who is
1068 Þat euer is polyced als playn as þe perle	polished as a pearl.
ſeluen.	
For loke fro fyrſt þat he lyȝt with-inne þe lel mayden!	

IT WAS EVER PURE.

By how comly a kest he wat3 clos þere,
When venkkyst wat3 no *vergynyte*, ne *vyolence*
maked,

1072 Bot much clener wat3 hir corse, god *kynned*
þerinne;

& efte when he borne wat3 in *bepelen* þe *ryche*,
In wych *puryte* þay departed; þa3 þay *pouer* were,
Wat3 neuer so blysfyl a *bour* as wat3 *abos* þenne

1076 Ne no schroude hous so schene as a *schepon*
þare,

Ne non so glad vnder god as ho þat grone schulde;
68

For þer wat3 seknesse al sounde þat sarrest is
halden,

& þer wat3 rose *reflayr* where *rote* hat3 ben euer,
1080 & þer wat3 solace & songe wher sor3 hat3 ay
cryed;

For aungelles *with instrumentes* of organes &
pypes,

& rial ryngande rotes & þe reken *fypel*,
& alle hende þat honestly mo3t an hert glade,
1084 Aboutte my lady wat3 lent, quen ho delyuer were.

Þenne wat3 her blyþe barne burnyst so clene,
Þat boþe þe ox & þe asse hym hered at-ones;
Þay knewe hym by his clannes for kyng of nature,
1088 For non so clene of such a clos com neuer er
þenne;

& 3if clanly he þenne com, ful cortays þer-after,
Þat alle þat longed to luper ful lodly he hated;
By nobleye of his norture he nolde neuer towche
1092 O3t þat wat3 vngoderly oþer ordure wat3
inne.

3et comen lodly to þat lede, as lazares monye,
Summe lepre, summe lome, & *lomerande blynde*,
Poysened & parlatyk & pyned in fyres,

1096 Drye folk & ydropike, & dede at þe laste;
Alle called on þat cortayse & claymed his *grace*.

By how comely a
contrivance did he enter tl
womb of the virgin!

In what purity did he part
from her!

abos] *abof* (?).

No abode was better than
his.

The sorrow of childbirth v
turned to joy.

[Fol. 7.]

Angels solaced the virgin
with organs and pipes.

The child Christ was so
clean that ox and ass
worshipped him.

He hated wickedness,

and would never touch ou
that was vile.

Yet there came to him laz:
and lepers, lame and blind

Dry and dropsical folk.

He heled hem wyth hynde speche of þat þay ask
after,

He healed all with kind
speech.

For what-so he towched also-tyd tourned to hele,

1100 Wel clanner þen any crafte cowþe devyse;

So clene wat3 his hondelyng vche ordure hit schonied,

& þe gropyng so goud of god & man boþe,

His handling was so good

þat for fetys of his fyngeres fonded he neuer

1104 Nauper to cout ne to kerue, with knyf ne wyth
egge,

cout] *cut* (?).

that he needed no knife to
cut or carve with.

For-þy brek he þe bred blades wyth-uten;

The bread he broke

For hit ferde freloker *in fete in* his fayre honde,

more perfectly than could
the tools of Toulouse.

Displayed more pryuyly when he hit part schulde,

1108 Þenne alle þe toles of tolowse mo3t ty3t hit to
kerue,

Þus is he kyryous & clene þat þou his cort asks;

How can we approach his
court except we be clean?

Hov schulde þou com to his kyth bot if þou clene
were?

Nov ar we sore & synful & sov[er]ly vch one,

sov[er]ly] MS. *sovly*.

1112 How schulde we se, þen may we say, þat syre
vpon throne?

69

God is merciful.

3is, þat mayster is mercyable; þa3 þou be man
fenny,

& al to-marred *in* myre whyl þou on molde lyuyes,

þou may schyne þur3 schryfte, þa3 þou haf schome
serued,

NCE MAKES MAN PURE AS A PEARL.

1116 & pure þe with penaunce tyl þou a perle
worþe.

Through penance we may
shine as a pearl.

Perle praysed is prys, þer perre is schewed,

[Fol. 7:

þa3 hym not derrest be demed to dele for penies,

Why is the pearl so prized

Quat may þe cause be called, bot for hir clene
hwes,

1120 Þat wynnes worschyp, abof alle whyte stones?

For ho schynes so schyr þat is of schap rounde,

Wyth-outen faut oþer fylþe 3if ho fyn were;
& wax euer in þe worlde in weryng so olde,
1124 3et þe perle payres not whyle ho in pyese
lasttes

She becomes none the wo
for wear.

& if hit cheue þe chaunce vncheryst ho worþe,
þat ho blyndes of ble in bour þer ho lygges,
No-bot wasch hir wyth wourchyp in wyn as ho askes,
1128 Ho by kynde schal be-com clerer þen are;
So if folk be defowled by vnfre chaunce,
þat he be sulped in sawle, seche to schryfte
& he may polyce hym at þe prest, by penaunce
taken,

If she should become dim
wash her in wine.

She then becomes clearer
than before.

So may the sinner polish l
by penance.

1132 Wel bry3ter þen þe beryl oþer browden perles.
Bot war þe wel, if þou be waschen wyth water of
schryfte,

Beware of returning to sir

& polysed als playn as parchmen schauen,
Sulp no more þenne in synne þy saule þer-after,
1136 For þenne þou dry3tyn dyspleses with dedes
ful sore,

For then God is more
displeased than ever.

& entyses hym to tene more trayþly þen euer
& wel hatter to hate þen hade þou not waschen;
For when a sawele is sa3tled & sakred to dry3tyn,
1140 He holly haldes hit his & haue hit he wolde,
þenne efte lastes hit likkes, he loses hit ille,
As hit were rafte wyth vn-ry3t & robbed wyth þewes. þewes] þeues. (?).
War þe þenne for þe wrake, his wrath is achaufed,

The reconciled soul God
holds as His own.

Ill deeds rob Him of it.

PUNISHES IMPURITY.

1144 For þat þat ones wat3 his schulde efte be vn-
clene,

God forbids us to defile ai
vessels used in His servic

þa3 hit be bot a bassyn, a bolle, oþer a scole,
A dysche oþer a dobler þat dry3tyn one3 serued,
70

To defowle hit euer vpon folde fast he for-bedes,
1148 So is he scoymus of scape þat scylful is euer.
& þat wat3 bared in babyloyn in Balta3ar tyme,

In Belshazzar's time, the
defiling of God's vessels

[Fol. 7v

wyth] MS. *wyth* *with*.

He herzed vp alle israel & hent of þe beste,

CHADNEZZAR BESIEGES JERUSALEM.

1180 & þe gentylest of Iudee *in Ierusalem* biseged,

71

Vmbe-walt alle þe walles wyth wyȝes ful stronge,
At vche a dor a doȝty duk, & dutte hem wyth-inne;

For þe borȝ watȝ so bygge baytayled alofte,

1184 & stoffed wyth-inne *with* stout men to stalle
hem þer-oute.

Þenne watȝ þe sege sette þe Cete aboute,
Skete skarmoch skelt, much skaȝe lached;

At vch brugge a berfray on basteles wyse,

1188 Þat seuen syȝe vch a day asayled þe ȝates,

Trwe tulkkes *in toures* teueled wyth-inne,

In bigge brutage of borde, bulde on þe walles;

Þay feȝt & þay fende of, & fylter togeder

1192 Til two ȝer ouer-torned, ȝet tok þay hit neuer.

At þe laste vpon longe, þo ledes wyth-inne,

Faste fayled hem þe fode, enfaminied monie;

Þe hote hunger wyth-inne hert hem wel sarre,

1196 Þen any dunt of þat douthe þat dowelled þer-oute.

Þenne wern þo rowtes redles *in* þo ryche wones,

Fro þat mete watȝ myst, megre þay wexen,

& þay stoken so strayt, þat þay ne stray myȝt

1200 A fote fro þat forselet to forray no goudes.

Þenne þe kyng of þe kyth a counsayl hym takes,

Wyth þe best of his burnes, a *blench* forto make;

Þay stel out on a styлле nyȝt er any steuen rysed,

1204 & harde hurles þurȝ þe oste, er enmies hit
wyste,

Bot er þay *at-wappe* ne moȝt þe wach wyth-oute,

Hiȝe *skelt* watȝ þe askry þe skewes an-vnder,

Loude alarom vpon launde lulted watȝ þenne;

1208 Ryche, *ruped* of her rest, ran to here wedes,

Hard hattes þay hent & on hors lepes;

He besieges Jerusalem, and
surrounds the walls.

The city is stuffed full of
men.

Brisk is the skirmish.

[Fol. 7r]

Seven times a day are the
gates assailed.

For two years the fight goes
on, yet the city is not taken.

The folk within are in want
of food.

Meager they become.

For so shut up are they that
escape seems impossible.

But on a quiet night they
steal out,
and rush through the host.

They are discovered by the
enemy.

A loud alarm is given.

Cler claryoun crak cryed onlofte.
By þat wat3 alle on a hepe hurlande swyþee,
1212 Fol3ande þat oþer flote, & fonde hem bilyue,
Ouer-tok hem, as tyd, tult hem of sadeles,
Tyl vche prynce hade his per put to þe grounde;

They are pursued
and overtaken.

ING OF JUDAH IS MADE PRISONER.

& þer wat3 þe kyng ka3t wyth calde prynces,
72
1216 & alle hise gentyle for-iusted on ierico playnes,
& presented wern as presoneres to þe prynce
rychest,
Nabigo-de-no3ar noble in his chayer,
& he þe faynest freke þat he his fo hade,
1220 & speke spitously hem to & spylt þerafter.
þe kynges sunnes in his sy3t he slow euer vch
one,
& holkked out his auen y3en heterly boþe
& bede þe burne to be bro3t to babyloyn þe ryche,
1224 & þere in dongoun be don to dre3e þer his
wyrdes.

Their king is made prison

His chief men are present
as prisoners to
Nebuchadnezzar.

His sons are slain.

His own eyes are put out.
He is placed in a dungeon
Babylon.

[Fol. 7.

Now se, so þe soueray[n] set hat3 his wrake;
Nas hit not for nabugo ne his noble nauper,
þat oþer depryued wat3 of pryde with paynes stronge,
1228 Bot for his beryng so badde agayn his blyþe
lorde;
For hade þe fader ben his frende þat hym bifore
keped,

All for his “bad bearing”
against the Lord,
who might otherwise have
been his friend.

Ne neuer trespass to him in teche of mysseleue.
To Colde wer alle Calde & kythes of ynde,
1232 3et take torkye hem wyth her tene hade ben little;
3et nolde neuer nabugo þis ilke note leue,
Er he hade tuyred þis toun & torne hit to grounde;
He ioyned vnto Ierusalem a gentyle duc þenne,
1236 His name wat3 nabu-3ardan, to noye þe iues;
He wat3 mayster of his men & my3ty him seluen,

Nebuchadnezzar ceased n
until he had destroyed
Jerusalem.

Nebuzaradan was “chief c
the chivalry.”

þe chef of his cheualrye his chekkes to make,
He brek þe bareres as bylyue, & þe burȝ after,
1240 & enteres in ful ernestly, in yre of his hert.

What! þe maysterry watȝ mene, þe men wern away,
þe best boȝed wyth þe burne þat þe borȝ ȝemed;
& þo þat byden wer so biten with þe bale hunger,
1244 þat on wyf hade ben worþe þe welgest fourre;
Nabȝardan noȝt for-þy nolde not spare,
Bot bede al to þe bronde vnder bare egge.

þay slowen of swettest semlych burdes,
1248 Baȝed barnes in blod & her brayn spyllȝ;
Prestes & prelates þay presed to deþe,
Wyues & wenches her wombes tocoruen,
þat her boweles out-borst aboute þe diches,

73

1252 & al watȝ carfully kylde þat þay cach myȝt,
& alle [þat] swypped vnswoȝed of þe sworde kene,
þay wer cagȝed & kaȝt on capeles al bare,
Festned fettres to her fete vnder fole wombes,
1256 & broȝely broȝt to babyloyn þer bale to suffer,
To sytte in seruage & syte; þat sumtyme wer gentyle,
Now ar chaunged to chorles & charged wyth
werkkes,

Boȝe to cayre at þe kart & þe kuy mylke,
1260 þat sumtyme sete in her sale syres & burdes.

The best men were taken
of the city.

so] The MS. reads *fo*.

Nevertheless Nebuzaradan
spared not those left.

Brains of bairns were spil
Priests pressed to death.

Wives and wenches foully
killed.

All that escaped the swor
were taken to Babylon,

and were made to drag the
cart or milk the kine.

[Fol. 7.

ZARDAN PILLAGES THE TEMPLE.

& ȝet nabuzardan nyl neuer stynt,
Er he to þe tempple tee wyth his tulkkes alle;
Betes on þe barers, brestes vp þe ȝates,
1264 Slouen alle at a slyp þat serued þer-inne,
Pulden prestes bi þe polle & plat of her hedes,
Diȝten dekenes to deþe, dungen doun clerkkes,
& alle þe maydenes of þe munster maȝtyly
hokyllen

1268 Wyth þe swayf of þe sworde þat swoȝed hem alle.

Nebuzaradan burst open t
temple,

and slew those therein.

Priests, pulled by the poll,
were slain along with
deacons, clerks, and
maidens.

Þenne ran þay to þe relykes as robbors wylde,
& pyled alle þe apparently þat pented to þe
kyrke,

þe pure pyleres [o]f bras pourtrayd in golde,
 1272 & þe chef chaundeler charged with þe lyzt,
 þat ber þe lamp vpon lofte, þat lemed euer more,
 Bifore þ[e] sancta *sanctorum* þer selcouth watz ofte.

Pay caȝt away þat condelstik, & þe crowne als,
 1276 þat þe auter hade vpon, of apel golde ryche;
 Þe gredirne & þe goblotes garnyst of syluer,
 Þe bases of þe bryȝt postes & bassynes so schyre;
 Dere disches of golde & dubleres fayre,
 1280 Þe vyoles & þe vesselment of *vertuous* stones.

Now hat3 nabuzardan nomen alle byse noble
bynges,

& pyled þat *precious* place & pakked þose godes;
 Þe golde of þe gaʒafylace to swyþe gret noumbre,

1284 Wyth alle þe vrnmentes of þat hous, he
hamppred to-geder.

Alle he spoyled spitously *in* a sped whyle,
 Bat salomon so mony a sadde 3er so3t to make,

74
Wyth alle þe coyntyse þat he cowþe clene to wyrke;
1288 De-uised he þe vesselment, þe vestures clene,
Wyth slyzt of his ciences, his souerayn to loue,
þe hous & þe anournementes he hyztled to-gedere.

Now hat3 nabuzardan numnend hit al samen,
1292 & syþen bet down þe bur3 & brend hit *in*
askes;

Þenne wyth legiounes of ledes ouer londes he rydes,
Herzeȝ of Israel þe hyrne aboute.

Wyth charged chariotes þe cheftayn he fynde[3],

CHADNEZZAR IS PLEASED WITH THE SPOIL.

1296 Bikennes þe catel to þe kyng, þat he caȝt
hade,

Presented him þe prisoneres in pray þat þay
token,

Presents the prisoners to the
king,

Moni a worþly wyȝe whil her worlde laste,
Moni semly syre sone, & swyþe rych maydenes,
1300 þe pruddest of þe prouince, & prophetes childer,
As Ananie & azarie & als Mizael,
& dere daniel also, þat watȝ deuine noble,
With moni a modey moder chylde mo þen in-noghe.

among whom were Danie
and his three companions.

1304 & nabugo-de-nozar makes much ioye,
Nov he þe kyng hatȝ conquest & þe kyth wunnen,
& dreped alle þe doȝtyest & derrest in armes,
& þe lederes of her lawe layd to þe grounde,
1308 & þe pryce of þe profecie prisoners maked;

Nebuchadnezzar has great
joy,

because his enemies are
slain.

IZES GREATLY THE SACRED JEWELRY.

Bot þe ioy of þe iuelrye so gentyle & ryche,
When hit watȝ schewed hym so schene, scharp
watȝ his wonder,

Great was his wonder whan
he saw the sacred jewelry.

Of such vessel auayed þat vayled so huge,
1312 Neuer ȝet nas nabugo-de-nozar er þenne.
He sesed hem *with* solemneté, þe souerayn he
praysed,

He praises the God of Isra

þat watȝ apēl ouer alle, israel dryȝtyn;
Such god, such gomes, such gay vesselles
1316 Comen neuer out of kyth, to Caldee reames.

Such vessels never before
came to Chaldea.

He trussed hem in his tresorye in a tryed place
Rekenly wyth reuerens, as he ryȝt hade;
& þer he wroȝt as þe wyse, as ȝe may wyt here-after,
1320 For hade he let of hem lyȝt, hym moȝt haf lumpen
worse.

They are thrust into the
treasury.

Þat ryche in gret rialté rengned his lyue,
75

Nebuchadnezzar reigns as
emperor of all the earth,

As *conquerour* of vche a cost he cayser watȝ hatte,
Emperour of alle þe erþe & also þe saudan,
1324 & als þe god of þe grounde watȝ grauen his name
& al þurȝ dome of daniel, fro he deuised hade,

fro] *for* (?).

Pat alle goudes com of god, & gef hit hym bi
samples,

Pat he ful clanly bi-cnv his carp bi þe laste,
1328 & ofte hit mekned his mynde, his maysterful
werkkes.

Bot al drawes to dyȝe *with* doel vp[o]n ende;
Bi a haþel neuer so hyȝe he heldes to grounde,
& so nabugo-de-noȝar as he nedes moste;
1332 For alle his empire so hiȝe *in* erþe is he
grauen.

Bot þenn þe bolde baltazar, þat watȝ his barn
aldest,

He watȝ stalled *in* his stud, & stabled þe rengne;
In þe burȝ of babiloyne þe biggest he trawed,
1336 Þat nauþer *in* heuen ne no erþe hade no pere;
For he bigan *in* alle þe glori þat hym þe gome lafte,
Nabugo-de-Noȝar, þat watȝ his noble fader;
So kene a kyng *in* Caldee com neuer er þenne.

1340 Bot honoured he not hym þat *in* heuen
wonies,

Bot fals fantummes of fendes, formed with handes
Wyth tool out of harde tre, & telded on lofte,
& of stokkes & stones, he stoute goddes callȝ
1344 When þay ar gilde al with golde & gered wyth
syluer,

& pere he kneles & calleȝ, & clepes after help.

& þay reden him ryȝt rewarde he hem hetes,
& if þay gruchen him his grace to gremen his hert,
1348 He cleches to a gret klubbe & knokkes hem to
peces;

Þus in pryde & olipraunce his Empyre he haldes,
In lust & *in* lecherye, & lopelych werkkes;
& hade a wyf forto welde, a worþelych quene,
1352 & mony a lemman, neuer þe later, þat ladis
wer called.

In þe clernes of his concubines & curious wedeȝ,
In notyng of nwe metes & of nice gettes,

through the “doom of
Daniel,”

bi-cnv] Looks like bicu
in MS.

who gave him good couns

Bi] *be* (?).

Nebuchadnezzar dies and
buried.

[Fol. 7]

Belshazzar succeeds him.

He holds himself the bigg
in heaven or on earth.

no] *on* (?).

He honours not God,

but worships false phanto

&] *An* (?).

He promises them reward
good fortune befall.

If they vex him he knocks
them in pieces.

He has a wife, and many
concubines.

Al wat3 þe mynde of þat man, on misschapen
þinges,

1356 Til þe lorde of þe lyfte liste hit abate.

76

HAZZAR PROCLAIMS A FEAST,

The mind of the king was
fixed upon new meats and
other vain things.

XIII.

Thenne þis bolde Baltazar biþenkkes hym ones,
To vouche on a vayment of his vayne g[l]orie;
Hit is not innoghe to þe nice al no3ty þink vse,
1360 Bot if alle þe worlde wyt his wykked dedes.

Baltazar þur3 babiloyn his banne gart crye,
& þur3 þe cuntre of caldee his callyng con spryng,
þat alle þe grete vpon grounde schulde geder hem
samen

1364 & assemble at a set day at þe saudans fest.
Such a mangerie to make þe man wat3 auised,
þat vche a kythyn kyng schuld com þider;
Vche duk wyth his duthe & oþer dere lordes,
1368 Schulde com to his court to kype hym for
lege,

& to reche hym reuerens & his reuel herkken;
To loke on his lemanes & ladis hem calle,
To rose hym in his rialty rych men so3tten,
1372 & mony a baroun ful bolde, to babyloyn þe noble.
þer bowed toward babiloyn burnes so mony,
Kynges, Cayseres ful kene, to þe court wonnen,
Mony ludisch lordes þat ladies bro3ten,
1376 þat to neuen þe noumbre to much nye were.
For þe bour3 wat3 so brod & so bigge alce,
Stalled in þe fayrest stud þe sterrez an-vnder,
Prudly on a plat playn, plek alþer-fayrest,
1380 Vmbe-sweyed on vch a syde with seuen grete
wateres,

Belshazzar, to exhibit his
vainglory

þink] þing (?).

proclaims throughout
Babylon,

that all the great ones shoul
assemble on a set day, at the
Sultan's feast.

Kings, dukes, and lords were
commanded to attend the
court.

[Fol. 71

To do the king honour many
nobles came to Babylon.

It would take too long to
name the number.

The city of Babylon is broad
and big.

It is situated on a plain,
surrounded by seven
streams,

With a wonder wroȝt walle wruxeled ful hiȝe,
With koynt carneles aboue, coruen ful clene,
Troched toures bitwene twenty spere lenȝe,
1384 & þiker þrowen vmbe þour-with ouer-þwert
palle.

a high wall, and towers.

þour] *þore* (?).

Þe place, þat plyed þe pursaunt wyth-inne,
Watȝ longe & ful large & euer ilych sware,
& vch a syde vpon soyle helde seuen myle,
1388 & þe saudans sete sette in þe myddes;
Þat watȝ a palayce of pryde passande alle oþer,
Boþe of werk & of wunder & walle al aboute;

The palace was long and large,

each side being seven miles in length.

77

High houses were within the walls.

Heȝe houses *with-inne* þe halle to hit med,
1392 So broȝd bilde in a bay, þat blonkkes myȝt renne.

HIGH KINGS AND EMPERORS ARE INVITED.

When þe terme of þe tyde watȝ to vsched of þe
feste,

The time of the feast has come.

Dere droȝen þer-to & vpon des metten,
& baltazar vpon bench was busked to sete,
1396 Stepe stayred stones of his stoute throne.

Belshazzar sits upon his throne:

Þenne watȝ alle þe halle flor hiled *with* knyȝtes,
& barounes at þe side-bordes bounet ay-where,
For non watȝ dressed vpon dece bot þe dere seluen,
1400 & his clere concubynes in cloþes ful bryȝt.

the hall floor is covered with knights.

When alle segges were þer set, þen seruyse
bygynnes,

When all are seated, service begins.

Sturnen trumpen strake steuen in halle,
Aywhere by þe woves wrasten krakkes,
1404 & broȝe baneres þer-bi blusnande of gold;

Trumpets sound everywhere

[Fol. 71v]

Burnes berande þe breȝes vpon broȝe skeles,
Þat were of sylueren syȝt & seerved *þer*-wyth,
Lyfte logges þer-ouer & on lofte coruen,
1408 Pared out of paper & poynted of golde,
Broȝe baboynes abof, besttes an-vnder,
Foles in foler flakerande bi-twene,

þe] MS. *þe þe*.

Bread is served upon silver dishes.

seerved] MS. *severed*.

golde] MS. *glolde* (?).

Þe iueles out of ierusalem with gemmes ful bryȝt,
 Bi þe syde of þe sale were semely arayed;
 Þe ap̄el auter of brasse watȝ hade in-to place;
 1444 Þe gay coroun of golde gered on lofte,
 Þat hade ben blessed bifore wyth bischopes
 hondes
 & wyth besten blod busily anoynted,
 In þe solempne sacrefyce þat goud sauor hade,
 1448 Bifore þe lorde of þe lyfte in louyng hym
 seluen,
 Now is sette for to serue satanas þe blake,
 Bifore þe bolde baltazar wyth bost & wyth pryde.

Covers the cupboard with vessels.

[Fol. 7'

ierusalem] MS. *iesurak*

The Jewels of Jerusalem
deck the sides of the hall.

The altar and crown,
blessed by bishop's hands
and anointed with the blo
of beasts,

are set before the bold
Belshazzar.

CK THE FESTIVE HALL.

Houen vpon þis auter watȝ ap̄el vessel,
 1452 Þat wyth so curious a crafte coruen watȝ
 wyly;
 Salamon sete him s[eue]n ȝere & a syȝe more,
 With alle þe syence þat hym sende þe souerayn lorde,
 For to compas & kest to haf hem clene wroȝt;
 1456 For þer wer bassynes ful bryȝt of brende
 golde clere,
 En-aumaylde with aȝer & eweres of sute;
 Couered cowpes foul clene, as casteles arayed,
 Enbanded vnder batelment with bantelles quoynt,
 1460 & fyled out of fygyres of ferlyle schappes.
 Þe coperounes of þe canacles þat on þe cuppe
 reres,
 Wer fetysely formed out in fylyoles longe,
 79
 Pinacles pyȝt þer apert þat profert bitwene,
 1464 & al boiled abof with braunches & leues,
 Pyes & papeiayes purtrayed with-inne,
 As þay prudly hade piked of pomgarnades;
 For alle þe blomes of þe boȝes wer blyknande
 perles

Upon this altar were nobl
vessels curiously carved,

so] MS. *fo*.

basins of gold,

foul] *ful* (?).

cups arrayed like castles v
battlements,

ferlyle] *ferlyke* (?).

and towers with lofty
pinnacles.

Upon them were pourtray
branches and leaves,

the flowers of which were
white pearls,

The pollution of the sacred vessels is displeasing to God.

Soberly in his sacrafyce summe wer anoynted,
Þurȝ þe somones of him selfe þat syttes so hyȝe;

80

Now a boster on benche bibbes þerof
1500 Tyl he be dronkken as þe deuel, & dotes þer
he syttes;

So þe worcher of þis worlde wlates þer-wyth,
Þat in þe poynt of her play he poruayes a mynde;
Bot er harme hem he wolde in haste of his yre,
1504 He wayned hem a warnyng þat wonder hem
þoȝt.

Nov is alle þis guere geten glotounes to serue;
Stad in a ryche stal & stared ful bryȝtȝ,
Baltazar in a brayd bede vus þer-of.

1508 “Weȝe wyn in þis won, wassayl!” he cryes.

Swyfte swaynes ful swyþe swepen þer-tylle,
Kyppe kowpes in honde kyngeȝ to serue,
In bryȝt bolleȝ, ful bayn birlen þise oþer,
1512 & vche mon for his mayster machches alone.

Þer watȝ rynging, on ryȝt, of ryche metalles,
Quen renkkes in þat ryche rok rennen hit to cache,
Clatering of conacleȝ þat kesten þo burdes,
1516 As sonet out of sau[t]eray songe als myry.

Þen þe dotel on dece drank þat he myȝt,
& þenne arn dressed dukeȝ & prynces,
Concubines & knyȝtes, bi cause of þat merthe;

1520 As vchon hade hym in helde he haled of þe cuppe,

So long likked þise lordes þise lykores swete,
& gloryed on her falce goddes & her grace calles,
Þat were of stokkes & stones, stille euer more;

1524 Neuer steuen hem astel, so stoken is hor tonge,
Alle þe goude golden goddes þe gauleȝ ȝet
neuenen,

Belfagor & belyal & belssabub als,
Heyred hem as hyȝly as heuen wer þayres,
1528 Bot hym þat alle goudes giues, þat god þay
for-ȝeten,

For “a boaster on bench”
drinks from them till he is
“drunken as the devil.”

God is very angry.

Before harming the revell
He sends them a warning.

bryȝtȝ] ? bryȝte.

Belshazzar commands the
sacred vessels to be filled
with wine.

The cups and bowls are so
filled.

[Fol. 71

Music of all kind is heard
the hall.

Dukes, princes, concubine
and knights, all are merry.

Drinking of the sweet liqu
they ask favours of their
gods,

is] MS. is.
who, although dumb,

are as highly praised “as i
heaven were theirs.”

For þer a ferly bifel þat fele folk seȝen;
Fyrst knew hit þe kyng & alle þe cort after,

A marvel befals the feaste
The king first saw it.

LANDWRITING ON THE WALL.

In þe palays pryncipale vpon þe playn wowe,
1532 In contrary of þe candelstik þat clerest hit
schyned.

Upon the plain wall,

Þer apered a paume, *with poyntel in fynGRES*
Þat watȝ grysly & gret, & grymly he wrytes,

“a palm with pointel in
fingers” is seen writing.

81

Non oþer forme bot a fust faylande þe wryste,
1536 Pared on þe parget, purtrayed lettres.

When þat bolde baltazar blusched to þat neue,
Such a dasande drede dusched to his hert,
Þat al falewed his face & fayled þe chere;

The bold Belshazzar
becomes frightened.

1540 Þe stronge strok of þe stonde strayned his ioyn-
tes,
His cnes cachches to close & cluchches his
hommes,

His knees knock together.

& he *with plat-tyng* his paumes displayes his lers,
& romyes as a rad ryth þat roreȝ for drede,
1544 Ay biholdand þe honde til hit hade al *grauen*,
& rasped on þe roȝ woȝe runisch saueȝ.

lers] MS. *lerns*.

He roars for dread, still
beholding the hand, as it
wrote on the rough wall.

When hit þe scrypture hade scraped wyth a scrof
penne,

scrof] MS. *strof*.

As a coltour *in clay cerues þo forȝes*,
1548 Þenne hit vanist verayly & voyded of syȝt,
Bot þe lettres bileued ful large vpon plaster.
Sone so þe kyng for his care carping myȝt
wynne,

[Fol. 7v]

The hand vanishes but the
letters remain.

He bede his burnes boȝ to þat were bok lered,
1552 To wayte þe wryt þat hit wolde & wyter hym
to say,

The king recovers his spee
and sends for the “book-
learned;”

“For al hit frayes my flesche þe fynGRES so grymme.”
Scoleres skelten þeratte þe skyl forto fynde,
Bot þer watȝ neuer on so wyse couȝe on worde
rede,

but none of the scholars w
wise enough to read it.

1556 Ne what ledisch lore ne langage nauþer
What tyþyng ne tale tokened þo draȝtes.
Þenne þe bolde baltazar bred ner wode.
& ede þe Ceté to seche segges þurȝ-out,

Belshazzar is nearly mad.
ede] *bede* (?).

THE KING CONSULTS HIS DIVINERS.

1560 Þat wer wyse of wyche-crafte & warlaȝes
oþer,

Commands the city to be
searched throughout for the
“wise of witchcraft.”

Þat con dele wyth demerlayk, & deuine lettres:
“Calle hem alle to my cort þo calde clerkkes,
Vn-folde hem alle þis ferly þat is bifallen here,
1564 & calle wyth a hiȝe cry; ‘he þat þe kyng
wysses,

He who expounds the
strange letters,

In expounyng of speche þat spredes in þise lettres,
& make þe mater to malt my mynde wyth-inne,

Þat I may wyterly wyt what þat wryt menes,

1568 He schal þe gered ful gaye in gounes of
porpre,

shall be clothed in “gown
purple.”

& a coler of cler golde clos vmbe his þrote;

A collar of gold shall
encircle his throat.

82

He schal be prymate & prynce of pure clergie,
& of my þreuenest lordez þe þrydde he schal

He shall be the third lord in
the realm.

1572 & of my reme þe rychest to ryde wyth myseluen,
Out-taken bare two & þenne he þe þrydde.’”

Þis cry watȝ vp-caste, & þer comen mony
Clerkes out of caldye þat kennest wer knauen,

As soon as this cry was
upcast, to the hall came
clerks out of Chaldea,

1576 As þe sage sathrapas þat sorsory coupe;

witches and diviners,

Wycheȝ & walkyries wonnen to þat sale,
Deuinores of demorlaykes þat dremes cowþe rede,
Sorsers & exorsismus & fele such clerkes;

sorcerers and exorcists.

1580 & alle þat loked on þat letter as lewed þay
were,

But after looking on the
letters they were as ignorant
as if they had looked into
leather of the left boot.

As þay had loked in þe leþer of my lyft bote.

Þenne cryes þe kyng & kerues his wedes;

What! he corsed his clerkes & calde hem chorles,

The king curses them all &
calls them churls.

1584 To henge þe harlotes he heȝed ful ofte,

So wat3 þe wy3e wytles, he wed wel ner.

[Fol. 7v]

Ho herde hym chyde to þe chambre þat wat3 þe
chef quene;

He orders the harlots to be
hanged.

When ho wat3 wytered bi wy3es what wat3 þe
cause,

The queen hears the king
chide.

She inquires the cause.

1588 Suche a chaungande chaunce in þe chef halle,

þe lady to laue þat los þat þe lorde hade,

laue] *lance* (?).

Glydes down by þe grece & gos to þe kyng;

Goes to the king, kneels
before him,

Ho kneles on þe colde erþe & carpes to hym
seluen,

1592 Wordes of worchyp wyth a wys speche.

“Kene kyng,” *quod* þe quene, “kayser of vrþe,

Euer laste þy lyf in lenþe of dayes;

Why hat3 þou rended þy robe for redles here-inne,

and asks why he has rent his
robes for grief,

1596 Ða3 þose ledes ben lewed lettres to rede,

& hat3 a hapel in þy holde, as I haf herde ofte,

þat hat3 þe gostes of god þat gyes alle soþes;

when there is one that has
the Spirit of God,

His sawle is ful of syence, sa3es to schawe,

1600 To open vch a hide þyng of aunteres vn-cowþe;

þat is he þat ful ofte hat3 heuened þy fader

the counsellor of
Nebuchadnezzar,

Of mony anger ful hote *with* his holy speche.

When nabugo-de-no3ar wat3 nyed *in stoundes*,

1604 He de-vysed his dremes to þe dere trawþe,

the interpreter of his dream

He keuered hym *with* his counsayl of caytyf wyrdes;

83

Alle þat he spured hym in space he expowned clene,

Þur3 þe sped of þe spyryt þat sprad hym *with-*
inne,

through the holy Spirit of
God.

1608 Of þe godelest godde3 þat gaynes ay-where.

For his depe diuinité & his dere sawes,

EL IS SENT FOR.

Þy bolde fader baltazar bede by his name,

by] *be* (?).

þat now is demed danyel of derne coninges,

The name of this man is
Daniel,

1612 Ðat ca3t wat3 in þe captyuidé in cuntre of
iues;

who was brought a captive
from Judæa.

Nabuzardan hym nome & now is he here,
A prophete of þat prouince & pryce of þe worlde.

Sende in-to þe ceté to seche hym bylyue,
1616 & wyne hym with þe worchyp to wayne þe
bote,

& þa3 þe mater be merk þat merked is 3ender,
He schal de-clar hit also, as hit on clay stande.”

þat gode counseyl at þe quene wat3 cached as swyþe, *as*] MS. *as as*.

1620 Þe burne byfore balta3ar wat3 bro3t in a
whyle,

When he com bifore þe kyng & clanly had halsed,
Baltazar vmbe-brayde hym & “leue sir,” he sayde,
“Hit is tolde me bi tulkes, þat þou trwe were

1624 Profete of þat prouynce þat prayed my fader,
Ande þat þou hat3 in þy hert holy connyng,
Of sapyence þi sawle ful soþes to schawe;

Goddes gost is þe geuen þat gyes alle þynges,
1628 & þou vnhyles vch hidde þat heuen kyng
myntes;

& here is a ferly byfallen, & I fayn wolde
Wyt þe wytte of þe wryt, þat on þe wowe clyues,
For alle calde clerkes han cowwardely fayled;

1632 If þou with quayntyse conquere hit, I quyte þe
þy mede.

For if þou redes hit by ryzt & hit to resoun
brynges,

Fyrst telle me þe tyxte of þe tede lettres,
& syþen þe mater of þe mode, mene me þer-after,
1636 & I schal halde þe þe hest þat I þe hyzt haue;

Apyke þe in porpre cloþe, palle alþer-fynest,
& þe by3e of bryzt golde abowte þyn nekke,
& þe þryd þryuenest þat þrynges me after,

1640 Þou schal be baroun vpon benche, bede I þe
no lasse.”

The queen tells the king to
send for Daniel.

Her counsel is accepted.

[Fol. 7v]

Daniel comes before
Belshazzar.

The king tells him that he
has heard of his wisdom,

and his power to discover
hidden things,

and that he wants to know
the meaning of the writing
on the wall.

Promises him, if he can
explain the text of the letters
and their interpretation,

to clothe him in purple and
pall, and put a ring about his
neck,

and to make him “a baron
upon bench.”

Derfly þenne danyel deles þyse wordes:

84

“Ryche kyng of þis rengne rede þe oure lorde,

Hit is surely soth, þe souerayn of heuen

1644 Fylsened euer þy fader & vpon folde
cheryched,

Gart hym grattest to be of gouernores alle,
& alle þe worlde in his wylle welde as hym lykes.

Who-so wolde wel do, wel hym bityde,

1648 & quos deth so he deþyre he dreped als fast;

Who-so hym lyked to lyft, on lofte wat3 he sone,

& quo-so hym lyked to lay, wat3 lo3ed bylyue.

So wat3 noted þe note of nabugo-de-no3ar,

1652 Styfly stabled þe rengne bi þe stronge
dry3tyn,

For of þe hy3est he hade a hope in his hert,

Þat vche pouer past out of [þ]at prynce euen;

& whyle þat wat3 cle3t clos in his hert,

1656 Þere wat3 no mon vpon molde of my3t as hym
seluen,

Til hit bitide on a tyme, towched hym pryde

For his lordeschyp so large, & his lyf ryche;

He hade so huge an insy3t to his aune dedes,

1660 Þat þe power of þe hy3e prynce he purely
for3etes.

Þenne blynnes he not of blasfemyon to blame þe
dry3tyn,

His my3t mete to goddes he made *with* his wordes:

“I am god of þe grounde, to gye as me lykes,

1664 As he þat hy3e is in heuen his aungeles þat
weldes;

If he hat3 formed þe folde & folk þer vpone,

I haf bigged babiloyne, bur3 alþer-rychest,

Stabled þer-inne vche a ston in strenkþe of myn armes,

1668 Mo3t neuer my3t bot myn make such anoþer.”

Wat3 not þis ilke worde wonnen of his mowþe
one,

Daniel addresses the king.

and reminds him how that
God supported his father,

and gave him power to ex
or abase whomsoever he
pleased.

Nebuchadnezzar was
established

on account of his faith in
God.

So long as he remained tri
no man was greater.

[Fol. 8r]

But at last pride touches h
heart.

He forgets the power of G
and blasphemes His name

He says that he is “god of
ground,”

and the builder of Babyloi

Hardly had Nebuchadnezz
spoken,
when God’s voice is heard

Er þenne þe souerayn saze souned in his eres,
 “Now nabugo-de-nozar innoze hat3 spoken,
 1672 Now is alle þy pryncipalté past at ones,
 & þou, remued fro monnes sunes, on mor most
 abide,
 & in wasterne walk & wyth þe wylde dowelle,
 As best, byte on þe bent of braken & erbes,
 1676 *With* wroþe wolfes to won & wyth wylde asses.”
 In mydde þe poynt of his pryde de-parted he þere,
 85

saying, “Thy principality
 departed.

Thou, removed from men
 must abide on the moor, a
 walk with wild beasts, eat
 herbs, and dwell with wol
 and asses.”

PUNISHED FOR HIS PRIDE.

Fro þe soly of his solempneté, his solace he leues,
 & carfully is out-kast to contré vnknawen,
 1680 Fer *in*-to a fyr fryth þere frekes neuer comen.
 His hert heldet vnhole, he hoped non oþer
 Bot a best þat he be, a bol oþer an oxe.
 He fares forth on alle faure, fogge wat3 his mete,
 1684 & ete ay as a horce when erbes were fallen,
 Þus he countes hym a kow, þat wat3 a kyng ryche,
 Quyle seuen syþe3 were ouer-seyed someres I
 trawe.

For his pride he becomes
 outcast.

He believes himself to be
 bull or an ox.

Goes “on all fours,”

like a cow,
 for seven summers.

By þat, mony þik thy3e þry3t vmbe his lyre,
 1688 Þat alle wat3 dubbed & dy3t in þe dew of heuen;
 Faxe fyltered, & felt flosed hym vmbe,
 Þat schad fro his schulderes to his schyre wykes,
 & twenty-folde twynande hit to his tos ra3t
 1692 Þer mony clyuy as clyde hit cly3t to-geder.
 His berde I-brad alle his brest to þe bare vrþe,
 His browes bresed as breres aboute his brode
 chekes;

His thighs grew thick.

His hair became matted at
 thick,
 from the shoulders to the
 toes.

His beard touched the ear
 His brows were like briars

[Fol. 8r]

Hol3e were his y3en & vnder campe hores,
 1696 & al wat3 gray as þe glede, *with* ful grymme
 clawres

His eyes were hollow,
 and grey as the kite’s.

Þat were croked & kene as þe kyte paune;
 Erne-hwed he wat3 & al ouer-brawden,

paune] ? *panne*.

Eagle-hued he was.

Til he wȳst ful wel who wroȳt alle myȳtes,
1700 & cowȳe vche kyndam tokerue & keuer when
hym lyked;

Þenne he wayned hym his wyt þat hade wo
soffered,

At last he recovered his
“wit,”

Þat he com to knowlach & kenned hym seluen,
Þenne he laued þat lorde & leued in trawȳe,
1704 Hit watȳ non oȳer þen he þat hade al in
honde.

laued] *loued* (?).
and believed in God.

Þenne sone watȳ he sende agayn, his sete restored;
His barounes boȳed hym to, blyȳe of his come,
Hazerly in his aune hwe his heued watȳ couered,
1708 & so ȳeȳly watȳ ȳarked & ȳolden his state.

Then soon was he restored
his seat.

Bot þou baltazar his barne & his bolde ayre,
Seȳ þese syngnes *with* syȳt & set hem at lyttel,
Bot ay hatȳ hofen þy hert agaynes þe hyȳe dryȳt[y]n,
1712 *With* bobaunce & *with* blasfameȳe bost at hym
kest,

But thou, Belshazzar, hast
disregarded these signs,

and hast blasphemed the
Lord,

86

defiled his vessels,

& now his vessayles avyled in vanyté vnclene,
Þat in his hows hym to honour were heuened of fyrst;
Bifore þe barounȳ hatȳ hom broȳt, & byrled
þerinne

filling them with wine for
thy wenches,

1716 Wale wyne to þy wenches in waryed stoundes;
Bifore þy borde hatȳ þou broȳt beuerage in þede,
Þat blyȳely were fyrst blest *with* bischopes hondes,
Louande þeron lese goddeȳ, þat lyf haden neuer,
1720 Made of stokkes & stoneȳ þat neuer styry
moȳt.

and praising thy lifeless
gods.

& for þat froȳande fylȳe, þe fader of heuen
Hatȳ sende in-to þis sale þise syȳtes vncowȳe,
þe fyȳte *with* þe fyngeres þat flayed þi hert,
1724 Þat rasped renyschly þe woȳe *with* þe roȳ
penne.

For this sin God has sent
thee this strange sight,

Hatȳ sende] MS. *hatȳ*
sende hatȳ sende.

the fist with the fingers
writing on the wall.

Þise ar þe wordes here wryten *with-out*e werk
 more,
 By vch fygure, as I fynde, as oure fader lykes.
 “Mane, techal, phares, merked *in þrynne*,
 1728 þat þretes þe of þyn vnþryfte vpon þre wyse;
 Now expowne þe þis speche spedly I þenk.
 Mane menes als much as, maynful gode
 Hat3 counted þy kyndam bi a clene noumbre,
 1732 & ful-fylled hit *in fayth* to þe fyrre ende.
 To teche þe of techal, þat terme þus menes,
 Þy wale rengne is walt *in we3tes* to heng,
 & is funde ful fewe of hit fayth dedes.
 1736 & phares fol3es for þose fawtes to frayst þe
 trawþe,
 In phares fynde I forsoþe þise felle sa3es;
 De-parted is þy pryncipalté, deptryed þou
 worþes,
 Þy rengne rafte is þe fro, & ra3t is þe perses,
 1740 Þe medes schal be maysteres here, & þou of
 menske schowued.”
 Þe kyng comaunded anon to cleþe þat wyse,
 In frokkes of fyn cloþ, as forward hit asked;
 Þenne sone wat3 danyel dubbed *in ful dere porpor*
 1744 & a coler of cler golde kest vmbe his swyre.
 Þen wat3 demed a de-cre bi þe duk seluen,
 Bolde balta3a[r] bed þat hym bowe schulde
 Þe comynes a lof calde þat to þe kyng longed,
 87
 1748 As to þe prynce pryuyest preued þe þrydde,
 He3est of alle oþer, saf onelych tweyne,
 To bo3 after balta3ar *in bor3e* & *in felde*.
 Þys wat3 cryed & knawen *in cort* als fast,
 1752 & alle þe folk þer-of fayn þat fol3ed hym
 tylle;
 Bot how-so danyel wat3 dy3t, þat day ouer-3ede,
 Ny3t ne3ed ry3t now *with nyes fol mony*,
 For dazed neuer an oþer day þat ilk derk after,

These are the words:

“Mene, Tekel, Peres.

[Fol. 8

Mene.— God has counted
thy kingdom and finished

Tekel.— Thy reign is
weighed and is found
wanting in deeds of faith.

Peres.— Thy kingdom is
divided...

and given to the Persians.
The Medes shall be maste
here.”

The king commands Dani
to be clothed in a frock of
fine cloth.

Soon is he arrayed in purp
with a chain about his nec

coler] MS. *cloler*.

A decree is made, that all
should bow to him,

as the third lord that
followed Belshazzar.

The decree was made
known, and all were glad.

The day, however, past.
Night came on.

1756 Er dalt were þat ilk dome þat danyel deuysed,
 Þe solace of þe solempneté in þat sale dured
 Of þat farand fest, tyl fayled þe sunne;
 Þenne blykned þe ble of þe bryȝt skwes,
 1760 Mourkenes þe mery weder, & þe myst dryues
 Þorȝ þe lyst of þe lyfte, bi þe loȝ medoes;
 Vche hæpel to his home hyȝes ful fast,
 Seten at her soper & songen þer-after,
 1764 Þen foundeȝ vch a felazschyp fyrre at forþ naȝtes.

Before another day dawne
 Daniel's words were
 fulfilled.

The feast lasts till the sun
 falls.

blykned] *blaykned* (?)

The skies become dark.

Each noble hies home to his
 supper.

JS LAYS SIEGE TO BABYLON.

Baltazar to his bedd with blysse watȝ caryed,
 Reche þe rest as hym lyst, he ros neuer þer-after;
 For his foes in þe felde in flokkes ful grete
 1768 Þat longe hade layted þat lede his londes to
 strye,
 Now ar þay sodenly assembled at þe self tyme,
 Of hem wyst no wyȝe þat in þat won dowelled.
 Hit watȝ þe dere daryus þe duk of þise medes,
 1772 Þe prowde prynce of perce & porros of ynde,
 With mony a legioun ful large, with ledes of
 armes,
 Þat now hatȝ spyed a space to spoyle caldeeȝ.
 Þay þrongen þeder in þe þester on þrawen hepes,
 1776 Asscaped ouer þe skyre watteres & scaped þe
 walles,
 Lyfte laddres ful longe & vpon lofte wonen,
 Stelen styilly þe toun er any steuen rysed,
 With-inne an oure of þe nyȝt an entré þay hade;
 1780 Ȝet afrayed þay no freke, fyrre þay passen,
 & to þe palays pryncipal þay aproched ful style;
 Þenne ran þay in on a res, on rowtes ful grete,
 Blastes out of bryȝt brasse brestes so hyȝe,

Belshazzar is carried to bed
 but never rises from it,

[Fol. 8.

for his foes are seeking to
 destroy his land, and are
 assembled suddenly.

The enemy is Darius, leader
 of the Medes.

He has legions of armed
 men.

Under cover of the darkness
 they cross the river.

By means of ladders they
 upon the walls,

nyȝt] MS. *myȝt*.

and within an hour enter the
 city, without disturbing any
 of the watch.

They run into the palace, and
 raise a great cry.

88

1784 Ascry scarred on þe scue þat scomfyted mony.
 Segges slepande were slayne er þay slyppe myȝt,

Men are slain in their beds.

Vche hous heyred wat3, *with-inne* a honde-whyle;

HAZZAR IS BEATEN TO DEATH.

Baltazar in his bed wat3 beten to deþe,
1788 þat boþe his blod & his brayn blende on þe
cloþes;

The kyng in his cortyn wat3 ka3t bi þe heles,
Feryed out bi þe fete & fowle dispysed;
þat wat3 so do3ty þat day & drank of þe vessayl,
1792 Now is a dogge al so dere þat in a dych lygges;

For þe mayster of þyse medes on þe morne ryse,
Dere daryous þat day dy3t vpon trone,
þat ceté seses ful sounde, & sa3tlyng makes
1796 Wyth alle þe baroun3 *þer*-aboute, þat bowed
hym after.

& þus wat3 þat londe lost for þe lordes synne,
& þe fylþe of þe freke þat defowled hade
þe orne-mentes of godde3 hous þat holy were maked;
1800 He wat3 corsed for his vn-clannes, & cached
þer-inne,

Done doun of his dyngneté for dede3 vnfayre,
& of þyse worldes worchyp wrast out for euer,
& 3et of lykynges on lofte letted, I trowe,
1804 To loke on oure lofly lorde late bitydes.

þus vpon þrynne wyses I haf yow þro schewed,
þat vn-clannes to-cleues in corage dere
Of þat wynnelych lorde þat wonyes in heuen,
1808 Entyses hym to be tene, telled vp his wrake;
Ande clannes is his comfort, & coyntyse he
louyes,

& þose þat seme arn & swete schyn se his face.
þat we gon gay in oure gere þat grace he vus
sende,

1812 þat we may serue in his sy3t, *þer* solace neuer
blynne3.
Amen.

Belshazzar is beaten to
death,

and caught by the heels, is
fouly cast into a ditch.

Darius is crowned king,

and makes peace with the
barons.

Thus the land was lost for
the king's sin.

He was cursed for his
uncleanness,

and deprived of his honou
as well as of the joys of
heaven.

Thus in three ways has it
been shown,
that uncleanness

telled] telles (?).

makes God angry.

Cleanness is His comfort.

The seemly shall see his
face.

God give us grace to serui
His sight!

NOTES TO CLEANNESS.

The Notes were printed in a group, immediately before the Index. They have been distributed among the three poems for convenience.

Page 37. l. 3 *forering* = *for-bering*. (?)

10 *reken*, reverently, solemnly.

12 *cleche gret mede*, take great reward.

16 & *hym to greme cachen*, and him to wrath drive.

18 *hagherlych*, fitly, decently.

21 *scoymous* & *skyg*, scrupulous and particular; *skyg* implies dread, fear, shyness.

23 *in a carp*, in a discourse.

24 *heuened a3t happe3*, exhibited eight blessings.

25 *me myne3*, I remember.

109

P. 38. l. 27 *hapene3*, is happy, blessed.

29 *as so sayt3*, as one says.

32 *May not byde þat burne (? burre) þat hit his body
 ne3en,*

May not abide (suffer) that man (? blow), that it (? he)
 should approach his body.

39 *helded*, approached.

41 *tote3* = *tot3* = toes.

49 *worplych*, worshipful (? *worldlych*, worldly).

50 *in her* (? *herin*).

52 *here dere*, beloved heir.

54 *comly quoyntis*, comely attire.

56 *with sclazt*, against (for) slaughter.

59 *ropeled*, ready prepared, literally hastened.

62 *skyly*, device, excuse.

P. 39. l. 65 *nayed*, refused; *nurned*, uttered.

71 *a-drez*, aback, aside.

76 *More to wyte is her wrange, þen any wylle gentyl,*

More to blame is their fault, than any forlorn gentile.

Wylle has the significations of wandering, astray; as “*wyl dremes*,” wandering dreams, “*wylle of wone*,” astray from human habitations, having lost one’s way; and hence *wylle* is often used to denote uncertainty, bewilderment.

81 *laþez*, invite.

90 *styztled*, established, placed.

91 *þe marchal*, i.e. the marshal of the hall, whose duty it was, at public festivals, to place every person according to his rank and station.

95 *at þi banne*, at thy command.

96 *renischche renkeþ*, strange men.

97 *layteþ zet ferre*, search yet farther.

P. 40. l. 99 *wayteþ*, watch.

103 *balterande cruppeþ*, limping cripples. *Balter* signifies to jump, skip, hop, etc.

110 *demed*, decreed.

112 *Hit weren not alle on wyueþ suneþ, wonen with on fader,*

They were not all one wife’s sons, begotten with one father.

127 *& rehayte rekenly þe riche & þe poueren,*

And cheer, prince-like (nobly), the rich and the poor.

Rehete is the most common form of the word:

“Him would I comferte and *rehe*te.” —Rom. Rose,
l. 6509.

131 *syled fyrre*, proceeded farther.

132 *Tron fro table to table*, went from table to table. *Tron* is the
pret. of the verb *tryne*, to go, walk.

P. 41. l. 134 *Hit wat3 not*, there was one (who) was not.

135 *þryzt*, thrust; *unþryuandely*, badly.

144 *ratted*, rent, torn.

145 *goun febele*. Cf. *feble wede*, bad or poor clothing. —
Havelok the Dane, l. 418.

149 *broþe wordez*, angry (fierce) words.

150 *Hurkele*, cower, hang. *Hurkele* signifies, literally, to squat,
nestle, rest.

153 *laled*, spoke (quickly).

164 *ful3ed*, baptised.

166 *harne lache*, take hurt.

P. 42. l. 179 *As*, also; *bolnande priyde*, swelling pride.

180 *Þroly in-to þe deuele3 þrote man þrynge3 bylyue*,
Roughly into the devil's throat man is thrust soon.

181 *colwarde*, deceitful, treacherous. I have not been able to
meet with the word *colle* used as noun or verb in any writer of
the 14th or 15th century. *Col* occurs, however, as a prefix, in
Col-prophet (false prophet), *Col-fox* (crafty fox), used by
Chaucer; *Col-knyfe* (treacherous knife), which occurs in the
“Townley Mysteries.”

200 *hatel of his wylle*, anger of his will.

P. 43. l. 207 *attled*, endowed.

215 *met3* = *mess* (?), pity.

216 *tynt þe tye dool*, lost the tenth part.

222 *weued*, cut off. *swap*, blow.

230 *þe wrech saztled*, appeased the vengeance.

231 *wylnesful*, wilfulness.

233 *For-þy þa3 þe rape were rank, þe rawþe wat3 lyttel,*
Wherefore, though the blow were smart, the sorrow was
little.

237 *in obedyent* = *in-obedyent* (?), disobedient.

110

- P. 44. l. 246 *drepe*, destroy (slay).
257 *forme-foster* should be *forme-fostere3*, being in apposition
with *auncetere3*.
261 For *lede* read *lede3* (?).
270 *dezter of þe douþe*, the daughters of the mighty (doughty)
ones.
271 *on folken wyse*, after the manner of men.
- P. 45. l. 273 *meþele3*, immoderate, intemperate.
274 *alosed*, (? noted).
298 *þryuen*, grown up, adult.
306 *nwyed* = annoyed, *i.e.* displeased.
- P. 46. l. 320 *dutande*, shutting.
321 *halke3*, recesses.
331 *þis meyny of a3te*, this company (household) of eight.
335 *horwed*, unclean.
- P. 47. l. 350 *with-outen þrep*, without contradiction, gainsaying.
354 *a rowtande ryge*, a rattling shower.
359 *styste3* = *stynte3* stops, ceases.
362 & *alle woned in þe whichche*, and all abode in the ark.
Whichche is another (and genuine) form of *hutch*.
364 *Waltes out vch walle-heued, in ful wode streme3,*
 Bursts out each well-head (spring, fountain) in full wild
 streams.
365 *brymme*, stream.
366 *þe mukel lauande loghe*, the great flowing deep.
369 *fon*, ceased.

373 *moon*, moan, sorrow.

374 *dowed*, *availed*.

375 *wylger*, wilder, fiercer.

376 *dowelled* = *dwelled*.

377 *feng to þe flyzt*, took to flight.

378 *Vuche burde with her barne*, each woman with her child (bairn).

P. 48. 1. 379 *bowed*, hastened; *brentest*, highest, steepest.

380 *heterly*, quickly, (hotly); *haled*, rushed.

381 *Bot al wat3 nedlez her note*, but their device was altogether in vain.

382 *þe ro3e raynande ryg*, the rough raining shower; *raykande wawe3*, flowing waves.

383 *bopom*, a bottom or valley.

384 *demmed*, collected, accumulated.

391 *þe hy3e*, the heights, high grounds.

392 *bausene3*, badgers.

394 *re-coverer*, succour, refuge.

395 *Þat amounted*, etc., read *Þat amounted þe mase*, etc., that the astonishment increased. (Professor Child).

397 *Bi þat*, by that time. This phrase is still preserved in the North of England.

399 *Frende3, fellen in fere, faþmed to-geder*.

Friends, fallen in company, *embraced* (fathomed) together.

The verb *faþme* in Early English also signifies to *grope*.

400 *dry3*, suffer; *delful*, doleful.

404 *freten*, devoured; *waze3*, waves.

406 *hurkled*, rested. This word is still preserved in the local dialects of the North of England, with the sense of “to cower,” “squat.”

407 *mourkne*, rotten.

409 *here*, company.
411 *azt-sum*, in care, sorrowful.
413 *hurlande gotez*, rushing streams.
414 *kythez vncoupe*, unknown regions.

- P. 49. 1. 421 *flyt*, current, flitting.
424 *lumpen*, the passive participle of *lympen*, to befall, happen.
430 *yre3* is evidently an error for *ype3*, waves.
433 *Rac*, moving clouds, mists. Still in provincial use.
436 *meth*, pity, mercy.
438 *lasned*, lessened, became smaller.
439 *stac vp þe stange3*, closed up the pools. *Stang* = *stanc*, *stank*, a word still used in the North of England.
441 *lo3* = *logh*, deep.
443 *lome* = *loom*, i.e., the ark.
446 *rasse* = the provincial *raise*, a mound.
449 *kyste* = chest (ark); *wern* = *were* (?).
- P. 50. 1. 451 *eggez*, *edges*, banks, hills; *vnhuled*, uncovered.
452 *bynne*, within. Cf. *boute*, without.
461 *smach* smack, scent; *smoltes* (? *smolte*, i.e. smelt).
463 *3ederly*, quickly, soon; *steuen*, command, literally voice.
466 *fode3*, persons; *elle3*, provided that.
469 *doune* = *dovene*, a female dove (see line 481).

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476 *dre3ly*, drearily, sorrowfully.
480 *naytly*, dexterously (neatly).
482 *borne* = *burne*, stream.
483 *skwe*, sky, cloud; *skowte3*, looks.

- P. 51. 1. 485 *downe* = *dovene* (see ll. 469, 481).
487 *What!* lo!
490 *saztlyng*, reconciliation.

496 *woned* = *waned*, decreased, gone down.

498 *tyned*, enclosed.

499 *gode3 glam*, God's message (word); *glod*, came, literally glided.

501 *walt wafte* (?) (see B. 1. 857).

504 *proly prublande in pronge*, quickly pressing in throng (crowd), i.e., huddling together.

509 *brepe*, steam, savour.

511 *spede3 & spylle3*, prospers (speeds) and spoils.

517 *barnage*, childhood.

P. 52. l. 525 *sadde*, sharp, bitter.

529 *pen wat3 a skylly skyualde*, then was a design (purpose) manifested (ordered).

531 *nayte*, use, employ.

533 *wrype3*, crawl, creep.

534 *folmarde*, polecat.

536 *lake ryftes*, fissures of the lake.

537 *Herne3* = *erne3*, eagles.

539 *at a brayde*, in a moment.

P. 53. l. 558 *merked*, ordained.

561 *razt*, extended to, gave.

566 *syt*, fault.

567 *quyke3*, living (things); *qued*, wickedness.

573 *vnhappen glette*, unfortunate filth, unhappy sin.

579 *hepyng of seluen*, contempt of [God's] self.

583 *steppe y3e*, bright eye; *steppe* = *stepe* is often explained by steep, deep set; but we often meet with such phrases as “*stepe* stones,” bright stones, “*stepe* starres,” bright stars.

586 *losed þe listen*, lost the hearing; *lysten*, in O.E. has frequently the meaning of *to hear*.

587 *trave* = *trawe*, trow, believe.

588 *þer is no dede so derne þat ditteȝ his yȝen.*

There is no deed so secret that closes His eyes (*i.e.* that He does not see).

P. 54. 1. 591 *gropande*, searching, examining.

592 *Rypande of vche a ring þe reynyeȝ & hert*

Trying (probing) the reins and heart of every man.

Rype is still used in the North of England in the sense of to plunder. Cf. our modern use of the word *ransack* with its earlier meanings of to try, probe, search.

596 *honyseȝ*, disgraces, ruins, destroys.

598 *scarreȝ*, literally *scares*, is frightened, startled.

599 *to drawe allyt* = *to draw a lyte* = to draw back a little.

603 *blykked*, shone, glared.

605 *schunt*, aside, from *schunt*, to slip away, retreat.

P. 55. 1. 623 *orppedly*, quickly, hastily.

626 *happe*, cover, still in use in the north provincial dialects.

627 *som quat fat*, some sort of a vessel; *þe fyr bete*, make up the fire; *bete* signifies, literally, to mend.

632 *deruely* = *derfely*, quickly.

635 *þerue kakeȝ* = *therfe* or *tharfe* cakes, *i.e.*, cakes made without leaven.

646 *mensk*, thanks.

648 *leþe*, cease.

652 *ȝark*, select, chosen.

653 *for busmar*, in scorn.

654 *sothly* = truly (? *sotly*, foolishly or *softly*).

Numbered 655 and printed after following note. The word "sothely" also occurs in 657, but the text note ("sotly...") refers to 654.

655 *May þou traw for tykel þat þou tonne moȝteȝ,*

Mayst thou trow (believe) for the uncertainty (of such a thing) that thou mightest conceive;

for tykel, on account of the uncertainty.

- P. 56. l. 659 *byene* = *ben*, been or *bycame*. The sense would require *hade* before *byene*, if *byene* = *ben*.

668 *Pat for lot pat pay lanced ho lazed neuer*,

That for (any) sound that they uttered, she never
laughed;

lot = late, in the sense of *sound*, is not very common in Old English authors.

670 *a-loȝ* = lowly, softly.

686 *blod*, child.

687 *bos*, behoves.

688 *atlyng*, intention, purpose; *vn-haspe*, disclose.

112

- P. 57. l. 696 *fylter*, join.

698 *amed*, placed; *oddely dere*, singularly dear. *Oddely* occurs in some northern works with the sense of illustriously, nobly.

699 *drwry*, love; *doole alper-swettest*, the sweetest of all gifts; gift the sweetest of all.

703 *conne* is probably an error for *come*, but it may signify, be kindled, produced, begotten.

706 *stollen*, stealthy, secret.

711 *smod* = the Scotch *smot*, *smad*, stain, filth.

719 *þe worre half*, the weaker portion, literally, the worse half.

723 *laue*, law.

- P. 58. l. 732 *smolt*, be at peace.

740 *for hortying*, for hurting = for fear of hurting. This sense of *for* is very common in writers of the 16th and 17th centuries.

743 *fryst*, delay, put off.

747 *vsle*, ashes, cinders.

752 *leþe*, destroy.

754 *I schal my þro steke*, I shall moderate (literally, shut up) my anger.

756 *reken*, wise.

- P. 59. l. 764 *mese þy mode*, temper thy wrath.
778 *mere*, boundary, *meer*.
784 *lened* = leaned, reclined; but we may read *leued* = *beleued*, remained.
- P. 60. l. 796 *vnder-3ede* = *vnder-3ete*, understood.
801 *knaue3 kote*, servant's house. It looks at first sight like *kuchie3 kote*.
802 *fatte* = *vat*, vessel.
803 *norne* = *nurne*, request.
810 *gru3t*, gruched = begrudged.
813 *coupe*, knew.
814 *haylsed*, saluted.
824 *boute*, without.
830 *of glam debonere*, of pleasant, courteous conversation.
831 *wela-wynnely*, very joyfully.
- P. 61. l. 832 *wo3e* = *wowe*, wall.
835 *wakker* comp. *wayk*, weak.
836 *vmbe-ly3e*, surround.
838 *scowte-wach*, sentinel; *asscry*, cry, shout, noise.
846 *3e3ed* = chattered, gaggled; *3estande sor3e*, afflicting (or frothing) sorrow.
848 *brych* = what is low, vile, filthy (? *bryth*, breath); *vpbrayde3*, raises.
849 *glyfte with þat glam*, was frightened at that speech.
855 *wonded no woþe*, avoided no danger (hurt).
859 *meled*, spoke.
860 *hendelayk*, courtesy, civility.
- P. 62. l. 871 *tayt* = lively.
874 *a3ly* = *awly*, fearfully.

876 *out-comlyng*, a stranger. In this form it is still known in the North of England. *Comlyng* is the more usual form of the word in our early literature; *carle* = *churl*.

881 *ʒornen*, ran.

882 *wapped*, beat.

885 *in blande* = together (?); *banned*, cursed.

888 *nyteled*, laboured, toiled.

889 *of tayt*, from fear. *Teyt*, fear, alarm, occurs in the northern romance of Alexander.

890 *ropeled*, hastened.

892 *vglokest vnhap*, the most dreadful misfortune.

893 *Ruddon of þe day-rawe ros vpon vʒten.*

The light of the day-break rose on the morn.

894 *merk*, darkness.

895 *ruþen*, rouse.

901 *cayre tid of þis kythe*, depart quickly from this land.

P. 63. l. 905 *stemme no stepe*, stop (keep back), no step. Cf. our modern phrase “stem the tide.”

909 *losen*, destroy.

911 *gorde*, rush.

912 *clater*, shatter.

915 *kynned*, kindled.

916 *þe brath of his breth*, the fierceness of his wrath.

918 *foo-schip*, enmity.

921 *walle* = *wale*, choose; *wonnyng*, dwelling, abode.

927 *vtter*, without.

928 *wore* = *ware* = *were*. Cf. *thore* = *thare* = *there*.

931 *agayn-tote*, looking back; *tote* (toot) occurs frequently with the sense of “to peep,” “look,” in Early English.

P. 64. l. 944 *Loke ʒe bowe now bi bot*, Look ye go now by (according to) command.

947 *greme*, wrath.

948 *wakan*, arouse, stir up.

950 *flytande*, chiding, murmuring.

955 *smachande*, savouring, smelling.

964 *riftes*, fissures.

113

965 *cloutes*, pieces.

969 *Rydelles* = *redeless* = without counsel, helpless; *rowtes*, companies.

971 *Such a zomerly zarm of zellyng þer rysed,*
 Such a mournful (pitiful) outcry of yelling there rose.

- P. 65. l. 976 *Trynande ay a hyze trot*, going ever (at) a great pace.
987 *louez*, not *loaves*, but = the provincial *looves* = hands.
989 *dampned* = *dumped*, beaten down.
991 *malscrande mere*, accursed lake.
992 *on a lawe*, on a hill.
1000 & *alle lyste on hir lik* (i.e. *lick*) *þat arn on launde bestes*.

“Als so sco loked hir behind,
A stan sco standes bi þat way
And sua sal do to domesday;
In a salt stan men seis hir stand
þat best likes o þat land;
þat anes o þe wok day,
þan is sco liked al away
And þan þai find hir on þe morn,
Hale als sco was ar befor.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 17b.)

1002 *niye*, anguish.

- P. 66. l. 1009 *a ropun of a reche*, a rush of smoke, a mass of vapour;
blake, the black (pit).
1011 *flot*, fat, grease.

1016 *drouy*, turbid, from *droue*, to trouble.

1024 *costez of kynde* = natural properties.

1030 *bopem brobely*, filthy pit.

1031 *losyng*, perdition.

1033 *coostez* = properties.

1035 *alkaran*, Mandeville employs the term *alkatran*; *angré* = poisonous or grievous, or *augre* = *aigre*, sharp.

1036 *saundyuer* = *sandiver*, glass-gall.

1037 *waxlokes*, waves.

1038 *spuniande*, cleaving, sticky.

1039 *se halues*, sea coasts.

1041 *terne* = *tarne*, lake.

1044 *apple garnade* = pomegranate.

P. 67. l. 1072 *kynned*, conceived.

1076 *a schepon* = a stable.

P. 68. l. 1079 *reflayr*, smell, odour; *rote*, decay.

1082 *þe reken fypel*, the merry fiddle.

1094 *lomerande blynde*, the hesitating (slow, creeping), blind.
The primitive meaning of *lomerande* seems to be that of *slow*, sluggish.

1108 *tyzt*, endeavour.

P. 69. l. 1113 *fenny*, dirty, filthy, and hence sinful.

1118 *to dele*, to exchange.

1123 For “& wax euer,” etc., the sense seems to require that we should read “& wax ho euer,” etc.

1124 *in pyese* = whole.

1126 *blyndes of ble*, becomes dull of hue, loses its colour.

1127 *No-bot*, only.

1141 *lastes*, vices.

1142 *þewes* = *þeues* (?), thieves, or *unþewes*, vices (?)

- P. 70. l. 1153 *tyzt me a tom* = give me an opportunity; *tom* has the sense of *leisure* and not of *time*.
 1167 *fylsened*, helped, aided.
 1172 *lat*, late, slow.
 1178 *porpes*, cities.
- P. 71. l. 1186 *skete skarmoch, skelt*, brisk skirmish, hastened (came on quickly).
 1190 *brutage* = *bretage*, parapets of a wall.
 1202 *blench*, stratagem.
 1205 *at-wappe*, escape.
 1206 *skelt*, spread.
 1208 *ruþed*, roused.
 1209 *hard hattes*, (?) hats made of tow; *herd, hard* (*harden, hards*), in O. English signify cloth made of tow.
- P. 72. l. 1219 *faynest*, gladdest.
 1224 *dreze þer his wyrdes*, endure there his destiny.
 1246 *to þe bronde*, to the sword.
- P. 73. l. 1254 *on capeles*, on horses.
 1255 *fole wombes*, bellies of foals.
 1259 *to 114 cayre at þe kart & þe kuy mylke*, to drag at the cart and milk the cows.
 1265 *plat of*, strike off.
 1284 *hamppred* = *hampered*, packed up for removal.
- P. 74. l. 1290 *hyztled*, ornamented.
 1303 *modey* = *moody*, proud.
 1313 *sesed*, took possession of.
- P. 75. l. 1327 *bi-cnv* = *bicneu*, acknowledged.
 1330 *heldes*, descends.
 1332 *grauen*, buried.
 1334 *stalled in his stud*, placed in his stead (position).

- 1342 *tre*, wood; *telded*, raised.
 1344 *gered*, covered, decked.
 1346 *reden*, advise.
 1354 *notyng*, devising, contriving; *gettes*, devices.
- P. 76. l. 1358 *avayment*, exhibition.
 1361 *banne*, proclamation.
 1362 *callyng*, decree.
 1366 *vche a kythyn kyng*, every king of countries.
 1375 *ludisch lordes*, lords of nations.
 1379 *plek*, spot (plot of ground).
- P. 77. l. 1396 *Stepe stayred [þe] stones of his stoute throne*,
 Bright shone the stones of his firm throne.
 1397 *hiled* = covered.
 1398 *bounet*, went about.
 1402 *strake steuen* = struck up sound.
 1403 *wrasten krakkes*, sounds (notes) are raised.
 1410 *foles*, fowls, birds. *flakerande*, flickering, fluttering.
 1412 *on blonkken bak*, on the back of horses. In lines 1407-1412
 we have evidently an allusion to the “table subtilties” of the
 fourteenth century.
 1420 *wezed*, served.
 1425 *dotage*, folly.
- P. 78. l. 1435 *schin*, shall.
 1446 *besten blod*, blood of beasts; *busily*, laboriously.
 1462 *fylyoles*, round towers.
- P. 79. l. 1472 *Penitotes*. So in MS., but read *Peritotes*.
 1478 *cost*, contrivance.
 1495 *iaueles* = worthless wretches, used by Hall and Spenser.
- P. 80. l. 1501 *wlates*, is disgusted.
 1504 *wayned*, granted.

1505 *glotoun*, a general term of reproach.

1507 *vus* = *use*, drink.

1510 *kyppe*, take, seize, catch up.

1511 *birlen*, pour out.

1517 *dotel*, fool.

1520 as each one was disposed so tossed he off the cup.

P. 81. l. 1537 *neue*, fist.

1542 *lers*, features, but (?) *fers*, fears.

1543 *as a rad ryth*, as a frightened hound (literally mastiff).

1545 *runisch sauez*, strange words.

1554 *skelten*, hasten.

1557 *þo draȝtes*, the characters.

1559 *ede* = went, but *bede*, bade, commanded.

1560 *warlaȝes*, wizards.

1566 *malt*, to soothe.

1568 *gered*, clothed.

P. 82. l. 1585 *he wed wel ner*, he became nearly mad.

1603 *in stoundes*, at times.

P. 83. l. 1606 *spured*, asked, enquired of.

1634 *tede* = *tene*, ten (?)

1637 *apyke*, adorn, clothe.

P. 84. l. 1650 *loȝed*, made low.

1654 *pouer*, power.

1674 *wasterne*, wilderness; *dowelle*, dwelle.

1675 *braken*, fern.

P. 85. l. 1678 *soly*, seat.

1684 *ay* (?) = hay.

1686 *ouer-seyed*, passed over.

1690 *wykes*, members.

1692 *clyde*, plaister (?).

1694 *bresed*, rough, bristly; Sir F. Madden interprets it *broken*.

1695 *campe hores*, shaggy hairs.

1696 *glede*, kite.

1701 *wayned*, recovered.

1707 *hazerly*, properly.

P. 86. l. 1713 *auyled*, defiled.

1716 *wale wyne*, choice wine; *in waryed stoundes*, in accursed moments.

P. 87. l. 1755 *dazed*, dawned.

1759 *blykned* = *blaykned*, became dark, blackened.

1760 *Mourkenes*, becomes murky.

1761 *lyst*, path.

1768 *layted*, sought.

1773 *ledes of armes*, men of arms.

1775 *pester*, darkness.

115

P. 88. l. 1785 *slyppe*, escape.

1786 *honde-whyle*, a moment.

1788 *blende*, mingled.

1792 *now is a dogge also dere*, now is as valuable as a dog.

1808 *telled* = raised (?) *telles* = raises.

1811 *gere*, clothing.

PATIENCE.

I.

NCE IS TO BE COMMENDED.

90

Blessed are the peace-makers, for they shall be called God's sons.

þay ar happen also þat con her hert stere,
28 For hores is þe heuen-ryche, as I er sayde.

These arn þe happes alle a3t þat *vus* bihy3t weren,
If we þyse ladyes wolde lof in *lyknyng* of þewes;
Dame pouert, Dame pitee, Dame penaunce þe
þrydde,

32 Dame Mekenesse, Dame mercy & Miry
clannesse,

& þenne Dame pes & pacyence put in þer-after.
He were happen þat hade one, alle were þe better,
Bot *syn* I am put to a poynt þat pouerte hatte,
36 I schal me poruay pacyence, & play me *with*
boþe;

For in þe tyxte, þere þyse two arn in teme layde,
Hit arn fettled in on forme, þe forme & þe laste,
& by quest of her quoyntyse enquylen on mede,
40 & als in myn vpynyoun hit arn of on kynde;
For þer as pouert hir proferes ho nyl be put vtter,
Bot lenge where-so-euer hir lyst, *lyke oþer greme*,
& þere as pouert enpresses, þa3 mon pyne þynk,
44 Much maugre his *mun*, he mot nede suffer,
Thus pouerte & pacyence arn nedes play-feres.
Syþen I am sette *with hem* samen, suffer me by-
houes,

þenne is me *ly3tloker* hit lyke & her *lot*es prayse,
48 þenne wyþer wyth & be wroth & þe wers haue.
3if me be dy3t a destyné due to haue,
What dowes me þe *dedayn*, oþer dispit make?
Oþer 3if my lege lorde lyst on lyue me to bidde,
52 Oþer to ryde, oþer to renne, to rome in his ernde,
What *grayþed* me þe *grychchyng* bot grame more
seche?

Much 3if he me ne made, maugref my chekes,
& þenne þrat moste I þole, & vnþonk to mede,
56 *þe[t]* had bowed to his bode, bongre my hyure.
Did not Ionas in Iude suche Iape sum-whyle,
To sette hym to sewrte, vnsounde he hym feches?

Blessed are they that live
aright, for theirs is the
kingdom of heaven.

These blessings are promi
to those who follow

[Fol. 8:

poverty, pity, penance,
meekness, mercy, chastity
peace and patience,...

syn] MS. *fyn*.

Poverty and patience are t
be treated together.

They are "fettled in one
form,"

and have one meed.

Poverty will dwell where
lists,

mun] *mon* (?).

and man must needs suffe

Poverty and patience are
play-fellows.

What avails impatience,

if God send affliction?

Patience is best.

Did not Jonah incur dange
by his folly?

Wyl 3e tary a lyttel tyme & tent me a whyle,
60 I schal wysse yow þer-wyth as holy wryt telles.
91

tyme] MS. *tyne*.

H IS SENT TO NINEVEH.

II.

Hit bi-tydde sum-tyme in þe termes of Iude,
Jonas ioyned wat3 þer-inne ientyle prophete;
Goddess glam to hym glod, þat hym vnglad made,
64 *With* a roghlych rurd rownded in his ere;
“Rys radly,” he says, “& rayke forth euen,
Nym þe way to nynyue, wyth-outen oþer speche,
& in þat cete my sazes soghe alle aboute,
68 Þat, in þat place at þe poynt, I put in þi hert;
For Iwysse hit arn so wykke þat in þat won
dowelle3,
& her malys is so much I may not abide,
Bot venge me on her vilanye & venym bilyue;
72 Now swe3e me þider swyftly & say me þis
arende.”
When þat steuen wat3 stynt, þat stowned his mynde,
Al he wrathed in his wyt & wyþerly he þo3t,
If I bowe to his bode & bryng hem þis tale,
76 & I be Nummen in Nuniuē, my nyes begynes;
He telles me þose traytours arn typped schrewes,
I com wyth þose tybynges, þay ta me bylyue,
Pyne3 me in a prysoun, put me in stokkes,
80 Wryþe me in a warlok, wrast out myn y3en.
Þis is a meruayl message a man for to preche,
Amonge enmyes so mony & mansed fendes;
Bot if my gaynlych god such gref to me wolde,
84 For desert of sum sake þat I slayn were,
At alle peryles, *quod* þe prophete, I aproche hit no
nerre,

Jonah was a prophet of the
gentiles.

God’s word came to him,
saying,

“Rise quickly, take the way
to Nineveh.

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Say that which I shall put
thine heart.

Wickedness dwells in that
city.

Go swiftly and carry my
message.”

Jonah is full of wrath.

He is afraid that the shrew

will put him in the stocks,
or put out his eyes.

He thinks that God desires
his death.

For] MS. *fof*.

He determines not to go on
the city,

I wyl me sum *oper* waye, þat he ne wayte after;
I schal tee *in-to* tarce, & tary þere a whyle,
88 & lyztly, when I am lest, he letes me alone.
Þenne he ryses radly, & raykes bilyue
Ionas toward port Iaph, ay Ianglande for tene,
þat he nolde þole, for no-þyng, non of þose pynes,
92 Þa3 þe fader þat hym formed were fale of his
hele.

“Oure syre syttes,” he says, “on sege so hy3e
In his g[l]wande glorie, & gloumbes ful lyttel,
92

ILS FOR TARSHISH.

Þa3 I be nummen *in* nuniue & naked dispoyled,
96 On rode rwly to-rent, *with* rybaudes mony.”
Þus he passes to þat port, his passage to seche,
Fyndes he a fayr schyp to þe fare redy;
Maches hym *with* þe maryneres, makes her paye,
100 For to towe hym *in-to* tarce, as tyd as þay myzt.
Then he tron on þo tres & þay her tramme ruchen,
Cachen vp þe crossayl, cables þay fasten,
Wi3t at þe wyndlas we3en her ankres,
104 Sprude spak to þe sprete þe spare bawe-lyne,
Gederen to þe gyde ropes, þe grete cloþ falles;
Þay layden *in* on ladde-borde & þe lofe wynnes.
Þe blype breþe at her bak þe bosum he fyndes,
108 He swenges me þys swete schip swefte fro þe
hauen.

Wat3 neuer so Ioyful a Iue, as Ionas wat3 þenne,
þat þe daunger of dry3tyn so derfly ascaped;
He wende wel þat þat wy3 þat al þe world planted,
112 Hade no ma3t *in* þat mere no man forto greue.
Lo! þe wyttles wrechche, for he wolde no3t suffer,
Now hat3 he put hym *in* plyt of peril wel more;
Hit wat3 a wenyng vn-war þat welt *in* his mynde,

but fly to Tarshish.

Grumbling, he goes to port
Joppa.

He says that God will not
able to protect him.

Jonah reaches the port, finds
a ship ready to sail.

The seamen catch up the
cross-sail, fasten the cable
weigh their anchors,

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and spread sail.

A gentle wind wafts the ship
along.

Was never a Jew so joyful
was Jonah then.

He has, however, put himself
in peril,

in fleeing from God.

116 Þa3 he were so3t fro samarye þat god se3 no fyrre,
3ise he blusched ful brode, þat burde hym by sure,

þat ofte kyd hym þe carpe þat kyng sayde,
Dyngne dauid on des, þat demed þis speche,

The words of David.

120 In a psalme þat he set þe sauter *with-inne*;

O Fole3 in folk felez oþer whyle,

& vnderstonde3 vmbe-stounde, þa3 he be stape
fole,

Does He not hear, who m
all ears?

Hope 3e þat he heres not þat eres alle made?

124 Hit may not be þat he is blynde þat bigged
vche y3e.

He is not blind that forme
each eye.

Bot he dredes no dynt þat dotes for elde,

Jonah is now in no dread.

For he wat3 fer in þe flod foundande to tarce;

Bot, I trow, ful tyd, ouer-tan þat he were,

He is, however, soon
overtaken.

128 So þat schomely to schort he schote of his
ame.

For þe welder of wyt, þat wot alle þynges,
þat ay wakes & waytes, at wylle hat3 he sly3tes;

The wielder of all things l
devices at will.

93

OVERTAKEN BY A TEMPEST.

He calde on þat ilk crafte he carf *with* his hondes,

132 Þay wakened wel þe wroþeloker, for wroþely he
cleped:

“Ewrus & aquiloun, þat on est sittes,

He commands Eurus and
Aquilo to blow.

Blowes boþe at my bode vpon blo watteres.”

Þenne wat3 no tom þer bytwene his tale & her
dede,

The winds blow obedient
His word.

136 So bayn wer þay boþe two, his bone for to wyrk.

An-on out of þe norþ est þe noys bigynes,

Out of the north-east the
noise begins.

When boþe breþes con blowe vpon blo watteres;

Ro3 rakkes þer ros *with* rudnyng an-vnder,

[Fol. 8]

140 Þe see sou3ed ful sore, gret selly to here;

Storms arose,
winds wrestled together, t
waves rolled high,

Þe wyndes on þe wonne water so wrastel to-
geder,

þat þe wawes ful wode waltered so hi3e,

& efte busched to þe abyne þat breed fysches;

144 Durst nowhere for roȝ arest at þe bothem.

When þe breth & þe brok & þe bote metten,

Hit watȝ a ioyles gyn þat Ionas watȝ inne,

For hit reled on roun[d] vpon þe roȝe ypes.

148 Þe bur ber to hit baft þat braste alle her gere,

Þen hurled on a hepe þe helme & þe sterne,

Furst to murte mony rop & þe mast after.

Þe sayl sweyed on þe see, þenne suppe bihoued

152 Þe coge of þe colde water, & þenne þe cry ryses; *colde] MS. clolde.*

Ȝet coruen þay þe cordes & kest al þer-oute.

Mony ladde þer forth-lep to laue & to kest,

Scopen out þe scapel water, þat fayn scape wolde;

156 For be monnes lode neuer so luþer, þe lyf is ay *lode] lote (?)*

swete.

Þer watȝ busy ouer-borde bale to kest

Her bagges, & her feþer beddes, & her bryȝt

wedes,

Her kysttes, & her coferes, her caraldes alle,

160 & al to lyȝten þat lome, ȝif leþe wolde schape;

Bot euer watȝ ilyche loud þe lot of þe wyndes,

& euer wroþer þe water, & wodder þe stremes.

Þen þo wery for-wroȝt wyst no bote,

164 Bot vchon glewed on his god þat gayned hym

beste;

Summe to vernagu þer vouched a-vowes solemne,

Summe to diana deuout, & derf nepturne,

94

To mahoun & to mergot, þe mone & þe sunne,

168 & vche lede as he loued & layde had his hert.

and never rested.

Then was Jonah joyless.

The boat reeled around.

The gear became out of order.

Ropes and mast were broken.

A loud cry is raised, Many
lad labours to lighten the
ship.

They throw overboard the
bags and feather beds.

But still the wind rages, as
the waves become wilder.

Each man calls upon his g

Some called upon Vernag
Diana, and Neptune, to th
sun and to the moon.

H IS CONDEMNED TO DEATH,

Þenne bispeke þe spakest dispayred wel nere:

I leue here be sum losynger, sum lawles wrech,

Þat hatȝ greued his god & gotȝ here amonge vus;

Then said one of the sailo
“Some lawless wretch, th
has grieved his God, is in
ship.

172 Lo al synkes in his synne & for his sake marres!

I lovne þat we lay lotes on ledes vchone,
& who-so lympeþ þe losse, lay hym þer-oute;

& quen þe gulty is gon what may gome trawe,

176 Bot he þat rules þe rak may rwe on þose oþer?

Þis wat3 sette in asent, & sembled þay were,

Her3ed out of vche hyrne to hent þat falles.

A lodes-mon ly3tly lep vnder hachches,

180 For to layte mo ledes & hem to lote bryng,

Bot hym fayled no freke þat he fynde my3t,

Saf Ionas þe Iwe þat Iowked in derne.

He wat3 flowen for ferde of þe flode lotes

184 In-to þe boþem of þe bot, & on a brede
lyggede,

On helde by þe hurrok, for þe heuen wrache,

Slypped vpon a sloumbe, selepe, & sloberande he
routes.

Þe freke hym frunt with his fot & bede hym ferk
vp,

188 Þer ragnel in his rakentes hym rere of his dremes;

Bi þe haspede he hentes hym þenne,

& bro3t hym vp by þe brest & vpon borde sette,

Arayned hym ful runyschly what raysoun he hade

192 In such sla3tes of sor3e to slepe so faste;

Sone haf þay her sortes sette & serelych deled,

& ay þe lote, vpon laste, lymped on Ionas.

Þenne ascryed þay hym sckete, & asked ful loude,

196 “What þe deuel hat3 þou don, doted wrech?

What seches þou on see, synful schrewe,

With þy lastes so luper to lose vus vchone?

Hat3 þou, gome, no gouernour ne god on to calle,

200 Þat þou þus slydes on slepe when þou slayn
worþes?

Of what londe art þou lent, what laytes þou here

Whyder in worlde þat þou wylt, & what is þyn arnde?

95

Lo þy dom is þe dy3t, for þy dedes ille!

I advise that we lay lots upon
each man.

[Fol. 8v]

When the guilty is gone the
tempest may cease.”

This is agreed to.

All are assembled, from all
corners of the ship,

save Jonah the Jew,

who had fled into the bottom
of the boat.

There he falls asleep.

Soon he is aroused,

and brought on board.

Full roughly is he
questioned.

The lot falls upon Jonah.

þe] MS. þe þe.

Then quickly they said:
“What the devil hast thou
done, doted wretch?

What seekest thou on the
sea?

Hast thou no God to call
upon?

Of what land art thou?

Thou art doomed for thy ill
deeds.”

204 Do gyf glory to þy godde, er þou glyde hens.”

“I am an Ebru,” *quod* he, “of Israyl borne;

þat wyȝe I worchyp, Iwysse, þat wroȝt alle

þynges,

Alle þe worlde *with* þe welkyn, þe wynde & þe

sternes,

208 & alle þat woneȝ þer *with-inne*, at a worde one.

Alle þis meschef for me is made at þys tyme,

For I haf greued my god & gulty am founden;

For-þy bereȝ me to þe borde, & bapeȝes me þer-

oute,

212 Er gete ȝe no happe, I hope forsoþe.”

Jonah says: “I am a Hebre
a worshipper of the world
Creator.

All this mischief is caused
by me, therefore cast me
overboard.”

[Fol. 8v]

bapeȝes] *bapes* (?).

S CAST OVERBOARD.

He ossed hym by vnnyngeȝ þat þay vnder-nomen,

þat he watȝ flawen fro þe face of frelych dryȝtyn;

þenne such a ferde on hem fel & flayed hem *with-*

inne,

216 þat þay ruyt hym to rowwe & letten þe rynk

one.

Hapeles hyȝed in haste *with* ores ful longe,

Syn her sayl watȝ hem aslypped on sydeȝ to rowe;

Hef & hale vpon hyȝt to helpen hym seluen,

220 Bot al watȝ nedles note, þat nolde not bityde:

In bluber of þe blo flod bursten her ores,

þenne hade þay noȝt in her honde þat hem help

myȝt;

þenne nas no coumfort to keuer, ne counsel non oþer,

224 Bot ionas *in-to* his Iuis Iugge bylyue.

Fyrst þay prayen to þe prynce þat prophetes

seruen,

þat he gef hem þe grace to greuen hym neuer,

þat þay in baleleȝ blod þer blenden her handeȝ,

228 þaȝ þat hapel wer his, þat þay here quelled.

Tyd by top & bi to þay token hym synne,

In-to þat lodlych loȝe þay luche hym sone;

hym] *hem* (?).

He proves to them that he
was guilty.

The mariners are
exceedingly frightened.

They try to make way wit
their oars,

but their endeavours are
useless.

Jonah must be doomed to
death.

They pray to God,

that they may not shed
innocent blood.

Jonah is cast overboard.

He wat3 no tytter out-tulde þat tempest ne sessed,
232 Þe se sa3tled þer-with, as sone as ho mo3t.
Þenne þa3 her takel were torne, þat totered on
yþe3,

Styffe stremes & stre3t hem strayned a whyle,
Þat drof hem dry3lych adoun þe depe to serue,
236 Tyl a swetter ful swyþe hem swe3ed to bonk.
Þer wat3 louyng on lofte, when þay þe londe
wonnen,

To oure mercyable god, on moyses wyse,

96

With sacrafyse vp-set, & solempne vowes,
240 & graunted hym vn-to be god & graythly non oþer;
Þa3 þay be Iolef for Ioye, Ionas 3et dredes,
Þa3 he nolde suffer no sore, his seele is on anter;
For what-so worþed of þat wy3e, fro he in water
dipped,

244 Hit were a wonder to wene, 3if holy wryt nere.

D WHALE SWALLOWS JONAH.

III.

Now is ionas þe Iwe Iugged to drowne;
Of þat schended schyp men schowued hym sone.
A wylde walterande whal, as wyrde þen schaped,
248 Ðat wat3 beten fro þe abyne, bi þat bot flotte,
& wat3 war of þat wy3e þat þe water so3te,
& swyftely swenged hym to swepe & his swol3
opened;

Þe folk 3et haldande his fete þe fysch hym tyd hentes,
252 *With*-outen towche of any tothe he tult in his
prote.

Thenne he swenge3 & swayues to þe se boþem,
Bi mony rokke3 ful ro3e & rydelande strondes,
Wyth þe mon in his mawe, malskred in drede.

out-tulde] *out-tulte* (?).

The tempest ceases and the
sea settles.

The stiff streams drive the
ship about.

serue] *sterue* (?).

At last they reach a bank.

The seamen thank God,
and perform solemn vows

Jonah is in great dread.

Jonah is shoved from the
ship.

to] MS. to to.

[Fol. 80

A wild whale swims by the
boat.

He opens his swallow,

and seizes the prophet.

swayues] *swaynes* (?).

256 As lyttel wonder hit wat3 3if he wo drezed,
For nade þe hy3e heuen kyng, þur3 his honde
my3t,

It is not to be wondered at
that Jonah suffered woe.

Warded þis wrech man in warlowes gutte3,
What lede mo3t lyue bi lawe of any kynde,
260 Þat any lyf my3t be lent so longe hym *with-inne*?

Bot he wat3 sokored by þat syre þat syttes so hi3e,
Þa3 were waule3 of wele, in wombe of þat fissche,
& also dryuen þur3 þe depe, & in derk walttere3.

waule3] wanle3 (?).

The prophet is without ho

Cold was his comfort.

264 Lorde! colde wat3 his cumfort & his care huge,
For he knew vche a cace & kark þat hym lymped;
How fro þe bot in-to þe blober wat3 *with* a best
lachched,

& þrwe in at hit þrote, *with-oute*n þret more,

þrwe] þrwen (?).

268 As mote in at a munster dor, so mukel wern his
chawle3,

Jonah was only a mote in
whale's jaws.

He glydes in by þe giles, þur3 glaymande glette,
Relande in by a rop, a rode þat hym þo3t,
Ay hele ouer hed, hourlande aboute,
272 Til he blunt in a blok as brod as a halle;

He entered in by the gills,
and by means of one of th
intestines of the fish, cam
into a space as large as a
hall.

97

The prophet fixes his feet
firmly in the belly of the
whale.

& þer he festnes þe fete & fathme3 aboute,
& stod vp in his stomak, þat stank as þe deuel;
Þer in saym & in sor3e þat sauoured as helle,
276 Þer wat3 bylded his bour, þat wyl no bale suffer;
& þenne he lurkkes & laytes where wat3 le best,
In vche a nok of his nauel, bot nowhere he fynde3
No rest ne recouerer, bot ramelande myre,

He searches into every no
of its navel.

280 In wych gut so euer he got3; bot euer is god swete;
& þer he lenged at þe last & to þe lede called.

The prophet calls upon G

“Now prynce, of þy prophete pité þou haue!

Þa3 I be fol, & fykel, & falce of my hert,

[Fol. 8'

284 De-woyde now þy vengauce, þur3 vertu of
rauthe;

He cries for mercy.

Tha3 I be gulty of gyle as gaule of prophetes,
Þou art god, & alle gowde3 ar grayþely þyn owen;
Haf now mercy of þy man & his mys-dedes,

288 & preue þe lyztly a lorde, in londe & in water.”

With þat he hitte to a hyrne & helde hym þer-inne,

þer no de-foule of no fylþe wat3 fest hym abute;

þer he sete also sounde, saf for merk one,

292 As in þe bulk of þe bote, þer he by-fore sleped.

So in a bouel of þat best he bide3 on lyue,

þre dayes & þ[r]e ny3t ay þenkande on dry3tyn,

His my3t & his merci, his mesure þenne;

296 Now he knawe3 hym in care þat coupe not in sele.

He sits safely in a recess,

in a bowel of the beast,

for three days and three
nights.

WHALE WANDERS ABOUT.

Ande euer walteres þis whal bi wyldren depe,

þur3 mony a regioun ful ro3e, þur3 ronk of his

wylle,

For þat mote in his mawe mad hym, I trowe,

300 Þa3 hit lyttel were, hym wyth to wamel at his

hert,

Ande assayled þe segge; ay sykerly he herde

þe bygge borne on his bak & bete on his sydes;

þen a prayer ful prest þe prophete þer maked

304 On þis wyse, as I wene, his worde3 were

mony:

The whale passes through
many a rough region.

Jonah makes the whale fe
sick.

The prophet prays to God
this wise:

H PRAYS FOR HIS DELIVERANCE.

IV.

“**L**orde to þe haf I cleped, in care3 ful stronge,

Out of þe hole þou me herde, of hellen wombe

98

I calde, & þou knew myn vncler steuen;

308 Þou dipte3 me of þe depe se, in-to þe dymme

hert,

þe grete flem of þy flod folded me vmbe;

Alle þe gote3 of þy guferes, & groundele3 powle3,

& þy stryuande streme3 of strynde3 so mony,

“Lord! to thee have I crier
out of hell’s womb.

Thou dippedst me in the s

Thy great floods passed o
me.

The streams drive over m

312 In on daschande dam, dryue3 me ouer;
 & 3et I say, as I seet in þe se boþem,
 ‘Care-ful am I kest out fro þy cler y3en
 & deseuered fro þy sy3t; 3et surely I hope,
 316 Efte to trede on þy temple & teme to þy seluen.’
 I am wrapped in water to my wo stounde3,
 Þe abyeme byndes þe body þat I byde inne;
 Þe pure poplande hourle playes on my heued,
 320 To laste mere of vche a mount man am I
 fallen;
 Þe barrez of vche a bonk ful bigly me haldes,
 Þat I may lachche no lont & þou my lyf weldes;
 Þou schal releue me renk, whil þy ry3t slepe3,
 324 Þur3 my3t of þy mercy þat mukel is to tryste.
 For when þacces of anguych wat3 hid in my
 sawle,
 Þenne I remembred me ry3t of my rych lorde,
 Prayande him for peté his prophete to here,
 328 Þat in-to his holy hous myn orisoun mo3t entre.
 I haf meled with þy maystres mony longe day,
 Bot now I wot wyterly, þat þose vnwyse ledes
 Þat affyen hym in vanyté & in vayne þynges,
 332 For þink þat mountes to no3t, her mercy forsaken;
 Bot I dewoutly awowe þat verray bet3 halden,
 Soberly to do þe sacrafyse when I schal saue
 worþe,
 & offer þe for my hele a ful hol gyfte,
 336 & halde goud þat þou me hetes; haf here my
 trauthe.”

I am cast out from thy sig

The abyss binds me.

[Fol. 8’

The rushing waves play o
my head.

lont] *lond* (?).

Thou possessest my life.

In my anguish I remembe
my God,

and besought His pity.

hym] *hem* (?).

þink] *þing* (?).

When I am delivered from
this danger,

I will obey thy commands

VHALE VOMITS UP JONAH.

Thenne oure fader to þe fysch ferslych bidde3,
 Þat he hym sput spakly vpon spare drye;
 Þe whal wende3 at his wylle & a warþe fynde3,
 340 & þer he brake3 vp þe buyrne, as bede hym
 oure lorde.

God speaks fiercely to the
 whale,
 and he vomits out the
 prophet on a dry space.

Penne he swepe to þe sonde in sluchched cloþes,
Hit may wel be þat mester were his mantyle to
wasche;

Jonah has need to wash his
clothes.

99

þe bonk þat he blosched to & bode hym bisyde,
344 Wern of þe regiounes ryȝt þat he renayed hade;
Penne a wynde of goddeȝ worde efte þe wyȝe
bruxleȝ,

God's word comes to the
prophet.

“Nyȝt þou neuer to nuniue bi no-kynneȝ wayeȝ?”

“Ȝisse lorde,” *quod* þe lede, “lene me þy *grace*

348 For to go at þi gre, me gayneȝ non oþer.”

non] MS. *mon*.

“Ris, aproche þen to prech, lo þe place here!

He is told to preach in
Nineveh.

Lo! my lore is in þe loke, lance hit þer-inne.”

loke] *loken* (?).

Penne þe renk radly ros as he myȝt,

352 & to niniue þat naȝt he neȝed ful euen;

Hit watȝ a ceté ful syde & selly of brede,

On to þrenge þer-þurȝe watȝ þre dayes dede.

By nyȝt Jonah reaches the
city.

Nineveh was a very great
city.

ROPHET PREACHES AGAINST NINEVEH.

þat on Iournay ful Ioynt Ionas hym ȝede,

[Fol. 8r]

356 Er euer he warpped any worde to wyȝe þat he
mette,

& þenne he cryed so cler, þat kenne myȝt alle;

Jonah delivers his messag

þe trwe tenor of his teme he tolde on þis wyse:

“Ȝet schal forty dayeȝ fully fare to an ende,

“Yet forty days and Nineveh
shall come to an end.

360 & þenne schal Niniue be nomen & to noȝt
worþe;

Truly þis ilk toun schal tylte to grounde,

Vp-so-doun schal ȝe dumpe depe to þe abyme,

To be swolȝed swyftly wyth þe swart erþe,

It shall be turned upside
down,
and swallowed quickly by
the black earth.”

364 & alle þat lyuyes here-inne lose þe swete.”

þis speche sprang in þat space & spradde alle
aboute,

This speech spreads
throughout the city.

To borges & to bacheleres, þat in þat burȝ lenged;

Such a hidor hem bent & a hatel drede,

Great fear seizes all.

368 þat al chaunged her chere & chylled at þe hert.

Be segge sesed not 3et, bot sayde euer ilyche
“Be verray vengauce of god schal voyde þis place.”

Benne þe peple pitosly pleyned ful styлле,
372 & for þe drede of dryȝtyn doured in hert;
Heter hayreȝ þay hent þat asperly bited,
& þose þay bounden to her bak & to her bare
sydeȝ,

Dropped dust on her hede & dymly bisoȝten,
376 Ðat þat penaunce plesed him þat playneȝ on
her wronge.

& ay he cryes in þat kyth tyl þe kyng herde;
& he radly vp-ros & ran fro his chayer,

100

His ryche robe he to-rof of his rigge naked,
380 & of a hep of askes he hitte in þe myddeȝ;
He askeȝ heterly a hayre & hasped hym vmbe,
Sewed a sekke þer abof, & syked ful colde;
Per he dased in þat duste, *with* droppande teres,
384 Wepande ful wonderly alle his wrange dedes.
Benne sayde he to his seriauntes, “samnes yow
bilyue,

Do dryue out a decre demed of my seluen,
Ðat alle þe bodyes þat ben *with-inne* þis borȝ
quyk,

388 Boȝe burnes & bestes, burdeȝ & childer,
Vch prynce, vche prest & prelates alle,
Alle faste frely for her falce werkes;
Seseȝ childer of her sok, soghe hem so neuer,
392 Ne best bite on no brom, ne no bent naup̃er,
Passe to no pasture, ne pike non erbes,
Ne non oxe to no hay, ne no horse to water;
Al schal crye for-clemmed, *with* alle oure clere
strenþe,

396 Be rurd schal ryse to hym þat rawþe schal haue;
What wote oþer wyte may ȝif þe wyȝe lykes,
Ðat is hende in þe hyȝt of his gentryse?
I wot his myȝt is so much, þaȝ he be mysse-payed,

The people mourn secretly

clothe themselves in
sackcloth,

and cast ashes upon their
heads.

The message reaches the e
of the king.

He rends his robes,

clothes himself in sackcloth

and mourns in the dust.

He issues a decree,

that all in the city, men,
beasts, women and childre
prince, priest, and prelates

should fast for their sins.

[Fol. 8r]

Children are to be weaned
from the breast.

The ox is to have no hay, &
the horse any water.

Who can tell if God will
have mercy?

Though He is mighty,

400 Þat in his mylde amesyng he mercy may
 fynde;
 & if we leuen þe layk of oure layth synnes,
 & styлле steppen in þe styze he styztle3 hym seluen,
 He wyl wende of his wodschip, & his wrath leue,
 404 & for-gif *vus* þis gult 3if we hym god leuen.”
 Þenne al leued on his lawe & laften her synnes,
 Par-formed alle þe penaunce þat þe prynce radde;
 & god þur3 his godnesse forgef as he sayde,
 408 Ða3 he oþer bihyzt, [&] *with-helde* his
 vengaunce.

He is merciful,

and may forgive us our guilt
 All believed and repented

God forgave them through
 his goodness.

§ MERCY DISPLEASES JONAH.

V.

Muche sorze þenne satted vpon segge Ionas,
 He wex as wroth as þe wynde towarde oure lorde,
 So hat3 anger onhit his hert; he calle3
 412 A prayer to þe hyze prynce, for pyne, on þys
 wyse:
 101
 “I biseche þe syre now þou self iugge,
 Wat3 not þis ilk my worde þat worþen is nouþe,
 Ðat I kest in my cuntre, when þou þy carp sende3,
 416 Ðat I schulde tee to þys toun, þi talent to preche?
 Wel knew I þi cortaysye, þy quoynt soffraunce.
 Þy bounté of debonerté & þy bene grace,
 Þy longe abydyng wyth lur, þy late vengaunce,
 420 & ay þy mercy is mete, be mysse neuer so
 huge.
 I wyst wel when I hade worded quatsoeuer I cowþe,
 To manace alle þise mody men þat in þis mote
 dowelle3,
 Wyth a prayer & a pyne þay myzt her pese gete,
 424 & þer-fore I wolde haf flowen fer *in-to* tarce.

Much sorrow settles upon
 Jonah.

He becomes very angry.
 He prays to God and says

“Was not this my saying,
 when Thy message reached
 me in my own country?

I knew Thy great goodness

Thy long-suffering,
 and Thy mercy.

I knew these men might
 make their peace with The

therefore I fled unto
 Tarshish.

Now lorde lach out my lyf, hit lastes to longe,
Bed me bilyue my bale stour, & bryng me on
ende,

For me were swetter to swelt, as swyþe as me
þynk,

428 Þen lede lenger þi lore, þat þus me les makeþ.”

Þe soun of oure souerayn þen swey in his ere,

Þat vpbraydes þis burne vpon a breme wyse:

“Herk renk! is þis ryȝt so ronkly to wrath,

432 For any dede þat I haf don oþer demed þe
ȝet?”

Ionas al Ioyles & Ianglande vp-ryses

& haldeȝ out on est half of þe hyȝe place,

& farandely on a felde he fetteleȝ hym to bide,

436 For to wayte on þat won what schulde worþe after.

Þer he busked hym a bour, þe best þat he myȝt,

Of hay & of euer-ferne & erbeȝ a fewe,

For hit watȝ playn in þat place for plyande greueȝ,

440 For to schylde fro þe schene, oþer any schade
keste.

He bowed vnder his lyttel boþe, his bak to þe sunne,

& þer he swowed & slept sadly al nyȝt,

Take my life from me, O
Lord!

[Fol. 8r]

It is better for me to die than
live.”

God upbraids Jonah, saying

“Is this right to be so
wroth?”

Jonah, jangling, uprises,

and makes himself a bower
of hay and ever-fern,

to shield him from the sun

He slept heavily all night.

HIS SHELTERED BY A WOODBINE.

Þe whyle god of his grace ded growe of þat soyle,
444 Þe fayrest bynde hym abof þat euer burne wyste.

When þe dawande day dryȝtyn con sende,

Þenne wakened þe wyȝ vnder wodbynde,

Loked alofte on þe lef þat lylled grene;

448 Such a lefsel of lof neuer lede hade,

102

For hit watȝ brod at þe boþem, boȝted onlofte,

Happed vpon ayþer half a hous as hit were,

A nos on þe norþ syde & nowhere non elleȝ,

452 Bot al schet in a schaze þat schaded ful cole.

Þe gome glyȝt on þe grene graciose leues,

God prepared a woodbine

Jonah awakes, and is
exceedingly glad of the
bower.

þat euer wayued a wynde so wyþe & so cole;
þe schyre sunne hit vmbe-schon, þaʒ no schafte
myʒt

The prophet, under its
gracious leaves,

456 þe mountaunce of a lyttel mote, vpon þat man
schyne,

is protected from the sun's
rays.

þenne watʒ þe gome so glad of his gay logge,
lys loltrande þer-inne, lokande to toune,
so blyþe of his wodbynde he balteres þer vnde[r],
460 þat of no diete þat day þe deuēl haf, he roʒt;
& euer he laʒed as he loked þe loge alle aboute,
& wysched hit were in his kyth, þer he wony
schulde,

þe] *de* altered to *þe*.

Jonah wishes he had such
lodge in his own country.

On heʒe vpon Effraym oþer ermonnes hilleʒ,
464 “I-wysse a worþloker won to welde I neuer
keped.”

[Fol. 8^v]

& quen hit neʒed to naʒt nappē hym bihoued;
He slydeʒ on a sloumbe, slep sloghe vnder leues,
Whil god wayned a worme þat wrot vpe þe rote,
468 & wyddered watʒ þe wodbynde bi þat þe wyʒe
wakned;

God prepared a worm,
that made the woodbine
wither.

& syþen he warneʒ þe west to waken ful softe,
& sayeʒ *vnte* ʒeferus þat he *syfle* warme,
þat þer quikken no cloude bi-fore þe cler sunne,
472 & ho schal busch vp ful brode & brenne as a
candel.

vnte] *vnto* (?).

þen wakened þe wyʒe of his *wyl* dremes,
& blusched to his wodbynde þat broþely watʒ
marred,

Jonah awakes and finds hi
woodbine destroyed.

Al welwed & wasted þo worþelych leues;
476 þe schyre sunne hade hem schent, er euer þe schalk
wyst,

The leaves were all faded.

& þen hef vp þe hete & heterly brenned;
þe warm wynde of þe weste *wertes* he swyþeʒ.

The sun beat upon the hea
of Jonah.

MENTS ITS DESTRUCTION.

þe man marred on þe molde þat moʒt hym not hyde,

480 His wodbynde wat3 away, he weped for sor3e,
“With hatel anger & hot, heterly he calle3:

He is exceedingly angry,

A! þou maker of man, what maystery þe þynke3
þus þy freke to forfare forbi alle oþer,

103

484 With alle meschef þat þou may, neuer þou me
spare3?

I keuered me a cumfort þat now is ca3t fro me,
My wod-bynde so wlonk þat wered my heued,
Bot now I se þou art sette my solace to reue;

and prays God that he may
die.

488 Why ne dy3tte3 þou me to di3e; I dure to
longe?”

God rebukes the prophet.

3et oure lorde to þe lede lansed a speche:

“Dost thou well,” He says
“to be angry for the gourd

“Is þis ry3t-wys þou renk, alle þy ronk noyse,
So wroth for a wodbynde to wax so sone,

492 Why art þou so waymot wy3e for so lyttel?”

Jonah replies, “I would I
were dead.”

“Hit is not lyttel,” *quod* þe lede, “bot lykker to
ry3t,

I wolde I were of þis worlde wrapped in molde3.”

“Þenne byþenk þe mon, if þe for-þynk sore,

God asks if it is to be
wondered at that He should
help His handy work.

496 If I wolde help my honde werk, haf þou no
wonder;

þou art waxen so wroth for þy wod-bynde,
& trauallyde3 neuer to tent hit þe tyme of an
howre,

Is not Jonah angry that his
woodbine is destroyed,
which cost him no labour?

Bot at a wap hit here wax & away at an oþer,

[Fol. 8r]

500 & 3et lyke3 þe so luper, þi lyf wolde3 þou
tyne;

JUSTIFIES HIS MERCY AND FORBEARANCE.

Þenne wyte not me for þe werk þat I hit wolde
help,

God is not to be blamed for
taking pity upon people that
He made.

& rwe on þo redles þat remen for synne.

Fyrst I made hem myself of materes myn one,

504 & syþen I loked hem ful longe & hem on lode
hade;

& if I my trauayl schulde tyne of termes so longe,
& type doun 3onder toun when hit turned were,
þe sor of such a swete place burde synk to my
hert,

Should He destroy Nineve
the sorrow of such a swee
place would sink to His
heart.

508 So mony malicious mon as mournez þer-inne;
& of þat somme 3et arn summe such sottez for
madde,

In the city there are little
bairns who have done no
wrong.

As lyttel barnez on barme þat neuer bale wro3t,
& wymmen vnwytté þat wale ne coupe
512 Þat on hande fro þat oþer for alle þis hy3e
worlde,

[for] MS. fol.

Bitwene þe stele & þe stayre disserne no3t cunen,
What rule renes in roun bitwene þe ry3t hande
& his lyfte, þa3 his lyf schulde lost be þer-for;
516 & als þer ben doumbe bestez in þe bur3 mony,
Þat may not synne in no syt hem seluen to greue,
Why schulde I wrath wyth hem, syþen wy3ez wyl
torne,

And there are others who
cannot discern between th
right hand and their left
hand.

There are also dumb beast
in the city incapable of
sinning.

& cum & cnaue me for kyng, & my carpe leue?
104

cum] Or cun.

520 Wer I as hastif a[s] þou, heere were harme lumpen,
Coupe I not þole bot as þou þer þryued ful fewe;
I may not be so mal[i]cious & mylde be halden,
For malyse is no3[t] to mayntyne boutte mercy
withinne;

Judgment must be temper
with mercy.

524 Be no3t so gryndel god man, bot go forth þy
wayes."

Be preue & be pacient, in payne & in Ioye,
For he þat is to rakel to renden his cloþez,
Mot efte sitte with more vn-sounde to sewe hem
togeder.

He that is too hasty to ren
his clothes must afterwar
sit with worse ones to sew
them together.

528 For-þy when pouerté me enprece3 & paynez
in-no3e,

Poverty and pain must be
endured.

Ful softly with suffraunce sa3ttel me bihoue3,
For þe penaunce & payne to preue hit in sy3t,
Þat pacience is a nobel poynt, þa3 hit displese
ofte. Amen.

Patience is a noble point,
though it displeases oft.

NOTES TO PATIENCE.

All Notes were originally printed here, between *Patience* and the Glossarial Index. The Notes for *The Pearl* and *Cleanness* come immediately after their respective poems.

- Page 89. l. 3 *þe swelme leþe*, lessen the heat.
 4 *qued*, evil.
 5 *syt*, sorrow; *sele*, happiness.
 6 *þro*, anger.
 7 *þen is better to abyde þe bur vmbe-stoundes*,
 Then is it better to abide the blow sometimes.
 10 *melede*, related.
 11 *a3t*, eight.
 12 *sunder-lupes*, severally.
 13 *happen*, blessed.
- P. 90. l. 30 *lyknyng*, likeness; *þewes*, virtues.
 42 *lyke oþer greme*, pleasing or displeasing.
 47 *lyztloker*, more easily; *lotes*, forms.
 50 *what dowes me þe dedayn*, what avails me anger.
 53 *grayþed*, availed.
 56 *þe(t) had bowed*, etc., That should have been obedient.
- P. 91. l. 63 *Goddess glam to hym glod*, God's message came to him.
 66 *wythouten oþer speche*, without contradiction, without more words.
 67 *my sazes soghe*, etc., my saws (words) sow, etc.

77 *typped schrewes*, great sinners; literally, extreme, tip-top, schrews.

78 *ta me*, take me, seize me.

82 *mansed*, cursed.

94 *glwande*, glowing, bright; *gloumbes*, sees (indistinctly).

P. 92. l. 98 *to the fare*, to the voyage.

101 *tramme*, gear.

104 *Sprude spak to þe sprete þe spare bawlyne*,
Spread quickly to the sprit the spar bowline (?).

106 *ladde-borde*, larboard.

107 *blyþe breþe*, gentle wind; *bosum*, tide.

108 He refers to *breþe*.

112 *maȝt*, might; *mere*, sea.

115 *wenyng*, supposition.

117 *burde*, behoved.

119 *demed*, uttered.

122 *stapefole* = *stapeful* = high (?)

P. 93. l. 131 *crafte*, power.

135 *tom*, interval.

140 *souȝed*, sobbed, moaned; *selly*, marvel.

141 *wonne*, pale.

143 *busched* = *busked*, went.

144 *for roȝ* = for roughness.

148 *bur* = wave.

150 *to murte*, (?) *to-marte*, crushed, broken in pieces.

152 *coge*, boat.

155 *scapel*, hurtful, dangerous.

156 *lode* = *lote*, lot.

160 *leþe*, calm, quiet.

- 161 *lot*, noise, roar.
- P. 94. l. 173 *I lovne*, I offer (this advice), propose.
 183 *flode lotes*, the noises of the flood.
 184 *brede*, board.
 185 *hurrok*, oar.
 191 *runyschly*, fiercely.
 192 *sla3te*, strokes.
 198 *lastes*, crimes.
- P. 95. l. 208 *at a worde one*, at a word alone.
 213 *ossed*, showed, proved; *vnnynge*s, signs.
 216 *ruyt*, rush, hasten.
 227 *balelez*, innocent.
 229 *synne*, after.
- P. 96. l. 247 *as wyrde þen schaped*, as fate then devised.
 255 *malskred*, entranced, bewildered.
 258 *warlowes*, monster's.
 259 *lyue* = *leue*, believe.
 262 *waule3* = shelterless, destitute, but *wanlez* = *wonlez* = hopeless, is perhaps a better reading.
 268 *chawlez*, jaws.
 269 *glaymande glette*, slimy mud.
 270 *rop*, gut, intestine.
- P. 97. l. 273 *fapme3*, gropes.
 275 *saym*, fat, grease.
 277 *le*, shelter.
 291 *merk*, darkness.
 292 *bulk*, stern.
 302 *borne* = *burne*, man.
- P. 98. l. 309 *flem* = *flum*, stream.

317 *to my wo stoundez* = ? until my woe over-powers (confounds) me.

320 *to laste* ? to the last; *mere*, boundary.

325 *pacces*, blows.

329 *meled*, conversed.

338 *spare drye dry spar* (rafter) but ? *spare* = *space*.

339 *a warthe*, a ford.

341 *sluchched* = *sluched*, dirty, muddy.

342 *mester*, need.

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- P. 99. l. 345 *bruxlez*, reproaches, upbraids,
350 *loke* = *loken*, fastened.
362 *dumpe*, be thrust.
364 *swete*, life; *to lose þe swete* = to lose the (sweet) life.
372 *doured*, mourned, grieved. Cf. Sc. *dour*.
373 *Heter hayrez þay hent*, etc., rough hair shirts they took, etc.
- P. 100. l. 395 *for-clemmed*, very hungry, starved.
396 *rurd*, cry.
400 *amesyng* = *mesyng* = *mese*, pity, mercy.
403 *wodschip*, wrath.
411 *on-hit*, struck or inflamed (?); *callez*, addresses.
- P. 101. l. 418 *bene*, bountiful, kind.
419 *lur*, loss.
426 *bale-stour*, death-pang; *bale* in the sense of death is not very common.
447 *lylled*, flourished.
448 *lefsel* = *leaf-bower*. See Glossary.
- P. 102. l. 449 *bozted*, curved.
450 *happed*, covered.

451 *a nos* = a projection, opening (?) or is it a clerical error
for *abof* = *above*.

452 *scha3e* = wood, shaw.

453 *gly3t*, glanced.

460 *þe deuel* ? *ded euel*, did evil.

470 *syfle*, blow.

473 *wyl*, wandering.

478 *wertes he swyþe3*, herbs he scorches.

P. 103. l. 486 *wered*, protected.

489 *lansed*, uttered.

492 *waymot* = angry, passionate.

502 *remen*, mourn, lament.

509 *somme*, company.

P. 104. l. 524 *gryndel*, angry.

526 *rakel*, hasty.

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GLOSSARIAL INDEX

Note that I and J are listed separately, while all initial U except the one-letter word “u” are listed under V. As explained in the editor’s List of Abbreviations, the letters A, B, C refer respectively to *The Pearl*, *Cleanness* and *Patience*. Except for cross-references (“See...”), all links are to these external files.

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[N](#) [O](#) [P](#) [Q](#) [R](#) [S](#) [T](#) [U](#) [UV](#) [W](#) [Y](#) [3](#)

A

bate, lessen, put an end to, [A. 123](#); [B. 1356](#).

bate, abode, [A. 617](#).

bayst, downcast, abashed, [B. 149](#), pret. of *abaisse* or *abash*, Fr. *esbahir*.

ble, [A. 599](#).

bof, above, [A. 1023](#).

bominacione, [B. 1173](#).

broched, commenced, [A. 1123](#).

byde, (a) await, [A. 436](#), [486](#); (b) endure, [B. 7](#). A.S. *abidan*.

bydyng, sb. [C. 419](#).

byme, abyss, [A. 363](#); [B. 143](#).

byt, habit, dress, [B. 141](#).

Accorde,

Acorde, agreement, [A. 509](#), Fr. *accorder*, to agree with.

chaped, escaped, [B. 970](#).

chaufe, kindle, [B. 1143](#).

cheue, accomplish, [A. 475](#).

croche, encroach, [A. 1069](#), Fr. *accrocher*, to hook on; from *croc*, a hook.

daunt = daunt, [A. 157](#).

doun, down, [A. 988](#); [B. 953](#).

dreȝ, aside, aback, [B. 71](#). The word is used by Gower under the form *adrigh*.

O-dreghe, *one-dreghe*, 117b are other forms of the word. Sc. *on-dreich*.

“The tother withdrewe, *one-dreghe*

And durste do none other.”

(Morte Arthure, p. 352.)

“The tother droȝhe him *o-dreghe* for drede of the knyȝte.”

(Anturs of Arther, xlv. 3.)

“He with drogh hym *a draght* & a dyn made.”

(T. B. 1224.)

Adubbement, adornment, [A. 84, 85](#), O.Fr. *adoubement*; *dober, doubler*,
garnish, deck; Fr. *doubler*, to rig or trim a ship; Prov. Fr.
Adubmente, *adobar*, to arrange, prepare.

dyte, [A. 349](#).

ffraye, *sb.* fear, [A. 1174](#); *vb.* frighten, [B. 1780](#); Fr. *effrayer*, to scare, affright;
effroi, terror. Cf. *fray*, to scare birds.

ffyen, trust, [C. 331](#).

Agayn,
Agayne,
Agaynes,

against, [B. 266, 826, 1711](#).

gayneȝ, towards, [B. 611](#).

gayn-tote, *sb.* a looking back, [B. 931](#). *Tote*, look, peep, as a 118 verb or a
noun, is common in Old English writers.

“She went up wightly by a wall syde,
To the toppe of a tower, & *tot* ouer the water.”
(T. B. 862.)

ge, [A. 412, B. 426](#).

glyȝte, slipped from, [A. 245](#). *Glyȝt*, as a verb, signifies not only to slip but to
glance, look. Cf. *leme* = gleam, glance, slip.

labaunderynes, [B. 1470](#).

larom, alarm, [B. 1207](#).

l-bare, clearly, [A. 1025](#).

lce = als, also, [B. 1377](#).

lder = elder, [A. 621](#), *Aldest*, [A. 1042, B. 1333](#).

lder-men, elders, [A. 887](#).

legge, alledge, [A. 703](#).

liche, alike, [B. 1477](#).

lkaran = alkatran, [B. 1035](#).

lle-kynneȝ, all kinds of, [A. 1028](#).

llyt = a lyt = ? a little, [B. 599](#).

lmyȝt, almighty, [A. 498](#).

lofte, on high, [B. 1183](#).

l-one, [A. 933](#).

l-only, except, [A. 779](#).

losed, destroyed, [B. 274](#). See *lose*.

low, approve, praise, reward, [A. 634](#). O.Fr. *louer*. Lat. *laudare*.

loynte, removed, far from (from O.E. *aloigne*, *alogne*, to remove, carry off. O.Fr. *aloigner*).

loȝ, alow, softly, [B. 670](#).

ls, also, [A. 253](#), [827](#), [B. 516](#).

lso, as, [B. 984](#), [1045](#), [1792](#).

Also-tyd, }

Als-tyd, } at once, immediately, [B. 64](#). See *tyd*.

As-tyd, }

118b

l-þaȝ, although, [A. 759](#).

lþer-fayrest, fairest of all, [B. 1379](#).

lþer-fynest, finest of all, [B. 1637](#).

lþer-rychest, richest of all, [B. 1666](#).

lþer-swettest, sweetest of all, [B. 699](#).

lum, [B. 1035](#).

maffised, [B. 1470](#).

maraunȝ, [B. 1470](#).

matyst, amethyst, [A. 1016](#).

me, (1) *vb.* place, [A. 698](#); (2) *sb.* purpose, [B. 128](#). Germ. *ahmen*. Bavarian, *amen*, *hāmen*, to gauge a cask, fathom, measure.

mended, [B. 248](#).

mesyng, *sb.* moderation, [C. 400](#). See *mese*.

moneste, admonish, [B. 818](#).

mounted, [B. 395](#).

moynt, company, [A. 895](#).

nd = an, if, [B. 864](#).

n-ende (on-ende), lastly, finally, [A. 186](#).

n-ende = anente, opposite, [A. 1136](#); respecting, [A. 697](#).

n-ende3 = anentes, opposite, [A. 975](#). Sc. *anens*.

nger, [A. 343](#), [B. 572](#).

ngré, bitter, [B. 1035](#).

nguych, anguish, [C. 325](#).

nkrez, anchors, [A. 418](#), [B. 103](#).

non, at once (= anane, onane, in one moment), [A. 584](#).

nournement, ornament, [B. 1290](#).

noynted, [B. 1446](#).

nswar, answer, [A. 518](#).

nter, peril, [C. 242](#). To *aunter*, put a thyng in daunger, or adventure, *adventurer* (Palsgrave).

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n-vnder, under, [A. 1081](#). Sc. *anonder*. Cf. *down* and *adown*, *low* and *alow*.

paraunt, [B. 1007](#).

passed, past, [A. 540](#).

pert, openly, [A. 589](#).

pparaylmente, ornaments, [A. 1052](#).

pparement, ornaments, [B. 1270](#). Fr. *appareiller*, to fit, suit.

ppose, vb. question, [A. 902](#). Fr. *apposer*, to lay or set on, or near to.

proche, [A. 686](#), [B. 8](#), [167](#). Fr. *approcher*, draw near. Lat. *prope*, near.

pyke, adorn, [B. 1479](#), [1637](#).

quyle, demand, ask, obtain, [A. 690](#), [966](#). O.Fr. *aquillir*, to gather.

Array, [A. 719](#), [1166](#); [B. 816](#), [1442](#). O.Fr. *arroyer*, *arréer*, dispose, set in
Araye, order.

rayned, arraigned, [C. 191](#). O.Fr. *arraisonner*, *arraigner*.

re, before, previously, [B. 438](#), [1128](#).

rende, errand, message, [C. 72](#), A.S. *aerend*, *aerende*.

rest, *sb.* abode, resting place, [B. 906](#).

reset, *vb.* stop, cease, [A. 766](#), remain, [B. 144](#). Fr. *arrester*. Lat. *arestare*.

rewarde, apostate, [B. 208](#). Sc. *areird*, backward.

Arn,

Arne, are, [A. 458](#), [628](#), [B. 8](#), [1810](#).

ryue, [A. 447](#).

ry3t, aright, [A. 112](#).

r3e, terrify, frighten, fear, [B. 572](#), 119b 713. Provincial *arfe*, *arghe*, afraid. Cf.

“*Arwe* or *ferefulle* (*arwhe*, K. *arowe* or *ferdfulle* P.). *Timidus*, *pavidus*, *formidolus*.” (Prompt. Parv.) The original notion is that of laziness, inertness, and hence timidity, fear, etc. A.S. *earg*, inert, timid, weak. Ger. *arg*, bad. Du. *erg*. Icel. *argr*, lazy, cowardly. Sc. *argh*, *arch*, to hesitate, be reluctant.

“Antenor *arghet* with austerne wordes.”

(T. B. 1977.)

“Antenor, *arghly* auntrid of ship.”

(T. B. 1831.)

“A! Anec. quoth the qwene

me *ar3es* of my selfe,

I am all in aunter, sa

akis me the wame.”

(K. Alex. p. 29.)

“Sir Alexander and his ost was *ar3ed* unfaire.”

(*Ibid.* p. 132.)

r, are, [B. 1725](#).

re ? ane, one, [A. 711](#).

s, also, [B. 179](#).

s-bare, ? *al bare*, clearly, openly, [A. 836](#).

sayl, [B. 1188](#).

scape, escape, [B. 569](#).

scry, *sb.* cry, outcry, [A. 1784](#). *vb.* [B. 195](#). Swed. *anskri*, outcry, scream. O.N. *skri*, cry.

Asent,

Asente, [A. 391](#), “in *asent*,” [B. 788](#).

ske3, ashes, [B. 626](#).

skry, shout, cry, [B. 1206](#). See *ascry*.

slypped, escaped, lost, [C. 218](#).

spaltoun, asphalt, [B. 1038](#).

sperly, sharply, [C. 373](#).

120

ssayl, [C. 301](#).

sscaped, escaped, [B. 1776](#).

sscry, cry, shout. See *ascry*.

ssemble, [B. 1364](#), [1769](#).

ssemblé, [A. 760](#).

sspye, espy, see, [A. 704](#), [1035](#).

Assyse,

Asyse, form, fashion, [A. 97](#), [A. 844](#), service, [B. 639](#).

state, state, [A. 393](#).

straye, [A. 1162](#).

stel, stole from, [B. 1524](#).

s-tyt, immediately, at once, [A. 645](#), [B. 935](#).

sure, [B. 1411](#).

swage, [A. 3](#).

t, that, [A. 672](#).

tlyng, purpose, [B. 688](#). Sc. *ettle*, to endeavour. N.Prov.E. *ettle*, *attle*, intend. Icel. *aetla*.

“Armur & all thing *atlet* before.”
[\(T. B., 855.\)](#)

þel, noble, [A. 258, 411, 940](#), gracious, [A. 761](#), fine, [B. 1276](#), A.S. *aeþele*, noble, excellent.

tount, so much (?), [A. 179](#).

t-slyke, slip away, [A. 575](#).

tteny, attain, reach, [A. 548](#).

ttled, endeavoured. See [atlyng](#).

ttled, endowed, [B. 207](#). It sometimes occurs under the form *aghteld*.

N.Prov.E. *ettle*, to deal out, distribute. A.S. *aeht*, possession.

“She was eldist & heire *etlit* to his londes.”

([T. B. 394](#).)

t-wappe, escape, [B. 1205](#). See [Wap](#).

tyre, [B. 114](#).

ugoste, august, [A. 39](#).

uncetereȝ, auncestors, [B. 258](#).

120b

Aven,

Aune, own, [B. 11, 1222](#).

unte, [A. 233](#).

unter, adventure, marvel, [B. 1600](#). See [T. B. 1899](#).

uter, altar, [B. 10](#).

utly, noble, [B. 795](#). A.S. *áhtlíce*, courageously, manfully.

vaunt, *sb.* promise, [B. 664](#).

vayment, show, [B. 1358](#). F. *avoier*.

uaye, show, [B. 1311](#).

uenture, adventure, [A. 64](#). O.Fr. *aventure*.

uise, advise, [B. 1365](#).

vow, [B. 664](#).

voy, away! [B. 863](#).

vyle, defile, [B. 1151, 1713](#).

vysyoun, vision, [A. 1184](#).

wayed, shown, [A. 710](#).

wayle, avail, [B. 408](#).

wowe, avow, [C. 333](#).

y, always, ever, [A. 33](#), [720](#). A.S. *áva*, *a*, all, ever. O.Fris. *a*. Germ. *je*, ever.
yre, heir, [B. 650](#), [1709](#).

yper, each, [A. 831](#).

ywhere, everywhere, [B. 228](#).

ȝer = asure, [B. 1457](#).

ȝly = awly, fearfully, [B. 874](#), [937](#). Dan. *ave*, fear. Eng. *awe*. O.Eng. *agh*. Cf.
A.S. *aglác*, misery, grief.

Aȝt,

Aȝte, ought, *pret.* of *aȝe*, *agh*, or *awe*, [B. 122](#).

ȝt, eight, [A. 357](#), [B. 11](#), [29](#).

ȝt-sum, sorrowful, [B. 411](#).

ȝtȝe, eighth, [A. 1011](#).

B

aboyne, baboon, [B. 1409](#).

abtem, [A. 627](#). See [Baptem](#).

121

achlereȝ, batchelors, young men not yet raised to the order of knighthood,
[B. 86](#).

aft, abaft, [C. 148](#). A.S. *baefta*, the hinder part.

agge, baggage. [C. 158](#).

ale, bales, [C. 157](#). Sw. *bal*. Fr. *balle*, *bal*, a ball or pack.

ale, sorrow, woe; also misery, calamity, [A. 18](#), [373](#); [A. 1243](#), [1256](#); *baleȝ*,
[A. 123](#), [807](#). O.Fris. *bale*. A.S. *bealu*, torment, destruction. Icel. *böl*.

Phrases: “bodyly *bale*” (pain), [A. 478](#); “*bale* (torment) of helle,” [A. 651](#),
“*bale*-stour,” death pang, [B. 426](#).

aleleȝ = baleless, innocent, [C. 227](#).

alke, ridge of land, balk, [A. 62](#). Icel. *balkr*, the division between the stalls in a cow-house. Sw. *balka*, to partition off.

“To my shepe wylle I stalk, and herkyn anone,
Ther abyde on a *balk*, or sytt on a stone.”
(Town. Myst. p. 99.)

alleful = baleful, wretched, wicked, [B. 979](#).

alter, hop, jump, skip, [C. 459](#).

alterande, halting, limping, [B. 103](#). Sc. *balter*, to dance.

“He baltyrde, he bleryde.”
(Morte Arthure, p. 66.)

Etymologically it is connected with *palter* and *falter*, and is applicable either to the unsteady gait of the lame or faltering steps of the blind.

aly = bayly, authority, jurisdiction, dominion, [A. 1083](#).

121b

aneres, [B. 1404](#).

anne, proclamation, decree, [B. 95](#), [1361](#).

anne, curse, [B. 468](#), [885](#). Sw. *bann*, excommunication; *banna*, to reprove, chide, curse.

“*Bannet* worthe the bale tyme þat ho borne was.”
T. B. 1388.

anne, comfort, strengthen, [B. 620](#). O.Sc. *bawne*.

antel, [A. 991](#), [1017](#); [B. 1459](#), posts, pillars.

aptem, baptism, [A. 627](#), [653](#).

aptysed, [A. 818](#).

arayn, barren, [B. 659](#).

are, *adj.* naked, [B. 452](#); *sb.* 791.

are, only, [B. 1573](#). Sw. *bara*.

ared, disclosed, [B. 1149](#).

are-heued, bare-headed, [B. 633](#).

Bareres, bars, barriers, [A. 963, 1239](#); [B. 321](#). W. *bar*, rail, shaft. Fr. *barre*;
Barreȝ, *barrière*, a barrier. Cf. Sw. *s-parre*. Eng. *s-par*.

arme, bosom, [C. 510](#). A.S. *bearm*. “*Barme gremium*.” (Prompt. Parv.)

“He fond Horn in arme
On Rymenhilde *barme*.”

(K. Horn, p. 294.)

arnage, childhood, [B. 517](#).

arne, child, son, [A. 426](#); *barneȝ*, [A. 1040](#); [B. 1085](#). Sc. *bairn*. A.S. *bearn*.

aronage, nobility, [B. 1424](#). See [T. B. 211](#).

arouneȝ, barons, [B. 82, 1398](#).

Barreȝ,

Barers, bars, [B. 884, 1263](#).

arst, burst, [B. 963](#).

122

Base,

Basse, base, foundation, [A. 1000, B. 1278](#). See [T. B. 1652](#).

assyn, basin, [B. 1145, 1278](#).

astele, [B. 1187](#). “*Bastyle* of a castelle or cytye. Fascennia.” (Prompt. Parv.)

asyng, base, [A. 992](#).

ated, abated, [B. 440](#).

ater, [B. 1416](#).

atelment, [B. 1459](#).

aȝe, dip, plunge, [B. 1248](#).

ausen, badger, [B. 392](#). “*Bawstone* or *bawsone*, or a gray, *Taxus*, melota.”
(Prompt. Parv.)

awelyne, bow-line, [B. 417](#).

ay, recess, [B. 1392](#). The original meaning seems to be *opening* of any kind.
Cf. *bay*, space in a building between two main beams (Forby).

ayly, dominion, [A. 315, 442](#).

ayn, *adv.* readily, willingly, [A. 807](#), [A. 1511](#); ready, [B. 136](#). N.Prov.E. *bane*, near, convenient. “*Beyn* or *plyaunte*. *Flexibilis*.” (Prompt. Parv.) *Bainly*, readily, T. B. 135.

aysment, abasement, [A. 174](#).

ayte, [B. 55](#). O.N. *beita*.

aytayled, fortified, [B. 1183](#).

eauté, [A. 749](#).

Bed,

Bede, bid, command, invite; *p.p.* *beden*, [A. 715](#), [B. 95](#), [440](#). See T. B. 389.

eke, beak, [B. 487](#).

ekyrande, *sb.* biker, fighting, [B. 1474](#). “*Bekyryn* or *fyghtyn* (*bikkeringe*), *Pugno*, *dimico*.” (Prompt. Parv.)

“Bolde men to batell and *biker* with hond.”

T. B. 2944.

122b

ele, *vb.* boil, [A. 18](#). N.Prov.E. *bele*.

em, beam, ray, “*bem* of þe brode heuen,” [B. 603](#).

em, tree, [A. 814](#).

Ben,

Bene, are, *3rd pers. pl.* [A. 572](#).

ench, seat, [B. 130](#), [854](#).

ene, fair, [A. 198](#).

ene, *adj.* kind, merciful, [C. 418](#).

ent, field, plain, [B. 532](#), [1675](#). See T. B. 1192.

er, bore, *pret.* of *bere*, to bear, [A. 426](#), [B. 1480](#).

erdles, beardless, [B. 789](#).

ereste, breast, [A. 854](#).

erfray, watch tower, [B. 1187](#). O.F. *berfroir*, *beffroit*. Fr. *beffroir*. M.Lat. *belfredum*. The modern English *belfry* is a corruption of *berfray*.

eryl, [A. 110](#), [1011](#).

eryng, condition, state, behaviour, [B. 1060](#), [1228](#).

est, beast, [B. 288](#), [351](#).

este, sb. best (one), [A. 279](#).

esten, of beasts, [B. 1446](#).

ete, (the fire) mend, repair, kindle, [A. 627](#), *p.p. bet*, [B. 1012](#). Prov.E. *beat*, to mend, repair. A.S. *bétan*, (1) to improve, repair; (2) joined with *fyr* to mend a fire, to light or make a fire, to kindle.

ete, save, [A. 757](#). A.S. *bétan*, to remedy. Du. *boeten*, mend, fine, expiate.

et3 = bes, shall be, [A. 611](#). Present tense with future signification.

euerage, drink, liquor, [B. 1433](#), 123 1717. Fr. *beuvrage*, from Lat. *bibere*.

ewar, beware, [B. 292](#).

ewté, [A. 765](#).

eyng, sb. being, existence, [A. 446](#).

ibbe, sip, drink, [B. 1499](#). Prov.E. *beb*. Du. *biberen*, to drink much.

“Bacus he was brayne-wode for *bebbing* of wyne.”
(K. Alex. p. 154.)

icalt, becalled, called from, [A. 1163](#).

“The kyng was full curteus, *calt* on a maiden.”
(T. B. 388.)

i-cnɤ, acknowledged, [B. 1327](#).

idde, bide, abide. [C. 51](#).

iden, *p.p.* of *bide* = *abide*, [B. 616](#).

Bifalle,
Byfalle, befall, [A. 186](#).

ifore, before, [A. 49](#).

Bigge,
Bygge, great, [A. 43](#), *bygger*, [B. 374](#).

igge, build, [B. 1666](#). A.Sax. *byggan*. Icel. *byggja*. O.Sw. *byggja*, build, also inhabit.

igly, strongly, [C. 321](#). See T. B. 904.

igonne, began, [B. 123](#).

ihynde, behind, [B. 918](#).

iholde, behold, [B. 150](#).

ihy3t, promised, [C. 29](#).

ikenne, give, hand over, [B. 1296](#).

ilde, built, [B. 1392](#).

ileue, remain, [B. 1549](#).

ilooghe, below, [B. 116](#).

irle, pour out, [B. 1511](#). Prov.E. *burl*. A.S. *byrelian*, to give to drink.

“And seruanz war at this bridale
That *birled* win in cupp and schal.”
(Met. Hom. p. 120.)

123b

iropped, berolled, [B. 959](#).

iseche, beseech, [B. 614](#).

iso3ten, besought, [C. 375](#).

ispeke, speak, [C. 169](#).

isyde, beside, [B. 926](#).

i-talt, aroused, [A. 1161](#). A.S. *tealtian*, *tealtrian*; (1) to *tilt*, shake; (2) to be in danger. William of Shoreham uses one form of this word:

“For 3ef that water his kende lest
That cristninge stant *te-tealte*.”
(Poems, p. 9.)

“For if that water its kind loseth,
That christening standeth tottery, insecure” (*i.e.* not binding).

iteche, give up to, entrust to, [B. 871](#); pret. *bita3t*.

ited, bit, [C. 373](#).

Bipenkke,
Bipenke, bethink, [B. 1357](#).

ip03t, bethought, [B. 125](#).

ityde, betide; pret. bitydde, [C. 61](#).

ityde, befall, [B. 1804](#).

lade, [B. 1105](#).

lake, black, [A. 945](#); [B. 747](#), 1449.

lame, *vb.* [A. 275](#); [A. 877](#), 1661; *sb.* [B. 43](#).

lande, “in blande,” together, [B. 885](#). See *blende*.

Blasfamy,

Blasfemyon, [B. 1661](#), 1712.

layke, yellow, [A. 27](#). Brockett has *blayke* with the sense of yellow, of a golden colour. “*Bleyke* of colour.” Pallidus, subalbus. (Prompt. Parv.)

“Ther (in paradyse) were floures bothe blew and *blake*,
Of alle frutes thei myth ther take.”
(Cov. Myst. p. 2.)

124

laȝt, white, [A. 212](#), *p.p.* of *bleach*, just as *raȝt* is of *reach*. Sc. *blaucht*.

“As *blaȝt* ere thaire wedis
As any snyppand snawe.”
(K. Alex. p. 54.)

le, colour, complexion, [A. 76](#), 212; [B. 791](#), 1759. Prov.E. *ble*, *bly*. A.S. *bleo*.

leaunt, a robe of fine linen, [A. 163](#). O.Eng. *bliant*, fine linen, W. *llian*, linen. The *bl* is merely an imitation of the Celtic *ll*.

“A blewe *bleaunt* obofe brade him al ovir.”
(K. Alex. p. 167.)

lench, stratagem, device, [B. 1202](#). O.N. *blekkia*.

lemyst, blemished, [B. 1421](#). O.Fr. *blesmir*.

Blende, blended, mingled, mixt. [A. 385](#), 1016; [B. 967](#), 1788. A.S.

Blente, *blendian*. Icel. *blanda*, to mix.

lo = bla, blue, livid, pale. [A. 1017](#); [B. 134](#). O.H.G. *blao*, N.Fris. *bla*. O.Sc. *bla*.

Blober, } = blubber, waves, [C. 221](#), 266. Prov.E. *blubber*, bubble; *blob*,
Bluber, } *bleb*, a bubble. “*Blobure* (blobyre, P.) Burbulium.” (Prompt. Parv.)
“*Blober* upon water (or bubble) bouteillis.” (Palsg.) “The water
blubbers up.” (Baker, Northamptonshire Glossary.)

lod, a child, [B. 686](#). Supposing the *bl* to represent *ll* we might refer it to the W. *llawd*, a youth, 124b *lad*. O.Sw. *g-lott*. Cf. *bliant*, *bleant*, from W. *llian*.

“þis Abel was a blissid *blod*,
Bot Caim was the findes (devil’s) fode (offspring).”
(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 7b.)

lod, blood, [A. 650](#).

lok, space, [C. 272](#).

Blom, flower, bloom, [A. 578](#), [B. 1467](#). Sw. *bloma*, a flower. Du. *bloeme*.
Blome, Ger. *blume*. “*Blome* flowre. Flos.” (Prompt. Parv.)

lome3, blooms, flowers, [A. 27](#).

lonk, horse, *pl. blonke3*, [B. 87](#), [1392](#). See T. B. 2371.

lonkken, *gen. pl.* of horses, [B. 1412](#).

losched, looked, [C. 343](#). See [Blusch](#).

lose = blese, blaze, flame. [A. 911](#). Icel. *blossi*, a flame. A.S. *blaese*, a torch.
Dan. *blus*.

lot, spot, blemish, defilement, [A. 782](#).

“Ye ben worthy, he saide, to be *blottedede* and *spottedede*, foulede and defoulede with fenne (mire)
and with drit of water (*luto inquinari*), and of blode, that in tyme of werre ne were nat be
bespreynt, ne be wette with ennemyes blode.” (Quoted by Way, from Roy. MS. 18, A. xii. B. iii.
c. 10.)

lubrande = blubbering, bubbling, foaming, [B. 1017](#). See [blobber](#).

lunt, rushed, [C. 272](#).

lunt, faint, [A. 176](#). Icel. *blunda*, to sleep. Sw. *blunda*, to close the eyes. Dan.
blende, to dazzle. Cf. “Blunt of wytte. Hebes.” (Prompt. Parv.)

Blusch, ¹²⁵
Blusche, } look, glance, [A. 980](#), [1083](#), [B. 904](#), [998](#), [1537](#). N.Prov.E. *blush*,
resemblance. Cf. “At the first *blush*,” at the first appearance, at
first sight. Dan. *blusse*, to blaze, flame, glow. There seems to be an
etymological connection with words signifying to look, glow, blaze, shine,
etc.

“The kyng *blyschit* on the beryne (man) with his brode eghne.”
(Morte Arthure, p. 10.)

“He *blusshed* ouer backward to þe brodesee.”
(See T. B. 1316.)

Blusnande, shining, [B. 1404](#). Icel. *blys*. Dan. *blus*, a torch. Du. *blos*,
Blysnande, redness. Dan. *blusse*, to glow. Icel. *lysa*, to shine. Pl.D.
bleistern, to glisten.

luster, [B. 886](#), to wander or stray about.

“Ac there was wight noon so wys
The wey thider kouthē,
But *blustreden* forth as beestes
Over bankes and hilles.”

(Piers Ploughman, p. 108.)

lwe, blue, [A. 423](#).

lwe, blew, [B. 885](#).

lykked, shone, [B. 603](#). A.S. *blican*, glitter, dazzle. Ger. *blicken*, shine,
glance, look. Du. *blicken*, glitter; *blick*, a flash.

“Hire bleo *blyketh* so bryht
So feyr heo is ant fyn.”

(Lyric Poems, p. 52.)

lyknande, shining, [B. 1467](#).

lykned = blaykned, became black, [B. 1759](#).

125b

lynde, to become faded, dull, [B. 1126](#).

lynne, cease, [A. 729](#), [B. 440](#), [1661](#), [1812](#). A.S. *blinnan* (for *be-linnan*).

Blysfol,
Blysful, blissful, [A. 279](#), [409](#).

lysande, shining, [A. 163](#). See *blusande*.

lysned, shone, [A. 1048](#).

lype, joy, [A. 354](#). Blythe is still used as a noun in the North of England.

lypely, joyfully, [A. 385](#).

obaunce, boasting, Fr. *bobance*, [B. 179](#), [1712](#).

Bod, command, [A. 979](#); [B. 56](#). A.S. *bod*, *gebod*, command, precept,
Bode, message. “*Bode* or massage (*boode*, H.) nuncium.” (Prompt.
Parv.)

od = abode, *pret.* of *bide* = abide, [A. 62](#); [A. 982](#); wait for, [B. 467](#).

odworde, message, [B. 473](#). See T. B. 6262.

odyly, [A. 478](#).

offet, blast, [B. 885](#).

offeteȝ, buffets, blows, [A. 809](#); *boffet*, [B. 43](#).

ok-lered, book-learned, [B. 1551](#).

old, bad, [A. 806](#). A.S. *báld*, audacious. Sw. *båld*, proud, haughty, warlike. In early English writers the term was applied indifferently to men and women of bad character.

“Þou do me bote again þis *bald* (bad one)
For al þe soth I haf þe tald.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 48b.)

126

ol, bull, [A. 1682](#); *pl. boleȝ*, [B. 55](#).

ole, the round stem of a tree, [A. 622](#). It enters also into composition in the word *throte-bolle*. *Pl. bolleȝ*, [B. 76](#). Icel. *bolr*. Dan. *bul*. Sw. *bål*, trunk of a man's body. See T. B. 4960.

olle, bowl, [B. 1145](#), [1511](#). A.S. *bolla*. Icel. *bolli*.

olled, embossed, [B. 1464](#).

olnande, swelling, [B. 179](#).

olne, swell, [A. 18](#); [B. 363](#). Icel. *bolgna*. Sw. *bulna*, to swell. In some early English works we find *bollen* (ibolȝe) the *p.p.* of a verb *bolȝe* = bulge, swell. “*Bolnyn, Tumeo, turgeo, tumesco.*” (Prompt. Parv.)

onc, bank, [A. 907](#).

one, prayer, petition, command (= boon). [A. 912](#), [916](#); [B. 826](#). A.S. *ben*. S.Sax. *bone*. O.N. *bón* rogatio. “*Bone* or graunte of prayer (*boone* P.) Precarium, peticio.” (Prompt. Parv.)

one, good, [B. 28](#).

Boner,

Bonere, good, [B. 733](#).

onerté, goodness, [A. 762](#).

ongre, willingly, agreeably to, [C. 56](#). See *Gre*.

onk, bank, hill, [A. 931](#), [B. 379](#). Ger. *bank*, bench, bank of a river, etc.

or, bower, chamber, dwelling, [A. 964](#). A.S. *bur*, a chamber. Icel. *bur*.

N.Prov.E. *boor*, a parlour.

ore, born, [A. 239](#), [B. 584](#).

orde, table, [B. 1433](#), [1717](#).

126b

orde, board of a vessel, [A. 470](#); [B. 211](#).

ore3, boars, [B. 55](#).

orges, burgess; sometimes written *burgeise*, [C. 366](#). O.Fr. *bourgeois*, from Lat. *burgensis*.

orgoun, to burgeon, bud forth, [B. 1042](#). Fr. *bourgeon*, *bourjon*, young bud or sprig. Prov. Fr. *boure*, bud. Fr. *abourioner*, to bud or sprout forth. See T. B. [4964](#).

orlych, burly, [B. 1488](#).

orne = burne, stream, water, [A. 482](#); *borne3 heued*, head of the stream, source, [B. 974](#). A.S. *burne*. Goth. *brunna*. Icel. *brunnr*. G. *born*, *brunnen*, well, spring.

ornyst, burnished, [A. 77](#), [220](#), [B. 554](#). Fr. *brunir*, to polish.

oro3t = bro3t, brought, [A. 628](#).

Bor3, city, town, [A. 957](#), [989](#), [B. 45](#), [834](#), [1750](#). A.S. *burg*, *burh*. Goth.

Bor3e, *baurgs*. Icel. *borg*.

os = bus = behoves, [B. 687](#).

osk, take, [A. 351](#); *boske* to, go to, [B. 834](#). See *Busk*.

oske3, bushes, [B. 322](#). Icel. *buskr*.

osum, bay, [C. 107](#). Cf. N.Prov.E. *bosom*, the eddy.

“Eneas and his feris on the strand
Wery and forwrocht, sped thame to the nerrest land,
And at the cost of Lyby arryvit he.
Ane havyn place with a lang hals or entre
Thar is, with an ile enveronyt on ather part,
To brek the wallis and storm of every art,
Within, the water in a *bosum* gays.”

(G. Doug. vol. i. p. 33.)

ost, boast, arrogance. [B. 179, 1450](#).

oster, boaster, [B. 1499](#).

ostwys = busteous, boisterous, rough, fierce, [A. 814](#). Pl. Du. *büster*, wild, fearful, savage. Cf. “*Boystows, rudis*.” (Prompt. Parv.) *Bustus*, rudis, rigidus, to be *bustus*, rudere. (Cath. Angl.) The form *bostwys* would seem to point to *bost*, boast, as the probable root.

ot, “to bot,” to boot, [B. 473](#).

ot, command, [B. 944](#). A.S. *beot*, threat, promise.

ot, only, [A. 18, 382](#), except, [A. 972](#); *bot-if*, unless, [B. 1110](#).

ote, saviour, [A. 275, 645](#); remedy, safety, [C. 163](#). A.S. *bót*, amends, atonement; *gebétan*, to make amends. Du. *boet*, remedy; *boeten*, to mend.

oþe, booth, tent, [C. 441](#).

Boþem, } valley, dale, [A. 383, 450](#); pit, sea, [B. 1030](#). *Bottom*, a valley, is
 Boþom, } still used in many of our provincial dialects, and is a frequent
 element in local names. A.S. *botm*, lowest point, depth, abyss.
 Du. *bodem*. Germ. *boden*. Icel. *botn*.

othem, bottom, [C. 144](#).

oþemleȝ, bottomless, [B. 1022](#).

Bouel,
 Bowel, } bowel, gut, [A. 1251](#); [B. 293](#).

ougoun (?) [B. 1416](#).

oun, (1) ready; (2) finished, [A. 534, 992, 1103](#). See T. B. 827. N.Prov.E. *boun*. Icel. *bua*, to prepare, p.p. *buinn*, prepared, ready.

127b

ounden, fastened, [A. 322](#); bound (*p.p.* of *binde*), [B. 1103](#).

ounet, went, *pret.* of *boun* or *bown*, to go, [B. 1398](#). See *boun*. See T. B. 827, 5230.

“And (he) *bowennes* over a brode mede
 With breth (anger) at his herte.”
 (M. Arthure, p. 290.)

ounté, goodness, [B. 1436](#).

oure3 (bowers), chambers. [B. 322](#). See *Bor*.

ourne = burne, man, [A. 617](#).

our3 = bor3, city, [B. 1377](#). See *Bor3*.

oute, without, [A. 260, 824](#); [B. 523](#).

Bow, to go, walk, literally, to bend (one's steps). [A. 126, 974](#); [B. 45](#),
Bowe, [379, 482](#).

"Forth heo gunnen *bugen*
In to Bruttaine."

(La3. 2, 410.)

"The burd *bowet* from þe bede."
(T. B. 775.)

A.S. *búgan*, to *bow*, *bend*, avoid, flee.

owe, obey (bend to), [C. 56, 75](#).

oy, a boy, youth, [B. 878](#).

oye3, boys, men of low position, servants; generally used in a bad sense,
"boye3 *bolde*," [A. 806](#).

"—— bot a *boye* one (alone)
Hoves by hym on a blonke (horse) and his spere holdes."
(Morte Arthure, p. 211.)

"I wende no Bretones walde bee basschede for so lyttile
And fore bare-legyde *boyes* that one the bente houys."
(*Ibid.* p. 178.)

o3 = bow, go, [A. 196](#); [B. 1242, 1551](#). See *Bow*.

128

o3e, bough, [B. 616, 1467](#).

o3t, bought, [A. 651](#).

o3ted, curved, [C. 449](#). A.S. *bugan*, to bend. Dan. *bugt*, bend, turn. Sc.
bought, to fold, bend.

rade, broad, [A. 138](#).

rake vp = break up, throw up, spew, [C. 340](#). Ger. *sich brechen*. Du. *braeken*,
to vomit. "*Brakyn*, or castyn or spewe. Vomo." (Prompt. Parv.)

raken (*brake*, *bracken*), fern, [B. 1675](#), Sw. *bräken*, Dan. *bregne*, Icel. *brok*,
sedge. "A *brakane* filix, a *brakan*, *buske* filicarium." (Cath. Angl.)

raste, burst, [C. 148](#).

rathe = breþe, anger, ire, also fierceness. [A. 1170](#); [B. 916](#). O.N. *braedi*, anger. It sometimes signifies angry.

“Bade hom blyn of hor *brathe*.”

(T. B. 5075.)

“For this word was Saul wrath,

For oft-sith was he bremli brath.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 42b.)

rapeʒ, *pl.* of braþe, [A. 346](#).

raunches, [B. 1464](#).

raundysch, display, [A. 346](#).

ray, utter (aloud), roar, [A. 346](#). Sw. *bräka*.

rayde, brought, [A. 712](#); aroused, awakened, [A. 1170](#); “at a *brayde*,” at a start (Icel. at *bragði*), at once, [A. 539](#); “in a *brayd*,” in a moment, [B. 1507](#). O.N. *bregtha*, weave, move, brandish, seize, awake, to leap, start. *Bragth*, quick motion. 128b

“Þe Philistienes wituten les

Ran on Sampson in a res,

Bot Sampson þat selcuth smert,

Ute o þair handes son he stert

And gave a *braid* sa fers and fast,

Þat alle þe bandes of him brast.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 40b.)

rayden, ornamented, *p.p.* of *braid*, [B. 1481](#).

red, bread, [B. 636](#).

Brede,

Bred, = breed, become, [A. 1558](#); replenish, [A. 415](#), [814](#); [B. 257](#).

rede, board, [C. 184](#). “*Brede* or lytylle borde. Mensula, tabula, tabella, asserulus.” (Prompt. Parv.) A.S. *bred*, plank, board, etc.

rede, breadth, [A. 1030](#).

rede, stretch out, [A. 814](#).

reed, bred, [C. 143](#).

ref, short, brief, [A. 268](#).

rek, broke, [B. 1105](#), [1239](#).

reme, full, complete, [A. 863](#). A.S. *breme*, famous, glorious.

reme, fierce, [A. 346](#); [A. 229](#); [B. 430](#). Du. *bremen*, to burn with desire. Fris. *brimme*, to rage.

“A *brem* lowe.” (T. B. 860.)

remly, vigorously, [B. 509](#).

Brend,

Brende, = brente, burnt, bright, [A. 989](#); [B. 1292](#).

rennande, burning, [B. 1012](#).

renne, burn, [B. 509](#), [916](#).

rent, burnt, bright, [A. 106](#).

rent, steep; *superl. brentest*, highest, [B. 379](#). N.Prov.E. *brant*, steep. Sw. *brant*, steep, a precipice. 129

“A man may syt on a *brante* hyll syde.”

(Ascham’s *Toxoph.* p. 58, ed. Arber.)

“Apon the bald Bucifelon *brant* up he sittes.”

(K. Alex. p. 124.)

“Thane come thai blesnande till a barme of a *brent* lawe (hill).”

(*Ibid.* p. 164.)

rere, briar, [B. 791](#), [1694](#). N.Prov.E. *brere*, *breer*. A.S. *brér*.

resed, rough, like bristles, shaggy (?), [B. 1694](#). Cf. Sc. *birs*, *birse*, bristle.

rest, attack, outburst, [B. 229](#). N.Prov.E. *birst*, attack (Brockett). O.E. *burst* = injury, A.S. *byrst*.

reste, to burst, [B. 1783](#).

Breth, } wind, [C. 107](#), [138](#); smell, vapour, [B. 509](#), [967](#). Cf. “*brethe* of
Brethe, } smoke.” (Hampole’s *Pricke of Conscience*, l. 4727.) Sc. *broth*.
Ger. *brodem*, *broden*, steam, vapour. A.S. *bræth*, an odour, scent,
breath. “*Brethe* at his wille.” (T. B. 1945.)

reth, wrath, [B. 916](#). See [Brath](#).

reue, tell, [A. 755](#).

“*Breve* us thi name.” (K. Alex. p. 78.)

reued, related, written, [B. 197](#). O.N. *brefa*.

reyped, rushed, [B. 1421](#). See [Braid](#).

rod, great; “*brod* wonder,” B. 584.

rode, broad, A. 650.

Brok, brook, river, stream, A. 981; *pl. brokeȝ*. A. 1074, sea; C. 145. A.S.
Broke, *broca*.

129b

rom (broom), heath, C. 392. A.S. *bróm*.

ronch, branch, B. 487.

ronde, sword, B. 1246. O.N. *brandr*.

rond, brand, B. 1012.

rope, angry, fierce, rough, B. 149, 1409. The original form in O.E. is *brathe*.
It is connected with *brethe*, *brathe*, anger, wrath.

“Wreth it es a *brath* on-fall (outburst)

Menging o mode that cums o galle.”

(The Deadly Sins, in Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii.)

Broþely, fierce, rough, and hence vile, bad, A. 848, 1030; vilely,
Broþlych, A. 1256; B. 474. The original form is *braply*, fiercely,
vigorously.

“Thoner o-loft fal sal he (Antichrist) gar,

And tres *brathli* blomes bere;

Brathli to do the see be reth (stormy)

And *brathli* to do it be smeth.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 124a.)

roun, brown, A. 537, 990.

rowden, clustered, B. 1132.

roȝt, brought, A. 286.

rugge = brigge, bridge, B. 1187. A.S. *bricge*.

runt, blow, A. 174.

“All þat was bitten of the best (beast)

was at a brunt dede.”

(K. Alex. p. 134.)

rurd, border, edge, B. 1474. Sc. *breard*. A.S. *brerd*, *breard*, *briord*, *breord*,
brim, margin, rim, shore, brink.

rurd-ful, brimful, full up to the brim, [B. 383](#). Chaucer uses *bret-ful* in the same sense.

130

rutage = bretage, parapets of a wall, ramparts, [B. 1190](#). Fr. *breteche*.

ruhle, upbraid, reprove, [C. 345](#). O.N. *bríxla*, to reprove, reproach.

rych, filth, uncleanness, [B. 848](#). The meaning here assigned to *brych* is conjectural. Cf. Du. *brack*, refuse, damaged. Ger. *brechen*, to vomit, *Bryche* as an adjective occurs in Robt. Brunne's "Handlyng Synne," p. 182, where it is glossed low (loghe) *i.e.* vile.

"Now ys Pers bycome *bryche*

That er was bothe stoute and ryche." In the Romance of Alexander, ed. Stevenson, we find the form *bicchid* = *briched* (?). Cf. *shille* and *shrille*, etc.

"And on the aȝtent day, eftire the prime

A basilisk in a browe, breis (annoys) thaim unfaire,

A straȝtill and a stithe worme *stinkande* of elde,

And es so bitter, and so breme, and *bicchid* (foul) in himselfe,

That with the *stinke* and the strenth he stroyes noȝt allane,

Bot quat he settes on his sizt, he slaes in a stonde."

(p. 165.)

ryd, lady, [A. 769](#). A.S. *bryd*, a bride, a wife, woman.

rydde, bird, [B. 288](#), [1482](#).

rydale, wedding, marriage, [B. 142](#).

Brym,

Brymme, bank, shore, [A. 232](#), [1074](#). Dan. *bremme*.

rymme, stream, water, [B. 365](#). 130b A.S. *brym*, the sea. In this sense *brymme* seems to have been unknown to the Southern dialect.

"O þis water þat sua stanc

Wa was þam þat it nedings dranc,

Þat toþer oncom þat him felle,

Was frosse þat na tung moght telle,

Þat ute o *brim* and brokes bred,

And siþen over al Egypte spred."

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 32b.)

rynkeȝ, brinks, banks, [B. 384](#).

rynston, brimstone, [B. 967](#).

ryȝt, *adj.* bright, [A. 110](#); *sb.* bright one, [A. 755](#).

ukke3, bucks, [B. 392](#).

ulde, built, [B. 1190](#).

ule3, bulls, [B. 392](#).

ulk, stern of a ship. A.S. *bolca*, O.H.G. *pl. balkun*. Agiavia, loca per quæ ad remiges acceditur. (Graff. iii. p. 108.)

Bur, blow, assault, [A. 176](#); [C. 7](#). O.Sc. *byr*, a blow. N.Prov. *birre*, *burr*.

Burre, W. *bur*, violence, rage. See Wicliffe, St. Luke, viii. 33.

“—— no buerne might ffor the *birre* it abide.”

(T. B. 170. Cf. T. B. 571, 1902.)

ur, wave, [C. 148](#). Prov.E. *bore*. Icel. *bara*. O.Ger. *bare*. Du. *baar*, wave, billow. In Lazamon, vol. iii. p. 121, *þe beares* occurs in the latter version for *þa vðen* of the older copy.

urde, behoved, [A. 316](#); [C. 117](#), [507](#). O.N. *byrjar*. Dan. *bör*.

urde, a woman, lady. [B. 80](#), [653](#). See [Bryd](#). See T. B. 3984.

131

Burghe,
Bur3,
Bur3e,

city, town, [A. 980](#); [A. 982](#); [B. 366](#).

urne, man, [A. 397](#), [712](#); [A. 1202](#); “*burne3 & burde3*,” men and women, [B. 80](#). A.S. *beorn*, warrior, hero.

Burnist,

Burnyst, burnished, [B. 1085](#).

urre, blow, [A. 176](#). See *bur*.

urþen, burden, [B. 1439](#).

utter, [B. 636](#).

ur3, city, town, [B. 1666](#). See *burghe*.

Busch,

Busche, = buske, to go, [A. 1416](#); [B. 143](#), [472](#).

“& he (she) wist it as wel or bet as 3if it were hire owne,

Til hit big was & bold to *buschen*, on felde.”

(William and the Werwolf, p. 7.)

usily, laboriously, [B. 1446](#).

usk, prepare, made ready, dress, to direct one's steps towards a place, to go, hasten. [A. 142](#), [333](#), [351](#), [633](#), [1395](#); [B. 437](#). Icel. *at buast* (for *at buasc*) = *at bua sig*, to bend one's steps, to prepare, etc. See T. B. 1186.

usmar, scorn, mockery, [B. 653](#). A.S. *bismer*, reproach, blasphemy.

ustwys, impetuous, fiery, [A. 911](#). See *bostwys*.

usyeȝ = busies, troubles, [A. 268](#).

uyrne = burne, man, [C. 340](#). See *Burne*.

ycalle, call, [A. 913](#).

ycalt, aroused, called, [A. 1163](#).

ycom, became, [A. 537](#).

131b

yde, abide, [A. 399](#); suffer, [A. 664](#); [A. 32](#); remain, [B. 449](#), [622](#).

ydene, quickly, [A. 196](#).

ye, buy, [A. 732](#).

yfallen, befallen, [B. 1629](#).

yfore, before, [A. 530](#).

Bigge,

Byge, great, [B. 229](#).

Byggynȝ, building, [A. 932](#); dwelling, [B. 378](#). A.S. *byggan*, to build, Icel.

Bygynȝ, *byggia*. See T. B. 1379.

ygly, great, strong; “*bygly bylde*,” great building, [A. 963](#). See T. B. 5216.

Bygonne,

Bygonnen, begun, *p.p.* of *byginne*, [A. 33](#); [A. 749](#); began, [B. 549](#).

ygyn, begin, [A. 547](#).

ygynner, beginner, [A. 436](#).

yhelde, beheld, [B. 452](#).

yhod, behoved, [A. 928](#). Cf. *bud*, behoved; *bus*, behoves.

yholde, behold, [A. 810](#); [B. 64](#).

Byhynde,
Byhynden, behind, [B. 653](#), [980](#).

Byld,
Bylded, built, See [Bulde](#).

ylde, building, [A. 727](#), [963](#).

ylyue, immediately, at once, quickly, [B. 353](#), [610](#).

ynde, bine, woodbine, C. 444. Sw. *binda*. Ger. *winde*. Eng. *bind-weed*.

ynne, within, [B. 452](#), [467](#).

yrled, poured out, [B. 1715](#). See [Birle](#).

Bysech,
Byseche, beseech, [A. 390](#).

yseme, beseem, [A. 310](#).

132

ysulpe, defile, [B. 575](#). See [Sulpe](#).

yswyke, defraud, [A. 568](#). A.S. *swícan*, deceive.

ysyde, beside, [B. 673](#).

Bytaȝt,
Bytaȝte, = betaught, entrusted, confided; *pret.* of *biteche*, [A. 1207](#); [B. 528](#).

yte, fierce, [A. 355](#).

yþenk, repent, [B. 582](#).

ytterly, *adv.* [B. 468](#).

ytwene, between, [A. 140](#), [658](#).

ytwyste, betwixt, [A. 464](#).

ytyde, betide, happen, [A. 397](#); [B. 522](#).

yye, buy, [A. 478](#).

yȝe, crown, [A. 466](#); ring, collar, [B. 1638](#). A.S. *beáh*, *beág*, ring, collar, diadem.

yȝonde, beyond, [A. 141](#), [146](#), [158](#), [981](#).

C

able, [C. 102](#).

ace, case, chance, [C. 265](#).

Cache, } = catch, drive away, take away. (1) “*cache* to,” run to, [A. 629](#);
Cachche, } (2) take, [A. 898](#), [1252](#). *Cachche*, to knock together, [A. 1541](#).
Cached, caught, [B. 1800](#). Prov. Fr. *catcher*. Fr. *chasser*. It.
cacciare.

achen (3d pers. pl. of *cache*), [B. 16](#).

agged, drawn along (?), [B. 1254](#).

aggen (3d pers. pl. pres. of *cagge*), draw (?), [A. 512](#).

“Cables were *caget* togedur.”

(T. B. 3703.)

132b

“He plyes ovir the pavement with pallene webis.

Mas on hiȝt ovir his hede for hete of the sone,

Sylours of sendale to sele ovire the gatis,

And sammes thaim on aither side with silken rapis,

And then he *caggis* up one

Cordis, as curteyns it ware.”

(K. Alex. p. 52.)

al, *sb.* call, invitation, [B. 61](#).

alder, colder, [A. 320](#).

alleȝ, addresses, [C. 411](#).

allyng, *sb.* proclamation, [B. 1362](#). N.Prov.E. calling, notice. “*Callynge*, or clepyng to mete: Invitacio.” (Prompt. Parv.)

alsydoyne, chalcedony, [A. 1003](#).

ambe, came, [A. 775](#).

anacle, [B. 1461](#). M.Lat. *canicellus*, a little box, chest.

andel, [C. 472](#).

andelstik, [B. 1478](#).

apeles, horses, [B. 1254](#). *Capul* or *caple*, horse. Caballus. (Prompt. Parv.)

apstan, [B. 418](#).

aptyuidé, captivity, [B. 1612](#).

araldes, [C. 159](#).

arayne, carrion, [B. 459](#).

are, sorrow, [A. 50](#), [371](#); [B. 777](#). A.S. *cáru*. Goth. *kara*.

areful, sorrowful, [B. 770](#).

arf, carved, formed, [C. 131](#).

arfully, sorrowfully, [B. 1252](#).

arle, a low fellow, a churl, [B. 876](#). A.S. *ceorl*, a man, countryman. Du. *kaerle*. Ger. *kerl*.

arneles, battlements, embrasures, [B. 1382](#).

arpe, *sb.* discourse, [A. 883](#); 133 parable, [A. 23](#); speech, [B. 1327](#).

arpe, vb. to discourse, talk, speak, [A. 381](#); [A. 74](#); of carpe, discourse of, [B. 752](#). “*Carpyn* or talkyn, fabulor, confabulor, garrulo.” (Prompt. Parv.)
Port. *carpire*, cry.

arping, discourse, speech, [B. 1550](#).

as, case, [A. 673](#).

Cast,
Caste,
Kest,

condition, [A. 1163](#).

ast, look, [B. 768](#).

asydoyne, [B. 1471](#). See *Calsydoyne*.

atel, wealth, [B. 1296](#).

awse, reason, [B. 65](#).

ause, [A. 702](#).

ayre, to turn one’s steps to a place, to go, [A. 1031](#); [B. 85](#), [901](#), [1259](#). “Kaire to þi londe,” T. B. 836. A.S. *cérran*. Ger. *kehren*. Du. *keeren*, to turn.

ayser, emperor, [B. 1322](#).

aytif, wretched, [B. 1426](#).

Caȝt, caught, [A. 50](#); caȝte of, took off, [A. 237](#); caȝt away, [A. 1275](#);

Caȝte, [B. 485](#). See *Cache*.

erteȝ, truly, [B. 105](#).

erue, cut, dig, [B. 1547](#).

eté, city, [A. 927](#).

euer, recover, reach, [A. 319](#).

hace, drive, [A. 443](#).

hambre, [A. 904](#); [B. 1586](#).

hapel, [A. 1062](#).

harde, turned, [A. 608](#). A.S. *cérran*, to turn, avert. Cf. *ajar*, older form *a-char*, *on-char*.

harged, commanded, [B. 464](#).

harged, loaded, [B. 1154](#), [1295](#).

hariote, [B. 1295](#).

haryté, [A. 470](#).

hast, chasten, [B. 860](#).

hastyse, [B. 543](#).

haufen, heat, increase, [B. 128](#).

haunce, chance, [B. 1125](#).

haundeler, candlestick, [B. 1272](#).

haunge, change, [B. 1588](#).

hawleȝ, jaws, [C. 268](#). N.Prov.E. *chavel*. A.S. *ceafl*. S.Sax. *cheuele*. Cp. the vulgar phrase “cheek by *jowl*.”

Chayer,

Chayere, chair, seat, [A. 885](#); [B. 1218](#).

hef, chief, [B. 684](#), [1238](#).

heftayn, chieftain, [B. 1295](#).

hekke, [B. 1238](#).

here, cheer, [A. 407](#); countenance, [A. 887](#). Prov. Sp. *cara*, O.Fr. *chiere*, countenance, favour, look.

Cheryche,

Cherisch, cherish, [B. 128](#), [543](#), [1154](#), [1644](#).

hes, chose (*pret.* of *chese*), [A. 759](#).

heualrye, chivalry, [B. 1238](#).

heue, achieve, accomplish, [B. 1125](#). Fr. *achever*, to bring to a head, accomplish. Fr. *chevir*, to compass.

Cheuetayn,

Cheuentayn, chieftain, [A. 605](#); [B. 464](#). O.Fr. *chevetaine*.

Childer,

Chylder, children, [A. 718](#); [B. 1300](#).

horles, churl, [B. 1258](#). See *Carle*.

hos, went. See “chosen,” T. B. 490.

hyche, niggard, [A. 605](#). Fr. 134 *chice*, avarice. *Chynche* and *kynche* are other forms of the same word.

hyde, [A. 403](#).

hyldryn, (*gen. pl.*) of children, [B. 684](#).

hyllled = chilled, shivered, became cold, [C. 368](#).

hysly = choysly, aptly, well, [B. 543](#).

iences, sciences, knowledge, [B. 1289](#).

lam (*pret.*), climbed, [B. 405](#).

lambe (2 *sing. pret.*), climbedst, [A. 773](#).

lanner, cleaner, [B. 1100](#).

Clanly, cleanly, purely, [A. 2](#); [A. 264](#), [1089](#), [1327](#); neatly, [B. 310](#). T. B.
Clanlych, 53.

lannes, clannesse, cleanness, purity, [A. 1](#), 12, 1809.

laryoun, clarion, [B. 1210](#).

Clater,
Clatter, shatter, [B. 912](#).

“So hard was she beseged soth for to telle,
And so harde sautes to the cite were zeuen,
That the komli kerneles were to-*clatered* with engines.”
(William and the Werwolf, p. 103.)

latering, clattering, [B. 1515](#). Du. *klateren*, to rattle.

lat3, clash, clatter, [B. 839](#). Ger. *klatschen*, to clap; *klatsch*, slap, clash.

lawres, claws, [B. 1696](#). *Clawres* is perhaps an error for *clawes*. It may, however, be another form of O.E. *clever*, *claver*, a claw. Du. *klaveren*, *kleveren*. 134b N.Prov.E. *claiver*, to claw oneself up, to scramble.

lay, [A. 312](#). Clay-daubed, [B. 492](#).

layme, call for, cry for, [B. 1096](#).

leche, receive, take, [A. 12](#). “*Cleches* to,” takes, lays hold of, [B. 634](#). Sc. *cleik*, *clek*, *cluke*, claw, hook; *cleke*, *cleik*, catch, snatch. O.Sw. *klaencka*, to snatch, seize.

lef, cleft, split (*pret.* of *cleve*), [B. 367](#).

lem, claim, [A. 826](#).

leme, daub, plaster with clay, [B. 312](#). N.Prov.E. *cleam*. *Clam*, to daub, glue. S.Prov.E. *cloam*, earthenware; *clomer*, a potter. A.S. *clem*, *clám*, clay; *clæmian*, to *clam*, smear.

“I stoppe thys ouyn wythowtyn dowte,
With clay I *clome* yt uppe ryght fast,
That non heat cum [ther] owte.”

(The Play of the Sacrament, p. 132.)

lene, perfect, whole, [B. 1731](#).

lenge, cling, stick, [B. 1034](#). Dan. *klynge*, to cluster, crowd. S.Prov.E. *clunge*, to crowd, squeeze; *clungy*, sticky.

lente, clenched, fastened, [A. 259](#). Cf. *queynte* = quenched, *dreynte* = drenched.

lepe, to call, [B. 1345](#). A.S. *clypian*.

Cler,

Clere, clear, [A. 2](#), 207; bright, [A. 620](#), [735](#); plain, [B. 26](#).

lergye, learning, [B. 1570](#).

lerkeȝ, clerks, scholars, [B. 193](#).

lernes, clearness, beauty, [B. 1353](#).

135

leȝe, clothe, [B. 1741](#).

Cleȝt,

Clyȝt, = clutched, fastened, (*p.p.* of *cleche*), [A. 858](#); fixed, [B. 1655](#).

lobbeȝ, clubs, [B. 839](#).

los, enclosure, house, [B. 839](#).

los, closed, [A. 183](#); [B. 12](#).

losed, enclosed, [B. 310](#).

lot, mount, hill, [A. 789](#). In the “Owl and Nightingale,” 999, we find *clude*, a hill. A.S. *clúd*. Low Ger. *kloot*, a hill.

lot, soil, earth, [A. 22](#), [320](#). Du. *klot*, *klotte*, clod, clot.

lotte₃, clods, [A. 857](#).

loþ, sail, [C. 105](#).

Cloutes,
Clowte₃, pieces, [B. 367](#), [965](#).

loystor, cloister, [A. 969](#).

luchche, clutch, [B. 1541](#).

lustered, [B. 367](#), [951](#). See T. B. 1647.

lutte, clouted, patched (?), [B. 40](#). A.S. *clút*, a clout.

lyde, plaister (?), [B. 1692](#). A.S. *clitha*. Cf. “*Clyte*, *clete*, or vegge (*clete* or *wegge*, K.) *cuneus*.” (Prompt. Parv.)

lyffe, cliff, [A. 159](#); [B. 405](#), [965](#).

lyket, clicket, latch, [B. 858](#). Prov. Fr. *cliche*, a latch, bolt. *Clyket* of a dore, *clicquette*. (Palsgrave.)

lynge, wither, decay, [A. 857](#). A.S. *clingan*.

lyppe, fasten, [B. 418](#). A.S. *clyppan*, to embrace.

“I wold yonder worthy weddit me hade,
So comly, so cleane to *clippe* uppon nightes.”
(T. B. 474.)

lypper, shearer, [A. 802](#).

135b

Clyue, cleave, cling to, [B. 1630](#), [1692](#). Du. *kleeven*, *klijven*, to fasten. A.S.
Clyuy, *clífan*.

lyuen, cleave, [A. 1196](#).

lyzt, clutched, stuck, [B. 1692](#).

nawe, know, acknowledge, [C. 519](#).

nawyng, *sb.* knowledge, [A. 859](#).

noken, knock, [A. 727](#).

ob-hous = cov (cow)-house (?), [B. 629](#). *Cob* may be another form of Prov. Ger. *colb*, a heifer.

of, quickly, [A. 60](#), [898](#); quick, [B. 624](#). A.S. *cáf*, quick, expert.

Cofer, coffer, chest, coffin, [A. 259](#); ship, ark, [B. 310](#), [339](#); jewel box, Cofere, 1428. Fr. *coffre*.

ofly, quickly, [B. 1428](#).

oge, boat, [C. 152](#). *Cogges* with cablis cachyn to londe, T. B. 1077.

okrez, cockers, a kind of rustic high shoes or half boots fastened with laces or buttons, [B. 40](#). “*Cocur* boote. *Ocrea*. *coturnus*.” (Prompt. Parv.) The term is still used in the north of England = gaiters, leggings.

ole, coal, [B. 456](#).

ole, cool, [C. 452](#).

olde, great, severe, [A. 50](#); “*carez* colde,” great sorrow, [A. 808](#).

oler, collar, [B. 1569](#), [1744](#).

olored, [B. 456](#).

olour, [A. 753](#).

oltour = coulter, (of a plough), [B. 1547](#). Fr. *coultre*. Lat. *culter*.

136

olwarde, deceitful, [B. 181](#). See [note on this word](#). Cf. *kolsipe* (col-ship), deceit.

omaunde, [B. 1428](#).

ombre, to trouble, destroy, [B. 901](#), [1024](#). Du. *kommer*, *kombre*, loss, adversity, care, grief.

ombraunce, trouble, [B. 4](#). See T. B. 726.

ome, *sb.* coming, arrival, [A. 1116](#); [B. 467](#)

“Of his *come* fayne.”

(T. B. 975.)

omende, [A. 1](#).

Comfort,

Comforte, *sb.* [A. 55](#), [357](#).

Comly,
Comlych, comely, [A. 259](#); [B. 546](#).

ommune, common, [A. 739](#).

omparisune, vb. compare, [B. 161](#).

ompas, [A. 1072](#), [B. 319](#), 1455.

ompast, [B. 697](#).

ompaynye, company, [B. 119](#).

omyne, B. [B](#) See T. B. 12863.

on = can, did (used as an auxiliary of the past tense), [A. 453](#); [A. 1561](#); *cone3*,
didst, [B. 482](#).

onacle = canacle, cup, [B. 1515](#).

onciens, conscience, [A. 1089](#).

oncubine, [B. 1353](#).

ondelstik, candlestick, [B. 1275](#).

onfourme, conform, [B. 1067](#).

Coninge,
Connyng, wisdom, science, [B. 1611](#), 1625.

onquere, [B. 1431](#), 1632.

onquerour, [B. 1322](#).

onquest, conquered, [B. 1305](#).

onsayue, conceive, [B. 649](#).

onterfete, counterfeit, feign, [B. 13](#).

ontraré, contrary, [A. 4](#), 266; in *contrary*, opposite, [B. 1532](#).

136b

ontroeued, contrived, [B. 266](#).

ontryssyoun, contrition, [A. 669](#).

onueye, guide, [B. 678](#), 768.

ooste3, properties, [B. 1033](#).

operounes, tops, [B. 1461](#). “*Coporne* or *coporoun* of a thyng (*coperone*, K. H. *coperun*, P.), capitellum.” (Prompt. Parv.) “The Catholicon explains *capitellum* as signifying merely the capital of a column, but in the Medulla it is rendered ‘*summa pars capitis*.’” (A. Way, in Prompt. Parv.)

oppe, top; “hyl *coppe*,” [A. 791](#). A.S. *copp*, head, top, apex.

“Now bowis forth this baratour and bidis na langir,
Up at a martene mountane, he myns with his ost,
And viii daies bedene the driȝe was and mare,
Or he miȝt covir to the *copp*, fra the cave undire.”
(K. Alex. p. 163.)

orage, heart, [B. 1806](#).

orbyal, raven, [B. 456](#).

ordes, [C. 153](#).

oroun, sb. [A. 237](#); vb. [A. 415](#), [767](#).

ors, course, [B. 264](#).

orse, corpse, [A. 320](#).

orse, to curse, [B. 1032](#), [1583](#).

orsye, corrosive, [B. 1034](#).

Cortays,
Cortayse, courteous, [A. 433](#); [A. 512](#); pure, [B. 1089](#).

ortaysye, courtesy, [A. 468](#), [480](#); good conduct, [B. 13](#).

ortaysly, courteously, [A. 381](#); kindly, [B. 564](#), [1435](#).

orte, court, [A. 701](#).

137

ortel, kirtle, [A. 203](#). A.S. *cyrtel*. Dan. *kjortel*, a garment either for a man or woman.

orteȝ, courteous, [A. 754](#).

orupte, [B. 281](#).

oruen (*p.p.* of *kerue*), cut, reaped. [A. 40](#); [B. 1407](#).

ost, contrivance, [B. 1478](#). A.S. *costian*. O.Sw. *kosta*. Du. *koste*, to try, attempt. This word is sometimes written *cast*. See “William and the Werwolf,” p. 167.

ost, coost, property, [B. 1024](#), [1033](#).

ost, coast, border, side, [B. 85](#).

ostoum, custom, [B. 851](#).

oumforde, comfort, [A. 369](#).

Counseyl,

Counsayl, counsel, [A. 319](#); [B. 683](#), [1201](#).

ounte, [B. 1685](#), [1731](#).

ountenaunce, appearance, [B. 792](#).

ounerfete, defraud, [A. 556](#).

ountes, countess, [A. 489](#).

ourtaysye, courtesy, [A. 457](#).

out, cut, [B. 1104](#).

outhe, knew, known, [B. 813](#), [1054](#).

oueyte, covet, desire, [B. 1054](#).

Couenaunde,

Couenaunt, covenant, [A. 562](#), [563](#).

ouetyse, covetousness, [B. 181](#).

owpe, cup, [B. 1458](#).

owpe, could; cowpe3, couldst, [A. 484](#).

owwardely, cowardly, [B. 1631](#).

oyntyse, skill, craft, [B. 1287](#). *Coint*, skilful, occurs in T. B. 125. “hir *coint* artys.” Cf. *Coyntly*, T. B. 164.

rafte, power, wisdom; *pl.* crafte3, 137b A. 356; contrivance, [A. 890](#); power, [C. 131](#).

rage3, crags, [B. 449](#).

rak, sound, [B. 1210](#).

raue, ask, pray for, [A. 663](#); beg, [B. 801](#).

rede, creed, [A. 485](#).

resse, cress, [A. 343](#).

reste, [A. 856](#).
roked, bad, [B. 181](#).
roke3, reapinghooks, sickles, [A. 40](#).
rone3, cranes, [B. 58](#).
rossayl, cross-sail, [C. 102](#).
rouke3, croaks, [B. 459](#).
ruppele3, cripples, [B. 103](#).
ry, proclamation, [B. 1574](#).
Crysolite,
Crysolyt, chrysolite, [A. 1009](#).
rysopase, chrysoprasus, [A. 1013](#).
rystal, [A. 159](#).
umly, [A. 929](#). See *Comly*.
upborde, [B. 1440](#).
Cupyde,
Cubit, [B. 315, 319, 405](#).
umfort, [C. 485](#).
upple, pair, [B. 333](#).
ure, care, [A. 1091](#).
urious, [B. 1353](#).
Cyté,
Ceté, city, [A. 927, 939](#).

D

ale, [A. 384](#) (phrase: “doun and *dale3*,” hill and dale), [B. 121](#).
alt, dealt, fulfilled, [B. 1756](#).
am, stream, [A. 324](#); the deep, [B. 416](#). Icel. *dammr*. Dan. *dam*, a fish pond.
ampned, damned, condemned, [A. 641](#).

amped, quelled, [B. 989](#). Ger. 138 *dampfen*, to suffocate, choke. Du. *dempen*. Sw. *dåmpa*, to extinguish, repress, damp.

amysel, damsel, [A. 489](#).

are, to tremble, be afraid, [A. 839](#). Sw. *darra*, to tremble, shake.

ard = dured, endured, [A. 609](#).

aschande, dashing, [C. 312](#).

asande, stupefying, [B. 1538](#).

ase, lie hid, cower, [C. 383](#). Cf. *dare*, to lie hid, cower. For the interchange of *r* and *s* compare O.E. *gaure*, to gaze.

ased, stupid, frightened, [A. 1085](#). Sc. *dozen*, *dosen*, to stupefy, benumb. Du. *daesen*, to lose one's wits; *daes*, *dwaes*, foolish, mad. (Kil.) Prov. Ger. *dasen*, to be still.

“For he was *dased* of the dint and half dede him semyd.”
(K. Alex. p. 136.)

ate, [A. 492](#); limit, [A. 493](#); time, [A. 504](#), [516](#); age, [A. 1040](#).

aube, daub, plaister, [B. 313](#), [492](#). Prov.E. *daub*, clay. “*Dawber* or cleyman; *dawbyn*, lino, muro.” (Prompt. Parv.)

aunce, dance, [A. 345](#).

aunger, power, [A. 11](#); insolence, [B. 71](#).

awande, dawning, [C. 445](#). A.S. *dagian*, to become day. Icel. *dagan*, dawn.

awe3, days; “don out of *dawe3*,” deprived of life, dead, [A. 282](#).

ayly, [A. 313](#).

aynty, [B. 38](#), [1046](#).

ay-rawe, daybreak, [B. 893](#); *rawe* 138b or *rewe* signifies a *streak*. Cf. *day-rim*, in “Owl and Nightingale,” l. 328.

“Qwen the *day-rawe* rase, he rysis belyfe.”
(K. Alex. p. 14.)

azed, dawned, became day, [B. 1755](#). See *Dawande*.

ebate, strife, contest, [A. 390](#).

ebonere, gracious, courteous, kind, [A. 162](#); [B. 830](#).

ebonerté, goodness, [A. 798](#); [C. 418](#).

ece = dese, seat of honour, [B. 38, 1399](#). See *Dese*.
 eclar, explain, [B. 1618](#).
 eclyne, [A. 333](#).
 ecre, decree, [A. 1745](#); [B. 386](#).
 edayn, disdain, displeasure, [A. 74](#); [B. 50](#).
 efence, prohibition, [B. 243, 245](#).
 efoule, defilement, [C. 290](#).
 efowle, to defile, [B. 1129, 1147](#).
 egre, degree, condition, [B. 92](#).
 egres, steps, [A. 1022](#).
 ekenes, deacons, [B. 1266](#).
 ele, deal, distribute, give, [A. 606](#); exchange, [B. 1118](#).
 ele, utter, [B. 344](#).
 ele (dole), sorrow, [A. 51](#).
 elled, dealt, [C. 193](#).
 elful, doleful, sorrowful, [B. 400](#).
 elfully, dolefully, sorrowfully, [A. 706](#).
 elyt, delight, [A. 642, 1116](#).
 elyuer, delivered, [B. 1084](#).
 elyuer, deliver, [A. 652](#); [B. 500](#).
 eme, deem, judge, [A. 312, 313](#); [A. 1118](#); utter, decree, [A. 1745](#); [C. 119](#); call, name, [B. 1020, 1611](#). A.S. *déman*.

139

Demerlayk, magic, glamour, [B. 1561, 1578](#). S.Sax. *dweomer-lake*, magic.
 Demorlayk, A.S. *dweomere*, a juggler.

“And all this *demerlayke* he did bot be the devylle craftes.”
 (K. Alex. p. 15.)

emme, vb. become faded, lost, [A. 223](#). A.S. *dem*, damage, hurt, loss.
 emmed = dammed, collected (?), [B. 384](#). A.S. *demman*, to dam, stop water.
 Carr gives *demin*, a term applied to clouds when collected in masses. Sw.

dämma. O.Fris. *demma*, to stop, obstruct.
ene, vale, dale, [A. 295](#). A.S. *dene*, *denu*.
enely, loud, [A. 51](#).
enned, resounded. If it does not signify *dinned*, it must mean settled, took up its abode. [A. 51](#).
enounce, renounce, forsake, [B. 106](#).
eparte, separate, part, [A. 378](#); [B. 396](#), [1677](#).
epaynt, painted, adorned, [A. 1102](#).
Dep,
Depe, profound, [A. 406](#); [B. 1609](#).
epres, depress, [A. 778](#).
epryue, [A. 449](#); take away, [B. 185](#).
ere, vb. to harm, injure, [A. 1157](#); [B. 862](#). See T. B. 1260. A.S. *derian*, to hurt, damage, injure.
ere, precious, [A. 400](#); valuable, [B. 1792](#). A.S. *deóre*, dear, precious.
ere, dear ones, [A. 777](#).
139b
Derelych,
Derely, = dearly, beautifully, excellently, [A. 995](#); very, [B. 270](#).
ere3, sb. harms, injuries, [A. 102](#). See T. B. 920. A.S. *dar*, *daru*, hurt, harm.
“Thai dre3e him up to the drye (land), and he na *dere* sufird.”
(K. Alex. p. 189.)
erf, great, bold, [B. 862](#). O.N. *diafr*. Sw. *djerf*, strong, bold. “A *derfe* dragon,” T. B. 166. “Dang him *derffly* don in a ded hate.” *Ib.* 1339.
erfly, quickly, [A. 1641](#); [B. 110](#).
erk, dark, [A. 1020](#); [C. 263](#); night, [B. 1755](#). A.S. *deorc*.
erne, *adj.* secret, hidden, [A. 588](#), [1611](#); *adv.* secretly, [B. 697](#). See T. B. 1962. A.S. *dearn*, dark, secret, hidden.
errest, dearest, [B. 115](#), [1306](#).
erþe = dearth, preciousness, value, worth, [A. 99](#). See *Dere*.

eruely = derfely, quickly, [B. 632](#).

erworth, precious, beautiful, [A. 109](#). See *Dere*.

Des,

Dese, dais, seat of honour, [A. 766](#); [B. 115, 1394](#).

esert, [C. 84](#).

esserte, desert, [A. 595](#).

eseuered, severed, [C. 315](#).

essypele, disciple, [A. 715](#).

estyné, [A. 758](#); [C. 49](#).

esyre, [B. 545](#).

etermynable, [A. 594](#).

euine, *sb.* divine, [A. 1302](#); *vb.* [B. 1561](#).

euinores, diviner, [B. 1578](#).

euote, devout, [A. 406](#).

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euoutly, [B. 814](#).

euoyde, do away with, destroy, [A. 15](#); [B. 908](#).

Deuyce,	}	devise, imagine, A. 1046, 1100 ; describe, A. 99, 984 ; order,
Deuyse,		
Deuice,		

euyse, *sb.* device, [A. 139](#).

euysement, description, [A. 1019](#).

evoydyng, putting away, *sb.* [B. 544](#).

ewoutly, devoutly, [C. 333](#).

ewoyde = devoyde, [C. 284](#).

ewyne = dwine, pine, [A. 11](#).

eystyné, destiny, [B. 400](#).

De3ter,

De3teres, daughters, [B. 270](#), [866](#), [899](#), [933](#), [939](#). See T. B. 1489.

De3tters,

ialoke, discourse, [B. 1157](#).

ispayred, in despair, [C. 169](#).

isplay, [B. 1107](#).

isplese, [A. 1](#).

ispit, spite, [C. 50](#).

ispoyled, stripped, [C. 95](#).

isserued, [B. 613](#).

isstrye, destroy, [B. 907](#), [1160](#).

isserne, discern, [C. 513](#).

issert, desert, [C. 12](#).

istres, [B. 880](#), [1160](#).

iuinité, [B. 1609](#).

itte3, stops up, closes, [B. 588](#). N.Prov.E. *ditt*, to stop up. A.S. *dyttan*.

ize, die, [C. 488](#).

izte, order, arrange, [B. 1266](#). A.S. *dihtan*, to set in order, dispose, arrange, direct, etc.

o, doe, “*daunce as any do*,” [A. 345](#).

obler, dish, [B. 1146](#). O.Fr. *doublier*.

140b

oc, duke, [A. 211](#).

Doel,

Dol, sorrow, [A. 326](#), [339](#), [642](#); [B. 852](#).

ole, part, [A. 136](#).

Dom, doom, judgment, purpose, [A. 157](#), [580](#), [667](#); [A. 597](#); command,

Dome, [A. 632](#); doom, [B. 203](#).

ongoun, dungeon, [B. 1224](#).

ool, part, [B. 216](#).

ool (dole), sorrow. See [Doel](#).

oole, gift, [B. 699](#).

or, door, [B. 320](#).

otage, folly, [B. 1425](#).

ote, act foolishly, [A. 286](#), [1500](#); [C. 125](#); be astonished, frightened, [B. 852](#).

Sc. *doit*. Icel. *dotta*, to slumber. Du. *doten*, *dutten*, delirare, desipere.

(Kilian.) “Maddyn, or *dotyn*, desipio.” (Prompt. Parv.)

oted, foolish, wicked, [C. 196](#). N.Prov.E. *doited*, stupid.

otel, a fool, [B. 1517](#).

oun, down, [A. 230](#).

oun, down, hill, [A. 121](#).

ungoun, dungeon, [A. 1187](#).

oured, grieved, mourned, [C. 372](#). Sc. *dour*.

ousour, sweetness, [A. 429](#).

oute, doubt, [A. 928](#).

Douth,	brave, noble, A. 839 , B. 270 , 597 , A.S. <i>duguth</i> , the nobility,
Douþe,	senate, etc. <i>Dugeth</i> , good, virtuous. <i>Dugan</i> , to profit, avail, be good, etc.

Doune, a female dove, [B. 469](#), [481](#). Cf. O.E. *wulvene*, a female wolf,

Dovene, and E. *vixen*, a female fox.

owe, avail, profit, [B. 374](#); [C. 141](#) 50. See T. B. 5001. See [Douth](#).

owelle, dwell, [A. 376](#), [1770](#); [B. 69](#).

owne, dove, [B. 485](#).

ownez, downs, hills, [A. 73](#), [85](#).

owyne, dwine, pine, [A. 326](#).

owrie, [B. 185](#).

ozter, daughter, [B. 814](#).

o3ty, doughty, valiant, [B. 1182](#), [1791](#). See *Douth*.

o3tyest, bravest, [B. 1306](#).

ra3, draw, [A. 699](#).

ra3t = draught, character, [B. 1557](#).

rede, doubt, [A. 1047](#).

repe, to kill, slay, [A. 246](#); destroy, [B. 599](#), [1306](#).

“This stone with his stremys stroyed all the venym,
And *drepit* the dragon to the dethe negh.”
(T. B. 929.)

A.S. *drepan*. O.N. *drepa*.

resse, order, direct, prepare, [A. 495](#), [860](#); [B. 92](#); *pret. dressed, drest*.

reue, drive, [A. 323](#).

reued, drove, went, [A. 980](#).

re3e = dreghe, suffer, endure, [B. 1224](#). Sc. *dree*. A.S. *dreógan*, to bear, suffer, endure. Cf. “dyntes full *dreghe*.” T. B. 935.

re3ly, sorrowfully, [B. 476](#). See T. B. 2379.

rof, drove, [A. 30](#), [1153](#).

rouy, turbid, [B. 1016](#). A.S. *dréfe*, muddy, foul; *dréfan*, to trouble, make turbid. O.E. *drove*, to trouble. Goth. *drobjan*, to trouble. Du. *droeven*.

“*Drovy* 141b turbidus, turbulentus.” (Cath. Ang.)

“He (the fool-large) is like to an hors that seketh rather to drynke *drovy* watir and trouble, than for to drinke water of the welle that is cleer.” (The Persones Tale: *Remedium contra avariciam*.)

rowned, was drowned, [B. 372](#).

ro3, drew, [A. 1116](#); [A. 71](#); *pl. drozen*, [B. 1394](#).

ro3the = drouthe, drought. A.S. *druguth*. Du. *drooghte*. Sc. *drouth*, from A.S. *dryg*. Du. *droogh*, dry.

ruye, dry, [A. 412](#); dry land, [B. 472](#).

rwry, dreary (?), [A. 323](#).

rwry = drury, love, [B. 699](#), [1065](#). O.Fr. *druerie*, *drurie*.

Dry3,

Dry3e, dry, [B. 385](#).

Dryȝ,
Dryȝe, heavy, sorrowful, [A. 823](#); [B. 342](#).

ryȝe, suffer, [B. 372](#), [400](#), [1032](#). See *Dreȝe*.

Dryȝly, strongly, rapidly, [A. 125](#); wrathfully, angrily, [A. 74](#), [344](#);
Dryȝlych, [B. 235](#).

ryȝtyn, Lord, [A. 349](#); [B. 1065](#). A.S. *drihten*.

Dubbed,
Dubbet, decked, [A. 73](#), [97](#), [202](#); adorned, [B. 115](#). See T. B. 1683.

ubbement, adornment, [A. 121](#).

ublere, a dish, [B. 1279](#). See *Dobler*.

ue, [A. 894](#); [C. 49](#).

uk, duke, [A. 38](#), [1182](#); leader, [B. 1771](#).

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umpe, be dashed, fall, [C. 362](#).

“*Dumpe* in þe depe.”

(T. B. 1996.)

“Þan sal þe rainbow descend,
In hu o galle it sal be kend;
Wit þe wind sal it melle,
And drive þam dun alle until helle;
And *dump* the devels þider in,
In þair bale alle for to brin.”

(*Signa Ante Iudicium*, in Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii.)

ungen, 3d pers. pl. pret. of *ding*, to beat, [B. 1266](#). Sw. *dänga*.

“So *dang* he þat dog with dynt of his wappon.”

(T. B. 302.)

unne, dun, [A. 30](#). See T. B. 925.

unt, blow. See *Dynt*.

urande, lasting, during, [A. 336](#).

ure, last, [A. 1021](#); [B. 488](#).

usched, struck, [B. 1538](#). Sc. *dusche*, to smite; *dusch*, a blow.

“All *dusshet* into the diche.”

(T. B. 4776.)

Dan. *daske*, to slap. Icel. *dust* a blow.
 utande, shutting, closing (from *dutte*, to shut), [B. 320](#). See *Ditte3*.
 utte, fasten, close, [B. 1182](#). Prov.E. *dýt*, stop up. O.N. *ditta*.
 ych, ditch, [A. 607](#); [B. 1792](#).
 yd, caused, [A. 306](#).
 ylle = dull, slow, sluggish, foolish, [A. 680](#). N.Prov.E. *dull*, hard of hearing.
 O.N. *dilla*, lallare.
 ym, black, [B. 1016](#).
 ymly, secretly, [C. 375](#).
 ymme, dark, [B. 472](#).
 yn, noise, [B. 862](#).
 “All *dynnet* the *dyn* the dales aboute.”
 (T. B. 1197.)
 yngne, worthy, [C. 119](#).
 yngneté, dignity, [B. 1801](#).
 142b
 ynt, blow, [C. 125](#).
 yscreuen, describe, [A. 68](#).
 yscouere, reveal, make known, [B. 683](#).
 ysheriete, disinherit, [B. 185](#).
 ysplese, to be displeased, [A. 422](#); to displease, [A. 455](#); [B. 1136](#).
 yspyt, spite, [B. 821](#).
 yssente, descend, [A. 627](#).
 ysstrye, destroy, [B. 520](#).
 ystresse, distress, [A. 280](#), [337](#).
 ystryed, destroyed, [A. 124](#).
 yt, doeth, [A. 681](#).
 y3e, die, [A. 306](#).
 y3t, decked, [A. 202](#), [987](#); ordered, prepared, [A. 243](#), [632](#); ordained, [A. 49](#);
 placed, seated, [C. 920](#); [B. 1794](#).

y3tte3, causest, [C. 488](#).

E

fte, again, [A. 328](#); afterwards, [A. 332](#); [B. 562](#).

gge = *edge*, hill, [B. 451](#).

gge, edge (of a knife), [A. 1104](#); of a hill, [B. 383](#). A.S. *ecge*. O.N. *egg*, edge.
Du. *egghe*, an angle, corner, angle. Ger. *ecke*, a corner.

ggyng, instigation, [B. 241](#). Prov.E. “egg on.” O.N. *egg*, an edge; *eggia*, to sharpen, and hence instigate.

lde, age, [A. 657](#); [B. 125](#). A.S. *eld*, *yld*, age.

lle3, else, otherwise, [A. 32](#); 724; so that, [B. 466](#).

Emerad,

Emerade, emerald, [A. 118](#), [1005](#).

mperise, empress, [A. 441](#).

Empire,

Empyre, [A. 454](#); [B. 540](#), [1332](#).

143

Enaumayld,

Enaumaylde, enamelled, [B. 1411](#), [1457](#).

nbaned, supported (?), [B. 1459](#). Sir F. Madden renders it *ornamented*.

nclose, [B. 334](#).

nclynande, inclining, bowing, [A. 236](#).

nclyned, prone, [B. 518](#).

Enclyin,

Enclyne, incline, [A. 630](#), [1206](#).

ncres, increase, [A. 959](#).

ncroche, approach, [A. 1117](#); receive, [C. 18](#).

nde, die, [A. 402](#); *on ende*, to death, [B. 426](#). Cf. *ender-day*, and *ending day* = the day of one’s death.

ndeleg, endless, [A. 738](#).

ndente, [A. 639](#), [1012](#).

ndentur, crevices, holes, [B. 313](#). O.Fr. *endenter*, to notch, jag.

ndorde, adored, [A. 368](#).

Endure,

Endeure, [A. 476](#), [1082](#).

ndyte, indite, [A. 1126](#).

ne, once; *at ene*, at once, [A. 291](#); *at ene*, at one, [A. 953](#). A.S. *æne*, once.

nfaminied, famished, [B. 1194](#).

nforsed, forced, [B. 938](#).

ngendered, begat, [B. 272](#).

nherite, inherit, [B. 240](#).

nle = enely (? *onlepi*), alone, singly, [A. 849](#).

nleuenþe, eleventh, [A. 1014](#).

Enmie,

Enmye, enemy, [B. 1204](#).

nourled, encircled, surrounded, [B. 18](#). Fr. *ourler*, to hem. *Orle* ^{143b} in Heraldry = border. Ital. Orlo = hem, edge. Spanish and Portug. Orla = selvedge, border.

Enprece,

Enpresse, press, [C. 43](#), [528](#).

npresse, impress, [A. 1097](#).

npoyssened, poisoned, [B. 242](#).

nprysonment, imprisonment, [B. 46](#).

nquylen, obtain, [C. 39](#). See [Aquyle](#).

nsens, incense, [A. 1122](#).

ntent, intent, [A. 1191](#).

ntre, enter, [A. 38](#), [1067](#).

ntré, entrance, [B. 1779](#).

ntyse, to provoke, [B. 1137, 1808](#).

nurned, adorned, decked, [A. 1027](#).

r, ere, before, [A. 324, 328](#); [B. 648](#).

Erber,

Erbere, arbour, [A. 9, 38, 1171](#).

rbes, herbs, [B. 1684](#).

rde, land, abode, [A. 248](#); [B. 596, 601, 1006](#). A.S. *eard*, native soil, country, region; *eardian*, to dwell, inhabit.

“Eson afterward *erdand* on lyffe,
Endured his dayes drowpyaite (? *drowpande*) on age.”
(T. B. 121.)

rigant, arrogance, [B. 148](#).

rly, early, [A. 392](#).

rnde, errand, message, [C. 52](#). See *Arende*.

rne, eagle, [B. 1698](#). A.S. *earn*, eagle.

rnestly, quickly, rapidly, [B. 277, 1240](#). A.S. *eornostlíce*.

rrour, [A. 422](#).

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rytage, heritage, [A. 443](#).

pe, easy, [A. 1202](#); [B. 608](#). A.S. *eáth*.

uen (wyth), *vb.* to be equal to, [A. 1073](#).

uen-songe, vespers, [A. 529](#).

uentyde, [A. 582](#); [B. 479](#).

uer-ferne, ever-fern, [C. 438](#). A.S. *eforfearn*, polypodium vulgare. See Gloss.
to Saxon Leechdoms, ii. 381.

were, ewer, [B. 1457](#).

xcuse, [A. 281](#).

Expoun,

Expoune, expound, [A. 37](#); [B. 1058, 1729](#).

Expowne,

xpounyng, *sb.* expounding, [B. 1565](#).

xpresse, [A. 910](#); [B. 1158](#).

F

able, [A. 592](#).

ace, [B. 1539](#).

ader, father, [A. 872](#).

Falce,

False, [B. 205](#), [474](#).

alewed, became pale, faded, [B. 1539](#). Ger. *falb*, pale, faded. A.S. *fealo*, pale, reddish or yellowish; *fealwian*, to grow yellow.

ale, good, [C. 92](#). A.S. *fæl*, clean, good, true.

alleȝ, falls, happens, [B. 494](#).

alure, [A. 1084](#).

amacion, defamation, [B. 188](#).

amed, celebrated, [B. 275](#).

ande, found, [A. 871](#).

anneȝ, fans, flaps, [B. 457](#).

antumme, phantom, [B. 1341](#).

arande, pleasing, [A. 865](#); handsome, [A. 607](#); joyous, [B. 1758](#). ^{144b} N.Prov.E. *farant*, decent, pleasant, nice. Gael, *farranta*, stout, brave.

arandely, pleasantly, [C. 435](#). N.Prov.E. *farantly*.

are, *vb.* go, [A. 129](#), [147](#); [A. 100](#), [621](#), [929](#); fare, [B. 466](#). A.S. *faran*. O.N. *fara*.

are, *sb.* voyage, course, [C. 98](#). A.S. *faru*, *fær*.

“Þe caſ he caſt o corn ſum quile,

In þe flum þat hatt þe Nile;

For-qui þat flum þat rennes þar,

Til Joſeph huſ it haſ þe *fare*.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 27b.)

are, conduct, [A. 832](#); [B. 861](#).

aren, gone, passed, [B. 403](#).

asor, form, [A. 431](#). See T. B. 3956.

asoun, fashion, [A. 983](#), [1101](#).

at, [B. 627](#).

ateȝ, fades, [A. 1038](#).

athme, (a) embrace, [A. 399](#); (b) grope, [B. 273](#).

(a) "Als I sat upon that lawe,
I bigan Denemark for to awe,
The borwes, and the castles stronge,
And mine armes weren so longe,
That I *fadmede*, al at ones,
Denemark with mine longe bones."
(Havelok the Dane, l. 1291.)

O.N. *fadma*. Dan. *fadme*. A.S. *fæthmian*, to embrace.

atte, vessel, [B. 802](#). A.S. *fæt*.

atted, fattened, [B. 56](#).

aunt, child, maiden, [A. 161](#).

aure, four, [B. 958](#).

aurty, forty, [B. 741](#), [743](#).

Faut,
Faute, fault, [B. 177](#), [236](#), [571](#).

autleȝ, faultless, [B. 794](#).

auty, faulty, sinful, [B. 741](#).

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Fauor,
Fauour, [A. 428](#); "gret fauor," [A. 968](#).

awre, four, [B. 938](#).

awte, fault, [B. 1736](#).

Fax,
Faxe, hair, [B. 790](#), [1689](#). A.S. *feax*.

ay, *in faye*, in faith, indeed, [A. 263](#); *par ma fay*, by my faith, [A. 489](#).

aylande, failing, lacking, [B. 1535](#).

ayle, be wanting, [A. 737](#). Set (of the sun), [B. 1758](#).

ayly, fail, [A. 34](#); [B. 548](#).

ayn, glad, [A. 393](#); *fayn of*, [A. 642](#); *faynest*, [B. 1219](#).

ayned, false, [B. 188](#).

ayth, “in *fayth*” indeed, [A. 1732](#); gen. sing, [B. 1735](#).

azte, fought, [A. 54](#).

Febele,

Feble, poor, bad, [B. 47](#), [101](#), [145](#).

Fech,

Feche, fetch, [A. 847](#), [1158](#); [B. 621](#).

ede, [A. 29](#).

ees, cities, [B. 960](#). Fr. *fief*. Prov. Fr. *feu*, *fieu*. M.Lat. *feudum*. Eng. *fee*. The origin of this term is to be found in Goth. *faihu*, possessions. O.H.G. *fihu*, *fehu*, cattle. O.N. *fe*. A.S. *feoh*, cattle, money.

el, bitterly, [B. 1040](#). A.S. *fell*, cruel, severe.

elazschyp, fellowship, [B. 271](#).

elde, field, [B. 1750](#).

ele, (?) hide, [B. 914](#).

ele, many, [A. 21](#), [927](#). A.S. *féla*.

ele (feel), taste, [B. 107](#).

ele-kyn, many kinds of, [B. 1483](#).

elle, cruel, severe; *felle chere*, stern countenance, [B. 139](#); 145b sharp, [A. 367](#); [A. 156](#), [1737](#); boisterous, rough, [A. 421](#); bitter, [B. 954](#).

elly, fiercely, bitterly, [B. 559](#), [571](#).

elonye, crime, sin, [A. 800](#); [B. 205](#).

eloun, sinner, criminal, [B. 217](#).

elt, hair, [B. 1689](#). A.S. *felt*. Du. *velt*, felt, cloth. Cf. W. *gwallt*, Gael. *falt*, hair of the head.

emmale, female, [B. 696](#).

ende, fiend, devil, [B. 205](#), [1341](#).

ende, fend, [B. 1191](#). Fr. *defendre*.

enden, of fiends, [B. 224](#).

eng, took (*pret.* of fonge), [B. 377](#).

enny, dirty, vile, [B. 1113](#). Cf. S.Prov.E. *venny*, mouldy. A.S. *fenn*, mud, dirt. Goth. *fani*.

enyx, phenix, [A. 430](#).

er, far, [A. 334](#).

erd, Ferde, frightened, [B. 897](#), [975](#).

erde, fear, [A. 386](#); [B. 215](#). A.S. *forhtian*, to fear; *forht*, fear.

erde, went, *pret.* of *fare*, [B. 1106](#).

ere, a companion; *in fere*, in company, together, [A. 89](#), [884](#); [B. 985](#), [1062](#). A.S. *fera*, *gefera*, a companion.

ere3, carries, [A. 98](#). A.S. *férian*.

ere3, companions, [A. 1150](#). See *fere*.

erke up, get up, [A. 897](#); ferke over, go, walk over, [B. 133](#).

“The freike upon faire
wise *ferke* out of lyne.”
(T. B. 145.)

146
“He salle *ferkke* before
And I salle come aftyre.”
(Morte Arthure, p. 347.)

“Now *ferkes* to the fyrthe,
thees fresche mene of armes.”
(*Ibid.* p. 209.)

“The kyng *ferkes* furthe
on a faire stede.”
(*Ibid.* p. 202.)

i T. B. 185, it is used transitively. The verb *to ferk* seems to be related to the
Eng. *firk*, a quick movement, jerk, etc. A.S. *frician*, to dance.

erly, *adj.* wondrous, A. 1084; *adv.* wonderfully, A. 269, 960; *sb.* wonder,
astonishment, A. 1086; marvel, B. 1529. A.S. *fær*, *færlice*, sudden.

erlyly, exceedingly, B. 962.

erre, farther, *comp.* of *fer*, B. 97, 98.

ers, fierce, B. 101.

erslych, fiercely, C. 337.

eryed, ferried, A. 946. O.N. *feria* (from *fara*, to go), to transport; set over.

est, fast, C. 290.

est, Feste, feast, A. 283; B. 642, 1758.

esten, fasten, establish, A. 156, 327, 1255; B. 273.

ester, B. 1040.

estial, festive, B. 136.

ete, *in fete*, indeed, B. 1106. O.Fr. *faict*. Fr. *fait*, a deed, feat.

eper-beddes, C. 158.

etly = featly, aptly, fitly, B. 585. See *fete*.

ette, fetch, B. 802.

ettle, set in order, provide, make, 146b B. 343, 585; C. 38, 435. Prov.E. *fettle*,
set in order, etc. O.Fris. *fitia*, to adorn. Goth. *fetjan*. Norse, *fitla*, to labour
at a thing in order to get it right. Pl.D. *fisseln*, to bustle about.

ette, fetter, [B. 1255](#).

eture, feature, [B. 794](#).

Fetys, neat, well made, [A. 174](#); dexterity, [B. 1103](#). O.Fr. *faictis*. Lat.

Fetyse, *factitius*, well made, neat, handsome.

etysely, handsomely, beautifully, [B. 1462](#).

e3t, fight, [B. 275](#), [1191](#). A.S. *feoht*. Ger. *fecht*, fight. See T. B. 1751.

e3tande, fighting, struggling, [B. 404](#).

iled, defiled. See *Fyled*.

lake, flake; *flake of soufre*, [B. 954](#). O.N. *flak*, plank, slice.

lake = fleck, spot, blemish, [A. 947](#). O.N. *fleckr*. Ger. *fleck*, spot, blot, stain.

lakerande, flickering, fluttering, [B. 1410](#). Ger. *flackern*, to flare, blaze, flutter.

lambe, flame, [A. 769](#).

laumbande, flaming, [A. 90](#); shining, [B. 1468](#).

launke, spark, [B. 954](#). Prov.E. *flanker*, a flying spark. Pl. D. *flunkern*, to flicker, sparkle. Ger. *flunke*, spark.

lauore, flavour, [A. 87](#).

lawen, fled, [C. 214](#).

lay, terrify, [A. 960](#), [1723](#); [B. 215](#). See T. B. 4593. N.Prov.E. *flay*, *flee*.

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layn, flayed, [A. 809](#).

la3t, plot of ground, a flat, [A. 57](#).

lee3, fleece (of golde), [B. 1476](#).

Flem,

Fleme, banish, [A. 334](#); [B. 31](#), [596](#). A.S. *flyman*.

lem, stream, [C. 309](#). Cf. Prov.E. *flume*, *flem*, *fleme*, a mill-stream. Norse, *flom*, *flaum*, flood, overflow of water; *flauma*, to overflow.

Fleschlych,

Fleschly, fleshly, carnal, [A. 265](#); [B. 1082](#).

let, *pret.* of flete, to flow, [A. 1058](#).

Flete, flow, [A. 1025](#); to people, [B. 685](#). See T. B. 278, 4715. A.S. *fleotan*.

Flet, Sw. *flyta*, flow, float. O.N. *fliota*. Prov.E. *fleet*.

lette, floated, *pret.* of *flete*, to float, [B. 387](#).

“Childer,” he said, “yee list and lete,
I sagh caf on þe water *flete*.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 27b.)

le3e, flew, [A. 431](#).

Flod,

Flode, flood, [A. 874](#), [1058](#); [B. 369](#).

lokke, flock, company, [B. 386](#), [1767](#).

lonc = flong = flung, [A. 1165](#).

lor, flower, [A. 29](#), [962](#); *pl.* *flores*.

lor, floor, [B. 133](#).

losed, flossed, [B. 1689](#). Cf. *floss*-silk. Ital. *floscio flosso*, drooping, flaccid.

lot, grease, fat, [B. 1011](#). A.S. *flótan*, to float; *flót-smere*, scum of a pot, floating fat. O.N. *flót*, the act of floating, the ^{147b} grease swimming on the surface of broth. Prov.E. *fleet*.

Flot,

Flote, company, [A. 786](#), [946](#); army, [B. 1212](#). O.Fr. *flote*, a crowd.

Flot,

Flote, flowed, floated, [A. 46](#); [A. 421](#), [432](#); [B. 248](#).

Flotte,

loty (? *flotery*), waving, [A. 127](#).

lour-de-lys, lily, [A. 753](#).

loury, flowery, [A. 57](#).

lowen, flew, fled, [A. 89](#); [B. 945](#).

lowred, flowered, [A. 270](#).

lo3ed, flowed, [B. 397](#).

lurted, flowered, figured, [A. 208](#).

lyt, force, literally chiding, [B. 421](#). O.S. *flit*, contention.

lyte, to quarrel, strive, [A. 353](#). Prov.E. *flite*, scold. A.S. *flitan*.

lytande, chiding, [B. 950](#).

lyȝe, flay (?), [A. 813](#).

lyȝt, flight, [B. 377](#).

o, enemy, [B. 1219](#).

ode, person, people, [B. 466](#); *fode*, a child (King Horn, 1384); *fodder*, producer, mother (King Alys. 645); A.S. *fedan*, *afedan*, to bring forth, give birth to, rear. O.N. *fæda*. Dan. *föde*.

ogge, dry grass, [B. 1683](#). W. *fwg*.

ol, full, [B. 1754](#).

ol, fool, [B. 750](#), [996](#).

ol, foolish, [C. 283](#).

olde, folded, [A. 434](#).

olde, earth, [A. 334](#); [B. 403](#), [950](#).

olde, to beat, buffet, [A. 813](#).

ole, fowl, [B. 1410](#).

ole, fool, [B. 202](#).

ole, foal, [B. 1255](#).

oler, [B. 1410](#).

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oles, acts foolishly, [B. 1422](#).

Folewande,

Folwande, following, [A. 1040](#), [B. 429](#), [1212](#).

Folk,

Folke, people, [B. 100](#), [542](#), [960](#).

olken, of people, [B. 271](#).

olmarde. Properly the beech-martin, but commonly applied to the pole-cat.

O.Fr. *foine*, *faine* (Lat. *fagina*), beechmast.

olyly, foolishly, [B. 696](#). See T. B. 575.

ol3e, follow, [A. 127](#); [B. 6](#), [677](#), [918](#), [1752](#). A.S. *folgian*.

ol3ed, baptized, [A. 654](#). A.S. *fullian*, *fulwian*, to baptize.

oman, enemy, [B. 1175](#).

on, ceased, *pret.*, of *fyne*, [A. 1030](#); [B. 369](#). The northern form is *fan*.

“Bot ai þe quils he ne *fan*
To behald þe leve maidan.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii, fol. 20a.)

onde, to found, establish, [A. 939](#); [B. 173](#).

onde, to go, proceed, [A. 150](#).

onde, try, [B. 1103](#). A.S. *fandian*.

onden, found, [B. 356](#).

onge, take, receive, [A. 439](#), [479](#); [A. 540](#); *fonge3 to the fly3t*, takes to flight, [B. 457](#). A.S. *fon*. Ger. *fangen*, take, seize. Goth. *fahan*.

ont, [B. 164](#).

onte = *fond*, examined, [A. 170](#), [327](#).

Fooschyp,

Foschip, enmity, [B. 918](#), [919](#).

or, from, [A. 740](#); because, [B. 323](#).

orbede, forbid, [A. 379](#); [B. 1147](#).

148b

orbi, beyond, [C. 483](#).

orboden, forbidden, [B. 826](#), [998](#).

orbrent, burnt, [A. 1139](#).

or-clemmed, starved, [C. 395](#). Prov.E. *clem*, to starve, pinch with hunger. Du. *klemmen*, to pinch, compress.

or-didden, did away with, [A. 124](#).

or-dolked, severely wounded, [A. 11](#). A.S. *dolc*, *dolh*, *dolg*, a wound; *dilgian*, to destroy.

orering, [A. 3](#). See [Note](#).

orfare, destroy; also to perish, [A. 1168](#); [C. 483](#); *forferde*, (*pret.*), [B. 571](#), [1051](#).

orfete, [A. 619](#), [639](#); [B. 743](#).

orfyne, lastly.

Forgart, = for-did, lost, *pret.* of for-gar, ruin, destroy, lose, [A. 321](#);

Forgarte, [B. 240](#). See [Gar](#).

orged, made, [B. 343](#).

orhede, forehead, [A. 871](#).

oriusted, overthrown, defeated, [B. 1216](#). Fr. *jouster*, to tilt.

“So many groundes he *for-justede* & of joy broght.”
(T. B. 296.)

orlete, lost, [A. 327](#).

or long, very long, [A. 586](#).

orlonge, furlong, [A. 1030](#).

orlote3 = forlete3, forsake, [B. 101](#).

“Þe laghes bath he (Adam) þan *forlete*
Bath naturel and positif.”
(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 52b.)

orloyne, forsake, depart, go astray, err, [A. 368](#); [B. 282](#), [750](#), [1155](#), [1165](#). Fr. *loin*, far.

or-madde, very mad (foolish), [C. 509](#).

149

ormast, first, foremost, [B. 494](#).

orme, first, [C. 38](#).

Forme-fader,

Forme-foster, first-father, progenitor, [A. 639](#); [B. 257](#).

ornes, furnace, [B. 1011](#).

or-payned, severely troubled, [A. 246](#).

orray, forage, [B. 1200](#). Fr. *fourrager*, to fodder, forrage, prey. O.Fr. *fourrer*.
Mid. Lat. *foderare*, *forrare*, from A.S. *foder*. Ger. *futter*, food, victuals.

orsetlet, a fortified place, [B. 1200](#). “*Forcelet*, stronge place (*forslet*, H. P.)
Fortaliciūm.” (Prompt. Parv.) O.Fr. *forcier*. It. *forciere*. Mid. Lat. *forsarius*,
a strong box, safe, coffer.

orser = forcer, forcet, [A. 263](#). See preceding word.

orsette, compass, [B. 78](#).

orsothe, forsooth, indeed, [C. 212](#).

orst, frost, [B. 524](#). A.S. *forst*.

orþe, way, passage, [A. 150](#). See T. B. 4094, 4166. Welsh, *ffordd*, a way.

“The kyng fraystez [seeks] a *furth* over the fresche strandez,
One a strenghe by a streme in thas straytt landez.”
(Morte Arthure, p. 103.)

orth-lep, forth-leapt, [C. 154](#).

orþoʒt, repented, [B. 557](#).

orþrast, for-thrust, [B. 249](#).

orþy, therefore, wherefore, [A. 234](#); [B. 545](#), [1020](#).

orþynke, repent, [B. 285](#).

ortune, [A. 306](#).

orwarde = forward, covenant, 149b promise, [B. 327](#), [1742](#). A.S. *fore-weard*.

“*Forwarde*, or cuuinawnt, convencio, pactum.” (Prompt. Parv.)

orwroʒt, over-worked, weary, [C. 163](#).

orʒes, furrows, [B. 1547](#). A.S. *furh*. Ger. *furche*, a furrow.

orʒete, forgot, [B. 203](#).

ote, foot, [A. 970](#).

oted, footed, [B. 538](#).

ounce, bottom, [A. 113](#). See *Founs*.

oundande, going, [C. 126](#).

ounde, to go, [B. 903](#).

“Quen we suppose in our sele
to sit alther heist,

Than *fondis* furth dame fortoun
to the flode 3ates,
Drazes up the damme borde
and drenchis us evir.”

(K. Alex. p. 64.)

“Fflorent and Floridas with fyve
score knyghttez,
ffollowede in the foreste, and on the
way *foundys*,
Fflyngande a faste trott,
and on the folke dryffes.”

(Morte Arthure, p. 231.)

oundemente, foundation, [A. 993](#).

ounden, found, [B. 547](#).

ounded, destroyed, perished, [B. 1014](#).

Founs,
Founce, bottom, [B. 1026](#).

“Onone as thai on Alexander
and on his ost waites,
Thai flee as fast into flode,
and to the *founce* plungid.”

(K. Alex. p. 141.)

ourferde, perished, *pret.* of *forfare*, [B. 560](#).

owle, foully, [B. 1790](#).

150

owled, became defiled, foul. [B. 269](#).

owre, four, [A. 886](#).

oysoun, abundant, [A. 1058](#). Fr. *foison*. O.Fr. *fuson*, from Lat. *fusio*, pouring
out.

raunchyse, liberality, [A. 609](#); [B. 750](#).

ray, terrify, [B. 1553](#). See [Afray](#).

rayne3, demands, asks, desires, [A. 129](#). A.S. *fregnan*, to ask. Goth. *fraihnan*.

rayste (a), sought, [A. 169](#); (b) literally, to try, prove, [B. 1736](#). O.N. *fresta*.

(a)

“Bot wete thou wele this iwis, within a wale time,
Fra that I *fraist* have that faire (faice?) of my faire lady,
I sall the seke with a sowme of seggis enarmed.”

(K. Alex. p. 69.)

Frek, } man, [B. 6, 79, 540](#). This word is used by Skelton. A.S. *freca*,
Freke, } a daring warrior, from *frec*, *freca*, bold, daring, eager. The adjective
freke (*frek*, *frike*), was not unknown to O.E. writers of the 14th
century.

“Israel wit þis uplepp,
Ðat moght noght forwit strid a step,
Witouten asking help of sun;
Ðat quak wit ilk lim was won,
Ðat first for eild moght noght spek,
To bidd hast now es nan sa frek.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 29b.)

reles, blameless, [A. 431](#). O.N. *fryja*, to blame. *Frie*, to blame, occurs in the
romance of *Havelok the Dane*, 1998.

150b

reloker, more freely, [B. 1106](#).

rely, lordly, [A. 162](#); beautiful, [A. 173](#); freely, [B. 20](#).

relych, lordly, [A. 162](#); bountiful, [B. 214](#).

rench, an error for *frech* (*fresh*) or *frelich*, [A. 1086](#).

rete, gnaw, eat, devour, [B. 1040](#). A.S. *fretan*.

reten, devoured, [B. 404](#).

rette, furnish, [A. 339](#); ornament, [B. 1476](#). A.S. *frætu*, ornament; *frætewian*,
frætwian, trim, deck, adorn.

ro, from, [A. 427](#); [A. 396](#). This is another form of the Northumbrian *fra*. O.N.
frá; “to ne fro,” [B. 347](#).

Frok,

Frokke, dress, garment, frock, [B. 136, 1742](#).

roþande, frothing, frothy, filthy, [B. 1721](#).

runt, kicked, [C. 187](#). See T. B. 5968.

rym, beautiful, fresh, vigorous, [A. 1079](#). Prov.E. *frim*; *frum*, tender, fresh.

A.S. *freme*, advantageous, good. Drayton uses the phrase “*frim* pastures,”
i.e. luxuriant pastures.

ryst, delay, put off, [B. 743](#). A.S. *fyrstan*, to give respite; *fyrst*, a space of time,
interval. Icel. *frest*, delay; “to *frist*, to trust for a time” (Ray); to delay

(Jam.).

Fryt,

Fryte, fruit, [A. 29](#); [B. 1044](#).

ryth, wood, [A. 89](#); [B. 534](#), 1680. Gael, *frith*, a heath, deer park, forest.

151

ul, foul, [B. 231](#).

ulfille, accomplish, [B. 264](#), 1732.

ulzed, baptized, [B. 164](#). See *Folz*ed.

undament, foundation, [A. 1010](#).

unde, found, [B. 1735](#).

ust, fist, [B. 1535](#).

yf, five, [A. 849](#).

ygure, [A. 170](#), 747.

ykel, treacherous, deceitful, [C. 283](#).

yldor, gold thread, [A. 106](#). Fr. *fil d'or*.

yled, defiled, dirty, [B. 136](#).

yled, formed, [B. 1460](#).

ylsened, strengthened, aided, supported, [B. 1167](#), 1644. A.S. *fylst*, help, assistance; *fylstan*, to help, aid.

ylter, huddle together, [A. 224](#); join, [A. 696](#); meet together in battle, [B. 1191](#); become ragged, entangled. Prov.E. *felter*, entangle, clot. Fairfax uses the phrase "*feltred* locks." Cf. the phrase a "*filtered* fole," a shaggy foal. Baker says that the term *felt* is applied to a matted growth of grass.

"His fax and his foretoppe was *filterede* togeder."

(Morte Arthure, p. 91.)

glyoles (= *fyells*, *phiolls*), round towers, [B. 1462](#). Cf. *Fala*, a tour of tre.

Med. Gram.

yne, vb. end, die, [A. 328](#); cease, [A. 353](#); [A. 450](#); delay, [B. 929](#).

yne, sb. cessation, [A. 635](#).

ynne, fin, [B. 531](#).

yole, [B. 1476](#).

ymament, [B. 221](#).

151b

yrre, *adv.* farther, comp. of *fer*, [A. 103](#), [127](#); [A. 766](#); [C. 116](#); *adj.* distant, [B. 148](#). A.S. *fyrre*.

yrte, fearful, trembling, [A. 54](#). A.S. *fyrhto*; *fyrhtu*, fear, fright, trembling; *forht*, fearful, timid.

ypel, fiddle, [B. 1082](#).

ypere, feather, [B. 530](#), [1026](#).

G

alle, gall, stain, filth, [A. 1060](#); [B. 1022](#). Cf. to *gall*, fret. Fr. *galler*. W. *gwall*. O.N. *galli*, fault, imperfection. Dan. *gal*, wrong, ill.

ain, against, [A. 138](#).

ardyn, [A. 260](#).

are, cause, make, drive, [A. 331](#); [B. 690](#). N.Prov.E. *gar*. O.N. *göra*, *gera*.

arlande, [A. 1186](#).

arnyst, garnished, ornamented, [B. 1277](#).

art, forced, made, [A. 1151](#). See *gare*; *garten*, 3d pers. pl. [A. 86](#).

ate, way, [A. 395](#), [526](#); [B. 676](#), [931](#). See T. B. 6292. O.N. *gata*.

Gaule,

Gawle, [A. 463](#); [C. 285](#). See *galle*.

Gay,

Gaye, [A. 260](#); [B. 830](#), [1315](#).

ayn, *vb.* avail, [A. 343](#); [C. 164](#); prevail, [B. 1608](#). Sc. *gane*; *gain*, to be fit or suitable.

Gayn,

Gayne, useful, available, good, [B. 259](#), [749](#).

Gaynly, gainly, gracious, [A. 728](#); [B. 83](#). Cf. ungainly = awkward. O.N.
Gaynlych, *gegn*, 152 convenient, suitable; *gegna*, to meet.

a3afylace, royal treasury, [B. 1283](#).

eder, gather, [C. 105](#).

ef, gave, [A. 174](#).

ele, spy, see, [A. 931](#).

emme, [A. 253](#).

endered, engendered, [B. 300](#).

endrez, genders, kinds, [B. 434](#).

eneracyoun, [A. 827](#).

Gent,

Gente, gentle, noble, gracious, [A. 118](#), [253](#), [265](#); [B. 1495](#).

entryse, nobleness, [B. 1159](#), [1216](#).

entyl, noble, [A. 278](#); *gentyleste*, [A. 1015](#); [B. 1180](#).

entylmen, [B. 864](#).

ere, gear, [A. 16](#); [B. 148](#).

ere, clothing, attire, [B. 1811](#).

ered, covered, clothed, ornamented, [B. 1344](#), [1568](#). O.N. *gerfi*. A.S. *gearwa*,
habiliments. O.H.G. *garawi*, ornament, dress. A.S. *gearwan*; *gearwian*,
make ready, prepare, supply.

esse, tell, [A. 499](#). Norse, *gissa*.

este, tale, saying, [A. 277](#).

Geste,

Gest, guest, [B. 98](#), [640](#).

ettes, devices, [B. 1354](#). O.N. *geta*, to conceive. A.S. “and-*gitan*,” get, know,
understand.

euen, given, [A. 1190](#).

ilde, guilt, [B. 1344](#).

iles, gills, [C. 269](#).

ilofre, gilly flower, [A. 43](#). Fr. *giroflée*. Lat. *caryophyllus*, a clove.

lace = glance, [A. 171](#). Fr. *glacer*, 152b *glacier*, slide, slip. Cf. O.E. *glace*, to polish, glance as an arrow turned aside.

lade, vb. to gladden, [A. 861](#).

lam, word, message, [A. 499](#); [A. 63](#); talk, speech, [C. 830](#); noise, [B. 849](#).

Obsolete Swedish, *glamm*, talk, chatter; *glamma*, to talk, chatter. Gael.

glam, outcry. O.N. *glam*, clash; *glamra*, to rattle. Sc. *glamer*, noise, clatter.

“Alle thire he closis in that cliffe, and cairis on forthire,
To the occyann at the erthes ende, and, ther in an ilee, he heres
A grete *glaver* and a *glaam* of grekin tongis.”
(K. Alex. p. 188.)

Glas,

Glasse, [A. 990](#), [1025](#).

lauere, to deceive, [A. 688](#). Cf. N.Prov.E. *glaver*, *glaiver*, to talk foolishly;
glauver, flattery. W. *glafir*. Irish *glafaire*, a babbler.

“Sir,” sais syr Gawayne,
“So me gode helpe,
Siche *glaverande* gomes
greves me bot lyttille.”
(Morte Arthure, p. 212.)

See extract under word *glam*.

laymande, slimy, [C. 269](#). Cf. “gleyme or rewme, reuma;” “gleymyn or
yngleymyn, visco, invisco.” (Prompt. Parv.)

layre, glare, amber, [A. 1026](#). A.S. *glære*, amber. O.N. *glér*. Dan. *glar*, glass.

layue, a sword, [A. 654](#). Fr. *glaive*. Lat. *gladius*.

le, joy, glee, [A. 95](#), [1123](#).

lede, kite, [B. 1696](#). A.S. *glída*.

153

Glem, gleam, light, [A. 79](#); brightness, [A. 218](#); *day-glem*, daylight,

Gleme, [A. 1094](#); *heaven-glem*, heaven light, [B. 946](#).

lemande, gleaming, shining, [A. 70](#), [990](#).

lene, glean, gather, [A. 955](#).

Glent, shone, [A. 70, 114, 1026](#); [B. 218](#). Sc. *glent*, *glint*, to gleam. Dan.
Glente, *glindse*, to glisten; *glindre*, to glitter.

“The schaftes of the schire sone schirkind the cloudis,
And gods glorious gleme *glent* tham emannge.”
(K. Alex. p. 164.)

Glent, slipped, fell, [A. 671](#). Sc. *glint*, *glent*, not only signifies to gleam,
Glente, shine, but also to glide, slide. W. *ysglentio*, to slide.

“Glissonand as the glemes þat *glenttes* of þe snaw.”
(T. B. 3067.)

lente3, sb. looks, [A. 1144](#).

Glet, dirt, mud, slime, and hence filth, sin, [A. 1060](#); [A. 306, 573](#);
Glette, [B. 269](#). Pl. D. *glett*, slippery. Sc. *glít*, pus. O.N. *glæta*, wet.

lewed, called, prayed, [C. 164](#). Fr. *glay*, cry.

lode3, glades, [A. 79](#).

loped, was terrified, frightened, amazed, [B. 849](#). O.N. *glapa*, stare, gaze,
gape. O.Fris. *glupa*, to look, peep. Dan. *glippe*, to wink. N.Prov.E. *glop*,
gloppen, to be amazed, to frighten.

“Bees not *agloped* madame ne greved at my fadire.”
(K. Alex. p. 30.)

153b

“Thane *gloped* the glotone and glorede unfaire.”
(Morte Arthure, p. 90.)

“O, my hart is rysand in a *glope*!
For this nobylle tythand thou shalle have a droppe.”
(Town. Myst. p. 146.)

loppedly, fearfully, [B. 896](#).

lory, [A. 934](#); [B. 1522](#).

Gloryous,	}	
Glorious,	}	A. 799, 915 .
Gloryus,	}	

lotoun, a wicked wretch, a loose fellow, a ribald, [B. 1505](#).

loumb, look, observe, [C. 94](#). Chaucer uses *glombe* in the sense of looking
gloomy, sullen, frowning. It seems to be connected with O.N. *glampa*, to

glitter, shine. Cf. O.E. *glent*, to shine, and *glent*, to look. So also *stare* signifies not only to look steadfastly at, but to shine, glitter.

lowed, shone, [A. 114](#). O.N. *gloá*, to glow, burn, shine.

lwande, glowing, shining, bright, [C. 94](#).

lydande, going, walking, [B. 296](#).

lyde, to go, walk, slip along, [B. 325](#), [677](#), [1590](#). Pl. D. *gliden*, *glien*, slip, glide.

lyfte, became frightened, [B. 849](#). Originally to stare, look astonished.

“Þys munke stode ande lokede þarto,
And hade þerof so moche drede,
Þat he wende have go to wede:
As he stode so sore *aglyfte*
Hys ryzt hande up he lyfte,
Ande blessedde hym self stedfastly.”
(Handlyng Synne, l. 3590.)

Gliffe, in O.E. signifies also to look, shine, glow. Sc. *glevin*, to glow; *gliff*, a glimpse; *gliffin*, to wink. Dan. *glippe*, to wink.

lymme, brightness, [A. 1088](#). O.Sw. *glimma*, to shine.

lysande, shining, glistening. [A. 1018](#). A.S. *glisnian*. O.N. *glyssa*, to sparkle, glitter.

lyzt, shone, [A. 114](#); looked, [C. 453](#). Du. *glicken*, to shine. Icel. *glugga*, to peep. *A-glyzte*, slipped from, in line 245, is evidently another form of *glyzt*. Cf. N.Prov.E. *glea*, *aglea*, crooked, aside; *gledge*, to look askint. Sc. *gley*, *gly*, to squint, all of which originally signified simply to look, shine. See [T. B. 3943](#).

nede, niggardly, beggarly, [B. 146](#). The MS. reads nede, but *gnede* is the correct form. Dan. *gnide*, to rub. A.S. *gnidan*. Cf. O.E. *nithing*, a miser. A.S. *gnethen*, moderate, sparing.

“Sua lang has thir tua boght þair sede,
Þat þair moné wex al *gnede*.”
(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 31a.)

“Bot fra þair store bigan to sprede
The pastur þam bigan to *kne*de.”
(*Ibid.* fol. 15a.)

“Bot al he tok in godds nam,
And thold luveli al þat scam;
For al to *gnede* him thoght þe gram

þat he moght thol on his licam”
(*Ibid.* fol. 51a.)

oande, going, [B. 931](#).

oblote, goblet, [B. 1277](#).

God,

Gode, good, wealth. See [Goud](#).

odhede, godhead, [A. 413](#).

154b

odlych, good, [B. 753](#).

olf, deep, abyss, [A. 608](#).

ome, man, [A. 231](#); [B. 1315](#).

orde = *girde*, rush, go headlong, [B. 911](#), [957](#). See T. B. 169.

ore, filth, [B. 306](#). A.S. *gor*, wet, filth, mud. N. *gor*.

orste, gorse, [B. 99](#), [534](#). W. *gores*, *gorest*, waste, open.

Gost,

Goste, spirit, [A. 86](#); [B. 325](#), [1598](#).

ostly, spiritual, ghostly, [A. 790](#).

ote, stream, [A. 934](#); [A. 413](#); [C. 310](#); *pl.* *gote3*, [B. 608](#). Prov.E. *gote*, *goit*,
gowt, ditch, sluice, mill-stream. Du. *gote*, kennel, conduit. A.S. *geotan*, to
pour.

“As *gotes* out of *guttars* in *golanand*, (*glomand* ?) *wedors*,
So voidis down the venom be *vermys* *schaftes*.”

(K. Alex. p. 163.)

Goud,
Goude,
God,

adj. good, [A. 33](#), [568](#); *sb.* wealth, riches, [A. 731](#), [734](#); [B. 1326](#).

Goun,

Goune, gown, dress, [B. 145](#), [1568](#).

overnor, [A. 1645](#); [B. 199](#).

owde3, goods, [C. 286](#).

race, [A. 436](#).

Gracios,

Gracious, [A. 95, 260, 934](#); [C. 26](#).

racyously, [B. 488](#).

rame, wrath, vengeance, [C. 53](#). A.S. *grama*. Ger. *gram*, anger, displeasure.

raunt, *sb.* leave, permission, [A. 317](#); *vb.* grant, [A. 765](#); [B. 240](#).

rauayl, gravel, pebbles, [A. 81](#).

rauen, graven, [B. 1324](#).

rauen, buried, [B. 1332](#).

155

raynez, grains, [A. 31](#).

rayped, prepared, [A. 343](#), placed, [A. 1485](#); availed, [B. 53](#). See T. B. 229.

O.N. *greitha*, to make ready. N.Prov.E. *graid*.

raypely, quickly, readily, [A. 341](#); truly, [A. 499](#); [B. 240](#). N.Prov.E. *gradely*.
See T. B. 54.

“On Gydo, a gome þat *graidly* had soght,
And wist all þe werks by wegges he hade.”
(T. B. 229.)

Cf. *Graiþe* = ready.

re, will, desire, [C. 348](#); hence *bongre*, *malgre*, etc. O.Fr. *gret*. Fr. *gré*, will,
pleasure. Lat. *gratus*, pleasing.

rece, step, [B. 1590](#).

redirne, gridiron, [B. 1277](#).

reffe, grief, [A. 86](#).

reme, *adj.* displeasing, [A. 42](#); wrath, [C. 16, 947](#); *vb.* to make angry,
displease, [B. 138, 1347](#). A.S. *gremian*, to displease.

reme, spot, blemish, [A. 465](#). Norse *grima*, a spot.

resse, grass, [A. 10, 245](#); [B. 1028](#).

rete, the whole, [A. 637](#), ? altogether [A. 851](#); a *grete*, in the gross—a head,
[A. 560](#).

rete, weep, [A. 331](#). A.S. *grætan*, Prov.E. *greet*.

retyng, *sb.* weeping, [B. 159](#).
 reue, grieve, [A. 471](#); [B. 138](#), [302](#), [306](#).
 reue, grove, [A. 321](#); [B. 99](#).
 reuing, *sb.* sorrowing, grief, [B. 159](#).
 romylyoun, the herb *gromwell*, grey millet, (*Lithospermum officinale*),
[A. 43](#). “*Gromaly* 155b herbe. *Milium solis*.” (Prompt. Parv.)
 rone, groan, [B. 1077](#).
 ropande, searching, trying, [B. 591](#). A.S. *gráþian*, to touch, feel, seize, grope.
 O.N. *greipa*.
 ropyng, *sb.* handling, [B. 1102](#).
 rounde, ground, sharpened, [A. 654](#).
 roundeleȝ, bottomless, [C. 310](#).
 rouelyng, on the face, [A. 1120](#). O.N. *grufa*; *grufa nidr*, to stoop down.
Liggia á grufu, to lie face downwards, to lie groveling.
 ruche, begrudge, [B. 1347](#).
 ruȝt, *pret.* of *gruche*, [B. 810](#).
 rychchyng, *sb.* murmuring, repining, [C. 53](#).
 rym, black, [A. 1070](#).
 rymly, sharply, [A. 654](#); roughly, [B. 1534](#).
 rymme, horrible, [A. 1553](#); sharp, [B. 1696](#). A.S. *grim*; *grimm*, fury, rage;
 sharp, bitter; “a *grym* toole,” T. B. 938.
 rynde, [A. 81](#).
 ryndel, angry, [C. 524](#). Norse *grina*, wry the mouth; *grinall*, sour looking.
 Du. *grinnen*, *grinden*, to grin, snarl.
 rysly, horrible, [B. 1534](#). A.S. *grislic*, horrible; *a-grísan*, to dread, fear
 greatly.
 ryspyng, *sb.* gnashing of the teeth. A.S. *grist-bítung*.
 ryste, dirt (?), [A. 465](#).
 uere, gear, [B. 1505](#).

uferes, evidently an error for *guterres*, [C. 310](#). See T. B. 3072. See extract under word *gote*.

156

Gult,

Gulte, guilt, [A. 942](#); [B. 690](#).

ulty, guilty, [C. 210](#), [285](#).

ut, [C. 280](#).

yde-ropes, [C. 105](#).

ye, govern, [B. 1598](#). Fr. *guider*; *guier*, direct, guide.

yle, guile, [A. 671](#), [688](#); [C. 285](#).

ylt, guilt, [B. 731](#).

ylte3, [A. 655](#).

yltle3, guiltless, [A. 668](#).

yltyf, guilty, [A. 669](#).

yn, machine; applied to the ark, [A. 491](#); to a boat, [B. 146](#).

yng, company, [A. 455](#). A.S. *genge*. See T. B. 1225.

“Þan was Jacob busked yare,
Wit al þe *gynge* þat wit him ware.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 30*a*.)

yngure, ginger, [A. 43](#).

yse, guise, [A. 1099](#).

yternere, [A. 91](#). Fr. *guitarre*; *guiterne*, a gittern. (Cot.) Lat. *cithara*, a harp.

H

abbe, have, [A. 75](#); *habes*, *habbes*, has, [B. 555](#), [995](#).

Hach,

Hachche, hatch (of a ship), [A. 409](#); [B. 179](#).

afyng. See *Hauyng*.

agherlych, fitly, [B. 18](#). See *Hazerly*.

aldande, holding, [C. 251](#).

alde, hold, [A. 454](#), [490](#); [B. 652](#).

alden, held, [A. 1191](#); [B. 42](#).

ale, flow, [A. 125](#). The original meaning is to drag along. Ger. *holen*. O.N. *hala*. Fr. *haler*. Cf. T. B. 1782.

ale, toss, [A. 1520](#); [B. 219](#).

156b

alf, side, quarter, [B. 950](#). O.N. *halfa*.

alke, recess, [B. 104](#), [321](#). A.S. *hylca*, hooks, turnings. “*Halke* or *hyrne*. Angulus, latibulum.” (Prompt. Parv.) See Canterbury Tales, 11433.

alse, salute, wish one health, [B. 1621](#). O.N. *heilsa*. Sw. *halsa*, to salute. O.N. *heilsa*, health. See T. B. 367.

alt, lame, [B. 102](#). O.N. *halltr*, lame; *haltra*, *halta*, to limp.

alue, behalf, [B. 896](#).

alue, side, border, [B. 1039](#).

alyday, holy day, [A. 134](#); [B. 9](#).

alȝed, hallowed, sanctified, [B. 506](#), [1163](#).

ampre, to pack up for removal, [B. 1284](#).

an (3d pers. pl. pres.), have, [A. 776](#).

ande-helme, [B. 419](#).

apeneȝ, is blessed, [B. 27](#).

appe, joy, [A. 16](#), [1195](#); *happeȝ*, blessings, [A. 24](#); [B. 11](#). O.N. *happ*.

appe, cover, [A. 626](#); [B. 450](#). Prov.E. *hap*, to cover; *happing*, covering.

“Lord, what (lo) these weders ar cold, and I am ylle happyd.”

(Town. Myst. p. 98.)

Happyn or *whappyn*’ yn cloȝys.” “*Lappyn*’, or *whappyn*’ yn cloȝys (*happyn* to-gedyr, S.; *wrap* to-geder in clothes, P.) Involvo.” (Prompt. Parv.)

appen, *adj.* happy, blessed, [C. 13](#), [17](#), [19](#), [21](#).

157

ard, coarse cloth made of tow, “*hard* hattes,” [B. 1209](#). A.S. *heordan*, *heordas*, hards, refuse of tow.

“Sum araies thaim in ringes, and sum in row breuys,
With *hard hattes* on thaire hedis hied to thaire horsis.”
(K. Alex. p. 102.)

ardy, bold, [B. 143](#).

ardily, boldly, [A. 3](#).

are, [B. 391](#).

arlot, underling, [A. 39](#); servant, profane jester, [A. 860](#), [1584](#); *harlotez*,
harlot's, [A. 34](#); harlots, [B. 860](#). This term was not originally confined to
females, nor even to persons of bad character. W. *herlawd*, *herlod*, a youth;
herlodes, a damsel. Cf. “*harlotte* scurrus.” “Gerro a tryfelour or a harlott.”
Med. MS. Cant. “An *harlott*, balator, rusticus, gerror, mima, jocularor,
nugatur, scurrulus, manducus. An *harlottry*, lecacitas, inurbanitas,” etc. To
do harlottry, scurrari.” Cath. Ang. in Prompt. Parv.

“Ffore *harlottez* and *hause-mene* (house-men) salle helpe bott littille.”
(Morte Arthure, p. 229.)

arlottrye, profane speaking, [B. 579](#).

arme, *sb.* wrong, sin, [A. 17](#); *pl.* *harmez*, harms, [C. 388](#).

armlez, guiltless, [A. 676](#), [725](#).

arpe, [A. 881](#).

arpen (*3d pers. pl. pres.*), play on the harp, [A. 881](#).

arporez, harpers, [A. 881](#).

157b

aspe, fasten, [A. 419](#); clothe, cover, [B. 381](#). O.N. *hespa*, a clasp, buckle. Cf.
“*haspyng* in armys.” T. B. 367.

aspede, hook, [C. 189](#). Cf. Dan. *haspe*, windlass, reel; *haspevinde* capstan of
a ship.

Hastif,

Hastyf, hasty, [C. 520](#).

Hastyfly,

Hastyly, hastily, quickly, [B. 200](#), [1150](#).

at, call, [B. 448](#). A.S. *hátan*, to call.

Hatel, } anger, [A. 200](#); fierce, [A. 227](#); keen, sharp, [B. 367](#), [481](#). S.Saxon,
 Hattel, } *hatel, hetel*, keen, sharp, bitter. A.S. *hétel*, fierce. O.Sax. *hatol*.
 A.S. *atol*, dire, cruel.

atere, clothing, garments, [B. 33](#). A.S. *hætern, hæter*, clothing, apparel.

aþel, man, literally noble, [A. 676](#); [B. 27](#), [409](#), [1597](#). A.S. *æthele*, noble;
ætheling, a ruler, man.

“Homer was holden *haithill* of dedis.”
 (T. B. 38.)

atte, is called, [A. 926](#); [B. 35](#).

aunte, practise, [C. 15](#). Fr. *hanter*, frequent, haunt, literally, to follow a certain course.

aeuke, hawk, [B. 537](#).

auen, haven, port, [B. 420](#).

auyng, condition, behaviour, [A. 450](#), [754](#).

aylsed, saluted, [A. 238](#); [B. 612](#), [814](#). See *Halse*. See T. B. 1792.

ayre, heir, [B. 666](#).

ayre3, shirts of horse-hair, hair-cloth, 158 sack-cloth, [C. 373](#). A.S. *héra*.

azerly, fitly, properly, [B. 18](#). This word occurs in the Ormulum under *hazherrlike*. O.N. *hægr*, dexter, facilis. Dan. *haage*, to please; *haagelig*, agreeable, acceptable.

ede, notice, [A. 1051](#).

ef, heaved, raised, [C. 219](#).

eke = eke, also, [A. 210](#).

elde, bend to, come to, [B. 1330](#). A.S. *healdan*; *hyldan*, incline, lean to. Dan. *helde*.

elde, *adv.* willingly, [A. 1193](#); *in helde*, in mind, in purpose, disposed,
[B. 1520](#).

eldeo, approached, [B. 39](#).

elde3, goes, walks, [B. 678](#).

“Þir brether *helid* ai forþ þair wai
 Þat to þair fader ful suith com þai.”
 (Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 29b.)

ele, safety, [A. 335](#); health, [C. 1099](#); pleasure, [B. 16](#). A.S. *hél*.

elle-hole, [B. 223](#).

ellen, of hell, [C. 306](#).

elme, [C. 149](#).

em, them, [C. 180](#).

emme, border, [A. 1001](#).

ende, gracious, [A. 612](#); [C. 398](#); pleasant, [B. 1083](#). Norse *hendt*, adapted; *hendug*. Dan. *hændig*, handy, dextrous. Cf. *hendly*, T. B. 1792.

endelayk, mildness, civility, [B. 860](#). Hard-*laike* occurs in T. B. 2213.

Heng,
Henge, hang, [B. 1584, 1734](#).

ens, hence, [C. 204](#).

158b

Hent, take, seize, receive, [A. 388, 669](#); [B. 151, 376, 883, 1150](#). O.N.
Hente, *henda*. A.S. *hentan*.

epe, heap, company. [B. 1775](#).

er, their, [A. 888](#).

ere, heir, [B. 52](#).

“Bede his doughter come downe and his *dere heire*.” (T. B. 389.)

ere, hair, [A. 210](#).

ere, company, [B. 409, 902](#). T. B. 6253. A.S. *here*, an army, host, etc.

ered, honoured, [B. 1086](#). A.S. *hérian*, to praise, commend.

Herken,
Herkne, hearken, [B. 193, 458](#).

erne3, brains, [A. 58](#). O.N. *hjarni*. Sw. *hjerna*.

erne3 = erne3, eagles, [B. 537](#).

ert, heart, [B. 1723](#).

ertte, hart, [B. 391, 535](#).

eruest, harvest, [B. 523](#).

ery, honour, praise, [B. 1527](#). See *hered*.

Herytage,

Heritage, [A. 417](#); [B. 652](#).

erȝe, harry, [A. 1179](#), [1294](#); drag out, [B. 178](#). Sc. *herry*; *harry*, rob, spoil, pillage. A.S. *hergian*, *herian*, to plunder, afflict, vex. Fr. *harrier*, provoke, molest. O.N. *heria*, to make an inroad on.

Hest,

Heste, command, [A. 633](#); [A. 94](#), [341](#); promise, [B. 1636](#).

ete, promise, vow, [A. 402](#); [A. 1346](#); [B. 336](#). O.N. *haeta*, to threaten. T. B. 240.

eter, rough, [C. 373](#). See T. B. 159 5254. N.Prov. *hetter*, *hitter*, eager, earnest.

eterly, quickly, greatly, fiercely, [A. 402](#); [A. 380](#), [1222](#); [B. 381](#), [477](#). See T. B. 3499.

epe, heath, [B. 535](#).

eþen, hence, [A. 231](#). O.N. *hëthan*. See T. B. 5115.

eþyng, scorn, contempt, [A. 579](#), [710](#); [B. 2](#). O.N. *háthung*. See T. B. 1753, 1818.

eue, heave, raise, [A. 314](#), [473](#). O.N. *hefia*.

eued, head, [A. 459](#), [465](#).

euen, raise, exalt, [A. 16](#); [A. 24](#), [506](#); increase, “*heuen þi hele*.” [B. 920](#). We also meet with the phrase to “*heuen harm*.”

“Qua folus lang wit uten turn,

Oft his fote sal find a spurn;

Reu his res þan sal he sare,

Or *heuen* his harme with foli mare.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 25a.)

euen-ryche, the kingdom of heaven, [A. 719](#); [C. 14](#).

euy, sorrowful, [A. 1180](#); [A. 2](#).

eyred, harried, dragged, pulled, [B. 1786](#). See *Herȝe*. “*Harryn*’ or *drawyn*’ trahicio, pertraho” (Prompt. Parv.)

eyred = heryed, honoured, [B. 1527](#). See *Hered*.

eȝe, high, lofty, [B. 1391](#), [1749](#).

hege, hasten, [B. 1584](#). See [Hyge](#).

Heȝt,
Heȝpe, height, [A. 1031](#); [B. 317](#).

Hide,
Hidde, hid, hidden, [B. 1600](#), [1628](#).

idor, fear, [C. 367](#). O.Fr. *hisdour*; *hidour*, dread.

159b

iled, covered, [B. 1397](#). A.S. *hēlan*, *hēlian*. Prov.E. *hele*, *hill*, *hile*, to cover.
O.N. *hylia*, to hide.

itte, to make for, [A. 289](#); come, [C. 479](#); [B. 380](#). O.N. *hitta*, to light on, find.

“Ȧi turne into Tessaile withouten tale more,
Hit up into a havyn all the hepe samyn.”
(T. B. 991.)

ize = high, loud, [B. 1564](#).

izly, greatly, [B. 920](#).

o, she, [A. 232](#), [233](#); [B. 659](#). A.S. *heo*. Prov.E. *hoo*.

o-besteȝ, she-heasts, [B. 337](#).

od, hood, [B. 34](#).

odleȝ, hoodless, [B. 643](#).

ofen, (*p.p.* of *heve*), exalted, raised, [B. 1711](#).

okyllen, beat, [B. 1267](#). Is this an error for *hollkyen*? See [Holkke](#).

ol, whole, [B. 102](#), [594](#).

ole-foted, [B. 538](#).

olde, dominion, [B. 1597](#).

olkke, thrust out, [B. 1222](#). The original meaning seems to be “to make hollow, dig out, pierce.” A.S. *holian*, to hollow; *hol*, *holh*, a hole. Cf. O.Sc. and O.E. *holket*, hollow; *holk*, dig out. Prov.E. *hulk*, to take out entrails of rabbits and hares (Baker). Sw. *holka*, *hulka*, to hollow.

olly, wholly, [B. 104](#), [1140](#).

olteȝ, woods, [A. 921](#). A.S. *holt*, wood, grove; “*holte woddes*,” T. B. 1351.

olȝe, hollow, [B. 1695](#). A.S. *holh*.
omly, familiar, domestic, [A. 1211](#).
ommes, hams, thighs, [B. 1541](#). O.N. *höm*, the back of the thigh.
onde, hand, [A. 49](#), [706](#); [B. 174](#).
ondel, handle, [B. 11](#).
ondelyng, *sb.* handling, [B. 1101](#).
ondelynge, *adv.* with hands, [A. 681](#).
onde-werk, handwork, [C. 496](#).
onde-whyle, a moment, [B. 1786](#). A.S. *hand-hwíl*; “in a *hond-while*,” T. B. 406.
one, to delay, abide, [A. 921](#). See Met. Hom., p. 129.
onest, [B. 14](#), [18](#).
onestly, [B. 134](#), [705](#).
onour, [A. 852](#); [B. 594](#).
onyseȝ, destroys, ruins, [B. 596](#). O.Fr. *honeison*, shame; *honnir*, to shame, blame, borrowed from Goth, *haunjan*. Ger. *höhn*.

“And Alexander alle that quile asperly rydis
To the grete flode of Granton, and it one a glance fyndes,
Or he was soȝt to the side ȝit sondird the qweryns,
His hors it *hunyschist* for evir, and he with hard schapid.”

(K. Alex. p. 102.)

ope, expect, think, suppose, [A. 142](#); [B. 663](#).

ores, theirs, [C. 14](#).

ores (?), [B. 1695](#).

ortyng, *sb.* hurting, harm, [B. 740](#).

orwed, unclean, [B. 335](#). A.S. *horwa*, *hóru*, dirt; *hyrwian*, to defile.

160b

oryed, hurried, [B. 883](#).

Hot,

Hote, angry, [B. 200](#).

ourlande, rolling, rushing, hurling, [C. 271](#).

ourle, wave, [C. 319](#).

ousehold, [B. 18](#).

oue, abide, [B. 927](#). W. *hofian*; *hofio*, to fluctuate, hover, suspend.

oueȝ, hovers, [B. 458](#), [485](#).

ouen, exalted, raised, [B. 206](#), [413](#), [1451](#).

ue, cry, voice, [A. 873](#).

Hue,

Huee, hue, complexion, [A. 842](#); [B. 1483](#).

uge, great, [B. 4](#), [1659](#).

unger, *vb.* [C. 19](#).

urkele, hang, [B. 150](#); rest, 406. The original meaning is to nestle, crouch, squat. N.Prov.E. *hurkle*, to squat, crouch, nestle. Du. *hurken*, to squat. O.N. *hruka*.

“Then come ther in a litill brid into his arme fleȝe,
And ther *hurkils* and hydis as sche were hande tame,
Fast scho flekirs about his fete, and fleȝtirs aboute.”

(K. Alex. p. 18.)

urlande, hurling, rushing, [B. 413](#), [1211](#).

urle, rush, [B. 44](#), [223](#), [376](#), [874](#), [1204](#); “hurlet out of houses,” T. B. 1365.

urrok, oar, [A. 419](#); [B. 185](#). Prov.E. *orruck*. “Orruck-holes, oar-drawing holes, as distinct from thole-pins, which are less used in our boats: *rykke*, to draw (Dan.). Compare English *rullocks*.” Norfolk 161 Words: Miss A. Gurney in Transactions of Philological Society for 1855, p. 34.

uyde, hide, [B. 915](#).

uyle, while, [A. 41](#).

we, hue, [A. 896](#); *hwes*, [B. 1119](#).

wed, coloured, [B. 1045](#).

yde, skin, [A. 1136](#).

yl-coppe, hill-top, [A. 791](#). See *Coppe*.

ynde = hende, courteous, [A. 909](#); [B. 1098](#).

yne, servants; *hinds*, [A. 505](#), [632](#), [1211](#). A.S. *hina*, *hine* (for *higna*, *higne*), a domestic. O.N. *hion*, family.

yre, *sb.* hire, wages, [A. 534](#), [539](#).

yre, *vb.* [A. 507](#), [560](#).

yrne, corner, [A. 1294](#); [B. 178](#). A.S. *hyrne*. “Hyd hom in houles and *hyrnys* aboute,” T. B. 1362.

ytte3, strives, seeks, [A. 132](#).

yue, hive, [B. 223](#).

yure, hire, [C. 56](#).

y3e, high grounds, heights, [B. 391](#).

Hy3e, high, [A. 39](#), [395](#); [A. 380](#); “on *hy3e*,” [A. 413](#); “*hy3e* trot,” quick
Hy3, pace, [B. 976](#).

y3e, hie, hasten, [A. 33](#), [392](#), [538](#); [B. 217](#). A.S. *higan*, *higian*.

y3e, labourer, servant, [B. 67](#). A.S. *higo*, a servant. See [Hine](#).

y3ly, greatly, [B. 1527](#).

y3t, named, called, promised, [A. 305](#), [950](#); [B. 24](#), [665](#), [1162](#).

yȝt, height, [A. 458](#); [B. 398](#).

yȝtled, ornamented, decorated, [B. 1290](#).

“He had a hatt on his hede *hiȝtild* o floures.”
(K. Alex. p. 155.)

I

brad, extended, reached, [B. 1693](#). See [Brayde](#).

hose, chosen, [A. 904](#).

lolatrye, [B. 1173](#).

k, same, [B. 1755](#).

le, bad, evil, [B. 577](#).

yche = alike, [A. 228](#), [975](#); [B. 161](#). A.S. *gelíc*.

nage, [B. 983](#).

ɪ-blande, together, [B. 885](#). Dan. *iblandt*. See [Bland](#).

ɪflokke, flock in, [B. 1767](#).

ɪlyche, alike, [A. 546](#), [603](#).

ɪ-melle, among, [A. 1127](#). This word is usually written *i-melle*. Icel. *á-milli*.

In-monge,

In-mongeȝ, among, amidst, [B. 278](#), [1485](#).

In-mydde,

In-myddeȝ, amidst, [B. 125](#), [1677](#).

ɪnocens, innocence, [A. 708](#).

Innoghe,

Innoȝe, enough, sufficiently, [A. 612](#), [625](#), [637](#); abundant, [C. 528](#).

ɪ-nome, taken in, [A. 703](#).

Innoscent,

Inoscente, innocent, [A. 666](#), [672](#), [684](#).

ɪobedyent, disobedient, [B. 237](#). Fr. *inobedient*.

l-seme, together, [A. 838](#). A.S. *gesome*. O.E. *ysome*.

l-stoundes, at times, [B. 1603](#).

l-strumente, [B. 1081](#).

l-syzt, opinion, [B. 1659](#).

l-e, wrath, [B. 572](#).

162

l-vysse, truly, indeed, [B. 84](#). A.S. *gewis*.

l-wyth, within, [A. 970](#).

J

l-cynth, [A. 1014](#).

l-nglande, muttering, [C. 90](#). O.Fr. *jangler*, to chatter.

l-pe, device, sin, [A. 272](#), [864](#); [B. 57](#). Fr. *japper*, to yelp, chatter. The original meaning of *jape* is in O.E. to deceive, to lie.

l-sper, [A. 999](#).

l-uele, a wicked wretch, a base fellow, [B. 1495](#). “*Javel*, Joppus, gerro.” (Prompt. Parv.)

“The Lieutenant of the Tower advising Sir Thomas Moor to put on worse cloaths at his execution, gives this reason, because he that is to have them is but a *javel*; to which Sir Thomas replied, shall I count him a *javel* who is to doe me so great a benefit.” —MS. Lansd. 1033, in Hall.)

l-aunte, giant, [B. 272](#).

Jolef, }
Jolyf, }
Joly, }

} handsome, happy, true, [A. 842](#), [929](#); [A. 300](#), [864](#); [B. 241](#).

l-parde, jeopardy, [A. 602](#).

l-styse, justice, judge, [B. 877](#).

l-urnay, [C. 355](#).

l-orked, slept, [C. 182](#).

Joy,
Joye, [A. 266](#).

oyfol, [A. 288](#).

oylez, joyless, sorrowful, [A. 252](#); [C. 146](#).

oyne, [B. 726](#).

oyned, [A. 1009](#); [B. 434](#).

oyned, enjoined, [A. 877](#); [B. 62](#), [355](#).

oynte, [B. 1540](#).

oyst, [B. 434](#).

162b

Juel,
Juele, jewel, [A. 249](#), [253](#), [278](#).

Jueler,
Juelere, jeweller, [A. 252](#), [264](#).

ielrye, jewelry, [B. 1309](#).

igge, judge, [A. 7](#), [804](#); [C. 224](#).

iggement, judgment, [B. 726](#).

Juis,
Juise, judgment, doom, [A. 726](#); [B. 224](#).

impred (? *Jumpre* from A.S. *geomer*, miserable, sad), trouble, [B. 491](#).

istyfyet, justified, [A. 700](#).

K

able, [B. 418](#).

ake, [B. 625](#), [635](#).

ark, sorrow, [C. 265](#). W. and Gael. *carc*, care.

arle, churl, [B. 208](#). See [Chorle](#).

art, [B. 1259](#).

ayrene, to go, [B. 945](#). See *Cayre*.

ayser, emperor, [B. 1593](#).

a3t, caught, [B. 1215](#).

ene, great, noble, [A. 839](#), [1593](#); sharp, [B. 1697](#).

enely, quickly, [B. 945](#).

enne, to know, make known, show, [A. 55](#); [A. 865](#), [1707](#); [B. 357](#). O.N. *kenna*.

Norse *kjenna*, to perceive by sense, recognise, observe.

ennest, keenest, [B. 1575](#).

epe, care for, regard, [B. 508](#).

erve, dig, [A. 512](#); cut, [A. 1104](#); rend, [B. 1582](#).

Kest,

Keste, contrive, [A. 1070](#), [1455](#); cast, [A. 66](#); [B. 414](#).

eue, depart, [A. 320](#).

eued, separated, [A. 981](#).

euer, recover, restore, [B. 1605](#), [1700](#).

163

eye, key, [B. 1438](#).

lubbe, club, [B. 1348](#).

lyffe3, cliffs, [A. 66](#), [74](#).

naue, knave, [A. 855](#); servant, [B. 801](#).

Knaue, }

Knaw, } } know; *knawen*, known, [A. 637](#); [B. 1435](#), [1575](#).

Knawe, }

nawlach, knowledge, [B. 1702](#); See T. B. 1083.

not, crowd, company, [A. 788](#).

nyt, knit, unite, establish, [B. 564](#).

ost, coast, border, [B. 912](#).

ote, house, [B. 801](#).

oynt = quaint, curious, crafty, [B. 1382](#).

rakke, sound, [B. 1403](#).

uy, kine, cows, [B. 1259](#).

Kyd, showed, proved, (*pret.* of *kythe*), [B. 23](#), [208](#). *Kyde*, as an *adj.* =
Kydde, renowned.

“This kyde realme.”

(T. B. 213.)

ylle, to strike, [B. 876](#). See T. B. 1211, 1213.

yndam, kingdom, [B. 1700](#).

ynde, nature, species, [B. 266](#), [505](#), [507](#).

Kyndely,
Kyndly, naturally, properly, [A. 1](#), 319.

ynne, conceive, [B. 1072](#). A.S. *cennan*, to conceive, beget.

ynned, kindled, [B. 915](#). O.N. *kynda*.

ynneȝ, “alle kynneȝ = of every kind,” [A. 1028](#).

yntly = kyndly, naturally, [A. 690](#).

yppe, take up, seize, [B. 1510](#). Prov.E. *kep*. O.N. *kippa*. A.S. 163b *cépan*. See
Robt. of Glouc. 125. Havelok the Dane, 2407. “*Kyppyn*’ idem quod
Hynton;” “*Kyppyng*e or *hyntyng*e (*hentyng*e, K. P.), Raptus.” (Prompt.
Parv.)

Kyrk,
Kyrke, church, temple, [A. 1061](#); [B. 1270](#).

yryous = curious, careful, particular, [B. 1109](#).

Kyst,
Kyste, chest, ark, [A. 449](#), [1438](#); [B. 159](#).

ype, show, exhibit, [A. 356](#); [A. 851](#), acknowledge, [B. 1368](#). A.S. *cíthan*, to
make known.

“Ye *kyþe* me *suche* kyndnes,”

(T. B. 557.)

Kyþ, city, land, region, [A. 1198](#); [A. 414](#), [571](#), [901](#), [912](#); [B. 18](#). A.S. *cyth*,
Kype, a region, home, native place.

“Ther was a kyng in þat coste þat þe *kithe* ought.”
(T. B. 103.)

yþyn (*gen. pl. of kype*), of cities, B. 1366.

L

about, *sb.* A. 634; *vb.* A. 504.

Lache, = latch, take, receive, A. 166; *lached*, received, A. 1186; taken,
Lachche, A. 266; reach, C. 322; “*lach* out,” take away, B. 425. A.S.
læccan.

ad, led, A. 801.

adde = lad, man (of inferior station), A. 36; B. 154. O.H.G. *laz*, libertinus.
Ger. *lasse*. Du. *laete*, a peasant.

adde-borde, larboard, C. 106.

addres, ladders, B. 1777.

ade, led, A. 1146.

164

adyly, A. 774.

adyschyp, A. 578.

afte, left, B. 1004.

aftern, (*3d pers. pl. pret.*) left, A. 622; C. 405.

Lake,

Llak, lake, deep, B. 438, 536.

akke, sin against, abuse, B. 723. Dan. and Sw. *lak*, fault, vice. Dan. *lakke*,
decay, decline.

Lalled, spoke, B. 153, 913. Dan. *lalle*, to prattle. Bavarian *lallen*, to speak

Laled, thick, talk. Gr. *λαλειν*, to talk.

ance, take, C. 350.

angage, language, B. 1556.

angour, sorrow, A. 357.

ansed (? *laused*), uttered, [A. 668](#); [B. 489](#). *Launch*, in the dialect of Worcestershire, signifies to cry out, groan.

ansed, ? quaked, [B. 957](#).

ante3 (? *lance3*), lentest, gavest, [B. 348](#).

antyrne, [A. 1047](#).

ape, lap, taste, [B. 1434](#). *Lape*, lape, taste (Baker's Northampton Glossary).

appe, *sb.* [A. 201](#). A.S. *læppa*, border, hem. "*Lappe*, skyrte (*lappe*, barme, K.). Gremium." (Prompt. Parv.)

"The word *lap*, according to many ancient writers, signified the skirt of a garment. Thus G. de Bibelsworth says,

'Car par deuant avez eskours (*lappes*),
Et d'en costé sont vos girouns (*sidgoren*).'

It denoted, likewise, the hinder skirt." (Way in Prompt. Parv.)

164b

apped, folded, clothed, [B. 175](#). See T. B. 236.

asched, [B. 707](#). ? became hot, lascivious.

asned = lessened, made smaller, [B. 438](#), [441](#).

asse, less, [A. 599](#), [600](#); [B. 1640](#).

aste, follow, [A. 1146](#); [C. 320](#). A.S. *last*, footstep. Goth, *laistjan*, to follow after.

aste, fault, crime, [C. 198](#).

astes, becomes faulty, [B. 1141](#). Dan. *last*, vice, fault. O.N. *löstr*. S.Sax. *last*, calumny, blame. Icel. *last*. Ger. *lästerung*, slander.

at, slow, late, [B. 1172](#). A.S. *læt*, slow, late. Cf. "*lat*-a foot, slow in moving." (Wilbraham's Cheshire Glossary.)

ape, to invite, [B. 81](#). A.S. *lathian*. O.Sax. *lathian*. O.N. *lada*. Prov.E. *lathe*, to invite. A.S. *lathu*, invitation. N.Prov.E. *lathing*, invitation.

auce, loosen, do away with (?), [B. 1589](#).

aue, law, [B. 723](#).

auande, pouring, flowing, [B. 366](#).

aue, pour out, [A. 607](#); [C. 154](#). A.S. *lafian*.

aunce³, branches (of trees), [A. 978](#).

aunde, an open space between woods, a park; *lawn*, [B. 1000](#), [1207](#). “*Saltus a lawnd.*” (Nominale MS.) Welsh *llan*. “*Lawnde* of a wode. *Saltus.*” (Prompt. Parv.) “*Indago*, a parke, a huntynge place, or a *launde.*” (Ortus.) “*Lande*, a *land* or *launde*, a wild untilled 165 shrubbie or bushy plaine.” (Cotg.) O.Fr. *lande*, *saltus*.

“Sythyne [he] wente into Wales wyth his wyes alle;
Sweys into Swaldye with his snelle houndes,
For to hunt at the hartes in thas hye *laundes.*”
(Morte Arthure, p. 6.)

awe, hill, [B. 992](#). Sc. *law*. A.S. *hlæw*, mound, mount. Goth. *hlaiw*.

awles, [C. 170](#).

ay, put down, [B. 1650](#).

ayke, *sb.* sport, play, amusement, [B. 122](#), [1053](#).

ayke, *vb.* to play, [B. 872](#). A.S. *lác*, play; *lácán*, to play.

ayke, device, [A. 274](#); [B. 401](#).

ayned, kept secret, [A. 244](#). N.Prov.E. *lane*, to hide. O.N. *leyna*.

ayth, vile, evil, [C. 401](#). A.S. *láth*, evil, harm; *láth*, hateful, evil; “*laithe hurtes*,” T. B. 1351.

ayte, seek, search, [B. 97](#), [1768](#). N.Prov.E. *late*. Icel. *leita*. Sw. *leta*, to look for; “*laytyng* aboute,” T. B. 2348.

azares, lepers, [B. 1093](#).

aze, laugh, [B. 653](#), [661](#).

La³te,
La³t, = laught, took, [A. 1128](#), [1205](#). See *Lache*.

e, shelter, [C. 277](#). A.S. *hleō*, shade, shelter. Cf. T. B. 2806. O.N. *hlja*, to protect. Cf. *Leeside* = the sheltered side of a ship.

“—— thar I the tell
Is the richt place and sted for 3our cite,
And of 3our travell ferm hald to rest in *le.*”
(G. Doug. vol. i. p. 152.)

165b

“Þe wicked alsua þe gode sal se,
Wit-in þair gamen stad and gle,

Þat þai þe sorfuller sal be,
Þat losen folili has þat *le*.” (i.e., heaven).

(“De Penis,” quoted in “Hampole’s Pricke of Conscience,” l. 4, p. xii.)

eauty, loyalty, [B. 1172](#).

ebarde, leopard, [B. 536](#).

echerye, [B. 1350](#).

Led,

Lede, man, person, [A. 542](#); [B. 412](#). A.S. *leód*, man.

Led,

Leede, people, nation, [B. 691](#), [772](#), [909](#). A.S. *leóde*, people, folk.

edden = leden, sound, [A. 878](#). Chaucer uses the word *leden* in the sense of *speech, language*. A.S. *hlyd*. O.N. *hliod*, a sound.

edisch, national, pertaining to a people or country, [B. 1556](#). S.Sax. *leodisce*.
See [Lede](#).

Leef, *adj.* dear, precious; *sb.* dear one, wife, [A. 266](#), [418](#); [B. 772](#), [939](#),

Lef, [1066](#). A.S. *leóf*.

efly, dear, beloved, [B. 977](#). A.S. *leóflíc*.

efsel, bower, house formed of leaves, [C. 448](#).

“By a lauryel ho (Dame Gaynour) lay, vndur a *lefe-sale*,
Of box and of barberè, byggyt ful bene.”

(The Anturs of Arther in Robson’s Met. Rom. p. 3, vi. 5.)

“With *lefsales* uppon lofte lustie and faire.”

(T. B. 337.)

A.S. *leaf*, a leaf, and *sel*, dwelling, hall. Sw. *löfsal*, a hut built of green boughs. *Levesel* (another form of *lefsel*) is used 166 by Chaucer (Reve’s Tale, 4059), but is left unexplained in the glossary to Wright’s edition. Tyrwhitt’s derivation of this term from A.S. *lefe*, folium, and *setl*, sedes, is certainly very near the mark. Cf. “*levecel* beforne a wyndowe, or other place. Umbraculum.” (Prompt. Parv.)

ege, liege, subject, [B. 94](#), [1174](#).

egioune, [A. 1121](#), [B. 1293](#).

el, true, [B. 425](#). “Leve this for *lell*.” T. B. 239.

elly, truly, faithfully, [A. 305](#); [B. 1066](#). See T. B. 420.

eme, glide away, [A. 358](#).

eme, shine, gleam, [A. 119](#), [1043](#); [B. 1273](#). A.S. *leóma*, a ray of light; *leóman*, to shine. See T. B. 699.

emman = leof-man, beloved one, mistress, [A. 763](#), [796](#), [805](#); [B. 1352](#). A.S. *leóf*, dear, and *man*. O.E. *leofmon*, a lover.

ene, grant, [C. 347](#). A.S. *lænian*.

enge, dwell, abide, [A. 261](#), [933](#); [A. 81](#), [412](#), [497](#), [994](#); [B. 42](#). See T. B. 1937.

enger, longer, [A. 600](#), [977](#); [A. 810](#); *lengest*, [B. 256](#).

enghe, length, [A. 416](#).

ent (*pret.* of *lend*), abode, dwelt, [A. 256](#); *watz lent*, had dwelt, [B. 1084](#).

ent, arrived, [C. 201](#). A.S. *gelandian*, to land, arrive.

“Langour *lent* is in land, all lychtnes is lost.”
(G. Douglas, vol. i. p. 447.)

enþe, length, [A. 1031](#); [B. 425](#), [1594](#).

166b

ep, leaped, [C. 179](#).

ere, to teach, [B. 843](#). A.S. *læran*

ere, reward, ? *here*, [A. 616](#).

Ler, countenance, [A. 398](#); *pl. lers*, features, [B. 1542](#) A.S. *hleor*. See T. B.
Lere, 480.

ese, false, [A. 865](#). See *Lese*.

esande, loosening, opening, [A. 837](#). O.E. *lese*, *les*, to loose. Goth. *lausjan*.

ese, false, [B. 1719](#). A.S. *leas*.

Lest,
Leste, lost, [A. 9](#); [B. 887](#).

esyng, *sb.* lie, [A. 897](#). A.S. *leasung*.

eþe, assuage, lessen, cease, bate, cool. [A. 377](#); [A. 648](#); [B. 3](#). A.S. *leothian*, to release, slacken. See Met. Hom. p. 135.

eþe, sb. calm, [C. 160](#). N.Prov.E. *leath*, rest, quiet. Stratmann compares O.Du. *lede*, ease, *leath*.

ether, leather, [B. 1581](#).

ette, hinder, prevent, [A. 1050](#); [B. 1803](#).

etter, [B. 1580](#).

ettrure, letters, learning, [A. 751](#).

eue, “*aske leue*,” [A. 316](#); “*take leue*,” [B. 401](#).

eue, forsake, [C. 401](#).

eue, believe, [A. 69](#), [865](#), [876](#); [B. 1493](#).

eued, leaved, [A. 978](#).

ewed, ignorant, [B. 1580](#). A.S. *leóde*, *leúd*, the people.

ik, to lick, [B. 1000](#).

ikke, sip, drink, [B. 1521](#).

iure3, dresses, garments, [A. 1108](#). O.Fr. *livree*.

ode, lot, [C. 156](#).

167

ode, course, conduct, guidance, [C. 504](#). A.S. *lád*, *ládu*, way. O.N. *leid*, course. Cf. *lode*, a way for water.

odesmon, conductor, pilot, [A. 424](#); [B. 179](#). A.S. *ládman*, a leader.

Lodly, loathsome, hateful, vile, [B. 274](#), [1090](#), [1093](#). N.Prov.E. *laidly*,

Lodlych, ugly, foul. A.S. *láthlíc*, odious, detestable.

“He laid on þat *loodly*, lettyd he noght.” (T. B. 934.)

ofly, dear, lovely, [B. 1804](#).

ofte, “*upon lofte*,” on high, [B. 206](#), [318](#), [808](#). O.N. *lopt*, sky, air.

Loge, tent, lodge, [A. 784](#), [807](#), [1407](#); [B. 457](#). Fr. *loge*, a hut. See T. B.

Logge, 1140, 1369.

ogging, lodging, [B. 887](#).

Loghe,

Lo3, = low, lau, pit, deep, abyss, [B. 366](#). O.N. *lagr*. Sw. *låg*, low.

okande, looking, [C. 458](#).

oke = loken, enclosed, [C. 350](#).

oke, guard, watch over, [C. 504](#).

okying, sb. sight, looking, [A. 1049](#).

oltrande, ? *loitrande*, lolling, loitering, [C. 458](#). Du. *loteren*, to loiter. O.N. *lotra*, to go lazily.

ombe, lamb, [A. 841](#), [1047](#).

ome, lame, [B. 1094](#).

ome, vessel, instrument of any kind; (1) ark; (2) boat, [A. 314](#), [412](#), [443](#); [B. 160](#). A.S. *gelóma*, *lóma*.

omerande, hesitating, creeping, 167b B. 1094. This term seems to be connected with *lumber*. O.E. *lumer*, *lomer*, to move heavily. O.Du. *lammer*, *lemmer*, impedimentum, molestia. (Kil.) Dan. *belemre*. Du. *belemmern*, to encumber, impede.

ompe, lamp, [A. 1046](#).

onde, land, [A. 148](#), [937](#).

one, path, lane, [A. 1066](#). N.Prov.E. *lone*, *lannin*. Fris. *lona*, *lana*, a narrow way between gardens and houses. Is it connected with O.N. *leyna*, to hide, conceal?

ongande, belonging, [A. 462](#).

onged, belonged, [B. 1090](#), [1747](#).

ont, land, [C. 322](#).

open (*p.p.* of *lepe*, to leap), leapt, [B. 990](#).

ore, wisdom, learning, [B. 1556](#). A.S. *lár*.

ore, mode, wise, [A. 236](#).

orn, lost, destroyed, [B. 932](#).

os, loss, [B. 1589](#).

ose, destroy, [A. 909](#); [C. 198](#); depart, be lost, [B. 908](#).

osed, lost, [B. 586](#).

osyng, perdition, [B. 1031](#).

osynger, *sb.* liar, deceiver. O.Fr. *losengier*.

Lot, } sound, noise, roar, [A. 876](#); [C. 161](#), [183](#); word, [B. 668](#). Sw. *låtå*, to
Lote, } sound; *låt*, sound; *lâte*, cry, voice. A.S. *hleóthor*, a sound, noise.
O.E. *lud*, voice. The original form of the word is *late*.

“Than have we liking to lithe (listen to) the *lates* of the foules.”
(K. Alex. p. 149.)

168

“(He) *late* so lathely a *late* and sa loude cried
That all the fest was aferd and othire folke bathe.”
(K. Alex. p. 17.)

“He gaped, he groned faste, with grucchande *latez*.”
(Morte Arthure, p. 90.)

ote = late, countenance, feature, form, manner, [A. 899](#); [C. 47](#). This word occurs in Lazamon under the form *late*, looks, glances. Glossarial remarks to Lazamon, p. 449. *Lete*, countenance, is found in the Owl and Nightingale, 35, 403. A.S. *wlite*. O.N. *læti*.

ote, lot, [A. 1205](#); [C. 173](#).

ote = lout, bow, [A. 238](#). A.S. *lútan*, to bend, bow, stoop. Sw. *luta*. See [T. B. 1900](#).

oþe, *sb.* sorrow, [A. 377](#). A.S. *láth*, evil, harm.

oþelych, wicked, bad, [B. 1350](#).

oute, abide, sit, [A. 933](#).

oute, bow, make obeisance. [B. 798](#). See [Lote](#).

ouande, praising, [B. 1719](#).

oue, praise, [A. 285](#), [1124](#), [1127](#); [B. 497](#), [987](#). A.S. *lofian*.

oue3, hands, [B. 987](#). N.Prov.E. *leuf*, palm of the hand, and hence used for the hand itself. *Palm* is used for the hand in early English authors. O.N. *lofi*. Sc. *loof*.

“(He) held the letter in his *love*.”
(K. Alex. p. 71.)

“——he takis
The licor in his awen (one) *loove*,
the letter in the tothire.”
(*Ibid.* l. 2569.)

oueloker, more lovely, [A. 148](#).

168b

ovne, offer (advice), propose, [C. 173](#). N.Prov.E. *loave*, *loff*, to offer. O.N. *lofa*, promise, praise. Du. *looven*. Flem. *loven*, estimate. Cf. “*Lovon and bedyn as chapmen, Licitor.*” (Prompt. Parv.)

ouy, love, [B. 841](#), [1053](#).

Louely,	}	
Louyely,	}	
Louyly,	}	lovely, A. 565 , 693 ; B. 1486 .
Louelych,	}	

owe, flame; “*luf lowe*,” flame of love, [B. 707](#). O.E. *logh* (see T. B. 168) “the *lowe hot*,” T. B. 494.

owkande, locking, shutting, [B. 441](#).

Lo3,
Lo3e, the deep, pit, sea, [A. 119](#); [A. 441](#), [1031](#); [B. 230](#). See *Loghe*.

o3, Lo3e, low, [B. 798](#), [1761](#).

o3ed, made low, abased, [B. 1650](#).

o3en, laughed (3rd pers. pl. pret. of *laze*, [B. 495](#).

o3ly, humbly, [B. 614](#), [745](#).

uche, pitch, throw, [C. 230](#). N.Prov.E. *lutch*, to pulsate strongly. W. *lluchio*, to fling, throw violently. Stratmann suggests A.S. *lyccan*, pull, lutch.

Ludych,
Ludisch, national, [B. 73](#), [1375](#). See *Ledisch*.

uf, *gen. sing.*, of love, [B. 707](#).

Lufly,	}	
Luflych,	}	lovely, A. 880 ; A. 81 ; 939 ; B. 419 .
Luflyly,	}	

ufsoum, *sb.* lovesome, beloved one, [A. 398](#).

uged, was pulled, [B. 443](#). O.N. *lugga*.

ulted, sounded, [B. 1207](#). O.N. *lulla*, to lull, sing to sleep. Cf. “*lullit* on slepe,” T. B. 648. Ger. *lallen*, to sing without words, only repeating the syllable *la*. N.Prov.E. *lilt*, to sing with a loud voice; *lilt*, a song.

uly-whit, lilly-white, [B. 977](#).

umpen, befallen, [B. 424](#), [1320](#). See *Lympe*.

ur, loss, [C. 419](#).

“What *lure* is of my lyfe & I lyffe here.”
(T. B. 582.)

ureȝ, losses, [A. 339](#), [358](#). A.S. *lyre*, *lor*.

Lurke,
Lurkke, [A. 978](#); [C. 277](#). See T. B. 1140.

usty, [B. 981](#).

uther, bad, wicked, [A. 163](#), [1090](#); [B. 156](#). A.S. *lyther*.

uuy, love. See *Louy*.

yf, life, [B. 1719](#).

yflode, sustenance in life, [B. 561](#). A.S. *lif-láde*, from *lád*, a way.

Lyft,
Lyfte, heavens, firmament, sky, [B. 212](#), [366](#), [1356](#), [1448](#). A.S. *lyft*.

yftande, lifting, rising, [B. 443](#).

yfte, raised, [A. 567](#).

yfte, left, [B. 981](#), [1581](#).

ygge, lie, [B. 1126](#), [1792](#). A.S. *licgan*.

yke, *vb.* *impers.* please, [A. 566](#); [B. 36](#), [411](#), [693](#), [1646](#).

yke, *adj.* pleasing, [C. 42](#).

ykker, more like, [C. 493](#).

ykneȝ, likens, compares, [A. 500](#); is like, [B. 1064](#).

yknyng, *sb.* likeness, [C. 30](#).

ykoreȝ, liquors, drinks, [B. 1521](#).

ykyng, *sb.* pleasure, [A. 247](#); [B. 172](#), [1803](#). See T. B. 2912.

ylled, flourished, shone, [C. 447](#). N.Prov.E. *lilli-lo*, a bright flame. Cf. Mod. Gr. λουλούδι, a blossom; λουλουδιαζω, to flourish, bloom. Is *lylle*, to flourish, connected with the word *lilly*?

ympe, befall, happen, [C. 174](#), [194](#). See T. B. 36. A.S. *limpan*, to happen, concern.

yne, lineage, [A. 626](#).

ynne, linen, [A. 731](#).

yre, flesh, [B. 1687](#). A.S. *lira*.

ysoun, trace, [B. 887](#).

Lyst, *sb.* pleasure, [A. 467](#), [908](#); [A. 843](#); lust, [A. 693](#); *vb.* desire, please, Lyste, [A. 146](#); [B. 415](#), [1766](#).

yst, path, border, [B. 1761](#). Du. *lijst*, edge, border.

ysten, to hear, [A. 880](#).

ysten, hearing, [B. 586](#). A.S. *hlist*, hearing; *hlistan*, to hear, listen. O.N. *hlust*, an ear.

yte, little, [B. 119](#).

yth, limb, [A. 398](#). A.S. *lith*.

yþe, assuage, lessen, [A. 357](#). See *Leþe*.

yþe, grant, [A. 369](#).

yþer, evil, wickedly, [A. 567](#). See *Luþer*.

yþerly, badly, negligently, [B. 36](#).

Lyuie,
Lyuy, *live*, [A. 558](#), [581](#); [B. 364](#).

yuyande, living, [A. 700](#).

yze, lie, [A. 304](#).

yzt, light, [A. 69](#), [1043](#); bright, [A. 500](#); innocent, guiltless, pure, [A. 682](#); [B. 987](#); *lette* 170 *lyzt*, esteem, treat lightly, [B. 1174](#), [1320](#).

Ly3t,
Ly3te, vb. to light, fall upon, [A. 247, 943, 988](#); [B. 213, 1069](#).

y3ten, to lighten, [C. 160](#).

y3tly, easily, [A. 358](#); soon, quickly, [A. 817, 853](#); [C. 88](#). Comp. *lyztloker*,
[B. 47](#).

M

Ia, make, [A. 283](#); [B. 625](#).

Ia, man (?), [A. 323](#).

Mach,
Machche, = make, fellow, companion, [B. 124, 695, 1512](#). See *Make*.

Iache, to make familiar with, [C. 99](#).

Mad, foolish, [A. 267, 290, 1166](#); [B. 654](#). Prov. Ger. *maden*, to tattle;
Madde, *madeln*, to mutter.

“Thi momlyng and thi *mad* wordes.”
(See T. B. 1864.)

Iadde, vb. to render foolish, [A. 359](#).

Iaddyng, folly, [A. 1154](#).

“*Madding* marrid has thi mode, and thi mynd changid.”
(K. Alex. p. 121.)

Mak, = mach, match, equal, fellow, wife, [A. 759](#); [B. 248, 331, 994](#). A.S.

Make, *maca*, a mate; *mace*, a wife.

“Þe king him (Joseph) did a wiif to tak,
Hight Assener, a doghti *mak*.”
(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 27a.)

Iakelez, matchless, [A. 435, 733, 757, 780](#).

Iale, [B. 337, 695](#).

Ialicious, [C. 508](#).

170b

Ialscrande, accursed, [B. 991](#).

lalskred, bewildered, [C. 255](#). Bosworth quotes “*malscra*, a bewitching,” upon the authority of Somner.

Malt,

Malte, ease, assuage, soothe, [B. 776](#), [1566](#). O.N. *melta*, to dissolve.

lalte, discourse, speak, [A. 224](#), [1154](#). A.S. *mælan*, to speak, converse; *mathelian*, *mæthlan*, to discourse.

Malyce,

Malys, [A. 250](#), [518](#); [B. 4](#).

Ian = maken (3d pers. pl. pres.), make, [A. 512](#).

Ianace, threaten, [C. 422](#).

Ianayre, manor, [A. 1029](#).

Iancioun, mansion, [B. 309](#).

Ianer, manner, [B. 701](#).

Ianer, manor, [A. 918](#).

Ianerly, properly, decently, [B. 91](#).

Iangerie, feast, [B. 52](#), [1365](#). Fr. *manger*, to eat, from Lat. *manducare*.

Iankyn, mankind, [A. 637](#).

Iansed, cursed, [A. 774](#); [B. 82](#). A.S. *a-mánsumian*, to excommunicate.

Iantyle, mantle, [C. 342](#).

Iarchal, marshal, [B. 91](#), [118](#).

Iare, more, [A. 145](#).

Margary,

Margyrye, pearl, [A. 199](#), [1037](#); [B. 556](#).

Iarie, marry, [B. 52](#).

Iarked, market, [A. 513](#).

Iarre, corrupt, spoil, destroy, perish, [A. 23](#); [A. 279](#), [991](#); [B. 172](#), [474](#). O.H.G. *marrjan*, to hinder, make void. A.S. *merran*, 171 *myrran*, to hinder. Du. *merren*, to obstruct.

Iarerez = marrez (?). [A. 382](#).

Maryag,
Maryage, [A. 414, 778; B. 186.](#)

laryed, married, [B. 815.](#)

larryng, *sb.* spoiling, preventing, [B. 186.](#)

larschal, [B. 1427.](#)

laryners, [C. 99.](#)

las, mass, [A. 1115.](#)

lascelleȝ, spotless, [A. 732.](#)

lascle, spot, [A. 726.](#) Du. *maese*, *masche*, *maschel*, a spot, stain; *maschelen*, to stain.

lase (masse), astonishment, alarm, [B. 395.](#)

Maskelleȝ,	{	spotless, A. 744, 745, 756, 768.
Maskelles,		
Maskelleȝ,		

laskle, spot, stain, [B. 556.](#) See [Mascle](#).

lasporye (?), [A. 1018.](#)

late, dejected, downcast, subdued, [A. 386.](#) Fr. *mat*.

late, to overcome, [A. 613.](#) Fr. *mater*. O.Fr. *amater*. Cf. Du. *mat*, exhausted, overcome. Ger. *matt*, feeble, faint.

later, subject, [B. 1617.](#)

latere, matter, [C. 503.](#)

Maugre,	{	C. 44, 54. Fr. <i>malgré</i> , in spite of, against the will of; <i>mal</i> , ill; <i>gré</i> , will, pleasure. In B. 250 <i>mawgre</i> is used as a <i>sb.</i> = displeasure.
Maugref,		
Mawgre,		

lawe, stomach, [C. 255.](#) Ger. *magen*. Du. *maag*.

lay, maid. [A. 435, 780.](#) A.S. *mæg*.

laynful, great, powerful, [A. 1093;](#) 171b [B. 1730.](#) A.S. *mægen*, power, force, strength. O.N. *megin*, strength; *mega*, to be able.

laynly, loudly, [B. 1427.](#)

layntnaunce, maintenance, [B. 186](#).

layntyne, maintain, [C. 523](#).

layster, master, lord, [A. 462, 900](#); [B. 1793](#).

laysterful, powerful, [A. 401](#); [B. 1328](#).

laystery, mastery, [C. 482](#).

lazt, power, [C. 112](#). Goth. *mahts*. Ger. *macht*, might, power.

lazty, mighty, [B. 273, 279](#).

laztyly, mightily, [B. 1267](#).

lede = meed, reward, [B. 1632](#).

ledoes, meadows, [B. 1761](#).

legre, meagre, lean, [B. 1198](#). Fr. *maigre*. Lat. *macer*, lean.

lekne, make meek, [B. 1328](#).

lele, meal, [B. 625](#).

lele, *sb.* discourse, [A. 23](#).

lele, *vb.* to talk, relate, say, [A. 497, 589](#); [A. 736](#); [B. 10](#).

“To *mele* of this mater.” (T. B. 209.)

lelle, speak, [A. 797](#). See *Malte*.

lembrez, members, [A. 458](#).

lendes, amends, [A. 351](#).

lendyng, *sb.* improvement, repentance, [A. 452](#); [B. 764](#).

lene, general, common, [B. 1241](#). A.S. *gemæne*. Ger. *gemein*.

lene, mean, [A. 293](#).

lene, tell, explain, [B. 1635](#). A.S. *mænan*, to tell.

Meng,

Menge,

mix, join, [B. 337, 625](#). A.S. *mengan*.

Mensk, *sb.* honour, [A. 162, 783](#); [A. 121, 522](#); thanks, [B. 646](#); *vb.* to

Menske, honour, 172 [B. 141, 1740](#). A.S. *mennisc*, human. N.Prov.E.

mense, to grace, deck; *mense*, decency, good manners.

lensked, honoured, [B. 118](#).

lenteene, maintain, [A. 783](#).

lercy, [A. 576](#), [623](#).

lercyable, merciful, [A. 1113](#); [B. 238](#).

lercyles, [B. 250](#).

lere = meer, boundary, [A. 778](#); [B. 320](#). Du. *meere*. O.N. *mæri*, boundary.

lere, sea, lake, stream, [A. 140](#), [158](#), [1166](#); [A. 991](#); [B. 112](#). A.S. *mere*. O.Sax. *meri*. O.N. *mar*.

lerit, [B. 613](#).

lerk, *adj.* dark, obscure, [B. 1617](#).

lerk, *sb.* darkness, [A. 894](#); [B. 291](#). A.S. *myrc*, dark. O.N. *myrkr*, darkness; *myrka*, to darken, grow dark.

lerke, make, devise, order, place, [B. 558](#), [637](#), [1487](#), [1617](#). A.S. *mearcian*. O.N. *merkia*, to mark, perceive, signify.

lersy, [A. 383](#); [B. 776](#).

Meruayle,

Merwayle, *adj.* marvellous, [A. 81](#); *sb.* a marvel, [C. 1081](#), [1130](#); [B. 586](#).

Ieruelous, [A. 1166](#).

Iery, pleasant, [B. 1760](#).

Ies, [A. 862](#). See *Messe*.

Iessage, [A. 454](#); [B. 81](#).

Ieschef, evil, misfortune, [A. 275](#); [B. 373](#), [1164](#).

Iese, moderate, temper, assuage, [B. 764](#). See *Methe*.

“Sir Pylate mefe you now no more,
But *mese* youre hart, and mend youre mode.”
(Town. Myst. p. 175.)

172b

“Kyng Eolus set hie apon his chare,
With ceptoure in hand, thar muyd
(mood) to *meys* and stille.”
(G. Douglas, vol. i. p. 27.)

“The blastis *mesit*.”
(*Ibid.* p. 130.)

“A *mes* you of malice,
but a mene qwile.”

(T. B. 12842.)

lesse, mass, service, [A. 497](#).

lesse₃, messes (of meat), [B. 637](#).

lester, need, [A. 67](#); [B. 342](#).

lesure, measure, moderation, [A. 224](#); [A. 215](#), [247](#), [565](#); [B. 295](#).

lesurable, mild, temperate, [B. 859](#).

letalles, [B. 1513](#).

lete, meat, food, applied to an apple, [A. 641](#).

leten, to measure, [A. 1032](#).

Meth,

Mepe, moderation, mildness, pity, [B. 247](#), [436](#), [565](#).

“And Mari ledd hir life with *methe*
In a toun that hiht Nazarethe.”

(Met. Hom. p. 107.)

A.S. *mæthian*, to measure, estimate, use gently; *mæth*, measure, degree;
mæthlic, kind, courteous. N.Prov.E. *needless*, without measure,
immoderate.

lepele₃, immoderate, [B. 273](#).

lette, measure, [B. 625](#).

let₃ = mese (?), pity, [B. 215](#).

leuande, moving, [B. 783](#).

leue, move, [A. 156](#); [B. 303](#).

leuen (3rd pers. pl. pres.), move, [A. 64](#). See T. B. 384.

leyny, labourers, servants, [A. 542](#); household, [A. 331](#); company, [A. 892](#), [899](#),
[925](#); [A. 454](#); [B. 10](#).

liry, pleasant, [C. 32](#).

lisschapien (monstrous), wicked, [B. 1355](#).

173

listrauthe, unbelief, [B. 996](#).

lo, more, [A. 870](#), [1194](#); [B. 674](#).

Mod,
Mode, = mood, pride, [A. 401, 738](#); [B. 565, 764](#).

Ioder, mother, [A. 435](#).

Modey,
Mody, = proud, haughty, [A. 1303](#); [B. 422](#).

Iokke, muck, dirt, [A. 905](#).

Iol = mul, dust, [A. 382](#). Flem. *mul*, *gemul*, dust. Du. *mullen*, to crumble. Pl.
D. *mull*, loose earth, dust. Cf. “peat-*mull*,” the dust and fragments of peat.
(Brockett.)

Iolde, earth, [A. 279](#); *moldez*, lands, [A. 454](#); “*on molde*,” on earth, [A. 514, 1114](#); “*in molde*,” in earth, [B. 494](#). A.S. *molde*, mould, earth. Goth. *mulda*. O.H.G. *molta*. Dan. *muld*.

“Loo! here the ducheze dere to daye was cho takyne,
Depe dolvene and dede, dyked *in molde*.”
(Morte Arthure, p. 82.)

Ion, man, [A. 310](#).

Ion, moan, sorrow, [A. 374](#).

Ione, moon, [A. 923](#).

Ionkynd, mankind, [B. 564](#).

Ion-sworne, perjury, [B. 182](#). Other forms of this word are *main-sworn*, *man-sworn*. O.H.Ger. *meinsweridi*, perjury, from *main*, *mein*, spot, stain, injury, impure, bad. O.N. *mein*, sore, crime.

Iony, many, [A. 572](#); [B. 1164](#).

Ionyth, month, [B. 493](#), [1030](#).

Ioan, moan, sorrow, [B. 373](#).

Ioote = mote, spot, blemish, [A. 948](#).

173b

Ior, moor, [B. 385](#), [1673](#). A.S. *mór*, a moor, heath.

Iorehond, more, [A. 475](#). Cf. *nerehande*, near; *betuixande*, betwixt.

Morn,

Morne, morning, [A. 493](#); morrow, [B. 1001](#).

Iornyf, mournful, [A. 386](#).

Iornyng, *sb.* mourning, [A. 262](#).

Iorteres, mortars, [B. 1487](#).

Most,

Moste, greatest, [B. 254](#), [385](#).

Iot, must, may, [A. 397](#), [663](#).

Mot,

Mote, spot, blemish, sin, [A. 764](#), [843](#), [855](#). Du. *mot*, dust.

Iote, *vb.* speak to, [A. 613](#). A.S. *mótian*, to moot, debate. Then Medea with mowthe *motys* thus agayne. T. B. 610.

lote, building, dwelling, abode, [A. 142, 936, 937, 948, 949](#); city, [C. 422](#).

Mote signifies a hill, mound, moat, and hence a city on a hill (?). Mid. Lat. *mota*, hill or mound. O.Fr. *mote*.

“Þe bryght ceté of heven is large and brade,
Of whilk may na comparyson be made
Tille na ceté þat on erth may stand,
Ffor it was never made with mans hand.
Bot yhit, als I ymagyn in my thoght,
I lyken it tylle a ceté þat war wroght
Of gold, of precyouse stones sere,
Opon a *mote*, sett of berylle clere,
With walles, and wardes, and turrets,
And entré, and yhates, and garrettes.”

(Hampole’s *Pricke of Conscience*, p. 239, l. 8896.)

MS. Lansd. 348, reads *mount* for *mote*.

174

Moteles,

Motelez, spotless, [A. 899](#).

loul = mould, earth, [A. 23](#).

loun (3rd pers. pl. of *mowe*, to be able), are able, [A. 536](#).

lount, [A. 868](#); [B. 447](#).

lountaunce, amount, [C. 456](#).

lountayne, [B. 385](#).

Mountes,

Mountez, = amounts, avails, [A. 351](#); [C. 332](#).

lourkenes, *mirkens*, becomes dark, [B. 1760](#). O.N. *myrka*, to darken, Dan. *mörkne*.

lourkne, to rot, become rotten, [B. 407](#). From this verb is derived the O.E. *morkin*, a dead beast, carrion, a scarecrow. O.N. *morkinn*, rotten; *morkna*, to rot.

lourne, to mourn, [C. 508](#).

lozt, might, could, [B. 1108, 1668](#).

ludde, [B. 407](#).

lukel, great, [B. 52, 366, 1164](#). O.N. *mikill*.

lul, dust, dirt, [A. 905](#); [B. 736](#). See [Mol.](#)

lultyplyed, [B. 278](#).

lun, [C. 44](#). This may be another form of *mon* = moan. But the phrase “*maugre his mun*,” leads us to reject this interpretation. *Maugre* is generally used with some part of the body, as “*mawgre his tethe*,” “*maugre his chekes*,” etc. *Mun* may therefore signify the mouth. (Sw. *mun*, a mouth.) The term is still retained in the north of England. Halliwell quotes the following: 174b

“A common cry at Coventry on Good Friday is—
‘One a penny, two a penny, hot cross buns,
Butter them and sugar them and put them in your *muns*.’”

lunster = minster, church, cathedral, temple, [A. 1267](#); [B. 268](#).

lunt, purpose, [A. 1161](#). N.Prov.E. *munt*, a hint. See [Mynt](#).

lurte, break, crush, [C. 150](#). Pl. D. *murten*, to crush. See [to-murte](#). In T. B. 4312 we have *myrte* = to crush. Bothe mawhownus & maumettes *myrtild* in peces.

lydde3, midst, [A. 740](#). See [In-mydde3](#).

lydney3t, midnight, [B. 894](#).

Iyke, *sb.* [B. 417](#). Cf. Du. *mik*. The crutches of a boat, which sustain the main boom or mast and sail when they are lowered for the convenience of rowing.

Iyke3, free labourers (?), [A. 572](#). A.S. *mecg*, a man. In the *Cursor Mundi*, Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 17, the angels are represented as speaking to Lot as follows:

“‘Has þou her,’ þai said, ‘ani man,
Sun or doghter, *mik* or mau,
To þe langand, or hei or lau
Þou lede þam suith out o þis tun
Ar þat hit be sunken don.’” But ? *be myke3* = he *myke3*, he chooses.

Iyne3, “*me myne3*,” I remember, [B. 25](#). A.S. *mynan*, to remember. O.N. *minna*.

Iynge, record, mention, [A. 855](#). A.S. *myngian*, to remind.

175

Iynne, recollect, remember, [A. 583](#); [B. 436](#), [771](#). See T. B. 1434. See [Myne3](#).

lynte, devise, purpose, [B. 1628](#). A.S. *myntan*, *myntian* to dispose, settle, appoint. “*Myntyn*’ or *amyn*’ towarde for to assayen. Attempto.” (Prompt. Parv.)

lynstralsy, [B. 121](#).

lynyster, minster, temple, [A. 1063](#).

lynystre, vb. [B. 644](#).

lyre, [B. 1114](#).

lyrþeȝ, joys, [A. 140](#).

lyrþeȝ, gladdens, [A. 862](#).

Myri, = merry, pleasant, [A. 23](#), [158](#); [A. 417](#), [804](#); *myryer*, [A. 850](#);

Myry, *myryest*, [B. 435](#).

lyryly, pleasantly, joyously, [B. 493](#).

Mys,

Mysse, wrong, sin, [A. 262](#); [C. 420](#).

lyserecorde, mercy, [A. 366](#).

lyse-tente, misunderstood, [A. 257](#).

lysse, to lose, [A. 329](#); [B. 189](#). O.N. *missa*, to lose. Du. *missen*, to fail, miss.

lysse, loss, grief, [A. 364](#).

lysseleue, unbelief, [B. 1230](#).

lysse-payed, displeased, [C. 399](#).

lysse-ȝeme, mis-use, [A. 322](#).

lyst, [B. 1760](#).

lyste, mysteries, secrets, (?), [A. 462](#).

lysterys, [A. 1194](#).

lyþe, to trouble, weary (?), [A. 359](#). A.S. *méthe*, wearied; *méth*, feeble.

lyȝt, might, [A. 630](#).

lyȝtes = mights, powers, [B. 644](#), [1699](#).

N

hadde = ne hadde, had not, [B. 404](#).

akeryne (*gen. pl. of naker*), [B. 1413](#); *naker*, *nacaire*, seems to signify a kettle-drum.

as = ne was, was not, [B. 727](#), [983](#).

ature, [A. 749](#).

auel, [C. 278](#).

aule, nail, [A. 459](#).

Naupele₃,
Nawpeles, nevertheless, [A. 877](#), [950](#).

Nauper,
Nawper, neither, [A. 1087](#); [B. 1226](#).

awhere, nowhere, [A. 534](#).

ay, refuse, deny, [B. 805](#).

ayed, refused, [B. 65](#).

ayt, use, employ, [B. 531](#). See T. B. 1038. A.S. *neotan*. O.N. *nyta*.

aytly, neatly, dexterously, [B. 480](#). See T. B. 2427. Nestor, a noble man, *naitest* in werre. T. B. 1038. N.Prov.E. *nately*, neatly.

a₃te, night, [A. 1203](#); [B. 484](#), [807](#), [1002](#).

e, nor, [B. 1226](#).

ece, niece, [A. 233](#).

edde, needed, [A. 1044](#); hem nedde = they needed.

Nede,
Nede₃, of necessity, [A. 344](#).

edle₃, needless, useless, [A. 381](#); [B. 220](#).

ee = ne, nor, [A. 262](#).

el, ne wille, will not, [B. 513](#).

em, took (*pret. of nimme*), [A. 802](#); [B. 505](#).

emme, name, [A. 997](#). See T. B. 152.

176

ente, ninth, [A. 1012](#).

ere, *ne were*, were not, [B. 21](#).

Nere,

Ner, near, nigh, [A. 286](#), [404](#); *wel ner*, nearly, [B. 1585](#).

erre, nearer, [A. 233](#); [C. 85](#).

esch, gently, [A. 606](#). A.S. *hnesc*, soft, tender.

eue, fist, hand, [B. 1537](#). N.Prov.E. *neve*, *neif*, a fist. O.N. *hnefi*.

euen, name, [B. 410](#), [1376](#), [1525](#). O.N. *nafn*, a name; *nefna*, to name.

Ne3,

Ne3e, nigh, near, [A. 528](#); [B. 803](#).

Ne3,

Ne3e, approach, [B. 32](#), [143](#), [805](#), [1016](#), [1754](#).

Ne3en,

ice, *adj.* foolish, [A. 1354](#); *sb.* [B. 1359](#). Fr. *nice*, foolish, simple.

if, *ne-if*, if not, [B. 30](#).

iye, trouble, [B. 1002](#).

oble, [A. 1097](#).

obley, nobleness, [B. 1091](#).

o-bot, only, [B. 1127](#). N.Prov.E. *no-bot*.

ok, nook, [C. 278](#).

olde, *ne wolde*, would not, [B. 805](#), [1091](#).

Nom,

Nome, took, [A. 587](#); [B. 1613](#); *pret.* of *nimme*, to take.

ome, name, [A. 872](#).

omen, seized, taken; *p.p.* of *nimme*, [A. 1281](#); [B. 360](#).

orne, entreat, ask, [B. 803](#). A.S. *gnornian*, to complain, murmur.

orture, nurture, [B. 1091](#).

ote, city, [A. 922](#); [B. 1233](#).

ote, devise, ordain, [A. 1651](#); [B. 220](#).

ote, device, purpose, [A. 155](#); 176b [B. 381](#), 727. A.S. *nota*, use, duty, employment; *notian*, to employ, use.

“The Bibel telles us openlye
Of Nembrot and his maistri,
Hou the fole that was wit him
Bigan to mak a tour that tim,
That suld reche to the lifte;
Bot Godd that skilfulli kan skift.
Mad them alle serely spekand,
That nan moht other understand,
And gert them lef thair wilgern werk,
Bot of thair *not* yet standes merk,
In Babilony the tour 3et standes,
That that folk mad wit thair handes.”

(Met. Hom. p. 61.)

“Mony noble for þe nonest to þe *note* gode.”

(T. B. 284.)

ote, [A. 879](#), [883](#).

otyng, device, devising, [B. 1354](#). See *Note*.

oumbre, number, [B. 1283](#), [1376](#).

oupe, now, [C. 414](#).

owpelese, nevertheless, [A. 889](#).

oye, trouble, annoy, [B. 1236](#).

Noys,

Noyse, [A. 849](#); [B. 490](#).

o3t, naught, nothing, [A. 520](#); [A. 888](#); not, [B. 106](#).

o3ty, bad, [B. 1359](#).

ummen (*p.p. nimme*), taken, [A. 1291](#); [B. 76](#).

urne, speak, say, [B. 669](#).

uye, displease, [B. 578](#).

uyed, troubled, [B. 1176](#).

Nw,
Nwe, new, [A. 527](#); anew, [A. 1079](#).

wy, wrath, [B. 301](#).

wyed, displeased, [B. 306](#).

ye, trouble, [A. 1376](#); nyes, troubles, [A. 1754](#); [B. 76](#).

yed, troubled, [B. 1603](#).

yf = ne if, if not, [B. 424](#).

177

yl, ne wyl, will not, [A. 1261](#); [B. 41](#).

ylt, ne wylt, wilt not, [C. 346](#).

Nym,
Nymme, take, [B. 481](#). A.S. *niman*.

ys, ne ys, is not, [A. 951](#).

yse, nice, dainty, [B. 824](#).

yteled, laboured, toiled, [B. 888](#). Prov.E. *nattle*, to endeavour, to be busy about trifles. O.E. *nyte*, to use, employ, enjoy. O.N. *nyta*.

y3e, nigh, [A. 484](#); *wel ny3e*, [B. 704](#).

Ny3t,
Ny3te, night, [A. 243](#); [B. 526](#).

O

beche, reverence, [B. 745](#). Prov. Fr. *obezir*.

bes, obey, [A. 886](#).

dde, (1) not even, [A. 426](#); (2) spotless, faultless, [B. 505](#). See T. B. 4401, 6157, 6172, 6179, 6189, 6194, 6198.

ddely, (a) alone, [A. 923](#); (b) nobly, [B. 698](#).

(b) "I Alexandre the aire and eldest childe hattene,
Of kyng Philip the fers, that fest am in Grece,
And of the quene Olimpades, the *oddest* under heven,
To all 3ow of Athenes, thus I etill my sages."

(K. Alex. p. 79.)

“For thai the mesure and the mett of alle the mulde couthe,
The sise of alle the grete see and of the gryme wawys,
Of the ordere of that *odde* home [heaven] that overe the aire hingis.”

(*Ibid.* p. 2.)

ke, oak, [B. 602](#).

177b

lipraunce, vanity, fondness for gay apparel, [B. 1349](#). Prov.E. *olypraunce*,
a merry making.

“Of tournamentys y preue thereynne
Seven poyntes of dedly synne;
Fyrst ys pryde, as þou wel wost
Avauntement, bobaunce and bost;
Of rych atyre ys here avaunce,
Prykyng here hors wyth *olypraunce*.”

(Robt. of Brunne’s *Handlyng Synne*, p. 145.)

n, an, [A. 9](#).

ne, alone, self, [B. 872](#), [923](#), [1669](#).

nelych, only, [B. 1749](#).

neȝ, once, [B. 801](#).

nhede, unity, concord, [B. 612](#).

n-hit, struck, inflamed with anger (?), [C. 411](#). A.S. *onhætan* to inflame, heat.

n-lofte, aloft, on high, [B. 692](#); 947.

n-ryȝt, aright, [B. 1513](#).

n-sydeȝ, aside, [C. 219](#).

n-wyde, about, [B. 1423](#).

n-yȝed, one-eyed, [B. 102](#).

rdaynt, ordained, [B. 237](#).

rdenaunce, ordinance, [B. 698](#).

rdure, filth, [B. 1092](#).

re, oar, [C. 218](#).

renge, orange, [B. 1044](#).

rgane, [B. 1081](#).

risoun, prayer, [C. 328](#).

rnemente, ornament, [B. 1799](#).

rppedly, quickly, [B. 623](#). N.Prov.E. *orput*, quick (at learning). Orped is generally derived from O.N. *verpa*, to throw; *p.p. orpinn*. But this etymology is very doubtful. Cf. “*Orpud*, audax, bellipotens.” (Prompt. Parv.)

ossed, showed, [C. 213](#). N.Prov.E. 178 *awse*, oss, to attempt, offer. W. *osi*.

“Quat and has thou ossed to Alexander
this *ayndain* (angry) wírdes.”

(K. Alex., p. 79.)

ste, host, army, [B. 1204](#).

þer, or, [A. 141](#).

uer-borde, [C. 157](#).

uer-brawden, covered over, [B. 1698](#).

uer-seyed, passed over, gone, [B. 1686](#).

uer-tan, overtaken, [C. 127](#).

uer-þwert, across, [B. 316](#), [1384](#).

uer-tok, [B. 1213](#).

uer-torne, past, [B. 1192](#).

uer-walte, overflowed, [B. 370](#).

uer-3ede, past, went, [B. 1753](#).

uerte, open, clear, [A. 593](#).

uerture, opening, [A. 218](#).

ure, prayer, [A. 690](#).

ut-borst, *vb.* outburst, [B. 1251](#).

ut-comlyng, a stranger, [B. 876](#). N.Prov.E. *out-cumling*, a foreigner, stranger.
The more usual form in early English is *comling*.

ut-dryf, drive out, [A. 777](#).

ut-fleme, banished, [A. 1177](#). See *Fleme*.

ut-kast, [B. 1679](#).

ut-sprent, outburst, [A. 1137](#).

ut-taken, excepted, [B. 1573](#).

ut-tulde, thrown out, [C. 231](#).

3e = owe, ought, [A. 552](#).

O3t,

O3te, vb. ought, [A. 341](#).

O3t,

O3te, pr. aught, [A. 274](#); [B. 663](#).

P

ace, passage, [A. 677](#).

178b

Pacience,

Pacyence, [A. 1](#), 36.

akke, pack, [B. 1282](#).

akke, company, [A. 929](#).

Palayce,

Palays, [B. 83](#), 1389, 1531.

ale, [A. 1004](#).

alle = pall, fine cloth, [B. 1384](#), 1637.

ane, a side, division of a building, [A. 1034](#). Lat. *pagina*, a leaf, any flat expanse. "A *pane*, piece or pannel of a wall, of wainscot, of a glasse window." (Cotg.) "*Pane* of a wall, *pan de mur*." (Palsg.)

anne, head, but we may read *paune*, paws, claws, [B. 1697](#).

apeiay = a popinjay, a parrot, [B. 1465](#). It. *papagallo*. O.Fr. *papegau*, *papegay*. Sp. *papagayo*, parrot.

arage, kindred, rank, nobleness, [A. 419](#); [B. 167](#). O.Fr. *parage*.

aramore3, paramours, lovers, [B. 700](#). Fr. *par amour*, by way of love.

araunter, peradventure, [A. 588](#).

archmen, parchment, [B. 1134](#).

are, cut, [B. 1408](#), [1536](#).

arform, perform, [A. 542](#); [B. 406](#).

arfyt, perfect, [A. 638](#).

arget, plaister of a wall, [B. 1536](#). “*Pariette* for walles, blanchissure.” (Palsg.)

arlatyk, paralytic, [B. 1095](#).

artle3, partless, portionless, [A. 335](#).

artrykes, partridges, [B. 57](#).

ass, surpass, [A. 428](#).

assage, journey, [C. 97](#).

179

assande, passing, [B. 1389](#).

asture, [C. 393](#).

ater, paternoster, [A. 485](#).

aume, palm, hand, [B. 1533](#), [1542](#).

Pay,

Paye, pleasure, [A. 1](#), [1164](#), [1176](#); [C. 99](#).

ay, please, [A. 1165](#), [1177](#).

ayment, [A. 598](#).

aynt, [A. 750](#).

ayre, pair, [B. 335](#).

ayre = appayre, become worse, fade, [B. 1124](#). Lat. *pejor*, worse. “To *appayre* to waxe worse.” (Palsg.)

ayred, impaired, [A. 246](#).

echche, sin, fault, [A. 841](#). Fr. *péché*.

Penance,

Penaunce, [A. 477](#).

ene3, pens, folds (for cattle), [B. 322](#).

enitotes, (? *Peritotes*), a kind of stone (the *peritot* or *peridot* Marsh),
[B. 1472](#).

enne, [B. 1724](#).

enne-fed, [B. 57](#).

ensyf, pensive, [A. 246](#).

ented, appertained, belonged to, [B. 1270](#).

eraunter, peradventure, [B. 43](#).

Pere,

Per, equal, peer, [A. 4](#); [B. 1214](#), [1336](#).

ere3, pears, [A. 104](#).

erile, [B. 856](#), [942](#).

erré, precious stones, jewelry, [A. 730](#); [B. 1117](#).

ertly = apertly, openly, [B. 244](#). See T. B. 1130. Cf. “*pert* wordes,” T. B. 977.

eryle, [A. 695](#); [C. 85](#).

179b

es, peace, [A. 952](#).

ich, pitch, [B. 1008](#).

ike = pick, pluck, [B. 1464](#).

innacle, [B. 1463](#).

ité, pity, [B. 232](#).

Pitously,

Pytosly, [A. 370](#), [798](#).

laned, [B. 310](#).

lanete, [A. 1075](#).

laster, [B. 1549](#).

lat, flat, [B. 1379](#).

lat, struck (*pret.* of *plette*, to strike), [B. 1265](#). A.S. *plættian*.

“Hwan he hauede him so schamed,
His hand (he) of *plat*, and yvele lamed.”
(Havelok the Dane, 2755.)

later, plate, platter, [B. 638](#).

lateȝ, [A. 1036](#).

lat-ful, brimful, [B. 83](#).

lattyng, *sb.* striking (or folding?), [B. 1542](#).

lay, [A. 261](#).

lay-fere, play-fellow, companion, [C. 45](#).

layn, *adj.* even, clear, [A. 178](#), [689](#); [A. 1068](#); [B. 439](#).

layn, *sb.* [A. 104](#), [122](#); [B. 1216](#).

layned, lamented, [A. 53](#), [242](#).

layneȝ, complains, [C. 376](#).

laynt, complaint, [A. 815](#).

lek, place, plot of ground, [B. 1379](#). “*Pleckke* or plott, porculetum.” (Prompt. Parv.) N.Prov.E. *pleck*. A.S. *plæc*.

“Se that the hare hathe be at pasture in grene corne, or in eny other *plek*.”

(Quoted by Way from MS. Harl. 5086, fol. 47.)

leny, to complain, [A. 549](#).

lete, demand, plead for, [A. 563](#).

180

leyn, mourn, [C. 371](#).

lontte, plant, [A. 104](#).

low, plough, [B. 68](#).

lyande, pliant, [C. 439](#).

lye, [A. 1039](#); [B. 196](#), [1385](#).

lyt, danger, fault, [A. 647](#); [A. 1494](#); [B. 114](#). A.S. *pliht*.

lyȝt, condition, [A. 1075](#); [B. 111](#).

obbel, pebble, [A. 117](#).

ole, pool, stream, [A. 117](#).

olle, poll, head, [B. 1265](#). Du. *polle*, *pol*, head, top, crown.

olmente, a kind of pottage, [B. 628](#). O.Fr. *polment*. Lat. *pulmentum*.

“*Pulmentarium* a *pulment*.” Nominale, MS.

“His brother (Jacob) he fand give—and his tent

To grayth a riche *pulment*.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 21a.)

Polyce,

Polyse, polish, [B. 1068](#), [1131](#), [1134](#).

oyle, poultry, [B. 57](#). Fr. *poule*, a hen; *poulet*, a chicken. Lat. *pullus*.

“*Polayle*, bryddys or fowlys, Altilis.” (Prompt. Parv.)

omgarnade, pomegranate, [B. 1466](#). Cf. Lat. *malum granatum*. It. *granata*.

Sp. *granada*.

oplande, rushing, foaming, [C. 319](#). N.Prov.E. *popple*, to tumble about with a quick motion. O.Sc. *pople*, to flow, rush.

“The wawis of the wild see apone the wallis betes,
The pure *populand* hurle passis it umby.”

(K. Alex. p. 40.)

“And on the stanys owt thar harnys [he] dang,
Quhil brayn and eyn and blude al *poplit* owt.”

(G. Douglas, vol. i. p. 167.)

180b

orchase, purchase, [A. 439](#).

orche, [B. 785](#).

ore, poor, [A. 873](#).

orfyl, hem, [A. 216](#). Fr. *pourfiler*, to work upon the edge, embroider; *fil*, a thread. O.E. *purfle*, to overlay with gems or gold. “*Purfyll* or hemme of a gowne, bort.” (Palsg.)

orpre, purple, [B. 1568](#).

orros, [B. 1772](#).

ort, gate, [A. 856](#); harbour, [B. 90](#).

ortale, [A. 1036](#).

ortray, [B. 700](#).

Poruay,

Poruaye, to provide, [A. 1502](#); [B. 36](#).

ossyble, [A. 452](#).

otage, [B. 638](#).

oursent, course, [A. 1035](#).

ourtray, [B. 1271](#). Fr. *pourtraire*.

ouer, power, [B. 1654](#).

Pouer,

Pouere, poor, [B. 615](#), [1074](#).

oueren (*pl.* of *pouer*), poor, [B. 127](#).

ouert, poverty, [C. 43](#).

ouerté, [C. 13](#).

owdered, [A. 44](#).

owleȝ, pools, [C. 310](#).

oyned, trimmed, ornamented, [A. 217](#).

oynt, *sb.* particle, [A. 891](#).

oyssened, [B. 1095](#).

oyntel, a style, [B. 1533](#).

ray, *sb.* prey, [A. 1297](#); *vb.* to plunder, [B. 1624](#).

rayse, [A. 301](#).

rece, press, [B. 880](#).

rechande, preaching, [B. 942](#).

Precios,

Precious, [A. 4](#), [216](#); [B. 1282](#).

181

relate, [A. 1249](#); [B. 389](#).

res, press, [A. 730](#); to press, [A. 957](#).

rese, praise, honour; “his *prese*, his *prys*,” [A. 419](#). Sp. *prez*, honour, glory. Fr. *prix*, value, worth, price.

“Fra þan forth heild Sir Moyses
Þis wandes bath in *pris* and *pres*.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 36a.)

Prese,
Pres, *sb.* press, [A. 1114](#); *vb.* [B. 1249](#).

Presens,
Presente, presence, [A. 389](#); [B. 8](#), [1496](#).

resent, *vb.* [B. 1217](#).

resonere, prisoner, [B. 1217](#).

rest, ready, [A. 147](#); [B. 303](#). Ital. *presto*.

restly, quickly, [B. 628](#).

resyous, [B. 1496](#).

retermynable, [A. 596](#).

reue, prove, [A. 983](#); [B. 704](#), [1748](#).

risoner, [B. 1297](#).

rofecie, [B. 1158](#), [1308](#).

rofere, [A. 235](#), [1200](#).

rofert, [B. 1463](#).

rofessye, [A. 821](#).

rofete, prophet, [A. 797](#).

roper, [A. 686](#).

roperitéz, properties, [A. 752](#).

ropery, [A. 446](#).

rophete, [A. 831](#); [B. 1300](#).

rosessyoun, procession, [A. 1096](#).

rouince, [B. 1300](#).

ruddest, proudest, [B. 1300](#).

rudly, proudly, [B. 1379](#), [1466](#). See T. B. 857.

ryce, chief, [B. 1308](#).

rymate, [B. 1570](#).

ryncipale, [B. 1531](#), [1781](#).

ryncipalté, dominion, [B. 1672](#), [1738](#).

Priys,

Prys, value, worth, [A. 272](#), [419](#), [755](#); [B. 1117](#). See *Prese*.

rysoun, [C. 79](#).

ryuely, [B. 238](#).

ryuy, [A. 12](#); *pryuyest*, [B. 1748](#).

ulde, pulled, [B. 1265](#).

ulle, draw, [B. 68](#).

ure, *adj.* [A. 227](#); [A. 704](#); *vb.* [B. 1116](#).

Purely,

Purly, [A. 1004](#); [B. 1660](#).

urpre, purple, [A. 1016](#).

ursaunt, a sergeant, [B. 1385](#). O.Fr. *pursuivant*.

ursue, [B. 1177](#).

urtraye, [B. 1465](#), [1536](#).

uryté, [B. 1074](#).

yche, pitch, fix, [B. 477](#).

ye, [B. 1465](#).

yked, adorned, [A. 1036](#).

ykeȝ, pick, choose, [A. 573](#).

yle, building, [A. 686](#).

yle, to rob, [B. 1270](#), [1282](#). Fr. *piller*, to rob.

ylere, pillar, [B. 1271](#).

yne, *vb.* to torment, [A. 1095](#); *sb.* pain, [B. 330](#). Du. *pijnen*, to torture.

yne = pynd, fasten, [C. 79](#). A.S. *pyndan*, to shut in.

ynkardine, ? *perre carnadine*, carnelian stone (Marsh), [B. 1472](#).

yony, [A. 44](#).

yτοςly, pitifully, [A. 370](#).

yty, [A. 1206](#).

y3t, fixed, placed (*pret.* of *pyche*), [A. 117](#), [228](#), [742](#); [B. 785](#).

182

Q

uat, what, [A. 293](#).

uat-kyn, what kind of, [A. 771](#).

uauende, flowing, waving, [B. 324](#).

uayle, *sb.* quail, [A. 1085](#).

uayntyse, wisdom, craft, [B. 1632](#). O.Fr. *accointer*, to make known; *coint*, informed, acquainted with. Lat. *cognitus*.

ued, *sb.* evil, crime, ill, [A. 567](#); [B. 4](#). Du. *kwaad*, bad. Pl. D. *quat*.

uelle, kill, [A. 799](#); [A. 324](#); subdue, [B. 4](#). A.S. *cwellan*.

ueme, *adj.* pleasing, [A. 1179](#). A.S. *cweman*, to please. Your *qweme* spouse, T. B. 634.

uen, when, [A. 40](#), [93](#), [232](#), [804](#).

uenche, [C. 4](#).

uere, where, [A. 65](#).

uery, [A. 803](#).

uest, [C. 39](#).

ueþer-so-euer, whether-so-ever, [A. 606](#).

uikken, [C. 471](#).

uo, who, [A. 747](#).

uo-so, who-so, [A. 1647](#); [B. 5](#).

uos, whose, [B. 1648](#).

uoynt, wise, [A. 889](#); [A. 160](#), [871](#); curious, [B. 1459](#). See [Quayntyse](#).

uoyntis, clothing, [B. 54](#). “*Quoyntyse*, yn gay floryschynge, or other lyke. Virilia.” (Prompt. Parv.)

uoyntyse, device, [C. 39](#). See [Quayntyse](#).

Quyck,

Quik, quick, living (*pl. quyke3*, [A. 1179](#); [A. 567](#)), [B. 324](#).

uyl, while, [B. 627](#).

182b

uYTE, requite, reward, [A. 595](#); [B. 1632](#).

uYTE, white, [A. 220](#), [842](#), [844](#).

R

aas = rase, rese, way, course, [A. 1167](#). A.S. *ræs*, way, course, race. Sw. *resa*.

ac, storm, vapour, [B. 433](#). N.Prov.E. *rack*, driving clouds, clouds driven along by the wind.

“A *rak* and a royde wynde rose in her saile.”
(T. B. 1984)

achche, proceed, go, [B. 619](#). A.S. *ræcan*, to reach, extend. O.H.G. *rechen*. N.Prov.E. *ratch*, stretch. Perhaps *rachche* is a softened form of *rayke* (Icel. *reika*, to go), to go. S.Sax. *ruchen*.

ad, frightened, [B. 1543](#). Sw. *raedd*, afraid. N.Prov.E. *rade*.

“In a *rad* haste.”

(T. B. 917.)

“Vn-to the gryselyche gost Syr Gauane is gone,
And rayket to hit in a res, for he was neuYr *radde*;
Rad was he neuYr 3ette, quoso ry3te redus.”

(The Anturs of Arther, p. 5; ix. 8, 9.)

adde, advised, [C. 406](#) (*pret.* of *rede*, to advise). See [Rede](#).

adly, readily, quickly. A.S. *rád*, ready, quick; *rádlice*, speedily.

“The sight of þat semely sanke in hir herte,
And rauysshed hir *radly* þe rest of hir sawle.”
(T. B. 462)

aft, bereft, took, (*pret.* of *reve*), [A. 1142](#), [1431](#); taken, [B. 1739](#). See [Reue](#).

ak, [C. 176](#). See [Rac](#).

183

akel, hasty, rash, [C. 526](#). N.Prov.E. *rackle*.

akente, chain (?), [C. 188](#). A.S. *raccenta*.

akke, [C. 139](#). See *Rac*.

amelande, fetid, filthy, [C. 279](#). Prov.E. *ram*, fetid; *rammely*, tall, rank; *ramel*, rubbish, dirt.

andeȝ, paths, borders, [A. 105](#). A.S. *rand*, *rond*, a border, rim, edge.

ank, strong, severe, [B. 233](#). Fris. *rank*, long-grown, rank. Dan. *rank*, upright. See T. B. 1392, 1879.

anker, rancour, [B. 756](#).

ape, blow, [B. 233](#). Sw. *rapp*.

apely, quickly, [A. 363](#), [1168](#). O.E. *rape*, haste. O.N. *rápa*, cursitare. In T. B. *rape* = to hasten (818).

asch, [A. 1167](#).

asp, [B. 1545](#), [1724](#).

asse, summit, top, [B. 446](#). N.Prov.E. *raise*, a mound, cairn. O.N. *reysa*.

atted, rent, ragged, [B. 144](#); from O.E. *ratte*, to tear, rend. N.Prov.E. *rats*, pieces, fragments. Fris. *rite*, tear, pull.

“Thane the Romainys relevyde that are ware rebuykkyde,
And alle *to-rattys* oure mene with theire risté horsses.”
(Morte Arthure, E. E. T. S. 2235.)

Raupe,

Rawpe, = ruth, pity, sorrow, [A. 858](#); [A. 233](#), [972](#); mercy, [B. 21](#).

aue, [A. 363](#), [665](#).

auen, [B. 455](#).

auyste, ravished, [A. 1088](#).

183b

awe, row, “vpon a *rawe*,” in a row, in order, [A. 545](#).

aweȝ, rows, borders, [A. 105](#).

aw-sylk, [B. 790](#).

axled, roused up, [A. 1174](#). A.S. *ræscian*, to shake, rustle. O.N. *ruska*. Sc. *rax*, to stretch.

ay, [A. 160](#).

aykande, going, flowing, [A. 112](#); [B. 382](#).

ayke, go, [A. 465](#), [671](#); [B. 89](#). O.N. *reka*. N.Prov.E. *rake*, to go about.

aynande, raining, [B. 382](#).

ayn-ryfte, rain-fissure, [B. 368](#).

aysoun, reason, cause, [A. 268](#); [C. 191](#).

Raȝt, afforded, extended (*pret.* of *rache*), [B. 561](#), [766](#), [1691](#). See
Raȝte, *Rachche*.

eame, realm, [B. 1316](#).

ebaude, ribald, [B. 873](#). Fr. *ribald*, from O.H.G. *hrúpa*, a prostitute. (Burguy.)

ebel, [B. 455](#).

ebounde, [B. 422](#).

ebuke, [A. 367](#).

ecen, tell, [A. 827](#). A.S. *recan*.

eche, reach, extend, [B. 10](#), [1369](#).

Rech,
Reche, reck, care, [A. 333](#); [B. 465](#). A.S. *récan*.

eche = reke, smoke, [B. 1009](#). A.S. *reác*.

ecorde, *sb.* [A. 831](#); *vb.* [B. 25](#).

ecoverer, recovery, [B. 394](#).

ede, *vb.* to counsel, advise, [A. 1346](#); explain, [B. 1578](#). A.S. *rædan*.

Redles,
Redeles, without counsel, uncertain, fearful, [A. 1197](#); [B. 502](#).

184

efete, feed, refresh, [A. 88](#); [C. 20](#).

eflayr, smell, [A. 46](#); odour, [B. 1079](#). Fr. *flairer*, to smell. Prov. Fr. *flairar*, to
smell, sniff.

efrayne, [B. 756](#).

eget, [A. 1064](#).

egretted, [A. 243](#).

egioun, [A. 1178](#); [B. 760, 964](#).

ehayte, cheer, [B. 127](#). O.Fr. *rehaïter*.

eiatéȝ, kingdoms, royalties, [A. 769](#). O.Fr. *reiauté* = *reialté*, royalty.

eken, beautiful, [A. 5, 906](#); joyous, [A. 92](#); merry, [A. 1082](#); pious, [A. 10, 738](#); wise, [B. 756](#). See Wright's *Lyrical Poems*, p. 27. A.S. *recan*. O.S. *recon*, to order, direct. Pl. D. *reken*, right, straight, orderly.

ekenly, nobly, princely, [B. 127, 1318](#).

ekken up, [A. 2](#).

elande, reeling, [C. 270](#).

ele, reel, roll, [C. 147](#).

Reles,

Relece, cessation, [A. 956](#); [B. 760](#).

eleue, [C. 323](#).

elusaunt, shining, [A. 159](#). O.Fr. *reluire*, to shine.

elygioun, [B. 7, 1156](#).

elyke, [B. 1156, 1269](#).

eme, realm, [A. 448, 735](#).

eme, lament, cry, [A. 858, 1181](#); [C. 502](#). A.S. *hreman*.

emembre, [C. 326](#).

emnaunt, remainder, [A. 1160](#); [B. 433](#).

emorde, grieved, [A. 364](#).

Remue,

Remwe, remove, [A. 427, 899](#); [B. 646, 1673](#).

184b

enay, reject, forsake, [A. 105](#); [B. 344](#).

Renge,

Rengne, reign, [B. 328, 1321](#).

engneȝ, courses, [B. 527](#). A.S. *ryne*, course.

enischche, foreign, strange, [B. 96](#). See [Runische](#).

Renk, a man, originally a warrior, [B. 7, 96, 766, 969](#). A.S. *rinc*. O.N.

Renke, *reckr*.

enne, run, [B. 527, 1392](#).

enoun, [A. 986, 1182](#).

enowleȝ, renews, [A. 1080](#).

enyschly, fiercely, [B. 1724](#). See [Runische](#).

eparde, kept back, [A. 611](#).

epayre, vb. [A. 1028](#).

epente, [A. 662](#).

epreue, reprove, [A. 544](#).

equeste, [A. 281](#).

ere, rise, [A. 366, 423; A. 188](#); raise, [C. 873](#); proceed, [B. 160](#).

ert, if not *rered*, raised = *ert*, powerful, [A. 591](#). Cf. *ertid*. T. B. 2641, 4841.

es, onset, assault, [B. 1782](#). See [Raas](#).

eset, resting place, seat, abode, [A. 1067](#).

Resonabele,

Resounable, [A. 523; B. 724](#).

esoun, [A. 665, 716; B. 1633](#).

especte, “in respecte of,” [A. 84](#).

espyt, [A. 644](#).

esse, “on resse,” in course, [A. 874](#). See [Raas](#).

estay, keep back, restrain, [A. 716, 1168](#).

estleȝ = restless, unceasing, [B. 527](#).

185

estore, [A. 659; B. 1705](#).

etrete, treat of, [A. 92](#).

eue, bereave, [C. 487](#). A.S. *refian*, *reafian*. O.Fris. *râva*.

euel, [B. 1369](#).

euer, river, [A. 105](#).

Reuerence,

Reverens, [B. 10, 1318](#).

ewarde, [A. 604](#).

ewfully, sorrowfully, [A. 1181](#).

ewled, ruled, ordered, [B. 294](#).

eynyeȝ, reins, [B. 592](#).

eȝtful, rightful, [B. 724](#).

ial, royal, [B. 1082](#).

ialté, royalty, [B. 1321](#).

idlande, dropping (as out of a sieve), oozing, [B. 953](#). A.S. *hriddel*, a sieve;
hridrian, to sift.

iboudrye, ribaldry, [B. 184](#).

igge, back, [C. 379](#). A.S. *hrycg*.

ifteȝ, pieces, fragments, [B. 964](#).

ing = rink, man, [B. 592](#). See *Renk*.

obbor, [B. 1269](#).

oborrye, [B. 184](#).

oche, rock, [B. 537](#).

ode, cross, [A. 705](#); [C. 96](#).

ok, crowd, throng, [B. 1514](#). Sc. *rok*. O.Sw. *rok*, cumulus.

ollande, curly, waving, [B. 790](#).

ome = roam, go, [C. 52](#).

omy, roar, howl, [B. 1543](#). A.S. *reomian*, to cry out. O.E. *rome*. Sc. *rame*. Sw.
raama.

onk = rank, fine, [A. 844](#); bold, [A. 1167](#); [A. 490](#); bad, [A. 455, 760](#); full grown,
[C. 869](#); sb. boldness, [B. 298](#).

onkly, fiercely, [C. 431](#).

op, rope, [C. 150](#).

185b

op, gut, intestine, [C. 270](#). N.Prov.E. *ropp*s, the guts. A.S. *roppas*, the bowels, entrails, the *raps*. Cf. A.S. *rop-weorc*, the colic.

“Huervore he (the liar) is ase the gamelos (chameleon), thet leveth by the eyr, and naȝt ne heth ine his *roppes* bote wynd, and heth ech manere colour, thet ne heth non (of) his oȝen.”

(The Ayenbite of Inwyt, E. E. T. S. p. 62.)

ore, roar, cry, [B. 390](#), [1543](#).

ose, praise, [B. 1371](#). Sc. *ruse*. Sw. *rosa*. Dan. *rose*, to praise.

Rot,

Rote, root, [A. 26](#).

ote, *sb.* rot, decay, [B. 1079](#).

ote, lyre of seven strings, [B. 1082](#). O.H.G. *hrotta*. M.H.G. *rotte*. W. *crwth*. Eng. *crowd*.

opeled, prepared, [A. 59](#); rushed, hastened, [B. 890](#). A.S. *hrathian*, to be quick. Or from Welsh *rhuthr*, a sudden gust, onset, assault. Lanc. *rhute*, passion. Sc. *ruther*, uproar.

oþer, rudder, [B. 419](#).

oþun, rush, [B. 1009](#). See *Ropeled*.

oum, room, [B. 96](#).

oun = rune, discourse, [C. 514](#). A.S. *rún*, a letter, character, mystery, council, conversation.

ourde, sound, [A. 112](#). A.S. *reord*, *reard*, speech, language.

oute, snore, [C. 186](#). Fr. *router*. O.N. *rauta*, to roar, bellow.

“Dormiendo sonare, Anglice to *rowtyn*.”
(MS. Bibl. Reg. 12 B. i. f. 88.)

ownande, murmuring, [A. 112](#).

186

owned, sounded, [C. 64](#). A.S. *rúnian*, to whisper.

owtande, rushing, [B. 354](#). “A *routond* rayn,” T. B. 1986.

owte, company, band, host, [B. 969](#), [1197](#), [1782](#).

owwe, row, [C. 216](#).

oyl, royal, [B. 790](#).

Ro3,

Ro3e, rough, [A. 382](#), [1724](#); [A. 139](#), [147](#); roughness, [C. 1545](#); [B. 144](#).

o3ly, roughly, [B. 433](#). Is it an error for *rwly*, sorrowful?

o3t, cared for (*pret.* of *reche*), [C. 460](#).

uchen, fettle, set in order, [C. 101](#). M.H.G. *rechen*. O.S. *recon*. A.S. *recan*, to order, direct.

“(He) *riches* him radly to ride and remowis his ost.”
(K. Alex. p. 172.)

“[The king] Ricchis his reynys.”
(T. B. 1231.)

uddon, light, literally redness, [B. 893](#). O.N. *rodna*, rubescere, erubescere; *rodi*, rubor, rubigo. Prov.E. *roaded*, *rody*, streaked.

udnyng, ? lightning, [C. 139](#). See *Ruddon*.

ueled, rushed, [B. 953](#). O.N. *hrolla*. Dan. *rulle*.

uful, sorrowful, pitiful, [A. 916](#).

unnen (*p.p.* of *rinne*), run, [A. 26](#), [874](#).

unisch, strange, [B. 1545](#). A.S. *rénisc*, hidden; from *rún*, a mystery.

unyschly, fiercely, roughly, [C. 191](#). *Renisch* or *runisch*, signifies not only strange but fierce, 186b rough. N.Prov.E. *rennish*, *rinnish*, furious.

“Than has sire Dary dedeyne and derfely he lokes;
Rysys him up *renysche* and re3t in his sete.”
(K. Alex. p. 100.)

urd, cry, noise, [A. 390](#); [B. 64](#). A.S. *reord*.

uþe, arouse, [B. 895](#), [1208](#). See *Ropeled*.

uyt, hasten, endeavour, [C. 216](#). Fris. *rite*, to pull.

we, to pity, [C. 176](#), [502](#); vb. *impers. rwe*, repent, [B. 290](#), [561](#). A.S. *hreówan*, to rue, repent, grieve; *hreówian*, to be sorry for.

wly = ruly, sorrowfully, piteously, [A. 390](#); [B. 96](#).

yal, royal, [A. 160](#); [B. 786](#).

yally, royally, [A. 987](#); [B. 812](#).

ybaude, ribald, [C. 96](#).

ybe, ruby, [A. 1007](#).

ychē, kingdom, [A. 601](#), [722](#). A.S. *ríce*.

ychē, rich, [A. 770](#).

ydelande, drifting, [C. 254](#). See *Ridlande*.

ydelles, without counsel, uncertain, [B. 969](#). See *Redeles*.

yf = rife, abundant, plentiful, [A. 770](#), [844](#). A.S. *ryf*, frequent. O.N. *rifr*.

“Forþi he hight (promised) þam giftes *riif*,
þat suld bring David of his liif;
In feild and tun, in frith and felle,
Saul soght David for to quelle.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 43a.)

Ryg, rain, torrent, shower, [B. 354](#), [382](#). O.N. *hregg*. A.S. *racu*. N.Prov.E.

Ryge, *rag*.

187

yngande, ringing, [B. 1082](#).

ynk, man, [C. 216](#). See *Renk*.

ypande, searching, trying, [B. 592](#). O.E. *rype*, to probe, plunder. A.S. *rypan*; N.Prov.E. to investigate.

“Now if ye have suspowse to Gille or to me,
Com and *rype* oure howse, and then may ye se who had hir.”
(Town. Myst. p. 112.)

See State Papers, i. 295.

ysed, rose, [B. 1778](#).

yth, a hound, mastiff, [B. 1543](#). A.S. *riththa*, a mastiff.

y3t, right, [A. 622](#).

y3twys, righteous, right, [A. 675](#); [C. 490](#).

y3twysly, aright, [A. 709](#).

S

Sacrafyce,

Sacrefyce, [A. 510, 1447](#); [B. 239](#).

Sad,

Sade,

Sadde,

} sad, staid, solemn, [A. 211, 887](#); [A. 595](#); long, [A. 1286](#); bitter,
B. 525.

adele, saddle, [B. 1213](#).

adly, soundly, heavily, [C. 442](#).

af, safe, secure, [A. 672](#).

af, save, except, [B. 1749](#).

Saffer,

Safyre, sapphire, [A. 1002](#); [B. 1469](#).

age, [B. 1576](#).

aghe = saw, word, [A. 226](#). See *Saw*.

ake, fault, [A. 800](#); [C. 84](#). A.S. *sacu*.

akerfyse, sacrifice, [A. 1064](#); [B. 507](#).

akle3 = sakeless, innocent, faultless, [B. 716](#). Sc. *sackless*. O.N. *saklaus*, innocent. See *Sake*.

187b

akred, hallowed, [B. 1139](#).

ale, hall, palace, [B. 120, 1260, 1722](#). A.S. *sal*. T. B. 1657.

amen, *adv.* together, at once, [A. 518](#); [A. 400, 468](#); *adj.* [B. 985](#). O.N. *saman*.

amen, to consort with, [B. 870](#). A.S. *samnian*, to assemble, collect.

amne, assemble, [B. 53](#).

amned, assembled, [B. 126, 361](#).
 amnes (*imp.* of *samne*), [C. 385](#).
 ample, example, [A. 499](#); [B. 1326](#).
 apyence, wisdom, [B. 1626](#).
 ardiner, sardine stone, [B. 1469](#).
 ardonyse, sardonyx, [A. 1006](#).
 arre (*comp.* of *sare*), sorer, more painful, [A. 1195](#); *superl.* *sarrest*, [B. 1078](#).
 attle, settle, [C. 409](#). N.Prov.E. *sattle*.
 Sau,
 Saue, = saw, word, [B. 1545](#).
 auce, [B. 823](#).
 audan, sultan, [B. 1323](#).
 Saule,
 Sawle, soul, [A. 461](#); [A. 290](#); [B. 325](#).
 aundyuer, sandever, glass-gall, [B. 1036](#).
 auter, psalter, [A. 677](#).
 auteray, psaltery, [B. 1516](#).
 aue, [A. 666](#).
 auer, *vb.* savour, [B. 825](#).
 auerly, savourly, sweet, [A. 226](#).
 Sauor,
 Savour, [A. 510, 995, 1447](#); [B. 275](#).
 auyté, safety, [B. 489](#).
 Saw,
 Sawe, word, [A. 278](#); [B. 109](#). A.S. *sagu*.
 ayde = sadde, stedfast, [B. 470](#).
 188
 aym, fat, grease, [C. 275](#). Prov.E. *saim*, seam, lard. W. *saim*.

ayned, blessed, [B. 746](#). A.S. *senian*. Ger. *segnen*, to bless.

“Swa sal I *saine* þe in lif mine,
Sic benedicam te in vita mea,
And sal lift mi handes in name thine,
Et in nomine tuo levabo manus meas.”
(Psalm lxii. 5.)

aynt, [A. 835](#).

Sa₃,
Sa₃e, word, [B. 1599](#), [1737](#). See *Saw*.

a₃, saw, [A. 1021](#).

Sa₃t, reconciliation, [A. 1201](#); *adj.* at peace, [A. 52](#). A.S. *saht*, peace; *saht*,
Sa₃te, reconciled; *sahtlian*, to reconcile.

a₃tled, appeased, reconciled, [B. 230](#), [1139](#).

a₃tled, settled, restored, [A. 445](#); became calm, [B. 232](#).

a₃tlyng, reconciliation, peace, [B. 490](#), [1795](#).

a₃ttel, to be calm, patient, [C. 529](#).

cale, [A. 1005](#).

cape, escape, [A. 62](#), [529](#), [928](#); [B. 155](#).

carre = scare, *vb.* be frightened, [A. 598](#), [838](#); scatter, [B. 1784](#). N.Prov.E.
skair, wild, timid. S.Sax. *skerren*, to terrify.

cape, harm, ruin, wrong, sin, [B. 21](#), [196](#), [569](#), [600](#), [1148](#).

cape, to break, destroy, [B. 1776](#). A.S. *scethan*, to injure, hurt, harm. *Sceththe*,
injury, loss, guilt.

capel, dangerous, [C. 155](#). Goth. *skathuls*. O.H.G. *scadhal*, hurtful. 188b

“Lokez the contree be clere the corners are large:
Discovers now sekerly skrogges and other,
That no *skathelle* (hurtful thing) in the skroggez skorne us here-aftyre;
Loke 3e skyfte it so that no *skathe* lympe.”
(Morte Arthure, pp. 137-8.)

Ascalphus, a *skathel* duke, T. B. 4067.

celt, spread, served (?), [B. 827](#).

chad, descended, [B. 1690](#).

chadowed, shaded, [A. 42](#).

chafte, beams, rays, [A. 982](#); [C. 455](#). A.S. *sceaft*, dart, arrow.

“(He) had on a mitre
Was forged all of fyne gold, and fret fulle of perrils,
Stiȝt staffulle of stanes that straȝt out bemes
As it ware schemerand *schaftis* of the schire sonne.”
(K. Alex. p. 53.)

Schalk, man, fellow, [A. 762](#), [1029](#); [B. 476](#). A.S. *scealc*, a warrior,
Schalkke, serving man. Goth. *skalks*. O.S. *scalç*. O.N. *skálkr*.

chape, devise, form, [A. 247](#); endeavour, [C. 762](#); happen, [B. 160](#). A.S. *scapan*,
to appoint, shape, create. O.N. *skapa*.

chauen, shaven, scraped, [B. 1134](#).

chawe, show, [B. 1599](#).

Schawe, grove, thicket, wood, [A. 284](#); [C. 452](#). Prov.E. *scow*, *shaw*. O.N.
Schaze, *skógr*, Dan. *skov*, a wood.

chede, depart, [A. 411](#).

cheldez, shields (of a boar), [B. 58](#).

chende, ruin, destroy, [B. 519](#). 189 A.S. *scendan*, to confound, shame, destroy.

chended, accursed, [C. 246](#).

chene = sheen, *sb.* bright, beautiful, [A. 166](#), [965](#); brightness, [A. 440](#); *adj.*
[C. 203](#), [1145](#); [B. 1076](#), [1310](#). A.S. *sceone*, beautiful; *scine*, splendour.

Schent,
Schente, destroyed, [A. 668](#); [A. 1029](#); ruined, [B. 47](#), [580](#).

chep, sheep, [A. 801](#).

chepon, stall, stable, [B. 1076](#). A.S. *scypen*.

chere, divide, separate, [A. 107](#); purify, [A. 165](#). A.S. *scéran*, to divide.

chet, shut, [C. 452](#).

chin, shall, [B. 1435](#). See “Liber Cure Cocorum,” p. 29, l. 29.

“For in a slac thou shalle be slayn,
Seche ferlès *schyn* falle!”
(The Anturs of Arther, p. 12, xxiii. 13.)

chome, shame, [B. 1115](#).

chomely, shamefully, [C. 128](#).

chonied, shunned, [B. 1101](#).

chor, shower, [B. 227](#).

chore, shore, [A. 230](#).

chorne (gold), purified, refined, [A. 213](#). See [Schere](#).

chortly, quickly, hastily, [B. 519](#), [600](#).

chowte, shout, [A. 877](#).

chowue, shove, [B. 44](#), [1029](#), [1740](#).

chrewe, a wicked person, a wretch, [A. 186](#); [B. 77](#).

chrewedschyp, wickedness, [B. 580](#).

chrowde, clothing, [B. 47](#), [170](#). A.S. *scrúd*, garment, shroud.

189b

chrylle = shrill, clear, [A. 80](#).

chulder, shoulder, [B. 981](#), [1690](#).

chunt = aside, aslant, [B. 605](#). O.E. *shunt*, to slip aside, withdraw. A.S. *scunian*, to shun. Du. *schuins*, slope, slant.

“He schodirde and schrenkys and *shontes* bott lyttile.”

(Morte Arthure, p. 354.)

“3a werpes tham up (the 3ates) quoth
the wee, and wide open settes,

If at 3e schap 3ow to *schount* unschent
of oure handes.”

(K. Alex. p. 73.)

chylde, to shield, [A. 965](#); [C. 440](#).

chyldere, shoulder, [A. 214](#).

chym, bright, [A. 1077](#). A.S. *scima*, a brightness. M.H.G. *schîm*. A.S. *sciman*, to glitter, shine. See T. B. 4974.

chymeryng, *sb.* brightness, [A. 80](#). A.S. *scimrian*, to shine. Du. *schémeren*, to dazzle. Sw. *skimra*, to glitter.

chyn, shall, [B. 1810](#). See [Schin](#).

chynde, shone, [A. 80](#).

Schyr, brightly, [A. 28](#); bright, beautiful, [A. 42, 284](#); [A. 553, 605, 1278](#);
Schyre, bare, [A. 1690](#). Comp. *schyrrer*, [B. 982](#). A.S. *scír*, *sheer*, pure,
clear, bright. See T. B. 1269.

clade = slade, valley, green plain, [A. 1148](#). A.S. *slæd*.

clazt, slaughter, [B. 56](#).

coghe, scoff, or perhaps perverseness, backsliding, [A. 610](#). A.S. *sceoh*,
askew, perverse.

cole, cup, [B. 1145](#). O.N. *skál*. Dan. *skaal*.

colere, scholar, [B. 1554](#).

comfyt, to discomfit, [B. 1784](#).

190

cope, scoop, [C. 155](#).

Scorn,

Scorne, *vb.* [A. 709](#); *sb.* [B. 827](#).

coumfit, discomfited, [B. 151](#).

cowte-wach, sentinel, guard, [B. 838](#).

“Thane the price mene prekes and proves their horsez,
Satilles to the cete appone sere halfes;
Enserches the subbarbes sadly thare-aftyre,
And skyrmys a lyttile;
Skayres thaire skottefers
And their *skowtte-waches*.”

(*Morte Arthure*, p. 206.)

coymous, particular, scrupulous, fearful, [B. 21, 1148](#).

crof, rough, [B. 1546](#).

crypture, writing, [B. 1546](#).

cue. See [Skewe](#).

cylle, wit, [B. 151](#). It signifies also reason, cause. O.N. *skil*.

cylful, wise, [B. 1148](#).

Sech,

Seche, seek, [A. 354](#); [B. 29, 420](#).

eele, joy, happiness, [C. 242](#). A.S. *sél*, good, excellent. Cf. *unsell*, T. B. 1961.

ege, seat, [C. 93](#). Fr. *siége*.

ege, siege, [B. 1185](#).

Segg, a man, servant, [B. 93](#), [398](#), [549](#), [681](#). A.S. *secg*, a man, literally a
Segge, messenger, speaker; from *secgan*, to say.

egge, say, [B. 621](#).

egh, saw, [A. 790](#).

ekke, sack, [C. 382](#).

elconth, a marvel, [B. 1274](#). A.S. *sel-cúth* = *seld-cúth*, rare, seldom known.

elden, seldom, [A. 380](#). A.S. *seldan*.

190b

ele, happiness, bliss, [C. 5](#). See *Seele*.

elepe = slep, slept, [C. 186](#).

elf, very, [A. 1046](#); same, [B. 1769](#).

elly, a marvel, [A. 140](#); wonderfully, [C. 353](#). A.S. *séllíc*, *síllíc*, worthy,
wonderful; *séllíce*, wonderfully.

“For thou has samned, as men sais, a *selly* noimbre
Of wrichis and wirlinges out of the west endis,
Of laddis and of losengers and of litille thevys.”
(K. Alex. p. 59.)

See T. B. 1544.

ely, fortunate, blessed, happy, [A. 659](#); [B. 490](#). See *Seele*.

em, seam, [B. 555](#).

emblaunt, appearance, cheer, [A. 211](#), [1143](#); [B. 131](#), [640](#).

emblé, assembly, [B. 126](#).

embled, assembled, [C. 177](#).

eme, seemly, [A. 190](#); [B. 549](#), [1810](#). O.Sw. *sæma*. Dan. *sömme*, to be fitting,
bear one's self becomingly. O.N. *sæmr*, seemly.

eme, to be fitting, become, [B. 793](#).

emed, [A. 760](#).

Semely,	}	seemly, beautiful, A. 34 , 789 ; A. 209 , 1442 . Comp. <i>sem-loker</i> ,
Semly,		
Semlych,		

[B. 868](#).

engeley, ever, constantly, [A. 8](#). A.S. *singallíce*, perpetually.

Ser, diverse, various, separate, [A. 358](#); *ser kynde*, [A. 507](#); *sere course*,
Sere, [A. 1418](#); *ser wyse*, [B. 12](#).

191

erelych, severally, separately, [C. 193](#).

ergaunt, a royal servant, a squire, [B. 109](#).

erges, wax tapers, [B. 1489](#). Lat. *cerea*.

eriaunte, sergeant, [C. 385](#). See *Sergaunt*.

erkynde3, diverse kinds, [B. 336](#).

erlype3, diverse, different, separate, [A. 994](#).

ermoun, discourse, speech, [A. 1185](#).

ertain, certainly, [A. 685](#).

eruage, bondage, [B. 1257](#).

eruaunt, [A. 699](#); [B. 631](#).

erue, avail, [A. 331](#).

erue, deserve, [A. 553](#); [B. 1115](#).

eruyse, [B. 1152](#), [1401](#).

ese, cease, [A. 523](#); *sese3*, let cease, [B. 391](#).

esoune, season, [B. 523](#).

Sessed,
Sesed, took possession of, [A. 417](#); [B. 1313](#).

Sete,
Seete, sat, [A. 161](#); [A. 1171](#). *pl. seten*, [B. 1763](#).

ete, seat, [C. 24](#).

eþe = seethe, boil, [B. 631](#).

Seue,
Seve, = sewe, sew, a kind of pottage, [B. 108](#), [825](#).

ewer, the officer who set and removed the dishes, tasted them, etc., [B. 639](#).

ewrté, surety, [C. 58](#).

exte, sixth, [A. 1007](#).

eyed, passed, [B. 353](#).

“Seyet furth with sory chere.”
(T. B. 2512.)

eysoun, season, [A. 39](#).

e3, saw, [A. 158](#), [531](#), [698](#); [B. 209](#).

191b

ide-borde, [B. 1398](#).

iue, sieve, [B. 226](#).

karmoch, fight, skirmish, [B. 1186](#).

kape, harm, danger, sin, [B. 151](#), [598](#), [1186](#). See *Scape*.

kele, dish, [B. 1405](#).

kelt, scattered, spread, [B. 1186](#), [1206](#). O.E. *skale*, to scatter. N.Prov.E. *scale*, to spread. See Hall, Richard III. f. 15. A.S. *scylan*, to separate, divide; *pret. scel*.

“Skairen out skoute wacche for *skeltyng* of harme.”
(T. B. 1089, 6042.)

kelt, hasten, run, [B. 1554](#). Sw. *skala*, to scamper, scour.

kete, quick, sudden, [A. 1186](#); quickly, [B. 195](#). See T. B. 13672. O.N. *skjótt*.

kewe, sky, cloud, [B. 1206](#), [1759](#). Sw. *sky*, a cloud. A.S. *scúa*, a shadow.

kowte, look, search, [B. 483](#). See T. B. 1089.

koymous, [B. 598](#). See *Scoymous*.

kwe, sky, [B. 483](#).

kyfte, devise, order, ordain, [A. 569](#). A.S. *scyftan*.

kyfte, shift, change, [B. 709](#). Sw. *skifta*.

kyg, scrupulous, careful, [B. 21](#). Sw. *skygg*, shy. N.Prov.E. *sky*, to shun.

Skyl, reason, wit, [A. 312](#); *by skylle*, rightly, reasonably, [A. 674](#);
Skyle, ordinance, [A. 709](#); meaning, [B. 1554](#). See *Scylle*.

kylle³, doubts, [A. 54](#).

kylly, device, purpose, [B. 529](#).

192

kyly, excuse, [B. 62](#).

kyre = shire = sheer, clear, [B. 1776](#). See *Schyre*.

kyrme, screams (?), [B. 483](#).

“Scho gaffe *skirmande* skrikes at all the skowis range.”
(K. Alex. p. 176.)

Or does it here signify to look about, like Prov.E. skime? O.N. *Skima*, to look about.

kyualde, ordained, manifested, [B. 529](#). Prof. Child suggests Somerset, *scaffle*, scramble, scuffle. See *Skyfte*.

lade, valley, [A. 141](#).

lake, absolve (lit. to loosen), [A. 942](#). A.S. *sleacian*, to slacken.

laupe, sloth, [B. 178](#).

laȝt, slaughter, [A. 801](#).

laȝte, stroke, [A. 59](#); [C. 192](#). A.S. *slagan*, to strike, beat, kill.

leke, assuage, lessen, [B. 708](#). See *Slake*.

lente = slant, a slope, declivity, [A. 141](#). Sw. *slinta*, to slip.

lep, slept, [C. 466](#).

loberande, slobbering, drivelling, [C. 186](#). *Slobber* is evidently formed from *slob*, *slab*, in the same way as *blubber* is formed from *blob*, *blab*, a drop. Cf. “*Slobur* or *blobur*, of fysshe and other like Burbulum.” (Prompt. Parv.) O.E. *slab*. Prov.E. *slob*, thick, slimy. Ir. *slaib*, mud, ooze. O.N. *sluppra*. Dan. *slubbre*, to sip, sup. Du. *slubberen*, to hang loose and slack.

lode, slid, [A. 59](#).

loghe, slow, [C. 466](#).

loue, slew, [B. 1264](#).

lounbe, slumber, [C. 186](#), [466](#). N.Prov.E. *sloomy*, dronish, slow; *sloum*, *sloom*, slumber. O.E. *slome*, *sleme*, to sleep. A.S. *sluma*, a slumber. O.N. *slæmi*. Cf. the modern phrase, “to slumber and sleep.”

“(Sire Telomew) cairys into a cabayne, quare the kyng ligges,
Fand him *slomande* and on slepe, and sleely him rayses.”
(K. Alex. p. 176.)

low, slew, [B. 1221](#).

luchched, muddy, dirty, [C. 341](#). Prov.E. *slutch*, mud; *slotch*, a sloven; *slotching*, slovenly.

lyde, fall, [C. 466](#).

“And *slydyn* uppon slepe by slomeryng of age.”
(T. B. 6.)

lyke, slide, slip. O.N. *slikja*, to make smooth. See [Atslyke](#).

lyp, stroke, blow, [B. 1264](#).

lyppe, go, glide, make off, slip away, [A. 985](#); fall, [B. 186](#). A.S. *slipan*.

lyppe, escape, [B. 1785](#). Sw. *slippa*, to escape.

lyzt, slight, [A. 190](#).

lyzt, wisdom, [A. 1289](#); device, [B. 130](#). O.E. *sleghe*, *sleze*, wise. O.N. *slægr*.

mach, scent, smell, [B. 461](#), [1019](#). A.S. *smæc*. Prov.E. *smatch*, flavour.

machande, smelling, savouring, [B. 955](#).

martly, quickly, [B. 711](#).

mod, stain, filth, [B. 711](#). Sc. *smot*, *smad*. O.Sw. *smuts*, spot, stain. Dan. *smuds*, dirty. Pl. D. *smuddern*, to dirty.

molderande, smouldering, smothering, [B. 955](#).

molt, be at peace, quiet, [B. 732](#). A.S. *smolt*, serene, clear. Prov.E. *molt*-water, clear exudation; *smolt*, smooth, clear. See *Smelt*, T. B. 1669.

moltes; so in MS., but ? an error for *smolte* = *smelt*, [B. 461](#).

“A smoke *smulte* through his nase.”
(T. B. 911.)

mope, smooth, [A. 6](#).

mopely, quietly, [B. 732](#).

mylt, decayed (?), [B. 226](#). Sw. *multna*, to moulder. Dan. *smuldre*, to crumble, moulder.

naw, snow, [B. 222](#).

oberly, quietly, [A. 256](#); courteously, decently, [B. 117](#), [799](#), [1497](#). See T. B. 248.

obre, gentle, [A. 532](#).

odanly, suddenly, [A. 1098](#); [B. 1769](#).

oerly, [an error for Soberly](#), [B. 117](#).

offer, suffer, [A. 940](#).

offraunce, forbearance, [C. 417](#).

oghe, sow, [C. 67](#).

oghe, moan, [C. 391](#). A.S. *swógan*, *swégan*, to make a noise, howl. O.S. *suôgan*.

ok, *sb.* suck, [C. 391](#).

okored, succoured, [C. 261](#).

olace, [A. 130](#); [B. 870](#), [1080](#).

olased, [B. 131](#).

Solemne,

Solempne, [A. 1171](#), [1447](#); [B. 239](#).

olempnely, [B. 37](#).

Solemneté,

Solempneté, [B. 1313](#), [1678](#), [1757](#).

193b

Solie,

Soly, throne, [B. 1171](#), [1678](#). A.S. *sylla*, a chair; *saló*, a hall, palace.

omere, [B. 1686](#).

Sommoun,

Somone, *vb.* [A. 1498](#); *sb.* summons, [B. 1098](#).

onde, sand, [C. 341](#).

onde = sande, message, word, [A. 943](#); messenger, [B. 53, 781](#). A.S. *sánd*.

ondeȝ-mon, messenger, [B. 469](#).

one, soon, [B. 461](#).

Sonet,

Sonete, [B. 1415, 1516](#).

ongen, *pl.* sang, [B. 1763](#).

ope, sup, [B. 108](#).

oper, supper, [B. 107, 829, 997, 1763](#).

Sor,

Sore, sorrow, [A. 130; A. 242, 507](#); *adv.* sorely, [C. 550; B. 290](#).

orewe, sorrow, [B. 778](#).

orquydryȝe = surquedrie, presumption, arrogance, conceit, [A. 309](#).

orsers, sorcerers, [B. 1579](#).

orsory, sorcery, [B. 1576](#).

orte, lot, [C. 193](#).

Sorȝ,

Sorȝe, sorrow, [A. 352; B. 75, 563, 1080](#).

Soth,

Sope, true, truth, [A. 482, 653; A. 515](#); *sopes*, truths, [B. 1598](#). A.S. *sóth*.

oȝefast, faithful, [B. 1491](#).

othfol, truthful, [A. 498](#).

Soply,

Sopely, truly, [B. 299, 654, 657](#).

otte, fool, sot, [A. 581; B. 501](#). A.S. *sot*. See T. B. 1961.

otyle, subtle, [A. 1050](#).

oufre, sulphur, [B. 954](#).

oumme, company, [C. 509](#).

oun, sound, word, [A. 532](#); [C. 429](#); to sound, [B. 973](#), [1670](#).

ounande, sounding, [A. 883](#).

ouped, supped, [B. 833](#).

our, bad, vile, [B. 192](#). Cf. “Soory or defowlyd yn sowr or filth. Cenosus.” (Prompt. Parv.)

ouzed, sobbed, sighed, [C. 140](#). See T. B. 342. Prov.E. *sugh*, *sow*, *suff*, to murmur. O.Sc. *swouch*, a noise, sound. A.S. *swoeg*, a noise; *swógan*, to sound, howl. Du. *zwoegen*, to pant, puff.

ouerayn, [B. 93](#), [552](#).

oyle, soil, earth, [A. 1039](#), [1387](#); [B. 443](#).

o3t, sought, [A. 518](#), [730](#); *so3t to*, reached, [A. 510](#), [563](#); made for, [C. 249](#); endeavoured, [B. 1286](#).

pak, quickly, [A. 104](#); *spakest*, boldest, [C. 169](#).

pakk, spake, [A. 938](#).

pakly, certainly, surely, quickly, [A. 755](#); [B. 338](#).

pare, spar, [C. 104](#), [338](#). Sw. *sparre*. O.H.G. *sparro*.

parred, spurred, rushed, [A. 1169](#).

pec, speck, [B. 551](#).

Special,

Specyal, [A. 235](#), [938](#); [B. 1492](#).

ped, help, [B. 1607](#).

pede, prosper, [A. 511](#); hasten, [B. 551](#).

pedly, quickly, [B. 1729](#).

ped-whyle, a short space of time, a moment, [B. 1285](#).

peke, spoke, [B. 1220](#).

194b

pelle, tell, relate, [A. 793](#).

pelle, speech, [A. 363](#). A.S. *spell*.

penned, folded, [A. 49](#). O.N. *spenna*. A.S. *spannan*.

penned, allured, enticed away, [A. 53](#). A.S. *spanan*. N.Prov.E. *span*, to wean from.

piritually, [B. 1492](#).

pitous, fell, abominable, [B. 845](#).

pitously, fiercely, angrily, [B. 1220](#).

ponne = spun, grew, [A. 35](#).

pornande, rushing, dashing, [A. 363](#). O.E. *sporn*, *spurn*, to dash. A.S. *spurnan*.

“Now aithir stoure on ther stedis,
Spurnes out spakly with speris in hand.”
(K. Alex. p. 27.)

pot, blemish, [A. 12](#), [764](#).

pote, place, spot, [A. 13](#); [B. 551](#).

potlez, spotless, pure, [A. 856](#).

potty, to defile, [A. 1070](#).

poyle, [B. 1285](#), [1774](#).

Sprad,

Spradde, spread (*pret.* of *sprede*), [A. 1607](#); [B. 365](#).

prange, sprung, [A. 13](#).

prawlyng, [B. 408](#).

prete = sprit (as in bow-sprit), [C. 104](#). A.S. *sprit*.

prude = spread, fasten, [C. 104](#).

pryngande, springing, [A. 35](#).

puniande = spinnande, sticky, cleaving, [B. 1038](#). *Pynnand* occurs in this sense in the Northern Romance of Alexander, p. 142.

“Than vmbyclappis thaim a cloude and covirs all ovir,
As any *pynnand* pik (pitch) the planets it hidis.”

195

pure = spere, ask, inquire of, [B. 1606](#). Sc. *speer*. A.S. *spirian*. See T. B. 823.

puten = spouted, uttered, [B. 845](#).

put = spat, vomited, [C. 338](#).

Spyce,

Spyse, [A. 235, 938](#); *pl. spysez*, [A. 25, 35](#).

pye, [B. 780, 1774](#).

pylt, destroyed, [B. 1220](#).

pyrakle, breath, spirit, [B. 408](#).

pysereȝ, spice-mongers, [B. 1038](#).

pyt, cruelty, [A. 1138](#); vengeance, [B. 755](#).

pytously, [B. 1285](#). See *Spitously*.

table, *adj.* [A. 597](#); *vb.* [B. 1334, 1652](#).

tac (*pret.* of *steke*), closed, fastened, [B. 439](#). See *Steke*.

Stad,

Stadde, placed, fixed (*pret.* of *stede*), [B. 806, 983, 1506](#).

tage, state, [A. 410](#).

tal, seat, [B. 1506](#). A.S. *stal*, *steal*.

tale, step, degree, place, [A. 1002](#).

talke, [A. 152](#).

talle, place, fix, [B. 1334](#). A.S. *stælan*.

talle, *vb.* bring, place, [A. 188](#); [B. 1184](#).

“Lia he (Jacob) *stalle* until his bedd.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 22b.)

talworth, strong, [A. 884](#); great, [B. 983](#).

talworþest, bravest, [B. 255](#).

tamyn, threshold, [B. 486](#).

tanc, pool, [B. 1018](#). N.Prov.E. *stank*. Gael. *stang*, a pool.

“*Stagnum*, a pounde, a *stanke*, a dam.”

(MS. Harl. 2270, f. 181.)

tanden (*p.p.*), stood, [A. 519, 1148](#).

195b

tange, pool, [B. 439](#). See *Stanc*.

tape-fole, high, [C. 122](#).

tare, vb. [A. 149](#); [B. 389](#).

tare, star, [B. 583](#).

tared, shone, [B. 1506](#).

taren (3rd pers. pl. pres.), shine, [A. 116](#). “*Staring* stone,” T. B. 3037. Cf. “*Staryng*, or schynyng as gaye thyngys. Rutilans.” “*Staryñ* or schynyñ and glyderyñ, niteo.” (Prompt. Parv.)

“Many *starand* stanes strikes of thair helmes.”

(K. Alex. p. 28.)

“As ai stremande sternes *stared* alle thaire wedes.”

(*Ibid.*, p. 129.)

tart, [A. 1159](#).

tatue, [B. 995](#).

Staue,

Staw, = stow, place, [B. 352](#), [360](#), [480](#).

tayre, shine, [B. 1396](#). See *Staren*.

tayre, ladder, [C. 513](#).

tayre, steep, high, [A. 1022](#). A.S. *stígan*, to ascend; *stæger*, a stair. O.E. *staire*, to ascend.

“A hundreth daies and a halfe he held be tha playnes,
Till he was comen till a cliffe, at to the cloudis semed,
That was so *staire* and so stepe, the storé me tellis,
Mizt ther no wee, bot with wynges, winne to the topp.”

(K. Alex. p. 164, l. 4828.)

“With that *stairis* he forth the stye that strezt to the est.”

(*Ibid.*, 4834.)

teke, fasten, shut up, close, [B. 157](#), [352](#), [754](#), [884](#). N.Prov.E. *steek*. A.S. *stician*, to stick in. O.N. *steckr*, a fold.

196

tel, stole, [B. 1203](#).

tele, approach stealthily, [B. 1778](#). A.S. *stélan*.

tele, a step (of a ladder), [C. 513](#). See *Stale*.

“This ilke laddre (that may to hevene leste) is charite,
The *stales* gode theawis.”

(Poems of Wm. of Shoreham, p. 3.)

temme = stem, to stop, delay, [B. 905](#). The same root occurs in *stammer*, stumble, etc. Sw. *stämma*, to dam.

tepe, step, [B. 905](#).

Stepe, bright, [B. 583](#), [1396](#). S.Sax. *steap*, bright, brilliant. “Stepe ene.”

Steppe, T. B. 3101. Cf. “eyen *stepe*.” Chaucer. C. T. Prologue, l. 201.

tere, direct, [A. 623](#); rule, [C. 27](#).

terne, star, [A. 115](#); [C. 207](#). O.N. *stjarna*.

terne (of a boat), [C. 149](#).

terre, star, [B. 1378](#).

tewarde, [B. 90](#).

teuen, voice, [A. 188](#); sound, [A. 1125](#); [A. 1203](#), [1402](#); noise, [A. 1778](#);
command, [B. 360](#), [463](#). A.S. *stefen*.

tiffe, [B. 983](#).

tifly, firmly, [B. 157](#).

tik, fix, fasten, [B. 157](#). See *Steke*.

tille, dumb, [B. 1523](#).

toffe, fill, [B. 1184](#). See T. B. 2748.

token, fastened, enclosed, shut (*p.p.* of *steke*), [A. 1065](#); [B. 360](#), [1199](#), [1524](#).

“Sothe stories ben *stoken* up & straught out of mind.”

(T. B. 11.)

196b

Stokke,

Stoke, stocks, [B. 46](#), [157](#).

tonde, stand, [B. 1490](#).

tonde, blow, [B. 1540](#). A.S. *stunian*, to beat, strike. O.E. *stund*, to strike.

“Quat! wyns (wenis) þou I am a hund,

Wit þi stans me for to *stund*.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 42b.)

tonen, *adj.* of stone, [B. 995](#).

ton-harde, fast, [B. 884](#).

toore, a great (number), [A. 847](#).

“A *store* man of strength and of stuerne will.”
(T. B. 538.)

tote, stand, stop still, [A. 149](#). Dan. *stötte*, stay, support. S.Sax. *stuten*, to stop.
Sc. *stoit*, stumble. “*Stotyng*, Titubatus.” (Prompt. Parv.)

“Anone to the forest they found (go),
There they *stoted* a stound.”
(Sir Degrevant, 225.)

“Ffurth he stalkis a styte, by tha stille euys,
Stotays at a hey strette, studyande hym one.”
(Morte Arthure, p. 290.)

“Than he *stotays* for made, and alle his strenghe faylez.”
(*Ibid.*, p. 357.)

tound, Stounde, a space of time, moment, [A. 659](#); [A. 1716](#); *in stoundes*, at times, [B. 1603](#). A.S. *stund*.

ounde, blow, and hence sorrow, [A. 20](#). See *Stonde*.

tour, conflict; *bale-stour*, death pang, [C. 426](#). Cf. *dede-stoure*, death conflict.
Hampole’s *Pricke of Conscience*, 1820, 5812. O.N. *styr*. 197

“Son efter-ward, it was not lang,
Gain Saul þai gaf batail strang;
þaa sarȝins þan þe king umsett,
In hard *stur* þai samen mett;
Ful snaip it was þair, *stur* and snelle,
The folk al fled of Israel.”
(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 43b.)

tout, firm, stable, [A. 779](#), [935](#); brave, [B. 1184](#).

towed, placed, [B. 113](#).

towned, troubled, astonished, [C. 73](#). A.S. *stunian*.

trake, struck up, sounded, [B. 1402](#).

trate, street, [A. 1043](#).

traunge, strange, [B. 409](#).

tray, [A. 1173](#); [B. 1199](#). See T. B. 6258.

trayne, strain, [A. 128](#); labour, [A. 691](#); pain, [A. 1540](#); trouble, [B. 234](#).

trayt, [B. 880](#), [1199](#).

Strech,
Streche, stretch, [A. 843, 971](#); [B. 905](#).

tremande, shining, [A. 115](#). See extract under the word *Staren*.

trenkle, scatter, [B. 307](#).

trenpe, strength, [B. 1155, 1430](#).

treny, strain, toil, labour, [A. 551](#).

treȝt, strait, [A. 691](#); [C. 234](#). Cf. streght, T. B. 351.

tronde = strand, stream, river, [A. 152](#); [C. 254, 311](#).

“Midward þat land a wel springes,
þat rennes out wit four *strandes*,
Fflummes farand in fer landes.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 7b.)

“Quen thai war passed over *strand*,
And raght apon þe toiþer land,
Witte yee þat þai war ful gladd.”

(*Ibid.*, fol. 46a.)

197b

trot = strut, contest, chiding, [A. 353, 848](#).

“O pride bicums unbuxumnes,
Strif and *strutt* and frawardnes.”

(The Seven Deadly Sins, in Cott. MS. Vesp. A. [iii.](#))

trope, bold, fierce (?), [A. 115](#).

trye, destroy, [A. 307, 1768](#); *stryed*, [B. 1018](#).

tryf, [A. 248](#).

tryke, pass, go, [A. 1125](#). A.S. *strican*.

trynde = strond, stream, [C. 311](#).

tryuande, striving, [C. 311](#).

tud = stede, place, [B. 389, 1334](#).

turnen, strong, [B. 1402](#).

Styf,

Styffe, strong, [A. 779](#); [C. 234](#); *styfest*, strongest, [B. 255](#).

tyfly, fast, firmly, [B. 352, 1652](#).

tyke = stryke, walk, go (?), [A. 1186](#).

tykked, fixed, placed, [B. 583](#). See *Steke*.

tylle, secret, [A. 20](#); [A. 589](#), [706](#); quiet, [A. 1203](#); quietly, [B. 486](#). See T. B. 1778.

“State from þe slyth kyng *styllé* by night.”
(T. B. 988.)

tylle, secretly, [B. 806](#), [1778](#).

tyngande, stinging, [B. 225](#).

tynkande, stinking, [B. 1018](#).

tynst, a mistake for stynt, stop, [A. 353](#).

tynt, stop, [A. 225](#), [381](#), [1261](#); stopped, [B. 73](#). A.S. *stintan*.

tyry, stir, move, [B. 403](#), [1720](#).

tyste3 = stynte3, stops, [B. 359](#).

ty3e, path, [C. 402](#). A.S. *stíg*.

ty3e, ascend, climb, [B. 389](#). A.S. *stígan*, to ascend.

198

ty3tle, place, order, fix, [A. 90](#); [B. 402](#). A.S. *stihtan*, to arrange, dispose. See T. B. 1997.

“Unstithe for to stire or *stightill* the Realme.”
(T. B. 117.)

ued, followed, [B. 681](#).

Suffer,
Suffre, [A. 554](#).

uffraunce, endurance, patience, [A. 3](#), 529.

uffyse, [A. 135](#).

Sulp, } defile, pollute, [B. 15](#), [550](#), [1130](#), [1135](#). O.E. *sulwe*, to defile, soil.
Sulpe, } M.H.D. *be-sulwen*. O.N. *söla*, to pollute. Prov. Ger. *sulpern*,
unclean, to defile. The word *sulp* (*solp*) occurs in the Romance of
K. Alexander, ed. Stevenson, but the editor renders it “to swallow”!

“Oure inward enmys ilkane we inwardly drepis,
That is to say alle the sin, at *solp* may 3e (the ?) saule.”
(K. Alex. p. 146.)

ulpande, defiling, [A. 726](#).

umkyn, of some kind, [A. 619](#).

umoun, to summon, [A. 539](#).

um quat, some sort of, [B. 627](#).

um-while, formerly, [C. 57](#).

underlupes, severally, [C. 12](#).

uppe, [A. 108](#); [B. 151](#).

upplantor, [A. 440](#).

ure, [A. 1089](#).

um, one, “*al & sum*,” one and all, [A. 584](#).

urely, [A. 1643](#); [B. 315](#).

ustnaunce, [B. 340](#).

ute (?) [A. 203](#), [1108](#).

198b

ve = sue, follow, go after, [A. 976](#).

walt, died, [A. 816](#), [1160](#). See T. B. 1200, 4687. See *Swelt*.

waneȝ, swans, [B. 58](#).

wange (*pret.* of *swenge* or *swinge*), toiled, worked, [A. 586](#). A.S. *swingan*, to dash, to labour.

wange, flowed, [A. 1059](#).

wangeande, flowing, rushing, [A. 111](#). See T. B. 13024.

wap, blow, [B. 222](#). A.S. *swipian*. O.N. *svipa*, to shake. O.E. *swepe*, *swappe*, to beat. See T. B. 1889.

“He swynges out with a swerd and *swappis* him to dethe.”

(K. Alex. p. 38.)

“With a swinge of his sworde *swappit* hym in þe fase.”

(T. B. 1271.)

ware, square, [A. 837](#); [B. 1386](#).

ware, answer, [A. 240](#); [B. 1415](#). O.N. *svara*. See T. B. 1200.

warme, [B. 223](#).

wart, black, [C. 363](#).

Swat,
Swatte, sweated (*pret.* of *swete*), [A. 586, 829](#).

wayf, blow, literally, a sudden movement. See [Swayue](#).

“Than Alexander
Swythe swyngis out his swerde and his *swayfe* feches,
The nolle of Nicollas, the kyng, he fra the nebb partis.”
(K. Alex. p. 28.)

wayne, swain, servant, [B. 1509](#).

wayue, swims. T. B. 2358. Dan. *swæve*, to wave, move, flutter.

we, follow, [A. 892](#); ran, [B. 956](#).

weande, flowing, [B. 420](#).

weft, swift, [C. 108](#).

199

welme, heat, [A. 3](#). A.S. *swell*, a burning; *swélan*, to burn, *sweal*.

“[He] lete asauage, or he sware (spoke), the *swelme* of his angirs.”
(K. Alex. p. 21.)

welt, die, perish, [A. 108](#); [C. 427](#); destroy, [B. 332](#). A.S. *sweltan*. O.N. *svelta*.

wemande (*pres. part.* of *sweme*), afflicting, [B. 563](#). A.S. *swima*, a stupor.
S.Sax. *sweamen*, to grieve, vex.

“Whan this was seide, his hert began to melt
For veray *sweme* of this *swemeful* tale.”
(Lydgate’s *Minor Poems*, p. 38.)
“Sum swalt in a *swym* with outen sware more.”
(T. B. 1200.)

weng, *sb.* toil, labour, [A. 575](#). A.S. *sweng*, a stroke, blow. See [Swange](#). See
T. B. 1271.

wenge, hasten, rush, dash out, [A. 109](#), [667](#); [B. 108](#), [250](#), [253](#).

“He *swynges* out with a swerd and swappis him to dethe.”
(K. Alex. p. 33.)

A.S. *swingan*, to swing, dash.

wepe, glide, [A. 111](#); hasten, [B. 1509](#). See T. B. 342. O.E. *swippe*, to pass
quickly. O.N. *svip*, a rapid movement; *svipa*, to whip, do quickly, turn.

wepe, to seize, [C. 341](#). A.S. *swipian*, to take by violence.

wer, swore, [B. 69](#), [667](#).

wete, life; *to lose the swete* = to die, [C. 364](#). *Swete* may here signify *sweet*,
the word *life* being understood. 199b

“And alle at lent ware on loft loste ther the *swete*.”

(K. Alex. p. 105.)

“—— the brande es myne awene
Many swayne, with the swynge [struck], has the *swete* levede.”

(Morte Arthure, p. 281.)

“All the kene mene of kampe, knyghtes and other,
Killyd are colde dede and castyne over burdez
Theire swyers sweyftly has the *swete* levyde.”

(*Ibid.* p. 309.)

wetter, sweeter, [C. 236](#).

weuen, dream, [A. 62](#). A.S. *swefen*.

wey, go, walk, [A. 788](#); came, [B. 429](#). See T. B. 2512. O.N. *sweigia*. Dan.
sveje, to bend. N.Prov.E. *swey*, to swing; *sweigh*, to press. See [Sve](#).

weyed, swayed, [C. 151](#).

weze, go, [A. 72](#); drove, [C. 236](#).

wolze, swallow, [C. 250](#), [363](#); kill, [B. 1268](#).

wone, swoon, [A. 1180](#). A.S. *aswunan*.

wowed, swooned, [C. 442](#). S.Sax. *swowen*, to swoon.

wyed = sweyed, followed, [B. 87](#).

wyere, squire, [B. 87](#),

wypped, escaped, [B. 1253](#). See [Swepe](#).

wyre, neck, [B. 1744](#). A.S. *sweora*.

wyþe, firm, strong, [A. 354](#); [A. 236](#); great, [A. 1283](#); very, [A. 816](#); many,
[A. 1299](#); quickly, [A. 1059](#); [C. 354](#); greatly, [B. 987](#). A.S. *swíth*, strong, great;
swíthe, very, greatly.

wyþe, burn, scorch, [C. 478](#) (*pret.* 200 *swath*). N.Prov.E. *swither*, to singe;
swidden, to scorch. O.N. *svítha*.

“Mi Gode, als whele set þam,
Als stubble bi-fore wind lickam
Als fire that brennes wode swa;
Als lowe *swiþand* hilles ma.”

(Ps. lxxxii. 15.)

yence, [B. 1454](#), [1599](#).

yfle, blow, [C. 470](#). *Syfle* sometimes signifies to *whistle*. It may be connected
with the Prov.E. *suffe*, to pant, blow. A.S. *siofian*, mourn, lament.

ykande, sighing, [B. 715](#). A.S. *sycan*, to sigh.

yked, sighed, [C. 382](#).

ykerly, surely, [C. 301](#). O.Fris. *sikur*. Ger. *sicher*, sure.

yle, to glide, go, proceed, [B. 131](#). See T. B. 364, 1307. Prov.E. *sile*, to go. O.N. *síla*.

“With that the segge all himselfe *silis* to his chambre.”
(K. Alex. p. 5.)

See T. B. 364.

ylueren, silver, [B. 1406](#).

ymbale, [B. 1415](#).

ymples, [A. 1134](#); [B. 746](#).

ympelnesse, [A. 909](#).

yn, since, [C. 218](#).

yngne, sign, [B. 489](#), [1710](#).

ynglerty, singularity, singleness, [A. 429](#).

ynglure, uniqueness, [A. 8](#).

yngnette³, signets, [A. 838](#).

ynne, after, [B. 229](#).

yre, lord, [B. 1260](#).

Syt,

Syte, sorrow, sin, [A. 566](#), [1257](#); [B. 5](#), [517](#). O.N. *sút*.

“Jacob wen he was mast in *siit*,
God lighted him witouten *liit*.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 27b.)

200b

“This tre in forbot haf I laid,
If þou sa bald be it to bite,
Þou sal be ded in sorou and *site*,
And if þou haldes mi forbot,
Þou sal be laverd ouer ilk crot.”

(*Ibid.* fol. 52b.)

yþe, time, [A. 1079](#); [B. 1169](#), [1417](#), [1686](#). A.S. *sith*.

yþen, afterwards, [A. 13](#), [643](#), [1207](#); [A. 998](#); since, [B. 245](#).

ytrole, citole, guitar, [A. 91](#).

Sy₃,
 Sy₃e, saw, [A. 308, 788, 985; B. 985.](#)
 Sy₃t,
 Sy₃te, sight, [A. 226; B. 552, 1710.](#)

T

a, take, arrest, [C. 78](#). “Ta me,” take, arrest me. Tat₃, take, [B. 735](#). (Cf. O.E. *ma* = make.)

abarde, coat. It sometimes signifies a short coat or mantle, [B. 41](#). Fr. *tabar*. Ital. *tabaro*.

abelment, [A. 994](#).

aborne, tabour, [B. 1414](#).

ached, fixed, fastened, [A. 464](#).

akel, [C. 233](#).

ale, tale, message, [B. 1437](#).

alent, will, pleasure, [C. 416](#). See T. B. 464.

alle = tuly (?), [B. 48](#).

an, taken, [B. 763](#).

at₃, take, [B. 735](#). See *Ta*.

ayt, agreeable, lively, [B. 871](#). O.N. *teitr*.

“The laddes were kaske and *teyte*.”
 (Havelok the Dane, 1841.)

“Ther mouhte men se the boles beyte,
 And the bores with hundes *teyte*.”
 (*Ibid.* 2331.)

201

ayt, fear, [B. 889](#).

“Brynges furthe, [as] sayd the boke, bestes out of noumbre,
 And trottes on toward Tyre with *taite* at thaire hertes.”
 (K. Alex. p. 42.)

eche, teach, [B. 160](#).

æche, mark, sign, [B. 1049](#).

æche, fault, [A. 1230](#); device, [B. 943](#). Fr. *tache*.

æde, an error for *tene* = ten (?), [B. 1634](#).

æe, go, [A. 9](#), [1262](#); [B. 87](#).

“Let hym *tegh* to þe tempull.”
(T. B. 2541.)

A.S. *teon*. Cf. *teght*, T. B. 1786.

ælde, tent, [B. 866](#). A.S. *teld*.

ælded, raised, [B. 1342](#). See T. B. 6075.

elle, raise, excite, [B. 1808](#). Du. *tillen*, to lift up.

eme, approach, [A. 460](#); [A. 9](#); [B. 316](#). See T. B. 3306. It seems to be connected with the A.S. *geteman*, to bear witness; *teama*, to cite, summon. In Lazamon *teman* signifies to go, proceed, approach, vol. i. p. 53, l. 1245.

“Albion hatte that lond;
Ah leode ne beoth thar nane,
Ther to thu scalt *teman* [wende]
& ane neowe Troye thar makian.”

eme, team, [C. 37](#).

eme, theme, [C. 358](#).

empest, [C. 231](#).

empe, [A. 1062](#).

empre, moderate, [B. 775](#).

emptande, tempting, [B. 283](#).

ender, [A. 412](#); [B. 630](#).

ene, *sb.* anger, sorrow, [A. 332](#); 201b B. 283, 687, 1137; [A. 90](#); *adj.* angry, [C. 1808](#); *vb.* punish, [B. 759](#). A.S. *teonan*, *tynan*, to anger; *teona*, wrong, mischief.

enfully, sorrowfully, bitterly, [B. 160](#).

enor, [C. 358](#).

enoun, [A. 993](#).

Tent,
Tente, attend, care for, [A. 676, 935](#); [C. 59, 498](#); heed, [B. 387](#).

erme, term, [A. 1053](#); [B. 1393](#).

erne, lake, [B. 1041](#). N.Prov.E. *tarn*. O.N. *tjörn*.

euel (or *tenel* ?), enclose, or ? *undermine*, [B. 1189](#).

acce, blow, [C. 325](#). A.S. *thaccian*, to stroke.

ayreȝ, theirs, [B. 1527](#).

aȝ, though, [A. 134](#).

ede, country, [A. 711](#). A.S. *theód*.

“I sett ȝowe ane ensample ȝe se it alle day,
In thorps and in many *thede* ther ȝe thurȝe ride,
At ilka cote a kene curr, as he the chache walde,
Bot as bremely as he baies, he bitis never the faster.”
(K. Alex. p. 62.)

ede, vessel, [B. 1717](#). Prov.E. *thead*, a strainer used in brewing. “*Thede*,
bruares instrument, qualus.” (Prompt. Parv.)

eder, thither, [B. 461](#).

ef, thief, [A. 273](#).

heme, [A. 944](#); [C. 358](#).

Den,
Denne, than, [A. 134](#).

enkande, thinking, [C. 294](#).

erue, unleavened, [B. 635](#). Prov.E. 202 *therf*, *tharf*, *thar*. A.S. *theorf*, *therf*.

ester, darkness, [B. 1775](#). A.S. *theostru*. See T. B. 2362.

ewe, virtue, [A. 1436](#); [C. 30](#); ordinances, [B. 544, 755](#).

ewed, virtuous, [B. 733](#).

ewes, thieves, [B. 1142](#).

ikker, oftener, [C. 6](#).

irled, pierced, [B. 952](#).

o, the (*pl.*), [A. 635](#); those, [B. 557](#).

ole, suffer, [A. 344](#); [A. 190](#); [B. 6](#). A.S. *thólian*, to suffer, endure.
 onc, *sb.* thank, [A. 901](#).
 onkke, *vb.* thank, [B. 745](#).
 ore, there, [A. 562](#).
 orpe, city, [B. 1178](#). O.N. *thorp*.
 or3, through. See [bur3](#).
 o3, though, [A. 345](#).
 o3t, seemed, [A. 153](#); [B. 562](#).
 o3t, imagination, [B. 516](#).
 rad, reproached, tormented, [B. 751](#). A.S. *threagan* (*pret. threáde*, *p.p. thread*), to blame, vex, torment.
 range, pierce, [A. 17](#). See [brenge](#).
 rast, stroke, thrust, [B. 952](#).
 rat, vexation, torment, [C. 55](#). A.S. *threat*, threat; *threatian*, to vex, distress.
 ratten (*3d pers. pl. pret.*) threatened, [B. 937](#).
 rawe, to reach, [B. 590](#).
 rawen, close, thick, [B. 1775](#).
 renge, press, crowd after, follow, [A. 930](#); pass, [B. 354](#). A.S. *thringan*, to press, crowd, throng. O.N. *threnga*.
 rep, contradiction, [B. 350](#). 202b N.Prov.E. *threap*, *threpe*, to dispute. A.S. *threapian*, to reprove, chide.
 “Withoutyn threp more.”
 (T. B. 1127.)
 repyng, *sb.* strife, [B. 183](#). A.S. *threapung*.
 þret,
 þrete, threaten, [A. 561](#); [B. 680](#), [1728](#).
 retty, thirty, [B. 751](#).
 reuenest, wisest, noblest, [B. 1571](#).
 ro, anger, [A. 754](#); [C. 6](#); angry, [B. 344](#). N.Prov.E. *thro*, keen, eager. O.N. *thrá*.
 “Be þou nought in þi hert so thra.”

(MS. Harl. 4196. fol. 94.)

Cf. “his *throo* hert,” T. B. 147. “A *throo* (bold) knight.” *Ib.* 1482.

ro, good, [A. 868](#).

ro, sharply, quickly, [B. 220](#). A.S. *threá*.

ro, thoroughly, [B. 1805](#).

roble, press, [B. 879](#).

roly, fiercely, quickly, [B. 180](#), [514](#).

“*Throly* he thoght in his hert.”
(T. B. 209.)

Þrong,

Þronge, *sb.* crowd, [B. 135](#), [504](#), [754](#).

rongen (*3d pers. pl. pret. of thringe*), crowded, pressed, [B. 1775](#).

“Mony thoughtes full thro *thronge* in hir brest.”
(T. B. 470.)

rublande, pressing, [B. 504](#). See *Þroble*.

Þrwen,

Þrowen, thrown, [B. 220](#), [504](#).

rych, through, [A. 17](#). O.Sc. *throuch*.

203

Þryd,
Þryde,
Þrydde,

third, [A. 833](#); [B. 249](#), [300](#), [1639](#).

rye3, thrice, [B. 429](#).

rynge, press, [A. 180](#); follow, [B. 1639](#). See *Þrenge*.

rynnne, three, [B. 606](#), [1727](#).

ryuande, good, pure, [B. 751](#). See T. B. 1482.

ryue, prosper, thrive, [A. 249](#); [B. 521](#).

ryuen, prudent, wise, [A. 868](#), [1192](#); grown up, adult, [A. 298](#); *Þryuenest*,
wisest, noblest, [B. 1639](#).

ryȝt, thrust, pressed, thronged, [A. 670, 706, 926](#); [B. 135](#); Cf. *thriccing* of hondys. T. B. 1522. A.S. *thryccan* (*pret. thrycte*), to thrust, press, tread on.

urȝ, through, [A. 670](#).

ykke, closely, [B. 504](#).

yȝe, thigh, [B. 1687](#).

ȝ, toe, [C. 229](#).

ȝ-cleues, separate, [B. 1806](#).

ȝ-corue (3d pers. pl. *pret.*), slit, ript up, [B. 1250](#).

ȝken, betoken, [B. 1557](#).

ȝ-kerue, divide, [B. 1700](#).

Tole,

Tool, tool, [B. 1108, 1342](#).

Tolk,

Tolkke, } man, [B. 687, 757](#). *Tolk*, like *segge*, signified originally a speaker,
Tolkke, } an interpreter. O.N. *túlka*, to explain, interpret; *túlkr*, an
Tulkke, } interpreter, a mediator. See T. B. 63.

ȝm, (1) leisure, [A. 134](#); opportunity, [A. 1153](#); interval, [B. 135](#); 203b (2) time, [A. 585](#). O.Sw. and O.N. *tóm*. “*Toom oportunitas*.” (Prompt. Parv.)

“Tharfore þis tyme I may noght cum

Telle þi lord I haue no *tome*.”

(MS. Harl, 4196, fol. 105.)

In T. B. 1088, we have *tomly*.

ȝ-marred, spoilt, [B. 1114](#).

ȝ-murte, crushed to pieces, [C. 150](#). See *murte*, T. B. 6128.

ȝonne (or toune?), conceive, [B. 655](#).

ȝp, head, [C. 229](#).

ȝpace, topaz, [B. 1469](#).

ȝr, tower, [A. 966](#).

ȝr, hard, [A. 1109](#). O.N. *tor*. Sans. *dus*, hard, difficult. Cf. O.E. *torfer*, hardship, T. B. 81.

“But this tyme is so *tore*.”

(T. B. 645.)

To-rente,
To-rent, rent asunder, [A. 1136](#); [A. 368](#); [B. 96](#).

ɔ-riuen, torn away, [A. 1197](#).

ormenttour, [B. 154](#).

ɔ-rof (*pret.* of *to-riue*), burst, [A. 964](#); [B. 379](#).

orreʒ, towers, [A. 875](#),

oter, totter, [C. 233](#).

oteʒ = totʒ, toes; Cf. *gotʒ* = goes, etc., [B. 41](#).

ɔ-torne, torn, [B. 41](#).

otʒ, goes, [A. 513](#). Sw. *tota*.

our, tower, [B. 216](#).

ourneʒ = turns, devices, [B. 192](#).

ɔw, two, [B. 866](#).

“Two pyllers he pight in a place low.”
(T. B. 310.)

ɔ-walten, overflowed (*3d pers. pl.*), [B. 428](#).

204

ɔwche, to relate, deliver a message, speak, [A. 898](#); [B. 1437](#).

“Litille kyngis there come
Touches titly thair tale and tribute him askis.”
(K. Alex. p. 31.)

ɔwche, *sb.* touch, [C. 252](#).

owe, [C. 100](#).

owen, drawn, [A. 251](#).

ɔʒe, tough, [B. 630](#).

ɔʒt, firm, binding, [A. 522](#).

ra, high (?), [B. 211](#), or (?) *tor*, great, difficult of access.

“This castel es o lue and grace,
Bath o socur and o solace,
Apon the mathe it standes traist;
O fede ne dredes it na fraist;

It is hei sett upon þe crag,
Trai and hard wituten hag.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 55a.)

ramme, tackle, gear? [C. 101](#). In the northern Romance of Alexander, p. 5, *tramme* signifies an instrument (optical).

“He toke *trammes* him with to tute (look) in the sternes.”

ras = trace, path, course, [A. 1113](#). “*Trace*, a streyght way, *trace*.” (Palsg.)

rasches = trauses or trossers, drawers or trousers? [B. 40](#).

rauayle, *sb.* labour, [A. 505](#); *vb.* [A. 550](#); [C. 498](#).

rave = trawe, believe, [B. 587](#).

rauerce = traverse, [B. 1473](#).

Traw, = trow, believe, suppose, [A. 282, 295](#); [B. 655, 1335, 1686](#). See
Trawe, T. B. 298.

rawande, believing, [B. 662](#).

Trawþe,
Traupe, truth, [A. 495](#); [B. 63, 667](#); belief, 1490, 1703.

204b

rayled, [B. 1473](#).

raysoun, treason, [B. 187](#).

Trayply, certainly, surely? [B. 907, 1137](#). If *trayply* be derived from
trauth, truth, the meaning here assigned to it may be correct;
Traypely, but the sense of *fiercely, fearfully*, would suit the context
better.

raytoure, [A. 1041](#); [B. 77](#).

re, wood, [B. 1342](#).

rendel, roll, [A. 41](#).

res, yards (of a ship), [C. 101](#).

Tresor,
Tresore, treasure, [A. 237, 331, B. 866](#).

resorye, treasury, [B. 1317](#).

respas, [B. 48](#).

respast, [B. 1230](#).

restes, trestles, [B. 832](#).

richcherye, treachery, [B. 187](#).

roched, ornamented? An architectural term of uncertain meaning, [B. 1383](#).

Tron,

Trone, went (*pret.* of *tryne*), [A. 1113](#); [A. 132](#); [B. 101](#). See *Trynande*.

rone, throne, [A. 1055](#).

rot, *sb.* pace, step, [B. 976](#).

row, believe, [B. 1049](#).

rumpen, trumpets, [B. 1402](#).

russed, deposited, [B. 1317](#). See T. B. 1819.

rwe, true, [A. 460](#).

ryed, select, trusty, [B. 1317](#). O.E. *trie*, choice. See T. B. 695.

ryfled = trayfoled, ornamented with knots, [B. 1473](#). Fr. *treffilier*, a chain maker.

rynande, going, walking, [B. 976](#). Dan. *trine*, to go. 205

“Than the traytoure treunted the Tyesday thar aftyre,
Trynnys in with a trayne tresone to wirke.”

(*Morte Arthure*, p. 326.)

“The trays (path) of the traytoure he *trynys* fulle evenne,
And turnys in be Treynte, the traytoure to seche.”

(*Ibid.* p. 339.)

“They *tryne* unto a tente whare tables whare raysede.”

(*Ibid.* p. 267.)

ryste, trusty, [A. 460](#); *vb.* to trust, [C. 324](#).

rysty, trusty, [B. 763](#).

ryȝe, to trust in, rely upon, [A. 311](#). N.Prov.E. *trigg*, firm, faithful. Sw. *trygg*, safe, sure.

uch, cloth, [B. 48](#). Ger. *tuch*. Cf. Eng. *tuck* and *tucker*.

ulkke, man, soldier, [B. 1189](#), [1262](#). See *Tolk*.

“The Tothyr was a *Tulke* out of Troy selfe.”

(T. B. 63.)

ulket = tulked, sounded, [B. 1414](#). The original meaning of *tulk* is to speak, explain (O.N. *túlka*), hence to utter, sound.

“The Tebies *tulked* (addressed) us with tene (anger).”
(K. Alex. p. 83.)

ult, threw, pitched. [A. 1213](#); [B. 252](#). See *Tilt*, in T. B. 914, 3704. A.S. *tealtian*, to tilt, shake.

uyred, destroyed, [B. 1234](#).

wayned, separated, [A. 251](#).

weyne, two, [B. 674](#), [1749](#).

wynande, entwining, [B. 1691](#). Sw. *twinna*, to twine.

wynne, two, [A. 251](#); [B. 1047](#).

wynne, separate, [B. 402](#).

205b

yd, quickly, [A. 64](#), [1213](#); [B. 100](#), [229](#). A.S. *tíd*, *tídlíce*. Sw. *tida*, frequently.

yde, time, [B. 1393](#).

ykel, uncertain, [B. 655](#).

ylle, to, [B. 1064](#).

ymbre, [B. 1414](#). “Tymbyr a lytyl taboure, timpanellum.” (Prompt. Parv.)

ylte, overturn, [A. 832](#); tumble, [B. 361](#).

“*Tylude ouer borde.*”
(T. B. 3704.)

ynde, branch, [A. 78](#). A.S. *tine*. O.E. *tind*, a tine, tooth, prong, fork.

yne, lose, [A. 332](#); destroy, [B. 775](#), [907](#). O.N. *tyna*.

ynt, lost, [B. 216](#). See T. B. 1208.

ype, overturn, [C. 506](#).

ypped, extreme, [C. 77](#).

yraunte, [B. 943](#).

yrauntyré, tyranny, [B. 187](#).

yrne, flay, [B. 630](#). Du. *tornen*, to rend, rip up.

“And so thai did al bidene and sum oure douth sloze,
Take out the tuskis and the tethe, and *ternen* of the skinnes.”

(K. Alex. p. 140.)

yt, quickly, [A. 728](#). N.Prov.E. *tite*, soon. Cf. *tytly*, T. B. 1094. See *Tyd*.

yþe, tenth, [B. 216](#).

yþyng, tiding, [A. 458, 498](#); [B. 78](#).

ytter, sooner, [C. 231](#). N.Prov.E. *titter*. See *Tyt*.

yxt, text, [A. 1634](#); [B. 37](#).

yzed, tied, [A. 464](#); [B. 702](#).

206

Tyȝt, described, [A. 1053](#); give, [A. 1153](#); endeavour, [A. 1108](#); near,

Tyȝte, [B. 503](#). See T. B. 1358. A.S. *tihtan*, to draw.

U

= o = of, [A. 792](#).

UV

Vch,
Vche,
Vcha,

} = ilk, ilka, each, every. [A. 33, 117](#).

chon, each one, [A. 546](#).

glokest (*superl.* of *vgly*), most horrid, dreadful, [B. 892](#). See *vgsome*, horrible, T. B. 877.

mbe, about, [A. 879, 1384](#); [B. 309](#). A.S. *ymbe*.

“Grete toures full toure all þe toune *vmbe*.”

(T. B. 320.)

mbe-brayde, accost, [B. 1622](#). See *Brayde*.

mbe-grouen, overgrown, [B. 488](#).

mbe-kest, look about, [B. 478](#).

mbe-lyze, compass, surround, [B. 836](#).

mbe-pyȝte, surrounded, [A. 1052](#).

imbre, rain, [B. 524](#). Cf. *ymur*, in T. B. 897. Lat. *imber*.

imbe-schon, shone about, [C. 455](#).

Vmbe-stounde,

Vmbe-stoundes, at times, sometimes, [C. 7](#), [122](#).

imbe-sweyed, encircled, [B. 1380](#).

imbe-walt, surrounded, [B. 1181](#).

navysed, unadvised, thoughtless, [A. 292](#).

nblemyst, unblemished, [A. 782](#).

n-brosten, unburst, [B. 365](#).

nblype, dismal, [B. 1017](#).

ncheryst, uncherished, uncared for, [B. 1125](#).

nclannesse, uncleanness. [B. 30](#), [1800](#), [1806](#).

206b

nclene, [B. 550](#), [1713](#).

ncler, indistinct, [C. 307](#).

nclose, disclose, [B. 26](#), [1438](#).

ncortoyse, uncourteous, [A. 303](#).

Vncoupe,

Vncowpe, unknown, [B. 414](#), [1600](#), [1722](#).

nder, the third hour of the day, [A. 513](#). A.S. *undern*. Goth. *undaurns*.

nder-nomen, understood, perceived, [C. 213](#).

nder-stonde, understand, [A. 941](#); [C. 122](#).

nder-3ede = under-3ete, understood, [B. 796](#). A.S. *undergitan*, to perceive.

ndyd, destroyed, [B. 562](#).

nfayre, bad, [B. 1801](#).

nfolde, [B. 1563](#).

nfre, unfortunate, [B. 1129](#).

ngarnyst, unadorned, [B. 137](#).

inglad, sorry, [C. 63](#).
 ingoderly, bad, wicked, [B. 145](#), [1092](#).
 inhap, misfortune, [A. 143](#), [1150](#); misery, [B. 892](#). See T. B. 1402.
 inhappen, unfortunate; and hence bad, [B. 573](#).
 inhaspe, disclose, [B. 688](#).
 inhole, badly, [B. 1681](#).
 inhonest, vile, [B. 579](#).
 inhuled, uncovered, [B. 451](#). See [Hile](#).
 inhyde, disclose, [A. 973](#).
 inhyle, disclose, [B. 1628](#). See [Hile](#).
 inknawen, unknown, [B. 1679](#).
 inkyndely, wickedly, [B. 208](#).
 inmard, undefiled, [B. 867](#).
 inmete, unmeet, unfit, [A. 759](#).
 inneuened, unnamed, [B. 727](#). See [Neuen](#).

207

innynge, signs, [C. 213](#). A.S. *unnan*, to give, grant, permit.
 inpynne, to unpin, unfasten, [A. 728](#).
 inresounable, unreasonable, [A. 590](#).
 inryȝt, wrong, [B. 1142](#).
 insmyten, [B. 732](#).
 insounde, wicked, evil, bad, [A. 575](#); [C. 527](#); misfortune, wretched state, [B. 58](#). See T. B. 495.
 insoundely, badly, [B. 201](#). See T. B. 1826.
 instered, unmoved, [B. 706](#).
 instrayned, untroubled, [A. 248](#).
 inswolȝed, unhurt, [B. 1253](#). See [Swolȝe](#).
 Vnþank,
 Vnþonk, wrath, displeasure, [A. 183](#); [B. 55](#).

npewe, fault, vice, [B. 190](#). See *Thewe*.
 npryfte, folly, wickedness, [B. 516](#), [1728](#).
 npryftyly, unwisely, badly, [B. 267](#).
 npryuandly = unthrivingly, badly, [B. 135](#). See T. B. 4893.
 ntrwe, untrue, [A. 897](#); [A. 456](#); unfaithful, [B. 1160](#).
 ntwynne, separate; and hence, destroy, [B. 757](#).
 nwar, foolish, [C. 115](#).
 nwaschen, unwashed, [B. 34](#).
 nwelcum, [B. 49](#).
 nworpelych, unworthy, [B. 305](#).
 nwytté, unwise, foolish, simple, [C. 511](#).
 pbrayde, literally to raise; and hence to utter loudly, rebuke, [C. 430](#). See *Brayde*. In the sense of to utter, speak, we find 207b *upbrayde* used in the following passage.
 “Again my brether haue I bene
 Oft-sith lightly for to tene,
 Wit flitt, wit brixil, strive and strut;
 Myn euen cristen haue I hurt,
 And oft unsaght o him I said,
 And of his lastes (faults) gane upbraid.”
 (Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 156.)
 p-caste, spoken, [B. 1574](#).
 p-folden, up-folded, [B. 643](#).
 p-lyfte, uplifted, [B. 987](#).
 pon, open, [B. 453](#).
 p-rerde, upreared, [B. 561](#).
 p-ros, uprose, [C. 378](#).
 pryse, [C. 433](#).
 p-set, raised, [C. 239](#).
 p-so-doun, upside down, [C. 362](#).
 p-wafte, uprose, [B. 949](#).
 pynyoun, opinion, [C. 40](#).

rnementes, ornaments, [B. 1284](#).

rþe, earth, [A. 442](#).

rþely, earthly, [A. 135](#); [B. 35](#).

sage, [B. 710](#).

sched, [A. 1393](#), *to vsched* = ? *tousched* = *towched*, approached. See [B. 1437](#).

se, [B. 11](#).

Vsle, ashes, cinders, [B. 747](#), [1010](#). A.S. *ysle*, ashes. O.N. *usli*, fire. “Isyl,
Vsle, of fyre. Favilla.” (Prompt. Parv.) Prov.E. *isle*, *easle*, embers; *eizle*,
ashes.

tter, out, [A. 42](#); without, [B. 927](#).

t-wyth, without, outside, [A. 969](#).

us, us, [B. 842](#).

ʒten, the morning, dawn, [B. 893](#). A.S. *uhta*.

“Hi sloʒen and fuʒten
þe niʒt and þe *uʒten*.”

(K. Horn, 1424.)

208

ale, [A. 127](#); [B. 673](#).

anyté, [A. 1713](#); [B. 331](#).

anyste, vanished, [B. 1548](#).

ayle, avail, [A. 912](#); [B. 1151](#), [1311](#).

ayment, exhibition, show, [B. 1358](#).

ayn, [A. 811](#); [B. 1358](#).

ayned, brought, [A. 249](#). See [Wayned](#).

enge, avenge, [A. 199](#), [559](#); [B. 71](#).

engeaunce, [B. 247](#), [1013](#).

Venkkyst,

Venquyst, vanquished, [B. 544](#), [1071](#).

enym, venom, filth, [A. 574](#); [B. 71](#).

Veray,
 Verray, true, [A. 1184, 1185](#); truly, [A. 333](#); very, [C. 370](#).
 verayly, verily, [B. 664, 1548](#).
 veered, veered, raised, [A. 254](#).
 vergyne, virgin, [A. 1099](#).
 Vergynté,
 Vergynyte, virginity, [A. 767](#); [B. 1071](#).
 vertue, [A. 1126](#).
 vertuous, precious, [B. 1280](#).
 essayl, vessel, [B. 1713](#).
 esselment, vessels, [B. 1280, 1288](#).
 esture, [B. 1288](#).
 eued = weued, passed, [A. 976](#). See *Weue*.
 ilanye, [C. 71](#).
 ilté, filth, vileness, [B. 199](#). O.Fr. *vilté*.
 iolent, [B. 1013](#).
 ioched, prayed, [A. 1121](#). Fr. *voucher*.
 iouche, resolve, [B. 1358](#).
 iouched, vowed, [C. 165](#).
 iowe, [C. 239](#).
 ioyde, do away with; [A. 744](#); destroy, [A. 1013](#); [C. 370](#); depart, [B. 1548](#).
 208b
 us, use, or ? drink, [B. 1507](#). We may, however read, and thus preserve the
 alliteration, *bus* = *bous* = *bouse*, to drink deeply. Du. *buysen*.
 ycios, vicious, [B. 574](#).
 yf, wife, [A. 772](#).
 ygour, 971.
 yl, vile, evil, [B. 744](#).

ylanye, crime, sin, [B. 544, 574](#).

yle, defile, [B. 863](#).

yole, vial, [B. 1280](#).

yolence, [B. 1071](#).

yrgyn, [A. 426](#).

Vys,

Vyse, face, [A. 254](#). O.Fr. *vis*.

yuez, wives, [A. 785](#).

W

/ach, watch, [B. 1205](#).

/ade, [A. 143, 1151](#).

/aft, closed, [B. 857](#). A.S. *wefan*, *wæfan*, to cover. O.N. *vefa*.

/afte, move, lift up, raise, [A. 453](#) O.N. *veifa*, to raise, move, swing. *Waft*, [B. 857](#), in the sense of *closed* may be of the same origin with *waft*.

/age, endure, [A. 416](#).

/age, wave, [B. 1484](#). A.S. *wágian*.

/ake, watch, [A. 85](#); [B. 130](#). A.S. *wæccan*. O.N. *vaka*.

/aken, raise, arouse, awake, [A. 1171](#); [A. 323, 437, 891, 933, 948](#); [B. 132](#); O.N. *vakna*.

“Wyndis at hir wille to *wakyn* in the aire.”
(T. B. 404.)

/akker (*comp.* of *wayke*), weaker [B. 835](#).

Wale, vb. discern, [A. 1000](#); choose, select, [A. 921](#); [B. 511](#); *adj.* noble,

Walle, choice, B.

209 1734. Sc. *wale*. See T. 386, 4716. Ger. *wählen*, to choose, select. O.N. *val*, electio, optio, delectus.

“O mister was ther wimmen tuin,
Þat ledd þar liif wit sike and sin,
Ffor þai had husing nan to *wale*,
Þai lended in a littel scale.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 48a.)

“Of choys men syne, *walit* by cut (lot), thai tuke
A gret numbyr, and hyd in bylgis dern.”

(G. Douglas, vol. i. p. 72.)

“Awai þan drou him son Davi,
Bot Saul dred him mo forþi,
And of a thusand men o *wal* (worth)
He made him ledder and marscal.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 43a.)

“That worthy had a wyfe *walit* hym seluon.”

(T. B. 105.)

/alkyries, witches, fate-readers, [B. 1577](#). O.N. *valkyriur*; *f. pl. Parcæ*. Dan. *valkyrier*.

/allande, boiling, bubbling up, [A. 365](#). A.S. *weallan*, to boil up.

/alle-heued = well-head, spring, [B. 364](#).

Walt, rolled, turned, [B. 501](#), [1734](#). Prov.E. *walt*, *welt*. A.S. *wealtian*, to
Walte, roll. O.N. *vella*.

“Hit *walt* up the wilde se.”

(T. B. 4633.)

/alter, roll, flow, [A. 415](#), [1027](#); [B. 142](#). O.Sc. *welter*, *walter*. Dan. *vælte*, to
roll. See [Walt](#).

/alterez, an error for watterez = waters? [C. 263](#).

/alterande, swimming, [C. 247](#).

/altez, pours, rushes, flows, [B. 364](#), [1037](#). See *Walte*, T. B. 3699, 4632.

209b

/ame, belly. See [Wombe](#).

/amel, to wamble, [C. 300](#). O.N. *vambla*. Dan. *vamle*, to wamble, to create or
cause a squeamishness or loathing. “*Wamelyn*’ in the stomake. Nauseo.”

“*Wamelynge* of the stomake, Nausia.” (Prompt. Parv.)

/an (*pret.* of *wynne*), got, reached, [A. 107](#); [B. 140](#).

/ap, a step, [C. 449](#). O.N. *vapp*. It is generally explained by a blow, stroke,
which was probably its original meaning.

“The world wannes at a *wappe* and the wedire gloumes.”

(K. Alex. p. 141.)

“It (worldly wealth) wites away at a *wapp*, as the wynd turnes.”

(*Ibid.* p. 181.)

See T. B. 207, 6405.

/appe, to strike, knock, [B. 882](#).

/ar, aware, [A. 1096](#); crafty, [B. 589](#). A.S. *wær*, wary. O.N. *var*.

War,

Ware, guard, beware, [B. 165](#), [545](#), [1133](#). A.S. *wárian*.

/arded, guarded, [C. 258](#). A.S. *weardian*, to guard.

/are, were, [A. 151](#).

/arisch, protect, [B. 921](#).

/arla3e, wizard, [B. 1560](#). See *Warlow*.

/arlok, prison, [C. 80](#).

/arlow, a monster, [C. 258](#). A.S. *wér-loga*, a liar, a faith-breaker.

“Þe warla3 was wete of his wan atter.”
(T. B. 303.)

/arne, bid, [C. 469](#).

/arnyng, sb. [B. 1504](#).

Warpe, cast, hurl, [A. 444](#); ejaculate, utter, [B. 879](#); 210 B. 152, 213. O.N.

Warpen, *varpa*. A.S. *weorpan*, to throw, cast.

/arpe, a water-ford, [C. 339](#). A.S. *warth*, *waroth*, the shore.

/ary, curse, [B. 513](#). A.S. *wærgian*, to curse.

/aryed, accursed, [B. 1716](#).

/assayl, [B. 1508](#).

Wast,

Waste, destroy, [B. 326](#), [431](#), [1178](#). A.S. *wéstan*.

/asturne, a wilderness, [B. 1674](#). *Wasterne* signifies a desert place, from the A.S. *wéste*, desert, barren, and *ærn*, a place.

“Methoughte I was in a wode willed myne one,
That I ne wiste no waye whedire that I scholde,
Ffore woluez and whilde swynne, swykkyde bestez,
Walkede in that *wasterne* wathes to seche.”
(Morte Arthure, p. 270.)

/ate = wot, know, [A. 502](#). A.S. *witan* (*Ic wát, þu wást, he wát*).

/ater, stream, [A. 107, 139](#); river, [B. 1380](#).

/auleȝ, shelterless, from the A.S. *wáh*, a wall (?), [C. 262](#). We should perhaps read *wanleȝ* = *wonleȝ*, hopeless, from the A.S. *wén*. O.N. *von*. O.E. *wone*, hope.

/awe, wave, [A. 287](#); [A. 382](#); [B. 142](#). A.S. *wæg*.

/ax, increase, [B. 521](#).

/axlokes, waves (?), [B. 1037](#).

/ayferand, wayfaring, [B. 79](#).

/aykned, weakened, [B. 1422](#). O.N. *veikr*. A.S. *wác*, weak; *wácan*, to become weak.

/ayle, select, choice, [B. 1716](#). See [Wale](#).

210b

/aymot, passionate, [C. 492](#). A.S. *weamod*.

/ayne, give, [B. 1504](#); gain, recover, 1616, 1701. The original meaning seems to be that of gaining, getting. O.Fr. *gaagnier*. In some O.E. works *wayne* is used like our word *get*.

“Than past up the proude quene into prevé chambre,
Waynes (i.e. puts out her head) out at wyndow and waytes aboute.”
(K. Alex. p. 33.)

/ayte, look into, search, [A. 99](#); be careful, [A. 292](#); look about, [A. 1423](#); inquire, [B. 1552](#). See T. B. 876. “*Waytyn* or *aspyyn*, observo.” (Prompt. Parv.)

/aȝeȝes, *wazes*, waves, [B. 404](#).

“Girdon ouer the grym *waghes*.”
(T. B. 1410.)

See [Wawe](#).

/ebbe, cloth, [A. 71](#).

/edde, [A. 772](#); [B. 69](#).

/edded wyf, [B. 330](#).

/eddyng, [A. 791](#).

Wed,

Wede, garments, weeds, [A. 748, 766](#); [B. 793](#). A.S. *wæd*.

Wed,
Wede, become mad, [B. 1585](#). A.S. *wédan*, to rave, be mad.

/eder, storm, [B. 444, 948](#).

/eder, weather, [B. 1760](#).

/ela-wynnely, very joyfully, [B. 831](#). A.S. *welig*, rich, bountiful; *wyn*,
pleasure, joy.

Welcom,
Welcum, [B. 813](#).

/elde, govern, rule, wield, [A. 195, 835](#); use, employ, possess, [A. 705, 1351](#);
[B. 16](#). A.S. *wealdan*, rule, exercise, possess.

/elder, ruler, [C. 129](#).

211

/ele, joy (*pl. wele3*), [A. 14, 154, 394](#); [A. 651](#); [B. 262](#). A.S. *wela*.

/elgest, worthiest, [B. 1244](#). A.S. *welig* (*welga*), rich, wealthy.

/elke, walked, [A. 101](#).

/elkyn, welkin, the sky. A.S. *welcn*, *wolcen*. O.Sc. *walk*, a cloud.

/elle-hede3, springs, [B. 428](#).

/elt, revolved, [C. 115](#). See *Walter*.

/elwed, faded, [C. 475](#). A.S. *wealwian*.

“The grond stud burrant, widderit dosk or gray,
Herbis, flowris and gersis *wallowyt* away.”
(G. Douglas, vol. i. p. 378.)

/ely, joyous, happy, [A. 101](#). A.S. *welig*.

“*Welli* make, Laverd, and noght ille,
To Syon in þi gode wille.”
(Ps. i. 20.)

“Þan was þar never suilk a hald,
Ne nan in *welier* in werld to wald.”
(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 55b.)

Wem,
Wemme, spot, blemish, [A. 1003](#). A.S. *wem*.

/emle3, spotless, without blemish.

/enche, woman, [A. 974, 1250](#); concubine, [B. 1716](#). A.S. *wencle*, a maid.
S.Sax. *wenchell*, a child.

/ende = wened, thought, [A. 1148](#); [C. 111](#).

/ene = ween, believe, [A. 47](#); [A. 821](#); [B. 244](#). A.S. *wénan*.

/ene, doubt, [A. 1141](#).

/eng, avenge, [B. 201](#).

/enyng, supposition, [C. 115](#).

/epande, weeping, [C. 384](#).

/eppen, weapon, [B. 835](#).

211b

/ered, guarded, protected, [C. 486](#). A.S. *weren*. Ger. *wehren*, defend.

/erkez, labours, [B. 136](#).

/erp (*pret.* of *warp*), threw, [B. 284](#).

/erre, war, [B. 1178](#).

/ers, worse, [B. 80](#).

/erte, root, herb, [C. 478](#). A.S. *wyrt*.

/eryng, wearing, age, [B. 1123](#). “*Weryn* or wax olde, febyl, *veterasco*.”
(*Prompt. Parv.*)

/esch, washed, [A. 766](#).

/esternays, wrongly, [A. 307](#). See [Note on this word](#), p. 106. ? wiper-ways,
wrong-wise.

/ete, wet, [A. 761](#).

/eue, pass, [A. 318](#).

/eued, cut off (?), [B. 222](#).

/ex (*pret.* of *wax*), became, [A. 538](#); [B. 204](#).

/eze, weigh (anchor), [C. 103](#); carry round, [B. 1420, 1508](#). A.S. *wegan*, to
weigh, carry.

/ezte, weight, [B. 1734](#).

/ham, whom, [A. 131](#).

/hatez = watz, was, [A. 1041](#).

/hat-kyn, what kind of, [B. 100](#).

/hichche = hutch, ark, [B. 362](#). “*Hutche* or *whyche*, cista, archa.” (Prompt. Parv.) A.S. *hwæcca*.

/hyle, moment, [B. 1620](#).

/ite, blame. See [Wyte](#).

/ith-droȝ, withdrew, [A. 658](#).

/ith-nay, refuse, deny, [A. 916](#).

/iȝt = wight, quickly, [C. 103](#). See [Wyȝt](#).

/late, to abhor, hate, detest, [A. 305](#); to be disgusted at, [B. 1501](#). A.S. *wlættian*.

/latsum, hateful, abominable, [B. 541](#).

212

Wlonc, beautiful, [A. 122](#), [1171](#); [A. 606](#), [793](#), [933](#); [C. 486](#); good, [B. 903](#).

Wlonk, A.S. *wlanc*.

Wod, mad, enraged, [A. 204](#), [1558](#); foolish, [A. 828](#); fierce, strong, [A. 364](#);

Wode, [B. 142](#). A.S. *wód*.

/odbynde, woodbine, [C. 446](#).

/odder (*comp.* of *wode*), fiercer, rougher, [C. 162](#).

/oghe, wrong, sin, [A. 622](#). A.S. *woh*.

/olde = walde, perform, do, [A. 812](#). See [Welde](#).

/olde, would, [A. 772](#).

/olen, woollen, [A. 731](#).

/olle, wool, [A. 844](#).

/ombe, belly, [B. 462](#), [1250](#).

Won, sb. dwelling, abode, [A. 32](#), [1049](#); [A. 140](#), [928](#); woneȝ, [A. 917](#), [924](#);

Wone, vb. to dwell, [A. 404](#), [298](#); [B. 875](#). A.S. *wunian*. O.Fris. *wona*.

/on = wone, custom, usage, [B. 720](#). A.S. *wune*.

/onde, fear, hesitate, [B. 855](#). A.S. *wandian*.

/onde = wande, delay, cease, [A. 153](#).

“[I wole] for no dethe *wonde*.”

(T. B. 591.)

“I wille noghte *wonde* for no werre,
To wende whare me likes.”

(Morte Arthure, p. 292.)

“Sua did þis wiif I yow of redd,
Sco folud Joseph ai þar he fledd,
And for sco foluand fand a spurn,
Sco waited him wit a werr turn,
Hirself in godds gram and gilt,
And almost did him to be spilt;
How sco broght him to the fand (trial),
Fforth to telle wil I noght *waand*.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 25a.)

212b

/onder, *adj.* wonderful, [A. 1095](#); [B. 153](#).

/onderly, wonderfully, [A. 570](#); [B. 384](#).

/oned = waned, decreased, [B. 496](#). A.S. *wanian*, to decrease.

/onen (*pret. pl.*) got, [B. 1777](#).

/onne, pale, wan, [C. 141](#). A.S. *wonn*, wan.

/onne, got, [A. 32](#).

/onnen, begotten, [B. 112](#).

/onnyng, dwelling, [B. 921](#). See [Won](#).

/ont, be wanting, [B. 739](#).

/ony, dwell, abide, live, [A. 284](#); [A. 431](#); [B. 462](#). See [Won](#).

/onyande, dwelling, living, [B. 293](#).

/onys, dwells, [A. 47](#).

/orche, *vb.* work, labour, [A. 511](#).

/orcher = worker, maker, [B. 1501](#).

/orchyp, honour, [B. 1802](#).

/orded, spoken, uttered, [C. 421](#).

/ore, were, [A. 142](#), [232](#); [B. 928](#).

/orme, reptile, [B. 533](#).

/orre, weaker, literally, worse, [B. 719](#). O.N. *verr*. Sw. *värre*. O.Sc. *war*. O.E. *werr*, worse.

/orschyp, honour, [A. 394](#).

/orteȝ, herbs, [A. 42](#). See *Werte*.

/orpe, to be, [C. 22](#).

Worpely,

Worpelych,

Worply,

Worplych,

Worpyly,

worthy, [A. 47](#), [846](#), [1073](#); [B. 471](#), [651](#), [1298](#), [1351](#); beautiful, [C. 475](#).

/orploker, more worthy (*comp.* of *worpelych*), [C. 464](#).

Wost,

Woste, knowest, [A. 293](#), [411](#); [B. 875](#). See *Wot*.

/ot, know, [A. 47](#), [1107](#); [C. 129](#).

213

/ote, knows, [C. 397](#).

/ope, hurt, harm, [B. 855](#). This word occurs under the forms *quathe*, *wathe*, and seems to be related to O.E. *qued*. Low Ger. *quat*, bad. O.E. *wathe*, bad; *wathely*, badly.

“Ffor woþe of þe worse.”

(T. B. 1223.)

/ope, path, [A. 151](#), [375](#). A.S. *wáth*, *wáthu*. O.E. *wathe*, a way, path. See extract under the word *Wasturne*.

Wowe, wall, [A. 1049](#); [B. 832](#), [839](#), [1403](#), [1531](#). A.S. *wáh*. “Wowe or wal, Woȝe, murus.” (Prompt. Parv.)

/rache, vengeance, [A. 204](#), [229](#); [B. 185](#). A.S. *wrec*, *wracu*.

/rak (*pret.* of *wreke*), avenged, [B. 570](#).

/rake, vengeance, [B. 213](#), [235](#), [718](#), [970](#), [1225](#).

/rakful, angry, bitter, [B. 302](#), [541](#).

/rang, wrong, [A. 15](#); [A. 76](#); wrongly, [A. 488](#), [631](#); bad, [B. 384](#).

/raste (*pret.* of *wreste*), raised, uplifted, [A. 1166, 1403](#); thrust, 1802; [B. 80](#).

Wrastel,

Wrastle, wrestle, [A. 949](#); [B. 141](#).

/rape, become angry, [A. 230](#); [C. 74](#); make angry, [B. 719](#).

/raʒte, wrought, [A. 56](#).

/rech = wrache, vengeance, [B. 230](#).

Wrech, }

Wreche, }

Wrechche, }

wretch, [A. 84, 828](#); [B. 113](#).

/rech, wretched, [C. 258](#). A.S. 213b *wrec*, wretched. With *wrech* and *wretched*, cf. *wik* and *wikked*.

Wrek,

Wreke, avenged, [B. 198](#).

/renche, device, [B. 292](#). A.S. *wrence*.

/ro, passage; literally, corner, [A. 866](#). O.Sw. *wraa*. Dan. *vraa*.

/roken, (*pret.* of *wreke*), banished, exiled, [A. 375](#). A.S. *wrecan*, to exile, banish.

/rot (*pret.* of *wrote*), grubbed up, [C. 467](#). A.S. *wrótan*, to turn up with the snout; *wrót*, a snout.

“With wrathe he begynnus to wrote,

He ruskes vppe mony a rote

With tusshes of iij. fote.”

(Avowynge of Arthur, xii. 13.)

/rope, fierce, [B. 1676](#). A.S. *wráth*, wroth, enraged.

/ropeloker (*comp.* of *wropely*), more fiercely, angrily, [C. 132](#).

Wropely,

Wroply, angrily, fiercely, [A. 280, 949](#); [B. 132](#).

/roper (*comp.* of *wrope*), fiercer, [C. 162](#).

Wroʒt,

Wroʒte, wrought, worked, [A. 525, 748](#).

/ruxeled, raised, [B. 1381](#). *Wrixle* = change, turn, occurs in T. B. 445.

“Dis unwarnes of wit *wrixlis* hys mynd.”

/ryst, [B. 1535](#).

/ryt, [B. 1552](#).

/rype, turn, [A. 350](#), [488](#); wriggle, [A. 533](#); toil, [A. 511](#); bind, thrust, [B. 80](#).
A.S. *wriþan*, to writhe, bind, twist. “*Writhen* like a wilde eddur.” T. B. 4432.

/under, [B. 1390](#).

/unnen, won, [B. 1305](#).

214

/yche, [B. 1577](#).

/yche-crafte, [B. 1560](#).

/yddere, wither, [C. 468](#).

/ydowande (*wyndowande*), withering, dry, [B. 1048](#); *wyndowand* = burnt up.
N.Prov.E. *winny*, to dry, burn up.

/yke, member, part, [B. 1690](#). O.N. *vik*.

Wykke, wicked, [B. 908](#), [1063](#). A.S. *wícan*, to become weak, to yield.

Wyk, O.N. *víkia*.

Wykket,

Wyket, wicket, gate, door, [B. 501](#), [857](#).

Wyl, wandering, [C. 473](#); forlorn, [B. 76](#). O.N. *villa*, error; *villa*, to lead
Wylle, astray, beguile. Phrase, *wille o wan*, astray from abode, uncertain
where to go; *wil-sum*, *wil-ful*, lonely, solitary, desert.

“So I *wilt* in the wod.”

(T. B. 2359.)

“Adam went out ful *wille* o wan.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 7a.)

“All wery I wex and wyle of my *gate*.”

(T. B. 2369.)

“Sone ware thay *willid* fra the way the wod was so thick.”

(K. Alex. p. 102.)

“Sorful bicom þat fals file (the devil)

And thocht how he moght man *bi-wille*;

Agains God wex he sa gril,

þat alle his werk he wend to spil.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 5b.)

“His suns þat (we) of forwit melt,
Al þe werld bituix þam delt;
Asie to Sem, to Cham Affrik,
To Japhet Europ þat *wilful* wike:
Al þer þre þai war ful rike.”

(*Ibid.* fol. 13a.)

/yldren = wyldern (?), waste, wilderness, [C. 297](#). A.S. *wild*, 214b *wild*, and *ærn*, a place (?). See [Wasturne](#).

“In *wildrin* land and in wastin,
I wil tham (the Israelites) bring of þair nocin;
Bot wel I wat he (Pharaoh) is ful thra,
Lath sal him think to let þam ga.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 33a.)

/ylsfully, wilfully, [B. 268](#).

/ylger, wild, fierce, [B. 375](#). See [extract under the word Note](#).

/ylle, forlorn, [B. 76](#). See [Wyl](#).

/ylnes, apostacy, [B. 231](#).

/ylneȝ, desirest (2d pers. sing of *wylne*), [A. 318](#). A.S. *wilnian*.

/yly, curiously, craftily, [B. 1452](#). A.S. *wile*, a device.

/yndas, windlass, [C. 103](#).

/yndowe, [B. 453](#).

/ynne, joyful, [A. 154](#). A.S. *wyn*, pleasure, delight.

/ynne, obtain, get, [A. 579](#); [B. 617](#). A.S. *winnan*. See T. B. 1165.

/ynnelych, gracious, [B. 1807](#), Cp. *wynly* = dexterously, 1165.

/yrde, fate, destiny, [A. 249](#), [273](#); [B. 1224](#). Sc. *wird*. A.S. *wyrd*.

/yrle, flew, [B. 475](#).

/yschande, hoping for, wishing, [A. 14](#).

/yse, manner, [A. 1095](#); *wyses*, [B. 1805](#).

Wyse, show, appear, [A. 1135](#), [A. 1564](#); direct, send out, [A. 453](#); instruct,

Wysse, [B. 60](#). A.S. *wissian*.

Wyst,

Wyste, knew, [A. 376](#); [B. 152](#).

/yt, wisdom, [A. 348](#); [B. 129](#).

/yt, know, learn, [B. 1319](#), [1360](#). A.S. *witan*.

215

/yte, blame, [A. 76](#); [B. 501](#). A.S. *wítian*.

/yte, pass away (?), [C. 397](#). A.S. *wítan*.

/yter, true, truly, [B. 1552](#). O.N. *vittr*, wise, prudent.

“& her ice wile shæwenn ȝaw
Summ þing to *witter* tákenn.”

(Ormulum, vol. i. p. 115.)

“Ne þe nedder was noght bitter
þan, þowf he was ever *witter*;
Ffor of alle, als sheus þe boke,
Mast he cuth o crafte and crok.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 5b.)

/ytered, informed, [B. 1587](#).

/yterly, truly, [B. 171](#), [1567](#). Dan. *witterlig*, known, manifest.

/ype, gentle, soft, [C. 454](#). A.S. *wéthe*, soft, pleasant.

/yper, contrary, opposite, [A. 230](#); adverse, hostile, [C. 48](#). S.Sax. *witherr*,
adverse, evil. A.S. *witherian*, to oppose, resist. Cf. *wetheruns* = *wetherings*,
enemies, T. B. 5048.

“Ga, *witherr* gast, o bacch fra me.”

(Ormulum, vol. ii. p. 41.)

/yperly, fiercely, angrily, [A. 198](#); [B. 74](#).

/yth-halde, withhold, [B. 740](#).

/ythouten, without, [A. 390](#).

/ytles, foolish, [A. 1585](#); [B. 113](#).

/ytte, meaning, [A. 1630](#); wit, [A. 294](#); *wytteȝ*, devices, [B. 515](#).

Wyȝ, person, being, [A. 131](#), [579](#); [B. 545](#). A.S. *wiga*, a warrior, soldier;

Wyȝe, *wig*, war.

/yȝt, quick, quickly, [A. 617](#); [B. 103](#). O.E. *wight*. Sw. *vig*, active.

/yȝtly, quickly, [B. 908](#).

“He waites vmbe hym *wightly*.”

(T. B. 876.)

Y

dropike, dropsical, [B. 1096](#).

le, isle, [A. 693](#).

lle, bad, evil, [C. 8](#).

nde, blue, [A. 1016](#); [B. 1411](#).

“ƿe toiƿer heu neist (to grennes) for to find,
Es al o *bleu*, men cals it *ynd*.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 53a.)

ow, you, [A. 287](#).

or, your, [A. 761](#).

re, anger, [B. 775](#), [1240](#).

ƿe, wave, [A. 430](#); [B. 147](#). A.S. *ythu*, a wave, flood. S.Sax. *uthe*.

“ƿe roghe *yƿes*.” —T. B. 1045.

Ʒe, eye (*pl. yƷen*), [A. 254](#), [302](#).

3

are = yare, plainly, accurately, [A. 834](#). A.S. *gearo*, ready, prepared, accurate.

ark, *adj.* select, [A. 652](#); prepare, [A. 1708](#); *vb.* to grant, [B. 758](#). A.S. *gearcian*, to prepare, make ready. See T. B. 414.

arm, cry, [B. 971](#). As the character 3 in these poems always represents *g* or *gh*, 3arm is evidently not derived from the A.S. *cyrn*, noise, retained in O.E. *charm*, a humming noise, the cry of birds, etc., but is from the Welsh *garm*, shout, outcry; *garmio*, to set up a cry, from which the A.S. *cyrn*, is itself derived.

ate, gate, [A. 1034](#).

e, ye, [A. 381](#).

ede (*pret.* of *go*), went, [A. 526](#), [1049](#); [B. 432](#).

ederly, quickly, soon, [B. 463](#). O.N. *gedugr*, exceedingly. The adjective *3eder* does not occur in the poems, but was not unknown to O.E. literature. It occurs in the glossary to the Romance of King Alexander, ed. Stevenson, but is left unexplained by the editor.

“Then bownes agayn the bald kyng, baldly he wepis,
That he so skitly suld skifte and fo his skars terme;
So did his princes, sais the profe, for pete of himselfe,
With *3edire* 3oskinges and 3erre 3ette out to grete.”

(p. 172.)

“*3edire* 3oskinges = great (frequent) sobbings.”

elde, yield, perform, [B. 665](#).

ellyng = yelling, outcry, [B. 971](#). A.S. *geallian*, to yell. “*3ellyn*’ or hydowsly cryin’, Vociferor.” (Prompt. Parv.)

eme, protect, guard, [B. 1242](#), [1493](#). A.S. *géman*, to care for, take care of.

emen, yeomen, [A. 535](#).

ender, yonder, [B. 1617](#).

3ep,

3epe, quick, active, bold, [B. 796](#), [881](#). A.S. *gæp*.

“So yonge & so *3epe*.” T. B. 357.

eply, quickly, [B. 665](#), [1708](#). See T. B. 414.

3er,

3ere, year, [A. 483](#), [588](#).

erne = yearn, desire, [A. 1190](#); [B. 66](#), [758](#).

estande, [B. 846](#). If from the A.S. *gæston*, “afflicted,” we may render this term “afflicting,” but if, as is more probable, it is from the A.S. *gist*, froth, yeast, we may explain it as “frothing,” “overflowing.” Cf. the phrase, “the *yesty* waves.”

216b

ete, offer, give, [A. 558](#). O.E. *yate* (pret. *yatte*). O.N. *géta*.

“He *yatte* hir freli al hir bone (prayer).”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 47a.)

Gate, in T. B. 979, seems to mean a request.

“And he hir graunted þat *gate* with a good wille.”

ete, yet, [A. 1061](#).

eized, spoke, [B. 846](#). Prov. Ger. *gaggen*, to stutter, gabble.

if, if, [B. 758](#).

ise, truly, yes, [C. 117](#).

isterday, yesterday, [B. 463](#).

okke, yoke, [B. 66](#).

olden, restored, [B. 1708](#).

olpe, vb. boast, [B. 846](#). A.S. *gilpan*.

omerly, sorrowful, lamentable, [B. 971](#). A.S. *geomor*, sad; *geomorlíc*, doleful.
Cf. *zomeryng*, T. B. 1722.

on, yon, [A. 693](#); [B. 772](#).

onde, yonder, [B. 721](#).

3ong,

3onge, young, [A. 412, 474](#); [B. 783](#).

ore, before, [A. 586](#). A.S. *geara*.

ore-fader, forefather, [A. 322](#).

ore-whyle, ere-while, [B. 842](#).

ornen (3rd pers. pl. pret.), ran, [B. 881](#). A.S. *ge-yrnan*, to run.

yrð, go, hasten, [A. 635](#). The original meaning of *zyrd* is perhaps a sudden
sting, blow, hence to strike, then to start forward. Goth. *gazd*, a sting, goad.
Lat. *hasta*. O.E. *gird*, to strike.

“Gird out the grete teth of the grym best.”
(T. B. 177.)

B. The word “comynes” appears at B. 1747, but the only number that fits the blank space is 111. This entry is not in the 1864 edition; the editor may have left a space, intending to come back and fill in the correct line number.

Comyne, B. 111. See T.B. 12863.

This e-text is based on the 1869 (second) edition of the *Alliterative Poems*. A few apparent misprints were checked against the 1864 edition, but the texts as a whole were not closely compared.

The text includes characters that will only display in UTF-8 (Unicode) text readers, primarily ȝ ȝ (yogh). There are also a few Greek words in the Index, and a handful of letters with overline or macron, such as ī. If these characters do not display properly, or if the quotation marks in this paragraph appear as garbage, you may have an incompatible browser or unavailable fonts. First, make sure that your browser's "character set" or "file encoding" is set to Unicode (UTF-8). You may also need to change the default font.

All brackets are in the original.

Typographical errors are shown with mouse-hover popups. Quotation-mark errors—especially orphaned open quotes—are similarly marked. In some cases it may be possible to guess where the missing quotation mark belongs, but it seemed safer to leave the text as printed. No quotation marks disappeared between the 1864 and 1869 editions.

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EDITED FROM
THE UNIQUE MANUSCRIPT
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NERO A. x

BY

RICHARD MORRIS

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PREFACE.

All page references in Arabic numerals refer to the main text, located in a separate file. Parenthetical Roman numerals *do not* correspond to the editor's section headings, but the text summary is generally similar to the appropriate headnote.

THE following poems are taken from a well known manuscript in the Cottonian collection, marked Nero A. x, which also contains, in the same handwriting and dialect, a metrical romance, ¹ wherein the adventures of Sir

Gawayne with the “Knight in Green,” are most ably and interestingly described.

Unfortunately nothing can be affirmed with any certainty concerning the authorship of these most valuable and interesting compositions. The editor of “Syr Gawayn and the Green Knight” considers that Huchowne, a supposed ² Scotch *maker* of the fourteenth century, has the best claims to be recognised as the author, inasmuch as he is specially referred to by Wyntown as the writer of the *Gret gest of Arthure* and the *Awntyre of Gawayne*.

I do not think that any certain conclusions are to be drawn from the Scotch historian’s assertion. It is well known that more versifiers than one during the fourteenth century attempted romance composition in the English language, having for their theme the knightly deeds of Arthur or Sir Gawayne. These they compiled from French originals, from which they selected the most striking incidents and those best suited to an Englishman’s taste for the marvellous. We are not surprised, ^{vi} then, at finding so many romance poems treating of the exploits of the same hero, and laying claim to be considered as original productions. In Scotland, Huchowne’s works might no doubt have been regarded as the standard romances of the period, but that they were the only English *gests* is indeed very doubtful.

The Early English alliterative romance, entitled the *Morte Arthure*, published from a manuscript in Lincoln Cathedral by Mr. Halliwell, ³ is considered by Sir F. Madden to be the veritable *gest of Arthure* composed by Huchowne. An examination of this romance does not lead me to the same conclusion, unless Huchowne was a Midland man, for the poem is not written in the old Scotch dialect, ⁴ but seems to have been originally composed in one of the Northumbrian dialects spoken *South* of the Tweed. ⁵

The manuscript from which Mr. Halliwell has taken his text is not the original copy, nor even a literal transcript of it. It exhibits certain orthographical and grammatical peculiarities unknown to the Northumbrian dialect which have been introduced by a Midland transcriber, who has here and there taken ^{vii} the liberty to adapt the original text to the dialect of his own locality, probably that one of the North Midland counties, where many of the Northumbrian forms of speech would be intelligible. ⁶

A comparison of the Arthurian romance with the following poems throws no light whatever upon the authorship of the poems. The dialect of the two works is altogether different, although many of the terms employed are common to both, being well known over the whole of the North of England. The grammatical forms (the best test we can have) in the poems are quite distinct from those in the *Morte Arthure*, and of course go far to prove that they do not proceed from the pen of the same writer.

The Editor of “Syr Gawayn and the Green Knight” acknowledges that the poems in the present volume, as now preserved to us in the manuscript, are not in the Scottish dialect, but he says “there is sufficient internal evidence of their being *Northern*,⁷ although the manuscript containing them appears to have been written by a scribe of the Midland counties, which will account for the introduction of forms differing from those used by writers beyond the Tweed.”

Now, with regard to this subsequent transcription of the poems from the Scotch into a Midland dialect,—it cannot be ^{viii} said to be improbable, for we have abundant instances of the multiplication of copies by scribes of different localities, so that we are not surprised at finding the works of some of our popular Early English writers appearing in two or three forms; but, on the other hand, a comparison of the original copy with the *adapted transcriptions*, or even the reading of a transcribed copy, always shows how the author’s productions have suffered by the change. Poetical works, especially those with final rhymes, of course undergo the greatest amount of transformation and depreciation. The changes incident upon the kind of transcription referred to are truly surprising, and most perplexing to those who make the subject of Early English *dialects* a matter of investigation.

But, in the present poems, the uniformity and consistency of the grammatical forms is so entire, that there is indeed no internal evidence of subsequent transcription into any other dialect than that in which they were originally written. However, the dialect and grammatical peculiarities will be considered hereafter.

Again, in the course of transcription into another dialect, any literary merit that the author’s copy may have originally possessed would certainly be destroyed. But the poems before us are evidently the work of a man of birth and education; the productions of a true poet, and of one who had acquired a

perfect mastery over that form of the English tongue spoken in his own immediate locality during the earlier part of the fourteenth century. Leaving out of consideration their great philological worth, they possess an intrinsic value of their own as literary compositions, very different from anything to be found in the works of Robert of Gloucester, Manning, and many other Early English authors, which are very important as philological records, but in the light of poetical productions, cannot be said to hold a very distinguished place in English literature. The poems in the present volume contain many ^{ix} passages which, as Sir F. Madden truly remarks, will bear comparison with any similar ones in the works of Douglas or Spenser.

I conclude, therefore, that these poems were not transcribed from the Scotch dialect into any other, but were written in their own West-Midland speech in which we now have them.

Mr. Donaldson, who is now editing for the Early English Text Society the *Troy Book*, translated from Guido di Colonna, puts forward a plea for Huchowne as its author, to whom he would also assign the *Morte Arthure* (ed. Perry) and the *Pistel of Sweet Susan*. ⁸ But Mr. Donaldson seems to have been misled by the similarity of vocabulary, which is not at all a safe criterion in judging of works written in a Northumbrian, West or East Midland speech. The dialect, I venture to think, is a far safer test. A careful examination of the *Troy Book* compels me to differ in toto from Mr. Donaldson, and, instead of assigning the *Troy Book* to a Scotchman, say that it cannot even be claimed, in its present form, by any Northumbrian south of the Tweed; moreover, it presents no appearance of having been tampered with by one unacquainted with the dialect, though it has perhaps been slightly modernised in the course of transcription.

The work is evidently a genuine West-Midland production, ⁹ having most of the peculiarities of vocabulary and inflexions that are found in these *Alliterative Poems*. ¹⁰ I feel greatly inclined to claim this English *Troy Book* as the production of the author of the *Alliterative Poems*; for, leaving out identical and by no means common expressions, we find the same power of ^x description, ¹¹ and the same tendency to inculcate moral and religious truths on all occasions where an opportunity presents itself. ¹² Without dwelling upon this topic, which properly falls to the Editor of the *Troy Book*, it may not be out of place to ask the reader to compare the following description of a

storm from the Troy Book, with that selected from the present volume on pp. 14 and 18.

A TEMPEST ON ÞE SEE.

There a tempest *hom* toke on þe torres hegh:—
A *rak* and a royde wynde rose in *hor* saile,
A myst & a *merkenes* was mervell to se;
With a *routond* rayn ruthe to be-holde,
Thonret ¹³ full *throly* with a thicke haile;
With a leuenyng light as a *low* fyre,
Blaset all the brode see as it bren wold.
The flode with a felle cours flowet on hepis,
Rose uppon rockes as any *ranke* hylles.
So wode were the waghes & þe wilde *ythes*,
All was like to be lost þat no lond hade
The ship ay shot furth o þe *shire waghes*,
As qwo clymbe at a clyffe, or a clent ¹⁴ hille.
Eft *dump* in the depe as all drowne wolde.
Was no *stightlyng* with stere ne no stithe ropes,
Ne no sayle, þat might serue for *unsound* wedur.
But all the buernes in the bote, as *hom* best liked,
Besoght unto sainttes & to sere goddes; (p. 65)

A STORME ON THE SE.

All the company enclinet cairyn to ship;
Cachyn in cables, knyt up *hor* ancrs,
Sesit vp *hor* sailes in a sad hast;
Richet þere rapes, rapit unto see.
xi
Hokit out of hauyn, all the hepe somyn,
Hade bir at hor bake, blawen to þe depe;
Sailyn forthe *soberly*, somyn but a while,
Noght fyftene forlong fairly to the end.
.
When sodenly the softe aire *unsoberly* rose;
The cloudis overcast, *clatterit* aboute;
Wyndes full wodely *walt* up the *ythes*;
Wex *merke* as the mydnighte mystes full thicke:
Thunret in the *thestur throly* with all;
With a *launchant laite* lightonyd the water;
And a *ropand* rayne *raiked* fro the heuyn.

The storme was full stithe with mony stout windes,
Hit *walt* up the wilde se vpon wan hilles.
The ffolke was so ferd, that *on flete* were,
All drede for to drowne with dryft of the se;
And in perell were put all the proude kynges.

—(p. 150.)

The poems in the present volume, three in number, seem to have been written for the purpose of enforcing, by line upon line and precept upon precept, Resignation to the will of God; Purity of life as manifested in thought, word, and deed; Obedience to the Divine command; and Patience under affliction.

In the first poem, entitled by me “*The Pearl*”, the author evidently gives expression to his own sorrow for the loss of his infant child, a girl of two years old, whom he describes as a

Perle plesaunte to prynces paye
Pearl pleasant to princes' pleasure,
To clanly clos in golde so clere
Most neatly set in gold so clear.

Of her death he says:

Allas! I leste hyr in on erbere
Alas! I lost her in an arbour,
Þurȝ gresse to grounde hit fro me yot
Through grass to ground it from me got. —(p. 1.)

The writer then represents himself as visiting his child's grave (or arbour) in the “high season of August,” and giving way to his grief (p. 2). He falls asleep, and in a dream is carried ^{xii} toward a forest, where he saw rich rocks gleaming gloriously, hill sides decked with crystal cliffs, and trees the leaves of which were as burnished silver. The gravel under his feet was “precious pearls of orient,” and birds “of flaming hues” flew about in company, whose notes were far sweeter than those of the cytole or gittern (guitar) (p. 3). The dreamer arrives at the bank of a stream, which flows over stones (shining like stars in the welkin on a winter's night) and pebbles of emeralds, sapphires, or other precious gems, so

Þat all the loȝe lemed of lyȝt
That all the deep gleamed of light,
So dere watȝ hit adubement
So dear was its adornment. —(p. 4.)

Following the course of the stream, he perceives on the opposite side a crystal cliff, from which was reflected many a “royal ray” (p. 5).

At þe fote þer-of þer sete a faunt
At the foot thereof there sat a child,
A mayden of menske, ful debonere
A maiden of honour, full debonnair;
Blysnande whyt wat3 hyr bleaunt
Glistening white was her robe,
(I knew hyr wel, I hade sen hyr ere)
(I knew her well, I had seen her before)
At glysnande golde þat man con schore
As shining gold that man did purify,
So schon þat schene an-vnder schore
So shone that sheen (bright one) on the opposite shore;
On lenghe I loked to hyr þere
Long I looked to her there,
þe lenger I knew hyr more & more
The longer I knew her, more and more. —(pp. 6, 7.)

The maiden rises, and, proceeding along the bank of the stream, approaches him. He tells her that he has done nothing but mourn for the loss of his Pearl, and has been indeed a “joyless jeweller” (p. 8). However, now that he has found his Pearl, ^{xiii} he declares that he is no longer sorrowful, but would be a “joyful jeweller” were he allowed to cross the stream (p. 8). The maiden blames her father for his rash speech, tells him that his Pearl is not lost, and that he cannot pass the stream till after death (p. 10). The dreamer is in great grief; he does not, he says, care what may happen if he is again to lose his Pearl. The maiden advises him to bear his loss patiently, and to abide God’s doom (p. 11). She describes to him her blissful state in heaven, where she reigns as a queen (p. 12). She explains to him that Mary is the Empress of Heaven, and all others kings and queens (p. 13). The parable of the labourers in the vineyard ¹⁵ (pp. 15-18) is then rehearsed at length, to prove that “innocents” are admitted to the same privileges as are enjoyed by those who have lived longer upon the earth (p. 18). The maiden then speaks to her father of Christ and his one hundred and forty thousand brides (p. 24), and describes their blissful state (p. 26). She points out to him the heavenly Jerusalem, which was “all of bright burnished gold, gleaming like glass” (p. 29). Then the dreamer beholds a procession of virgins going to salute the Lamb, among whom he perceives his “little queen” (p. 33). On attempting to cross the stream

to follow her, he is aroused from his dream (p. 35), laments his rash curiosity in seeking to know so much of God's mysteries, and declares that man ever desires more happiness than he has any right to expect (p. 35).

The second poem, entitled "*Cleanness*," is a collection of Biblical stories, in which the writer endeavours to enforce Purity of Life, by showing how greatly God is displeased at every kind of impurity, and how sudden and severe is the punishment which falls upon the sinner for every violation of the Divine law.

After commending cleanness and its "fair forms," the author relates (I.) The Parable of the Marriage Feast (p. 39); xiv (II.) the Fall of the Angels (p. 43); (III.) The wickedness of the antediluvian world (p. 44),

He wat3 famed for fre þat fezt loued best
He was famous as free that fight loved best,
& ay þe bigest in bale þe best wat3 halden
And ever the biggest in sin the best was held; (p. 45.)

(IV.) The destruction of mankind by the Flood. When all were safely stowed in the ark,

Thenne sone com þe seuenþe day, when samned wern alle
Then soon came the seventh day when assembled were all,
& alle woned in þe whichche þe wylde & þe tame.
And all abode in the ark (hutch), the wild and the tame.
þen bolned þe abyme & bonke3 con ryse
Then swelled the abyss and banks did rise,
Waltes out vch walle-heued, in ful wode streme3
Bursts out each well-head in full wild streams,
Wat3 no brymme þat abod vnbrosten bylyue
There was no brim (stream) that abode unburst by then,
þe mukel lauande loghe to þe lyfte rered
The much (great) flowing deep (loch) to the loft (sky) reared.
Mony clustered clowde clef alle in clowte3
Many a clustering cloud cleft all in clouts (pieces),
To-rent vch a rayn-ryfte & rusched to þe vrþe
Rent was each a rain-rift and rushed to the earth;
Fon neuer in forty daye3, & þen þe flod ryse3
Failed never in forty days, and then the flood rises,
Ouer-walte3 vche a wod and þe wyde felde3
Over-flows each wood and the wide fields;
.
Water wylger ay wax, wone3 þat stryede

Water wildly ever waxed, abodes that destroyed,
 Hurlid in-to vch hous, hent þat þer dowelled
Hurled into each house, seized those that there dwelt.
 Fyrst feng to þe fly3t alle þat fle my3t
First took to flight all that flee might,
 Vuche burde with her barne þe byggyng þay leue3
Each bride (woman) with her bairn their abode they leave,
 & bowed to þe hy3 bonk þer brentest hit wern
And hied to the high bank where highest it were,
 xv
 & heterly to þe hy3e hille3 þay [h]aled on faste
And hastily to the high hills they rushed on fast;
 Bot al wat3 nedle3 her note, for neuer cowþe stynt
But all was needless their device, for never could stop
 Þe ro3e raynande ryg [&] þe raykande wawe3
The rough raining shower and the rushing waves,
 Er vch boþom wat3 brurd-ful to þe bonke3 egge3
Ere each bottom (valley) was brim-ful to the banks' edges,
 & vche a dale so depe þat demmed at þe brynke3
And each dale so deep that dammed at the brinks. —(pp. 47, 48).

The ark is described as “heaved on high with hurling streams.”

Kest to kype3 vncoupe þe clowde3 ful nere
Cast to kingdoms uncouth the clouds ful near,
 Hit waltered on the wylde flod, went as hit lyste
It tossed on the wild flood, went as it list,
 Drof vpon þe depe dam, in daunger hit semed
It drove upon the deep dam, in danger it seemed,
 With-uten mast, oþer myke, oþer myry bawe-lyne
Without mast, or mike, or merry bow-line,
 Kable, oþer capstan to clyppe to her ankre3
Cable or capstan to clip to their anchors,
 Hurrok, oþer hande-helme hasped on roþer
Oar or hand-helm hooked on rudder,
 Oþer any sweande sayl to seche after hauen
Or any swinging sail to seek after haven,
 Bot flote forthe with þe flyt of þe felle wynde3
But floated forth with the force of the fell winds.
 Wheder-warde so þe water wafte, hit rebounde
Whither-ward so (as) the water waft, it rebounded,
 Ofte hit roled on-rounde & rered on ende
Oft it rolled around and reared on end,
 Nyf our lorde hade ben her lode3-mon hem had lumpen harde
Had our Lord not been their (pilot) leader hardship had befallen them. —(p. 49.)

mike] See Glossary.

(V.) The Visit of Three Angels to Abraham (p. 54).

(VI.) The destruction of Sodom and Gomorrah (pp. 64, 65), including a description of the Dead Sea, the tarn (lake) of traitors (p. 66).

xvi

(VII.) The invasion of Jerusalem by Nebuchadnezzar (p. 71), and the captivity of Judah (p. 74).

The following is a paraphrase of the fourth and fifth verses in the twenty-fifth chapter of the second book of Kings. ¹⁷

Þenne þe kyng of þe kyth a counsayl hym takes
Then the king of the kingdom a counsel him takes,
Wyth þe best of his burnes, a blench for to make
With the best of his men a device for to make;
Þay stel out on a styлле nyȝt er any steuen rysed
They stole out on a still night ere any sound arose,
& harde hurles þurȝ þe oste, er enmies hit wyste
And hard hurled through the host, ere enemies it wist,
Bot er þay at-wappe ne moȝt þe wach wyth oute
But ere they could escape the watch without,
Hiȝe skelt watȝ þe askry þe skewes an-vnder
High scattered was the cry, the skies there under,
Loude alarom vpon launde lulted was þenne
Loud alarm upon land sounded was then;
Ryche, ruped of her rest, ran to here wedes,
Rich (men) roused from their rest, ran to their weeds,
Hard hattes þay hent & on hors lepes
Kettle hats they seized, and on horse leap;
Cler claryoun crak cryed on-lofte
Clear clarion's crack cried aloft.
By þat watȝ alle on a hepe hurlande swyȝee
By that (time) was all on a heap, hurling fast,
Folȝande þat oȝer flote, & fonde hem bilyue
Following that other fleet (host), and found them soon,
Ouer-tok hem, as tyd, tult hem of sadeles
Over-took them in a trice, tilted them off saddles,
Tyl vche prynce hade his per put to þe grounde
Till each prince had his peer put to the ground;
& þer watȝ þe kyng kaȝt wyth calde prynces
And there was the king caught with crafty princes,

xvii

& alle hise gentyle for-iusted on Ierico playnes
And all his nobles vanquished on Jericho's plains. —(pp. 71, 72.)

as tyd] Immediately.

(VIII.) Belshazzar's impious feast (pp. 76-80), and the handwriting upon the wall (pp. 80, 81).

In þe palays pryncipale vpon þe playn wowe
In the palace principal upon the plain wall,
In contrary of þe candelstik þat clerest hit schyned
Opposite to the candlestick that clearest there shone.
Þer apered a paume, with poyntel in fyngres
There appeared a palm with a pointel in its fingers,
Þat wat3 grysly & gret, & grymly he wrytes
That was grisly and great, and grimly it writes,
None oþer forme bot a fust faylaynde þe wryst
None other form but a fist failing the wrist
Pared on þe parget, purtrayed lettres
Pared on the plaister, pourtrayed letters.
When þat bolde Baltazar blusched to þat neue
When that bold Belshazzar looked to that fist,
Such a dasande drede dusched to his hert
Such a dazzling dread dashed to his heart.
Þat al falewed his face & fayled þe chere
That all paled his face and failed the cheer;
Þe stronge strok of þe stonde strayned his ioyntes
The strong stroke of the blow strained his joints,
His cnes cachche3 to close & cluchches his hommes
His knees catch to close, and he clutches his hams,
& he with plat-tyng his paumes displayes his lers *lers] ? feres.*
And he with striking his palms displays his fears,
& romyes as a rad ryth þat rore3 for drede
And howls as a frightened hound that roars for dread,
Ay biholdand þe honde til hit hade al grauen,
Ever beholding the hand till it had all graven,
& rasped on þe ro3 wo3e runisch saue3
And rasped on the rough wall uncouth saws (words).

(IX.) The story of Nebuchadnezzar's pride and its punishment (pp. 84, 85), and the interpretation of the handwriting by Daniel (p. 86).

xviii

(X.) The invasion of Babylon by the Medes (pp. 87, 88).

Baltazar in his bed wat3 beten to deþe
Belshazzar in his bed was beaten to death,
Þat boþe his blood & his brayn blende on þe cloþes
That both his blood and his brains blended on the clothes;
Þe kyng in his cortyn wat3 ka3t by þe heles
The king in his curtain was caught by the heels,

Feryed out bi þe fete & fowle dispysed
Ferried out by the feet and foully despised;
 Ðat wat3 so do3ty þat day & drank of þe vessayl
He that was so doughty that day and drank of the vessels,
 Now is a dogge also dere þat in a dych lygges
Now is as dear (valuable) as a dog that in a ditch lies. —(p. 88.)

The third poem, entitled “*Patience*,” is a paraphrase of the book of Jonah. The writer prefaces it with a few remarks of his own in order to show that “patience is a noble point though it displease oft.”

The following extract contains a description of the sea-storm which overtook Jonah:—

Anon out of þe norþ est þe noys bigynes
Anon out of the north east the noise begins,
 When boþe breþes con blowe vpon blo watteres
When both breezes did blow upon blue waters:
 Ro3 rakkes þer ros with rudnyng an-vnder
Rough clouds there arose with lightning there under,
 Þe see sou3ed ful sore, gret selly to here
The sea sobbed full sore, great marvel to hear;
 Þe wyndes on þe wonne water so wrastel togeder,
The winds on the wan water so wrestle together,
 Ðat þe wawes ful wode waltered so hize
That the waves full wild rolled so high,
 & efte busched to þe abyss þat breed fyssches
And again bent to the abyss that bred fishes;
 Durst nowhere for ro3 arest at þe bothem.
Durst it nowhere for roughness rest at the bottom.
 When þe breth & þe brok & þe bote metten
When the breeze and the brook and the boat met,

boþe breþes]
 Eurus and Aquilo.

xix
 Hit wat3 a ioyles gyn þat Ionas wat3 inne
It was a joyless engine that Jonah was in,
 For hit reled on round vpon þe ro3e yþes
For it reeled around upon the rough waves.
 Þe bur ber to hit baft þat braste alle her gere
The bore (wave) bear to it abaft that burst all her gear,
 Þen hurled on a hepe þe helme & þe sterne
Then hurled on a heap the helm and the stern,
 Furste to murte mony rop & þe mast after
First marred many a rope and the mast after.*
 Þe sayl sweyed on þe see, þenne suppe bihoued
The sail swung on the sea, then sup behaved

to murte, marred]
 ? = to-marte.

þe coge of þe colde water, & þenne þe cry ryſes
The boat of the cold water, and then the cry rises;
 3et coruen þay þe cordes & keſt al þer-oute
Yet cut they the cords and caſt all there-out.
 Mony ladde þer forth-lep to laue & to keſt
Many a lad there forth leapt to lave and to caſt,
 Scopen out þe ſcapel water, þat fayn ſcape wolde
To ſcoop out the ſcathful water that fain eſcape would;
 For þe monnes lode neuer ſo luper, þe lyf is ay ſwete
For þe man's lot never ſo bad, the life is aye ſweet. —(p. 93.)

The writer, in concluding the ſtory of Jonah, exhorts his readers to be
 “patient in pain and in joy.”

For he þat is to rakel to renden his cloþe3,
 Mot efte ſitte with more vn-ſounde to ſewe hem togeder.
For he that is too raſh to rend his clothes,
Muſt afterwards ſit with more unſound (worse ones) to ſew them together. (p. 104.)

This brief outline of the poems, together with the ſhort extracts from them,
 will, it is hoped, give the reader ſtomach to diſteſt the whole. It is true that
 they contain many “uncouth” terms; but this will be their hiſheſt merit with
 the ſtudent of language, as is ſhown, by Dr. Gueſt's teſtimony, that they are
 “for ſeveral reaſons curious, and eſpecially ſo to the philologiſt.”²² To thoſe
 readers who do not appreciate the importance ^{xx} of ſuch a very large addition
 to the vocabulary of our Early Language as is made by theſe treatiſes, let Sir
 Frederic Madden's opinion of their literary merit ſuffice. That diſtinguiſhed
 editor ſays, of the author's “poetical talent, the pieces contained in the MS.
 afford unqueſtionable proofs; and the deſcription of the change of the
 ſeaſons, the bitter aſpect of winter, the tempeſt which preceded the
 deſtruction of Sodom and Gomorrah, and the ſea ſtorm occaſioned by the
 wickedneſs of Jonas, *are equal to any ſimilar paſſages* in Douglas or
 Spenser.”²³ Moreover, as to the hardneſs of the language—inasmuch as the
 ſubject matter of the poem will be familiar to all who may take up the preſent
 volume, the difficulty on the word-point will not be ſuch as to deter the
 reader from underſtanding and appreciating the production of an old Engliſh
 poet, who—though his very name, unfortunately, has yet to be diſcovered—
 may claim to ſtand in the foremoſt rank of England's early bards.

The Editor of the preſent volume has endeavoured to do juſtice to his author
 by giving the text, with ſome few exceptions, as it ſtands in the

manuscript. ²⁴ The contractions of the scribe have been expanded and printed in italics, a plan which he hopes to see adopted in every future edition of an early English author.

The [Glossary](#) has been compiled not only for the benefit of the reader, but for the convenience of those who are studying the older forms of our language, and who know how valuable a mere index of words and references sometimes proves.

In conclusion, I take the present opportunity of acknowledging the kind assistance of Sir Frederic Madden and E. A. Bond, Esq., of the British Museum, who, on every occasion, were most ready to render me any help in deciphering the manuscript, in parts almost illegible, from which the poems in the present volume are printed.

xxi

REMARKS UPON THE DIALECT AND GRAMMAR.

Higden, writing about the year A.D. 1350, affirms, distinctly, the existence of three different forms of speech or dialects, namely, Southern, Midland, and Northern; ²⁵ or, as they are sometimes designated, West-Saxon, Mercian, and Northumbrian. Garnett objects to Higden's classification, and considers it certain "that there were in his (Higden's) time, and probably long before, five distinctly marked forms, which may be classed as follows:— 1. Southern or standard English, which in the fourteenth century was perhaps best spoken in Kent and Surrey by the body of the inhabitants. 2. Western English, of which traces may be found from Hampshire to Devonshire, and northward as far as the Avon. 3. Mercian, vestiges of which appear in Shropshire, Staffordshire, and South and West Derbyshire, becoming distinctly marked in Cheshire, and still more so in South Lancashire. 4. Anglian, of which there are three subdivisions—the East Anglian of Norfolk and Suffolk; the Middle Anglian of Lincolnshire, Nottinghamshire and East Derbyshire; and the North Anglian of the West Riding of Yorkshire—spoken most purely in the central part of the mountainous district of Craven. 5. Northumbrian," spoken throughout the Lowlands of Scotland, Northumberland, Durham, and nearly the whole of Yorkshire.

Garnett's division is based upon peculiarities of pronunciation, which will be found well marked in the *modern* provincial dialects, and not upon any essential differences of inflexion that are to be found in our Early English manuscripts. ²⁶

The distinction between Southern and Western English was not at all required, as the Kentish Ayenbite of Inwyt (A.D. ^{xxii} 1340) exhibits most of the peculiarities that mark the Chronicles of Robert of Gloucester (Cottonian MS. Calig. A. xi.) as a Southern (or West-Saxon) production. The Anglian of Norfolk, Lincolnshire, and Nottinghamshire may be referred to one group with the Mercian of Lancashire, as varieties of the Midland dialect.

A careful examination of our early literature leads us to adopt Higden's classification as not only a convenient but a correct one.

There is, perhaps, no better test for distinguishing these dialects from one another than the verbal inflexions of the plural number in the present tense, indicative mood.

To state this test in the briefest manner, we may say that the Southern dialect employs *-eth*, the Midland *-en*, and the Northumbrian *-es* as the inflexion for all persons of the plural present indicative: ²⁷—

	Southern.	Midland.	Northern.
1st pers.	Hop- <i>eth</i> .	Hop- <i>en</i> .	Hop- <i>es</i> . (we) hope.
2nd „	Hop- <i>eth</i> .	Hop- <i>en</i> .	Hop- <i>es</i> . (ye) hope.
3rd „	Hop- <i>eth</i> .	Hop- <i>en</i> .	Hop- <i>es</i> . (they) hope.

It is the constant and systematic employment of these inflexions, and not their occasional use that must be taken as the criterion of dialectical varieties.

In a pure specimen of the Southern dialect, we never find the Northumbrian *-es*. We do occasionally meet with the Midland *-en*, but only in those works written in localities where, from their geographical position, Southern and Midland forms would be intelligible. ²⁸ We might look in vain for the Southern plural *-eth* in a pure Northumbrian production, but might be more successful in finding the Midland *-en* in the third person plural; as, “*thay arn*” for “they *ar*”, or “*thay er*.”

In a work composed in Lincolnshire, Nottinghamshire, or Lancashire, we should be sure to find the occasional use of the Northumbrian plural *-es*.²⁹

The inflexions of the verb in the singular are of value in enabling us to discriminate between the several varieties of the Midland dialect.³⁰ The Southern and Midland idioms (with the exception of the West-Midland of Lancashire, Cheshire, etc.) conjugated the verb in the singular present indicative, as follows:—

1st pers.	hope	(I) hope.
2nd „	hop- <i>est</i>	(thou) hopest.
3rd „	hop- <i>eth</i>	(he) hopes.

The West-Midland, corresponding to Garnett's Mercian, instead of *-est* and *-eth* employs the inflexions that are so common in the so-called Northumbrian documents of the ninth and tenth centuries:—

1st pers.	hope	(I) hope.
2nd „	hop- <i>es</i>	(thou) hopest.
3rd „	hop- <i>es</i>	(he) hopes.

The Northumbrian dialect takes *-es* in all three persons; but mostly drops it in the first person.

The peasantry of Cheshire and Lancashire still preserve the verbal inflexions which prevailed in the fourteenth century, and conjugate their verbs in the present indicative according to the following model:—

	Singular.	Plural.
1st pers.	hope	hopen.
2nd „	hopes	hopen.
3rd „	hopes	hopen.

Inasmuch as the poems in the present volume exhibit the ^{xxiv} systematic use of these forms, we cannot but believe that they were originally composed in one of those counties where these verbal inflexions were well known and extensively used. We have to choose between several localities, but if we assign the poems to Lancashire we are enabled to account for the large number of Norse terms employed. It is true that the ancient examples of the

Lancashire dialect contained in Mr. Robson's Metrical Romances, ³¹ the Boke of Curtasye, ³² and Liber Cure Cocorum, ³³ present us with much broader forms, as *-us* for *-es* in the plural number and possessive case of nouns, *-un* for *-en* in the plural present indicative mood, in passive participles of irregular (or strong) verbs, *-ud* (*-ut*) for *-ed* in the past tense and passive participle of regular (or weak) verbs, and the pronominal forms *hor* (their), *hom* (them), for *her* and *hem*. ³⁴

These forms are evidence of a broad pronunciation which, at the present time, is said to be a characteristic of the northwestern division of Lancashire, but I think that there is good evidence for asserting that this strong provincialism was not confined, formerly, to the West-Midland dialect, much less to a division of any particular county. We find traces of it in Audelay's Poems (Shropshire), the Romance of William and the Werwolf, ³⁵ and even in the Wickliffite version of the Scriptures.

Formerly, being influenced by these broad forms, I was led to select Cheshire or Staffordshire as the probable locality where the poems were written; but I do not, now, think that either of these counties ever employed a vocabulary containing so many Norse terms as are to be found in the Lancashire dialect. But although we may not be able to fix, with certainty, ^{xxv} upon any one county in particular, the fact of the present poems being composed in the West-Midland dialect cannot be denied. Much may be said in favour of their Lancashire origin, and there are one or two points of resemblance between our poems, the Lancashire Romances, and Liber Cure Cocorum, that deserve especial notice.

I. In Sir Amadace, ³⁶ lxviii. 9, there occurs the curious form *miztus* = *miztes* = *mightst*. ³⁷ As it appears only once throughout the Romances we might conclude that it is an error of the scribe for *miztest*, but when we find in the poems before us not only *myzte3* = *myztes* (mightst), but *woldez* = *woldes* (wouldst), *couthes* = *couthes* (couldst), *dippte3* (dippedst), *travayledez* (travelledst), etc., we are bound to consider *miztus* as a genuine form. ³⁸ In no other Early English works of the fourteenth century have I been able to find this peculiarity. It is very common in *the Wohunge of Ure Lauerd* (xiiith cent.). See O.E. Homilies, p. 51. The Northumbrian dialect at this period rejected the inflexion in the second person preterite singular, of regular verbs, ³⁹ and in our poems we find the *-es* often dropped, ^{xxvi} so that we get

two conjugations, which may be called the inflected and the uninflected form.

	Inflected.	Uninflected.	
1st pers.	hopede	hoped	(I) hoped.
2nd „	hopedes	hoped	(thou) hopedest.
3rd „	hopede	hoped	(he) hoped.

Originally the inflected form may have prevailed over the whole of the North of England, but have gradually become confined to the West-Midland dialect.

II. The next point of resemblance is the use of the verb *SCHIN* or *SCHUN* = *schal* = *shall*. It is still preserved in the modern dialect of Lancashire in combination with the adverb *not*, as *schunnot* ⁴⁰ = *shall not*. The following examples will serve to illustrate the use of this curious form:—

“— þay *schin* knawe sone,

Dere is no bounté in burne lyk Baltaʒar þewes.” ⁴¹

—(B. l. 1435.)

“& þose þat seme arn & swete *schyn* se his face.” ⁴²

—(*Ibid.* l. 1810.)

“Pekokys and pertrikys perboylyd *schyn* be.” ⁴³

—(Liber Cure Cocorum, p. 29.)

“For þer bene bestes þat *schyn* be rost.” ⁴⁴

—(*Ibid.* p. 34.)

“Alle *schun* be draʒun, Syr, at þo syde.” ⁴⁵

—(*Ibid.* p. & 35.)

“Seche ferlies *schyn* falle.” ⁴⁶

—(Robson’s Met. Rom. p. 12, l. 4.)

^{41.} They *shall* know soon there is no goodness in man like Belshazzar’s virtues.

^{42.} And those that seemly are and sweet *shall* see His (God’s) face.

^{43.} Peacocks and partriches parboiled *shall* be.

^{44.} For þer are beasts þat *shall* be roasted.

^{45.} All *shall* be drawn (have the entrails removed), Sir, at the side.

^{46.} Such marvels *shall* happen.

III. Nothing is more common in the present poems than the use of *hit* as a genitive = *its*, which is also found in the Lancashire romances.

xxvii

“Forþy þe derk dede see *hit* is demed ever more,

For *hit* dedeʒ of deþe duren þere ʒet.” ⁴⁷

—(Patience, l. 1021.)

“And, as *hit* is corsed of kynde & *hit* coosteʒ als,

þe clay þat clenges þer-by arn corsyes strong.” ⁴⁸

—(*Ibid.* l. 1033.)

“For I wille speke with the sprete,

And of *hit* woe wille I wete,

^{47.} Wherefore the dark dead sea it is called ever more.

For *its* deeds of death endure there yet.

^{48.} And as it is cursed of kind and *its* properties also,

The clay that clings thereby are corrosives strong.

Gif that I may *hit* bales bete.” ⁴⁹
—(Robson’s Met. Romances, p. 5, ll. 3, 4.)

⁴⁹. I will speak with the
spirit,
And of *its* woe will I wit
(know),
If that I may *its* bales (grief)
abate.

The present dialect of Lancashire still retains the uninflected genitive:—

“So I geet up be strike o’ dey, on seet eawt; on went ogreath tilly welly coom within two mile
oth’ teawn; when, os tha dule woud height, o tit wur stonning ot an ale heawse dur; on me
kawve (the dule bore eawt *it* een for me) took th’ tit for *it* mother, on woud seawk her.” ⁵⁰
(Tummus and Meary).

Thus much for the dialectical peculiarities of our author. The scanty material at our disposal must be a sufficient excuse for the very meagre outline which is here presented to the reader. As our materials increase, the whole question of Early English dialects will no doubt receive that attention from English philologists which the subject really demands, and editors of old English works will then be enabled to speak with greater confidence as to the language and peculiarities of their authors. Something might surely be done to help the student by a proper classification of our manuscripts both as to date and place of composition. We are sadly in want of unadulterated ^{xxviii} specimens of the Northumbrian and East-Midland idioms during the twelfth and thirteenth centuries. There must surely be some records of these dialects in our university libraries which would well repay editing. ⁵¹

GRAMMATICAL DETAILS.

I. NOUNS.

(1) *Number*.—The plurals generally end in *-es* (*e3*), *-s*. *Y3en* (eyes), *trumpen* (trumpets), are the only plurals in *-en* that occur in the poems. In Robson’s Metrical Romances we find *fellun* (fells, hills,), *dellun* (dells), and *eyren* (eggs), in Liber Cure Cocorum. The plurals of *brother*, *child*, *cow*, *do3ter* (daughter), are *brether*, *childer*, *kuy*, and *de3ter*.

(2) *Gender*.—The names of inanimate things are in the neuter gender, as in modern English. The exceptions are *deep* (fem.), *gladnes* (fem.), and *wind* (masc.).

(3) *Case*.—The genitive singular (masc. and fem.) ends in *-es* (*-e3*), *-s*, but occasionally the inflexion is dropped; as, “Baltazar thewes,” the virtues of Balshazzar. ⁵² If “*honde my3t*,” “*honde werk*,” “*hellen wombe*,” are not compounds, we have instances of the final *-e* (*en*) which formed the genitive case of *feminine* nouns in the Southern English of the fourteenth century.

In the phrases “*besten blod*” (blood of beasts), “*blonkken bak*” (back of horses), “*chyldryn fader*” (father of children), “*nakeryn noyse*” (noise of nakers), we have a trace of the genitive plural *-ene* (A.S. *-ena*).

II. ADJECTIVES.

(1) *Number*.—The final *e*, as a sign of the plural, is very frequently dropped. *Pover* (poor), *sturn* (strong), make the ^{xxix} plurals *poveren* and *sturnen*. In the phrase, “*þo sy3te3 so quyke3*” ⁵³ (those sights so living), the *-e3* (= *-es*) is a mark of the plural, very common in Southern writers of the fourteenth century, and employed as a plural inflexion of the adjective until a very late period in our literature.

The Article exhibits the following forms:

SINGULAR.		PLURAL.
Masc.	Fem.	
The.	tho. ⁵⁴	tho.

This forms the plural *thise* and *thes* (*these*). *That* is always used as a demonstrative, and never as the neuter of the article; its plural is *thos* (those). ⁵⁵ The older form, *theos* = *these*, shows that the *e* is not a sign of the plural, as many English grammarians have asserted.

(2) *Degrees of Comparison*.—The comparative degree ends in *-er*, and the superlative in *-est*.

Adjectives and adverbs terminating in the syllable *-lyche* form the comparative in *-loker* and the superlative in *-lokest*; as, positive *uglyche* (= ugly), comp. *ugloker*, superl. *uglokest*. The long vowel of the positive is often shortened in the comp. and superl., as in the modern English *late*, *latter*, *last*.

Positive.	Comparative.	Superlative.
Brade (broad),	bradder,	braddest.

Dere (dear),	derrer,	derrest.
Lyke (like),	lykker,	lykkest.
Swete (sweet),	swetter,	swettest.
Wayke (weak),	wakker,	wakkest.
Wode (mad),	wodder,	woddest.

The following irregular forms are occasionally met with:

Positive.	Comparative.	Superlative.
Fer (far),	ferre (fyrre),	ferrest.
He3e (high),	herre,	he3est (hest).
xxx Ne3e (nigh, near)	nerre,	nerrest (nest).
Sare (sore),	sarre,	sarrest.
Forme (first),		formast.
Mikelle (great),	mo	most.
Yvel, ill (bad),	wers (worre),	werst.

Numerals.—*Twinne* and *thrinne* occur for two and three. The ordinal numbers are—

first (fyrste), the forme,
 secunde, that other, tother,
 thryd,
 thrydde,
 furþe,
 fyfþe,
 sexte,
 sevenþe,
 a3tþe,
 nente,
 tenþe,
 type.

The Northumbrian numerals corresponding to *sevenþe*, *a3tþe*, *nente*, *tenþe*, are *sevend*, *aghtend*, *neghend*, *tend*. The Southern forms end in *-the*, as

sevenþe, eiȝteope, nyþe, teope (type).

III. PRONOUNS.

In the following poems we find the pronoun *ho*, she, still keeping its ground against the Northumbrian *scho*.⁵⁶ *Ho* is identical with the modern Lancashire *hoo* (or *huh* as it is sometimes written), which in some parts of England has nearly the same pronunciation as the accusative *her*.

The Northumbrian *thay* (they) has displaced the older Midland *he*, corresponding to the Southern pronoun *hii*, *hi* (A.S. *hî*). *Hores* and *thayrez* (theirs) occasionally occur for *here*.⁵⁷ The genitives in *-es*, due no doubt to Scandinavian influence, are very common in Northumbrian writers of the fourteenth century, but are never found in any Southern work of the same period.

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Hit is frequently employed as an indefinite pronoun of all genders, and is plural as well as singular. It is, as has been previously shown, uninflected in the genitive or possessive case.

Me in Southern writers is used as an indefinite pronoun of the *third* person, and represents our *one*, but in the present poems it is of all persons, and seems to be placed in apposition with the subject of the sentence corresponding to our use of *myself*, *thysself*, *himself*, etc.; as,

“*He* swenges *me* þys,” etc. = He himself sends this, etc.⁵⁸

“Now sweȝe *me* þider swyftly” = Now go (thou) thysself thither swiftly.⁵⁹

“*He* meteȝ *me* þis good man” = He himself meets this good man.⁶⁰

Sturzen-Becker (“Some Notes on the leading Grammatical Characteristics of the Principal Early English Dialects, Copenhagen, 1868”) thinks that I have been led astray with regard to this use of *me*, which he says is nothing more than the *dativus ethicus*.

The *me* in these examples may be merely an expletive, having arisen out of the general use of the dative ethicus, but the context does not satisfy me that it has the force of a dative. Dr. Guest (Proceedings of Philolog. Soc., vol. i. p. 151-153, 1842-1844) has discussed this construction at some length, and he carefully distinguishes the dative of the 1st person from the indeterminate

(or indefinite) pronoun *me* = Fr. one. He says that in Old Frisian the indefinite pronoun has two forms, *min* and *me*, “the latter of which seems to be always used as a suffix to the verb, as *momme*, one may; *somme*, one should,” etc. The same construction was occasionally used in our own language, and it no doubt gave rise to those curious idioms which are noticed by Pegge in his “Anecdotes of the Eng. Lang.,” p. 217. This writer, whose evidence to a *fact* we may avail ourselves of, whatever we think of his criticism or his scholarship, quotes the following as forms of speech then prevalent among the ^{xxxii} Londoners: “and so says *me* I;” “well what does *me* I;” “so says *me* she;” “then away goes *me* he;” “what does *me* they?” Here it is obvious that *me* is the indeterminate pronoun, and represents the *subject*, while the personal pronoun is put in apposition to it, so that “says *me* I” is equivalent to “*one* says, *that is I*,” ⁶¹. These idioms are not unknown to our literature.

(1) ‘But as he was by diverse principall young gentlemen, to his no small glorie, lifted up on horseback, *comes me* a page of Amphialus, etc.’ Pembr. Arcad. B. iii.

Other idioms, which have generally been confounded with those last mentioned, have the indeterminate pronoun preceded by a nominative absolute.

(2) ‘*I*, having been acquainted with the smell before, knew it was Crab, and—*goes me* to the fellow, who whips the dogs,’ etc. Two Gent. of Verona, 4. 4.

(3) ‘*He thrusts me* himself into the company of three or four gentlemanlike dogs under the Duke’s Table.’ *Ib.* See B. Jons. Ev. Man in his Humour, 3, 1.

Johnson considers the *me* in examples 2 and 3 to be the oblique case of the first pers. pron., and treats it as “a ludicrous expletive.” It is difficult to say how he would have parsed example 2 on such a hypothesis.

With these instances of the use of *me* (indef. or reflexive), the reader may compare the following:

(1) “Suche a touche in that tyde, *he* tazte (Gauan) hym in tene
And *gurdes me*, Sir Gallerun, evyn grovelonges on grounde.”
(The Anturs of Arther at the Tarnewathelan, p. 22.)

(2) There at the dore he (the Fox) cast *me* downe hys pack.
Spenser’s Shep. Cal. ed. Morris, p. 460, l. 243.

Cp. *Cut me*, i. Hen. IV. Act 4. Sc. 4; *steps me*, *Ib.* Act 4, Sc. 3; *comes me*, *runs me*, *Ib.* Act 3, Sc. 1.

(3) “Juno enraged, and fretting thus,
Runs me unto one Æolus.”
 (Virgile Travestie, 1664.)

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The indefinite *me* = one is not uncommon in Elizabethan writers. Cf. “*touch me* his hat;” “*touch me* hir with a pint of sack,” etc.; “and *stop me* his dice you are a villaine” (Lodge’s Wit’s Miserie).

The following table exhibits the declension of the personal and relative pronouns:—

SINGULAR.					
Nom.	I,	thou,	<u>he</u> ,	ho,	hit.
Gen.	My, myn,	thy, thyn,	his,	hir, her,	hit.
Dat.	Me,	the,	him,	hir, her,	hit.
Acc.	Me,	the,	him,	hir, her,	hit.
PLURAL.					
Nom.	We,	3e,	thay,		hit.
Gen.	Oure,	yor, youre,	her (here),	hor,	hit.
Dat.	Vus (= uus),	yow, you,	hem, hom,		hit.
Acc.	Vus (= uus),	yow, you,	hem, hom,		hit.
Nom.	Who (quo).				
Gen.	Whose (quos).				
Dat.	Whom,	(quom).			
	Wham				
Acc.	Whom,	(quom).			
	Wham				

IV. VERBS.

Infinitive Mood.—The *-en* of the infinitive is frequently dropped, without even a final *-e* to mark its omission. Infinitives in *-y*, as *louy* (love), *schony* (shun), *spotty* (spot, defile), *stiry* (stir), *wony* (dwell), occasionally occur, and probably owe their appearance to the author’s acquaintance with Southern literature. ⁶²

Indicative Mood.—The final *e* often disappears in the first and third persons of the preterite tense, as I *loved*, he *loved*, instead of I *lovede*, he *lovede*.

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The *-en* in the plural of the present and preterite tenses is frequently dropped. The pl. present in *-e3* occasionally occurs.

Imperative Mood.—The imperative plural ends in *-es* (*e3*), and not in *-eth* as in the Southern and ordinary Midland dialects.

Participles.—The active or imperfect participle ends in *-ande* ⁶³ and never in *-ing*.

The participle passive or perfect of regular verbs terminates in *-ed*; of irregular verbs in *-en*. Occasionally we find the *n* disappearing, as *bigonn-e*, *fund-e*, *runn-e*, *wonn-e*, where perhaps it is represented by the final *-e*.

The prefix *-i* or *-y* (A.S. *-ge*) occurs twice only in the poems, in *i-chose* (chosen), and *i-brad* (extended); but, while common enough in the Southern and Midland dialects, it seems to be wholly unknown to the Northumbrian speech.

The verb in the West-Midland dialect is conjugated according to the following model:—

I.—CONJUGATION OF REGULAR VERBS.

INDICATIVE MOOD.

PRESENT TENSE.

Singular.	Plural.
(I) hope,	(We) hopen.
(Thou) hopes,	(3e) hopen.
(He) hopes,	(Thay) hopen.

PRETERITE TENSE.

(I) hoped ⁶⁴ (hoped),	(We) hoped ^{en} .
(Thou) hopedes (hoped),	(3e) hoped ^{en} .
(He) hoped ⁶⁴ (hoped),	(Thay) hoped ^{en} .

Hope (thou). Hopes (3e).

Hopande. Hoped.

(We) corven, runnen, smiten, stonden.
(3e) ” ” ” ”

(Thay) „ „ „ „

PASSIVE PARTICIPLES.

Corven, runnen, smiten, stonden.

The Northumbrian dialect does not preserve any separate form for the preterite plural, and this distinction is not always observed in the present poems.

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TABLE OF VERBS.

A.—SIMPLE ORDER.

	Present.	Preterite.	Passive Participle.
Class I.	Hate,	hatede,	hated.
Class II. (a)	Bede (offer),	bedde,	bed.
	Dype (dip),	dypte,	dypt.
	Kythe (show),	kydde,	kyd.
	Lende,	lende,	lent.
	Rende,	rende,	rent.
	Sende,	sende,	sent.
(b)	Clothe,	cladde,	clad.
	Dele (deal),	dalte,	dalt.
	Lede,	ladde,	lad.
	Leve,	lafte,	laft.
	Rede (advise),	radde,	rad.
	Sprede (spread),	spradde,	sprad.
	Swelt (die),	swalte,	—
	Swette (sweat),	swatte,	—
	Threte (threaten),	thratte,	thrat.
Class III.	Byye (buy),	bozte,	bozt

Bringe,	broʒte,	broʒt.
Cache (catch),	caʒte,	caʒt.
Lache (seize),	laʒte,	laʒt.
Reche (reck),	roʒte,	——
Reche (reach),	raʒte,	——
Selle,	solde,	sold.
Worche (work),	wroʒte,	wroʒt.

B.—COMPLEX ORDER.

DIVISION I.

	Present.	Preterite.	Passive Participle.
Class I.	Bere (bear),	ber,	born.
	Bete (beat),	bet,	beten.
xxxvii	Breke (break),	brek,	broken.
	Chese (choose),	ches (chos),	chosen.
	Cleve (cleave),	clef,	cloven.
	Ete (eat),	ette (<i>for</i> et),	eten.
	Forʒete (forget),	forʒet,	forʒeten.
	Frese (freeze),	fres,	frosen.
	Gife (give),	gef,	given, geven.
	Heve (heave),	hef,	hoven.
	Ligge (lie),	leʒ,	leyen, lezen.
	Lepe (leap),	lep,	lopen.
	Nemme Nimme (take),	nem (nam),	nomen.
	Schere (shear),	scher,	schorn.
	Slepe (sleep),	slep,	slepen.
	Speke (speak),	spek,	spoken.
	Stele (steal),	stel,	stolen.

Class II.	Swere (swear),	swer,	sworen.
	Wepe (weep),	wep,	wopen.
	Wreke (avenge),	wrek,	wroken.
	Falle,	fell,	fallen.
Class III.	Fonge (take),	feng,	fongen.
	Growe,	grew,	growen.
	Hange, honge,	heng,	hangen, hongen.
	Knowe, knawe,	knew,	knawen, knowen.
	Schape (make),	schep,	schapen.
	Walke,	welk,	walken.
	Wasche,	wesch,	waschen.
xxxviii	Drawe, draze,	droz,	drawen,...
	Fare (go),	for,	faren.
	Laze (laugh),	loz,	lazen.
	Stande, stonde,	stod,	standen.
	Slaye,	slow, slew,	slayn.
xxxviii	Take,	tok,	tane, tone.
	Wake,	wok,	waken.

DIVISION II.

	Present.	Preterite.	Passive Participle.
Class I.	Biginne,	bigon,	bigonnen, bigunnen.
	Breste,	brast, borst,	brusten, bursten.
	Climbe,	clamb, clomb,	clumben.
	Drinke,	dronk, drank,	drunken, dronken.

Class II.	Finde,	fand, fond,	funden.
	Fizte,	fa3t, fe3t,	fo3ten.
	Helpe,	halp,	holpen.
	Kerve (cut),	carf,	corven.
	Melte,	malt,	molten.
	Renne (run),	ran,	runnen.
	Ringe,	rong,	rungen, rongen.
	Singe,	song, sang,	sungen.
	Steke,	stac,	stoken.
	Serve (die),	starf,	storven.
	Werpe (throw),	warp,	worpen.
	Win,	wan, won,	wonnen, wunnen.
	3elde (yield),	3ald,	3olden.
	Bide (abide),	bod,	biden.
	Bite,	bot,	biten.
	Drive,	drof,	driven.
	Fine (cease),	fon,	—
	Glide,	glod,	gliden.
	Ride,	rod,	riden.
	Rise,	ros,	risen.
xxxix Class III.	Schine,	schon,	—
	Slide,	slod,	sliden.
	Smite,	smot,	smiten.
	Trine (go),	tron,	—
	Fly,	fle3, flegh, fla3,	flowen.

See,	se3, segh, sy3,	seen.
Stize, ste3e,	ste3	——

ANOMALOUS VERBS.

Can,	pret. couthe.
Dare,	„ dorste.
May,	„ mi3te.
Mot,	„ moste.
O3e (owe),	„ o3te.
Schal,	„ scholde, schulde.
Thar,	„ thurte.
Wote,	„ wiste.
Wille,	„ wolde.

Schal (shall) in the second person singular is *schal* or *schalt*; so, too, we occasionally find *wyl* for *wylt*.

The present plural of *schal* is *schul*, *schulen*, or *schyn*.

The verb *to be* is thus conjugated:—

INDICATIVE MOOD.

PRESENT TENSE.

PAST TENSE.

Singular.

(I) am.	(I) was, wat3.
(Thou) art.	(Thou) was, wat3.
(He) is, bes, bet3.	(He) was, wat3.

Plural.

(We) arn, are, ar.	(We) wern, were.
(3e) arn, are, ar.	(3e) wern, were.
(Thay) arn, are, ar.	(Thay) wern, were.

The verbs *be*, *have*, *wille*, have negative forms; as, *nam* = am not; *nar* = are not; *nas* = was not; *naf* = have not; *nade* = had not; *nyl* = will not.

The following contractions are occasionally met with: *bos* = behoves; *byhod* = behoved; *ha* = have; *ma* = make; *man* = make (pl.) *matz* (*mas*) = makes; *ta* = take; *tatz* (= *tas*) = takes; *tane*, *tone* = taken.

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V. ADVERBS.

The Norse forms *hethen*, *quethen* (*whethen*), ⁶⁶ and *thethen*, seem to have been known to the West-Midland dialect as well as the Saxon forms *hence* (*hennes*, *henne*), *whence* (*whennes*), *thence* (*thennes*), etc. ^A The adverbs *in-blande* (together), *in-lyche* (alike), *in-myddde* (amidst), *in-monge* (amongst), are due, perhaps, to Scandinavian influence.

VI. PREPOSITIONS.

The preposition *from* never occurs in the following poems; it is replaced by *fro*, *fra* (Northumbrian), O.N. *frá*.

VII. CONJUNCTIONS.

The conjunction *if* takes a negative form; as, *nif* = if not, unless.

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DESCRIPTION OF THE MANUSCRIPT USED IN THE PRESENT VOLUME. ⁶⁷

COTTON MS. NERO A. X. A small quarto volume, consisting of three different MSS. bound together, which originally had no connection with each other. Prefixed is an imperfect list of contents in the hand-writing of James, the Bodley Librarian.

The first portion consists of a panegyric oration in Latin by Justus de Justis, on John Chedworth, archdeacon of Lincoln, dated at Verona 16th July, 1468. It occupies thirty-six folios, written on vellum, and is the original copy presented by the author.

The second portion is that we are more immediately concerned with. It is described by James as “*Vetus poema Anglicanum, in quo sub insomnia figmento multa ad religionem et mores spectantia explicantur*,” and this account, with some slight changes, is adopted by Smith and Planta, in their catalogues; both of whom assign it to the fifteenth century. It will appear, by what follows, that no less than four distinct poems have been confounded together by these writers.

This portion of the volume extends from fol. 37 to fol. 126, inclusive, and is written by one and the same hand, in a small, sharp, irregular character, which is often, from the paleness of the ink, and the contractions used, difficult to read. There are no titles or rubrics, but the divisions are marked by large initial letters of blue, flourished with red, and several illuminations, coarsely executed, serve by way of illustration, each of which occupies a page.

1. Four of these are prefixed to the first poem. In the first the Author is represented slumbering in a meadow, by the side of a streamlet, clad in a long red gown, having falling sleeves, turned up with white, and a blue hood attached round the neck.

xlii In the second the same person appears, drawn on a larger scale, and standing by the stream. In the third he occurs nearly in the same position, with his hands raised, and on the opposite side a lady dressed in white, in the costume of Richard the Second's and Henry the Fourth's time, buttoned tight up to the neck, with long hanging sleeves. Her hair is plaited on each side, and on her head is a crown. In the fourth we see the author kneeling by the water, and beyond the stream is depicted a castle or palace, on the embattled wall of which appears the same lady, with her arm extended towards him.

The poem commences on fol. 39, and consists of one hundred and one twelve-line stanzas, ⁶⁸ every five of which conclude with the same line, and are connected by the iteration of a leading expression. It concludes on fol. 55b.

2. Then follow two more illuminations; in the first of which Noah and his family are represented in the ark; in the second the prophet Daniel expounding the writing on the wall to the affrighted Belshazzar and his queen. These serve as illustrations to the second poem, which begins at fol. 57, and is written in long alliterative lines. It concludes on fol. 82.

3. Two illuminations precede, as before; one of which represents the sailors throwing the prophet Jonas into the sea, the other depicts the prophet in the attitude of preaching to the people of Nineveh. The poem is in the same metre as the last, and commences at fol. 83.

It is occupied wholly with the story of Jonas, as applicable to the praise of meekness and patience; and ends on fol. 90.

4. The Romance intitled *Sir Gawayne and the Grene Knyzt* follows, fol. 91. Prefixed is an illumination of a headless knight on horseback, carrying his head by its hair in his right hand, and looking benignly at an odd-eyed bill-man before him; while from a raised structure above, a king armed with a knife, his queen, an attendant with a sabre, and another bill-man scowling looks on. Here and elsewhere the only colours used are green, red, blue, and yellow. It ends on fol. 124*b*., and at xliii the conclusion, in a later hand, is written “Hony soit q̃ mal penc,” which may, perhaps, allude to the illumination on the opposite page, fol. 125, representing the stolen interview between the wife of the Grene Knyzt and Sir Gawayne. Above the lady’s head is written:

Mi mind is mukel on on, þat wil me noȝt amende,
Sum time was trewe as ston, & fro schame couþe hir defende.

It does not appear very clearly how these lines apply to the painting. Two additional illuminations follow; in the first of which Gawayne is seen approaching the *Grene Chapel*, whilst his enemy appears above, wielding his huge axe; and in the second Sir Gawayne, fully equipped in armour, is represented in the presence of king Arthur and queen Guenever, after his return to the court.

The third and concluding portion of the Cotton volume extends from fol. 127 to fol. 140*b*, inclusive, and consists of theological excerpts, in Latin, written in a hand of the end of the thirteenth century. At the conclusion is added *Epitaphium de Ranulfo, abbate Ramesiensi*, who was abbot from the year

1231 to 1253, and who is erroneously called *Ralph* in the *Monasticon*, vol. ii. p. 548, new ed.

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CONTRACTIONS USED IN THE GLOSSARY.

The letters A. B. C. refer severally to the poems, entitled by me, “The Pearl,” “Cleanness,” and “Patience.”

A.S.	Anglo-Saxon.
Dan.	Danish.
Du.	Dutch.
E.	English.
O.E.	Old English.
Prov.E.	Provincial English.
N.Prov.E.	North Provincial English.
<u>N.P.E.</u>	
Fr.	French.
O.Fr.	Old French.
Prov. Fr.	Provincial French.
Fris.	Frisian.
G. Doug.	Gawin Douglas’s <i>Æneid</i> , published by the Bannatyne Club, 2 vols.
<u>Ger.</u>	German.
Goth.	Gothic.
Icel.	Icelandic.
Jam.	Jamieson’s <i>Scottish Dictionary</i> .
K. Alex.	King Alexander, <i>Romance of</i> (Ed. Stevenson).
Met. Hom.	Metrical Homilies (Ed. Small).
O.N.	Old Norse.

O.S.	Old Saxon.
<u>Prompt. Parv.</u>	Promptorium Parvulorum (Ed. Way).
Sc.	Scotch.
O.Sc.	Old Scotch.
S.Sax.	Semi-Saxon.
Sw.	Swedish.
O.Sw.	Old Swedish.
Town. Myst.	Townley Mysteries.
T. B.	Troy Book (Ed. Donaldson).

Gaps in numbering represent notes that were shown inline, with or without visible numbers.

1. Edited by Sir Frederic Madden for the Bannatyne Club, under the title of “Syr Gawayn and the Grene Knyȝt,” and by me for the Early English Text Soc., 1865.
2. Wyntown nowhere asserts that Huchowne is a Scotchman.
3. Edited for E. E. T. Soc. by Rev. G. G. Perry, M.A.
4. This is evident from the following particulars:—
 - I. In old Scotch manuscripts we find the guttural *gh* (or *ȝ*) represented by *ch*; thus, *aght*, *laght*, *saght*, *wight*, are the English forms which, in the Scotch orthography, become *aucht* (owed), *laucht* (seized), *saucht* (peace), *wicht* (active). It is the former orthography, however, that prevails in the *Morte Arthure*.
 - II. We miss the Scotch use of (1) *-is* or *-ys*, for *-es* or *-s*, in the plural number, and of possessive cases of nouns, and in the person endings of the present tense indicative mood of verbs; (2) *-it* or *-yt*, for *-ed* or *-d*, in the preterites or passive participles of regular verbs.
 - III. There is a total absence of the well-known Scotch forms *begouth* (began), *sa* (so), *sic* (such), *throuch*, *thorow* (through). Instead of these *bigan*, *so*, *syche*, *thrughe* (*thurgh*) are employed. See Preface to Hampole’s *Pricke of Conscience*, pp. vii, viii.
5. This is shown by the frequent employment of *-es* as the person ending of the verb in the present tense, plural number. The corresponding Southern verbal inflexion *-eth* *never* occurs; while the Midland *-en* is only occasionally met with in the third person plural present, and has been introduced by a later copyist. There are other characteristics, such as the predominance of words containing the A.S. long *a*; as *hame* (home), *stane* (stone), *thra* (bold), *walde* (would), etc.; the frequent use of *thir* (these), *tha* (the, those), etc.
6. The peculiarities referred to do not appear to be owing to the copyist of the Lincoln manuscript (Robert de Thornton, a native of Oswaldkirk in Yorkshire), who, being a Northumbrian, would probably have restored the original readings. The non-Northumbrian forms in the *Morte Arthure*

are— 1. The change of *a* into *o*, as *bolde* for *balde*, *bote* for *bate*, *one* for *ane*, *honde* for *hande*, *londe* for *lande*; 2. *they*, *theyre*, *them*, *theym*, for *thay*, *thaire*, *tham*; 3. *gayliche*, *kindliche*, *semlyche*, etc., for *gayly*, *kindly*, *seemly*, etc. (the termination *lich*, *liche*, was wholly unknown to the Northumbrian dialect, being represented by *ly* or *like*); 4. *churle*, *churche*, *iche*, *mache*, *myche*, *syche*, *wyrche*, etc., for *carle*, *kirke*, *ilk*, *make*, *mykelle*, *swilk*, *wyrk*, etc.; 5. infinitives in *-en*, as *drenschēn*, *schewenne*, *wacchēne*, etc.; 6. the use of *eke*, *thos*, for *als* (*alswa*), *thas*; 7. the employment of *aye* for *egg*. The former word *never* occurs in any pure Northumbrian work, while the latter is seldom met with in any Southern production.

7. The poems are *Northern* in contradistinction to *Southern*, but they are not Northern or Northumbrian in contradistinction to *Midland*.

8. Printed by Mr. D. Laing in his “Inedited Pieces,” from a MS. of Mr. Heber’s. Other copies are in the Vernon MS., and Cotton Calig. A. ii.; the latter imperfect.

9. Other specimens of this dialect will doubtless turn up. Mr. Brock has found a MS. in British Museum (Harl. 3909) with most of the peculiarities pointed out by me in the preface to the present work, and I believe that this dialect was probably a flourishing one in the 13th century. See O.E. Homilies, p. li.

10. (1) *en* as the inflexion of the pres. tense pl., indic. mood of verbs; (2) *s* in the second and third pers. sing. of verbs; (3) *ho* = she; (4) *hit* = its; (5) *tow* = two; (6) *deȝter* = daughters, etc.

11. See p. 36, ll. 1052-1066; p. 37, ll. 1074-1089; pp. 161-162, ll. 4956-4975.

12. See pp. 25, 26 (Jason’s unfaithfulness); pp. 74, 75, ll. 2241-2255; p. 75, ll. 2256-2263; p. 69, ll. 2267-2081; p. 158, ll. 4839-4850; p. 189, ll. 4881-4885; p. 165, ll. 5078-5086, etc.

13. In the Harl. MS. 3909, nearly all the p. part. and preterites end in *-et* (*-ut* and *-et* occur in Romances ed. by Robson).

14. This seems to furnish an etymology for *Clent* Hills, Worcestershire—*brent* is the term employed in Alliterative.

15. Matthew, chapter xx.

17. “4. And the city was broken up, and all the men of war fled by night by the way of the gate between two walls, which is by the king’s garden: (now the Chaldees were against the city round about:) and the king went the way toward the plain.

“5. And the army of the Chaldees pursued after the king, and overtook him in the plains of Jericho: and all his army were scattered from him.”

22. History of English Rhythms, vol. i. p. 159.

23. Syr Gawayn, ed. Madden, p. 302.

24. Wherever the Text has been altered, the reading of the MS. will be found in a foot-note.

25. Polychronicon R. Higdeni, ap. Gale, p. 210, 211. See Garnett’s Philological Essays, p. 43, and Specimens of Early English, p. 338.

26. It is to be regretted that Garnett did not enter upon details, and give his readers some tests by which to distinguish the “five distinctly marked forms.”

27. In English works of the fourteenth century the *-en* of the Midland, and the *-es* of the Northumbrian is frequently dropped, thus gradually approximating to our modern conjugation.

28. We are here speaking of works written in the thirteenth and fourteenth centuries.

29. Robert of Brunne, in his “Handlyng Synne,” often employs it instead of *-en*, but only for the sake of the rhyme.

30. The Midland dialect is a very difficult one to deal with, as it presents us with no uniform type; and, moreover, works written in this idiom are marked by Northern or Southern peculiarities, which have led many of our editors altogether astray in determining the locality of their composition.

31. Published by the Camden Society, 1842.

32. Edited by Mr. Halliwell for the Percy Society.

33. Edited by me for the Philological Society, 1862.

34. *-us* and *-ud* for *-es* and *-ed*, as well as *hom*, *hor*, do occasionally occur in the MS. containing our poems.

35. The Romance of William and the Werwolf is written in the West-Midland dialect as spoken probably in Shropshire.

36. Robson’s Metrical Romances, p. 54, l. 9.

37. *Woldus* = *woldes* = *wouldst*, appears in Audelay’s poems (in the Shropshire dialect of the fifteenth century), p. 32, l. 6.

38. The so-called Northumbrian records of the ninth and tenth centuries frequently use *-es* instead of *-est*, in the 2nd pers. preterite of regular verbs, *e.g.*,

ðu forcerdes usic on-bec = Thou turnedst us hindward. —(Ps. xliii. 11.)

ðu saldes usic = Thou gavest us. —(Ps. xliii. 12.)

ðu bi-bohtes folc ðin butan weorðe = Thou soldest thy folk without price. —(Ps. xliii. 12.)

ðu ge-hiowades me & settes ofer me hond ðine = Thou madest me and settest over me thy hand. —(Ps. cxxxviii. 5.)

ðu ðreades ða ofer-hygdan = Thou hast rebuked the proud. —(Ps. cxviii. 21.)

Ic ondeto ðe fader drihten heofnes forðon ðu gedeigeldes ðas ilco from snotrum & hogum & ædeaudes ða ðæm lytlum = I thank thee, O father, Lord of heaven and earth, because thou hast hid these things from the wise and prudent, and hast revealed them unto babes. —(Matt. xi. 25).

39. *Þou torned* us hindward. —(Early English Nn. Psalter, xliii. 11.)

Þou salde þi folk. —(*Ibid.* xliii. 12.)

Þou meked us. —(*Ibid.* xliii. 20.)

Þou made me and set þi hand over me. —(*Ibid.* cxxxviii. 5.)

Þou snibbed proude. —(*Ibid.* cxviii. 21.)

40. I am informed by a Shropshire friend that it prevails in his county under the form *shinne*.

Win = will, in *winnot*, *wunnot* = will not, is still heard in the West-Midland districts. It is found in Robson’s Romances and in Liber Cure Cocorum.

50. So I got up by break of day and set out; and went straight till I well nigh came within two miles of the town, when, as the devil would have it, a horse was standing at an ale-house door; and my calf (the devil bore out *its* eyes for me) took the horse for *its* mother, and would suck her.

51. Three specimens of the East-Midland dialect have come to light since writing the above. Harl. MS. 3909; Troy Book, ed. Donaldson, E. E. T. Soc.; The Lay-folks Mass-Book, ed. Simpson, E. E. T. Soc.

52. In the romance of “Syr Gawayn and the Grene Knyȝt” we find “*blonk* (horse) sadele,” “*fox felle*” (skin). In *blonk* an *e* has probably been dropped.
53. The feminine form is seldom employed.
54. The Northumbrian plural article is *tha*.
55. The Northumbrian corresponding form is *thas*.
56. *Scho* occurs *once* in the present poems.
57. *Yowreȝ* (yours) sometimes takes the place of *youre* in the romance of “Sir Gawayne and the Grene Knyȝt.”
58. Page 92, l. 108.
59. Page 91, l. 72.
60. Syr Gawayn, l. 1932.
61. I would say that *says me I* = I myself say. —R. M.
62. *Schonied* occurs for *schoned*. No Southern writer would retain, I think, the *i* in the preterite.
63. Garnett asserts that the present participle in *-ande* is “a *certain criterion* of a Northern dialect subsequent to the thirteenth century.” It is never found in any Southern writer, but is common to many Midland dialects. Capgrave employs it frequently in his *Chronicles*. It is, however, no safe criterion by itself.
64. The final *e* is often dropped.
65. In *The Wohunge of Ure Lauerd* the *e* is constantly omitted.
66. “Syr Gawayn and the Grene Knyȝt.”
67. Taken with some few alterations from Sir F. Madden’s “Syr Gawayn.”
68. A line, however, is missing from the MS. on fol. 55*b*. See page 15.
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Collected Sidenotes

This section was added by the transcriber. It contains the editor’s summaries as given in his sidenotes, and can be read as a condensed version of the full text. Headings in Roman numerals link to sections of the poem.

[The Pearl](#)
[Cleanness](#)
[Patience](#)

The Pearl: Sidenotes

I.

Description of a lost pearl (*i.e.* a beloved child).

The father laments the loss of his pearl.

He often visits the spot where his pearl disappeared, and hears a sweet song.

Where the pearl was buried there he found lovely flowers.

Each blade of grass springs from a dead grain.

In the high season of August the parent visits the grave of his lost child.

Beautiful flowers covered the grave.

From them came a delicious odour.

The bereaved father wrings his hands for sorrow, falls asleep upon the flowery plot, and dreams.

II.

In spirit he is carried to an unknown region, where the rocks and cliffs gleamed gloriously.

The hill sides were decked with crystal cliffs.

The leaves of the trees were like burnished silver.

The gravel consisted of precious pearls.

The father forgets his sorrow.

He sees birds of the most beautiful hues, and hears their sweet melody.

No tongue could describe the beauty of the forest.

All shone like gold.

The dreamer arrives at the bank of a river, which gave forth sweet sounds.

In it, stones glittered like stars in the welkin on a winter night.

III.

His grief abates, and he follows the course of the stream.

No one could describe his great joy.

He thought that Paradise was on the opposite bank.

The stream was not fordable.

More and more he desires to see what is beyond the brook.

But the way seemed difficult.

The dreamer finds new marvels.

He sees a crystal cliff, at the foot of which, sits a maiden clothed in glistening white.

He knows that he has seen her before.

He desires to call her but is afraid, at finding her in such a strange place.

IV.

So he stands still, like a well trained hawk.

He fears lest she should escape before he could speak to her.

His long lost one is dressed in royal array—decked with precious pearls.
She comes along the stream towards him.
Her kirtle is composed of 'sute,' ornamented with pearls.
She wore a crown of pearls.
Her hair hung down about her.
Her colour was whiter than whalebone.
Her hair shone as gold.
The trimming of her robe consisted of precious pearls.
A wonderful pearl was set in her breast.
No man from here to Greece, was so glad as the father, when he saw his pearl on the bank of the stream.
The maiden salutes him.

V.

The father enquires of the maiden whether she is his long-lost pearl, and longs to know who has deprived him of his treasure.
The maiden tells him that his pearl is not really lost.
She is in a garden of delight, where sin and mourning are unknown.
The rose that he had lost is become a pearl of price.
The pearl blames his rash speech.
The father begs the maiden to excuse his speech, for he really thought his pearl was wholly lost to him.
The maiden tells her father that he has spoken three words without knowing the meaning of one.
The first word. The second. The third.

VI.

He is little to be praised who loves what he sees.
To love nothing but what one sees is great presumption.
To live in this kingdom (*i.e.* heaven) leave must be asked.
This stream must be passed over by death.
The father asks his pearl whether she is about to doom him to sorrow again.
If he loses his pearl he does not care what happens to him.
The maiden tells her father to suffer patiently.
Though he may dance as any doe, yet he must abide God's doom.
He must cease to strive.
All lies in God's power to make men joyful or sad.

VII.

The father beseeches the pearl to have pity upon him.
He says that she has been both his bale and bliss.
And when he lost her, he knew not what had become of her.
And now that he sees her in bliss, she takes little heed of his sorrow.

He desires to know what life she leads.
The maiden tells him that he may walk and abide with her, now that he is humble.
All are meek that dwell in the abode of bliss.
All lead a blissful life.
She reminds her father that she was very young when she died.
Now she is crowned a queen in heaven.

VIII.

The father of the maiden does not fully understand her.
Mary, he says, is the queen of heaven.
No one is able to remove the crown from her.
The maiden addresses the Virgin.
She then explains to her father that each has his place in heaven.
The court of God has a property in its own being.
Each one in it is a king or queen.
The mother of Christ holds the chief place.
We are all members of Christ's body.
Look that each limb be perfect.
The father replies that he cannot understand how his pearl can be a queen.
He desires to know what greater honour she can have.

IX.

She was only two years old when she died, and could do nothing to please God.
She might be a countess or some great lady but not a queen.
The maiden informs her father that there is no limit to God's power.
The parable of the labourers in the vineyard.
The lord of the vineyard hires workmen for a penny a day.
At noon the lord hires other men standing idle in the market place.
He commands them to go into his vineyard, and he will give them what is right.
At an hour before the sun went down the lord sees other men standing idle.
Tells them to go into the vineyard.

X.

As soon as the sun was gone down the "reeve" was told to pay the workmen.
To give each a penny.
The first began to complain.
Having borne the heat of the day he thinks that he deserves more.
The lord tells him that he agreed only to give him a penny.
The last shall be first, and the first last.
The maiden applies the parable to herself.

She came to the vine in eventide, and yet received more than others who had lived longer.
The father says that his daughter's tale is unreasonable.

XI.

In heaven, the maiden says, each man is paid alike.
God is no niggard.
The grace of God is sufficient for all.
Those who live long on the earth often forfeit heaven by sinning.
Innocents are saved by baptism.
Why should not God allow their labour.
Our first father lost heaven by eating an apple.
And all are damned for the sin of Adam.
But there came one who paid the penalty of our sins.
The water that came from the pierced side of Christ was baptism.

XII.

Repentance must be sought by prayer with sorrow and affliction.
The guilty may be saved by contrition.
Two sorts of people are saved, the *righteous* and the *innocent*.
The words of David.
The innocent is saved by right.
The words of Solomon.
David says no man living is justified.
Pray to be saved by innocence and not by right.
When Jesus was on earth, little children were brought unto him.
The disciples rebuked the parents.
Christ said, "Suffer little children to come unto me," etc.

XIII.

No one can win heaven except he be meek as a child.
The pearl of price is like the kingdom of heaven, pure and clean.
Forsake the mad world and purchase the spotless pearl.
The father of the maiden desires to know who formed her figure and wrought her garments.
Her beauty, he says, is not natural.
Her colour passes the fleur-de-lis.
The maiden explains to her father that she is a bride of Christ.
She is without spot or blemish.
Her weeds are washed in the blood of Christ.
The father asks the nature of the Lamb that has chosen his daughter, and why she is selected as a bride.

XIV.

The Lamb has one hundred and forty thousand brides.
St. John saw them on the hill of Sion in a dream, in the new city of Jerusalem.
Isaiah speaks of Christ or the Lamb.
He says that He was led as a lamb to the slaughter.
In Jerusalem was Christ slain.
With buffets was His face flayed.
He endured all patiently as a lamb.
For us He died in Jerusalem.
The declaration of St. John, "Behold the Lamb of God," etc.
Who can reckon His generation, that died in Jerusalem?
In the New Jerusalem St. John saw the Lamb sitting upon the throne.

XV.

The Lamb is without blemish.
Every spotless soul is a worthy bride for the Lamb.
No strife or envy among the brides.
None can have less bliss than another.
Our death leads us to bliss.
What St. John saw upon the Mount of Sion.
About the Lamb he saw one hundred and forty thousand maidens.
He heard a voice from heaven, like many floods.
He heard the maiden sing a new song.
So did the four beasts and the elders "so sad of cheer."
This assembly was like the Lamb, spotless and pure.
The father replies to the maiden.
He says he is but dust and ashes.
He wishes to ask one question, whether the brides have their abode in castle-walls or in manor.

XVI.

Jerusalem, he says, in Judea.
But the dwelling of the brides should be perfect.
For such "a comely pack" a great castle would be required.
The city in Judæa, answers the maiden, is where Christ suffered, and is the Old Jerusalem.
The New Jerusalem is where the Lamb has assembled his brides.
Jerusalem means the city of God.
In the Old city our peace was made at one.
In the New city is eternal peace.

XVII.

The father prays his daughter to bring him to the blissful bower.

His daughter tells him that he shall see the outside, but not a foot may he put in the city.

XVIII.

The maiden then tells her father to go along the bank till he comes to a hill.

He reaches the hill, and beholds the heavenly city.

As St. John saw it, so he beheld it.

The city was of burnished gold.

Pitched upon gems, the foundation composed of twelve stones.

The names of the precious stones.

- i. Jasper.
- ii. Sapphire.
- iii. Chalcedony.
- iv. Emerald.
- v. Sardonyx.
- vi. Ruby.
- vii. Chrysolite.
- viii. Beryl.
- ix. Topaz.
- x. Chrysoprasus.
- xi. Jacinth.
- xii. Amethyst.

The city was square.

The wall was of jasper.

Twelve thousand furlongs in length and breadth.

XIX.

Each “pane” had three gates.

Each gate adorned with a pearl.

Such light gleamed in all the streets, that there was no need of the sun or moon.

God was the light of those in the city.

The high throne might be seen, upon which the “high God” sat.

A river ran out of the throne; it flowed through each street.

No church was seen.

God was the church; Christ the sacrifice.

The gates were ever open.

There is no night in the city.

The planets, and the sun itself, are dim compared to the divine light.

Trees there renew their fruit every month.

The beholder of this fair city stood still as a “dazed quail.”

XX.

As the moon began to rise he was aware of a procession of virgins crowned with pearls, in white robes, with a pearl in their breast.

As they went along they shone as glass.
The Lamb went before them.
There was no pressing.
The “alder men” fell groveling at the feet of the Lamb.
All sang in praise of the Lamb.
The Lamb wore white weeds.
A wide wound was seen near his breast.
Joy was in his looks.
The father perceives his little queen.

XIX.

Great delight takes possession of his mind.
He attempts to cross the stream.
It was not pleasing to the Lord.
The dreamer awakes, and is in great sorrow.
He addresses his pearl; laments his rash curiosity.
Men desire more than they have any right to expect.
The good Christian knows how to make peace with God.
God give us grace to be his servants!

Cleanness: Sidenotes

I.

Cleanness discloses fair forms.
God is angry with the unclean worshipper, and with false priests.
The pure worshipper receives great reward.
The impure will bring upon them the anger of God, Who is pure and holy.
It would be a marvel if God did not hate evil.
Christ showed us that himself.
St. Matthew records the discourse.
The clean of heart shall look on our Lord.
What earthly noble, when seated at table above dukes, would like to see a lad badly attired approach the table with “rent cockers,” his coat torn and his toes out?
For any one of these he would be turned out with a “big buffet,” and be forbidden to re-enter, and thus be ruined through his vile clothes.
The parable of the “Marriage of the King’s Son.”
The king’s invitation.
Those invited begin to make excuses.
One had bought an estate and must go to see it.

Another had purchased some oxen and wished to see them “pull in the plough.”
A third had married a wife and could not come.
The Lord was greatly displeased, and commanded his servants to invite the wayfaring, both men and women, the better and the worse, that his palace might be full.
The servants brought in bachelors and squires.
When they came to the court they were well entertained.
The servants tell their lord that they have done his behest, and there is still room for more guests.
The Lord commands them to go out into the fields, and bring in the halt, blind, and “one-eyed.”
For those who denied shall not taste “one sup” to save them from death.
The palace soon became full of “people of all plights.”
They were not all one wife’s sons, nor had they all one father.
The “brightest attired” had the best place.
Below sat those with “poor weeds.”
All are well entertained “with meat and minstrelsy.”
Each with his “mate” made him at ease.

II.

The lord of the feast goes among his guests.
Bids them be merry.
On the floor he finds one not arrayed for a holyday.
Asks him how he obtained entrance, and how he was so bold as to appear in such rags.
Does he take him to be a harlot?
The man becomes discomfited.
He is unable to reply.
The lord commands him to be bound, and cast into a deep dungeon.
This feast is likened to the kingdom of heaven, to which all are invited.
See that thy weeds are clean.
Thy weeds are thy works that thou hast wrought.
For many faults may a man forfeit bliss.
For sloth and pride he is thrust into the devil’s throat.
He is ruined by covetousness, perjury, murder, theft, and strife.
For robbery and ribaldry, for preventing marriages, and supporting the wicked, for treason, treachery, and tyranny, man may lose eternal bliss.

III.

The high Prince of all is displeased with those who work wickedly.
For the first fault the devil committed, he felt God’s vengeance.
He, the fairest of all angels, forsook his sovereign, and boasted that his throne should be as high as God’s.
For these words he was cast down to hell.
The fiends fell from heaven, like the thick snow, for forty days.

From heaven to hell the shower lasted.
The devil would not make peace with God.
Affliction makes him none the better.
For the fault of one, vengeance alighted upon all men.
Adam was ordained to live in bliss.
Through Eve he ate an apple.
Thus all his descendants became poisoned.
A maiden brought a remedy for mankind.

IV.

Malice was merciless.
A race of men came into the world, the fairest, the merriest, and the strongest that ever were created.
They were sons of Adam.
No law was laid upon them.
Nevertheless they acted unnaturally.
The “*fiends*” beheld how fair were the daughters of these mighty men, and made fellowship with them
and begat a race of giants.
The greatest fighter was reckoned the most famous.
The Creator of all becomes exceedingly wroth.
Fell anger touches His heart.
It repents Him that He has made man.
He declares that all flesh shall be destroyed, both man and beast.
There was at this time living on the earth a very righteous man: Noah was his name.
Three bold sons he had.
God in great anger speaks to Noah.
Declares that He will destroy all “that life has.”
Commands him to make “a mansion” with dwellings for wild and tame.
To let the ark be three hundred cubits in length, and fifty in breadth, and thirty in height, and a window
in it a cubit square.
Also a good shutting door in the side, together with halls, recesses, bushes, and bowers, and well-
formed pens.
For all flesh shall be destroyed, except Noah and his family.
Noah is told to take into the ark seven pairs of every clean beast, and one of unclean kind, and to
furnish the ark with proper food.
Noah fills the ark.

V.

God asks Noah whether all is ready.
Noah replies that all is fully prepared.
He is commanded to enter the ark, for God tells him that he will send a rain to destroy all flesh.
Noah stows all safely in the ark.

Seven days are passed.
The deep begins to swell, banks are broken down, and the clouds burst.
It rains for forty days, and the flood rises, and flows over the woods and fields.
All must drown.
The water enters the houses.
Each woman with her bairns flees to the hills.
The rain never ceases.
The valleys are filled.
People flock to the mountains.
Some swim for their lives.
Others roar for fear.
Animals of all kinds run to the hills.
All pray for mercy.
God's mercy is passed from them.
Each sees that he must sink.
Friends take leave of one another.
Forty days have gone by, and all are destroyed.
All rot in the mud, except Noah and his family, who are safe in the ark.
The ark is lifted as high as the clouds, and is driven about, without mast, bowline, cables, anchors, or sail to guide its course.
At the mercy of the winds.
Oft it rolled around and reared on end.
The age of the patriarch Noah.
Duration of the flood.
The completeness of the destruction.
God remembers those in the ark.
He causes a wind to blow, and closes the lakes and wells, and the great deep.
The ark settles on Mount Ararat.
Noah beholds the bare earth.
He opens his window and sends out the raven to seek dry land.
The raven "croaks for comfort" on finding carrion.
He fills his belly with the foul flesh.
The lord of the ark curses the raven, and sends out the dove.
The bird wanders about the whole day.
Finding no rest, she returns about eventide to Noah.
Noah again sends out the dove.

VI.

The dove returns with an olive branch in her beak.
This was a token of peace and reconciliation.

Joy reigns in the ark.
The people therein laugh and look thereout.
God permits Noah and his sons to leave the ark.
Noah offers sacrifice to God.
It is pleasing to Him that “all speeds or spoils.”
God declares that He will never destroy the world for the sin of man.
That summer and winter shall never cease.
Nor night nor day, nor the new years.
God blesses every beast.
Each fowl takes its flight.
Each fish goes to the flood.
Each beast makes for the plain.
Wild worms wriggle to their abodes in the earth.
The fox goes to the woods.
Harts to the heath, and hares to the gorse.
Lions and leopards go to the lakes.
Eagles and hawks to the high rocks.
The four ‘frekes’ take the empire.
Behold what woe God brought on mankind for their hateful deeds!
Beware of the filth of the flesh.
“One speck of a spot” will ruin us in the sight of God.
The beryl is clean and sound,—it has no seam.

VII.

When God repented that he had made man, he destroyed all flesh.
But afterwards He was sorry, and made a covenant with mankind that He would not again destroy all the living.
For the filth of the flesh God destroyed a rich city.
God hates the wicked as “hell that stinks.”
Especially harlotry and blasphemy.
Nothing is hidden from God.
God is the ground of all deeds.
He honours the man that is honest and whole.
But for deeds of shame He destroys the mighty ones.

VIII.

Abraham is sitting before his house-door under a green oak.
He sees three men coming along, and goes toward them.
He entreats them to rest awhile, that he may wash their feet, and bring them a morsel of bread.
Abraham commands Sarah to make some cakes quickly, and tells his servant to seethe a tender kid.
Abraham appears bare-headed before his guests.

He casts a clean cloth on the green, and sets before them cakes, butter, milk, and pottage.
God praises his friend's feast, and after the meat is removed, He tells Abraham that Sarah shall bear him a son.
Sarah, who is behind the door, laughs in unbelief.
God tells Abraham that Sarah laughs at His words.
Sarah denies that she laughed.
Abraham's guests set out towards Sodom, two miles from Mamre.
The patriarch accompanies them.
God determines to reveal to Abraham his secret purposes.

IX.

He informs him of the destruction about to fall upon the cities of the plain, for their great wickedness, in abusing the gifts bestowed upon them.
The ordinance of marriage had been made for them, but they foully set it at nought.
The flame of love.
Therefore shall they be destroyed as an example to all men for ever.
Abraham is full of fear, and asks God whether the "sinful and the sinless" are to suffer together.
Whether he will spare the cities provided fifty righteous are found in them?
For the sake of fifty the cities shall be spared.
The patriarch beseeches God to spare the city for the sake of forty-five righteous.
For the lack of five the cities shall not be destroyed.
For forty the cities shall be spared.
Abraham entreats God's forbearance for his speech.
Thirty righteous, found in the cities, shall save them from destruction.
For the sake of twenty guiltless ones God will release the rest.
Or if ten only should be found pure.
The patriarch intercedes for Lot.
Beseeches Him to "temper His ire," and then departs weeping for sorrow.

X.

God's messengers go to Sodom.
Lot is sitting alone at the "door of his lodge."
Staring into the street he sees two men.
Beardless chins they had, and hair like raw silk.
Beautifully white were their weeds.
Lot runs to meet them.
Invites them to remain awhile in his house, and in the morning they may take their way.
Lot invites them so long that at last they comply.
The wife and daughters of Lot welcome their visitors.
Lot admonishes his men to prepare the meat, and to serve no salt with it.
Lot's wife disregards the injunction.

The guests are well entertained.
But before they go to rest the city is up in arms.
With “keen clubs” the folk clatter on the walls, and demand that Lot should deliver up his guests.
The wind yet stinks with their filthy speech.
Lot is in great trouble.
He leaves his guests and addresses the Sodomites.
He offers to give up to them his two daughters.
The rebels raise a great noise, and ask who made him a justice to judge their deeds, who was but a boy when he came to Sodom.
The young men bring Lot within doors, and smite those outside with blindness.
In vain they try to find the door of Lot’s house.

XI.

Early in the morning the angels command Lot to depart from Sodom, with his wife and two daughters, and to look straight before him, for Sodom and Gomorrah shall be destroyed.
Lot asks what is best to be done, that he may escape.
He is told to choose himself a dwelling which shall be saved from destruction.
He chooses Zoar.
The angels command Lot to depart quickly.
He wakes his wife and daughters.
All four are hastened on by the angels, who “preach to them the peril” of delay.
Before daylight Lot comes to a hill.
God aloft raises a storm.
A rain falls thick of fire and sulphur.
Upon the four cities it comes, and frightens all folks therein.
The great bars of the abyss do burst.
Cliffs cleave asunder.
The cities sink to hell.
Such a cry arises that the clouds clatter again.
Lot and his companions are frightened, but continue to follow their face.
Lot’s wife looks behind her, and is turned to a stiff stone “as salt as any sea.”
Her companions do not miss her till they reach Zoar.
By this time all were drowned.
The people of Zoar, for dread, rush into the sea and are destroyed.
Only Zoar with three therein (Lot and his daughters) are saved.
Lot’s wife is an image of salt for two faults:
1. She served salt before the Lord at supper.
2. She looked behind her.
Abraham is up full early on the morn.
He looks towards Sodom, now only a pit filled with pitch, from which rise smoke, ashes and cinders, as from a furnace.

A sea now occupies the place of the four cities.
It is a stinking pool, and is called the Dead Sea.
Nothing may live in it.
Lead floats on its surface.
A feather sinks to the bottom of it.
Lands, watered by this sea, never bear grass or weed.
A man cannot be drowned in it.
The clay clinging to it is corrosive, as alum, alkanar, sulphur, etc., which fret the flesh and fester the bones.
On the shores of this lake grow trees bearing fair fruits, which, when broken or bitten, taste like ashes.
All these are tokens of wickedness and vengeance.
God loves the pure in heart.
Strive to be clean.
Jean de Meun tells how a lady is to be loved.
By doing what pleases her best.
Love thy Lord!
Conform to Christ, who is polished as a pearl.
By how comely a contrivance did he enter the womb of the virgin!
In what purity did he part from her!
No abode was better than his.
The sorrow of childbirth was turned to joy.
Angels solaced the virgin with organs and pipes.
The child Christ was so clean that ox and ass worshipped him.
He hated wickedness, and would never touch ought that was vile.
Yet there came to him lazars and lepers, lame and blind.
Dry and dropsical folk.
He healed all with kind speech.
His handling was so good, that he needed no knife to cut or carve with.
The bread he broke more perfectly than could all the tools of Toulouse.
How can we approach his court except we be clean?
God is merciful.
Through penance we may shine as a pearl.
Why is the pearl so prized?
She becomes none the worse for wear.
If she should become dim, wash her in wine.
She then becomes clearer than before.
So may the sinner polish him by penance.
Beware of returning to sin.
For then God is more displeased than ever.
The reconciled soul God holds as His own.

Ill deeds rob Him of it.

God forbids us to defile any vessels used in His service.

In Belshazzar's time, the defiling of God's vessels brought wrath upon the king.

XII.

Daniel in his prophecies tells of the destruction of the Jews.

For their unfaithfulness in following other gods, God allowed the heathen to destroy them, in the reign of Zedekiah, who practised idolatry.

Nebuchadnezzar becomes his foe.

He besieges Jerusalem, and surrounds the walls.

The city is stuffed full of men.

Brisk is the skirmish.

Seven times a day are the gates assailed.

For two years the fight goes on, yet the city is not taken.

The folk within are in want of food.

Meager they become.

For so shut up are they that escape seems impossible.

But on a quiet night they steal out, and rush through the host.

They are discovered by the enemy.

A loud alarm is given.

They are pursued and overtaken.

Their king is made prisoner.

His chief men are presented as prisoners to Nebuchadnezzar.

His sons are slain.

His own eyes are put out.

He is placed in a dungeon in Babylon.

All for his "bad bearing" against the Lord, who might otherwise have been his friend.

Nebuchadnezzar ceased not until he had destroyed Jerusalem.

Nebuzaradan was "chief of the chivalry."

The best men were taken out of the city.

Nevertheless Nebuzaradan spared not those left.

Brains of bairns were spilt.

Priests pressed to death.

Wives and wenches foully killed.

All that escaped the sword were taken to Babylon, and were made to drag the cart or milk the kine.

Nebuzaradan burst open the temple, and slew those therein.

Priests, pulled by the poll, were slain along with deacons, clerks, and maidens.

The enemy pillages the temple of its pillars of brass, and the golden candlestick from off the altar.

Goblets, basins, golden dishes, all are taken by Nebuzaradan, and hampered together.

Solomon had made them with much labour.

The temple he beats down, and returns to Babylon.
Presents the prisoners to the king, among whom were Daniel and his three companions.
Nebuchadnezzar has great joy, because his enemies are slain.
Great was his wonder when he saw the sacred jewelry.
He praises the God of Israel.
Such vessels never before came to Chaldea.
They are thrust into the treasury.
Nebuchadnezzar reigns as emperor of all the earth, through the “doom of Daniel,” who gave him good counsel.
Nebuchadnezzar dies and is buried.
Belshazzar succeeds him.
He holds himself the biggest in heaven or on earth.
He honours not God, but worships false phantoms.
He promises them rewards if good fortune befall.
If they vex him he knocks them in pieces.
He has a wife, and many concubines.
The mind of the king was fixed upon new meats and other vain things.

XIII.

Belshazzar, to exhibit his vainglory, proclaims throughout Babylon, that all the great ones should assemble on a set day, at the Sultan’s feast.
Kings, dukes, and lords were commanded to attend the court.
To do the king honour many nobles came to Babylon.
It would take too long to name the number.
The city of Babylon is broad and big.
It is situated on a plain, surrounded by seven streams, a high wall, and towers.
The palace was long and large, each side being seven miles in length.
High houses were within the walls.
The time of the feast has come.
Belshazzar sits upon his throne: the hall floor is covered with knights.
When all are seated, service begins.
Trumpets sound everywhere.
Bread is served upon silver dishes.
All sorts of musical instruments are heard in the hall.
The king, surrounded by his loves, drinks copiously of wine.
It gets into his head and stupifies him.
A cursed thought takes possession of him.
He commands his marshal to bring him the vessels taken from the temple by Nebuchadnezzar, and to fill them with wine.
The marshal opens the chests.
Covers the cupboard with vessels.

The Jewels of Jerusalem deck the sides of the hall.

The altar and crown, blessed by bishop's hands, and anointed with the blood of beasts, are set before the bold Belshazzar.

Upon this altar were noble vessels curiously carved, basins of gold, cups arrayed like castles with battlements, and towers with lofty pinnacles.

Upon them were portrayed branches and leaves, the flowers of which were white pearls, and the fruit flaming gems.

The goblets were ornamented with flowers of gold.

The candlestick was brought in, with its pillars of brass, and ornamental boughs, upon which sat birds of various hues.

Lights shone bright from the candlestick, which once stood before the "Holy of Holies."

The pollution of the sacred vessels is displeasing to God.

For "a boaster on bench" drinks from them till he is as "drunken as the devil."

God is very angry.

Before harming the revellers He sends them a warning.

Belshazzar commands the sacred vessels to be filled with wine.

The cups and bowls are soon filled.

Music of all kind is heard in the hall.

Dukes, princes, concubines, and knights, all are merry.

Drinking of the sweet liquors they ask favours of their gods, who, although dumb, are as highly praised "as if heaven were theirs."

A marvel befalls the feasters.

The king first saw it.

Upon the plain wall, "a palm with pointel in fingers" is seen writing.

The bold Belshazzar becomes frightened.

His knees knock together.

He roars for dread, still beholding the hand, as it wrote on the rough wall.

The hand vanishes but the letters remain.

The king recovers his speech and sends for the "book-learned;" but none of the scholars were wise enough to read it.

Belshazzar is nearly mad.

Commands the city to be searched throughout for the "wise of witchcraft."

He who expounds the strange letters, shall be clothed in "gowns of purple."

A collar of gold shall encircle his throat.

He shall be the third lord in the realm.

As soon as this cry was upcast, to the hall came clerks out of Chaldea, witches and diviners, sorcerers and exorcists.

But after looking on the letters they were as ignorant as if they had looked into the leather of the left boot.

The king curses them all and calls them churls.

He orders the harlots to be hanged.

The queen hears the king chide.

She inquires the cause.

Goes to the king, kneels before him, and asks why he has rent his robes for grief, when there is one that has the Spirit of God, the counsellor of Nebuchadnezzar, the interpreter of his dreams, through the holy Spirit of God.

The name of this man is Daniel, who was brought a captive from Judæa.

The queen tells the king to send for Daniel.

Her counsel is accepted.

Daniel comes before Belshazzar.

The king tells him that he has heard of his wisdom, and his power to discover hidden things, and that he wants to know the meaning of the writing on the wall.

Promises him, if he can explain the text of the letters and their interpretation, to clothe him in purple and pall, and put a ring about his neck, and to make him “a baron upon bench.”

Daniel addresses the king, and reminds him how that God supported his father, and gave him power to exalt or abase whomsoever he pleased.

Nebuchadnezzar was established on account of his faith in God.

So long as he remained true, no man was greater.

But at last pride touches his heart.

He forgets the power of God, and blasphemes His name.

He says that he is “god of the ground,” and the builder of Babylon.

Hardly had Nebuchadnezzar spoken, when God’s voice is heard, saying, “Thy principality is departed. Thou, removed from men, must abide on the moor, and walk with wild beasts, eat herbs, and dwell with wolves and asses.”

For his pride he becomes an outcast.

He believes himself to be a bull or an ox.

Goes “on all fours,” like a cow, for seven summers.

His thighs grew thick.

His hair became matted and thick, from the shoulders to the toes.

His beard touched the earth.

His brows were like briars.

His eyes were hollow, and grey as the kite’s.

Eagle-hued he was.

At last he recovered his “wit,” and believed in God.

Then soon was he restored to his seat.

But thou, Belshazzar, hast disregarded these signs, and hast blasphemed the Lord, defiled his vessels, filling them with wine for thy wenches, and praising thy lifeless gods.

For this sin God has sent thee this strange sight, the fist with the fingers writing on the wall.

These are the words: “Mene, Tekel, Peres.

Mene.— God has counted thy kingdom and finished it.

Tekel.—Thy reign is weighed and is found wanting in deeds of faith.

Peres.— Thy kingdom is divided, and given to the Persians.

The Medes shall be masters here.”

The king commands Daniel to be clothed in a frock of fine cloth.

Soon is he arrayed in purple, with a chain about his neck.
A decree is made, that all should bow to him, as the third lord that followed Belshazzar.
The decree was made known, and all were glad.
The day, however, past.
Night came on.
Before another day dawned, Daniel's words were fulfilled.
The feast lasts till the sun falls.
The skies become dark.
Each noble hies home to his supper.
Belshazzar is carried to bed, but never rises from it, for his foes are seeking to destroy his land, and are assembled suddenly.
The enemy is Darius, leader of the Medes.
He has legions of armed men.
Under cover of the darkness, they cross the river.
By means of ladders they get upon the walls, and within an hour enter the city, without disturbing any of the watch.
They run into the palace, and raise a great cry.
Men are slain in their beds.
Belshazzar is beaten to death, and caught by the heels, is foully cast into a ditch.
Darius is crowned king, and makes peace with the barons.
Thus the land was lost for the king's sin.
He was cursed for his uncleanness, and deprived of his honour, as well as of the joys of heaven.
Thus in three ways has it been shown, that uncleanness makes God angry.
Cleanness is His comfort.
The seemly shall see his face.
God give us grace to serve in His sight!

Patience: Sidenotes

I.

Patience is often displeasing, but it assuages heavy hearts, and quenches malice.
Happiness follows sorrow.
It is better to suffer than to be angry.
Matthew tells us of the promises made by Christ: Blessed are the poor, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.
Blessed are the meek, for they shall "wield the world."
Blessed are the mourners, for they shall be comforted.
Blessed are the hungry, for they shall be filled.
Blessed are the merciful, for mercy shall be their reward.

Blessed are the clean of heart, for they shall see the Saviour.
Blessed are the peace-makers, for they shall be called God's sons.
Blessed are they that live aright, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.
These blessings are promised to those who follow poverty, pity, penance, meekness, mercy, chastity,
peace and patience.
Poverty and patience are to be treated together.
They are "fettled in one form," and have one meed.
Poverty will dwell where she lists, and man must needs suffer.
Poverty and patience are play-fellows.
What avails impatience, if God send affliction?
Patience is best.
Did not Jonah incur danger by his folly?

II.

Jonah was a prophet of the gentiles.
God's word came to him, saying, "Rise quickly, take the way to Nineveh.
Say that which I shall put in thine heart.
Wickedness dwells in that city.
Go swiftly and carry my message."
Jonah is full of wrath.
He is afraid that the shrews will put him in the stocks, or put out his eyes.
He thinks that God desires his death.
He determines not to go near the city, but fly to Tarshish.
Grumbling, he goes to port Joppa.
He says that God will not be able to protect him.
Jonah reaches the port, finds a ship ready to sail.
The seamen catch up the cross-sail, fasten the cables, weigh their anchors, and spread sail.
A gentle wind wafts the ship along.
Was never a Jew so joyful as was Jonah then.
He has, however, put himself in peril, in fleeing from God.
The words of David.
Does He not hear, who made all ears?
He is not blind that formed each eye.
Jonah is now in no dread.
He is, however, soon overtaken.
The wielder of all things has devices at will.
He commands Eurus and Aquilo to blow.
The winds blow obedient to His word.
Out of the north-east the noise begins.
Storms arose, winds wrestled together, the waves rolled high, and never rested.

Then was Jonah joyless.
The boat reeled around.
The gear became out of order.
Ropes and mast were broken.
A loud cry is raised, Many a lad labours to lighten the ship.
They throw overboard their bags and feather beds.
But still the wind rages, and the waves become wilder.
Each man calls upon his god.
Some called upon Vernagu, Diana, and Neptune, to the sun and to the moon.
Then said one of the sailors: "Some lawless wretch, that has grieved his God, is in the ship.
I advise that we lay lots upon each man.
When the guilty is gone the tempest may cease."
This is agreed to.
All are assembled, from all corners of the ship, save Jonah the Jew, who had fled into the bottom of the
boat.
There he falls asleep.
Soon he is aroused, and brought on board.
Full roughly is he questioned.
The lot falls upon Jonah.
Then quickly they said: "What the devil hast thou done, doted wretch?
What seekest thou on the sea?
Hast thou no God to call upon?
Of what land art thou?
Thou art doomed for thy ill deeds."
Jonah says: "I am a Hebrew, a worshipper of the world's Creator.
All this mischief is caused by me, therefore cast me overboard."
He proves to them that he was guilty.
The mariners are exceedingly frightened.
They try to make way with their oars, but their endeavours are useless.
Jonah must be doomed to death.
They pray to God, that they may not shed innocent blood.
Jonah is cast overboard.
The tempest ceases and the sea settles.
The stiff streams drive the ship about.
At last they reach a bank.
The seamen thank God, and perform solemn vows.
Jonah is in great dread.

III.

Jonah is shoved from the ship.

A wild whale swims by the boat.
He opens his swallow, and seizes the prophet.
It is not to be wondered at that Jonah suffered woe.
The prophet is without hope.
Cold was his comfort.
Jonah was only a mote in the whale's jaws.
He entered in by the gills, and by means of one of the intestines of the fish, came into a space as large as a hall.
The prophet fixes his feet firmly in the belly of the whale.
He searches into every nook of its navel.
The prophet calls upon God.
He cries for mercy.
He sits safely in a recess, in a bowel of the beast, for three days and three nights.
The whale passes through many a rough region.
Jonah makes the whale feel sick.
The prophet prays to God in this wise:

IV.

"Lord! to thee have I cried out of hell's womb.
Thou dippedst me in the sea.
Thy great floods passed over me.
The streams drive over me.
I am cast out from thy sight.
The abyss binds me.
The rushing waves play on my head.
Thou possessest my life.
In my anguish I remembered my God, and besought His pity.
When I am delivered from this danger, I will obey thy commands."
God speaks fiercely to the whale, and he vomits out the prophet on a dry space.
Jonah has need to wash his clothes.
God's word comes to the prophet.
He is told to preach in Nineveh.
By night Jonah reaches the city.
Nineveh was a very great city.
Jonah delivers his message; "Yet forty days and Nineveh shall come to an end.
It shall be turned upside down, and swallowed quickly by the black earth."
This speech spreads throughout the city.
Great fear seizes all.
The people mourn secretly, clothe themselves in sackcloth, and cast ashes upon their heads.
The message reaches the ears of the king.

He rends his robes, clothes himself in sackcloth, and mourns in the dust.
He issues a decree, that all in the city, men, beasts, women and children, prince, priest, and prelates,
should fast for their sins.
Children are to be weaned from the breast.
The ox is to have no hay, nor the horse any water.
Who can tell if God will have mercy?
Though He is mighty, He is merciful, and may forgive us our guilt.
All believed and repented.
God forgave them through his goodness.

V.

Much sorrow settles upon Jonah.
He becomes very angry.
He prays to God and says: "Was not this my saying, when Thy message reached me in my own country?
I knew Thy great goodness, Thy long-suffering, and Thy mercy.
I knew these men might make their peace with Thee, therefore I fled unto Tarshish.
Take my life from me, O Lord!
It is better for me to die than live."
God upbraids Jonah, saying: "Is this right to be so wroth?"
Jonah, jangling, uprises, and makes himself a bower, of hay and ever-fern, to shield him from the sun.
He slept heavily all night.
God prepared a woodbine.
Jonah awakes, and is exceedingly glad of the bower.
The prophet, under its gracious leaves, is protected from the sun's rays.
Jonah wishes he had such a lodge in his own country.
God prepared a worm, that made the woodbine wither.
Jonah awakes and finds his woodbine destroyed.
The leaves were all faded.
The sun beat upon the head of Jonah.
He is exceedingly angry, and prays God that he may die.
God rebukes the prophet.
"Dost thou well," He says, "to be angry for the gourd?"
Jonah replies, "I would I were dead."
God asks if it is to be wondered at that He should help His handy work.
Is not Jonah angry that his woodbine is destroyed, which cost him no labour?
God is not to be blamed for taking pity upon people that He made.
Should He destroy Nineveh the sorrow of such a sweet place would sink to His heart.
In the city there are little bairns who have done no wrong.
And there are others who cannot discern between their right hand and their left hand.
There are also dumb beasts in the city incapable of sinning.

Judgment must be tempered with mercy.

He that is too hasty to rend his clothes must afterwards sit with worse ones to sew them together.

Poverty and pain must be endured.

Patience is a noble point, though it displeases oft.

Text and Layout

The text is intended to replicate the layout of the printed book as closely as possible.

Headnotes, printed at the top of each page, have been moved to the most appropriate sentence break. Some shorter headnote pairs may be merged into one. **Sidenotes** giving plot summary are placed close to their original location.

The **Notes** were originally printed as a short (12 pages) section before the Glossarial Index. For this e-text they have been distributed among their respective texts. Links to the Notes are intended to be visible but not distracting.

Text-Critical Notes such as variant readings have been handled differently than in the printed book, where they appeared either as footnotes (numbered) or sidenotes (sometimes but not always marked). Here, the word they refer to is underlined if necessary, and the note itself will generally have this form:

leak] the *t* of the MS. has a *k* over it.

Where a single word has both an endnote and a marginal note, the link to the endnote is shown.

A. An unusual typographical error, shown with beginnings of adjoining lines:

the Saxon forms
thennes), etct The
in-myddde (amidst),

[Back to Top](#)
[Preface](#)
[The Pearl](#) (separate file)
[Cleanness](#) (separate file)
[Patience](#) (separate file)
[Glossarial Index](#) (separate file)
[Sidenotes](#)